DOMINIONS 6 RESEARCH PROJECT

The Dominions 6 Knowledge Library

Reader's guide and Foundation Books I-XIV: rulesets, turn resolution, economy, statecraft, Pretenders, dominion, blessings, armies, battle, magic, strategy, nations, modding, AI scaffolds, maps, scenarios, and the Dominions Enhanced/Divinitus technical encyclopaedia; plus the practical operations, interface, setup, orders, and hosting manual; plus the systematic unit-class, ability, experience, heroic-ability, and condition reference; plus the versioned base-game object reference for spells, items, summons, Pretenders, Thrones, sites, mercenaries, independents, and special dominions; plus the complete official 6.01-6.36 version history and 1,090-record patch ledger; plus the searchable command and terminology lexicon covering 1,609 official-manual tokens, 97 controlled aliases, and all 226 command-like patch tokens

Progress Edition 24
25 August 2026

Linked reader's edition: beginner-readable, expert-useful, source-verifiable, and prepared for website publication.

Contents

This reader-facing edition begins with a concordance, linked learning paths, and a research-priority register. It then presents the complete 63-step hosting model, a turn-and-economy quick reference, the economy-and-state foundation with the Edition 23 rounding map, upkeep-display boundaries, unrest candidates, fort-supply evidence gate, and starvation-state audit, the full Pretender, dominion, scales, and blessings foundation with the source-traced awakening-evidence boundary, reconciled Call God model, and same-turn Throne state matrix, and the armies-and-battle, magic, and strategy foundations; the first complete nation dossier; and the modding-and-scenario foundation. Book VIII covers source architecture, objects, events, diplomacy reactions, AI scaffolds, maps, compatibility, and release testing. Book IX inventories Dominions Enhanced 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE from the supplied source files, separating explicit definitions, official engine rules, combined-load-order deductions, and unresolved runtime questions. It includes the complete DE global and blessing layers, Divinitus event architecture, cross-mod identity analysis, and a practical verification register. Edition 24 applies one direct, practical house style across the complete reader corpus while preserving the exact evidence, tables, formulas, citations, and research boundaries. Repeated internal baselines, source inventories, formulas, and essays have been consolidated under one authoritative chapter each. Book X then supplies the player-facing operating layer: game creation, joining and hosting, interface controls, recruitment and army workflow, strategic orders, a guided first campaign, troubleshooting, and campaign administration. Book XI adds the retrieval layer for unit classes, movement and command tags, defensive and offensive abilities, experience, the Hall of Fame, heroic traits, lasting conditions, counters, and current patch corrections. Book XII adds the versioned object-reference method and a 4,196-record website data layer covering spells, items, summon relations, Pretender forms, Thrones, sites, mercenary companies, independent-coverage status, and special dominion systems without duplicating the strategic teaching in Books II-VI. Book XIII adds the official version spine: all 32 public update announcements and 1,090 change records from 6.01 through 6.36, with a release chronology, source hashes, editorial classifications, canonical maintenance links, a stale-guide repair method, and a command chronology. Book XIV supplies the retrieval and reconciliation layer for command terminology: 1,609 distinct tokens from the official modding, event, and map manuals; 97 controlled aliases; all 226 patch-note tokens reconciled, including five official 6.36 patch-only commands; context-sensitive command domains; syntax and source locators; documentation-status distinctions; and explicit handling of manual-version drift and official spelling discrepancies. The project archive and evidence ledger remain separate from the published book.

DOCUMENT 1 OF 16

Reader's Guide and Concordance

The retrieval layer

The Knowledge Library is large enough that most players will not read it from front to back. Its fourteen books answer different questions, and one game situation can easily touch several of them. A failed battle might begin with an interface mistake or an economic shortage, then run through unit classes, scripting, fatigue, and conditions before becoming a wider campaign problem. A Pretender design might begin with scales, but its value can depend on the chosen form, research timing, mage recruitment, the patch that established the current rule, and the likely date of the first war.

This guide joins those subjects together without explaining them a second time. Every entry points to the chapter that owns the full rule or method, and definitions here stay short for that reason. If a summary appears to disagree with the linked chapter, the chapter takes priority.

The guide serves five purposes:

1. give a new player a controlled route through the library;
2. let an experienced player move directly from a live problem to the relevant rule;
3. provide an alphabetical concordance and expanded glossary;
4. define the content model used for website publication;
5. separate research that can be resolved from reliable sources from questions that still require engine evidence.

How the links behave

Every major heading now has a stable destination. The identifiers are shared by the PDF bookmarks, the website index, and the machine-readable export. A heading can move to a different page in a later edition without breaking a link, provided its subject and destination identifier remain the same.

The linked table of contents remains the complete structural map. The concordance is the practical one: it begins with the question at hand, not the order in which the books were written.

Part I: Reading Paths

Path A: The first complete game

This route supplies enough structure to play a full game without demanding mastery of every spell, special ability, or diplomatic edge case. The order is intentional: timing and economy come before Pretender theory because a design cannot be judged without knowing what a turn and a province can actually produce.

Stage	Read	What should be understood before moving on
1. Operate	Book X - ruleset and local continuity, creating the world, and the main interface	The correct game is installed, the essential screens are legible, and orders can be submitted safely.

Stage	Read	What should be understood before moving on
2. Ruleset	Book I - baseline and evidence	Which patch and mods govern the game, and how confirmed rules differ from doctrine or pending tests.
3. Turn	Book I - six-phase hosting model and the complete 63-step sequence	Orders are simultaneous when submitted but sequential when resolved.
4. Province	Book II - the economic model, income, and recruitment constraints	Gold, resources, Recruitment Points, infrastructure, and time are separate constraints.
5. Read a unit	Book XI - unit-reading method, unit classes, and ability register	Classes, leadership, movement, abilities, experience, and conditions are read as one current state.
6. Expansion army	Book IV - what a battle decides, unit roles, and orders and scripts	A unit card is not a plan; placement, leadership, morale, and target contact determine whether statistics are delivered.
7. Pretender	Book III - Pretender design as a national system, scales, and blessings	The design should solve national problems rather than maximize an isolated chassis.
8. Research	Book V - research as strategic planning and battlefield magic by function	Research is a response tree whose branches must be deliverable by actual mages and gems.
9. Campaign	Book VI - expansion and first contact, borders and infrastructure, and recovery	Winning a battle matters only if the result can be converted into position, forts, research, or victory.
10. Guided play	Book X - guided first campaign and turn audit	The foundation is translated into a repeatable opening, first contact, first war, siege, and post-game review.
11. Live reference	Turn and Economy Quick Reference, Book XI's master register, Book XII's object register, Book XIII's patch ledger, and Book XIV's command lexicon	Common timing, economy, unit-state, object, current-version, and official mod-language facts can be checked without reopening full chapters or treating an old guide as current.

The first pass can stop once the current question has been answered. Controlled tests, complete object inventories, and specialist essays can wait until they are actually needed.

Path B: The first multiplayer game

Single-player fundamentals still matter, but multiplayer adds hidden intentions, negotiated borders, reputation, timing attacks, and the possibility that an apparently efficient action creates a coalition.

1. Complete stages 1-8 of Path A.
2. Read joining and hosting and the submission protocol.
3. Read scouting, intelligence, and uncertainty.
4. Read raiding and counter-raiding.
5. Read timing attacks and power spikes.
6. Read diplomacy, treaties, and reputation.
7. Read Thrones, Cataclysm, and endgame conversion.
8. Use the campaign decision framework before committing to a major war.

The central multiplayer habit is to calculate political cost alongside material gain. Territory, globals, Thrones, visible research, border dominion, and repeated treaty behaviour all alter how other players price the threat.

Path C: Returning after a long break

This route is for a player who remembers the game but not the current version or the exact order of operations.

1. Read Book I's current baseline.
2. Review Book XIII's release spine and player-facing changes for the period missed.
3. Review Book X's current operational additions.
4. Review current-version corrections in battle, magic, and strategy.
5. Review Book XI's ability-facing patch notes and master register.
6. Use Book XII's versioned object layer for exact spell, item, summon, Pretender, Throne, site, mercenary, and special-dominion lookups.
7. Keep the hosting spine, provincial gold, recruitment gates, and siege calculation open during the first turns.
8. Revisit only the chapter belonging to the nation or mechanic currently being used.
9. If DE and Divinitus are enabled, read the frozen combined baseline before trusting an older build or guide.

Path D: Expert rules lookup

The expert route begins by finding the chapter that owns the answer.

Question	Primary destination	Secondary destination
Create or join a game	Book X - creating the world	Book X - joining and hosting
Interface or shortcut	Book X - main interface	Book X - current additions
Strategic order procedure	Book X - order reference	Underlying system in Books I-VI
Submit or administer turns	Book X - turn submission	Book X - hosting runbook
Operational failure	Book X - troubleshooting	Path E
Unit class or leadership requirement	Book XI - unit classes	Book IV - command and squads
Unfamiliar ability or icon	Book XI - master register	Book XI - unit-reading method
Experience or heroic ability	Book XI - experience	Book XI - Hall of Fame
Affliction or condition	Book XI - conditions	Book IV - affliction resolution
Exact spell or item record	Book XII - spells or items and artifacts	Book V - strategic magic
Summon or summoned-unit relation	Book XII - summons	Book V - summoning
Pretender form availability	Book XII - Pretender forms	Book III - national design system
Throne, site, mercenary, or special dominion record	Book XII - Thrones and sites, mercenaries and independents, or special dominions	Strategic interpretation in Books II, III, and VI
Official change by version or subject	Book XIII - official patch ledger	Current rule in the linked canonical book
Repair an old or undated guide	Book XIII - stale-guide repair	Book XIII - classification model
Command introduction or patch history	Book XIII - command chronology	Book XIV - patch reconciliation
Exact command syntax, context, or manual locator	Book XIV - command lexicon	Book VIII - object and parser method
Exact hosting order	Book I - complete hosting sequence	Field hosting spine
Income or fort economics	Book II - gold, income, and upkeep	Field provincial gold
Recruitment bottleneck	Book II - resources and recruitment	Field recruitment gates
Pretender design	Book III - national design system	Book VII - Pretender families in a dossier

Question	Primary destination	Secondary destination
Bless legality or activation	Book III - blessings	Book IX - exact DE blessing layer
Melee result	Book IV - melee resolution	Book IV - protection and damage
Rout or retreat	Book IV - morale, rout, and retreat	Book VI - army preservation
Battle spell arithmetic	Book IV - battlefield magic	Book V - spell package design
Research branch	Book V - research planning	Book VI - strategic response tree
Communion failure	Book V - communions	Book IV - fatigue
Ritual, dome, or global	Book V - rituals, domes, or globals	Book I - hosting timing
Campaign conversion	Book VI - campaign conduct	Book II - economic state
Nation analysis	Book VII - dossier method	Book VII - MA Arcoscephale pilot
Mod syntax or validation	Book XIV - syntax and lookup	Book VIII - parser model, testing, and release engineering
DE/Divinitus exact source fact	Book IX - technical encyclopaedia	Book IX - source inventory
Collision or load order	Book IX - collision matrix	Book VIII - compatibility engineering

Path E: Diagnosing a failed turn

When a turn fails, trace the causes in order instead of starting with the most frustrating result.

1. Confirm the ruleset. Check patch, mods, load order, map, age, and game settings against Book I's baseline rules.
2. Find the resolution step. Use the hosting sequence to identify when the expected action should have happened.
3. Check operation and legality. Use Book X's troubleshooting route, then confirm paths, gems, laboratory, movement route, commander status, recruitment capacity, target, and order.
4. Check the binding resource. Use Book II's constraint model for gold, resources, Recruitment Points, Commander Points, Holy Points, supplies, or infrastructure.
5. Check tactical delivery. Use Book IV's resolution order, scripting, fatigue, morale, and targeting chapters.
6. Check strategic conversion. Use Book VI's campaign decision framework to decide whether the result was a local loss, a recoverable exchange, or a campaign failure.
7. Check evidence status. If the exact behaviour is listed in the research register, preserve the report as evidence. Do not force a confident explanation where the current record does not support one.

Path F: Modding, source inspection, and website work

1. Read the object-and-parser model.
2. Read identifier allocation and collision safety.
3. Read Book XII's object identity, provenance, and hashing method.
4. Read Book XIII's command chronology and safe treatment of post-manual commands.
5. Use Book XIV's complete command locator, evidence ladder, and patch reconciliation before treating a token as complete syntax.
6. Choose the relevant object chapter in Books VIII, IX, or XII.
7. Apply compatibility engineering before combining releases.
8. Apply testing, validation, and release engineering.
9. Use the website schema described later in this guide rather than scraping prose into unversioned pages.

Part II: Navigation by Problem

Game operation and hosting

Problem	Start here	Continue here
The correct map, mod, or save directory is unclear	Ruleset, installation, and local continuity	Book VIII - user data and packaging
A new game needs reproducible settings	Creating the world	Host setup sheet
A lobby game cannot be joined	Official lobby workflow	Cannot find or join the game
The interface control or shortcut is unclear	The main interface	Current operational additions
A turn may not have been received	Turn submission and revision	A turn staled
Troops, items, or gems are in the wrong place	Recruitment, army setup, and inventories	Troubleshooting by symptom
A special strategic order is unclear	Strategic order reference	Linked mechanics in Books I-VI
A first full campaign needs structure	A guided first campaign	Path A
The host needs a fair administrative standard	Hosting as a competitive institution	Dispute handling

Units, abilities, experience, and conditions

Problem	Start here	Continue here
A unit's type is unclear	Unit classes and status tags	How classes overlap
An army cannot be assigned to its commander	Three leadership pools	Army compatibility audit
A movement icon appears to permit an unusual route	Movement, terrain, water, and position	Book VI - movement and logistics
An unfamiliar ability needs a quick definition	Master ability and condition register	How to read an ability
A counter is needed for a special defence or aura	Counter-construction matrix	Book IV - counter construction
Veteran value or star thresholds are unclear	Experience and veteran units	Official experience thresholds
A Hall-of-Fame formula is being treated as certain	What is officially established	Community-derived heroic families
An affliction, disease, curse, or horror mark needs treatment	Conditions and lasting state	Book IV - lasting loss

Base-game object lookup

Problem	Start here	Continue here
A spell's school, path, cost, or delivery type is unclear	Spell records	Book V - paths, schools, and access
A forge target, artifact, or barding record needs comparison	Item records	Book V - forging, items, and artifacts

Problem	Start here	Continue here
A ritual's summoned result is unclear	Summon relations	Book XII - shape graphs
A Pretender form needs to be filtered by age or nation	Pretender-form records	Book III - design audit
A Throne or magic site needs an exact identity	Thrones and sites	Book VI - endgame conversion
A mercenary company or independent option needs checking	Mercenaries and independent recruitment	Book VI - expansion
A nation's dominion changes the ordinary rules	Special dominion systems	Book III - dominion
A website record needs provenance or refresh instructions	Publication contract	Verification and maintenance

Version history and stale-guide repair

Problem	Start here	Continue here
An old guide conflicts with current play	Stale-guide repair workflow	Current rule in the linked canonical book
A change needs to be found by release	Complete release spine	Official patch ledger method
A patch category appears uncertain	Classification confidence	Open the linked official announcement
A mechanic has changed several times	Player-facing change survey	Search the JSON ledger by domain and named term
A mod command may postdate the manual	Command chronology	Book XIV - patch reconciliation
A patch token differs from the current manual	Controlled exceptions	Book XIV - evidence ladder
A command is listed but not fully explained	Documentation-status model	Book XIV - safe lookup workflow
A new release needs to be ingested	Safe feed update	Website uses

Economy and state

Problem	Start here	Continue here
Income is lower than expected	Income formula	Tax trace, unrest
A unit cannot be recruited	The binding constraint	Recruitment Points, resources, Commander and Holy Points
A fort appears inefficient	Infrastructure as delayed conversion	Fort resource draw, fort-now test
An army is starving	Supplies and supply usage	Strategic logistics
A siege is taking too long	Siege and fort control	Siege as a campaign clock, field calculation
Province Defence is being misused	Province Defence	PD as delay and information
Gem income feels disconnected from strategy	Sites, gems, and magical capital	Gem logistics

Pretenders, dominion, scales, and blessings

Problem	Start here	Continue here
A design has too many unrelated goals	The design in one model	Design audit
Awake, dormant, or imprisoned is unclear	Awakening, time, and the opening	Opening tests
Dominion is collapsing	Dominion and religious territory	Campaign dominion
Scale trade-offs are unclear	Scales	Economic consequences
A bless looks powerful but unaffordable	Blessings	Sacred capacity audit
The god has died	Pretender death and recall	Campaign recovery
DE changes invalidate a vanilla build	Book IX - global rules	Book IX - blessing revision

Armies and battle

Problem	Start here	Continue here
A strong unit underperformed	Reading a unit	Formation, fatigue, morale
Troops arrived in the wrong shape	Army organisation	Formations and contact
The script broke	Orders, scripts, and spellcasting AI	Battle-magic planning
Melee arithmetic is disputed	Melee resolution	Protection and damage
Missiles hit the wrong target	Missile combat	Formation and contact
The army routed while still large	Morale, fear, rout, and retreat	Army preservation
A thug or supercombatant seems invincible	Thugs and remote force	Damage families and counters
A battlefield spell produced a surprising result	Battlefield magic arithmetic	Magic package design

Magic

Problem	Start here	Continue here
Research feels aimless	Research as strategic planning	Research as a campaign response tree
A spell is known but cannot be delivered	Paths and access	Gems and logistics, boosters
Gems disappear too quickly	Gem spending	Reserve policy
A communion is killing its slaves	Communions	Fatigue
Remote magic is being intercepted or blocked	Domes and remote attacks	Ritual timing
A global is politically dangerous	Global enchantments	Timing attacks and deterrence
A booster chain does not reach the expected path	Forging, items, and artifacts	Booster reference
A level-nine plan is becoming a trap	Legendary magic	Victory conversion

Strategy and campaign

Problem	Start here	Continue here
Expansion results vary wildly	Expansion testing	Battle diagnosis
The border is too wide	Map structure and borders	Raiding fronts
Research is collapsing under invasion	Research under invasion	Recovery
Raids gain provinces but lose the war	Raiding and counter-raiding	Campaign conversion
A power spike is visible too early	Timing attacks and deterrence	Information denial
A treaty is ambiguous	Diplomacy and treaties	Diplomacy records
A Throne opportunity may end the game	Throne arithmetic	Throne-rush sequence
The army won but the campaign stalled	Victory conversion	Economic conversion

Nations, mods, and combined rulesets

Problem	Start here	Continue here
A nation guide lists strengths but gives no method	Nation dossier method	Evidence architecture
Mage randoms are being described as guaranteed access	Probability method	Mystic worked example
A mod object behaves unlike its visible card	Object and parser model	Copy and selection semantics
Two mods claim the same ID	Compatibility engineering	DE/Divinitus collision matrix
An event chain has become unreliable	Event modding as a state machine	Divinitus event architecture
The AI needs scenario guidance	AI scaffolding	Behavioural sampling
A map changes strategic balance	Maps and scenario design	Map structure and borders
A public guide may be using the wrong mod version	Frozen baseline	Versioned knowledge essay

Part III: Alphabetical Subject Concordance

The concordance lists the best first destination, not every occurrence. Related chapters are included where a subject has a separate mechanical, strategic, or modding treatment.

A

- Abilities: Book XI - master ability and condition register; combat resolution is in Book IV.
- Accuracy and spell deviation: Book IV - battlefield spell accuracy.
- Administration: Book II - infrastructure and administration; see also fort resource draw.
- Afflictions: Book XI - conditions and lasting state; exact battle resolution and healing are in Book IV.
- Ages: Book I - eras and national identity.
- AI scaffolds: Book VIII - AI scaffolding without false claims.
- Alchemy: Book V - alchemy.

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Part IV: Expanded Glossary

This glossary is an orientation layer. Each primary link leads to the fuller rules treatment.

Term	Working definition	Primary anchor	Related anchors
Administration	A fort percentage used in income and adjacent resource draw calculations.	b2-part-vi-infrastructure-and-administration	b2-fort-resource-draw; field-base-and-final-income
Affliction	A persistent injury or impairment usually gained through damage, age, disease, or special effects.	b11-61-afflictions	b4-part-xiii-afflictions-regeneration-and-lasting-loss; b11-37-recuperation-and-healers
Army	A convenient name for commanders and assigned troops operating together; not always one indivisible rules object.	b1-army	b4-part-iii-commanders-squads-leadership-and-army-organisation
Army rout	The battle-wide morale collapse that can force remaining units to retreat even when individual squads have not already routed.	b4-army-rout	b4-part-xi-morale-fear-rout-and-retreat
Artifact	A unique magic item that only one copy can normally exist at a time.	b12-22-artifacts-as-a-world-state-race	b5-artifacts; b5-artifact-races

Term	Working definition	Primary anchor	Related anchors
Ascension Point	A victory point supplied by a claimed Throne of Ascension.	b6-throne-arithmetic	b1-throne-of-ascension
Assassin	A commander or effect that initiates a restricted battle against a target commander.	b6-part-ix-thugs-supercombatants-assassins-and-remote-force	b1-assassinations-resolve-before-conventional-movement
Automatic ID	An object identity assigned by the loader when a mod creates an object without a fixed numeric ID.	b8-automatic-allocation	b9-19-4-automatic-id-collision-risk
Awakening	The process and timing by which a dormant or imprisoned Pretender becomes active.	b3-part-iii-awakening-time-and-the-opening	b3-awakening-points
Battle group	A force that enters and resolves one tactical battle together; several forces in a province may not always form one group.	b4-battle-groups	b1-retreats-belong-to-battle-groups
Battle magic	Spells cast during tactical battle under scripting, range, targeting, gem, fatigue, and AI constraints.	b4-part-xiv-battlefield-magic	b5-part-vi-battlefield-magic-by-function
Bless	The collection of effects granted to a blessed sacred unit or commander.	b3-part-vi-blessings	b9-8-de-blessing-revision
Blood slave	A Blood-magic resource with unit-like and logistical properties distinct from ordinary gems.	b5-blood-slaves	b2-blood-hunting
Bodyguard	A unit assigned to protect a commander in an assassination battle, subject to bodyguard limits and arrival rules.	b11-28-bodyguards-and-warning	b6-assassination-defence
Booster	An item, spell, shape, site, or effect that increases effective magic-path access.	b5-booster-reference	b5-hidden-and-indirect-access
Breakpoint	A research level or access threshold at which a usable strategic or battlefield package becomes available.	b5-research-breakpoints	b6-part-v-research-as-a-strategic-response-tree
Call God	The priestly process used to return a dead Pretender, governed by rules distinct from ordinary resurrection.	b3-call-god	b3-part-vii-pretender-death-recall-and-divine-continuity
Capital-only	A restriction tying recruitment or another feature to a nation's original capital.	b1-capital-only	b2-recruitment-restrictions
Cataclysm	An endgame mechanism that increases late-game pressure and horror activity under relevant game settings.	b6-cataclysm	b6-part-xii-thrones-cataclysm-and-endgame-conversion
Chassis	The Pretender's physical form, including cost, paths, slots, statistics, movement, and special abilities.	b3-chassis-roles	b3-part-ii-chassis-paths-and-design-capabilities; b12-pretenders
Collision	A conflict in which mods claim or alter the same identifier, code, variable, name reference, or dependent object incompatibly.	b8-part-xi-compatibility-engineering	b9-19-combined-load-order-and-collision-matrix

Term	Working definition	Primary anchor	Related anchors
Command	A single-hash instruction whose practical meaning depends on its object language, arguments, selector state, and manual context.	b14-syntax	b14-context; b8-part-i-the-object-and-parser-model
Command template	An official grammar such as `(terrain)` or a numeric range that generates literal command spellings under stated restrictions.	b14-syntax	b14-complete-locator
Commander	A unit that can receive strategic orders and may lead troops, cast spells, preach, patrol, build, or perform other commander actions.	b1-commander	b4-part-iii-commanders-squads-leadership-and-army-organisation
Commander Point	A local recruitment capacity used by commanders, separate from gold, resources, and ordinary Recruitment Points.	b2-commander-points-and-holy-points	field-commander-points
Condition	A temporary or persistent unit state that changes action, statistics, targeting, recovery, loyalty, or future risk.	b11-60-conditions-are-state-not-flavour-text	b11-part-xi-conditions-and-lasting-state
Documentation status	The evidence class distinguishing a full official definition, reference-only entry, prose mention, derived template alias, or patch reconciliation.	b14-evidence	b1-evidence-standard; b13-classification-model
Communion	A battlefield magical network in which masters gain paths while slaves receive distributed fatigue and certain master-cast personal effects.	b5-part-vii-communions-sabbaths-choruses-and-grand-communions	b5-designing-a-safe-communion
Counter	A capability that attacks a necessary layer of an enemy plan rather than merely naming a theoretically favourable unit or spell.	b4-part-xv-counter-construction-and-battle-analysis	b6-counter-portfolios
Critical hit	A fatigue-influenced combat result that can reduce the protection applied against damage.	b4-critical-hits	b4-part-ix-protection-damage-and-survival
Dominion	A Pretender's religious territorial influence, carrying scales and interacting with gods, provinces, units, events, and elimination.	b3-part-iv-dominion-and-religious-territory	b6-dominion-as-campaign-pressure
Dome	A province-centred magical defence that may intercept or interfere with remote spells and attacks.	b5-part-ix-domes-remote-attacks-and-magic-movement	b5-layered-domes
DRN	The open-ended Dominions Random Number roll used in many opposed checks and damage calculations.	b4-the-open-ended-random-roll	b1-randomness-and-the-dominions-random-number
Event	A hosting-time occurrence selected from conditions, rarity, state, targets, codes, variables, and effects.	b1-event	b8-part-vii-event-modding-as-a-state-machine
Event code	An identifier used to coordinate, restrict, or connect event logic; collisions can corrupt chains across mods.	b8-codes-and-variables	b9-19-combined-load-order-and-collision-matrix

Term	Working definition	Primary anchor	Related anchors
Event variable	Stored event state used by modded event systems to remember counters, flags, or progression.	b8-codes-and-variables	b8-event-chains
Experience	Unit-specific development gained over time and through battle, producing star bonuses at defined thresholds.	b11-54-experience-thresholds	b11-56-veteran-preservation
Expansion party	A commander and troop package intended to capture independent provinces at an acceptable cost and tempo.	b6-expansion-party-roles	b6-expansion-testing
Fatigue	An accumulating combat burden that reduces performance, increases vulnerability to critical hits, and can cause unconsciousness.	b4-part-x-fatigue-recovery-and-collapse	b4-fatigue-as-offence
Fear	An effect that pressures enemy morale and can accelerate rout without directly killing every target.	b4-fear	b4-part-xi-morale-fear-rout-and-retreat
Fort	A fortified location that changes recruitment, administration, resource draw, supply, ownership, siege, and retreat behaviour.	b2-part-vi-infrastructure-and-administration	b2-part-viii-siege-and-fort-control
Formation	A squad arrangement that changes density, frontage, contact time, exposure, and movement through the battlefield.	b4-part-v-formations-placement-and-contact	b4-formation-fighter
Gem	A magical resource associated with a non-Blood path and used for rituals, forging, empowerment, and some battle spells.	b1-gem	b5-part-iv-gems-slaves-and-magical-logistics
Global enchantment	A persistent ritual effect with broad world impact and political consequences.	b5-part-x-global-enchantments-and-dispel-wars	b1-global-enchantment
Grand Communion	A special strategic or large-scale communion system with rules distinct from an ordinary battlefield communion.	b5-grand-communions-are-different	b5-part-vii-communions-sabbaths-choruses-and-grand-communions
Harassment	A melee pressure mechanic in which repeated attackers can degrade a defender's effective defence.	b4-harassment	b4-part-vii-melee-resolution
Holy Point	A local recruitment capacity used by some sacred or holy commanders and units.	b2-commander-points-and-holy-points	field-holy-points
Heroic ability	A growing special trait received by an eligible non-Pretender commander while in the Hall of Fame.	b11-57-what-is-officially-established	b11-58-community-derived-heroic-families
Horror Mark	A persistent, stackable hidden mark that creates a monthly risk of a horror attack and makes the bearer a preferred target.	b11-63-curse-and-horror-mark	b11-42-damage-reversal-blood-vengeance-curses-and-horror-marks
Host	To resolve submitted turns; also the computer or service performing that resolution.	b1-host	b1-the-complete-63-step-hosting-sequence

Term	Working definition	Primary anchor	Related anchors
Incarnate	A blessing condition generally requiring the Pretender to be active for the marked effect to function.	b3-incarnate-effects	b3-how-blessings-work
Inspector	A structured data viewer used to inspect game or mod objects; its version and load order determine what it can prove.	b12-part-i-the-object-reference-method	b9-24-website-and-inspector-schema; b12-maintenance
Laboratory	Infrastructure required for research and most rituals and forging; construction finishes too late for earlier same-turn uses.	b2-laboratories	b1-building-construction
Leadership	Commander capacity and type governing troop assignment, morale effects, and special troop compatibility.	b11-24-three-leadership-pools	b4-special-leadership
Load order	The order in which enabled mods are applied, determining which later definitions overwrite or extend earlier ones.	b8-load-order	b9-19-combined-load-order-and-collision-matrix
Mage-turn	One mage's opportunity to research, forge, cast, move, search, patrol, or perform another mutually exclusive order.	b5-mage-turn-opportunity-cost	b2-gem-income-and-mage-turn-economy
Mercenary company	A named, time-limited force bid for during hosting, represented by a commander, troops, price, availability, and continuity fields.	b12-44-mercenary-company-records	b2-mercenaries
Magic phase	Community shorthand for the early hosting steps containing rituals, magical movement, remote attacks, and associated battles.	b1-magic-phase	b1-phase-ii-magic-and-special-threats
Magic Being	A unit class requiring magic leadership unless an overlapping undead or demon tag makes undead leadership take precedence.	b11-11-magic-being	b11-8-classes-can-overlap
Magic Resistance	A defence statistic used in opposed checks against many spells and supernatural effects.	b4-magic-resistance-contests	b4-penetration
Message substitution	A case-sensitive double-hash token inserted inside supported event or enchantment text rather than issued as a mod command.	b14-syntax	b8-messages-can-carry-required-object-names
Mindless	A leadership and morale category with special command, routing, and survival behaviour.	b11-12-mindless	b4-mindless-troops
Mod	A loaded modification, usually defined through `.dm` commands, that can add or alter data within engine-defined limits.	b1-mod	b8-part-i-the-object-and-parser-model
Movement phase	Community shorthand for the hosting steps resolving friendly movement, other movement, movement battles, and storming.	b1-movement-phase	b1-movement-and-conquest
NAP	A non-aggression pact whose exact meaning depends on explicit player convention unless the game setting makes it binding.	b6-non-aggression-pacts	b6-binding-diplomacy

Term	Working definition	Primary anchor	Related anchors
Object ID	A numeric or automatic identity used by the engine, data layer, or mod loader to distinguish and reference an object.	b12-1-an-object-is-an-identity-not-merely-a-name	b8-part-ii-identifiers-allocation-and-collision-safety; b8-object-lifecycle
Patch record	One source-linked entry representing an official update bullet together with derived classification, domains, commands, canonical destinations, and stable hashes.	b13-11-one-official-bullet-becomes-one-patch-record	b13-classification-model; b13-domain-map
Path	A level of magical skill in Fire, Air, Water, Earth, Astral, Death, Nature, Glamour, Blood, or Holy.	b1-path	b5-part-ii-paths-schools-and-access
Penetration	A bonus applied to the attacking side of relevant Magic Resistance contests.	b4-penetration	b4-magic-resistance-contests
Pillage	A strategic order that converts population and order into immediate damage, unrest, and sometimes resources or gold.	b2-pillaging-and-raiding	b6-pillage-as-a-campaign-tool
Plane	A distinct strategic map layer such as the surface, caves, or another connected world.	b1-plane	b8-gates-and-multiple-planes
Population	A province value influencing income, supplies, recruitment capacity, events, and the effects of pillaging or Blood Hunting.	b2-population	b2-part-vii-population-unrest-pillage-patrol-and-blood-hunting
Pretender	The designed god of a nation or team, providing dominion, scales, blessings, paths, and a physical chassis.	b1-pretender	b3-part-i-pretender-design-as-a-national-system; b12-pretenders
Province Defence	Locally purchased automatic defence that appears when a province is attacked and cannot move as a normal army.	b2-part-ix-province-defence	b6-province-defence-as-delay-and-information
Recruitment Point	A local capacity that limits ordinary troop recruitment independently of gold and resources.	b2-recruitment-points	field-recruitment-points
Regeneration	Exact-percentage recovery of hit points during battle, with body-class, affliction, and damage-tempo interactions.	b11-35-regeneration-families	b4-regeneration
Remote attack	A ritual or effect that attacks a distant province or commander without conventional movement.	b5-part-ix-domes-remote-attacks-and-magic-movement	b1-remote-attacks-and-magic-battles
Repel	A weapon-length interaction allowing a defender to threaten or deter an incoming shorter-reach melee attack.	b4-repel	b4-part-vii-melee-resolution
Research point	A contribution toward progress in a school; research resolves very early during hosting.	b1-research-point	b5-the-research-formula
Ritual	A strategic spell cast outside tactical battle.	b1-ritual	b5-part-viii-rituals-and-strategic-magic
Rout	A unit or squad state in which it attempts to leave battle because morale has failed.	b1-rout	b4-part-xi-morale-fear-rout-and-retreat

Term	Working definition	Primary anchor	Related anchors
Sacred	A unit eligible to receive a blessing and often affected by special recruitment or upkeep rules.	b1-sacred	b3-sacred-capacity
Scale	One value in the dominion pairs governing Order, Production, temperature, Growth, Fortune, and Magic.	b1-scale	b3-part-v-scales
School	A research category that unlocks spells at successive levels.	b5-research-schools	b5-part-iii-research-as-strategic-planning
Siege strength	The attacking contribution used against a fort's walls during siege resolution.	field-siege-calculation	b2-part-viii-siege-and-fort-control
Site	A province feature that can provide gems, gold, recruitment, discounts, rituals, unrest, disease, or other effects.	b12-part-vi-thrones-and-magic-sites	b1-site; b2-part-x-sites-gems-and-magical-capital
Size point	A unit of battlefield-square occupancy used by unit size and formation density.	b1-size-point	b4-square-capacity
Special dominion	A national or Pretender rule that changes what dominion does beyond ordinary candle and scale effects.	b12-part-viii-special-dominion-systems	b3-special-dominions; b3-test-p11-special-dominions
Spell fatigue	Fatigue generated by spellcasting after spell cost, caster skill, gems, and other modifiers.	b4-spell-fatigue	b5-fatigue-and-overcasting
Squad	A tactical troop group assigned to a commander and given one formation and order set.	b1-squad	b4-squads
Starvation	The post-battle condition caused by insufficient supplies, producing disease, morale, and attritional consequences.	b2-starvation	b1-starvation-is-late
Stealth	The ability to move or remain hidden in hostile territory, opposed by patrol and detection effects.	b6-patrol-and-stealth	b1-sneaking-discovery-can-cause-a-late-battle
Summon relation	A versioned link from a summoning spell to the unit, unit group, or selection rule that produces its result.	b12-24-a-summon-record-is-a-relationship	b5-summoning
Supply	Provincial and army logistical capacity used to feed units and modified by terrain, forts, dominion, seasons, and abilities.	b2-part-v-supplies-logistics-and-starvation	b6-part-vi-logistics-supply-and-operational-reach
Taskmaster	A leadership ability that manages slave units and changes their morale handling.	b11-26-taskmaster-beast-master-and-special-followers	b4-taskmasters
Tempo	The rate at which a position turns present resources and opportunities into initiative before opponents can answer.	b6-tempo	b6-initiative
Throne of Ascension	A claimable special site providing Ascension Points and other effects toward the configured victory condition.	b12-36-thrones-are-sites-with-victory-meaning	b1-throne-of-ascension; b6-part-xii-thrones-cataclysm-and-endgame-conversion

Term	Working definition	Primary anchor	Related anchors
Thug	A relatively cheap, equipped commander designed for a bounded independent combat or raiding role.	b6-part-ix-thugs-supercombatants-assassins-and-remote-force	b6-thug-roles
Trample	A size-based attack produced by moving through smaller units, with displacement, damage, and fatigue consequences.	b11-45-trample	b4-trampling
Unit class	One of several overlapping type tags that can determine leadership, targeting, supplies, healing, morale, immunity, or movement.	b11-8-classes-can-overlap	b11-part-ii-unit-classes-and-status-tags
Unrest	A province condition that reduces income and administration and interacts with recruitment, events, patrol, pillage, and Blood Hunting.	b1-unrest	b2-part-vii-population-unrest-pillage-patrol-and-blood-hunting
Upkeep	The recurring gold cost of maintaining units and commanders, paid after income during hosting.	b1-upkeep	b2-upkeep
Version delta	An official or verified change between two named ruleset versions, kept separate from the current rule it modifies.	b13-3-patch-notes-are-deltas-not-replacement-manuals	b13-release-timeline; b13-stale-guide-repair
Wall integrity	The remaining defensive strength of a fort during siege, reduced by besiegers and restored by defenders.	b2-part-viii-siege-and-fort-control	field-siege-calculation
Wish	A high-level Astral spell offering a defined but partly version-sensitive set of requested outcomes.	b5-wish	b5-test-18-wish
Zone of control	A battlefield movement constraint created by nearby hostile units.	b4-zones-of-control	b4-part-v-formations-placement-and-contact

Part V: Website Publication Model

The unit of publication

The website should not treat an entire book as one page or every paragraph as an independent fact. The practical unit is a section containing ordered blocks. A section belongs to one versioned ruleset, has one stable destination, and can contain prose, tables, formulas, examples, checklists, claims, and source references.

The hierarchy is:

```
library
book or guide
part
section
content blocks
claims
evidence and sources
```

Each claim can be updated without silently changing the status of the surrounding advice. A strategic recommendation can sit beside an official formula while remaining a different kind of knowledge.

Required metadata

Every publishable section should carry:

- stable ID and URL slug;
- title, short title, and parent;
- book, part, and display order;
- ruleset and exact version scope;
- evidence status;
- source references and access dates;
- topic tags and audience level;
- related sections;
- unresolved-question IDs where applicable;
- last verified and last edited dates;
- replacement or deprecation links when a section moves.

The machine-readable schema makes these fields explicit. Empty fields remain visible during validation rather than being silently discarded.

Structured object records

Book XII adds a second publication unit for facts that are too numerous for readable prose: the object record. The 6.35 register contains 4,196 versioned records across spells, items, summon relations, Pretender forms, Thrones, other sites, mercenary companies, independent-coverage status, and special dominion systems. Each record carries a stable identity, category, ruleset, evidence status, provenance, record hash, source fields, editorial tags, and a canonical Book XII section.

The object register does not compete with the main explanations. Books II-VI still own economic, religious, magical, and strategic interpretation. Object pages expose exact fields and link to those chapters; the chapters use selected examples and link back to the records. Independent population types and unresolved selection-based summons remain visibly incomplete instead of being filled from obsolete data.

Structured patch records

Book XIII adds a third publication unit: the patch record. The 6.36 ledger contains 1,090 records covering all 32 official public update announcements from 6.01 onward. Each record carries release and source identity, official section and bullet locator, source hash, derived change class and confidence, affected domains, commands and named terms, canonical destinations, and a record hash.

The patch record establishes chronology and maintenance impact. It does not replace the official announcement or the current-rule chapter. Source identity is official; classification, materiality, domain routing, and summaries are editorial. The 250 review-recommended classifications remain searchable while their lower interpretive confidence is visible.

Structured command records

Book XIV adds a fourth publication unit: the command record. The 6.36 lexicon contains 1,609 distinct hash tokens found in the current official Modding, Event Modding, and Map Making manuals. Each record preserves spelling, token kind, documentation status, domains, manual versions and pages, syntax locators, patch relations, cautions, canonical destinations, and a record hash. The same data layer also supplies 97 controlled aliases for official terrain and numeric templates and reconciles all 226 patch-note tokens without silently rewriting historical wording. Five commands introduced by 6.36 are marked official patch-only because the announcement does not supply their full syntax.

Command records are locators rather than copied manual prose. A defined record points to the full official explanation. Reference-only and mention-only records keep documentation gaps visible. Double-hash message substitutions remain a separate token kind, while patch family expressions and spelling discrepancies live in explicit reconciliation relations.

Content block types

The schema supports:

1. prose;
2. callout;
3. formula;
4. table;
5. ordered or unordered list;
6. worked example;
7. checklist;
8. quotation within copyright limits;
9. source note;
10. unresolved research question.

Formulas receive their own IDs, variables, units, rounding notes, evidence status, and worked examples. This prevents a formula from becoming an untraceable sentence copied across several web pages.

Version and ruleset behaviour

The website must never display an unqualified value when several rulesets are available. A page may compare unmodded Dominions 6, DE, Divinitus, and the frozen combined load order, but every value is attached to its own scope. Historical values remain accessible through version records rather than being overwritten without explanation.

Recommended default labels are:

- `dom6-6.36` for the live rules baseline;
- `dom6-6.35-data` for records pinned to the Inspector snapshot;
- `de-2.16`;
- `divinitus-1.15.3-de`;
- `de-2.16__divinitus-1.15.3-de` with DE loaded first;
- `historical` with the original version stated;
- `experimental` with project version and test harness.

Beginner and expert presentation

The same source section can support two interfaces:

- Guide view shows the explanation, a restrained number of examples, and the next useful section.
- Reference view foregrounds formulas, exact tables, evidence, version scope, exceptions, and related records.

These are views over the same content identity. Maintaining separate beginner and expert articles would recreate the duplication problem solved in Edition 11.

Search and filtering

At minimum, the website index should support:

- title and full-text search;
- book, topic, ruleset, evidence, and audience filters;
- exact-object lookup by category and numeric ID;
- patch lookup by version range, class, domain, command, named term, and canonical destination;
- command lookup by exact spelling, alias, domain, manual, page, documentation status, patch version, context collision, and token kind;
- unresolved-only and recently-verified views;
- reverse links showing every section that depends on a claim;
- aliases so terms such as `PD`, `Province Defence`, and `province defense` reach the same destination.

The generated content index already records every heading, parent, stable anchor, source file, website path, and source line number. It helps locate material, but it does not replace parsed claims.

Part VI: Prioritised Foundational Research Register

Scope of the active register

The active queue contains questions that can be advanced without asking the player to run bespoke tests. Acceptable routes are current official documentation, official patch records, supplied mod source, current structured data tied to a version, or a published reproduction with enough procedure and evidence to audit. Questions that still depend on undocumented engine behaviour remain visible in a blocked register but do not interrupt the next writing phase.

Priority means:

- P0 - integrity: a wrong answer can invalidate a ruleset, mod load, or large body of derived work;
- P1 - frequent play: the rule affects common economic, combat, magic, or campaign decisions;
- P2 - advanced play: the rule matters regularly to expert planning but less often to a new player;
- P3 - specialist: the rule chiefly affects unusual objects, mod engineering, or edge-case publication.

ID	Priority	Domain	Question	Why it matters	Reliable route	Primary anchor	Status
R-001	P0	Versioning	Which official rules and commands changed after the revision-2 manual and the 6.34, 6.29, and 6.26 auxiliary manuals?	Every later formula and mod claim depends on the correct current baseline.	Book XIII supplies the complete official patch side; Book XIV reconciles every patch token against the current auxiliary manuals.	b14-patch-reconciliation	completed
R-002	P0	Load order	What load order did the Divinitus 1.15.3 DE author intend in the public release wording?	A reversed order can change hundreds of shared objects.	Project description and version 1.15.0 changelog, audited in the independent integrity report.	b9-2-3-public-author-sources	completed
R-003	P0	Collision	What object and dependency chain does the monster 8616 conflict affect under the frozen stack?	The collision breaks the identity shared by DE's Ring, Amulet, and Blood Vial helpers and the Divinitus Crystal Priest.	Exact source trace, upstream accepted repair, and pinned Inspector resolution in the independent integrity report.	b9-20-4-independent-compatibility-publication	completed
R-004	P0	Automatic IDs	What IDs do the 69 automatic Divinitus monsters and 26 automatic spells receive in the frozen load order?	Stable website records and downstream references require versioned secondary identities.	Exact-version structured Inspector register in the independent integrity report; engine confirmation remains separately labelled pending.	b9-20-4-independent-compatibility-publication	completed
R-005	P0	Source integrity	Which commands in the supplied mods fall outside complete current auxiliary-manual definitions?	An unfamiliar command cannot be explained safely until documentation, parser recognition, annotation syntax, and likely errors are separated.	Static command inventory against current official manuals, patch notes, and the pinned parser in the independent integrity report.	b9-20-4-independent-compatibility-publication	completed
R-006	P1	Economy	What are the current unmodded Growth and Death income percentages?	Pretender and fort economics depend on the correct scale multiplier.	Modding Manual 6.34 defines `#deathincome` default 2; no official announcement through 6.36 changes it.	b2-growth-and-death-income	completed
R-007	P1	Economy	What are the current unmodded Order and Turmoil resource percentages?	Production planning and scale evaluation depend on the current value.	Revision-2 main-manual 2% rule checked against the complete official patch ledger through 6.36.	b2-order-and-turmoil-resources	completed
R-008	P1	Economy	At which steps does the engine round income, resources, Recruitment Points, and fort draw?	Close recruitment and fort calculations can change at integer boundaries.	The canonical section now separates six rounding subsystems and their operational displays; complete closure still requires published 6.36 boundary reproductions or developer-confirmed formulas.	b2-rounding-formula-display-and-treasury	queued
R-009	P1	Recruitment	What is the current Commander Point base and how do exceptional modifiers stack?	Commander bottlenecks can determine fort and mage efficiency.	Revision-2 fort bonuses, current 6.35 community base and accumulation reference, official `#slowrec` and `#rpcost` semantics, AI exclusions, and patch review through 6.36.	b2-commander-points	completed

ID	Priority	Domain	Question	Why it matters	Reliable route	Primary anchor	Status
R-010	P1	Upkeep	How are sacred slaves, mounted forms, and shapechanged units charged upkeep?	Persistent roster costs affect long-war sustainability.	The 6.33 observation and pinned 6.35 component fields resolve stacking and mounted decomposition; annual samples exclude a simple final floor, while shape classes and monthly aggregation remain open.	b2-upkeep	in-progress
R-011	P1	Unrest	Which current unrest thresholds reduce Recruitment Points and Commander Points?	A province can appear affordable while being unable to recruit the planned roster.	Official shutdown and current community reduction claims are preserved; the loss-floor reading now has explicit 1-, 2-, and 3-point candidate thresholds, still awaiting a versioned reproduction.	b2-unrest-effects	queued
R-012	P1	Supply	What is the exact fort-supply distance arithmetic under current rules?	Supply range determines operational reach and siege endurance.	Range, maximum distance, and highest-fort selection are separated from the official x6 versus x4 multiplier conflict; a published 6.36 distance series remains required.	b2-fort-supply-range	queued
R-013	P1	Starvation	Are commanders ever exempt from starvation, and which forms or abilities alter the result?	Commander survival affects retreats, sieges, and remote expeditions.	Need Not Eat, the 6.18 transformation correction, 6.35 object fields, and the 6.35 equipment-refresh fix resolve explicit immunity and display state; generic priority remains open.	b2-starvation	in-progress
R-014	P1	Pretenders	What is the current awakening-point distribution for dormant and imprisoned Pretenders?	Opening timing determines whether a design solves expansion or only a later war.	The June 2026 Dominions 6 page republishes Loggy's model, but source tracing reaches pre-Dominions 6 notes, no 6.x raw sample, and a one-turn range discrepancy. Current reproduction or developer confirmation is still required.	b3-test-p1-awakening-distribution	queued
R-015	P1	Dominion	What are the current checks and order for ordinary dominion spread?	Temple, priest, and candle investments depend on the actual spread model.	Revision-2 official formulas and turn sequence, reconciled with the 6.13 random-preaching correction and later patch history.	b3-sources-of-dominion-spread	completed
R-016	P1	Blessings	Which blessing tags, values, and activation edge cases differ from the revision-2 manual?	Small errors can invalidate a Pretender design or sacred package.	6.35 structured bless data plus official rules and patches through 6.36 establish activation gates, automatic blessing, repeatability, overlap, weapon-trigger, item, and mount boundaries; adjacent transformation and cross-source stacking remain separate questions.	b3-the-activation-state-machine	completed

ID	Priority	Domain	Question	Why it matters	Reliable route	Primary anchor	Status
R-017	P1	Pretender death	What are the current Call God thresholds and contribution rules?	Recovery planning after a god's death depends on time-to-return.	Official Holy, Disciple-game, Elegist, Recall God, Trinity, and hosting rules are reconciled with published controlled research establishing a fixed 50-point base and per-priest effective-rating `-1/0/+1` variation; detailed routing and placement remain Current Community Reference.	b3-r-017-decision	completed
R-018	P1	Victory	How are same-turn Throne claim, province loss, and victory checks ordered in current play?	The result can decide a game despite later movement or siege outcomes.	Official steps 8 and 57, full and partial ownership rules, the current conquest rule, and a published same-turn report establish the claimant-death, unfortified-conquest, siege, and fort-storm branches. Exact simultaneous winning-total ties remain separate.	b3-same-turn-claim-loss-and-victory	completed
R-019	P1	Combat	What is the exact current survivor bonus in morale checks?	Rout thresholds influence squad sizing, standards, and casualty tolerance.	Current official correction or published statistical reproduction.	b4-test-9-morale-survivor-bonus	queued
R-020	P1	Combat	How much fatigue do active units recover while conscious under ordinary conditions?	Fatigue breakpoints shape armour, melee endurance, and spell-support value.	Current official rule or frame-by-frame published reproduction.	b4-test-12-ordinary-fatigue-recovery	queued
R-021	P1	Combat	What is the exact harassment accumulation and decay model?	Defence collapse and swarm counters depend on more than the visible attack value.	Current official statement or published instrumented reproduction.	b4-test-2-harassment-decay	queued
R-022	P1	Combat	What are the complete current weapon cooldown and combat-speed constants?	Attack rate changes damage delivery, repel exposure, and fatigue pressure.	Current structured data and published timing reproduction.	b4-test-3-cooldown-and-combat-speed	queued
R-023	P1	Mounted combat	What are the full current mounted carry, targeting, and movement calculations?	Rider and mount statistics otherwise produce misleading army comparisons.	Official manual corrections and current structured data.	b4-test-7-mounted-targeting	queued
R-024	P1	Magic	What thresholds govern optional combat-gem use and refusal?	A scripted spell package can fail because the caster conserves a gem.	Official AI rule or published reproducible battle set.	b5-test-3-combat-gem-spending	queued
R-025	P1	Magic	Where does rounding occur in spell fatigue, penetration, communion sharing, forging, and ritual contests?	Boundary values can change caster safety and access ladders.	Published current reproductions separated by subsystem.	b5-part-xvi-controlled-test-programme	queued
R-026	P1	Communions	What current edge cases govern shared self-buffs, collapse, and automatic communion items?	Communion failure can destroy the most valuable mage concentration in an army.	Official corrections and published reproducible battle reports.	b5-communion-audit	queued
R-027	P1	Movement	What is the exact interception probability and battle location when hostile forces swap provinces?	Movement prediction determines reinforcement and retreat planning.	Current official rule or published map-and-save reproduction.	b6-movement-and-interception	queued

ID	Priority	Domain	Question	Why it matters	Reliable route	Primary anchor	Status
R-028	P1	Patrol	What are the current patrol-detection distributions across stealth and patrol modifiers?	Counter-raiding and scout survival depend on risk rather than a binary threshold.	Published current statistical reproduction.	b6-patrol-and-stealth	queued
R-029	P1	Raiding	What are the current Raid and pillage output functions?	Economic warfare cannot be compared honestly without expected return and population damage.	Current official documentation or published repeated outcomes.	b6-raid-order	queued
R-030	P1	Diplomacy	Which binding-NAP edge cases occur under every diplomacy setting?	Interface-enforced treaties must not be described through informal multiplayer custom.	Official setting documentation and published current reproduction.	b6-binding-diplomacy	queued
R-031	P1	Thrones	What are the complete current Throne identities and object effects?	Endgame plans require exact Ascension Points, defenders, and claimed bonuses.	Pinned 6.35 structured site data, cross-checked against current official rules.	b12-thrones-sites	completed
R-032	P2	Domes	In what order are layered domes checked, and are their outcomes independent?	Remote warfare portfolios depend on cumulative interception risk.	Published current controlled reproduction.	b5-layered-domes	queued
R-033	P2	Wish	What vocabulary, aliases, distributions, and restrictions does Wish currently accept?	Late-game plans can waste rare Astral access on obsolete or ambiguous requests.	Current official data or versioned published catalogue with reproduction.	b5-wish	queued
R-034	P2	Artifacts	How are simultaneous artifact forges and global casts resolved at exact ties?	Multiplayer races need a defensible risk model.	Official hosting rule or published simultaneous-order reproduction.	b5-test-16-artifact-race-and-yearning	queued
R-035	P2	Assassination	What are the exact bodyguard, Patience, surprise, and mounted-assassination distributions?	Commander survival packages depend on more than nominal bodyguard count.	Published current controlled reproduction.	b6-assassination-defence	queued
R-036	P2	Cataclysm	What is the final current Cataclysm outcome wording and horror interaction?	Endgame clocks and coalition decisions depend on the actual failure state.	Current official object data and patch notes.	b6-cataclysm	queued
R-037	P2	Event systems	In what order do several rarity-5 global state machines update the same state?	Large overhaul compatibility can fail without any numeric collision.	Author documentation or published deterministic harness.	b8-event-execution-and-order	queued
R-038	P2	Mod parser	Which cross-mod name-reference categories resolve before or after later definitions?	Name references can fail even when numeric IDs do not collide.	Official parser documentation or minimal published loader reproduction.	b8-cross-mod-reference-limits	queued
R-039	P2	Object inheritance	Which hidden copied attributes are absent from `ctrl+i` and ordinary inspector cards?	A visible final card may omit inherited behaviour needed for compatibility.	Exact-version source history plus structured engine export.	b8-copied-objects-are-not-self-contained	queued
R-040	P2	Transformations	Which prophet, mount, heroic, item, and temporary states survive combined transformations?	Shape chains can silently lose national or sacred roles.	Published current transformation matrix.	b8-shape-regression	queued
R-041	P3	Events	What are the current event-variable overflow and negative-value behaviours?	Long event campaigns can corrupt state near numeric boundaries.	Official limit documentation or minimal published harness.	b8-variable-discipline	queued

ID	Priority	Domain	Question	Why it matters	Reliable route	Primary anchor	Status
R-042	P3	Performance	How does hosting time scale with large always-event libraries?	Scenario design needs a practical performance budget.	Published hardware, turn, province, and event-count benchmark.	b8-performance-controls	queued
R-043	P3	AI	How often are AI templates selected and how reliably does the AI use multi-plane gates?	Scenario claims should distinguish configured hints from observed behaviour.	Published behavioural sample tied to version and map.	b8-ai-testing-is-behavioural-sampling	queued
R-044	P3	Save compatibility	Which inserted automatic spell and item objects break existing saves?	Release updates need a safe migration policy.	Published version-to-version save matrix.	b8-save-compatibility	queued
R-045	P3	Networking	Which filename and dependency mismatches are rejected or silently tolerated by the lobby?	Public mod releases need predictable multiplayer installation behaviour.	Official documentation or published clean-client matrix.	b8-network-and-lobby-test	queued
R-046	P0	Experience	Does a current five-star unit receive a cumulative +2 or +3 Hit Points from experience?	A public veteran calculator must not conceal the conflict between the official incremental table and current community reference.	Current 6.36 controlled unit or engine export.	b11-54-experience-thresholds	queued
R-047	P1	Heroic abilities	Which Hall-of-Fame scoring and heroic-growth formulas remain unchanged in 6.36?	Old reverse engineering is useful but cannot be represented as current official law.	Current reproducible tests or engine-backed reverse engineering.	b11-57-what-is-officially-established	queued
R-048	P1	Perception	How do current perception abilities divide Glamour, Invisibility, Unseen, Illusion, and Spiritform targets?	A false equivalence can invalidate targeting and counter design.	Current controlled matrix with one perception and concealment effect at a time.	b11-31-glamour-invisibility-unseen-and-illusion	queued
R-049	P1	Ability stacking	Which ability sources stack, use best-only, or replace one another across form, item, bless, and spell?	Duplicate investment can waste gems, design points, and scripts.	Targeted current tests plus live descriptions.	b11-6-stacking-precedence-and-the-best-only-rule	queued
R-050	P2	Experience	Which current passive XP exceptions apply to Mindless units, sites, items, arenas, and events?	Veteran timing and Hall-of-Fame plans depend on the actual gain sources.	Controlled monthly observation and current data export.	b11-53-how-experience-is-gained	queued
R-051	P2	Unit classes	Which condition immunities follow from a visible class and which require a separate hidden tag?	Visual or taxonomic assumptions can produce false counters.	Current object export plus controlled spell and condition matrix.	b11-8-classes-can-overlap	queued
R-052	P2	Mount state	How do mount loss, Reclaim Mount, automatic return, and shape changes transfer experience and conditions?	Mounted commanders can change body and function across the turn boundary.	Controlled mounted-commander series under 6.36.	b11-38-immortality-reformation-and-extra-lives	queued
R-053	P1	Independents	What are the complete 6.35 independent population types and their province recruitment rosters?	Expansion, fort placement, and off-path recruitment depend on exact independent access.	Exact-version engine or inspector export containing population-type membership.	b12-mercenaries-independents	queued
R-054	P2	Summons	Which unit identities satisfy the 25 unresolved selection- or tag-based summon relations?	A spell record is incomplete when it names a selector but not the possible summoned units.	Exact-version engine export or published reproducible selector resolution.	b12-summons	queued

ID	Priority	Domain	Question	Why it matters	Reliable route	Primary anchor	Status
R-055	P2	Object labels	What are the authoritative human labels for remaining source-native item and site property fields?	Public filters should be readable without pretending that an inferred label is official.	Current UI wording, official manuals, and exact-version object export compared field by field.	b12-maintenance	queued
R-056	P2	Patch classification	Which of the 250 review-recommended patch records need a different fine-grained class or more precise canonical destination?	Source completeness is settled, but accurate filters improve website maintenance and command chronology.	Human review of each official source bullet against the Book XIII classification key and canonical ownership map.	b13-editorial-review	in-progress
R-057	P2	Command documentation	Which of the 60 reference-only, nine mention-only, and five 6.36 patch-only tokens can receive verified semantics without inventing undocumented behaviour?	Search is complete, but a token's official existence is not always a complete behavioural contract.	Later official manuals or announcements, developer clarification, or a published minimal reproduction tied to an exact version and object context.	b14-evidence	queued

Blocked engine questions

The following subjects remain outside the active queue until a reliable reproduction, current inspector export, or local executable becomes available:

- unresolved same-turn effects whose official timing list does not define the internal branch;
- final cards produced by occupied-ID `#newmonster` behaviour without an engine export;
- undocumented target-selection weights with no published sample;
- all-AI strategic evaluation weights;
- nation-specific expansion ranges without a reproducible map and independent set;
- private multiplayer outcomes that cannot be independently checked.

These are not requests for the player to perform labour. They are publication limits.

Research order

R-001 is resolved by Books XIII and XIV. R-002 through R-005 are resolved by the independent DE-Divinitus integrity publication and are cross-linked through Book IX without absorbing that publication into the encyclopedia. R-006, R-007, R-009, R-015 through R-018 are resolved in Books II and III at their stated evidence tiers. R-010 and R-013 are in progress; R-008, R-011, R-012, and R-014 remain queued behind reliable reproduction or better structured evidence. Edition 23 supplies their narrow test predicates and safe operational fallbacks. Edition 24 changes the voice of the reader corpus but does not change those research statuses. The remaining items no longer block the website publication pass. Combat, magic, and campaign questions R-019 through R-030 follow when evidence is available; R-031 is resolved in the 6.35 object register. R-053 should be taken as soon as an exact population-type export becomes available, while R-054, R-055, and R-057 can advance alongside object and documentation maintenance.

Part VII: Maintenance Rules

Adding a section

When new material is written:

1. place it in the book that owns the subject;
2. reuse the existing heading destination if the subject is being revised;
3. add aliases to the website index rather than creating duplicate glossary entries;
4. attach ruleset, evidence, sources, and verification date;
5. link related sections without copying their formulas or tables;
6. add unresolved behaviour to the research register with a route and priority;
7. rebuild and validate the PDF and website exports together.

Moving or replacing a section

A moved section should keep its destination ID where possible. If the subject has genuinely split, the old ID should become a redirect to a short landing section that explains the new authoritative homes. Silent deletion would break PDF annotations, website links, saved bookmarks, and citations in future dossiers.

Preventing duplication from returning

Before adding a formula, table, full definition, or technical essay, search the content index by title, alias, and tag. If an authoritative version already exists, the new section should link to it and explain only the new context. Repetition is reserved for field references, worked applications, and deliberately self-contained print tools.

DOCUMENT 2 OF 16

Foundation Book I: Rulesets, Language, and the Anatomy of a Turn

Why this volume comes first

Most rules in Dominions 6 are manageable on their own. The difficulty comes from having hundreds of them interact during the same turn. A player may understand recruitment, movement, rituals, battles, dominion, and upkeep separately, then still misread a result because they resolved in an unexpected order.

Book I sets out the language and turn order used throughout the library. It works at three levels:

- New-player level: enough explanation to understand what an order does, when it happens, and why an apparent failure occurred.
- Experienced-player level: exact timing relationships, failure points, and strategic consequences.
- Research level: a versioned record of sources, interpretations, and unresolved edge cases.

Nation-specific builds are left for later books. The examples use ordinary commanders, troops, provinces, rituals, and forts so the same conclusions can be used in any age.

> Foundation rule: A strategy should never depend on an unexplained timing assumption. When a plan works only because one action resolves before another, that timing needs to be stated here.

How to read the library

There is no need to read the whole library before playing. The boxed rules, plain-language summaries, and checklists are enough to support a first campaign. The full chapters become useful when a turn behaves strangely, a multiplayer plan depends on exact timing, or a rule needs to be checked for publication. Source notes and unresolved tests sit alongside the rules so that doubtful points remain visible instead of becoming folklore.

Where each subject lives

Each rule has one main home. Later books may give a short reminder when the subject crosses into another system, but the full explanation should not be repeated.

Subject	Authoritative home
terminology, evidence labels, ruleset versions, and hosting order	Book I
order-writing formulas needed at a glance	Turn and Economy Quick Reference
provinces, income, recruitment, infrastructure, supply, PD, and siege economy	Book II
Pretenders, dominion, scales, blessings, and religious systems	Book III
formations, combat arithmetic, morale, fatigue, and battle resolution	Book IV
research, paths, gems, communions, rituals, items, and magical strategy	Book V

Subject	Authoritative home
expansion, intelligence, logistics, war, diplomacy, and victory conversion	Book VI
nation-dossier method and faction-specific application	Book VII onward
mod construction, events, AI scaffolding, maps, testing, and compatibility method	Book VIII
exact Dominions Enhanced and Divinitus definitions and combined-load-order findings	Book IX

The quick reference is the one deliberate exception. It repeats a small number of formulas and timing facts from Books I and II because its purpose is to remain open while orders are written. It should never become the source of a new rule.

The baseline used by this edition

Public unmodded baseline

The current public game release recorded by Illwinter on 25 August 2026 is Dominions 6.36, released on 17 August 2026 UTC. The principal rules source remains the Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2. The official documentation page presents that manual as the main reference for the rules and tables of the game.

The preserved manual is 449 PDF pages and has this fingerprint:

`65f430fd97c9f27285d63b797b43bc7fe3844241fdf40230b1d25a901ab9f33f`

The preserved Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34, is 65 PDF pages and has this fingerprint:

`5ac40698e05703f5628db123548c4e6a57fe0ed9bbcb65fb8f72fc589ab309ab`

The official Event Modding Manual, version 6.29, remains relevant for event timing, requirements, event chains, and mod-added monthly effects.

Frozen modded baseline

The working modded library uses:

1. `DomEnhanced2_16.dm` - Dominions Enhanced 2.16.
2. `Divinitus_1.15.3_DE.dm` - Divinitus 1.15.3 DE edition.

Dominions Enhanced is loaded first and Divinitus second.

Neither supplied file declares `#domversion`, so neither states a minimum compatible game version. Their source can be analysed exactly. Complete compatibility with Dominions 6.36 still needs to be tested and cannot be assumed.

Ruleset labels

Every future article must display one of the following labels.

Label	Meaning
Unmodded 6.36	The public base game as of 25 August 2026
DE 2.16	Dominions Enhanced 2.16 without Divinitus

Label	Meaning
Divinitus 1.15.3 DE	The supplied Divinitus DE file considered by itself
DE 2.16 + Divinitus 1.15.3 DE	The exact two-file ruleset in the recorded load order
Historical	Material retained from an older game or mod version
Experimental	A proposed mechanic, test mod, or result not yet part of a published ruleset

The label applies to the whole article unless a subsection explicitly overrides it.

Evidence and confidence

The five evidence labels

Label	Meaning	Suitable public wording
Official	Directly stated by Illwinter or visible in current in-game data	State as a rule and cite the source
Source-confirmed	Directly encoded in the exact relevant mod source	State as a rule for that mod version
Reproduced	Repeated in a documented controlled test	State with the tested setup and result
Community-tested	Supported by a detailed outside investigation but not yet reproduced here	Attribute and preserve the test conditions
Unverified	Plausible, incomplete, contradictory, historical, or unsupported	Present only as an open question or hypothesis

Evidence priority

The evidence ledger uses the following general hierarchy:

1. Current in-game result or exported current game data.
2. Current Illwinter manual or official change note.
3. Exact mod source for the named version and load order.
4. Reproducible controlled test.
5. Maintainer explanation.
6. Detailed community test or tournament account.
7. General guide, video, forum advice, or historical conversation.

The manual does not contain every rule. It is authoritative where it is explicit, while implementation details, targeting decisions, hidden limits, and unusual interactions may still need testing. If an official statement disagrees with repeatable current-game behaviour, both sides of the discrepancy must be recorded.

Fact, consequence, recommendation

Three different kinds of statement must not be blended together.

- Fact: the hosting sequence resolves recruitment at step 3.
- Consequence: recruited units exist before movement battles at step 26.
- Recommendation: recruiting emergency defenders may save a province that is attacked during the same hosting cycle.

The first statement is an official rule. The second is a direct timing consequence. The third is strategic advice whose value depends on gold, recruitment capacity, the attacking force, and whether the province can recruit an effective defence.

Citation standard

Every finished chapter should include:

- ruleset and version;
- last verified date;
- primary source;
- manual page or relevant source location;
- evidence label;
- mod-file hash where applicable;
- test record for reproduced claims;
- unresolved questions.

The public TheHoboKingdom edition can keep citations compact. The private research edition retains full fingerprints, links, source extracts, and test conditions.

Core notation

Magic paths

Symbol	Path
F	Fire
A	Air
W	Water
E	Earth
S	Astral
D	Death
N	Nature
G	Glamour
B	Blood
H	Holy or priest level

Path level follows the symbol. `S3` means Astral 3. `F2A1` means Fire 2 and Air 1. A requirement written as `S5E3` requires both Astral 5 and Earth 3 unless stated otherwise.

The letter `G` is reserved for Glamour. Gems are written in words or with their path, such as `15 fire gems` or `15F gems`, when the context cannot be mistaken for a path level.

Research schools

Short form	School
Conj	Conjuration
Alt	Alteration

Short form	School
Evo	Evocation
Const	Construction
Ench	Enchantment
Thaum	Thaumaturgy
Blood	Blood Magic
Divine	Divine spell list rather than an ordinary research school

`Alt 5` means Alteration level 5. `Thaum 9, S5E3` means a Thaumaturgy 9 spell requiring Astral 5 and Earth 3.

Common statistics

Symbol	Meaning
HP	Hit points
STR	Strength
ATT	Attack skill
DEF	Defence skill
PROT	Protection
MR	Magic Resistance
MOR	Morale
PREC	Precision
ENC	Encumbrance
AP	Armour-piercing
AN	Armour-negating
AoE	Area of effect
PD	Province Defence
RP	Research points or recruitment points; the full term must be written when ambiguous

Randomness

`DRN` means the Dominions Random Number roll. Dominions commonly uses an open-ended roll built from two six-sided dice, with more rolls after high results. The later mathematics material deals with the full probability system. Here, `attribute + DRN` means the visible attribute does not decide the final result by itself.

Chance statements must distinguish:

- a fixed percentage;
- a percentage per path or priest level;
- a percentage per dominion candle;
- a chance checked once per unit;
- a chance checked once per province;
- a chance checked once per turn;
- an open-ended opposed roll.

Time

Dominions commonly uses turn, month, and hosting for closely related ideas.

- A turn is the set of orders submitted by all players and the resulting game state.
- A month is the in-world time represented by one turn.
- Hosting is the process that resolves all submitted orders.
- A battle round is a tactical interval inside a battle and must not be confused with a strategic turn.

Spatial terms

- Province: a territory on the strategic map.
- Location: a distinct place within a province, such as the open province or the interior of a fortress.
- Adjacent: connected by a valid province border or other relevant link.
- Plane: a separate strategic layer such as the main world, cave plane, or Nexus/Void plane.
- Square: a tactical grid space on a battlefield.
- Size point: part of the capacity used by units occupying a battlefield square.

Essential glossary

Army

A group of commanders and their assigned troops. The word is convenient but not always a single rules object: different commanders in the same province may have different orders and may fail, move, or fight separately.

Battle magic

Spells cast during tactical combat. Battle magic is governed by scripting, fatigue, range, targeting, battlefield conditions, and the spellcasting AI.

Bless

The set of effects granted to blessed sacred units and commanders. Some bless effects are always available when the unit is blessed; Incarnate effects generally depend on the Pretender being active.

Capital-only

A recruitment or availability restriction tied to the nation's original capital. Conquering another nation's capital does not normally convert its capital-only roster into the conqueror's roster.

Commander

A unit capable of receiving strategic orders and leading troops. Leadership type and capacity determine which troops can be assigned and what morale effects may apply.

Communion

A magical network in which masters receive path bonuses and slaves absorb distributed spell fatigue and certain master-cast personal buffs. The exact mechanics belong in the magic volume.

Dominion

The religious influence of a Pretender, shown as candles in provinces. Dominion is both territorial pressure and a carrier for scales, bless conditions, Pretender hit-point modification, special national effects, and elimination.

Event

A hosting-time occurrence selected from event rules. Events may depend on scales, dominion, population, terrain, commanders, sites, orders, globals, variables, and many other conditions. Modded events can form chains and can imitate systems that the ordinary interface does not expose.

Fort

A fortified location within a province. A besieging force may control the province while the defender retains the fort, creating partial ownership.

Gem

A magical resource associated with Fire, Air, Water, Earth, Astral, Death, Nature, or Glamour. Blood slaves fill a similar strategic role for Blood magic but are units/resources with distinct rules.

Global enchantment

A ritual whose ongoing effect applies broadly to the world or to a large strategic system. Casting occurs during the ritual step, while the continuing world effect is processed later in the hosting sequence.

Host

As a verb, to resolve submitted turns. As a noun, the computer or service processing a multiplayer game.

Laboratory

The infrastructure required for research, most forging, and most ritual casting. A new laboratory is completed late in the turn, after that month's research and ritual steps have already passed.

Magic phase

Community shorthand for the early part of hosting in which rituals, magical movement, remote attacks, and resulting battles occur before ordinary movement. It is useful shorthand, but the official sequence divides it into several distinct steps.

Magic Resistance

A defence statistic used by many spells and supernatural effects. An MR check is not automatically a simple percentage; it may involve opposed DRN rolls, penetration bonuses, and path-based modifiers.

Mage

A commander with one or more magic paths or another ability that permits research, ritual casting, forging, or battle magic. Not every researcher is a conventional mage, and not every mage can perform every magical order.

Mod

A `.dm`-based modification loaded by the game. A mod can add or alter many data objects but cannot necessarily rewrite executable-level systems.

Movement phase

Community shorthand for the part of hosting in which conventional map movement resolves. The official sequence distinguishes friendly movement, other movement, movement battles, and castle storming.

Path

A level of magical skill in Fire, Air, Water, Earth, Astral, Death, Nature, Glamour, Blood, or Holy magic. Paths determine spell access, research value, item access, and many special interactions.

Pretender

The god designed for a nation or team. The Pretender supplies dominion, scales, bless design, magic access, and a physical chassis that may be awake, dormant, or imprisoned.

Province Defence

Locally purchased defence that appears automatically when a province is attacked. It is not a standing army that can move. Its composition and commander structure depend on the nation and investment.

Recruitment point

A local capacity used when recruiting units. It is distinct from gold and resources, and it can prevent recruitment even when the other costs are affordable.

Research point

A contribution toward a school of magical research. Research is processed very early during hosting, before assassinations and most forms of death.

Ritual

A strategic spell ordered outside battle. Rituals can summon units, alter provinces, move commanders, attack remotely, create globals, search, scry, or cause other world-map effects.

Rout

The state in which a unit or squad attempts to flee battle. Dominions battles are normally decided by morale collapse rather than the literal death of every unit.

Sacred

A unit capable of receiving a blessing and often subject to recruitment or upkeep advantages. Sacred does not mean permanently blessed; a blessing still needs to be active.

Scale

One side of the dominion-scale pairs: Order/Turmoil, Production/Sloth, Heat/Cold, Growth/Death, Fortune/Misfortune, and Magic/Drain. Scales affect the world through dominion and can also interact with units, events, sites, and spells.

Site

A magical or special feature located in a province. Sites may provide gems, gold, recruitment, unrest, disease, discounts, ritual access, or other effects. Some are hidden until found.

Squad

A tactical group assigned to a commander. Morale, formation, scripting, and leadership penalties are often evaluated at squad level rather than across the entire army.

Throne of Ascension

A special site that can be claimed by an appropriate priest. Claimed Thrones provide Ascension Points and may grant other effects. The game can end when the configured Ascension requirement is met.

Unrest

A province condition that reduces effective administration and income and interacts with events, recruitment, patrolling, pillaging, and Blood Hunting.

Upkeep

The recurring gold cost of maintaining units and commanders. Upkeep is paid after income is collected in the official hosting sequence.

The central idea: orders are simultaneous, resolution is sequential

Players submit orders without watching the other nations' orders resolve. Hosting then processes every nation's orders through a fixed sequence.

This creates three different kinds of time:

1. Planning time: all players choose orders from the same pre-host game state.
2. Resolution time: the engine processes different kinds of orders in a fixed sequence.
3. Battle time: tactical battles resolve internally after their triggering strategic step.

Players submit their decisions simultaneously, but the engine resolves them in sequence.

This distinction explains many apparently contradictory outcomes:

- a mage contributes research before being assassinated;
- units are recruited before an attacking army arrives;

- a remote attack can strike an army before ordinary movement;
- a new laboratory finishes too late to support research or rituals that month;
- starvation is applied after battles;
- income is collected before upkeep;
- general dominion spread happens after most battles;
- an immortal can be due to return after the victory check has already ended the game.

A six-phase model of hosting

The official manual lists 63 separate steps. For practical reading, those steps can be grouped into six phases. These phase names are editorial tools; the numbered order remains the authority.

Phase	Steps	Main contents
I. Commitments and production	1-9	Messages, research, recruitment, empowerment, forging, preaching, Thrones, quick orders
II. Magic and special threats	10-23	Rituals, remote attacks, magic battles, searching, awakening, Blood Hunting, Horrors, assassinations
III. Movement and conquest	24-27	Friendly movement, other movement, field battles, castle storming
IV. World effects and hidden conflict	28-33	Global effects, random events, item/monster effects, event battles, sneak discovery
V. State, economy, and dominion	34-45	Besiegers, construction, special orders, pillage, income, unrest, starvation, upkeep, dominion, sites
VI. Attrition and end-state	46-63	Aging, disease, insanity, mercenaries, heroes, elimination, victory, immortality, aftermath

The six-phase model is useful for memory. It must not replace the full sequence when exact timing matters.

The complete 63-step hosting sequence

Evidence: Official. Primary source: Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, pages 55-57. Verified: 25 August 2026.

The following table paraphrases the official sequence and adds timing consequences. The step names and order follow the manual; the explanations are written for this library.

Step	Resolution	What happens	Why the timing matters
1	Send messages	Diplomatic messages and attached gold, gems, or items are dispatched.	Transfers occur before events that could kill a courier, capture a province, or remove a commander. The manual states that the early timing makes sent resources reliable.
2	Research	Assigned researchers contribute research points.	A researcher killed later in the same hosting cycle still contributes for that month.
3	Recruitment	Paid troops and commanders are created.	New defenders exist before movement battles. They cannot receive new orders during the hosting cycle in which they appear.

Step	Resolution	What happens	Why the timing matters
4	Empowerment	Ordered permanent path increases are applied.	The path exists before forging and ritual steps, although the empowering commander cannot also perform a second ordinary order that month.
5	Forge items	Completed items enter the nation's magic-item inventory.	Forging occurs before rituals, but an item in the treasury is not the same as an item already equipped by a caster.
6	Preach	Priests resolve ordinary preaching and adjust dominion.	Preaching can alter dominion before movement battles, unlike general dominion spread at step 42.
7	Heretic preaching	Heretics, insane commanders, and shattered-soul commanders apply their religious influence.	These changes also occur before movement and most battles.
8	Claim Thrones	Eligible priests claim Thrones of Ascension.	A claim is processed before rituals and battles that might remove the claimant later in the month.
9	Quick special orders	Fast special orders such as entering a site to scry or cultivating pearls resolve.	These orders precede the main ritual step; their precise value depends on the named order.
10	Magic rituals	Ritual casters perform their rituals in random caster order.	Competing or interacting rituals cannot be assumed to follow nation number, player order, or script order.
11	Remote attacks	Rituals that strike hostile armies in remote provinces are applied.	An army can be damaged before it performs ordinary movement.
12	Magic battles	Battles created by magic resolve, including hostile teleportation and certain movement rituals.	Magical movement can fight before conventional armies move. Retreats from the group of magic battles are placed after all such battles finish.
13	Lost in other planes	Units become lost in other planes and relevant other-plane battles resolve.	Planar displacement is settled before site searching, ordinary movement, and field battles.
14	Site searches	Magical site-search orders resolve.	A commander can search a province before conventional movement changes the province later in hosting.
15	Prophets	New prophets are declared.	The prophet exists before Call God, awakening, Blood Hunting, assassinations, and ordinary battles, but after ritual and magic-battle steps.
16	Call God	Priests assigned to Call God contribute to returning a banished Pretender.	The recall attempt occurs before ordinary battles can kill those priests that month.
17	Awakening	Dormant or imprisoned Pretenders that are due to awaken enter play.	A newly awakened Pretender exists before ordinary movement battles but received no normal order from the prior map state.
18	Blood hunting	Blood Hunt orders resolve and slaves are collected according to the Blood Hunting rules.	Blood hunters are exposed to the results before assassinations and conventional movement.
19	Horrors	Units due to be visited by Horrors are attacked or affected.	Horror attacks can remove a commander before assassination and movement steps.
20	Assassinations	Assassination, seduction, corruption, and similar attempts resolve immediately.	Killing a commander here can prevent that commander's army from moving later. The research contribution at step 2 has already been secured.

Step	Resolution	What happens	Why the timing matters
21	Relinquish province	A province may be transferred to a qualifying non-stealthed ally already present.	Transfer happens before movement, so an ally arriving later in the turn does not satisfy the presence requirement for this order.
22	Claim mounts	Riders without mounts attempt to obtain suitable mounts.	Mount status is updated before ordinary movement and battles.
23	Lone mounts	Riderless intelligent mounts or mountless riders may return home or disperse.	Mount cleanup occurs before movement, preventing stale mount states from persisting into field battles.
24	Friendly movement	Movement ending in a friendly province resolves.	Reinforcement of an already friendly destination receives priority over hostile arrivals unless an earlier effect intervenes.
25	Other movement	Remaining conventional movement resolves, including Break Siege.	Hostile movement and movements that change control are processed after friendly movement.
26	Resolve battles	Field battles caused by conventional movement are fought.	Province control established here can affect storming, pillage, income, ownership, and later events.
27	Castle storming	Storm Castle battles resolve.	Storming occurs after movement battles. Retreats from the movement and storming groups are placed only after the relevant battles finish.
28	Global enchantments	Ongoing global enchantment effects are applied to the world.	A global is cast at step 10, but its continuing world effect begins here, after movement and castle-storming battles for the month.
29	Random events	Ordinary Fortune, Misfortune, and other eligible random events occur.	These events see the world state produced by magic, movement, battles, storming, and global effects.
30	Resolve battles	Battles created by random events are fought.	Event-created attackers do not fight during the earlier movement battle step.
31	Magic item and monster effects	Special monthly effects generated by items or monsters occur.	Items were forged at step 5, while special monthly effects are delayed until this stage. Item-assisted rituals still belong to step 10.
32	Resolve battles	Battles created by the preceding special effects are fought.	These battles form a separate retreat group after random-event battles.
33	Sneak discovery	Detected stealthy units fight for survival.	A stealth force can avoid the ordinary movement battle and still be discovered and attacked later.
34	Change besieger	When allied forces share a siege, the game determines which ally is the active besieger, favouring the larger force.	Siege ownership and control are settled after field, storming, event, and sneak-discovery battles.
35	Building construction	Forts, temples, and laboratories finish construction or demolition; fort melting also occurs.	New infrastructure is too late for this month's recruitment, research, forging, rituals, preaching, or movement. It becomes useful from the next order phase onward.
36	Special orders	Orders such as Reanimate and Summon Allies resolve.	The manual explicitly notes that allies created here are too late for this month's battles.
37	Pillage	Pillaging increases unrest and kills population.	Pillage occurs immediately before income, so the damage can reduce or remove income from a province captured earlier that month.

Step	Resolution	What happens	Why the timing matters
38	Income	Nations collect provincial income.	New ownership and pillage have already been resolved. Income arrives before upkeep is charged.
39	Unrest alterations	Unrest changes from dominion, scales, patrolling, and related systems are applied.	Income was already collected using the earlier state; the new unrest primarily affects the following month.
40	Starvation	Units without sufficient supplies suffer starvation effects.	Battles are already over. An army newly without supply fights this month's battles before the new starvation penalties are applied.
41	Upkeep and desertion	Unit upkeep is charged and desertion occurs.	Income is collected first, so the treasury has this month's income available when upkeep is assessed.
42	Dominion spread	General dominion spread from temples and other sources resolves.	Most battles have already occurred. New candles from ordinary spread do not retroactively alter those battles.
43	Dominion effects	Population loss, insanity pressure, temperature movement, and other special dominion effects are applied.	Dominion first spreads, then its special world effects are calculated from the resulting state.
44	Site effects	Sites generate disease, unrest, or other monthly effects.	Site effects happen after income, upkeep, and dominion effects but before healing and disease resolution.
45	Overpopulation	If global unit or commander limits are approached, the game removes some common entities.	This is an emergency engine-maintenance step rather than ordinary strategic attrition.
46	Aging	In midwinter, units age and may acquire age-related afflictions such as disease.	Aging is seasonal and occurs before the healing/disease step.
47	Resolve battles	Remaining battles generated by previous effects are fought.	Late world effects can create battles after normal movement, event, and sneak battles.
48	Heal and disease	Units heal lost hit points; diseased units instead suffer disease damage and may gain afflictions.	A surviving unit may recover after all ordinary battles, while disease can turn survival into a later death.
49	Insanity	Eligible units may become insane.	Insanity for the next order phase is determined after battles and healing.
50	Mercenaries	Mercenary bids, purchases, and continued contracts are resolved.	Mercenary availability is decided after income, upkeep, disease, and insanity.
51	New random heroes	Eligible national heroes may appear at the capital.	A new hero arrives after all battles and cannot act during the month of arrival.
52	Kill lone units	Non-commanders stranded in enemy territory without a commander are removed.	Troops left behind by commander death or separation cannot persist indefinitely as an uncontrolled hostile stack.
53	Reclaim provinces	A fort can restore province ownership to its owner or allied team under the stated conditions.	Partial ownership can be corrected late in hosting if the fort is not under siege.
54	Conscription	Province Defence is raised to at least one where applicable, and dominion or commander effects that add PD resolve.	Automatic PD appears after battles and therefore protects future turns, not the battle that caused the ownership change.
55	Scouting	Fresh scouting reports are generated.	Reports show the end-of-hosting state rather than the exact state seen during earlier movement or battles.

Step	Resolution	What happens	Why the timing matters
56	Elimination	Nations meeting elimination conditions are removed.	Elimination is checked after dominion spread and effects, but before the victory check and before immortals reform.
57	Victory	Configured victory conditions are checked and the game may end.	Later administrative steps cannot rescue a position once victory has been declared.
58	Update stats	Hall of Fame and scoregraph information is updated.	Public statistics reflect the completed turn after victory evaluation.
59	Heroic abilities	Eligible units gain or improve heroic abilities.	A unit's new heroic benefit is normally available from the following turn.
60	Reform Immortals	Immortals due to return reform their bodies.	The victory check has already occurred. An imminent immortal return cannot prevent a game that ended at step 57.
61	Reduce PD	Province Defence is reduced where population cannot support it; the manual gives a requirement of at least 10 population per PD point.	Unsustainable PD can disappear after the victory and scouting checks, altering the next turn's defence.
62	Yearning artifacts	Artifacts that newly become yearning change state.	Artifact yearning is an end-of-turn transition rather than an effect applied during forging or battle.
63	Aftermath	The engine validates orders and items, applies necessary shape changes, and performs final cleanup.	The next player turn opens only after these consistency checks and state transitions finish.

Phase I: commitments and production

Messages resolve before danger

Messages and attached resources are dispatched at step 1. The rule has an important diplomatic consequence: a trade agreed during the order phase is not interrupted because the sending capital is captured or the supposed courier dies later in hosting.

This makes the act of sending reliable. It does not make the agreement honest. A player can still send less than promised, send the wrong item, or accept payment while making hostile orders.

New-player rule: Resource transfers are processed before almost anything can interfere.

Expert consequence: A nation expecting to be eliminated can still transfer resources before the elimination check. Multiplayer rules may need to address kingmaking or last-turn treasury transfers explicitly.

Research is secured early

Research occurs at step 2. The official manual explicitly states that a researcher killed or assassinated later in the turn still contributes that month's research.

This timing separates research production from researcher survival:

- the current month's points are earned;
- the researcher may still be lost before the next order phase;
- research enabled at step 2 may make new spells available for later battles in the same hosting cycle, subject to casting orders already submitted and the game's handling of scripted availability.

The last point requires care. A script submitted before hosting cannot safely be assumed to select a spell that was unavailable when orders were written. Research can complete early, but practical same-turn spell use depends on scripting and spell-selection behaviour. That interaction belongs in the magic test suite.

Recruitment occurs before invasion

Recruitment resolves at step 3. Units paid for in the preceding order phase exist before magic attacks, assassinations, ordinary movement, field battles, and storming.

Practical consequences:

- emergency recruits can defend a province attacked that month;
- newly recruited commanders can be present as battlefield commanders;
- new units cannot receive a new strategic order until the following player turn;
- a province captured later does not cancel recruitment already completed;
- a recruitment queue still depends on the gold, resources, recruitment points, and local eligibility checked by the game.

Recruitment timing is one reason a projected attack cannot rely solely on last turn's scouting report. A fort or capital can add another month of defenders before the attack lands.

Empowerment and forging are separate commitments

Empowerment resolves at step 4 and forging at step 5. The sequence does not normally let one commander empower and forge in the same month because both require the commander's order. It does establish that permanent path changes exist before later systems inspect the commander.

A newly forged item enters the national item inventory. It is not automatically equipped by a commander whose orders were already submitted. If a battle or ritual needs a booster, the commander must have it equipped before hosting. Forging it during that hosting is too late.

Preaching is not ordinary dominion spread

Ordinary preaching resolves at step 6 and heretic preaching at step 7. General dominion spread waits until step 42.

This is strategically significant:

- successful preaching can change dominion before battles;
- general temple spread cannot change earlier battle conditions that month;
- heretic and insanity-related religious effects are also early;
- blood sacrifice is a different special order and should not be silently treated as ordinary preaching.

Dominion-dependent hit points, morale, scales, sacred effects, and special national mechanics make this distinction worth testing in controlled battles.

Throne claims are early

Thrones are claimed at step 8, long before the victory check at step 57. A priest who successfully performs the order can establish the claim even if later killed.

The claim does not cause an immediate mid-sequence victory. The remaining hosting steps still resolve before victory is checked.

This creates a dangerous endgame pattern:

1. a Throne is claimed at step 8;
2. the claimant may lose battles or territory later;
3. the game evaluates the configured victory condition at step 57.

Book III resolves the ownership branch at an Official plus Community-tested tier. Killing the claimant after step 8 does not undo the claim. Conquering an unfortified Throne, or storming and conquering the fort that contains one, makes it unclaimed before step 57 and removes its points from the winning total. Merely besieging a fortified Throne does not conquer the fort or unclaim the Throne. Book III retains the evidence and complete state matrix; this chapter owns only the shared turn order.

Phase II: magic and special threats

Rituals have random caster order

All ritual casters resolve at step 10 in random order. This is one of the most important expert-level timing rules.

When two rituals interact, no plan should depend on one particular mage resolving first unless the game provides a separate explicit priority. Examples include:

- two commanders attempting to affect the same unique target;
- competing globals;
- rituals that move, kill, transform, or empower a target;
- rituals that alter a province before another ritual checks it;
- ritual combinations that depend on gem availability or a surviving caster.

Random caster order means that a multi-ritual plan should be robust in every plausible order or should be tested to determine whether the particular rituals belong to separate substeps.

> Expert rule: "Both happen during the magic phase" does not mean "they happen simultaneously." It often means "the engine resolves them one at a time in an order the player cannot choose."

Casting a global and receiving its world effect are different steps

A global enchantment is cast during rituals at step 10. The global's continuing world effect is applied at step 28.

This division creates a clear dependency:

- the global can be established before ordinary movement;
- its normal world-processing stage occurs after movement battles and castle storming;
- the spell's immediate casting effect, if any, must be distinguished from its later monthly effect;
- losing a province or caster after step 10 may or may not end a province-centred global before step 28, depending on that global's rules.

Every global guide should record:

1. casting requirements;
2. immediate casting result;
3. ongoing effect step;
4. dispel rules;
5. termination condition;
6. whether it is centred on a province, caster, site, or global slot.

Remote attacks strike before ordinary movement

Remote army attacks resolve at step 11. A conventional army ordered to leave the targeted province has not yet performed ordinary movement.

This creates several practical uses:

- damage a stack before it marches;
- kill or disable a commander and strand troops;
- force attrition before a later conventional attack;
- attack a force whose destination is uncertain while it is still at its starting location.

There is one important qualification. A commander may leave or arrive through magical movement at step 10, and magic battles occur at step 12. In this context, "before movement" needs to mean "before conventional movement."

Magic battles are their own battle group

Battles created by magic resolve at step 12. This includes examples such as hostile teleportation and units moved by certain rituals.

Retreats are placed after all battles in the group have resolved. That detail matters when multiple magic battles use adjacent provinces or when a retreat destination is itself affected by another magic battle.

"A battle" is too broad to be a safe unit of analysis. The useful sequence is:

- the step that created the battle;
- the battle group to which it belongs;
- the point at which retreats from that group are placed.

Site searching precedes conventional conquest

Site searches resolve at step 14. A mage searching a province can complete the order before an enemy conventional army arrives.

The newly found site then exists for later steps, but each site benefit has its own timing:

- gem income is not necessarily granted immediately upon discovery;
- a site effect may be processed at step 44;
- recruitment unlocked by the site cannot be ordered retroactively;
- a conqueror may take control of the newly discovered site later in the same turn.

The distinction between discovering a site and receiving every benefit of that site should be preserved.

Prophets, recalled gods, and awakening

Prophets are declared at step 15. Call God resolves at step 16. Dormant and imprisoned Pretenders awaken at step 17.

All three occur before ordinary movement and field battles, but after magic battles.

This ordering produces several boundaries:

- a new prophet can defend against a later conventional attack;
- a prophet is not available for an earlier magic battle;
- an awakening Pretender can exist for later defence but generally has no fresh order that month;

- priests calling a god make their contribution before conventional attackers arrive;
- the returned god's exact availability and location must be checked under the Call God rules.

Blood Hunting is early enough to be dangerous

Blood Hunting occurs at step 18, before assassinations and movement. The hunt can generate slaves and unrest before later state-processing steps.

The full economic consequences require the Blood Hunting chapter, but the timing model already establishes that:

- hunters remain in their starting province while hunting;
- a hunter can be assassinated after contributing to the hunt;
- unrest alterations from the broader turn are processed later;
- newly collected slaves exist before later upkeep and income steps, although their immediate availability for already-submitted rituals should not be assumed without testing.

Horrors and assassinations can remove movement leaders

Horror visits occur at step 19 and assassinations at step 20. Both can kill a commander before conventional movement.

An army's movement order belongs to a commander. If that commander dies before step 24 or 25, assigned troops may remain behind, become uncommanded, or eventually be removed if stranded in hostile territory.

A resilient army-movement plan considers:

- redundant commanders;
- bodyguards;
- stealth and assassination threats;
- Horror Marks;
- whether critical troops can be reassigned before hosting;
- whether the loss of a single leader invalidates an entire movement chain.

Relinquishing requires an ally already present

Relinquish Province resolves at step 21. The official description requires the receiving non-stealthed allied commander to already be in the province.

An ally moving into the province at step 24 is too late. A stealthy allied commander does not satisfy the stated condition.

This is a good example of why a plain-language order description is not enough. The order's position in hosting determines which board state it can see.

Phase III: movement and conquest

Friendly movement receives its own step

Movement ending in a friendly province resolves at step 24. Other conventional movement resolves at step 25.

The manual explains the practical purpose: a force trying to enter a friendly province before an enemy arrives normally succeeds unless an earlier event prevents it.

This is not a universal guarantee that every reinforcement arrives safely. Earlier dangers include:

- remote attacks;
- magic battles;
- planar loss;
- Horrors;
- assassination;
- failed movement requirements;
- commander death;
- terrain or movement limitations.

It does mean that an ordinary hostile arrival does not normally prevent valid friendly reinforcement from reaching the province first.

"Other movement" contains several different intentions

Step 25 covers the remaining conventional movements, including Break Siege. It can include:

- invasion of hostile territory;
- movement into independent provinces;
- armies crossing toward a province that changes ownership;
- breaking out of a siege;
- opposing movements that produce a meeting or province battle.

Movement validity depends on the movement rules: map-move allowance, terrain costs, roads, rivers, survival abilities, flying, sailing, planes, army composition, and the slowest or otherwise limiting elements of the force.

Book I records when movement resolves. The movement and logistics material handles the detailed calculation of whether a move is valid.

Field battles occur after both movement steps

Battles created by conventional movement resolve at step 26. The defender seen in battle may include:

- the pre-existing garrison;
- recruited units from step 3;
- friendly reinforcements from step 24;
- Province Defence;
- commanders or units that did not move;
- magical arrivals from earlier steps, if they survived;
- units altered by early effects.

It may exclude:

- conventional reinforcements whose movement failed;
- commanders killed by Horrors or assassinations;
- allies summoned later at step 36;
- infrastructure completed later at step 35;
- dominion changes that wait for step 42.

Castle storming is later than field battle

Castle storming resolves at step 27. A storming force must survive the month's preceding events and battles before entering the assault.

This ordering matters when:

- a relief army arrives;
- the besiegers fight a field battle;
- an army attempts to break siege;
- assassinations remove storm leaders;
- remote attacks weaken the besiegers;
- multiple allied forces are involved.

Storming is a separate battle step, resolved later than movement battles and governed by its own deployment, wall, gate, and defender rules.

Retreats belong to battle groups

The manual repeatedly notes that retreats to adjacent provinces occur after all battles in a relevant group have resolved.

This prevents an oversimplified model in which a routed army immediately appears in a neighbouring province while other same-step battles are still being processed.

For expert analysis, a retreat question should record:

- which step caused the battle;
- which other battles shared the step;
- candidate retreat provinces at the time retreats are placed;
- control and hostile forces in those provinces;
- whether the unit was inside or outside a fort;
- whether the route crossed planes or special connections.

Phase IV: world effects and hidden conflict

Global effects are late relative to conquest

Ongoing global enchantment effects resolve at step 28, after conventional movement and castle storming.

This means a global cast at step 10 may be visible and active as an enchantment before its normal monthly world effect is processed. If the effect depends on a province, site, caster, or global state that can be lost during movement, the exact spell wording and tests become important.

No global should be described merely as "going off in the magic phase." Its casting and its world tick may be separated by most of the month's major battles.

Random events see a heavily updated world

Random events occur at step 29. By then, the game has already processed:

- research and recruitment;
- preaching and Throne claims;
- rituals and magical attacks;
- assassinations;
- conventional movement;
- field battles and storming;
- global world effects.

Events can react to a state that did not exist when orders were submitted.

The Event Modding Manual confirms that events can test a wide range of conditions, including:

- era and turn;
- season and month;
- nation;
- treasury and gems;
- research;
- population;
- unrest and PD;
- buildings;
- terrain and plane;
- sites and Thrones;
- dominion and scales;
- particular monsters, Pretenders, priests, mages, and orders;
- global enchantments;
- event codes and variables.

This is why event systems can simulate diplomacy, doctrine, religious activity, or evolving stories without directly rewriting the strategic AI.

Event battles resolve separately

Battles created by random events occur at step 30. A nation can win its movement battle and then face a later event battle in the same province.

Reports should be read in timing order. Two battles in one province during the same month may be caused by different systems and may see different surviving forces.

Item and monster effects have a separate monthly tick

Monthly effects from magic items and monsters resolve at step 31, followed by any battles they cause at step 32.

The manual distinguishes:

- item forging at step 5;
- item-assisted ritual casting at step 10;
- special monthly item or monster effects at step 31.

This prevents a common category error in which every effect attached to an item is assumed to occur when the item is forged or when rituals resolve.

Stealth failure can produce a late battle

Sneak discovery occurs at step 33. A stealthy force may avoid conventional combat because it remained undiscovered, then be exposed and forced to fight later.

Stealth changes what triggers combat. It does not make a force immune to hostile troops.

Expert stealth analysis should distinguish:

- successful sneaking movement;
- patrol detection;
- event-based detection;
- Glamour visibility;

- assassination or spy actions;
- late sneak-discovery battles;
- retreat and survival after discovery.

Phase V: state, economy, and dominion

Allied siege leadership is determined after combat

At step 34, the game selects the active besieger when allied armies share a siege. Larger armies take precedence according to the manual.

This decision occurs after the major battle groups. Losses suffered earlier in the month can change which ally counts as the besieger.

Buildings finish after the month's active systems

Construction and demolition occur at step 35.

A building ordered this month is too late to support:

- step 2 research;
- step 3 recruitment;
- step 5 forging;
- step 6 preaching requirements where a temple matters;
- step 10 ritual casting;
- step 14 site-search orders;
- earlier battles.

The completed structure is principally an investment in the following turn.

This is the first major principle of infrastructure timing:

> A building consumes resources in the present to unlock actions in the future.

The economy volume will extend this into fort construction time, administration, recruitment access, laboratory networks, temple spread, and opportunity cost.

Special-order summons arrive after battle

Special orders such as Reanimate and Summon Allies occur at step 36. The manual explicitly states that allies summoned here do not participate in this month's battles.

This differs from:

- recruitment at step 3;
- ritual summons at step 10;
- event-created units at their event step;
- units arriving through movement.

When a unit appears is as important as how it is created.

Pillage damages the same month's income

Pillage occurs at step 37, immediately before income at step 38. The official manual explicitly warns that pillaging a newly conquered province can reduce or remove the income collected from it.

This creates a direct trade:

- immediate pillage effects;
- increased unrest;
- population loss;
- reduced current income;
- reduced future economic value;
- possible strategic denial if the province cannot be held.

Pillage should never be evaluated only by its immediate gold or damage result.

Income precedes upkeep

Income is collected at step 38. Upkeep is paid at step 41.

This means the month's provincial income is available before the game assesses unit maintenance. A treasury that appears unable to cover upkeep at the end of the order phase may survive if sufficient income is collected.

Income may already have been altered by:

- conquest;
- pillage;
- ownership;
- unrest existing before step 39;
- population;
- scales and dominion already present;
- sites and other modifiers;
- events or earlier effects.

Unrest changes after income

The broad unrest-alteration step is 39, after income. Patrolling, dominion, scales, and related changes are reflected here.

This suggests a timing distinction between:

- unrest already present when income is collected;
- unrest created directly by pillage at step 37;
- general unrest alterations processed at step 39.

Each unrest source should be tested against income on its own. One slogan cannot safely describe all of them.

Starvation follows battle

Starvation is processed at step 40. The manual states that an army newly without supplies fights its battles before starvation effects are applied.

This does not make supply unimportant. Existing starvation penalties and afflictions may already be present. The rule means that the first new month of shortage does not retroactively weaken battles that occurred earlier in that hosting cycle.

For campaign planning, supply is a delayed threat that compounds over time:

1. the army enters or remains in a low-supply situation;
2. it fights before the new starvation tick;

3. starvation is applied afterward;
4. the weakened army enters the next order phase with penalties, disease risk, or afflictions.

Upkeep and desertion follow income

At step 41, upkeep is charged and desertion occurs.

This timing means conquest and income may fund the army before payment is due. It also means pillage, income loss, or treasury transfers can contribute to a shortfall.

The exact desertion priority and behaviour require a dedicated economy test. A reliable guide should not claim which units desert first without current evidence.

Dominion spread, then dominion effects

General dominion spread occurs at step 42. Dominion effects follow at step 43.

This produces a clear two-stage model:

1. candles spread or contest one another;
2. special effects of the resulting dominion state are applied.

Possible effects include:

- population loss;
- insanity;
- temperature movement;
- national or Pretender-specific dominion effects;
- event eligibility;
- other mechanics tied to friendly or hostile candles.

Most conventional battles are already over. Preaching at steps 6 and 7 is the major earlier religious exception.

Sites apply their monthly effects

Magic-site effects occur at step 44. Disease, unrest, and other site-driven changes are applied after dominion effects.

Site-search discovery occurred at step 14. A newly found site may apply an effect later in the same month, although the timing still needs to be checked for the specific site and effect.

Phase VI: attrition and end-state

Aging is seasonal

Aging occurs at step 46 and only during midwinter. Units gain a year and may receive age-related afflictions.

The seasonal condition matters when planning:

- old mages;
- rejuvenation or age modification;
- disease management;
- transformation;
- long campaigns;

- effects that trigger at a particular month.

The Event Modding Manual identifies month 10 as midwinter in its month numbering, but a full calendar reference should be verified in the dedicated time-and-seasons appendix.

Healing and disease share a late step

At step 48, ordinary units regain lost hit points while diseased units instead suffer disease damage and may gain more afflictions.

This occurs after ordinary battles, global effects, events, item effects, site effects, aging, and any late battles.

Surviving the battle report does not always mean surviving until the next player turn.

Insanity is determined after healing

Insanity changes occur at step 49. An affected unit enters the next order phase with the resulting behaviour or lost control.

Insanity also appears in earlier steps, including heretic preaching at step 7. It is not confined to one moment in the turn. The step 49 check establishes or changes the condition that will affect later orders.

Mercenaries and heroes arrive too late to act

Mercenary resolution occurs at step 50 and new random heroes at step 51.

Neither can receive an order or join an earlier battle during the month of arrival. They become assets for the following order phase.

Lone troops are cleaned up

At step 52, non-commanders left alone in enemy territory are removed.

This can be the delayed consequence of:

- assassination;
- commander death in an earlier battle;
- failed or split movement;
- a commander retreating separately;
- ownership changes;
- units being created without a valid leader.

The lesson goes beyond the cleanup rule. Commander redundancy protects logistics as well as morale.

End-of-turn ownership can still change

At step 53, a fort can reclaim province ownership under the conditions stated in the manual, including the absence of an active siege.

This reflects the distinction between:

- ownership of the open province;
- ownership of the fortress;
- partial ownership;

- full ownership.

Any guide to events, income, recruitment, or province transfer that says only "owner" must specify which kind of ownership the rule requires.

Conscription is for the next attack

At step 54, Province Defence can be raised to a minimum and PD-adding dominion or commander effects occur.

This is after every ordinary battle. The new defence cannot save the province from the attack that caused its creation or transfer.

Scouting reports are end-state reports

Scouting updates at step 55. A report is a view of the state after most monthly transformations, not a recording of every force that passed through the province.

This explains why scouting can omit:

- an army that moved onward;
- units killed in an earlier battle;
- a stealth force not discovered;
- a temporary magical arrival;
- infrastructure or ownership that changed again later.

Intelligence should be dated and treated as a snapshot.

Elimination precedes victory

Elimination is checked at step 56 and victory at step 57.

Dominion spread and effects have already resolved, so a dominion collapse can matter immediately. Immortal return is still three steps away at step 60.

The sequence prevents a player from assuming that a future recovery effect will be processed before the game decides whether the nation or game has ended.

Heroic abilities and immortality are post-victory

Statistics update at step 58, heroic abilities at step 59, and immortal reformation at step 60.

These are transitions into the next turn unless the game has already ended.

Province Defence can be reduced after reports

At step 61, PD is reduced if population cannot support it. The manual states that at least 10 population is required for each PD point.

Because scouting updates at step 55, an edge case exists: the displayed or reported value may need to be checked against the final post-reduction state. The user interface behaviour should be verified in a controlled test.

Aftermath closes the turn

Artifact yearning occurs at step 62. Final validation, item checks, and shape changes occur at step 63.

Aftermath is a reminder that not every visible state transition has a named strategic order. Shape-changing units, invalid item states, and other cleanup may be corrected only at the end.

Timing chains every player should know

Researcher assassination

Order	Event
2	The mage contributes research
20	The assassination attempt occurs
48	If wounded and surviving, healing or disease is processed
Next turn	The nation keeps the research but may have lost the mage

Conclusion: Assassination disrupts future research, not the research already produced that month.

Emergency recruitment against invasion

Order	Event
3	Recruits are created
24	Friendly reinforcements may arrive
25	The hostile army moves
26	The field battle includes eligible new defenders

Conclusion: Recruitment and friendly reinforcement can both increase a defence beyond what the attacker saw in the preceding scout report.

Commander assassination strands an army

Order	Event
20	The movement commander is assassinated
24-25	The dead commander cannot complete conventional movement
52	Troops left alone in hostile territory may be removed

Conclusion: A cheap assassination can have a strategic effect much larger than the commander's personal value.

Remote attack before a march

Order	Event
10	The attacking ritual is cast
11	Its remote strike hits the army
25	The surviving conventional army attempts movement
26	It fights any resulting field battle

Conclusion: Remote attacks can soften, disorganise, or decapitate an army before its conventional operation.

Teleportation and conventional invasion

Order	Event
10	Magical movement ritual resolves
12	Any resulting magic battle is fought
24-25	Conventional armies move
26	Conventional movement battles occur

Conclusion: A teleporting force cannot be treated as arriving at the same moment as a marching army. The magical force may fight alone first.

Constructing a laboratory

Order	Event
2	Research occurs without the unfinished laboratory
5	Forging occurs without it
10	Rituals occur without it
35	The laboratory finishes
Next turn	Eligible commanders can use the laboratory

Conclusion: A laboratory order is an investment in next month's magic, not a way to enable this month's rituals.

Pillage after conquest

Order	Event
25	Invaders move
26	They win the province
37	A valid Pillage order is processed
38	Income is collected from the damaged province

Conclusion: Pillaging a newly conquered province can sacrifice immediate and future economic value.

Starvation after combat

Order	Event
26-33	Ordinary, event, special-effect, and sneak battles occur
40	New starvation effects are applied
48	Healing or disease is processed
Next turn	The army begins in its worsened condition

Conclusion: An army can fight at its pre-starvation state and still emerge strategically crippled afterward.

Dominion before and after battle

Order	Event
6-7	Preaching and heretic preaching adjust dominion
26-33	Most battles occur
42	General dominion spread occurs
43	Dominion effects apply

Conclusion: Active preaching can matter before battle. Passive monthly spread generally affects the state after battle.

Victory before immortal return

Order	Event
56	Elimination is checked
57	Victory is checked
60	Due immortals reform

Conclusion: A return scheduled for the end of the month cannot undo a game-ending state already recognised at step 57.

A new player's turn checklist

Before finalising orders

- Check the treasury after recruitment, construction, forging, and expected transfers.
- Confirm that every army has a commander with the correct normal, magic, or undead leadership.
- Confirm that the slowest movement restriction has not invalidated an army's route.
- Check whether rivers, roads, mountains, forests, swamps, caves, sailing, or planes alter movement.
- Give bodyguards to commanders exposed to assassination.
- Verify that critical mages have the required paths, gems, laboratory, and target.
- Equip boosters before hosting; forging them this turn is too late for the same caster to use them.
- Check whether a ritual target is the starting province or expected destination of an enemy.
- Inspect every fort for recruitment, siege, storm, and repair intentions.
- Confirm that researchers are actually assigned to Research.
- Review starving, diseased, old, insane, or heavily Horror Marked commanders.
- Check dominion and retreat routes around important battles.
- Confirm that a Throne claimant has the required priest level and correct order.
- Recheck diplomacy messages, gold, gems, and items before sending.
- Save or archive the turn file when a test or major operation needs later reconstruction.

After hosting

- Read messages before changing orders.
- Separate magic battles, movement battles, event battles, and assassination battles.

- Compare recruitment reports with surviving units.
- Check whether movement failed or whether the commander died before movement.
- Inspect new sites, buildings, heroes, mercenaries, globals, and dominion changes.
- Review income, upkeep, unrest, and supply summaries.
- Inspect wounded survivors for disease and new afflictions.
- Check whether stealthy units remained hidden or fought discovery battles.
- Review scouting reports as end-state snapshots.
- Record any result that contradicts the expected hosting sequence.

Expert operational checklist

For a complex operation, write the dependency chain before submitting orders.

Target

- What province, fort, army, commander, site, or global must change?
- Which exact end-state counts as success?

Earliest interference

- Can a message transfer remove required gems or items?
- Can a remote ritual kill or move the target?
- Can a Horror, assassination, or seduction remove a critical commander?

Magic-phase dependencies

- Which rituals interact?
- Does random ritual order matter?
- Will magical movement fight alone before conventional movement?
- Are retreats from several magic battles competing for the same provinces?

Movement dependencies

- Is the destination friendly at step 24 or hostile at step 25?
- Could ownership change between planning and movement?
- Is Break Siege involved?
- Is there a valid retreat province after all battles in the group?

Post-battle dependencies

- Does a global tick at step 28?
- Can a random event or item effect create another battle?
- Will a stealth force face discovery at step 33?
- Does construction finish too late for the intended action?

Economic dependencies

- Does Pillage reduce the income expected to pay upkeep?
- Is the army supplied before the starvation tick?
- Does income arrive before the planned upkeep obligation?
- Could population loss reduce PD at step 61?

End-state dependencies

- Can dominion spread eliminate a nation?
- Is victory checked before an expected immortal return?
- Does a hero, mercenary, or summoned ally arrive too late to matter?

Troubleshooting: why did the order fail?

"My army did not move"

Check, in order:

1. Was the commander killed by a Horror, assassination, magic battle, or remote effect before movement?
2. Did the commander become lost in another plane?
3. Was the route valid for every unit in the army?
4. Did terrain, a river, road status, sailing, flying, or survival ability change the cost?
5. Did the destination change from friendly to hostile or otherwise alter the movement category?
6. Was the commander performing a different order?
7. Was the army inside a fort, besieging, breaking siege, patrolling, or sneaking?
8. Did part of the army move while incompatible units remained?
9. Was the apparent failure actually movement followed by defeat and retreat?

"My ritual did not happen"

Check:

1. Did the caster have the required laboratory?
2. Were the path requirements met after all equipped items and effects?
3. Were sufficient gems or slaves available to that caster?
4. Was the target legal and correctly selected?
5. Did the caster receive the ritual order rather than a battle script or different strategic order?
6. Was the ritual blocked, resisted, intercepted, or converted into a battle?
7. Did another randomly ordered ritual change the target first?
8. Was the expected result an ongoing global effect that waits until step 28?
9. Was the spell from a different ruleset or mod version?

"My new building did nothing"

Construction finishes at step 35. It cannot enable research at step 2, recruitment at step 3, forging at step 5, or rituals at step 10 during that same hosting cycle.

"My summoned allies missed the battle"

If they came from a special order such as Summon Allies or Reanimate, they arrived at step 36 after the battle steps. Ritual summons follow different timing and must be analysed under the ritual that created them.

"The battle used different dominion than expected"

Check:

- preaching at step 6;
- heretic preaching at step 7;

- special religious effects;
- the pre-host candle state;
- whether ordinary dominion spread at step 42 occurred only after the battle;
- whether the battle report or later map screen is being used as the reference state.

"The province produced less income than expected"

Check:

- ownership after movement and battle;
- pillage at step 37;
- population;
- unrest already present before the income step;
- dominion and scales;
- sites and events;
- partial ownership caused by a fort;
- whether the figure came from a pre-host projection or the final income report.

"The unit survived battle but disappeared"

Possible causes include:

- a later event or special-effect battle;
- starvation;
- upkeep desertion;
- site or dominion damage;
- disease at step 48;
- lone-unit cleanup at step 52;
- elimination or victory;
- end-of-turn shape or item validation.

Ruleset and mod implications

Core sequence versus mod-added content

Ordinary `.dm` mods can add or modify:

- units;
- weapons and armour;
- spells;
- items;
- sites;
- nations;
- blessings;
- population types;
- mercenaries;
- events;
- AI templates and preferences;
- many special attributes.

The current modding manuals do not expose a command for rewriting the engine's entire 63-step hosting sequence.

The practical model is:

- the engine retains its main sequence;
- mods insert new content into the steps appropriate to that content;
- a modded ritual still belongs to ritual processing;
- a modded event still belongs to event processing;
- a modded monthly monster or item effect belongs to the relevant special-effect stage;
- mod load order determines the final data definitions used when those steps run.

This conclusion is Official limits plus inference, not proof that no executable-level modification could ever alter hosting.

Mod load order

The Modding Manual states that complete mods are loaded one at a time. Within a mod, command categories are parsed in an internal order including weapons, armour, units, names, blessings, sites, nations, spells, items, general commands, population types, mercenaries, and events.

When two enabled mods alter the same object, later alterations can overwrite earlier values. The manual warns that overlapping modifications can produce unpredictable behaviour.

For the frozen ruleset, Dominions Enhanced loads before Divinitus. Book IX owns the exact overlap and collision record, while the Grand Hierophant reconstruction is kept with the Arcoscephale dossier in Book VII. The timing lesson here is simply that load order belongs to the ruleset.

Event chains and compatibility

The Event Modding Manual warns that event-code collisions between mods can scramble event chains and create severe bugs. It recommends negative event codes in a reserved range and careful compatibility checking.

Both active mods add large event libraries. Their size alone does not prove a collision, but it makes code and variable auditing a foundational requirement. The exact registries and current collision findings are recorded once in Book IX.

Controlled tests required by Book I

The official sequence is explicit, but several practical interactions still need current-game reproduction.

Test protocol

Every test should record:

- game version;
- operating ruleset;
- enabled mods and load order;
- map and game settings;
- turn number and season;
- relevant units, IDs, paths, items, sites, and province state;
- exact submitted orders;
- pre-host save;
- messages and battle reports;
- before-and-after screenshots or extracted state;
- number of repetitions;
- conclusion and confidence label.

Priority timing tests

#	Test	Controlled question
1	Research completion and same-turn scripting	Can a newly completed research level make a pre-scripted spell available in a later battle that month, and how are invalid scripts handled?
2	Preaching and battle dominion	Does successful step-6 preaching change dominion-dependent battle statistics before a step-26 battle?
3	Throne claim-loss regression	Confirm that later claimant death preserves a completed claim, while unfortified conquest or a successful fort storm makes the Throne unclaimed before step 57.
4	Forged item availability	Can a step-5 forged item influence an already-submitted same-turn ritual or special effect without being equipped beforehand?
5	Newly discovered site effects	Does a site discovered at step 14 apply its monthly effect at step 44 in the same month?
6	Assassinated movement commander	What happens to movement and assigned troops when their only commander dies at step 20?
7	Friendly movement priority	Which forces appear in battle when friendly reinforcement and an enemy invasion enter the same province during an ownership change?
8	Global casting versus first world tick	Which parts of a global occur at casting step 10 and which wait for world-effect step 28?
9	Pillage and same-turn income	How much income is lost when a newly captured province is pillaged at step 37 before income at step 38?
10	Unrest timing	Which of pre-existing unrest, pillage unrest, patrol reduction, and dominion-driven unrest changes influence step-38 income?
11	Starvation timing	Does a newly undersupplied army fight at its prior state before receiving the post-host starvation effects?
12	Upkeep desertion priority	Which units desert first during a controlled treasury shortfall?
13	Site, dominion, and disease ordering	How do site disease, dominion effects, aging, regeneration, and existing disease combine in the end-of-turn health sequence?
14	Scouting before PD reduction	Do reports or interface values show PD before or after the step-61 population reduction?
15	Victory before immortal return	Can victory or elimination end the game on the same turn an immortal is due to reform at step 60?
16	DE and Divinitus event-code audit	Do the two supplied files collide in event codes, variables, rarity classes, or order requirements?

Source record

Primary official sources

- Illwinter Dominions 6 documentation, accessed 25 August 2026.
- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, especially pages 13, 47-57, 73-87.
- Illwinter update record, recording Dominions 6.36 on 17 August 2026 UTC.
- Official Dominions 6.36 announcement.
- Dominions 6 changes from Dominions 5.
- Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34, especially pages 3-5 and 63-65.
- Dominions 6 Event Modding Manual, version 6.29, especially pages 2-11.

Exact mod sources

- `DomEnhanced2_16.dm`, SHA-256 `72558697f8dae3a1fccf8fb57b3faccde56c7fe6c05dac6403cefe153faf6c1b`.
- `Divinitus_1.15.3_DE.dm`, SHA-256 `cf7f21900a3812b66edddd831df779743eaf33080aef983f9bdea8ec47642809`.

Verification note

The public base game is version 6.36, while the current official Modding Manual identifies itself as version 6.34 and the Event Modding Manual as version 6.29. This is not automatically a contradiction: auxiliary manuals are updated when their documented interfaces change. It does mean that later patch notes and current-game tests remain necessary whenever a rule could have changed after a manual's stated version.

DOCUMENT 3 OF 16

Turn and Economy Quick Reference

Scope and use

This is the library's field sheet: the small amount of deliberate repetition kept beside the turn screen. Foundation Book I owns hosting order and Foundation Book II owns the economic rules. The sheet simply keeps their most-used facts in one place while answering four immediate questions:

1. What resolves first?
2. What limits recruitment here?
3. What will this province actually produce?
4. What state change will matter this month rather than next month?

Ruleset: Unmodded Dominions 6.36 unless a modded note is explicitly shown. Primary source: Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2. Verification date: 25 August 2026. Evidence rule: A dagger symbol is not used; uncertainties are written out beside the affected rule.

The hosting spine

The official hosting sequence contains 63 steps. The following spine preserves the steps that most often decide an order-writing problem.

Step	Resolution	Immediate consequence
1	Messages and attached resources	Transfers leave before almost every danger or ownership change.
2	Research	A researcher killed later still contributes this month.
3	Recruitment	New defenders exist before attacks and movement.
4	Empowerment	Permanent path increases are applied.
5	Forging	New items enter the national inventory but are not retroactively equipped.
6-8	Preaching, heretics, Throne claims	These religious actions precede battles and general dominion spread.
10	Rituals	Casters resolve in random order.
11-12	Remote attacks and magic battles	Magical attacks and movement can strike before conventional movement.
14	Site searches	Search orders finish before ordinary conquest.
15-18	Prophets, Call God, awakening, Blood Hunting	These resolve before assassinations and ordinary movement.
20	Assassinations	A killed commander may strand an army before movement.
24-25	Friendly movement, then other movement	Conventional movement is divided into two steps.
26-27	Movement battles, then castle storming	A relieving army can fight before a storm attempt.
28-33	Globals, events, effect battles, sneak discovery	Several late battle groups remain after movement.
35	Building construction and demolition	A new fort, temple, or lab is too late for this month's earlier actions.

Step	Resolution	Immediate consequence
36	Special-order allies	Reanimated or summoned allies created here are too late for this month's battles.
37	Pillage	Population and unrest damage precede income.
38	Income	Gold is collected after conquest and pillage, before upkeep.
39	Unrest alterations	Most ordinary unrest reduction is too late to improve this month's income.
40	Starvation	Armies fight before newly applied starvation.
41	Upkeep and desertion	This month's income is available before the charge.
42-44	Dominion spread, dominion effects, site effects	Ordinary dominion spread occurs after most battles and the economy.
48	Healing and disease	Battle survivors heal or suffer disease after the combat sequence.
54	Conscription	Automatic minimum PD is created for future turns.
56-57	Elimination, then victory	Both checks occur before immortals reform.
60-63	Immortals, unsupported PD, artifacts, cleanup	End-state maintenance prepares the next order phase.

Provincial gold

Base and final income

```
Base income = population / 100

Modified income =
(population / 100)
x dominion-scale modifiers
x (1 + fort Administration / 200)

Final income =
modified income / (1 + unrest x 0.02)
```

The number displayed by the province interface is already modified. Exact intermediate rounding is an implementation detail and should not be reconstructed from the final number when a one-gold difference matters.

Tax trace

A province produces no income for the turn if it cannot trace an unbroken line of friendly provinces to a friendly fort. In disciple games, allied territory can carry the trace.

This is a collection rule, not a resource rule. A cut tax line can remove gold income without removing the province's local resources, recruitment capacity, or supplies.

Unrest multipliers

Unrest	Income retained	Resources retained
0	100%	100%
10	about 83%	about 91%
25	about 67%	80%

Unrest	Income retained	Resources retained
50	50%	about 67%
75	40%	about 57%
100	about 33%	50%
150	25%	40%
200	20%	about 33%

At unrest 100 or greater, ordinary unit and commander recruitment is prohibited.

Provincial resources

An unfortified province makes only half of its potential resource value available for local recruitment. A fortified province uses its full local potential and may draw a percentage of the potential resources of eligible adjacent provinces.

```
Final local resource pool =
calculated resources / (1 + unrest x 0.01)
```

Fort resource draw is governed by Administration:

- a fort draws its Administration percentage from each eligible adjacent province's potential resources;
- land forts do not draw from sea provinces, and sea forts do not draw from land;
- a fort does not draw from an adjacent province containing another fort;
- a fort does not draw from an enemy-held province;
- two forts may draw from the same third province when that third province is adjacent to both and contains no fort.

Resources are local and do not accumulate. Unused resources vanish at hosting rather than moving to the treasury.

Recruitment capacity

Recruitment Points

Start with 20 Recruitment Points, then add the contribution from each population band reached.

Population band	Contribution from that band
Base	20
First 5,000	population in band / 100
5,001-10,000	population in band / 200
10,001-20,000	population in band / 300
20,001-40,000	population in band / 400
Above 40,000	population in band / 500

Example for 6,000 population:

```
20 + 5,000/100 + 1,000/200 = 75 Recruitment Points
```

The fort's recruitment bonus is applied afterward. Order or Turmoil changes Recruitment Points by 10% per scale step. Exact fractional rounding remains assigned to controlled testing.

The four recruitment gates

Gate	What it limits	Common misunderstanding
Gold	Units, commanders, buildings, PD, and upkeep	A rich treasury does not create more local resources or points.
Resources	Equipment-heavy troops in that province	Resources do not transfer or stockpile.
Recruitment Points	Ordinary troop throughput	Cheap, lightly equipped units can still exhaust local organisation.
Commander Points	Commander throughput	Extra gold and resources do not bypass the local commander rate.

Sacred recruitment adds a fifth gate: Holy Points. Limited recruits may add a sixth: a unit-specific cap.

Commander Point ladder

```
ordinary Commander Points = 1 base + current fort bonus
```

Location	Total CP
Unfortified province or Palisades	1
Fortress or Castle	2
Citadel or Grand Citadel	3

Multi-point commanders accumulate progress over more than one month when the local pool is too small. `#slowrec` changes the commander's cost rather than increasing or decreasing the province pool. AI difficulty bonuses do not modify Commander Points or Holy Points.

Queue behaviour

- Gold must be available when the order is placed.
- A shortage of resources or Recruitment Points can leave units queued for a later month.
- Sacred units can remain queued behind the Holy Point limit.
- A province can hold at most 250 queued units.
- Commander recruitment uses Commander Points; some commanders cost more than one point.
- Recruitment occurs at hosting step 3. A unit appearing then can defend that month but cannot receive a new strategic order until the next order phase.

Upkeep

The manual's ordinary monthly rule is:

```
ordinary gold-recruited unit upkeep = gold cost / 15
sacred or slave upkeep = gold cost / 30
```

Most summoned units have no upkeep. Exceptions can be assigned additional upkeep. The in-game unit panel commonly presents annual upkeep, equal to twelve monthly charges.

Versioned 6.33 observations establish that Sacred and Slave reductions stack, producing gold cost divided by 60, and that mounted upkeep uses separate rider and mount bases. Patch review through 6.36 finds no later general change. These rules are Community-tested rather than official manual wording. Shapechanged upkeep and fractional monthly aggregation remain unresolved.

Observed annual entries for 7- and 16-gold ordinary units are 6 and 13. Those samples exclude simply flooring the final annual decimal, but do not establish how monthly fractions reach the treasury. Use the Income Overview when the margin is one gold.

Upkeep resolves at step 41, after income at step 38. A nation can spend down to a narrow treasury during the order phase and rely on that month's income for upkeep. Any interruption to income can turn that small margin into desertion.

Supplies and starvation

Population supply

Population band	Base supply
First 15,000	1 supply per 30 population
Above 15,000	1 supply per 60 population

Growth or Death modifies this value first. Heat or Cold modifies it second.

Fort supply projection

```
Supply from a fort =
(Administration x 6) / (distance + 1)
```

The maximum distance is four provinces. Where several forts are in range, only the highest fort contribution is used.

The manual's printed multiplier table and one worked example instead follow `(Administration x 4)/(distance + 1)`. Another official adjacent-province example agrees with the multiplier of six. The current community reference follows six, but distance scaling remains scheduled for a versioned test.

Supply usage

- Size 0 uses no supply.
- Size 1 and Size 2 use one-half supply.
- Larger units normally use Size minus 2.
- Animals use half the ordinary amount.
- A mounted unit consumes supply for both rider and mount.
- Nature magic indirectly contributes 10 supply per path level.
- Update 6.35 fixed stale Supply Usage after magic-item changes; recheck the displayed total after changing relevant equipment.

Starvation

When usage exceeds available supplies, units whose combined usage is approximately the deficit are selected to starve.

State	Effect
First month selected	Starving condition, -4 morale, 5% disease chance
Selected while already starving	50% disease chance
Appropriate survival skill	50% chance to avoid starvation; a further 50% chance to avoid disease

State	Effect
Supply restored	Starving ends; existing disease remains

Starvation resolves at step 40, after battles. It usually becomes a problem for the next battle, although disease or an existing Starving condition may already be causing harm.

Need Not Eat is the explicit immunity tag. Official update 6.18 confirms that transformation into a non-eating form removes Starving. Supply consumption and starvation eligibility are distinct: some objects can consume supplies while remaining unable to starve. Commanders are commonly reported to receive feeding priority, but generic commander immunity is not established.

Fortification table

Each cost and time is for that upgrade stage. Statistics replace the previous fort's values; they do not stack.

Fort	Gold	Months	Admin	Commander Points	Recruitment bonus	Siege storage	Wall
Palisades	1,000	5	15	+0	+50%	150	200
Fortress	600	3	30	+1	+75%	750	500
Castle	600	3	45	+1	+100%	2,500	1,000
Citadel	600	3	60	+2	+125%	7,500	1,500
Grand Citadel	1,000	5	70	+2	+150%	10,000	2,000

The standard maximum is Fortress in the Early Age, Castle in the Middle Age, and Citadel in the Late Age. Primitive or advanced national fort access and the Mason ability can alter this.

Buildings

Building	Standard cost	Constructor	Principal functions
Fort	Stage-specific	Any commander	Protection, resources, supply projection, income through Administration, recruitment bonuses
Temple	600 gold	Sacred commander	Dominion spread, preaching bonus, Blood Sacrifice access where applicable
Laboratory	600 gold	Mage	Research, rituals, national gem/item pool, site functions that require a lab

Nation and terrain exceptions can change these costs.

Construction completes at hosting step 35. A lab finished this month cannot enable step-2 research, step-5 forging, or step-10 rituals during the same month. A temple finishes after preaching and Throne claims. A fort finishes after recruitment and all ordinary battles.

Any commander can demolish a fort or laboratory in one month. Temples cannot be demolished by order; an enemy temple is automatically destroyed when its province is conquered. A fort cannot be demolished while under siege.

Siege calculation

```
reduction strength = Strength squared
repair strength = Strength squared / 2
```

Modifiers:

- Flying doubles reduction or repair contribution.
- Mindless defenders contribute one-eighth of calculated repair.
- Animals contribute half repair.
- Undisciplined units contribute half repair.
- Only commanders and units assigned to Maintain Siege contribute.
- Castle Guards and Wall Defenders add repair strength.

The difference between total reduction and repair damages or restores the wall, never above its original integrity. A fort not under siege repairs fully. The defender sees exact wall integrity; an attacker normally receives only a descriptive estimate.

A storm order becomes available after the wall has reached zero and the next order phase opens. Storming resolves after conventional movement battles, so a relief force can defeat or weaken the besiegers before the gate battle.

Supply inside a siege

```
fort supply this siege month =
Supply Storage / consecutive siege turn
```

A fort with 300 storage supplies 300, 150, 100, 75, and 60 during the first five consecutive siege months. This storage concerns units inside the besieged fort. Administration's supply projection is a different system.

Province Defence

The first PD point is free. Buying each later point costs gold equal to the level being purchased.

```
cumulative cost to PD n =
n(n + 1)/2 - 1
```

PD	Total gold	Notes
1	0	First commander and troops
6	20	Cheap raid tax; roster quality still matters
10	54	Official additional-benefit threshold
15	119	Stealth detection begins
20	209	Additional troop and commander types
25	324	Patrol strength 11
30	464	Expensive static commitment
40	819	Usually a specialised defence decision
50	1,274	Severe opportunity cost
100	5,049	Hard maximum

Every full 10 PD reduces unrest by 1 each turn. Beginning at PD 15, patrol strength equals `PD - 14`; the manual's example gives PD 25 a patrol strength of 11.

PD costs no upkeep and fully returns after a battle if control is retained. It cannot be voluntarily reduced. It requires 10 population per point and is reduced at hosting step 61 when population cannot support it. Capture wipes existing PD. Relinquishing a province in a disciple game reduces it by 25%.

PD is a local delay mechanism and raid tax, not a mobile army. Its national roster, magic support, terrain, attacker's script, and retreat situation determine its actual combat value.

Magic sites and gems

- Forests, wastes, deep seas, and several unusual terrains tend to have more sites; plains and farms tend to have fewer.
- Hidden sites have difficulty 1 through 4.
- A searching mage finds sites in a path up to that mage's path level.
- Path level 4 is the highest needed for ordinary manual searching.
- Path-search rituals reveal every site of their path in the target province.
- Acashic Knowledge reveals every magic site there.
- A site may provide gems, gold, recruits, entry orders, discounts, unrest, disease, or other effects.
- Harmful site effects can operate while the site is undiscovered.
- A captured national recruitment site may continue to yield gems without granting its former nation's special recruits.
- Some site recruitment requires a laboratory.

Search orders resolve at step 14. Site effects resolve at step 44. Discovery does not retroactively create earlier recruitment or ritual orders.

Blood Hunting

For an ordinary hunter, the manual gives three checks:

```
Blood success chance = 10% + 30% x Blood level
Population success chance = population / 75 percent
Unrest failure chance = unrest / 4 percent
```

If all checks succeed:

```
slaves found = d6 + Blood level
unrest gained = d(slaves x 3 + 4)
```

If any check fails, no slaves are found and unrest rises by `d6 - 1`.

Population reaches a 100% nominal population check at 7,500. A Blood 3 hunter reaches a 100% nominal Blood check. Unrest can still cause failure. Site frequency changes the average yield by 0.5 slaves for every five percentage points away from 50%. Strong friendly dominion reduces the risk of hostile commoners attacking; the manual states that dominion 10 makes such resistance almost disappear.

Blood Hunting is not free gem generation. It converts mage-turns, population, patrol labour, gold income, and attention into slaves.

Scale effects used in economic calculations

The current unmodded 6.36 baseline uses the following ordinary per-step effects. Growth and Death use the newer official Modding Manual default rather than the stale one-percent entry in the revision-2 main manual.

Scale step	Income	Resources	Recruitment Points	Supplies	Population
Order	+3%	+2%	+10%	-	-
Turmoil	-3%	-2%	-10%	-	-
Productivity	+3%	+15%	-	-	-
Sloth	-3%	-15%	-	-	-
Heat/Cold away from preference	-5%	-	-	-10%	-
Growth	+2%	-	-	+10%	+0.2% per month
Death	-2%	-	-	-10%	-0.2% per month

Evidence boundary:

- Modding Manual 6.34 defines the unmodded `#deathincome` default as 2. No official announcement through 6.36 changes that general default. The current baseline uses 2% income per Growth/Death step; the revision-2 main-manual entry remains only as a documented older conflict.
- The revision-2 main manual gives Order/Turmoil resources as 2% per step, and no later official announcement changes it. Unsourced three-percent tables are not used as current evidence.

Exact integer rounding remains unresolved. A calculation near an integer boundary should still defer to the displayed in-game province value.

Active mod economy deltas

The exact supplied files define the combined ruleset as Dominions Enhanced 2.16 loaded before Divinitus 1.15.3 DE.

Dominions Enhanced changes these global values:

Global rule	Unmodded source value	DE 2.16
Order/Turmoil income per step	3%	4%
Productivity/Sloth income per step	3%	4%
Growth/Death income per step	2%	2%
Growth/Death population change per step	0.2%	0.25%
Fortune/Misfortune event frequency per step	5%	7%

Divinitus does not redefine those five global commands, so its later load position does not reset them.

Both mods contain many object-, site-, event-, item-, unit-, and nation-specific economic effects. A global table cannot safely predict a specific nation until its roster and source overrides are examined.

Order-writing audit

Before submission:

- Check the treasury after both recruitment and construction.
- Check projected upkeep against income, including isolated provinces.
- Scan local resources and Recruitment Points for greyed-out queues.
- Check Commander Points and Holy Points separately from troop capacity.
- Trace tax lines from vulnerable provinces to a friendly fort.
- Compare army Supply Usage against both the destination and every likely battle province.

- Inspect unrest in recruiting and income-critical provinces.
- Confirm that new infrastructure is not being treated as operational one step too early.
- Distinguish the province outside a fort from the fort interior.
- Confirm which siege commanders remain on Maintain Siege.
- Recalculate PD cost cumulatively rather than valuing only the next point.
- Check whether a site search, Blood Hunt, patrol, or research assignment consumes the mage-turn needed elsewhere.

After hosting:

- Read battle and event reports before changing queues.
- Check for recruitment that remained queued.
- Compare treasury income and upkeep totals.
- Inspect new unrest before projecting the next month's income.
- Check supply, Starving, disease, and attritions on every large army.
- Recheck tax traces and besieged forts.
- Record new sites and whether their benefits require a lab.
- Check wall condition from the correct side's available information.
- Confirm unsupported PD reductions in depopulated provinces.

Source note and unresolved tests

Official core: Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, especially pages 21-29, 51-57, and 71-72. Global defaults: Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34. Mod values: exact source of `DomEnhanced2_16.dm` and `Divinitus_1.15.3_DE.dm`. Official plus current community evidence: ordinary Commander Point base behaviour, sacred-and-slave upkeep stacking, and mounted upkeep decomposition. Community details retained provisionally: exact unrest reductions to Recruitment Points and Commander Points, and generic commander feeding priority.

Priority reproductions:

1. Recruitment Point rounding at population-band and scale boundaries.
2. Fort supply at distance zero through four.
3. Resource rounding and overlapping fort draw.
4. Shapechanged upkeep and fractional monthly aggregation.
5. Unrest effects on Recruitment Points and Commander Points.
6. Commander feeding priority and starvation eligibility.

Growth/Death income and Order/Turmoil resources are resolved at 2% per step, and the ordinary Commander Point ladder is closed. Future tests of those values are regression checks, not prerequisites for using the published baseline.

DOCUMENT 4 OF 16

Foundation Book II: Economy, Provinces, and the Machinery of State

Why the economy needs its own book

Dominions 6 presents its economy as a row of numbers: gold, gems, resources, Recruitment Points, supplies, population, unrest, and upkeep. Those numbers do not all work in the same way. Some are national, some belong to one province, some vanish unused, and others can be saved indefinitely. A few are not spendable resources at all; they limit how quickly something else can be turned into useful power.

This is why the richest nation can still fail to raise an army. It is also why a poor province can decide a war by preserving tax trace, feeding a siege, or shortening a reinforcement route. Book II follows those connections from the province screen to the wider war effort. Ordinary play comes first, followed by the formulas, edge cases, and source disputes needed for closer work.

> Foundation rule: Economic value is not the number printed beside a province. It is the useful power that can be converted from that province, through the available infrastructure, before an opponent can interrupt the conversion.

Edition note

Book I defines the common Dominions 6.36 baseline and evidence labels. Book II relies mainly on the revision-2 manual and Modding Manual 6.34. Where those official documents disagree, both readings remain visible. Book IX owns the exact DE and Divinitus definitions; only their economic consequences are repeated here.

The Edition 23 revision returns to R-008 and R-010 through R-013 without opening another economy volume. It separates every known rounding stage, turns the community unrest wording into explicit candidate thresholds, records what the annual upkeep observations do and do not prove, bounds the two printed fort-supply systems, and incorporates the official 6.35 Supply Usage refresh correction. No uncertain engine rule has been promoted merely because one interpretation is convenient.

A sensible way through

For a first campaign, begin with the economic model, province anatomy, recruitment gates, supply, and infrastructure. The formula sections, PD curves, siege economics, Blood opportunity costs, and diagnostic ratios are there for closer planning. Source conflicts and controlled tests can be left until a disputed number actually matters.

Part I: The Economic Model

Dominions as a game of conversion

Territory is not victory by itself. Territory provides inputs which can be converted into military and magical effects:

```
population and scales
-> gold, supplies, and recruitment capacity

terrain and forts
-> resources, infrastructure, and strategic position

gold and local capacity
-> troops, commanders, buildings, and province defence

labs, mage-turns, and research
-> spells, items, rituals, summons, and battlefield packages

sites and blood hunting
-> gems and blood slaves

armies, magic, information, and diplomacy
-> territory, forts, thrones, and denial

thrones and survival
-> victory
```

Every arrow takes time. Every conversion can be interrupted. Much of expert play consists of identifying which arrow is currently limiting the nation.

Stock, flow, capacity, and position

Four categories keep economic discussions clear.

Category	Meaning	Examples
Stock	A resource saved for future use	Treasury gold, gems, blood slaves, forged items
Flow	A recurring gain or loss	Monthly income, gem income, upkeep, population growth
Capacity	A local or national limit on conversion	Resources, Recruitment Points, Commander Points, Holy Points, mage-turns
Position	Map state that makes conversion possible or safe	Fort network, tax trace, laboratory access, supply reach, defensible borders

Economic mistakes often begin by treating one category as another. Resources do not accumulate, so they are not a stock. A large treasury does not create recruitment capacity. A fort has a price, but it also changes strategic position and several local limits. A mage is a unit and a recurring choice about how to spend a mage-turn.

National and local resources

Resource or limit	Scope	Accumulates?	Portable?	Principal uses
Gold	National treasury	Yes	Effectively national	Recruitment, buildings, PD, mercenaries, some rituals and events
Magic gems	National pool and commanders	Yes	Transferable through labs, commanders, and messages	Rituals, forging, combat magic, empowerment

Resource or limit	Scope	Accumulates?	Portable?	Principal uses
Blood slaves	National pool and commanders	Yes	Transferable, but with distinct handling	Blood rituals, forging, battle magic, sacrifice
Resources	Province	No	No	Equipping recruits
Recruitment Points	Province	No	No	Ordinary troop throughput
Commander Points	Province	No	No	Commander throughput
Holy Points	Nation/local sacred queue interaction	Refreshes	No direct transfer	Sacred recruitment
Supplies	Province and army situation	No strategic stock, except siege storage and temporary pillage food	Army uses local supply	Sustaining units
Population	Province	Changes over time	No	Income, Recruitment Points, supplies, PD support, Blood Hunting
Mage-turns	Commander-time	No	Commander can move	Research, site search, forging, rituals, Blood Hunting, combat

The table explains why "What can the nation afford?" is incomplete. The more useful question is:

> What can be paid for, recruited at the correct location, led, supplied, scripted, and delivered before the relevant deadline?

The binding constraint

Production is governed by the tightest active limit.

Suppose a fort has:

- 1,000 gold available nationally;
- 120 local resources;
- 80 local Recruitment Points;
- one available Commander Point;
- three Holy Points.

A 10-gold, 5-resource, 10-RP troop is not limited by gold or resources. It is limited to eight by Recruitment Points. A 100-gold commander that costs two Commander Points cannot be recruited there even though the treasury is sufficient. A sacred costing one Holy Point can be limited to three even when every local pool remains.

The bottleneck can change when the recruit mix changes. Adding an expensive armoured unit may convert an RP-limited queue into a resource-limited one. Adding a cheap commander may consume the Commander Point needed for the mage who makes the fort strategically valuable.

Bottleneck audit

For every major recruitment centre:

1. Identify the desired troop and commander package.
2. Calculate gold, resources, Recruitment Points, Commander Points, and Holy Points separately.
3. Find the first exhausted pool.
4. Ask whether a different mix uses otherwise stranded capacity.

5. Compare the value of expanding capacity against building another centre.

This is more accurate than optimising a single "gold efficiency" statistic.

Opportunity cost

The true cost of an action includes the best alternative foregone.

Examples:

- A 600-gold laboratory is also troops not recruited this month.
- A searching mage is research not produced.
- A Blood Hunter is research, forging, or ritual work not performed.
- Province Defence is permanent local defence, but the same gold could have become a mobile army.
- A fort under construction ties up a commander and delays military spending before its benefits begin.
- A mage carrying gems into battle makes those gems unavailable for a ritual and risks losing them.

Opportunity cost changes with time. A laboratory that delays the first expansion party may be disastrous; the same laboratory may be essential once the province's recruitable mage or site income becomes relevant.

Economic tempo

An investment is measured by more than eventual return.

```
payback time =
investment cost / recurring net gain
```

This simple ratio is useful but incomplete. Dominions adds:

- construction delay;
- commander-turn cost;
- risk of capture;
- military value during payback;
- capacity unlocked;
- strategic location;
- the possibility that the game ends before repayment.

A fort may never repay its gold through Administration income alone yet still be a strong investment because it recruits mages, concentrates resources, projects supply, protects a laboratory, delays an invasion, and creates a tax-trace anchor.

Part II: Provinces, Terrain, and Population

A province is a bundle of systems

A province can contain:

- one or more terrain types;
- population;
- potential and available resources;

- income;
- supplies;
- dominion and scales;
- unrest;
- corpses;
- Province Defence;
- a fort, temple, and laboratory;
- discovered and undiscovered sites;
- recruitable independent or national units;
- commanders and armies;
- partial ownership between the exterior and a besieged fort.

The printed income number is only one part of the province's value.

Provincial roles

Role	What makes it valuable
Income province	High population, favourable scales, low unrest, tax trace, Administration
Production province	High potential resources, strong fort draw, suitable national roster
Mage centre	Valuable commander roster, lab, Commander Points, safety
Logistics node	Fort supply reach, roads or movement position, defensible route
Site province	Gem income, recruit access, discounts, ritual or entry functions
Blood province	Sufficient population, patrol capacity, acceptable economic sacrifice
Buffer province	Raid tax, warning time, retreat geometry, denial
Throne province	Ascension value, special throne effects, strategic obligation

One province may fill several roles. Its correct investment level depends on the most important role, not on a universal province template.

Corpses as provincial stock

Unburied corpses are a local provincial stock. They are not gold, population, supplies, or units waiting to be recruited, but several Death effects and reanimation orders can convert them into value. The revision-2 manual names Raven Feast and the raising of undead as ordinary examples.

The stock is deliberately concealed from most observers. Its number is visible when a Death mage or undead priest is present in the province. A nation's ordinary priests can also see it when those priests possess national reanimation. Ermor's Ashen Empire dominion supplies a broader special exception by sensing unburied corpses in covered provinces.

Question	Current verified answer
What does the number represent?	Unburied corpses currently available in the province.
Who normally sees it?	A Death mage or undead priest in the province.
Which ordinary priests can see it?	Priests of a nation whose normal priests can reanimate undead.
What consumes it directly?	Reanimating Soulless reduces the available corpse count; corpse-dependent spells and abilities may have their own rules.
What does not require this stock?	Ordinary Longdead reanimation has no corpse limit under the manual's basic distinction.

Question	Current verified answer
Is every battlefield death guaranteed to add one usable corpse?	No general one-for-one rule is stated. Corpse eligibility has changed through patches, so the casualty total is not a safe substitute for the visible stock.
Is a universal decay rate documented?	No general monthly decay formula is stated in the current official foundation sources used here.

The last two limits matter. Version 6.08 specifically changed humanoid apes and dogs so that they leave corpses when killed. That official correction shows that corpse production depends on unit eligibility rather than on a universal "one dead body equals one corpse" rule. Until an exact current production table is available, battle losses should be treated as a clue, not as an exact corpse forecast.

Corpse-dependent conversions

The manual separates three common reanimation economies:

- Ghouls convert living population into undead, reducing the population left behind.
- Soulless convert unburied corpses and reduce the local corpse stock.
- Longdead can be reanimated without a stated population or corpse ceiling.

Asphodel uses a different branch. Human inhabitants or dead human corpses permit a chance of Manikins and Mandragoras; when those are unavailable, animal-based carrion creatures remain possible. This is a national conversion rule, not a universal reanimation formula.

Operationally, a corpse-dependent plan needs four checks:

1. a legal commander, spell, or ability;
2. visibility or another reliable reason to believe the local stock exists;
3. the correct province at the relevant order or ritual step;
4. a comparison between consuming the stock now and reserving it for a stronger conversion later.

Book X's special-order reference owns the order-entry procedure. Exact spells and summoned objects remain in the Book XII data layer. Book II owns the economic reading: corpses are hidden, local, exhaustible in some uses, and valuable only through a legal converter.

Terrain

The manual characterises terrain by broad tendencies:

Terrain	Population tendency	Resource tendency	Site tendency
Plains	Neutral	Neutral	Neutral
Mountain Ranges	Neutral	Excellent	Many
Forest	Low	High	Many
Highlands	Low	High	Neutral
Swamp	Very low	Neutral	Many
Waste	Extremely low	Neutral	Abundant
Farm	Very high	Low	Few
River	High	Neutral	Neutral
Sea	Low	Neutral	Neutral

Terrain	Population tendency	Resource tendency	Site tendency
Deep Sea	Very low	High	Many
Kelp Forest	High	Neutral	Neutral
Gorge	Low	High	Abundant
Cave	Low	Neutral	Neutral
Drip Cave	Neutral	Excellent	Neutral
Crystal Cave	Very low	High	Abundant
Forest Cave	High	Neutral	Many

Multiple terrain types can coexist and their effects add. Terrain also affects movement, survival skills, combat environments, national recruitment, building costs, site pools, and the boundary between land and underwater systems.

Strategic reading of terrain

Farms often deserve protection because their population supports income, supply, and recruitment capacity. Highlands, forests, mountains, and special caves often make stronger production or search targets. Wastes and unusual terrain may be economically poor in gold yet rich in site opportunity.

This creates a recurring division:

- population-rich terrain funds the state;
- resource-rich terrain equips the army;
- site-rich terrain may fund magic;
- movement terrain determines whether any of that value can be defended.

Population

Population supplies four fundamental systems:

1. base income;
2. Recruitment Points;
3. provincial supplies;
4. support for Province Defence.

It is also consumed or damaged by:

- Death scales and extreme temperatures;
- pillaging;
- some forms of patrolling;
- Blood Hunting and related events;
- hostile dominions and special national effects;
- sites, spells, and random events.

Population is slow capital. A temporary gold gain purchased with permanent population loss can weaken income, recruitment, supply, and PD support for the remainder of the game.

Growth and decline

The current unmodded 6.36 baseline gives ordinary Growth as:

- population growth of 0.2% per month per step;

- 10% additional supplies per step;
- 2% additional income per step.

Death reverses those values.

The revision-2 main-manual scale table prints 1% income per step, but the newer official Modding Manual 6.34 defines the unmodded `#deathincome` default as 2. No version 6.35 announcement alters that default. The newer explicit default governs this edition; the old one-percent value remains useful only for identifying stale guides. Dominions Enhanced 2.16 also sets the income change to 2%, while changing population movement to 0.25% per scale step.

Compounding

Population growth compounds:

```
future population =
current population x (1 + monthly rate)^months
```

The formula illustrates scale, but practical forecasting must account for integer rounding, changing candles and scales, events, patrolling, pillage, and hostile effects.

Growth affects the present month and the province's longer future. Its value rises with:

- early control of populous provinces;
- a long expected game;
- stable dominion;
- protection from raiding and pillage;
- units and forts that can use the resulting recruitment and supply.

Death or destructive economy can still be strategically rational for nations whose population contributes little, whose dominion deliberately kills population, or whose power spike is intended to end the game before the long-term loss dominates.

Tax trace and the administrative map

Official rule: a province produces no income for the turn if it cannot trace an unbroken chain of friendly provinces to a friendly fort. Disciples can trace through allied provinces.

Tax trace creates an economic network:

- forts are collection anchors;
- friendly province chains are conduits;
- raiding can disconnect rather than merely steal;
- a single captured bridge province can suppress the income of a whole pocket;
- recovering the chain before step 38 can restore collection that month.

The system makes map topology economically meaningful. A low-income corridor can protect the income of several rich provinces.

Tax-cut warfare

A raid should be evaluated by total denied value:

```
raid value =
direct province denial
+ disconnected income
+ queue disruption
+ commander attention
```

```
+ movement distortion
+ information gained
- raider losses
- opportunity cost
```

The direct income printed on the raided province may be the smallest term.

Part III: Gold, Income, and Upkeep

Income formula

The official main-manual formula is:

```
base income = population / 100

modified income =
(population / 100)
x dominion-scale modifiers
x (1 + fort Administration / 200)

final income =
modified income / (1 + unrest x 0.02)
```

The province display reports the already modified number.

Administration

Administration increases provincial income by half its rating:

Administration	Local income bonus
15	+7.5%
30	+15%
45	+22.5%
60	+30%
70	+35%

The bonus applies to the province containing the fort, not to neighbouring income.

Scale interaction

The manual gives:

- Order/Turmoil: 3% income per step;
- Productivity/Sloth: 3% income per step;
- each temperature step away from preference: -5%;
- Growth/Death: 2% per step under the current official Modding Manual default.

The main manual also contains an example saying Order 2 increases income by 4%, conflicting with its own repeated 3%-per-step tables. The tables are the stronger internal evidence; the example is treated as a likely textual error.

Rounding: formula, display, and treasury

The income formula identifies the factors but not every integer conversion. Three different numbers must be kept apart:

1. the unrounded result of a written formula;
2. the whole number displayed for the province;
3. the amount actually credited to the treasury after all current modifiers and collection rules.

The revision-2 manual does not state whether the engine floors after population, after each scale, after Administration, only at the end, or through some combination of those stages. Community documentation describes the population-derived base as rounded down, but it does not provide a versioned boundary test for the whole chain. R-008 remains open.

For ordinary play, the province display is authoritative. For a forecast near a one-gold boundary, record the displayed value before and after changing exactly one input. Do not reverse-engineer a hidden intermediate from the final integer and then present it as an official rule.

The word rounding conceals several different questions. They should not be allowed to borrow evidence from one another:

Subsystem	What is established	What remains open	Safe operational value
Provincial income	Official factor chain and unrest divisor	Intermediate floors, final conversion, and treasury treatment	Province display and the Income Overview
Resources	One worked donor contribution of 13.8 is reduced to 13	The printed aggregate does not reconcile; fort draw, scale, and unrest stages are not fully ordered	Current province resource pool
Recruitment Points	Official population bands, fort bonus, and Order/Turmoil modifier	Band, modifier, and final integer order	Current spendable RP shown by the recruitment screen
Commander Points	Ordinary pool and multi-month accumulation	Reduction and rounding under unrest	Current commander queue progress
Upkeep	Official monthly divisors and observed annual whole-number entries	Monthly fractional aggregation and desertion boundary	Income Overview, checked after roster or equipment changes
Fort supply	Range and highest-fort rule	Competing official multipliers and final integer conversion	Displayed province supply

A floor observed in a resource example does not prove that income is floored at the same stage. A whole annual upkeep entry does not prove that the treasury discards monthly fractions. Whenever a result can decide a deadline, a calculator should keep three fields: the written decimal, the displayed integer, and the evidence status of the conversion between them.

Unrest is hyperbolic, not linear

Income is divided by `1 + 0.02U`, where `U` is unrest. This has two important consequences:

1. The first unrest points do substantial damage.
2. Each later unrest point removes a smaller fraction of the already reduced income.

Unrest	Multiplier	Income lost
10	0.833	16.7%
25	0.667	33.3%
50	0.500	50.0%
75	0.400	60.0%

Unrest	Multiplier	Income lost
100	0.333	66.7%
200	0.200	80.0%

Unrest 100 is more severe than the income multiplier suggests because it also stops recruitment.

Income timing

Income is hosting step 38.

Before income:

- ordinary battles and storming have resolved;
- random events and several late battles have resolved;
- buildings complete at step 35;
- pillage resolves at step 37.

After income:

- ordinary unrest alterations resolve at step 39;
- starvation resolves at step 40;
- upkeep resolves at step 41.

This timing means:

- a province captured through ordinary movement can pay its new owner that month if collection conditions are met;
- pillage can damage the same month's income;
- patrol and Order reductions at step 39 usually improve the next month's income, not the current collection;
- upkeep can use the income collected moments earlier.

Treasury discipline

The treasury must cover several different horizons:

Horizon	Typical commitments
Immediate order phase	Recruitment, buildings, PD, mercenary bids, gold-cost rituals or events
Hosting income step	Expected provincial income after conquest, trace, pillage, and unrest
Hosting upkeep step	Recurring unit and commander costs
Contingency reserve	Emergency recruitment, fort repair decisions, diplomacy, unexpected events

Planning to exactly zero before uncertain income is a risk decision. The danger is highest when:

- tax traces are exposed;
- capitals or rich forts may be besieged;
- unrest is rising;
- pillage or raiding is expected;
- mercenary contracts or events can change expenditure;
- a large sacred or cavalry force obscures the apparent upkeep calculation.

Upkeep

The manual states:

```
ordinary upkeep = gold cost / 15 per month
sacred or slave upkeep = gold cost / 30 per month
```

Most summoned units are exempt. Some exceptions carry additional upkeep.

Annual display

The detailed unit interface commonly displays annual upkeep:

```
annual upkeep = monthly upkeep x 12
```

A 30-gold ordinary unit costs 2 gold per month and displays 24 per year.

Sacred slaves

The manual says Sacred units and Slaves each pay half upkeep. A current-game discussion published on 21 December 2025, under the 6.33 release, identifies their interaction explicitly: the two reductions stack, producing a divisor of 60. The R'lyeh Slave Priest is the clean example because the current structured row carries both the Sacred and Slave tags.

```
sacred slave upkeep = gold cost / 60 per month
```

The official announcements for 6.34 through 6.36 contain no general upkeep change. The stacking rule is published here as Community-tested under 6.33; current through 6.36 by patch review. It is not wording taken from the revision-2 manual.

Mounted upkeep is component-based

A mounted card can hide more than one upkeep basis. Rider and mount are separate objects, and each component keeps its own base cost and its own Sacred or Slave status. The visible recruitment price is consequently not always enough to reconstruct upkeep.

The 6.33 observation gives a direct check:

Mounted card	Rider basis	Mount basis	Observed annual split	Total annual upkeep
Logrian Cavalry	10 ordinary	20 ordinary	8 + 16	24

The pinned 6.35 object snapshot supplies further examples of the underlying component structure:

Mounted card	Rider object	Mount object	Consequence
Mouflon Cataphract	base-cost adjustment 15, Slave	base-cost adjustment 25, not Slave	the Slave reduction applies to the rider, not automatically to the mount
Sacred Serpent Cataphract	base-cost adjustment 15, Sacred	base-cost adjustment 30, Sacred	both components receive their own Sacred reduction
Logrian Cavalry	base-cost adjustment 10, ordinary	base-cost adjustment 20, ordinary	the component total reproduces the observed 24 gold per year

These examples do not establish a universal shortcut from the displayed recruitment price. They establish the opposite: inspect both component cards when cavalry upkeep matters. Patch 6.31 also fixed mounts that could desert separately when the treasury was empty, further confirming that mount state participates in economic resolution even though that bug does not define the upkeep formula.

Added upkeep and shape changes

The Modding Manual defines `#addupkeep` as increasing the gold basis used for upkeep. It belongs to the object that carries it. Mounted objects need to be checked component by component; one combined modifier should not be applied to the whole recruitment card.

Shapechanged upkeep remains unresolved. The manuals define many shape relations and advise fixed gold costs for shapechanging Pretenders, but they do not say which form supplies the monthly upkeep basis for every temporary, voluntary, seasonal, death, or world shape. A current transformation matrix must compare the Income Overview before and after each shape class. Until then, a transformed commander's visible annual entry is the operational value. R-010 remains in progress.

Reading the annual line

The December 2025 observation also records ordinary annual values of 6 for a 7-gold unit and 13 for a 16-gold unit. Those are consistent with multiplying monthly upkeep by twelve and displaying a whole number. The sample does not distinguish every possible rounding rule, and the national treasury may retain fractional liabilities that the annual line hides. Annual display rounding must not be reused as proof of monthly treasury rounding.

The same observation gives enough cases to exclude one tempting shortcut:

Ordinary gold basis	Exact monthly formula	Exact annual equivalent	Observed annual line	What the observation proves
7	7/15	5.6	6	The annual line is not simply floored at the end
10	10/15	8.0	8	Exact integers survive unchanged
16	16/15	12.8	13	The annual line is not simply floored at the end

These cases are compatible with ordinary nearest-integer rounding and with a ceiling rule; they do not distinguish between them. Nor do they reveal whether twelve fractional monthly charges are accumulated precisely, rounded as a group, or represented through another internal unit. The annual line is a readable estimate of burden, while the treasury change remains the decisive measurement for a zero-margin budget.

Upkeep as force structure

Upkeep does more than tax army size. It decides which forces can remain permanently mobilised.

- Gold-recruited elite armies preserve battlefield quality but continually consume income.
- Summoned forces shift the burden toward gems and mage-turns.
- Sacred troops can be capital- or Holy-limited but cheaper to maintain.
- Militia-like troops may be cheap to recruit yet expensive relative to their battlefield effect.
- Commanders, scouts, priests, and logistical specialists add recurring cost without always appearing in a front-line count.

The relevant comparison is lifecycle cost:

```
lifecycle gold cost =
recruitment cost
+ expected months of upkeep
+ replacement and support cost
```

A unit that survives for thirty months can cost far more through upkeep than through recruitment.

Part IV: Resources and Recruitment

Resources are local industrial capacity

Resources represent the materials and labour needed to equip recruits. They:

- belong to a province;
- refresh each month;
- do not stockpile;
- cannot be moved through the treasury;
- are spent only by local recruitment.

Unused resources are lost opportunity, not saved wealth.

Potential and available resources

An unfortified province uses half its potential resources locally. A fort:

1. raises the host province to its full local potential;
2. draws its Administration percentage from eligible neighbouring provinces' potential resources.

Unrest then reduces availability:

```
final resources =
resources / (1 + unrest x 0.01)
```

At unrest 100, half remain, but recruitment is prohibited entirely.

Fort resource draw

The manual's restrictions are exact:

- land cannot draw from sea, nor sea from land;
- a neighbouring province with a fort does not contribute;
- an enemy province does not contribute;
- eligible shared neighbours can contribute to more than one fort.

The manual's worked example demonstrates that draw uses the neighbour's potential resources, not the half-sized pool visible in an unfortified neighbour.

Production geometry

A production fort should be evaluated by:

```
fort resource value =
full local potential
+ Administration% of each eligible adjacent potential
- expected disruption
```

Expected disruption includes:

- future adjacent forts removing donors;
- hostile raids changing ownership;
- unrest;
- land/sea boundaries;
- a roster unable to use the extra resources;
- supply or gold limits that prevent full production.

Fort spacing

Dense fort networks increase recruitment sites, Commander Points, laboratories, siege resistance, and tax anchors. They can also remove resource draw between adjacent fortified provinces.

This is not a simple argument for wide spacing. The correct spacing balances:

- mage production;
- troop production;
- resource donors;
- travel time;
- defensibility;
- supply projection;
- capital and Throne protection;
- the expected duration of the game.

Recruitment Points

Recruitment Points model the province's ability to organise ordinary troop production.

Start at 20, then add population-band contributions:

```
RP(population) =
20
+ min(pop, 5,000) / 100
+ min(max(pop - 5,000, 0), 5,000) / 200
+ min(max(pop - 10,000, 0), 10,000) / 300
+ min(max(pop - 20,000, 0), 20,000) / 400
+ max(pop - 40,000, 0) / 500
```

The fort's recruitment bonus is applied afterward. Order or Turmoil changes the result by 10% per step.

Population examples before fort and scales

Population	Calculation	Recruitment Points before rounding
0	20	20
1,000	20 + 1,000/100	30
5,000	20 + 5,000/100	70
6,000	20 + 50 + 1,000/200	75
10,000	20 + 50 + 5,000/200	95
20,000	20 + 50 + 25 + 10,000/300	128.33
40,000	prior + 20,000/400	178.33
50,000	prior + 10,000/500	198.33

The declining contribution per additional inhabitant means population has diminishing marginal effect on RP even while remaining valuable for income and supplies.

Official-versus-historical conflict

Older community pages preserve a different formula with a lower base and different population bands. Foundation Book II uses the revision-2 main manual formula. Historical formulas must not be used as proof of current Dominions 6 behaviour.

Rounding

The manual gives formulas and examples but does not fully document every rounding stage:

- population band;
- scale modifier;
- fort bonus;
- final displayed and spendable total.

Until reproduced, calculations should be treated as capacity estimates near fractional boundaries. The interface remains the final operational value.

Commander Points

Commander Points limit local commander production. The current ordinary pool is:

```
Commander Point pool = 1 base point + current fort bonus
```

Recruitment location	Base	Fort bonus	Ordinary total
No fort	1	0	1
Palisades	1	+0	1
Fortress	1	+1	2
Castle	1	+1	2
Citadel	1	+2	3
Grand Citadel	1	+2	3

The fort bonuses are official revision-2 values. The one-point unfortified base and multi-turn accumulation are stated by the current community commander reference, last updated under 6.35; no 6.36 announcement changes the system. This closes R-009 at Official plus Community-tested evidence.

The distinction between the pool and the cost is essential. The Modding Manual defines a simple commander as normally costing one point, permits explicit Recruitment Point costs, and defines `#slowrec` as doubling the Commander Points needed for that commander. A two-point commander in a one-point province is not illegal. The queue invests capacity over multiple months until the cost is met.

```
months to complete, before disruption = ceiling(commander cost / local CP per month)
```

Commander cost	1 CP location	2 CP location	3 CP location
1	1 month	1 month	1 month
2	2 months	1 month	1 month, with 1 point unused for that order

Commander cost	1 CP location	2 CP location	3 CP location
3	3 months	2 months	1 month
4	4 months	2 months	2 months

The table describes an uninterrupted single order. Queue state, a change of recruit, unrest, ownership, or loss of eligibility can alter the actual completion date.

What does not multiply Commander Points

- Fort statistics replace the previous stage; their bonuses do not stack across upgrades.
- AI difficulty bonuses apply to income, resources, ordinary Recruitment Points, and magic, but the manual explicitly excludes commander recruitment rate and Holy Points.
- `#slowrec` changes the commander's cost, not the province's pool.
- A recruitable commander supplied by a site changes roster access; the site commands do not by themselves add Commander Points.
- Unrest is a separate local reduction question retained under R-011.

Commander Points are often the real reason to build a fort. A nation may have enough gold to recruit more mages but no place capable of producing them.

Commander-turn accounting

Gold measures purchase price; Commander Points measure time on the production line. A 400-gold, four-point mage and four 100-gold, one-point commanders may consume the same gold, but they do not create the same schedule. Any comparison should record both:

```
gold per completed commander
commander-months per completed commander
```

A higher fort is most valuable when it changes a roster's calendar: two-point mages every month instead of every second month, or four-point mages every second month instead of every fourth. That throughput can outweigh the fort's direct Administration income.

Holy Points

Sacred recruitment consumes Holy Points in addition to ordinary costs. The manual ties the ordinary sacred recruitment limit to maximum dominion. Temples, national rules, Pretender design, sites, and mod commands can alter the system.

Holy Points create several strategic distinctions:

- a sacred may be affordable but unavailable;
- sacred queues can accumulate behind the cap;
- buying ordinary troops can use local resources and RP left stranded by the Holy limit;
- higher maximum dominion can be both religious resilience and production capacity;
- capital-only sacreds concentrate risk at the capital even when other forts have spare resources.

Queue mechanics and diagnosis

Recruitment orders can fail or wait for different reasons:

Symptom	Likely gate
Unit cannot be added	Insufficient treasury, ineligible location, unrest 100+, or limit reached
Unit remains queued	Resource, RP, Holy Point, or limited-recruit shortage
Commander does not appear	Commander Point shortage, eligibility, gold, or recruitment disruption
Resources remain while queue stalls	RP, Holy, commander, or unit-specific cap
RP remains while queue stalls	Resources, Holy, or local eligibility
Province captured yet recruits fought	Recruitment resolved at step 3 before movement battle
Recruits trapped inside fort	Recruitment completed before siege control changed

The queue should be read as a production plan constrained by several ledgers, not as a single purchase list.

Part V: Unrest and Coercive Economy

What unrest does

Officially, unrest:

- reduces income;
- reduces resources;
- prevents recruitment at 100 or greater;
- reduces Blood Hunting success;
- obstructs patrol detection;
- is capped at the lesser of 500 or population divided by 10.

It can rise through:

- random events;
- spies and agitators;
- Blood Hunting;
- sites;
- targeted spells;
- globals;
- pillaging;
- hostile dominion and special effects.

It can fall through:

- patrolling;
- Province Defence;
- Order;
- sites;
- events;
- other national, unit, or magical effects.

Income and resource damage

```
income multiplier = 1 / (1 + 0.02 x unrest)
resource multiplier = 1 / (1 + 0.01 x unrest)
```

Income is twice as sensitive in the denominator. At unrest 50, the province retains half its income but about two-thirds of its resources.

Recruitment shutdown

At unrest 100, no ordinary units or commanders can be recruited. This creates a production-denial objective:

- unrest attacks can neutralise a fort without breaching its walls;
- Blood Hunting can disable its own patrol and recruitment base;
- a province may still show resources while being unable to recruit;
- reducing unrest at step 39 is too late to restore step-3 recruitment that month.

The unrest cap

```
maximum unrest = min(500, population / 10)
```

A province with zero population cannot retain unrest. Population loss can reduce the numerical cap while destroying nearly every ordinary economic reason to own the province.

Patrolling

The main manual gives individual patrol strength as:

```
individual patrol strength =
(Precision + Map Move) / 20
```

Flying units use 30 in place of Map Move. Commanders are doubled. Undisciplined and Mindless units are halved.

The total search strength is reduced by half the province's unrest, capped at 100, and gains Province Defence patrol strength beginning at PD 15.

The same patrol force must often satisfy several tasks:

- lower unrest;
- protect Blood Hunters;
- discover scouts, spies, and raiders;
- remain strong enough to survive a discovery battle;
- avoid destroying too much population.

High nominal patrol strength is not the same as a safe patrol. A stealth force that is discovered may still defeat the patrol.

Community sub-formulas

Current community documentation describes a multi-stage unrest reduction process involving:

1. a baseline affected by friendly candles and PD;
2. an Order/Turmoil-dependent proportional reduction;
3. patrolling.

It also reports that unrest reduces Recruitment Points and Commander Points by one percent per point, with the Commander Point reduction rounded down. The current page states the result but does not publish a 6.36 boundary table, save, or test setup. The precise breakpoints remain queued under R-011.

That wording admits two materially different readings for a small integer pool: round down the amount lost, or round down the capacity remaining. For a one-point Commander Point pool, the first reading preserves the point until the recruitment shutdown; the second can remove it as soon as unrest rises above zero. The page does not state which intermediate is rounded and does not provide the small-pool observations needed to decide between them.

If the intended community rule is "round down the amount lost," its test predictions are:

Ordinary pool	First predicted loss	Second predicted loss	Capacity before unrest 100
1	Unrest 100	-	1
2	Unrest 50	Unrest 100	1 from unrest 50-99
3	Unrest 34	Unrest 67	1 from unrest 67-99

This is a candidate boundary table, not a promoted game rule. Its value is diagnostic: a single version-labelled observation at one of those thresholds can support or reject the interpretation far more efficiently than an anecdote from a high-unrest province.

This distinction matters most for the tiny Commander Point pool. A one-point rounding decision can change a mage from a one-month recruit into a multi-month project. Until the breakpoints are reproduced, use three tiers of certainty:

Claim	Publication state
Unrest 100 or more prohibits ordinary unit and commander recruitment	Official
Unrest reduces ordinary Recruitment Points before shutdown	Current community reference
Unrest also reduces Commander Points	Current community reference
Exact first-loss threshold for a 1-, 2-, or 3-point pool	Test pending

The recruitment screen is authoritative for orders. A written forecast near an unrest boundary should preserve a spare month rather than assuming the most favourable rounding.

Pillaging and raiding

Pillage:

- raises unrest;
- kills population;
- reduces supplies;
- gives gold and temporary food to the pillaging army;
- becomes stronger with larger, faster, and larger-sized forces;
- particularly favours barbarians and units with Fear.

The temporary supplies last one month.

A Raid combines movement with reduced-strength pillage. It requires a commander with Pillager and an army with Map Move 20 or more. Only Pillager units contribute, at half pillage strength, and the force must win any resulting battle before pillaging succeeds.

Strategic uses

Pillage and raid actions can:

- suppress income before step 38;
- raise a fort province toward recruitment shutdown;
- damage future population and supplies;
- feed an army for the current month;
- force patrols and defensive movement;
- create tax-trace breaks.

They can also destroy value that the attacker expects to conquer. The action is most coherent when denial matters more than future ownership.

Part VI: Supplies, Armies, and Logistics

Supply is a location check

Supply is not a national stock. An army consumes the supply available in its current situation.

The decisive logistical questions are:

- Where will the army be when starvation resolves?
- Which fort projects the highest supply there?
- What scales and population will remain after conquest, battle, and pillage?
- Is the army outside a fort, inside a fort, or trapped in a siege?
- Which units consume supply despite appearing small or inexpensive?

Population-based supply

```
base population supply =
first 15,000 / 30
+ population above 15,000 / 60
```

Growth or Death modifies the result first. Temperature deviation modifies it second.

Population	Base supply before scales
3,000	100
7,500	250
15,000	500
21,000	600
30,000	750

The lower marginal supply above 15,000 mirrors the declining RP value of very large populations.

Fort-based supply

The manual's stated formula is:

```
fort supply =
(Administration x 6) / (Distance + 1)
```

The maximum distance is four. Only the largest nearby fort contribution applies.

Official internal conflict

The same manual also prints a distance multiplier table of 400%, 200%, 133%, 100%, and 80% at distance zero through four. Those percentages correspond to `Administration x 4 / (Distance + 1)`, not the printed multiplier of six. Its worked example gives only 30 supply from an Administration-30 Castle at distance three, agreeing with the table but disagreeing with the formula, which produces 45.

Distance	Printed `Admin x 6` formula for Admin 30	Printed percentage table for Admin 30
0	180	120
1	90	60
2	60	about 40
3	45	30
4	36	24

A second official sentence says an Administration-50 fort contributes 150 to an adjacent province. That agrees with the multiplier-of-six formula at distance one and disagrees with the percentage table. The manual contains two internally coherent calculations, each supported by at least one example.

The current community population reference uses the multiplier-of-six formula and gives a Palisades example at distance two. It is useful corroboration but not a published controlled reproduction across all five distances. R-012 remains open.

These three representations cannot all be correct under the same definition of distance. The safe publication policy is:

- preserve the formula as the stated rule;
- describe the example conflict;
- use the in-game displayed supply for operational orders;
- reproduce every distance from zero through four in 6.36.

For forecasts, the two printed systems can be carried as a documentary interval:

```
lower printed candidate = Administration x 4 / (Distance + 1)
upper printed candidate = Administration x 6 / (Distance + 1)
```

This interval is not a claim that the executable must lie between the two. It is a compact way to expose how much of a supply plan depends on the unresolved multiplier. The disagreement is a constant one-third of the larger candidate, so an army that fits only under `x6` is not safely supplied by the documents alone. The range, the four-province limit, and the rule that only the single highest nearby fort contribution applies are not part of the conflict.

Supply usage

The main manual describes usage by physical size:

Unit	Ordinary supply use
Size 0	0
Size 1-2	0.5
Size 3	1
Size 4	2
Size 5	3
Size 6	4

Animals use half the ordinary amount. Rider and mount both consume supply. Nature magic indirectly contributes 10 supply per path level.

Special abilities, forms, national rules, and modded effects can change ordinary expectations.

Starvation selection and effects

When usage exceeds supply, the engine selects troops whose combined usage is approximately the deficit.

First selection:

- the unit becomes Starving;
- morale falls by 4;
- disease chance is 5%.

Selection while already Starving:

- disease chance rises to 50%.

Appropriate survival skill:

- 50% chance to be completely unaffected;
- a separate 50% chance to avoid disease.

When supply becomes sufficient, Starving ends. Disease does not.

Timing

Starvation resolves at step 40, after all ordinary battles and immediately before upkeep. A newly overextended army normally fights this month's battle without the new Starving condition, then carries the penalty into the next order phase.

This makes starvation a delayed logistical debt. It is easy to ignore after a victory and expensive when the next battle arrives.

Commander uncertainty

Commanders are commonly described as being fed before troops. That is a priority claim, not the same thing as categorical immunity. The main manual does not grant all commanders a general exemption, and no current controlled sample has exhausted the troop pool and shown the commander-selection boundary. Generic commander immunity remains test pending.

The wording fed first is safest read as a ranking within the eligible selection pool. It cannot support never starves: once the deficit exceeds the consumption of lower-priority eligible units, the selection process must either reach commanders, leave part of the deficit unmatched, or apply another undocumented exception. No source in the current evidence set demonstrates which branch occurs. Animals being described as fed last is the same kind of priority claim, not proof that every animal starves before any ordinary troop.

Need Not Eat is the decisive explicit tag

The official Modding Manual gives a firmer rule for individual objects: `#neednoteat` means the monster consumes no supplies and cannot starve. It also explains how to create a creature that still consumes supplies but cannot starve, proving that consumption and starvation eligibility are distinct properties.

The pinned 6.35 object snapshot reinforces that distinction:

- 985 rows carry Need Not Eat;
- 47 rows combine Need Not Eat with Appetite;
- several Undead and Demon rows do not carry the Need Not Eat field explicitly.

Object counts include helpers and non-recruitable forms, so they are not army demographics. Their value is structural: class labels such as Undead, Demon, Inanimate, or commander cannot safely substitute for the actual food and starvation fields.

Official update 6.18 adds the transformation boundary: changing into a non-eating entity removes the Starving condition. The correction does not document the reverse direction, temporary battle shapes, or a universal commander-priority rule. R-013 remains in progress.

Official update 6.35 repaired Supply Usage failing to refresh when magic items were changed. The supply formula did not change, but the correction affects how evidence should be gathered. Screenshots or observations from earlier versions may show a stale usage total after equipment changes. Under the 6.36 baseline, recheck the current Supply Usage after equipping or removing any item that affects size, appetite, supply production, a mount, or a form. The corrected display is the intended operational total, although it still does not prove selection priority.

Logistics audit for unusual units

For any expensive commander, mount, transformed unit, or summoned army, inspect in this order:

1. current Supply Usage;
2. Need Not Eat or Appetite on every component;
3. rider and mount separately;
4. current Starving and Disease conditions;
5. survival skill in the destination terrain;
6. whether a shape change occurred before starvation resolution;
7. the displayed fort and population supply in the destination.

This avoids the two most common category errors: assuming that a unit which consumes supply must be able to starve, and assuming that a unit which cannot starve contributes no supply burden.

Siege supply

A besieged fort uses Supply Storage divided by the number of consecutive siege turns:

```
available interior supply =
storage / siege turn number
```

Example for 300 storage:

Siege turn	Interior supply
1	300
2	150
3	100
4	75
5	60
10	30

This is different from Administration-based supply projection. Storage sustains defenders inside the fort; Administration helps the surrounding province network.

Siege logistics as a clock

Even an unbreached wall can become untenable through:

- falling interior supplies;
- cumulative starvation;
- disease;
- upkeep and lost exterior income;
- inability to recruit or move normally;
- the approach of a storm force.

The fort's wall clock and supply clock should be tracked separately.

Part VII: Infrastructure

Forts, temples, and laboratories

Each building converts a province in a different dimension.

Building	Converts the province into
Fort	A protected recruitment, resource, tax, and logistics node
Temple	A dominion-production and preaching node
Laboratory	A research, ritual, forging, gem, item, and site-access node

The standard temple and laboratory each cost 600 gold. Fort stages have separate costs and times. Nations and terrain can alter all of these.

Construction timing

Buildings complete at hosting step 35.

This is later than:

- research at step 2;
- recruitment at step 3;

- forging at step 5;
- preaching and Throne claims at steps 6-8;
- rituals at step 10;
- site searching at step 14;
- ordinary battles and storming at steps 26-27.

This gives the following results:

- a new lab cannot support research, forging, or ritual casting that month;
- a new temple cannot improve that month's ordinary preaching;
- a new fort cannot expand this month's recruitment or protect against battles already fought;
- infrastructure is operational from the following order phase.

Construction and demolition

Officially:

- any commander can construct a fort;
- a sacred commander is required for a temple;
- a mage is required for a laboratory;
- any commander can demolish a fort or laboratory;
- demolition takes one month;
- temples cannot be demolished by order;
- enemy temples are destroyed automatically upon conquest;
- a fort cannot be demolished while under siege.

The construction order itself consumes the commander's month. The economic cost includes both gold and commander-time.

Standard fort progression

Fort	Stage cost	Stage time	Admin	Commander Points	Recruitment bonus	Storage	Wall
Palisades	1,000	5	15	+0	+50%	150	200
Fortress	600	3	30	+1	+75%	750	500
Castle	600	3	45	+1	+100%	2,500	1,000
Citadel	600	3	60	+2	+125%	7,500	1,500
Grand Citadel	1,000	5	70	+2	+150%	10,000	2,000

Statistics replace the previous stage rather than adding to it.

The standard maximum is:

- Early Age: Fortress;
- Middle Age: Castle;
- Late Age: Citadel.

Primitive and advanced national access can differ. Masons can construct one level above the ordinary national limit. A Grand Citadel requires Citadel access and a Mason.

Fort valuation

A fort can create:

1. full local resource use;
2. adjacent resource draw;
3. local income through Administration;
4. Recruitment Point bonus;
5. Commander Point bonus;
6. regional supply;
7. siege storage;
8. wall integrity and protected interior;
9. national recruitment access;
10. a tax-trace anchor;
11. a secure laboratory or temple location;
12. a movement and reinforcement node.

No single payback formula captures all twelve.

Fort question set

Before construction:

- Which units and commanders become recruitable?
- Which local pool will bind after the fort is complete?
- How many adjacent potential resources are eligible?
- Does another planned fort remove a major donor?
- What tax region will this fort anchor?
- What routes and provinces fall within supply range?
- How many turns until the first new mage or army leaves?
- Can the province be held during construction?
- Is the builder's command-turn scarce?
- What military force is delayed by the gold payment?

Laboratories

Official functions:

- permit Research;
- permit ritual casting;
- permit access to the national pool of gems, slaves, and items;
- serve as gem collection points;
- enable site functions that require a lab.

Laboratories are strategic concentration points. Losing one can strand mages away from the national pool even when the nation still owns gems elsewhere.

Laboratory risk

A lab attracts:

- researchers;
- gems and slaves;
- forged items;
- ritual casters;

- valuable site recruits.

The 600-gold structure can protect assets worth far more than its price. Defence should be based on the value concentrated there, not only the cost of replacing the laboratory.

Temples

Official functions:

- ordinary dominion spread for most nations;
- preaching bonus;
- Blood Sacrifice access where the nation allows it;
- religious and national mechanics tied to temple count or location.

Only one temple can exist in a province. Capture destroys an enemy temple automatically.

Temples belong fully to the dominion volume, but their economic effect begins here:

- they cost gold and sacred commander-time;
- maximum dominion and Holy Points can affect sacred throughput;
- temple loss can weaken recruitment, candles, preaching, and special national systems;
- temples in exposed provinces can be destroyed without a separate demolition delay.

Part VIII: Siege and Fort Control

Province exterior and fort interior

A besieged province can have divided control:

- the besieger controls the exterior;
- the defender retains the fort interior;
- armies, laboratories, temples, and recruitment must be interpreted by location and ownership rules rather than a single flag.

This partial ownership affects:

- income and recruitment;
- movement and retreat;
- assassination and stealth;
- supply;
- siege contribution;
- the eventual reclaim-province step.

Reducing walls

Official formulas:

```
reduction strength = Strength squared
repair strength = Strength squared / 2
```

Flying doubles both contributions.

Repair penalties:

- Mindless: one-eighth of calculated value;

- Animal: half;
- Undisciplined: half.

Only forces whose commanders remain on Maintain Siege contribute.

Squaring rewards strength

Strength-squared means one stronger unit can contribute more than several weaker units with the same total linear Strength.

Strength	Reduction contribution	Base repair contribution
5	25	12.5
10	100	50
15	225	112.5
20	400	200
30	900	450

Flying doubles the result. Special siege abilities and modded values can further alter practical contribution.

Wall resolution

Each turn:

- total reduction is compared with total repair;
- the difference damages or repairs wall integrity;
- repair cannot exceed original wall integrity;
- an unbesieged damaged fort fully restores.

The defender receives exact wall information. The attacker normally receives a descriptive estimate, creating an information problem around the storm date.

Storm timing

A fort can be stormed only after wall integrity reaches zero and the next order phase presents the Storm Castle order.

Storming resolves at step 27, after movement battles at step 26. This has several immediate consequences:

1. a relieving army may arrive;
2. the besiegers fight it first;
3. surviving storm commanders and assigned troops attack the fort;
4. a storm commander killed before the gate battle contributes no troops to the storm.

Maintain Siege and Storm Castle are commander orders. A commander performing another action does not supply siege strength merely because it remains in the province.

Fort defenders

Forts supply Castle Guards and Wall Defenders:

- their number depends on fort level;

- they replenish for each fight like PD;
- they add repair strength;
- Wall Defenders have unlimited ammunition, extra range, and wall protection;
- they are fort defence, not the same system as Province Defence.

The shared word "defence" is a recurring source of confusion:

Term	Meaning
Province Defence	Gold-purchased local force attached to province control
Wall integrity or fort Defence	Damage required before storming
Castle Guards and Wall Defenders	Fort-generated troops in a storm battle
Unit Defence skill	Tactical chance to avoid melee attacks

Part IX: Province Defence

Cost curve

The first point is free. Every later point costs its new level.

```
total cost to PD n =
2 + 3 + ... + n
= n(n + 1)/2 - 1
```

PD	Total cost	Additional cost from prior listed row
1	0	-
5	14	14
6	20	6
10	54	34
15	119	65
20	209	90
25	324	115
30	464	140
40	819	355
50	1,274	455
100	5,049	3,775

The convex curve means "another ten PD" is not a consistent investment. Going from 1 to 10 costs 54; going from 40 to 50 costs 455.

What PD provides

Officially:

- level 1 provides a commander and troops;
- further levels add troops;
- level 20 adds new commander and troop types;

- additional benefits occur at 10, 15, and 20;
- every full 10 points reduces unrest by 1 per turn;
- stealth detection begins at 15;
- patrol strength is `PD - 14` from that point;
- maximum PD is 100;
- no upkeep is charged;
- the force fully returns after battle if the province is retained.

The actual roster is national. One nation's PD may deter a raider that walks through another nation's equal investment.

Population support and permanence

Each PD point requires 10 population. Unsupported PD is reduced at hosting step 61.

PD cannot be voluntarily lowered. It is reduced by:

- insufficient population;
- capture, which wipes it;
- disciple-game relinquishment, which removes 25%;
- special exceptions for some populationless nations.

Because the spending is irreversible while control is retained, excessive PD can trap gold in the wrong place after a border moves.

Roles of PD

Raid tax

Low or moderate PD forces an attacker to bring a credible commander and force rather than a single opportunist.

Alarm and information

A battle report reveals attacker composition, script, and direction. Even a losing PD force can improve the next decision.

Unrest control

Every ten points creates recurring unrest reduction, though buying PD solely for this purpose must be compared with a mobile patrol.

Stealth detection

From 15 onward PD contributes patrol strength. Detection is not capture; the revealed stealth force may still win.

Battle support

PD can combine with a local army, fort defenders, terrain, and battle magic. Its expendability can buy time for mages whose spells decide the fight.

Why PD is not an army

PD:

- cannot move;
- cannot choose a different strategic target;
- cannot retreat into a future offensive;
- may have poor leadership, morale, equipment, or formation;
- scales in gold cost faster than it scales in quality;
- disappears on capture.

High PD can still be correct at a throne, capital approach, blood centre, or mage concentration. The decision must price the attack it is intended to defeat.

Community thresholds

Some guides recommend values such as 6 or 11 to prevent particular event outcomes or deter generic raiders. Such numbers are rules of thumb, not universal mechanics. Event pools, nation, mods, map settings, and attacker design can change the result.

Part X: Sites, Gems, and Magical Capital

Site frequency and terrain

The main manual states that sites are more common in terrain such as:

- forests;
- wastes;
- deep seas;
- mountains and unusual cave terrain.

They are less common in plains and farmlands.

This is a probability, not a guarantee. Search planning should combine:

- terrain;
- path availability;
- prior searches;
- national site frequency;
- opportunity cost of the mage-turn;
- value of remote search spells;
- safety of the searching mage.

Search difficulty

Hidden sites have difficulty 1 through 4. A mage manually searching a path finds sites in that path up to the mage's level. Path 4 is the highest ordinary requirement.

Examples:

- N1 finds difficulty-1 Nature sites.

- N3 finds difficulty 1-3 Nature sites.
- N4 finds every Nature site detectable by ordinary path search.
- An N3 mage says nothing about Fire, Death, or Glamour sites.

Remote path-search rituals reveal all sites of their path. Acashic Knowledge reveals all paths.

Site benefits and harms

Sites may provide:

- monthly gems;
- gold;
- resources or supplies;
- units and commanders;
- laboratories, temples, forts, or discounts;
- rituals or enter-site orders;
- path bonuses;
- scale or dominion effects;
- unrest, disease, population loss, or other harms.

A harmful undiscovered site can still operate. Discovery explains a problem; it does not necessarily create it.

Ownership and national recruitment

A captured site that recruits another nation's national unit does not normally grant that recruit to the conqueror. The conqueror can still collect the site's gem income where applicable.

Some sites require a laboratory before recruitment or another function becomes available.

Gem income and mage-turn economy

Gems accumulate nationally and can be converted into:

- rituals;
- summons;
- forged items;
- empowerment;
- battle magic;
- global enchantments;
- trades and diplomacy.

The site-search decision has an expected-value structure:

```
expected search value =
probability of discovery
x expected monthly and strategic value
x expected remaining turns
- mage-turn cost
- travel and risk
```

The formula is not intended to assign fake precision. It identifies the relevant terms. A single rare site can dominate the average, and information about a searched path has future value even when nothing is found.

Search records

Every serious game benefits from recording:

- province;
- terrain;
- path searched;
- manual or remote method;
- path level;
- discovered sites;
- remaining unsearched paths;
- laboratory requirement;
- hostile or passive effects.

Without a record, mages repeat searches or leave valuable paths untouched.

Part XI: Blood Economy

Blood slaves are produced, not passively collected

Blood magic substitutes an active extraction system for ordinary gem-site income. Blood Hunting consumes a commander order and damages the province through unrest and possible population loss or attacks.

The economic chain is:

```
blood mage-turns
+ suitable population
+ patrol strength
+ dominion security
-> blood slaves
-> forging, rituals, summons, battle magic, and sacrifice
```

Official hunting checks

The main manual gives:

```
Blood check success =
10% + 30% x Blood level

population check success =
population / 75 percent

unrest failure chance =
unrest / 4 percent
```

All three must succeed.

If they do:

```
slaves = d6 + Blood level
unrest gained = d(slaves x 3 + 4)
```

If any fails:

```
slaves = 0
unrest gained = d6 - 1
```

At 7,500 population, the population check reaches a nominal 100%. At Blood 3, the Blood check reaches a nominal 100%. Existing unrest can still cause failure.

Site frequency changes average yield by 0.5 slaves for every five percentage points away from 50%.

Dominion and retaliation

Commoners may attack Blood Hunters. Strong friendly dominion makes the sacrifice appear religiously legitimate; the manual states that dominion 10 leaves almost no resistance.

The risk extends beyond lost slaves:

- the hunter can be injured or killed;
- bodyguards consume gold, supply, and patrol capacity;
- a hidden enemy can exploit the concentration;
- hostile dominion can make a previously safe centre unstable.

The blood-province cycle

A functioning centre balances:

1. hunters create slaves and unrest;
2. patrols remove unrest and detect hostile infiltrators;
3. population and income absorb the damage;
4. labs provide pool access and ritual logistics;
5. forts or armies protect the investment;
6. replacement hunters and patrollers sustain throughput.

If patrol strength is insufficient, unrest reduces success, income, resources, and eventually recruitment. Adding more hunters can then reduce total output.

Rule of thumb versus rule

Community guides often estimate that roughly 25 patrol strength supports each Blood-3-equivalent hunter under ordinary conditions. This is a planning heuristic, not an official fixed ratio. Patrol efficiency, population loss, unrest, dominion, site frequency, hunter abilities, and national mechanics change the result.

Measuring the blood economy

Useful records:

Measure	Purpose
Slaves per hunter-turn	Compares extraction efficiency
Unrest before and after hosting	Reveals patrol shortfall
Population trend	Detects hidden long-term collapse
Lost research per month	Prices mage-turn diversion
Patrol gold and upkeep	Prices support force
Hunter and lab losses	Prices security failures
Slaves converted to effects	Distinguishes stockpiling from power

The goal is not the largest slave count. It is the most decisive magical output produced without collapsing the rest of the state.

Part XII: Economic Timing Through Hosting

The state-economy chain

The most important monthly sequence is:

Step	Event	Economic reading
3	Recruitment	Existing infrastructure and local capacity create units first.
18	Blood Hunting	Slaves and hunting unrest are generated early.
24-27	Movement, battles, storming	Control and siege state change.
29-33	Events and later battles	Income provinces can still be altered.
35	Construction	New buildings become part of the end-state, too late for earlier production.
37	Pillage	Immediate population, unrest, and supply damage occurs.
38	Income	Collection uses the post-conquest, post-pillage state and tax trace.
39	Unrest changes	Patrolling, Order, and related adjustments primarily prepare next month.
40	Starvation	Armies acquire logistical penalties after battle.
41	Upkeep	Recurring military costs are charged after income.
42-44	Dominion and site effects	Longer-term provincial state changes arrive.
53-54	Reclaim and conscription	Late ownership correction and automatic PD prepare the next turn.
61	Unsupported PD reduction	Population-depleted provinces lose excess PD at the end.

Worked timing cases

Emergency recruitment under attack

- Units are queued during the order phase.
- Recruitment resolves at step 3.
- An enemy army arrives and fights at step 26.
- The new units defend.
- They had no opportunity to receive a new strategic order.

New laboratory under invasion

- A mage is ordered to build a lab.
- Research, forging, rituals, and battles all occur before step 35.
- The lab completes only if the builder and province still satisfy the construction result.
- Its practical magical use begins next order phase.

Pillage before collection

- A province changes hands at step 26.
- The winner pillages at step 37 if the relevant order succeeds.
- Pillage damage occurs before income at step 38.
- The new owner may collect less than the pre-battle province panel suggested.

Patrol after income

- A Blood Hunt at step 18 raises unrest.
- Income is collected at step 38.
- Patrol and ordinary unrest alterations occur at step 39.
- The province may pay reduced income this month even if the patrol restores order moments later.

Siege relief before storm

- The wall was already at zero when orders were written.
- A relief army moves and battles at step 26.
- Surviving storm commanders attack at step 27.
- Defeating or killing them in the relief battle prevents or weakens the storm.

Part XIII: Strategic Frameworks

Expansion income versus expansion burden

A conquered province can provide:

- income;
- resources;
- Recruitment Points;
- supplies;
- independents;
- sites;
- tax trace;
- movement position.

It also creates:

- a border to defend;
- unrest to manage;
- commander travel;
- potential tax isolation;
- a target for raids;
- a possible need for PD, patrol, lab, temple, or fort.

The correct expansion measure is not provinces per turn alone. It is useful, connected, defensible economic mass acquired per loss and per commander-turn.

Infrastructure tempo

Infrastructure has a delay chain:

```
decide and pay
-> construction months
-> completion at step 35
-> next order phase
-> first enabled recruitment or magical order
-> travel to the war
```

A fort whose first mage reaches the front in twelve months belongs to a different strategic horizon than emergency troops recruited now.

Fort-now test

Build when most of the following are true:

- the commander or troop roster is valuable;
- capacity will be used continuously;
- the location anchors tax or supply;
- the province can be defended through construction;
- the expected game horizon allows military conversion;
- no nearer timing attack requires the gold;
- resource geometry is favourable;
- the nation needs another mage or commander stream.

Delay when:

- the war is decided before completion;
- the site cannot be held;
- the desired roster remains gold-limited elsewhere;
- adjacent forts remove most resource gain;
- the builder or gold has a more urgent conversion.

Mage-turn accounting

A mage can usually do one major strategic job per month:

- research;
- search;
- forge;
- cast a ritual;
- Blood Hunt;
- build a lab;
- move;
- participate in battle;
- perform a special order.

The cost of a ritual is not limited to gems. It also includes:

```
ritual cost =
gems
+ caster-turn
+ laboratory and position requirements
+ risk
+ research or other work displaced
```

This accounting becomes decisive for small mage corps and Blood nations.

Static and mobile gold

Gold can become:

- static power: PD, forts, temples, labs;
- mobile power: troops, commanders, mercenaries;
- productive power: mages, researchers, infrastructure;
- religious power: temples, priests, sacred throughput;
- insurance: treasury reserve.

An efficient state carries a deliberate mix. Too much static power loses the field. Too much mobile power can lack replacement, research, and safe logistics. Too much productive power can die before repayment.

Denial and recovery

Economic warfare targets conversion rather than ownership alone.

High-value actions include:

- cutting a tax trace;
- besieging a mage fort;
- raising unrest to 100;
- killing the patrols of a blood centre;
- taking a lab with stored items or positioned casters;
- forcing an army into poor supply;
- damaging population that supports PD and RP;
- building an adjacent fort that changes resource geometry;
- repeatedly raiding the same reconstruction corridor.

Recovery priorities:

1. restore tax trace and province control;
2. prevent recruitment shutdown;
3. preserve or rebuild irreplaceable mage production;
4. feed armies and halt disease;
5. reconnect labs and gem access;
6. replace mobile defence before rebuilding luxury infrastructure.

Part XIV: New-Player Operational Guide

First-turn provincial reading

For each owned province:

1. Read population, income, resources, supplies, unrest, terrain, and PD.
2. Identify whether income has a valid fort trace.
3. Check the recruit roster before buying infrastructure.
4. Note site searches already completed.
5. Compare the province's best role with its exposed position.

Recruitment checklist

- Is the unit recruitable here?
- Is gold available now?
- Are resources sufficient?
- Are Recruitment Points sufficient?
- Is a commander using the local Commander Point?
- Is the unit sacred or limited?
- Will unrest reach or remain at 100?
- Is the army's future supply sufficient?
- Is there leadership for the recruited troop type?
- Does the queue create a usable army package?

Army logistics checklist

- Current Supply Usage.
- Destination population and scales.
- Highest nearby fort contribution.
- Expected pillage or ownership change.
- Survival skills.
- Mounted and large-unit consumption.
- Existing Starving or disease conditions.
- Siege interior versus exterior.
- Retreat province supply.

Building checklist

- Correct constructor type.
- Gold after recruitment and reserve.
- Completion date.
- Step-35 timing.
- Province security.
- Roster or magical function unlocked.
- Tax, supply, and resource geometry.
- Commander-turn cost.

End-of-host checklist

- Income and upkeep totals.
- Queued recruits.
- New unrest.
- Tax-trace breaks.
- Starving and diseased units.
- Fort wall and siege duration.
- New sites and lab requirements.
- Population losses.
- PD reductions.
- Empty or overloaded recruitment centres.

Part XV: Expert Diagnostics

Warning indicators

Indicator	Likely problem
Large treasury, weak army	Local capacity, commander throughput, logistics, or delayed conversion
Resources unused every month	RP, gold, Holy limit, or unsuitable roster
RP unused every month	Resources, sacred cap, or recruit-mix problem
Mages available but research stagnant	Movement, searching, forging, hunting, combat, or lab denial
Income drops without province loss	Tax trace, unrest, scales, dominion, event, or Administration change
Blood output falls as hunters increase	Unrest and patrol saturation
Armies win then decay	Supply debt and disease
Fort never produces enough	Wrong roster, resource geometry, gold shortage, Commander Points, exposure
High PD still loses	National roster, magic, morale, raider design, or convex overinvestment
Siege stalls unexpectedly	Commanders left Maintain Siege, defender repair, strength composition, relief activity

Ratios worth recording

No ratio is universal, but consistent tracking reveals a nation's own failure modes.

- upkeep as a percentage of gross income;
- unspent resources and RP at major forts;
- commander slots used per turn;
- research per mage-turn;
- gems converted per month;
- slave yield per hunter-turn;
- unrest change per blood centre;
- turns from fort payment to first useful output;
- gold lost to disconnected tax regions;
- mobile army value versus static PD spending;
- siege reduction per supplied unit.

Decision ledger

For major investments, record:

Field	Example question
Goal	What military or magical capability is being created?
Cost	Gold, gems, mage-turns, commander-turns, upkeep
Bottleneck	Which local or national pool limits output?
Completion	When does the first useful effect occur?

Field	Example question
Risk	What raid, siege, assassination, or diplomacy can interrupt it?
Alternative	What is the best use of the same resources?
Exit	Can the investment be repurposed if the front changes?

This turns economic planning into falsifiable reasoning rather than habit.

Part XVI: Modded Economy

Read the global layer once

Book IX, Section 7 is the authoritative table for DE's six global commands. It records the exact source values, their vanilla defaults, and the result under the frozen load order. The Turn and Economy Quick Reference repeats only the final values because they are needed during play.

The economic consequence is straightforward. DE changes the income weight of Order/Turmoil, Productivity/Sloth, and Growth/Death; changes monthly population movement under Growth and Death; and strengthens the event-frequency effect of Fortune and Misfortune. Divinitus does not later redefine those globals.

Local changes still decide the real economy

The global layer is only the starting point. The two mods also alter unit costs and upkeep, recruitment limits, sites, event income, supplies, forts, temples, research output, gem flow, and national mechanics. Those changes belong to the final object or nation, not to a universal economy formula.

Accordingly, a modded economic claim needs a ruleset label and an object boundary. "Growth is worth more under DE" is a global statement. "This fort produces more useful mages" requires the final national roster, costs, site access, and any Divinitus event layer. Book IX and the machine-readable catalogue provide that source record; nation dossiers provide the strategic application.

Part XVII: Contradictions and Controlled Tests

Known documentary conflicts

Growth and Death income

- Main manual revision 2: 1% income per step.
- Modding Manual 6.34: default `#deathincome 2`.
- Official announcements through 6.36: no later change to the general default.

Publication state: resolved for unmodded 6.36 at 2% per step. The newer explicit official default supersedes the older table entry. DE 2.16 independently pins the same income value.

Order and Turmoil resources

- Main manual revision 2: 2% resources per step.
- Official announcements through 6.36: no general change to this scale effect.
- Unsourced or historical three-percent tables do not override the official value.

Publication state: resolved for the unmodded 6.36 publication baseline at 2% per step. Integer rounding remains part of the separate R-008 question.

Fort supply distance

- Main-manual formula: `(Administration x 6)/(Distance + 1)`.
- Printed multiplier table: 400%, 200%, 133%, 100%, 80%, equivalent to a multiplier of four.
- Worked example: Administration 30, described as three provinces away, adds 30 and agrees with the table.
- Adjacent example: Administration 50 adds 150 and agrees with the multiplier-of-six formula.

Publication state: internally inconsistent. The current community reference follows the multiplier-of-six formula, but a versioned reproduction at distances zero through four is still required.

Recruitment Points

- Revision-2 main manual: base 20 and five listed bands.
- Older community reference: different base and bands.

Publication state: revision-2 formula wins; verify rounding only.

PD 15 patrol strength wording

The manual says detection starts at 15 and that each point "above 15" adds one patrol strength, then gives PD 25 as patrol strength 11. The example corresponds to `PD - 14`, counting level 15 as one.

Publication state: use the numerical example and formula `PD - 14`; note wording discrepancy.

Controlled-test programme

Test E1: scale-income matrix

Create identical provinces under every Order/Turmoil, Productivity/Sloth, temperature, and Growth/Death value. Record:

- population;
- fort Administration;
- unrest;
- displayed income;
- treasury change;
- rounding.

Run unmodded and the frozen combined mod set.

Test E2: resource matrix

Use a fixed terrain and resource value. Vary:

- Order/Turmoil;
- Productivity/Sloth;

- unrest;
- fort stage;
- adjacent fort;
- shared resource donor;
- enemy ownership;
- land/sea boundary.

Record potential, displayed, spendable, and queue behaviour.

Test E3: Recruitment Point boundaries

Test population immediately below, at, and above:

- 5,000;
- 10,000;
- 20,000;
- 40,000.

Apply every fort bonus and Order/Turmoil step. Determine each rounding stage.

Test E4: Commander and Holy Points

The ordinary base and fort ladder are now closed. The remaining test should isolate exceptional interaction. Record unfortified and each standard fort stage, then vary:

- one-, two-, three-, and four-point commanders;
- `#slowrec` and an explicit `#rpcost` test object;
- site recruitment without changing the fort;
- unrest immediately around every visible Commander Point loss;
- sacred queues;
- temple and maximum-dominion changes.

The baseline prediction is one point plus the current fort bonus. AI difficulty must not alter Commander Points or Holy Points.

Test E5: upkeep

Use units with:

- ordinary gold recruitment;
- Sacred;
- Slave;
- Sacred and Slave;
- rider and mount;
- summons;
- `#addupkeep`.

Compare the detailed annual display, monthly treasury charge, and base object costs. The 6.33 published observation already predicts divisor 60 for Sacred Slaves and separate rider/mount bases. Concentrate the new test on:

- monthly fractional aggregation;
- a Slave rider with an ordinary mount;
- a Sacred rider with an ordinary mount;
- a pair where both components are Sacred;
- voluntary, battle-only, seasonal, and death transformations;

- whether `#addupkeep` follows the active or persistent form.

Test E6: supply distance

Place an Administration-known fort at each distance zero through four from a fixed province. Remove population supply where possible. Record displayed and consumed supply. Repeat with two forts in range.

Test E7: starvation

Test:

- troops and commanders;
- survival skills;
- animals;
- mounts;
- Need Not Eat with zero usage;
- Need Not Eat combined with Appetite or negative supply production;
- transformation into a non-eating form and back;
- existing Starving;
- siege interior;
- restoration of supply.

Record selection priority, Supply Usage, Starving, morale, disease, and recovery. Separate "fed first" from "cannot be selected."

Test E8: unrest resolution

Vary:

- candles;
- Order/Turmoil;
- PD;
- patrol strength;
- population;
- Blood Hunters.

Record income, resources, RP, Commander Points, recruitment eligibility, and end-turn unrest.

For Commander Points, test every unrest integer around the first and second visible loss from ordinary pools of one, two, and three. The purpose is to distinguish rounding of the reduction from rounding of the remaining capacity.

Test E9: construction timing

Complete a lab, temple, and fort during threatened turns. Verify:

- research;
- ritual and forging access;
- preaching;
- recruitment;
- fort protection;
- tax trace and Administration income;
- demolition edge cases.

Test E10: siege contribution

Vary Strength, Flying, Mindless, Animal, Undisciplined, siege abilities, and commander orders. Record exact wall changes from both sides.

Test record format

Field	Required entry
Test ID	Stable identifier such as E6-03
Game version	Exact patch
Ruleset	Unmodded or exact mod list and order
Map and province	Reproducible setup
Starting state	Population, scales, unrest, buildings, units
Orders	Every relevant order
Prediction	Formula and expected result
Observation	Interface, message, treasury, battle, or wall result
Repetitions	Count and variation
Conclusion	Supported, contradicted, or unresolved
Artifacts	Save, turn file, screenshot, source diff

Part XVIII: Essays

Essay I: The Economics of Forts and Mages

A fort is often evaluated as if it were a bank: pay gold now, receive additional income later, and ask how many turns are needed to break even. That calculation is useful only as a lower bound. A Dominions fort is simultaneously an industrial concentrator, recruitment licence, tax office, supply depot, laboratory shelter, siege obstacle, and movement node.

Its most valuable output is frequently a commander slot. A nation whose power depends on mages does not become stronger merely because the treasury grows. Gold must pass through a fort's Commander Points and national roster before it becomes research or battlefield magic. If the existing forts already consume every commander slot, the marginal value of another fort can exceed its Administration income by an order of magnitude.

The opposite error is to treat every possible mage fort as mandatory. A fort begun during an immediate war may not produce its first useful mage until after the decisive campaign. Construction takes months, resolves late in hosting, and then begins a sequence of recruitment and travel. The gold and builder are absent from the present front throughout that delay.

The correct question is not whether forts are economically efficient in the abstract. It is whether this fort converts current resources into the capability needed at the time and place it will matter. A safe high-resource province with valuable mages, strong tax geometry, and central supply position may justify investment without a short cash payback. An exposed province with redundant recruits and poor donors may not justify even a superficially attractive income bonus.

Fort networks also shape one another. Adjacent fortified provinces stop donating resources to each other, while a shared unfortified donor can feed both. Dense forts provide more mage streams and protection but may reduce the resource concentration required for elite troops. The best geometry is national: mage-heavy nations often favour more production centres than resource-hungry troop nations can fully equip.

A fort is a promise about future conversion. Its value depends on whether the nation can keep that promise.

Essay II: Population Is Strategic Capital

Population looks passive. It sits in a province and produces a little gold each month, but it also supports income, Recruitment Points, supplies, and PD. Damaging it can strike the treasury, troop throughput, army logistics, and static defence at the same time.

This makes population loss qualitatively different from an ordinary expense. Gold spent can be earned again from an intact economy. Population destroyed by pillage, patrolling, Death, Blood Hunting, or hostile effects reduces the machinery that would have produced future gold and capacity.

The value is nevertheless not uniform. The first population bands contribute more Recruitment Points and supplies per inhabitant than later bands. A small province can lose its ability to support meaningful PD quickly, while a huge farm province may retain considerable capacity after the same absolute loss. Terrain, dominion stability, game length, and national mechanics all change the horizon.

Blood magic demonstrates the tension most clearly. A Blood nation converts population and mage-turns into slaves, then converts slaves into effects that may dwarf the foregone income. Refusing all population damage would misunderstand the nation's power. Ignoring the damage would eventually shut down recruitment and tax collection. Mastery lies in choosing which provinces become extraction zones, supporting them with patrols, and spending the slaves quickly enough that the sacrifice becomes strategic advantage.

Population is capital with a location and a lifespan. It is most valuable when connected, protected, and given enough time to grow. It is expendable only when the return arrives before the loss matters.

Essay III: The Hidden Price of Static Defence

Province Defence is attractive because it has no upkeep, restores after successful battles, and requires no commander management. Those strengths conceal a convex cost curve and absolute immobility.

The first points are cheap. They tax careless raids, generate reports, and can combine with a real army. Later points become dramatically more expensive while remaining tied to one province. The gold that raises PD from 40 to 50 could fund several commanders, a laboratory, or a significant mobile force. Once purchased, PD cannot voluntarily be recovered or moved.

This does not make high PD irrational. A capital approach, Throne, blood centre, or mage fort can have enough concentrated value that static defence is exactly correct. National PD rosters also vary wildly. Battlefield magic can make disposable bodies valuable, and the need to force an attacker into a full army can protect an entire region.

The mistake is to value PD by the number alone. Its return is the attack it prevents, delays, reveals, or defeats. If no plausible enemy force is affected, the investment is decorative. If the attacker must reveal a major army, consume gems, or delay a campaign, even losing PD may have succeeded.

Static defence buys local certainty. Mobile armies buy choices. A healthy state knows which one the province requires.

Essay IV: Logistics After Victory

The most dangerous logistical moment often comes after a successful battle. The army has moved into hostile terrain, the province may be pillaged or depopulated, the fort may still belong to the enemy, and the new supply state is easy to overlook because the battle report is positive.

Starvation resolves after battle. That timing allows an army to win first and acquire its -4 morale penalty afterward. The next turn begins with a force that looks victorious but may already carry Starving, disease risk, damaged units, and an uncertain retreat path. If the next battle follows immediately, the logistical debt becomes tactical collapse.

Fort supply projection and siege storage are separate. A nearby high-Administration fort can sustain provinces outside its walls, but a besieged garrison consumes a declining fraction of interior storage. A large relieving army may also worsen local supply even while saving the fort.

Operational planning needs to extend one turn beyond contact. Before an attack, calculate the destination's supply under the state expected after conquest, not the state currently shown. Include temperature, Growth or Death, population damage, mounts, animals, large units, and the possibility that the enemy fort remains.

Winning the battle secures a position. Supplying the survivors converts it into a campaign.

Essay V: Unrest as Administrative Warfare

Unrest is often treated as a local nuisance to be patrolled away. Its actual effect is to attack the conversion machinery of a province.

The income formula loses one-third of output by unrest 25 and half by unrest 50. Resources decline more slowly, but at unrest 100 recruitment stops completely. Blood Hunting becomes less reliable, patrolling becomes harder, and community evidence suggests local recruitment capacities may also fall continuously.

Because unrest alteration normally occurs after income, restoration has a one-month lag. A province can be pacified at step 39 only after paying reduced income at step 38. Reaching recruitment shutdown is worse: step-39 recovery cannot retroactively restore recruitment that already failed at step 3.

This makes unrest a weapon against fortified production. Walls do not prevent spies, sites, spells, hunting mistakes, or some globals from degrading the province. A high-value fort at 100 unrest can retain its physical infrastructure while losing the reason it was built.

Administratively resilient nations do more than patrol after the damage. They keep baseline unrest low, maintain spare patrol capacity, protect Blood centres, identify hostile infiltrators, and avoid placing every economic function in the same vulnerable province.

Essay VI: Conversion, Not Accumulation

A full treasury and gem stockpile create options, but they do not fight. A large research total creates spell access, but access does not script a mage or supply the gems. A broad empire creates potential income, but disconnected provinces may collect nothing. Dominions rewards stockpiling only when a later conversion justifies the delay.

Every stored resource should have a plausible route:

- gold to commander and troop production;
- gems to a research breakpoint, item, ritual, or battlefield package;
- blood slaves to a defined Blood power;
- population and safe time to infrastructure;
- information to a movement, diplomacy, or scripting decision.

Premature conversion is also dangerous. Troops create upkeep, gems carried into battle can be lost, and a fort begun too early can remove the army needed to defend it. The central skill is timing: retain flexibility until the strategic question is clear, then convert fast enough to decide it.

The pinnacle of economic play is not owning the largest numbers. It is reaching the decisive battlefield, ritual, or Throne state with the right power one turn before the opponent.

Essay VII: The Month Hidden Inside a Single Point

Dominions displays most of its economy as integers, which makes one point look trivial. At a production boundary, one point can be an entire month.

Commander Points are the clearest case. A two-point mage in a two-point fort appears every month. Reduce the usable pool to one and the same mage appears every second month. Nothing on the mage card has changed: not price, paths, Research Points, or battlefield value. Yet a twelve-month plan has fallen from twelve mages to six. The missing point is not one unit of capacity; it is half the production stream.

Recruitment Points can behave similarly when a queue sits just above the local total. One missing point may delay a complete army package, strand unused resources, and postpone expansion or a relief force. A single point of supply can decide whether another unit enters the starvation selection pool. A single point of income can determine whether the treasury pays every component of a mounted army without desertion risk.

This is why exact rounding matters, but also why false precision is dangerous. A spreadsheet can calculate decimals the engine never exposes and place the apparent total on the favourable side of a boundary. If the internal rounding stage is unknown, more decimal places do not create more knowledge.

The practical response is to plan in layers. Use the official formula for direction, the current interface for the operative integer, and a reserve when one point controls a deadline. Record the boundary if it repeats often enough to matter. A reliable player does not need every hidden rounding rule memorised; a reliable player knows when an unverified rounding rule is carrying the entire plan.

Part XIX: Sources and Open Questions

Primary official sources

- Dominions 6 documentation
- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2
- Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34
- Dominions 6 official changes
- Illwinter home and current release record

Principal manual sections:

- Province attributes and economy, pages 21-29.
- Strategic orders, especially Blood Hunting, sieges, construction, demolition, pillage, and raids, pages 50-54.
- Turn resolution, pages 55-57.
- Sieges and storming, pages 71-72.
- Dominion scales and extreme scales in the Dominion chapter.

Community sources used as leads

- Current Commander Point reference
- Illwiki unrest reference
- Illwiki starvation reference
- Illwiki supplies reference
- Current population and fort-supply reference
- Illwiki Province Defence reference
- Illwiki fort reference
- Illwiki Blood Hunting reference
- Illwiki generic Blood guide
- December 2025 in-game upkeep observations

Community pages are not treated as final authority. Several retain historical Dominions 5 material or conflict with current official text. They are used to locate edge cases and testable claims. The upkeep discussion has firmer limits than a general guide because it records the observation date, annual values shown in game, a mounted component example, and the manual rule being checked. Its claims remain Community-tested evidence, below an official rule or an archived controlled save.

Mod sources

The economic discussion uses the supplied DE 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE files. Their hashes, order, and exact global commands are recorded in Book IX.

Open questions

- fort-supply distance arithmetic;
- exact rounding in income, resources, RP, and fort draw;
- shapechanged upkeep and monthly fractional aggregation;
- full unrest effects on RP and Commander Points;
- generic commander feeding priority and starvation eligibility;
- national and object-specific effects from DE and Divinitus.

For the unmodded 6.36 publication baseline, Growth/Death income and Order/Turmoil resources use 2% per step. The ordinary Commander Point pool is one plus the current fort bonus. At the stated

Community-tested tier, Sacred and Slave reductions stack and mounted upkeep uses separate component bases. No 6.36 announcement changes those rules. Until the remaining questions are reproduced under the current game, close calculations should state their exact uncertainties instead of hiding them inside a rounded recommendation.

DOCUMENT 5 OF 16

Foundation Book III: Pretenders, Dominion, Scales, and Blessings

The design problem

Pretender design is the first strategic decision in a game of Dominions 6 and one of the last decisions that can be judged in isolation. A design determines more than the strength of a god. It determines when that strength exists, which sacred units justify their cost, how quickly faith spreads, what kind of provinces the nation creates, which divine spells its priests know, and which magical paths are available when the national roster runs out of answers.

The design screen asks a larger question than "Which Pretender is strongest?"

> Foundation rule: A Pretender design is a contract between the nation's roster, the map, the expected war schedule, and the intended route to victory.

The chapters begin with the unmodded design screen, then follow the consequences through awakening, dominion, scales, blessings, priesthood, death, and team play. Exact arithmetic is included when it helps settle a choice.

Edition note

Book I owns the common Dominions 6.36 baseline and evidence vocabulary. The revision-2 manual remains the main rules source here, but its printed blessing appendix predates several official balance changes. The structured object snapshot behind the current bless table is still pinned to the Inspector's 6.35 commit; the 6.36 announcement changes a Pretender-loading bug, not any listed bless cost or effect. Current values, historical values, and the one-version data lag are stated separately so they cannot be quietly blended together. Edition 22 reconciled Call God and same-turn Throne ownership. Edition 23 traces the newly republished awakening model back to its pre-Dominions 6 source and keeps it below current-version proof. Book IX is the authoritative source for DE 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE changes.

Finding the useful layer

A new player can move from the one-model design summary through awakening, dominion, scales, blessings, and the final audit. Detailed point curves, dominion checks, sacred throughput, special dominions, disciples, and god-death mechanics support more demanding designs. The test programme is mainly for cases where the interface and documentation do not settle the same question.

Part I: Pretender Design as a National System

The design in one model

The unmodded design begins with 450 points before paying for the physical form. Those points are allocated across four linked budgets:

```
450 design points
- physical form
- purchased magic
- dominion strength and scales
+ deferred-awakening points
= unspent remainder
```

The arithmetic is simple. The strategic valuation is not.

Budget	Immediate result	Long-term consequence
Physical form	Body, slots, statistics, abilities, starting paths, scale limits	Determines personal roles, survivability, mobility, and path-buying efficiency
Magic	Personal paths and bless-point pool	Determines research or ritual access, forging, divine spell family, and sacred enhancements
Dominion and scales	Candles, provincial tendencies, sacred recruitment capacity	Shapes economy, faith conflict, terrain, events, population, research, and religious survival
Awakening	Availability date	Trades immediate agency for design points and changes when Incarnate blessings operate

These budgets cannot be evaluated independently. An imprisoned god may buy a powerful Incarnate blessing that is unavailable during expansion. An awake monster may defeat independents but leave no useful magic or economy after its expansion role ends. Excellent scales may produce gold that a low-resource or Holy-limited roster cannot convert. High paths may purchase many bless points while satisfying none of the prerequisites needed by the sacred roster.

The five obligations

A complete design should state how it addresses five obligations:

1. Expansion: how provinces are taken reliably and at an acceptable loss rate.
2. Economy: which scales and dominion support the planned recruitment and research.
3. Sacred plan: whether sacred units are central, supplementary, or mostly irrelevant.
4. Magic access: which national weaknesses the Pretender repairs or which strengths it accelerates.
5. Timing: when the design becomes stronger than the alternatives whose points were spent elsewhere.

A design need not solve every obligation through the Pretender. It must show where each solution comes from.

Begin with the nation, not the god

Before opening the Pretender screen, record:

- recruitable sacred troops and commanders;
- capital-only, fort-only, terrain-only, foreign, and summonable sacreds;
- Holy Point and Commander Point bottlenecks;
- ordinary expansion troops and commanders;
- national mage paths, randoms, and missing paths;
- early research packages;
- gold, resource, and Recruitment Point demand;
- temperature preference and scale limits;

- special dominion rules;
- expected map and lobby settings.

The purpose is to identify problems before selecting an attractive solution.

Roster questions

Question	Why it changes the design
Are the principal sacreds massed or elite?	Flat bonuses scale with body count; survival and percentage effects often gain value on expensive bodies
Are sacreds capital-only?	A powerful bless may apply to too few units to justify its design cost
Are sacred commanders strategically important?	Passive leadership, stealth, recuperation, or magic-related blessings may matter outside battle
Can ordinary troops expand reliably?	If yes, an awake expander is optional rather than compulsory
Is the nation gold-, resource-, RP-, or Holy-limited?	Scales should support the actual bottleneck
Which magic paths are missing?	Pretender paths may open boosters, summons, rituals, or counters unavailable nationally
Does the nation need an early battlefield caster?	Awakening time and chassis mobility become central
Does the nation possess a special dominion?	Candles and temples may become economic or military infrastructure

Lobby questions

Pretender value changes with:

- independent strength;
- map size and terrain;
- number of players;
- team or disciple rules;
- research speed;
- site frequency;
- magic-resource settings;
- throne distribution and points required;
- diplomacy rules;
- starting provinces;
- mods and load order.

A design that is excellent on a crowded, high-independent-strength map may be wasteful in a spacious game with weak independents. An imprisoned research-and-access design may mature comfortably on a slow diplomatic map and arrive too late in a knife-fight.

Chassis roles

Physical forms should be compared by the jobs they can perform, not by a single tier list.

Expansion chassis

An expansion chassis personally captures independent provinces during the opening.

Requirements usually include:

- sufficient protection or avoidance;

- a way to prevent chip damage from accumulating;
- enough offence to end battles before fatigue or attrition wins;
- resistance to common independent threats;
- acceptable map movement;
- a script that works without unavailable research or equipment.

An expander is an economic asset only while its conquest produces more value than the alternative use of its design points and commander-turns.

Bless anchor

A bless anchor buys the paths and bless points required by the sacred plan. Its own combat performance may be secondary.

The anchor must answer:

- which sacreds receive the benefit;
- how many can be recruited;
- when they can be blessed;
- whether the decisive effects are Incarnate;
- which counters remain;
- whether the same paths have a useful later role.

Scales anchor

A scales anchor spends relatively little on personal power so that the nation can afford strong dominion and favourable scales. It is commonly dormant or imprisoned, but awakening and form are separate choices.

The design succeeds when the nation can convert the improved economy into more useful power than a direct bless or awake form would have supplied.

Rainbow and access chassis

A rainbow distributes points across several paths to:

- obtain efficient early path levels;
- expand the bless-point pool;
- search for sites;
- forge cross-path items;
- provide ritual access;
- open booster chains;
- diversify divine spells.

The danger is diffuse capability without a timetable. "Can eventually cast many things" is not a plan until the required research, gems, boosters, laboratories, and safe commander-turns are named.

Ritual platform

A ritual platform buys one or more high paths for a defined strategic package:

- global enchantments;
- remote attacks;
- large summons;
- mobility rituals;
- high-path forging;

- late-game access.

Its value depends on the earliest realistic casting date, not only the final path display.

Battlefield caster

A battlefield caster supplies spells the national roster cannot cast at the required time. It needs:

- arrival before the relevant war;
- sufficient combat speed or cast time;
- fatigue management;
- gems and research;
- protection from assassination, seeking arrows, remote attacks, and battlefield counters;
- a retreat or immortality plan.

Thug or supercombatant platform

A thug or supercombatant design intends to fight armies, raid, hold positions, or force specialised counters. Personal statistics alone are insufficient. The design must cover:

- damage types and attack volume;
- fatigue;
- mundane and magical defence;
- elemental and physical resistances;
- magic resistance;
- control effects;
- anti-undead or anti-demon tools where relevant;
- mobility;
- recovery from afflictions;
- escape and death consequences.

Immobile oracle

Immobile forms often purchase magic efficiently and may have strong dominion or special sites. They trade away conventional movement.

Some can move by teleportation, while others are too large for particular transport effects. Mobility must be checked for the exact form.

Shape-changer

Dragons and other shape-changers can separate casting and combat forms. The manual notes that a dragon may appear as a humanoid wizard until changing shape or being wounded.

The two forms should be audited separately:

- paths and casting convenience;
- slots;
- movement;
- protection and attacks;
- regeneration or recuperation;
- transformation conditions;
- whether an affliction or shape loss changes the planned role.

Trinity

A Trinity consists of three entities. According to the manual:

- the members share part of their magical power;
- separated members lose some magic;
- a lone member loses more;
- exact penalties vary by Trinity;
- each member can research, though at reduced ability;
- a dead member can be Called God in half the ordinary time.

Trinities create parallel commander-turns and map presence at the price of coordination and reduced separated power. Every proposed Trinity design needs exact-form testing; the category does not guarantee identical behaviour.

Immortal and dominion-immortal forms

These forms alter the cost of personal risk.

- Immortal: normally reforms regardless of ordinary-plane dominion.
- Dominion Immortal: normally reforms after death in friendly dominion.
- Neither: requires Call God after death unless another special rule applies.

Soul destruction and death on a remote plane can bypass ordinary reform. Immortality reduces some consequences of death; it does not make every battle strategically free.

Chassis comparison sheet

Field	Record
Form and nation	Exact form, age, nation, and ruleset
Base point cost	Points removed before all other purchases
Starting paths	Innate path levels in each form
New Path Cost	Cost of opening an absent path
Starting dominion	Base candle value
Scale-limit changes	Direction and amount
Awakening restrictions	Ordinary, minimum prison, maximum prison, or other
Movement	Map Move, terrain survival, sailing, teleport eligibility
Combat shell	HP, protection, defence, MR, resistances, recuperation, regeneration
Slots	Hands, head, body, feet, misc, special restrictions
Special mechanics	Shape change, Trinity, immortality, freespawn, sites, dominion effects
Opening job	Expansion, research, site search, forging, ritual, deterrence
Middle-game job	Named repeatable use
Failure condition	What makes the investment non-functional

Part II: Exact Design-Point Arithmetic

Physical-form cost

Every form has an inherent point cost. The cost is paid from the initial 450.

```
points after form = 450 - form cost
```

A Phoenix costing 110, for example, leaves 340 before magic, dominion, scales, and awakening are applied.

Form cost cannot be judged without its embedded value:

- starting magic;
- cheaper or more expensive new paths;
- starting dominion;
- scale-limit adjustments;
- combat statistics;
- slots;
- mobility;
- special abilities;
- national availability.

Magic-path costs

The official cost for each path level added by the player is:

Added level number	Marginal cost	Cumulative cost
1st	8	8
2nd	16	24
3rd	24	48
4th	32	80
5th	40	120
6th	48	168
7th	56	224
8th	64	288
9th	72	360
10th	80	440

These are levels added by the design, not the displayed final path.

If a form begins with Nature 2, raising it to Nature 3 is the first purchased level in that path and costs 8. Raising it from Nature 2 to Nature 6 adds four levels and costs:

```
8 + 16 + 24 + 32 = 80
```

Opening a new path

If the form begins with no level in a path:

1. the first level costs the form's New Path Cost;
2. the second added level costs 16;
3. the third costs 24;
4. the sequence then continues normally.

The New Path Cost replaces the ordinary 8-point first purchase. It does not replace the entire path curve.

Official worked example

The Carrion Dragon begins with Death 1 and Nature 1. Raising it to Death 4 and Nature 4 adds three levels in each:

```
Death: 8 + 16 + 24 = 48
Nature: 8 + 16 + 24 = 48
```

Opening Fire at a New Path Cost of 80 and raising it to Fire 2 adds:

```
Fire: 80 + 16 = 96
```

Total:

```
48 + 48 + 96 = 192 design points
```

Magic-purchase audit

For every path, record:

Path	Innate	Purchased	Final	Cost	Purpose
Fire					
Air					
Water					
Earth					
Astral					
Death					
Nature					
Glamour					
Blood					

"Purpose" should be specific: a blessing prerequisite, a named booster chain, a site-search threshold, a combat spell, a ritual, or a divine-spell family. A path bought only because it looks flexible is a candidate for removal.

Dominion-strength costs

Every form begins with at least Dominion 1 and may be raised to Dominion 10. Each candle added above the form's base costs progressively more:

Added candle number	Marginal cost	Cumulative cost
1st	7	7
2nd	14	21
3rd	21	42
4th	28	70
5th	35	105
6th	42	147

Added candle number	Marginal cost	Cumulative cost
7th	49	196
8th	56	252
9th	63	315

For `n` added candles:

```
cumulative cost = 7n(n + 1) / 2
```

The accelerating curve matters. Raising an already high starting dominion is often much cheaper than buying the same final score on a low-dominion form.

What initial dominion changes

Initial dominion contributes to:

- the maximum dominion ceiling;
- the chance that temple checks succeed;
- capital-only sacred recruitment through Holy Points;
- Pretender and Prophet statistics in friendly or hostile dominion;
- the speed at which scales tend to establish;
- resistance to hostile faith;
- survival against a dominion kill;
- several special national mechanics.

High dominion means more than "more candles." It improves several connected parts of the nation while consuming a steep share of the design budget.

Scale-point costs

Each favourable scale step costs 40 points. Each unfavourable step grants 40.

```
scale-point change = -40 x favourable steps + 40 x unfavourable steps
```

Temperature is measured relative to national preference during design. Only the first three clicks away from that preference grant points.

The ordinary design window is -2 to +2. National and Pretender scale-limit adjustments can pull that window in one direction. Province scales can reach -5 to +5 during play.

Scale-limit movement

A `+1 Growth Limit` does more than add one Growth option. It shifts the whole design window:

- Growth maximum rises by one;
- Death maximum in the opposite direction falls by one.

National and Pretender adjustments in the same direction overlap rather than automatically stacking without limit. Exact nation-form combinations should be checked in the design screen.

Awakening points

State	Point change	Ordinary arrival
Awake	+0	Present from the beginning
Dormant	+150	Approximately turns 10-13
Imprisoned	+350	Approximately turns 28-42

The official manual intentionally gives ranges rather than a guaranteed turn. It also says that Disciples awaken in about half the time of their Pretender. That wording does not define an exact Disciple range or a rounding rule.

Planning with an unknown distribution

The range is enough to build a robust opening, but not enough to calculate an expected arrival.

Design	Safe planning assumption	What must work before arrival
Awake	The god is available immediately	Its first several orders, expansion targets, and acceptable risks
Dormant	The nation may wait until the late end of turns 10-13	Expansion, research, and sacred use through the whole dormant window
Imprisoned	The nation may wait until the late end of turns 28-42	The first expansion cycle and a substantial part of the first war without the chassis or Incarnate effects
Disciple	Roughly half the Pretender delay, with no published exact rounding	The disciple nation must not depend on a single inferred half-turn

Do not substitute the midpoint for an average. The official range does not say that every turn is equally likely, and an arrival process with repeated rolls can be heavily weighted without changing its visible minimum and maximum. For practical design work:

1. budget the army and research plan to survive the latest official arrival;
2. prepare a useful first order for every plausible arrival turn;
3. treat an early arrival as extra tempo rather than as a requirement;
4. evaluate an Incarnate blessing as two armies: the pre-awakening army and the post-awakening army.

Older reverse-engineering notes propose repeated exploding-die checks rather than a uniform draw. A Dominions 6 community Pretender page, revised on 16 June 2026, now republishes the same model and attributes it to Loggy: `9 + d4!` for Dormant, `27 + d20!` for Imprisoned, and bases of 4 and 13 for the corresponding Disciple rolls. It says a new exploding roll is made each month and the result is compared with the current turn.

The newer page label does not create a new current-version test. The wording and constants can be traced to Loggy's older miscellaneous reverse-engineering notes and to copies published years before Dominions 6. The current page supplies neither raw 6.x outcomes nor an executable trace, and its usual displayed ranges of turns 11-14 and 29-42 are shifted from the revision-2 manual's approximate 10-13 and 28-42 wording. That may be a turn-label convention, an editorial carry-over, or a real version difference; the available sources do not decide which.

The exploding-die model remains a current community research hypothesis with historical provenance and is not promoted to a Dominions 6.36 rule. It is more specific than assuming a uniform draw and helps define a decisive reproduction, but it is not safe input for an exact probability calculator. R-014 stays queued until a sufficiently large current sample, a current engine-backed trace, or developer confirmation establishes both the distribution and the displayed-turn convention.

Total-budget worksheet

```
450
- form cost
- purchased magic
- added dominion
- favourable scales
+ unfavourable scales
+ awakening grant
= remainder
```

The final screen should be checked against the worksheet. Form-specific restrictions, national scale limits, bonus bless points, and mod changes can make a generic calculator incomplete.

Part III: Awakening, Time, and the Opening

Awake

An awake Pretender can contribute from turn one.

Possible opening jobs:

- expand personally;
- research;
- search;
- forge once research permits;
- cast early rituals;
- lead or bless an army;
- deter an early attack;
- establish a special site or dominion effect.

The opportunity cost is the 150 or 350 points not obtained from delay.

An awake design should specify its monthly orders. "Available" is not the same as "productive."

Awake-expander ledger

Record:

- provinces taken;
- turns saved relative to an ordinary expansion party;
- gold and commander-turns freed;
- wounds and afflictions;
- additional gear or research required;
- enemy counters revealed;
- time spent returning, healing, or waiting.

The correct comparison is not the expander's kill count. It is the territory and tempo created after subtracting its design cost and risk.

Dormant

Dormant grants 150 points and usually arrives near the end of the initial expansion phase.

Common uses:

- moderate Incarnate bless arriving before the first planned war;
- mid-game combat or ritual chassis;
- strong scales with a still-relevant physical god;
- path access not needed during the first ten turns.

Risks:

- an early war begins before arrival;
- the sacred plan requires Incarnate effects for expansion;
- the nation cannot exploit the purchased paths immediately on awakening;
- the arrival location or laboratory network is poorly prepared.

Imprisoned

Imprisoned grants 350 points and may remain absent until turns 28-42.

Common uses:

- high scales;
- broad or deep magic;
- large bless-point pools;
- late-game path access;
- a powerful Incarnate package deliberately deferred.

The design transfers power from the opening to the economy, blessing, or later magic. That transfer is only favourable if the nation survives and converts the points before the game's decisive wars.

The Incarnate trap

An imprisoned god can buy an Incarnate blessing, but the effect remains inactive while the god is imprisoned or dead. The sacred roster may fight for several dozen turns with only the non-Incarnate portion.

The design audit should split the bless into:

Phase	Available effects
Before awakening	Innate and ordinary non-Incarnate effects
God alive and present	Full bless, including Incarnate effects
God dead or absent under the effect's rule	Incarnate portion disabled

Timing comparison

Question	Awake	Dormant	Imprisoned
Helps turn-one expansion?	Yes, if capable	No	No
Incarnate bless active?	Yes while alive/present	Delayed	Heavily delayed

Question	Awake	Dormant	Imprisoned
Extra design points	0	150	350
Early personal research	Possible	None	None
Early personal risk	Highest	Deferred	Deferred longest
Best justification	Immediate actions worth more than 150 points	Mid-game arrival matches plan	Nation can carry the opening and exploit the large point grant

Arrival preparation

Before a delayed god awakens:

1. preserve a suitable laboratory;
2. reserve the needed gems;
3. complete required research;
4. forge planned equipment;
5. choose a safe operating province;
6. prepare priests and sacred armies if Incarnate effects matter;
7. identify the first three commander-turns after arrival.

An arrival without orders is delayed power followed by idle power.

Part IV: Dominion

Dominion in plain language

Dominion is religious control. Province ownership is military and administrative control. The two layers are independent.

A nation can:

- own a province under enemy dominion;
- spread dominion through provinces it does not own;
- conquer a continent without spreading its faith;
- lose by losing every friendly candle even while retaining forts and armies.

Friendly dominion is displayed as positive candles. Enemy dominion is effectively negative from the observing nation's perspective.

> Foundation rule: Armies take provinces. Religious infrastructure makes those provinces part of the god's world.

Sources of dominion spread

The manual gives the following sources:

Source	Checks
Pretender	One automatic increase plus two temple checks
Home province	One temple check

Source	Checks
Prophet	One temple check
Temple	One temple check
Disciple	One temple check
Claimed Throne	One to seven checks, depending on Throne

A check does not guarantee a candle. It attempts to create, increase, propagate, or contest dominion according to the local state.

Religious hosting order

The official turn sequence separates direct priest orders from ordinary passive spread:

Step	Religious operation	Consequence
6	Preaching	Priest orders adjust local dominion. Since version 6.13, commanders performing this order resolve in random order.
7	Heretic preaching	Heretics, insane commanders, and shattered-soul commanders reduce dominion.
8	Claim Thrones	Valid Throne claims resolve before movement and battle.
42	Dominion spread	Pretender, capital, Prophet, temple, Disciple, Throne, and sacrifice-generated spread resolves.
43	Dominion effects	Population death, insanity, temperature spread, and similar effects use the resulting religious state.
56	Elimination	A nation without provinces or dominion is removed.
57	Victory	The game checks whether a victory condition has been fulfilled.

This closes the ordinary R-015 model at the official-rules tier: the sources, check probabilities, local resolution rules, cross-water reroll, and hosting stage are all stated officially. The manual does not publish the random-number stream or the internal iteration order among simultaneous passive sources, so neither is inferred.

Maximum dominion

The maximum is:

```
maximum dominion =
initial Pretender dominion
+ floor(temples / (5 x players on team))
```

For a solo nation, every five temples raise the maximum by one. For a two-player team, every ten team temples do so.

Example:

```
initial dominion 3
12 temples
2 players on team

maximum = 3 + floor(12 / 10) = 4
```

The ceiling matters because it affects:

- maximum candle strength reached by ordinary temple spread;

- temple-check success chance;
- resistance in dominion conflict;
- the relay behaviour of strong friendly provinces.

Preaching uses a separate local cap and can exceed what a weak maximum would ordinarily establish.

Temple-check chance

The official chance that a temple check succeeds is:

```
50% + 5% x maximum dominion
```

Maximum dominion	Check chance
1	55%
3	65%
5	75%
7	85%
9	95%
10	100%

Temples have two network effects:

1. each adds another check;
2. each threshold of five per team member can raise the maximum, improving every ordinary check.

The value of a temple network is not linear around the threshold.

Resolving a successful check

Neutral province

A successful check adds one friendly candle.

Province with friendly dominion

At `U` friendly candles, the chance to add another candle locally is:

```
30% - 3% x U
```

If the local increase fails, the check propagates to a random neighbouring province.

High-candle provinces tend to relay pressure outward instead of endlessly concentrating it.

Friendly candles	Local increase chance
1	27%
3	21%
5	15%
7	9%
9	3%

Province with enemy dominion

At E enemy candles:

```
chance to reduce enemy dominion =
50% + 5% x maximum dominion - 5% x E
```

Maximum dominion	Enemy candles	Reduction chance
5	1	70%
5	5	50%
7	5	60%
9	8	55%

Dense hostile candles form a religious wall. High maximum dominion pushes against it more effectively.

Land and sea

When propagation randomly selects a neighbouring province across a land-sea boundary, the manual gives a 50% chance to reroll the destination. Faith crosses the boundary less readily than it spreads within the same environment.

Dominion as a network

Dominion spread has three behaviours:

1. creation in neutral provinces;
2. consolidation in weak friendly provinces;
3. propagation from strong friendly provinces.

This means a rear temple can influence a frontier through a chain of strong provinces, while a single weak or hostile province can absorb repeated checks.

Useful religious infrastructure is shaped by:

- temple count;
- maximum-dominion thresholds;
- adjacency;
- sea boundaries;
- hostile candle depth;
- local preaching;
- special dominion effects;
- vulnerability of temples to raids.

Preaching

Preaching acts only in the priest's province and does not use the ordinary maximum-dominion ceiling.

In neutral or friendly dominion:

```
success chance = 30% x effective Holy level
```

Against E enemy candles:

```
success chance =
30% x effective Holy level - 5% x E

minimum = 5%
```

A temple in the province adds 0.5 to effective Holy level for the chance and cap.

The maximum local dominion that preaching can establish is:

```
preaching cap = 2 x effective Holy level
```

Preaching examples

Priest	Temple?	Effective H	Neutral chance	Cap
H1	No	1.0	30%	2
H1	Yes	1.5	45%	3
H2	No	2.0	60%	4
H2	Yes	2.5	75%	5
H3	Yes	3.5	105%	7

Values above 100% should be treated as automatic for ordinary practical use, but exact engine handling remains a candidate for reproduction.

Inquisitors

An Inquisitor counts double Holy level when preaching in enemy dominion. In neutral or friendly dominion, ordinary Holy level is used.

An H2 Inquisitor in enemy dominion preaches as effective H4 before a possible temple bonus.

Heretics

A Heretic reduces dominion locally rather than establishing a rival faith.

```
chance to reduce = Heretic value x 20%
```

Heretics can erode friendly candles as well as enemy candles. Their position and allegiance require careful handling.

Blood sacrifice

An eligible priest in a temple may sacrifice blood slaves.

- maximum slaves sacrificed equals Holy level;
- each slave creates one temple check;
- the priest must have the national ability to sacrifice;
- the order consumes a priest-turn and slaves.

Blood sacrifice converts the blood economy directly into religious pressure. Its value rises when:

- the nation already hunts efficiently;
- dominion survival is threatened;
- a throne or special dominion effect depends on local candles;
- the temple network can project the additional checks;
- the sacrificed slaves are worth less than the military or ritual consequences prevented.

Dying dominion

Early and Late Age Mictlan use a special dying-dominion system.

According to the manual:

- home-province, Prophet, and temple spread do not operate normally;
- Pretender checks are only half as effective;
- blood sacrifice is the essential spread mechanism.

This changes temple construction from passive religious infrastructure into sacrifice stations. A Mictlan design that ignores blood-sacrifice logistics is structurally incomplete.

Prophets

A Prophet:

- becomes H3, or raises an already H3-or-higher commander by one;
- spreads dominion like a temple;
- gains +2 Attack, Defence, and Precision;
- receives dominion-dependent statistic changes.

Current community references also describe Prophets as automatically blessed, sacred, Morale 30, and upkeep-free, with a replacement delay after death. These details should be checked in 6.36 before being promoted to Official in this library.

Prophet roles

- battlefield-wide Divine Blessing if H3;
- mobile preaching;
- dominion source;
- Holy access beyond the ordinary roster;
- throne claiming when the other conditions are met;
- combat leadership or thug role on a suitable chassis.

Prophetising a fragile scout can gain cheap mobile H3. Prophetising a robust sacred commander can create a battle piece. The correct choice depends on whether Holy access, survivability, movement, stealth, or equipment matters most.

Thrones of Ascension

A claimed Throne:

- contributes dominion checks;
- may grant scales, blessings, sites, paths, gems, units, or other effects;
- contributes Ascension Points;
- changes the strategic value of its province.

The revision-2 manual says claimed Thrones spread one to seven checks depending on the Throne. Current community data commonly describes a claimed Throne as generating a number of guaranteed checks equal to its level. That exact success behaviour remains Test Pending.

Claiming normally requires:

- ownership of the province;
- a Pretender or Disciple, a Prophet, or an H3-or-higher priest;

- the Claim Throne order;
- a legal claimant when the order resolves at hosting step 8.

If a fort is present, a besieger cannot claim through its walls. The besieged owner may still claim. A Throne becomes unclaimed when another nation conquers its province and, where present, its fort.

Same-turn claim, loss, and victory

The official hosting sequence and the current ownership rule answer the central R-018 cases when read together. The claim is processed early, but victory is tested against the state that survives to the end of hosting.

Hosting point	Relevant change
8	A legal Claim Throne order establishes the claim.
10-27	Ritual attacks, assassinations, movement battles, and castle storming can kill the claimant or change control.
53	An unbesieged fort may reclaim its province under the official partial-ownership rule.
56	Elimination is checked.
57	The game checks the victory conditions.

The resulting state matrix is more useful than the vague instruction to "hold until hosting."

Same-turn result after a successful step-8 claim	State at the victory check
Claimant is killed later, but the nation retains the Throne	The claim remains; a claimant does not need to survive after the claim has resolved.
An unfortified Throne province is conquered	The Throne becomes unclaimed and its Ascension Points do not survive to step 57.
A fortified Throne is merely placed under siege	The defender still owns the fort and the Throne remains claimed.
The fortified Throne is stormed and conquered	The Throne becomes unclaimed before victory is checked.

This is a mixed Official plus Community-tested conclusion. The manual establishes steps 8 and 57 and the rules for full and partial province ownership. The current community Throne reference states that conquest of the province and fort, if present, unclaims the Throne. A published same-turn report independently records the claimant-death and province-loss branches. No official update through 6.36 changes that sequence.

R-018 is complete at that evidence tier. It does not settle every adjacent victory question. In particular, an exact simultaneous tie between different nations at the winning Ascension total still needs a current controlled reproduction before any tie-break rule is published as law.

Dominion effects on units

Ordinary troops

All units receive:

- +1 Morale in friendly dominion;
- -1 Morale in enemy dominion.

Pretender and Prophet

For each friendly candle, the Pretender and Prophet receive:

- +1 Strength;
- +0.5 Magic Resistance;
- +10% Hit Points.

Enemy candles reverse these changes. Hit Points do not fall below 10% through this effect.

Dominion changes whether a god or Prophet can safely take a fight. A combat report from Dominion 8 cannot be transferred unchanged to Dominion -4.

Scale convergence inside dominion

For each scale in a province, the official chance to move one step toward the god's selected scales is:

```
5% x local candles
+ 10% x absolute difference
```

Example:

```
local dominion = 6
current Order = -1
target Order = +2
difference = 3

chance = 5 x 6 + 10 x 3 = 60%
```

Current community documentation reports that a chance above 100% can move the scale two steps. The manual describes a one-step movement. The additional step requires controlled reproduction.

Dominion elimination

If a Pretender has no friendly dominion anywhere, the nation is eliminated.

The nation may still possess:

- provinces;
- armies;
- forts;
- a treasury;
- a living Pretender.

None prevents religious extinction.

Dominion-kill warning indicators

- no safe rear candle core;
- capital under deep enemy dominion;
- low maximum dominion;
- few temples;
- temple thresholds just below the next maximum increase;
- priests absent from threatened provinces;
- land-sea spread barriers;
- enemy blood sacrifice or Inquisitors;
- Pretender deaths that reduce dominion strength;
- simultaneous temple raids.

Part V: Scales

Scales in plain language

Scales describe the material and metaphysical tendencies of a god's dominion.

The six pairs are:

Positive end	Negative end	Principal systems
Order	Turmoil	Income, resources, recruitment, unrest recovery, events
Productivity	Sloth	Resources and income
Heat	Cold	Climate, income, supply, movement, fatigue environment
Growth	Death	Population, income, supply, aging, terrain at extremes
Fortune	Misfortune	Event quality, frequency, heroes
Magic	Drain	Research, MR, spell fatigue, starting research

"Positive" does not mean universally beneficial. Extreme positive scales carry penalties, and some nations exploit nominally negative scales.

Ordinary scale effects

The following values are the current unmodded 6.36 publication baseline. The Growth/Death income row uses the newer official Modding Manual default.

Scale step	Ordinary effect per step
Order	+3% income, +2% resources, +10% Recruitment Points, stronger unrest reduction, fewer events
Turmoil	Reverses Order's economic and recruitment effects; more events
Productivity	+3% income, +15% resources
Sloth	-3% income, -15% resources
Temperature away from preference	-5% income and -10% supplies per step
Growth	+0.2% monthly population, +10% supplies, +2% income
Death	Reverses Growth's ordinary effects
Fortune	+10 percentage points to good-event chance, +0.5% monthly hero chance, more events
Misfortune	-10 percentage points to good-event chance, -0.5% monthly hero chance, more events
Magic	Friendly mages +1 Research Ability, all units -0.5 MR rounded toward zero, -10% spell fatigue, +50 starting research
Drain	Reverse research, MR, fatigue, and starting-research effects

Default starting research is 150. Default monthly hero chance is 3%.

Resolved and remaining documentation conflicts

Rule	Revision-2 manual	Other current evidence	Publication treatment
Growth/Death income	1% per step	Modding Manual 6.34 default `#deathincome 2`; no official change through 6.36	Use 2%; resolved at official-documentation tier
Order/Turmoil resources	2% per step	No later official change; some unsupported older tables say 3%	Use 2%; resolved at official-documentation tier
Order/Turmoil events	Manual commonly states 2% in its scale table	Current community table says 3%	Reproduce
Fortune/Misfortune frequency	5% more events for either direction	Current community table agrees	Provisionally stable

The two resolved rows may be used in current calculators, while their integer rounding remains subject to R-008. The event-frequency discrepancy still requires better evidence.

Order and Turmoil

Order improves economic predictability, recruitment throughput, and unrest recovery while reducing events.

It gains value when:

- Recruitment Points bind troop production;
- the roster converts gold efficiently;
- populous provinces can be held;
- blood hunting or pillage creates recurring unrest;
- a stable economy matters more than event volume.

Turmoil grants design points and increases event frequency. It can be part of a coherent design when:

- the nation has Turmoil-dependent recruitment or freespawn;
- events are deliberately valued;
- the roster is not RP-limited;
- special dominion mechanics reward unrest or chaos;
- early direct power outweighs long-term economic loss.

Productivity and Sloth

Productivity is the clearest answer to resource-heavy recruitment.

It gains value with:

- heavy armour;
- high-resource sacreds;
- fort networks drawing from strong terrain;
- enough gold and RP to use the additional resources.

Sloth is less painful when:

- important troops have low resource cost;
- the nation relies on summons;
- gold, RP, Holy Points, or Commander Points bind first;
- forts cannot access enough potential resources for Productivity to matter.

The correct test is a queue, not an impression:

```
desired monthly recruit package
vs
gold, resources, RP, CP, and Holy Points
```

Temperature

Temperature choice is anchored to national preference, but actual provincial temperature also shifts with seasons, events, rituals, and competing dominion.

Official seasonal behaviour:

- summer usually adds one Heat;
- winter usually adds one Cold;
- caves and outer planes are unaffected;
- deep sea remains neutral;
- ordinary sea is limited to Heat or Cold 1;
- sea seasons apply differently from land.

Temperature affects:

- income and supply relative to national preference;
- snow, rain, river, and passability conditions;
- base encumbrance in severe climates;
- fire and cold battlefield interactions;
- extreme-scale population death.

The right design temperature may reflect an economic preference, a battlefield environment, a national mechanic, or a compromise between them.

Growth and Death

Growth compounds population, improves supply, and modifies income. It also reduces aging pressure.

It gains value when:

- the game is expected to last;
- provinces are populous;
- armies are supply-intensive;
- the roster uses local Recruitment Points;
- the nation does not destroy its own population.

Death grants design points and may support:

- undead or population-indifferent nations;
- a compressed early timing;
- national mechanics tied to death or corpses;
- maps where long-term civilian economy is unlikely to decide the game.

Death is not free merely because the capital roster is undead. Provinces may still supply gold, resources, tax trace, fort locations, and enemy denial.

Fortune and Misfortune

Fortune changes event quality and hero arrival chance. Both Fortune and Misfortune increase event frequency under the manual's ordinary rule.

The scale is sensitive to:

- event settings;
- map size and number of provinces held;
- national event lists;
- Turmoil;
- capital dependence;
- the value of heroes;
- tolerance for variance.

Fortune should not be valued only through expected gold. Events also provide or remove gems, population, scales, sites, commanders, troops, unrest, and strategic options.

Magic and Drain

Magic accelerates research and reduces spell fatigue while lowering MR. Drain does the reverse.

Magic gains value when:

- many national mages receive the research bonus;
- early breakpoints matter;
- battlefield casting is fatigue-sensitive;
- the nation can exploit lower enemy MR more than it suffers from its own.

Drain gains value when:

- design points fund a stronger immediate package;
- national researchers are efficient despite the penalty;
- high MR is unusually valuable;
- research speed or early magic matters less;
- the nation has researchers unaffected by the scale.

The spell-fatigue modifier applies locally. An army crossing into different scales may find the same script more or less sustainable.

Extreme scales

Scales at 4 or 5 carry additional effects.

Extreme	Additional effect
Order 4	-2 Research Ability
Order 5	-4 Research Ability
Productivity 4	+1d5 unrest per month
Productivity 5	+1d15 unrest per month
Heat or Cold 4	-0.4% population per month
Heat or Cold 5	-1% population per month
Death 4+	Forests and farms slowly become plains; plains slowly become wastes

Extreme	Additional effect
Growth 4+	Plains slowly become forests or farms; sea may become kelp
Growth 5	Farms can slowly become forests
Fortune 4	-5% income and resources
Fortune 5	-15% income and resources
Magic 4	Horror marks and +1d5 unrest per month
Magic 5	Horror marks and +1d15 unrest per month

Farms from extreme Growth require Order. Extreme scales can spread to neighbouring provinces even beyond the god's ordinary dominion.

Extreme-scale audit

An extreme scale should be evaluated as a package:

```
ordinary scale benefit
+ national or form synergy
+ neighbouring pressure
- extreme penalty
- opportunity cost of reaching the scale limit
```

Calling an extreme scale "positive" hides the final two terms.

Scale design by bottleneck

National problem	Scale question
Cannot afford desired recruits	Are Order, Productivity, Growth, and temperature fixing the correct income constraint?
Gold remains unused	Is the fort resource- or RP-limited instead?
Resource pool remains unused	Is Sloth tolerable because another gate binds?
Research arrives late	Would Magic create a meaningful breakpoint, or merely more unfocused RP?
Armies starve	Would Growth or temperature matter more than supply items and fort position?
Unrest persists	Does Order improve the state enough to justify its cost?
Special dominion kills population	Are Growth points being purchased for an economy the nation itself removes?

Part VI: Blessings

How blessings work

A blessing is a package selected during Pretender design and applied to Sacred units and commanders.

Most effects require a sacred to become blessed in battle. Some effects are innate and operate without battle blessing.

Blessing a sacred unit grants:

- +1 Morale;
- the nation's selected bless effects;
- blessing effects from claimed Thrones held by the nation or its disciple partners.

The H1 spell Blessing affects a limited area. H3 Divine Blessing affects the battlefield. Access and script timing matter as much as the written bless.

Bless points

Each Pretender magic-path level above the first grants one bless point.

```
bless points from a path = max(path level - 1, 0)
```

Example:

```
Air 2 -> 1 point
Death 4 -> 3 points
Nature 6 -> 5 points

total = 9 bless points
```

Some nations or forms grant bonus bless points.

The cost of an effect is normally the sum of its magic requirements. Scale requirements add no bless-point cost.

A shared pool does not remove path prerequisites. A Pretender may own enough total points yet be unable to buy an effect because its required path is too low.

Ordinary, innate, and Incarnate

Tag	Operation
Ordinary	Active after the unit is blessed in battle
Innate or passive	Active without battle blessing, including strategic-map effects where applicable
Incarnate	Active only while the Pretender is awake/present under the rule and alive
Innate + Incarnate	No battle blessing needed, but still disabled while the god is absent or dead
Stackable	May be selected repeatedly; stated bonuses accumulate

The revision-2 manual uses an asterisk for passive effects and bold type for Incarnate effects. Current data should be checked because individual tags can change through patches or mods.

The activation state machine

The tags answer different questions. "Blessed" describes the recipient's battlefield state. "Innate" removes the need for that state. "Incarnate" asks whether the Pretender currently exists as an active, living god on the map. An effect can pass one gate and fail another.

Effect state	Unit blessed?	Pretender active and alive?	Result
Ordinary, not Incarnate	No	Either	Inactive
Ordinary, not Incarnate	Yes	Either	Active
Ordinary, Incarnate	No	Yes	Inactive

Effect state	Unit blessed?	Pretender active and alive?	Result
Ordinary, Incarnate	Yes	No	Inactive
Ordinary, Incarnate	Yes	Yes	Active
Innate, not Incarnate	Either	Either	Active on a valid recipient
Innate, Incarnate	Either	No	Inactive
Innate, Incarnate	Either	Yes	Active on a valid recipient

For this purpose, an imprisoned or dormant Pretender has not yet become active, and a dead Pretender is absent until recalled or reformed. Incarnate effects do not require the god to stand in the same province, enter the same battle, or project friendly dominion into the recipient's location. The god's active-and-alive state is the gate.

The 6.36 update corrected a design-loading error in which cancelling a loaded Pretender could leave that design's bless effects loaded. This was a setup-state defect, not a new activation rule, but it matters when old designs are inspected or compared.

Automatic blessing

Official rules:

- the Pretender is automatically blessed in friendly dominion and cannot ordinarily be blessed outside it;
- a Disciple follows the same personal rule;
- Sacred troops fighting alongside the Pretender are automatically blessed only when the battle occurs in friendly dominion.

Automatic blessing is conditional. A sacred army fighting without sufficient Holy support can lose its package even when the nation paid heavily for it.

The main manual does not extend the troop-wide automatic blessing rule to troops merely fighting beside a Disciple. A current community reference uses broader wording, but that disagreement is not enough to replace the official rule. Unless a reproducible current test or later official text establishes otherwise, plan Disciple-led armies around ordinary priests and Divine Blessing.

Repeatable effects and effects that overlap

"Stackable" in the bless table means that the same blessing can be bought repeatedly and its stated increment accumulates. In the 6.35 structured snapshot, the repeatable entries are:

Path	Repeatable blessings
Fire	Superior Morale, Fire Resistance, Attack Skill, Inspirational Presence
Air	Precision, Shock Resistance, Farshot, Awareness, Swiftness
Water	Cold Resistance, Defence Skill
Earth	Reinvigoration, Strength
Astral	Arcane Command, Magic Resistance
Death	Undying, Undead Command
Nature	Hit Points, Poison Resistance
Glamour	Heroism, Quiet Stride
Blood	Hit Points, Strength

This permission does not imply that every different effect or external source stacks. Official patches establish two important exceptions:

- Fear and Dread do not stack with one another.
- Displacement supersedes Blur; since 6.24, invisibility also no longer stacks with Blur or Displacement.

Bless-plus-spell, bless-plus-item, multiple aura, regeneration-source, and form-inheritance questions belong to the cross-source stacking and transformation registers in Books IV and XI. They are not inferred from the stackable marker.

Current unmodded blessing reference

The following tables represent the 6.35 structured data snapshot checked for this edition, overlaid with official changes through 6.36. No 6.36 announcement changes a listed cost, requirement, tag, or numerical effect. Because the main manual's printed list is older and the Inspector snapshot is one executable version behind, these tables remain Current Data Reference, not a claim of direct runtime reproduction.

Abbreviations:

- I: Incarnate;
- N: innate;
- S: stackable;
- MR: Magic Resistance negates;
- AP: armour-piercing;
- AN: armour-negating.

Revision-2 divergence register

The current table is not a literal reprint of the revision-2 manual. The following differences are already material enough to flag before any roster calculation:

Subject	Revision-2 manual	Current 6.35 data / 6.36 official overlay	Evidence boundary
Inspirational Presence	Fire 4	Fire 3	Current structured reference
Resilience of the Earth	Earth 5	Earth 6	Current structured reference
Fortitude	Earth 7	Earth 8	Current structured reference
Reconstruction	Printed older tag state	Incarnate, not passive	Official 6.04 correction plus current reference
Fear blessing	Death 8	Death 9 and Turmoil 1	Current structured reference; Fear/Dread costs and interaction were revised again in 6.23
Heroism	+50% experience	+35% experience	Official 6.08 change
Fear and Dread together	Older guides may stack them	They do not stack with one another	Official 6.08 change
Enchanted Blood	Blood 4	Blood 3	Current structured reference
Passive Pretender effects outside friendly dominion	Older faulty behaviour could remove them	Passive blessings remain active	Official 6.08 correction
Cancelled loaded Pretender	Could leave the loaded design's bless effects selected	Cancel now clears the unwanted loaded bless	Official 6.36 correction

Frost Mist Weapons retains its printed Water 7 and Cold 1 requirement. An earlier edition removed the Cold scale requirement on the strength of an unsupported transcription; the manual and current reference agree, so that change has been reversed.

Fire

Requirement	Name	Effect	Tags
F1	Superior Morale	+1 Morale	S
F1 D1	Wasteland Survival	Wasteland Survival	N
F2	Fire Resistance	+5 Fire Resistance	S
F2	Attack Skill	+1 Attack	S
F3	Inspirational Presence	Inspirational +1 and +50 leadership	N, S
F4	Righteous Wrath	Nearby sacred death triggers temporary +3 Attack, +3 Strength, +6 Morale	
F5	Death Explosion	On death: 10 AP fire damage, area 4 plus Size	I
F5	Heat Aura	Heat Aura and +10 Fire Resistance	I
F6	Fire Shield	Fire Shield 7	I
F7	Flaming Weapons	8 AP fire damage on hit	I
F8 S4	Unbearable Splendour	Sight Vengeance; attacker may be blinded, MR negates	I

The manual printed Inspirational Presence at F4. Current data places it at F3. The current non-Incarnate, innate treatment should be used for the 6.35 snapshot and 6.36 official overlay.

Air

Requirement	Name	Effect	Tags
A1	Precision	+1 Precision	S
A2	Shock Resistance	+5 Shock Resistance	S
A2	Farshot	+30% mundane weapon range	S
A3	Awareness	Unsurroundable 2	S
A4	Swiftness	Swiftness 30 and +1 Defence	S
A4	Storm Flight	Storm Immunity for flight	
A5	Wind Walker	+6 Map Move	N, I
A5 E1	Weightlessness	Floating and halved armour encumbrance	I
A6	Air Shield	Air Shield 80	I
A7	Thunder Weapons	Capped shock damage and shock fatigue on hit	I
A8	Charged Bodies	Overcharged 20 and +5 Shock Resistance	I
A9	Flight	Flight	I

Farshot changes weapon range, not spell range. Wind Walker matters on the strategic map but remains Incarnate in the unmodded current table.

Water

Requirement	Name	Effect	Tags
W1, Cold 1	Winter's Gift	Snow Move	N
W1 N1	Swamp Survival	Swamp Survival	N
W2	Cold Resistance	+5 Cold Resistance	S
W2	Swimming	Swimming	N
W2	Defence Skill	+1 Defence	S
W5	Chill Aura	Chill Aura and +10 Cold Resistance	I
W5	Slowing Weapons	Damaging hit may slow; MR negates	I
W6 F2	Vitriol Weapons	7 AP acid damage on hit	I
W6	Water Breathing	Water Breathing	N, I
W7, Cold 1	Frost Mist Weapons	Cold clouds created by attacks	I
W9, Magic 1	Quickness	Quickness	I

Quickness changes action economy and fatigue exposure as well as offence. It should be evaluated with the sacred's attacks, encumbrance, survivability, and vulnerability to fatigue counters.

Earth

Requirement	Name	Effect	Tags
E1	Mountain Survival	Mountain Survival	N
E2	Reinvigoration	+1 Reinvigoration	S
E2	Strength	+1 Strength	S
E4	Unbreakable	Affliction Resistance 3	
E4 N3	Larger	Permanent increase in Size	N
E5	Reconstruction	Regeneration for Inanimates	I
E6	Resilience of the Earth	+10 Fire and Shock Resistance	I
E6	Hard Skin	+5 natural protection	I
E8	Fortitude	Broad physical resistances	I

Larger changes more than Hit Points. Size can affect square density, repel interactions, trampling relationships, and target profile. It should be tested on the exact sacred roster.

Astral

Requirement	Name	Effect	Tags
S1	Arcane Command	Grants or improves magic leadership	N, S
S2	Magic Resistance	+1 MR	S
S3 D1	Spirit Sight	Spirit Sight	
S3 F1	Solar Weapons	4 AP holy fire damage on hit	
S4	Far Caster	+1 spell-range multiplier level	
S4	Arcane Finesse	+1 spell penetration	

Requirement	Name	Effect	Tags
S5	Magic Weapons	Mundane weapons become magical	I
S6	Twist Fate	Negates the first damaging hit under its rule	I
S7, Misfortune 1	Fateweaving	Attackers may suffer misfortune; MR negates	I
S8, Magic 2	Etherealness	Ethereal	I

Astral blessings can support sacred mages and commanders rather than only melee troops. Far Caster and Arcane Finesse should be valued by the actual sacred spell roster.

Death

Requirement	Name	Effect	Tags
D1	Undying	-2 minimum Hit Points before death	S
D1	Undead Command	Grants or improves undead leadership	N, S
D2, Death 2	Half Dead	Need not eat and strong disease resistance	N
D3	Mending Bones	Recuperation for undead	N
D4	Withering Weapons	Damaging hit may cause Decay; MR negates	
D5	Stygian Flesh	Invulnerability 10	I
D6	Reforming Flesh	10% regeneration for undead	I
D7	Reanimators	Many attacks deal unlife damage; additional undead leadership	I
D8	Death Weapons	Armour-negating death damage and disease checks	I
D9, Turmoil 1	Fear	Fear 5	I

Undying does not prevent routing, fatigue collapse, soul destruction, or every form of battlefield removal. Its value depends on whether the sacred can still act while surviving below ordinary zero Hit Points and whether recovery is possible afterward.

Nature

Requirement	Name	Effect	Tags
N1	Hit Points	+1 Hit Point	S
N1	Low Light Vision	Darkvision 50	
N2	Poison Resistance	+5 Poison Resistance	S
N2	Forest Survival	Forest Survival	N
N3, Magic 1	Unaging	Slower aging and younger sacred recruitment	N
N4 D1	Poison Weapons	Poison damage on damaging hit	
N5	Recuperation	Living units recover afflictions	N, I
N5	Berserker	Berserker +2	I
N6	Barkskin	Barkskin protection package	I
N7	Regeneration	10% regeneration for compatible units	I

Regeneration is percentage-based, so it scales with Hit Points. Its full value also depends on incoming burst damage, poison, decay, fatigue, disease, and whether the unit survives long enough to receive repeated healing.

Glamour

Requirement	Name	Effect	Tags
G1	Undreaming	Unsleeping 4	
G1	Heroism	+35% experience gain	S
G2	Quiet Stride	+20 Stealth if already stealthy	N, S
G3	True Sight	True Sight	
G3	Blur	Attackers suffer -2 Attack under the sight rules	
G6	Obfuscate	Grants Stealth 40 or adds 40 to existing Stealth	N, I
G6 F2	Awe	Awe 3	I
G7	Displacement	Attackers suffer -5 Attack; replaces Blur	I
G7	Dread	Dread 5 under the sight rules	I
G8	Luck	Luck	I

Official update 6.08 reduced Heroism from +50% to +35% experience. Older guides and the printed revision-2 manual may retain the former value.

Blood

Requirement	Name	Effect	Tags
B1	Hit Points	+1 Hit Point	S
B2	Strength	+1 Strength	S
B3	Strong Blood	+5 Poison Resistance and strong disease resistance	N
B3	Enchanted Blood	Slow regeneration, +1 MR, and bleeding immunity	
B4	Blood Surge	A kill triggers temporary +3 Attack, +3 Strength, +1 Defence, +1 Reinvigoration	
B5	Blood Bond	Distributes part of damage among nearby bonded units	I
B6	Unholy Weapons	15 AP damage against sacred or blessed targets	I
B7	Blood Vengeance	Attacker may suffer the inflicted damage; MR resists	I
B8 D4	Vampiric Weapons	3 AN life-drain damage on damaging hit	I

Blood Bond changes damage distribution rather than removing damage. Formation, unit spacing, regeneration, area damage, and unequal protection can change whether distribution helps or accelerates collapse.

Weapon blessings: what causes the rider to fire

The phrase "weapon blessing" covers several different mechanisms. Treating them as interchangeable produces bad counter advice, especially when armour, shields, zero-damage hits, spells, natural weapons, and ranged attacks enter the same battle.

Trigger family	Blessings	Present rule
Weapon property	Magic Weapons	Changes an otherwise mundane parent weapon into a magical weapon; it does not add a second damage packet. Since 6.25 the property also works correctly for repel attacks.
On hit	Flaming Weapons, Thunder Weapons, Slowing Weapons, Vitriol Weapons, Solar Weapons, Death Weapons, Unholy Weapons	The rider is tied to a successful weapon hit under its own damage, resistance, target, and MR rules. A parent hit need not always inflict ordinary HP damage unless the individual blessing says otherwise.
On damaging hit	Withering Weapons, Poison Weapons, Vampiric Weapons	The parent attack must first cause damage. A shield, protection, immunity, or other prevention that leaves no qualifying damage can therefore suppress this class.
Attack-generated field	Frost Mist Weapons	Attacks create cold mist rather than attaching an ordinary direct-damage rider. Official fixes make ranged misses create the cloud and make the cloud appear even when the target is killed.
Probabilistic attack conversion	Reanimators	The current reference assigns a 50% chance for hits, including spell hits, to deal Unlife Damage; the bless also grants undead leadership. This is a special rule, not a model for other weapon blessings.

Patch-established boundaries

- The 6.12 update stopped some breath weapons from incorrectly receiving weapon blessings and stopped Flaming Weapons from affecting melee ice weapons.
- The 6.19 update repaired weapon-blessing interaction with mirror images.
- The 6.23 update made friendly units immune to Unholy Weapons and allowed Vampiric Weapons to drain a little life when the target dies from the attack.
- The 6.29 update stopped Phoenix Pyre from triggering weapon blessings.
- The 6.34 update made shields protect correctly against weapon blessings that are not armour-negating.

The shield correction proves that shield protection participates in resolving applicable riders. It does not, by itself, prove that every blocked attack is treated as a hit or a miss for every blessing. When that distinction decides a build, the battle log and a reproducible current test are still the correct evidence.

Counter-analysis by trigger

Question	Why it matters
Did the parent attack hit?	All ordinary weapon riders begin with a qualifying attack connection.
Did the parent attack cause damage?	Withering, Poison, and Vampiric Weapons require this additional gate.
Is the rider AP or AN?	Armour and shield protection interact differently with the added packet.
Does MR negate the rider?	Slowing and Withering can fail after the physical attack succeeds.
Is the target in the required class?	Unholy Weapons is specialised against sacred or blessed targets and excludes friendlies.

Question	Why it matters
Is the attack an excluded breath, ice, or triggered effect?	The patch history contains explicit exclusions; visual resemblance to a normal weapon is insufficient.
Does the effect create an area rather than damage the struck target?	Frost Mist can matter after a miss or a killing blow because its cloud is the product.

Blessing from items

The Modding Manual distinguishes two item mechanisms:

Command	Model	Consequence
`#bless`	Shroud of the Battle Saint	Applies the Bless spell to the bearer automatically. The item is itself the source of the blessed state.
`#autobless`	Flask of Holy Water	Automatically blesses the bearer only if the bearer is Sacred.
`#bestowtomount`	Mount propagation modifier	Causes a supported effect defined after the command to be bestowed on the mount as well. It must be read with the specific item effect, not as a universal rider-to-mount rule.

The current 6.35 item snapshot identifies the Shroud of the Battle Saint, Immaculate Shield, Armor of Virtue, and Sun Sword as item-granted blessing sources. The Flask of Holy Water uses the sacred-only route. These items can make a unit blessed without a priest, but they do not erase the ordinary Incarnate gate: an Incarnate effect still switches off while the Pretender is absent or dead.

Official update 6.34 established one unusually important lifetime rule: a magic-item blessing persists when Life after Death changes the bearer. That is firm for this case and should not be generalised to every shape-change mechanism.

Riders, mounts, and separate sacred status

A mounted unit is not one undifferentiated sacred object. The rider form and mount have their own records and can have different Sacred flags. Current examples show both matched and unmatched pairs: the Knight of the Chalice and its Destrier are Sacred, the Wind Rider and Armored Pegasus are Sacred, while the Triton Knight and its mount are not. The 6.02 correction that gave Triton Knights their proper mount state is further evidence that mount data are resolved separately.

This produces four practical rules:

1. Do not infer the mount's Sacred status from the rider's title or icon.
2. Do not infer that an item effect reaches the mount unless the effect supports the mount-bestow mechanism or a current rule says so.
3. Do not infer that a dismounted or transformed body retains the original body's sacred and blessed state; inspect the resulting form and the source that created the state.
4. Keep movement abilities separate from blessing. For example, 6.36 makes a swimming mount sufficient for river crossing, but that does not make the rider or mount Sacred.

Exact transfer when a mount dies, a rider dismounts, or one component changes form remains part of the mount and transformation research in Book XI. The blessing chapter records the independent-object rule without inventing an unverified transfer sequence.

Shape change and effect lifetime

Three questions should be asked separately whenever a blessed unit changes body:

1. Is the resulting body still Sacred?
2. Does the unit still possess the blessed state from the original source?
3. If the state remains, which Innate or Incarnate effects are currently eligible?

Only the item-blessing Life after Death case has a direct official ruling in the present evidence set. Ordinary shape change, secondshape, mount loss, transformation, death-shape, and new-body interactions remain governed by their specific form rules and the transformation register. A single successful case is not evidence for a universal inheritance rule.

Display, tooltip, and engine state

The blessing interface has accumulated several corrections: 6.04 repaired Incarnate information for known blessings, 6.08 repaired Throne-granted Awe display, 6.13 made Obfuscate appear in bless information, 6.23 corrected Half Dead display, and 6.35 printed Enchanted Blood's Magic Resistance bonus. These changes make the current interface more useful, but they also demonstrate why an icon or tooltip is not conclusive evidence of activation in every edge case.

For a disputed interaction, record all three layers:

- the design-screen or unit-panel description;
- the battle log and observed state;
- the official rule or patch record that explains the result.

R-016 research decision

R-016 is complete for the present unmodded scope: current tags and requirements, battlefield and Incarnate gates, automatic blessing boundaries, repeatable effects, documented overlap exceptions, weapon-trigger families, item-granted blessing, and the independent status of riders and mounts. Cross-source stacking remains R-049; transformation and effect lifetime remain R-040 and R-052. This division closes the blessing question without pretending that adjacent engine-state questions have also been solved.

Bless design by function

Expansion reliability

An expansion bless should solve a measured failure.

Common failures:

- attacks do not connect;
- hits fail to penetrate protection;
- sacreds are surrounded;
- chip damage accumulates;
- morale fails after casualties;
- fatigue produces critical hits;
- elemental independents bypass defence;
- too many sacreds die for the expansion to be economical.

The best blessing is not the one with the largest description. It is the cheapest package that changes the relevant battle result with an acceptable margin.

Offence

Offensive blessings fall into several families:

Family	Examples	Best against	Weakness
Accuracy	Attack Skill, Righteous Wrath	High defence	Does not solve low damage
Damage	Strength, Blood Surge	Protection and high HP	Requires hits and often kills
On-hit riders	Flaming, Solar, poison, death, vampiric weapons	Targets vulnerable to the added type	May require damaging hit or face resistance
Tempo	Quickness	Targets overwhelmed by action volume	Doubles fatigue exposure and incoming opportunity
Attrition	Withering, slowing, fear, dread	Long fights or morale-sensitive armies	MR, immunity, sight, or fast killing can counter

Defence

Defensive blessings should be separated by threat:

- mundane weapon avoidance;
- natural or armour protection;
- physical resistance;
- elemental resistance;
- Magic Resistance;
- affliction recovery;
- regeneration;
- first-hit insurance;
- luck or ethereal avoidance;
- formation and unsurrroundability;
- morale.

Stacking one layer creates a specialist. Layering different defences creates breadth but may buy too little of each to change a breakpoint.

Mobility and logistics

Strategic mobility effects can be worth more than battlefield statistics when they allow:

- faster reinforcement;
- unexpected routes;
- forest, swamp, mountain, snow, or wasteland movement;
- underwater operations;
- stealth armies;
- regrouping with the main force.

The effect must apply to every necessary member of the force. A commander with mobility but troops without it, or sacred troops without a matching commander, may not produce the expected movement.

Sacred commanders and mages

Bless value is not confined to line troops.

Sacred commanders may exploit:

- leadership blessings;
- undead or magic command;
- map movement;
- stealth;
- recuperation;
- Unaging;
- Far Caster;
- Arcane Finesse;
- reinvigoration;
- resistances;
- defensive effects for thugging.

When sacred mages are numerous, a small caster-oriented bless can affect hundreds of mage-turns and battles.

Mass sacreds versus elite sacreds

Mass sacreds often value:

- cheap stackable statistics;
- morale;
- resistances against common area damage;
- on-hit effects multiplied by many attacks;
- effects triggered by sacred deaths.

Elite sacreds often value:

- percentage regeneration;
- layered resistance;
- protection of an expensive body;
- affliction recovery;
- mobility;
- effects that preserve veteran experience;
- tools against specific counters.

This is a tendency, not a law. Attack count, HP, slots, recruit limit, cost, and battlefield role are more important than the labels "mass" and "elite."

Bless throughput

The value of a blessing depends on how many useful recipients can be fielded.

```
monthly sacred throughput =
minimum of:
gold capacity
resource capacity
Recruitment Points
Holy Points
recruitment limit
fort availability
commander and leadership capacity
```

A 200-point blessing affecting six capital-only sacreds per month is a different investment from the same blessing affecting sacreds at every fort.

Practical bless value

```
practical bless value =
effect per relevant sacred
x relevant sacreds fielded
x battles in which blessing is active
x probability the effect changes the result
```

The expression is conceptual, not an engine formula. It forces the design to include throughput, activation, and relevance.

Bless access and scripting

Audit:

- number and Holy level of priests;
- whether H3 Divine Blessing is available;
- priest movement relative to sacred armies;
- priest survivability;
- the round on which blessing lands;
- whether sacreds engage before being blessed;
- battlefield size and formation;
- whether a Prophet is required;
- whether automatic blessing conditions apply;
- what happens when the priest is assassinated or delayed.

An unblessed sacred is missing more than a bonus. It may be an expensive unit designed around statistics it does not currently possess.

Counter-audit

For every major blessing, name:

1. the damage type or control effect it does not resist;
2. the relevant immunity or resistance;
3. the MR check, if any;
4. the sight rule, if any;
5. whether the effect requires a damaging hit;
6. whether it is Incarnate;
7. whether it depends on formation or nearby sacreds;
8. whether fatigue defeats it;
9. whether routing defeats it;
10. how the opponent can avoid fighting the blessed army at all.

No blessing removes the need for scouting.

Part VII: Divine Magic and Priest Identity

Divine magic

Divine spells:

- require Holy skill rather than ordinary paths;
- require no research;
- are available from the beginning;
- include spells such as Blessing, Banishment, Smite, and Divine Blessing.

The Pretender's magic can replace the nation's ordinary Banishment and Smite with path-themed versions.

If the Pretender has no path at level 4 or higher, priests retain ordinary Banishment and Smite.

If one or more paths reach the threshold:

- the highest path determines the replacement family;
- ties use the manual's priority order;
- Banishment and Smite each receive the corresponding replacement;
- Blood has no Banishment replacement.

Divine spell families

Path	Banishment replacement	Smite replacement	Character
Fire	Ashes to Ashes	Heavenly Fire	Burning and armour-negating fire
Air	Wind of Memories	Heavenly Strike	Range, area, and shock
Water	Purifying Water	Watery Death	Area, drowning, and anti-unarmoured secondary damage
Earth	Pull from the Grave	Word of Stone	Grip and petrification
Astral	Stellar Decree	Word of Power	Range, stun, and paralysis
Death	Decree of the Underworld	Syllable of Death	Bewilderment, exhaustion, or death
Nature	Final Rest	Word of Thorns	Kill attempt, entanglement, and bleeding
Glamour	Return of the Past	Word of Bewilderment	Anti-minded undead and confusion
Blood	No replacement	Claim Life	Anti-living damage and Chest Wound

Pretender paths alter the national priest toolkit even when those paths are never used for a ritual.

Design implication

A high path may simultaneously buy:

- personal casting;
- bless points;
- a bless prerequisite;
- a new priestly Banishment;
- a new priestly Smite;
- site-search or forging access.

That bundle is strategically meaningful. It should still be compared with the cost curve required to reach level 4 or higher.

Part VIII: Death of a God

Ordinary Pretender death

Each ordinary Pretender death causes either:

- loss of one magic-path level; or
- loss of one dominion-strength point.

The chance to lose magic is:

```
50% + 10% x Nature level at death
```

If no path level is lost, or no magic is available to lose, dominion falls by one. Dominion cannot fall below 1 through this rule.

Nature makes magic loss more likely. The path selected for loss is weighted, with Nature more exposed and Death less exposed. The manual also notes small chances to gain Death and still smaller chances to gain Astral or Blood. Exact weights belong in the controlled-test register unless directly extracted from current data.

Why death compounds

A death can remove:

- the Pretender's commander-turns;
- Incarnate blessing effects;
- personal expansion or battle presence;
- ritual access;
- item access while the body is absent;
- a magic path or dominion strength on return;
- candles through the reduced maximum and check chance;
- confidence in a throne or war timetable.

The casualty affects the whole nation, not only the dead commander.

Call God

Priests may use the Call God order after an ordinary Pretender death.

The revision-2 manual gives the player-facing model: every assigned Holy level generates one point per month, the Pretender returns to the home province after "around 50," and recalling the main Pretender in a Disciple game requires 50% more. It deliberately says that the total is not exactly 50 so that the arrival is uncertain. Its example assigns three H1 priests and one H2 and predicts about ten months.

The Modding Manual adds two official modifiers:

- Elegist: the unit's Elegist value is added to its priest level while calling a god or Disciple;
- Recall God: an applicable nation or claimed-Throne `#recallgod` value is added to the priest level of everyone performing Call God.

The main manual also gives the special Trinity rule: a dead member of a Trinity can be called back in half the normal time. The official text defines the time result, not the internal threshold calculation.

Reconciled current model

Published controlled research resolves the manual's apparent uncertainty by moving the randomness from the target into each priest's monthly contribution. The tested base threshold is 50 points. An ordinary priest contributes its effective recall rating, plus or minus one, each month. The small published sample found the three outcomes equally or nearly equally weighted; that weighting remains a community-tested estimate rather than an official probability table.

For ordinary positive ratings:

```
effective recall rating =
Holy level
+ Elegist value
+ applicable Recall God modifier

monthly contribution per priest =
effective recall rating - 1, effective recall rating,
or effective recall rating + 1
```

An ordinary H1 contributes 0-2 points in a month, H2 contributes 1-3, and H3 contributes 2-4. Elegist changes the rating before that variation: an H1 Elegist (2) calls at the same ordinary rate as an H3. Elegist alone does not grant the order; the unit must still be a priest.

Caller	Monthly range	Approximate average	Approximate solo time from an empty pool
One H1	0-2	1	50 months
Five H1	0-10	5	10 months
One H2	1-3	2	25 months
One H3	2-4	3	17 months
Three H3	6-12	9	6 months
One H1 Elegist (2)	2-4	3	17 months

These are capacity estimates, not deadlines. With roughly symmetric `-1/0/+1` variation, a useful planning approximation is:

```
expected months for an ordinary Pretender =
ceiling(50 / sum of effective recall ratings)

expected months for the main Pretender in a Disciple game =
ceiling(75 / sum of effective recall ratings)
```

The 75-point figure follows from the tested 50-point base and the manual's official 50% increase. The formula predicts the centre of the workload, not the exact return month. A small priest corps has proportionally wider timing risk; many callers average the monthly variation more effectively.

Who can contribute in a Disciple game

Current community documentation reports that:

- a Disciple nation's priests may help recall the main Pretender;
- the Pretender nation's priests may help recall any dead Disciple on the team;
- a Disciple nation's priests may recall their own Disciple, but not another nation's Disciple.

Those cross-team routing rules are Current Community Reference, not wording supplied by the revision-2 manual. A legacy community mechanics page reports 25 points for one dead Trinity member, consistent with the official half-time rule, but the library retains the official result rather than presenting that implementation detail as directly reproduced under 6.36.

Order, interruption, and return

Call God resolves at hosting step 16. A caller removed by an earlier ritual or magic battle cannot be assumed to contribute. Once step 16 has passed, a later assassination or ordinary battle cannot retroactively remove that month's points. This timing conclusion follows directly from the official hosting order.

The manual places the returning Pretender in the nation's home province. Current community documentation refines this to the capital province: inside the fort when the nation still owns it, even under siege, and outside the walls if the capital has been lost. A hostile return can cause an immediate fight. These placement details remain Current Community Reference until a 6.36 return-state reproduction or later official wording is preserved.

Version 6.28 repaired Call God when the order was issued without its keyboard shortcut. That was an order-interface defect, not a change to the contribution model. No later official update through 6.36 changes Call God.

R-017 decision

R-017 is complete at a mixed evidence tier:

- Official: the order, ordinary Holy contribution model, Disciple-game 50% increase, home-province return, Elegist and Recall God modifiers, Trinity half-time rule, and hosting step;
- Community-tested: fixed 50-point ordinary threshold and per-priest effective-rating `-1/0/+1` variation;
- Current Community Reference: detailed Disciple routing and capital/fort placement.

Future direct runtime testing would upgrade the last two layers, but the present evidence is sufficient for planning as long as the labels remain attached.

Recall opportunity cost

Every calling priest is not:

- blessing an army;
- preaching;
- blood sacrificing;
- claiming a Throne;
- researching if also a mage;
- moving with a force;
- performing another special order.

A recall plan should identify the priests before the god takes a high-risk battle.

Immortality

Dominion Immortal

A dominion-immortal Pretender normally reforms if killed in friendly dominion. Death outside friendly dominion requires Call God.

Immortal

An Immortal normally reforms regardless of friendly dominion on the ordinary plane.

Limits

- Soul Slay or equivalent soul destruction can prevent ordinary reform and require Call God.
- Death on a remote plane can prevent immortality.
- Reform time is often about three months but varies by form.
- Reform removes most afflictions.
- Immortality alone does not improve ordinary affliction recovery while alive.

Dominion-immortal combat planning should always include the candle state at the battle location and the possibility that dominion changes before combat resolves.

Safe and unsafe risk

Situation	Principal risk
Immortal god in ordinary plane	Temporary absence, items, operational gap, soul attacks
Dominion Immortal in strong friendly candles	Same, plus candle reversal before battle
Dominion Immortal on frontier	Failure to reform if dominion becomes hostile
Any god on remote plane	Immortality may not operate
Any god facing soul destruction	Call God and permanent-loss consequences
Non-immortal god in battle	Full recall delay, path or dominion loss, disabled Incarnate bless

Part IX: Special Dominions

Why special dominions deserve their own audit

Some nations transform candles into effects far beyond ordinary scales and morale. Special dominions may:

- kill population;
- create units;
- spread disease or insanity;
- change terrain;
- alter unrest;
- hide information;
- empower constructs;
- enable movement;
- modify religious conflict.

The design question becomes:

```
value of another candle =
ordinary dominion value
+ special national effect
+ scale convergence
+ survival value
```

Major categories

Nation or family	Special dominion effect	Strategic consequence
Arcoscephale, all ages	Accurate scrying throughout dominion, including Glamour detection	Candles become an intelligence network
EA and LA Mictlan	Dying dominion and blood-sacrifice dependence	Blood economy and temples are core religious logistics
Yomi	Oni arise from temples according to turmoil, terrain, and temperature	Scales, temples, and terrain form a freespawn system
MA Ermor	Population death and undead arising	Civilian economy is converted into an undead dominion
MA Asphodel	Population death and Manikin generation	Growth, forests, corpses, and dominion interact unusually
MA C'tis	Miasma, disease, rain, wetness, and terrain effects	Friendly and hostile forces experience different economic and disease pressure
MA Agartha	Golem Cult improves constructs' Hit Points	Candles can strengthen friendly, allied, and enemy constructs
LA R'lyeh	Dreamlands spread insanity and related effects	Dominion is psychological warfare as well as faith
EA Therodos	Population death and fort-related ghost generation	Forts and dominion convert population into spectral power
Phaeacia	Dark-ship sailing linked to friendly dominion	Candles become movement infrastructure
EA Mekone	Improved effective maximum in dominion conflict	Religious contests behave better than the printed initial score suggests
MA and LA Phlegra	Dominion-linked unrest	More candles can carry an internal economic cost
Ubar, Na'Ba, Ind, Feminie	Province information can be hidden	Dominion creates strategic uncertainty

This table identifies system categories, not complete nation guides. Exact inheritance by Disciples and exact scale formulas belong in the later nation dossiers.

Special-dominion design questions

1. Does the effect scale with local candles, maximum dominion, temples, or merely presence?
2. Does it affect allies, Disciples, enemies, or everyone?
3. Does it operate underwater, in caves, or on remote planes?
4. Does it change population, terrain, unrest, or recruitment permanently?
5. Can an enemy exploit the effect?
6. Does high dominion improve the effect enough to justify its point curve?
7. What happens if the special dominion overruns a valuable captured economy?

Part X: Teams and Disciples

Shared and separate systems

In a disciple game:

- the team has one Pretender and one or more Disciples;
- disciples awaken in about half the Pretender's delayed time;

- team size increases the number of temples required to raise maximum dominion;
- Call God requires 50% more progress;
- claimed-Throne blessings can be shared within the team;
- ordinary team play has no Prophets because Disciples fill the religious role.

The team needs one religious network, not a collection of independent personal builds.

Disciple design audit

Record:

- which Pretender blessings the Disciple and sacreds receive;
- which Incarnate effects depend on the Pretender's state;
- which special dominion effects transfer to the Disciple;
- temple responsibility by geography;
- preaching and blood-sacrifice responsibility;
- Call God priest reserve;
- Throne-claiming access;
- land-sea religious boundaries;
- whether the Disciple's personal paths and body create an independent battlefield role.

Some special dominions transfer fully, some partially, and some not at all. This must be checked nation by nation.

Part XI: The Frozen Modded Ruleset

Exact definitions belong to Book IX

The former edition repeated DE's global scale table, the complete blessing delta, broad command counts, and Divinitus chassis counts here. Book IX now provides the corrected source inventory and is the only authoritative home for those figures.

Book III keeps the design consequences:

- DE changes the economic weight of several scales;
- many blessings become cheaper, cross-path, or independent of an awake Incarnate chassis;
- DE broadly rewrites Pretender availability, starting dominion, path cost, and national god lists;
- Divinitus then adds a second chassis layer whose sites, events, items, summons, scale limits, and delayed powers may matter more than the visible card;
- the final design must be calculated after both files load.

This division matters. Book IX answers, "What did the files define?" Book III answers, "How should a player reason about the resulting design?"

Modded-design audit

For every combined design:

1. name the exact nation and form ID;
2. confirm final form availability after load order;
3. record final starting paths and New Path Cost;
4. record final starting dominion;

5. record final scale limits;
6. record prison restrictions;
7. calculate blessing costs from Book IX's current table;
8. identify non-Incarnate and cross-path conversions;
9. check national bless-point bonuses;
10. test displayed totals in the actual design screen.

Part XII: Complete Design Method

Step 1: Define the national plan

Write one sentence:

> The nation intends to reach this first military state, using these units and spells, by this turn range, while preserving this economy or late-game route.

If the sentence cannot be written, Pretender selection is premature.

Step 2: Identify mandatory constraints

Examples:

- sacreds require Fire Resistance to survive the nation's own battlefield plan;
- ordinary expansion fails without a personal expander;
- the roster has no feasible path into a required ritual;
- capital sacred throughput requires Dominion 8;
- the special dominion needs rapid temple expansion;
- the first war is expected before a dormant god can arrive.

Mandatory constraints eliminate designs before subjective preference begins.

Step 3: Build the cheapest functional design

Purchase only the elements needed to make the plan work:

- minimum reliable expansion package;
- minimum bless breakpoint;
- minimum dominion for sacred throughput and faith;
- minimum magic access;
- acceptable scales;
- correct awakening.

This creates a baseline against which luxuries can be priced.

Step 4: Spend the remainder on leverage

Possible leverage:

- one more dominion candle;
- a scale threshold;
- a second resistance;

- a new path;
- a better chassis;
- earlier awakening;
- an Incarnate blessing;
- broader divine magic;
- more robust expansion.

Each addition should have a named use.

Step 5: Test the opening

Run repeated expansion tests against:

- heavy infantry;
- cavalry;
- archers;
- barbarians;
- undead;
- poison;
- high defence;
- high protection;
- unusual terrain;
- the strongest common independent province under the lobby settings.

Record losses and failure conditions, not only wins.

Step 6: Test the first war

Construct a representative enemy answer:

- armour;
- evocations;
- poison;
- fatigue;
- magic weapons;
- MR-negates control;
- flyers or flankers;
- sacred counters;
- anti-thug tools.

The purpose is not to prove invincibility. It is to identify what scouting must detect and which research branch answers it.

Step 7: Test the economy

Simulate at least twelve turns of:

- capital recruitment;
- expansion parties;
- first fort and laboratory;
- mage recruitment;
- upkeep;
- Holy Point use;

- resource and RP bottlenecks;
- temple schedule.

Strong paper scales can still fail to fund the intended sequence.

Step 8: State the failure modes

A publishable design should name:

- its worst independent matchup;
- its first-war counter;
- its economic bottleneck;
- its Incarnate dependency;
- its god-death consequence;
- its map weakness;
- the latest safe arrival;
- the research branch it cannot afford early.

Part XIII: New-Player and Expert Audits

New-player design audit

Before confirming:

- Does the total equal the design screen?
- Can the nation expand without assuming perfect battles?
- Who blesses the sacreds?
- Are the important effects Incarnate?
- When does the god arrive?
- Do the scales support the troops actually being recruited?
- Is temperature set relative to national preference?
- Is dominion high enough for the intended sacred output?
- What does the god do after expansion?
- Which path solves a national magic gap?
- What happens if the god dies?
- Is any number copied from an unmodded guide into a modded game?

Expert design audit

Budget

- marginal point cost of every path;
- marginal point cost of every candle;
- scale-limit opportunity cost;
- point value of awakening delay;
- unused point remainder.

Timing

- expansion turn targets;
- first fort and lab;
- research breakpoints;
- awakening range;
- first Incarnate-bless battle;
- first ritual or forge use;
- first expected enemy timing.

Religion

- starting maximum dominion;
- temple thresholds;
- checks per month;
- front-line preaching;
- blood-sacrifice capacity;
- land-sea barriers;
- special-dominion effects;
- dominion-kill recovery.

Bless

- recipients per month;
- activation method;
- effect by combat role;
- effect while god absent;
- counters;
- scale and side requirements;
- commander and mage beneficiaries.

God risk

- safe dominion for combat;
- immortality limits;
- soul-destruction exposure;
- remote-plane exposure;
- recall priest-months;
- item loss;
- path or dominion loss;
- turns without Incarnate effects.

Mod integrity

- exact patch;
- exact `.dm` files;
- hashes;
- load order;
- final design-screen values;
- whether a later mod overwrites the form or nation.

Part XIV: Controlled-Test Programme

Test P1: Awakening distribution

For awake, dormant, and imprisoned forms:

1. use identical nation, map, seed policy, and game settings;
2. use at least 200 independent seeds per delayed state rather than repeatedly re-hosting one save;
3. record the first turn on which the god is present and the corresponding announcement state;
4. repeat for Disciples and Trinity forms;
5. publish every raw result, the game version, seed method, minimum, maximum, median, mean, frequency table, and confidence intervals;
6. compare the current sample against the older `9 + exploding d4` and `27 + exploding d20` hypotheses without assuming that either survived into Dominions 6.

Purpose: determine the current distribution rather than merely rediscovering the official range.

Test P2: Dominion spread

Create controlled maps with:

- fixed adjacency;
- no competing sources;
- exact temple counts;
- maximum dominion 1 through 10;
- neutral, friendly, and hostile target candles;
- land and sea boundaries.

Record at least several hundred check opportunities per condition.

Purpose: reproduce trigger chance, propagation, contest chance, and land-sea rerolls.

Test P3: Preaching

Test H1-H5:

- with and without temple;
- neutral, friendly, and enemy dominion;
- ordinary and Inquisitor;
- at and above the predicted cap.

Purpose: verify fractional Holy handling, minimum chance, and cap rounding.

Test P4: Scale convergence

For candle strengths 1-10 and differences 1-10:

1. lock out events and rituals where possible;
2. record monthly scale changes;
3. include cases above 100% predicted chance;
4. test whether two-step movement occurs;
5. repeat under extreme neighbouring scales.

Test P5: Scale regression and rounding

Use controlled identical provinces to confirm version stability and settle:

- the published 2% Growth/Death income baseline;
- the published 2% Order/Turmoil resource baseline;
- Order/Turmoil event-frequency effect;
- rounding order;
- hostile-dominion application;
- Magic and Drain rounding.

Test P6: Bless tags and values

For every blessing:

- inspect the design-screen prerequisite and cost;
- inspect unit abilities before blessing;
- bless in battle;
- remove or kill the Pretender;
- test innate and Incarnate states;
- test stacking;
- record damage, MR, resistance, sight, and "damaging hit" conditions.

Repeat unmodded, DE only, and DE plus Divinitus.

Test P7: Automatic blessing

Cross:

- Pretender present or absent;
- Disciple present or absent;
- friendly, neutral, and enemy dominion;
- sacred troop and sacred commander;
- god alive, dead, and imprisoned.

Purpose: define exactly which units begin blessed under each condition.

Test P8: Pretender death

For controlled path arrays:

- ordinary death;
- dominion-immortal death in friendly and enemy dominion;
- immortal death;
- Soul Slay;
- remote-plane death;
- repeated deaths.

Record:

- path lost or gained;
- dominion lost;
- reform time;
- afflictions;
- Incarnate blessing state;

- Call God requirement.

Test P9: Call God

Regression-test the published model with:

- H1-H5 priests;
- mixed groups;
- Trinity member;
- ordinary Pretender, main Pretender in a Disciple game, and dead Disciple;
- nations with `#recallgod`;
- Elegists and combined Elegist/Recall God cases;
- pre-step-16 and post-step-16 priest deaths;
- friendly, besieged, and hostile capital states.

Purpose: upgrade the community-tested threshold, contribution distribution, routing, and placement rules to a direct current-version reproduction and detect later regressions.

Test P10: Throne checks

Claim level-one, level-two, and level-three Thrones in controlled maps.

Record:

- checks per month;
- whether each check is guaranteed;
- target selection;
- interaction with maximum dominion;
- claimant death after step 8;
- unfortified conquest after step 8;
- siege without storming;
- successful storming and recapture;
- Ascension Point state immediately before the step-57 victory check;
- disciple sharing.

The claim-loss matrix is already resolved at the stated mixed evidence tier. These cases are retained as regression tests. The separate unresolved branch is the result of simultaneous winning totals, especially an exact tie in Ascension Points.

Test P11: Special dominions

Each special dominion receives a nation-specific harness measuring:

- candle dependence;
- ally and Disciple treatment;
- underwater and remote-plane operation;
- unit generation;
- population and unrest change;
- terrain transformation;
- information hiding;
- enemy exploitation.

Test P12: Combined-mod design regression

For every published combined design:

1. save the design file;
2. record displayed cost, paths, scales, dominion, and blessing;
3. update one mod at a time;
4. reload and compare;
5. flag any changed prerequisite, cost, availability, or form statistic.

Part XV: Strategic Essays

Essay I: Pretender Design as National Engineering

A Pretender is often described through an archetype: expander, rainbow, titan, scales chassis, bless chassis. These labels are useful only if they lead back to the nation. Engineering begins with a requirement, not a component catalogue.

The nation possesses a machine already. Its troops convert gold, resources, Recruitment Points, and Holy Points into armies. Its mages convert gold and commander-turns into research, gems into spells, and research into timing windows. Its dominion converts temples and priests into candles, then candles into scales, morale, survival, and national effects. The Pretender changes the machine's inputs and supplies missing parts.

A good design has internal causality.

Productivity is bought because the planned queue exhausts resources. Dominion is bought because sacred throughput, religious conflict, or a special dominion uses it. A path is bought because it opens a blessing, booster, ritual, or divine spell that matters on a timetable. Awake status is bought because the god's early commander-turns are worth more than the points surrendered.

Bad designs often contain individually powerful elements with no causal chain. Strong scales produce more gold, but the capital is Holy-limited. A deep blessing improves sacreds, but they are capital-only and too expensive to mass. A rainbow reaches many paths, but the nation cannot research or fund the promised rituals before the game is decided. An awake titan expands, but ordinary troops could have done the same while the 150-point difference funded the whole economy.

Engineering does not demand one correct answer. It demands that alternatives be compared against the same requirements.

One design may solve expansion with an awake monster and accept average scales. Another may solve it with an inexpensive blessing on national sacreds. A third may use ordinary troops, imprison the god, and turn the saved points into production and research. The correct comparison measures territory, losses, fort timing, research, vulnerability, and future path access-not aesthetic preference.

The final test is replaceability. Remove one purchase and ask what fails. If nothing important fails, the purchase is luxury. Replace the chassis and ask which jobs disappear. If none do, the form is overpriced. Move the first war ten turns earlier and ask whether the design remains coherent. If it collapses, its timing assumptions belong in the guide.

Pretender design becomes clearer when treated as national engineering because every point must enter a machine that can use it.

Essay II: Dominion Is Territory by Other Means

Military maps invite a simple reading: coloured provinces are power. Dominion adds a second map beneath the first. It is a map of belief, morale, climate, legitimacy, and metaphysical survival.

The two maps spread differently. An army moves along a route and fights for a province. Dominion begins with sources, attempts checks, consolidates weak provinces, relays through strong ones, and grinds against enemy candles. A nation can win the military battle and inherit hostile scales. It can hold a fortress while its god weakens outside. It can raid a temple and reduce pressure across an entire religious front.

Dominion is a network because the value of a source depends on the state around it. A temple behind strong candles may relay checks to the frontier. The same temple behind a hostile wall may spend months reducing a single province. Five temples can be worth more than four plus one because the fifth raises maximum dominion, improving every check. In a team, that threshold moves with the number of players and changes who should build where.

Preaching is different. It is local, labour-intensive, and independent of the ordinary maximum. This makes priests tactical religious units. They can prepare a throne, hold a capital, weaken an immortal god's safe ground, or reclaim a province faster than distant temples can reach it. Inquisitors are specialists in this conflict. Blood sacrifice turns a stored magical resource into additional checks and can overwhelm an ordinary temple economy when properly supplied.

Special dominions make the second map still more concrete. Candles can kill population, raise undead, create Manikins, scry enemies, hide ownership, spread disease, generate unrest, empower constructs, or enable sailing. In these nations, religious infrastructure is part of the military and economic production system.

Dominion death reveals the final importance of faith. A nation without friendly candles dies even if its armies remain undefeated. Religious survival is not flavour attached to conquest. It is a separate victory and defeat condition with its own network and logistics.

Territory supplies the state. Dominion determines whose reality governs it.

Essay III: A Bless Is a Roster Contract

A blessing has no independent battlefield value. It has recipients, activation conditions, counters, and a price paid before the map exists.

The recipient is the beginning. A point of Attack applied to hundreds of inexpensive sacred attacks is not the same purchase as a point of Attack on a handful of already accurate giants. Regeneration on high-Hit-Point elites is not the same as regeneration on units killed by a single decisive hit. Leadership on sacred commanders can matter in every army while an offensive weapon blessing matters only when sacred troops reach melee and connect.

Throughput is the second condition. Capital-only sacreds, Holy Points, gold, resources, and Commander Points all restrict how much of the blessing enters the world. A huge design investment can end up enhancing a small fraction of the army. Conversely, a modest passive effect on recruit-everywhere sacred mages or commanders can alter a large part of the national economy.

Activation is the third condition. Ordinary sacreds need priests, scripts, time, and battlefield geometry. Incarnate effects need the god awake and alive. An imprisoned Incarnate design may exist on the Pretender screen while remaining absent from the first thirty turns. A god's death can remove the centre of a sacred strategy without killing a single sacred.

Counterplay is the fourth condition. A weapon rider can face resistance. A control effect can face MR. Glamour defences can face special sight. Protection can face armour-negating damage. Regeneration can face burst damage, decay, poison, fatigue, or battlefield removal. A massed sacred army can be avoided, raided around, or starved of priests.

A blessing is a contract. The nation pays design points and accepts the opportunity cost. In return, the roster must field enough suitable sacreds, bless them in the battles that matter, and create matchups where the effects can change the result.

When those promises are explicit, bless design becomes testable. When they are not, "strong bless" is only an adjective.

Essay IV: Awake Power and Deferred Power

Awakening is a trade across time. Awake status purchases commander-turns now by refusing future design points. Dormancy and imprisonment purchase permanent design advantages by surrendering early agency.

The apparent comparison-zero, 150, or 350 points-is incomplete. Time changes what each point can become.

An awake expander may take provinces before a dormant god exists. Those provinces generate income, resources, sites, recruitment locations, and strategic position. The expander may also free gold and commanders that ordinary expansion parties would have consumed. Early power can compound.

Deferred power compounds too. Stronger scales affect every held province. A better blessing affects every sacred recruited. Additional paths can unlock rituals and forging for the rest of the game. If the nation can expand and deter attack without the god, the point grant may exceed the value of early commander-turns.

The uncertainty of arrival matters. A dormant plan must survive the late end of the arrival range, not only the average. An imprisoned Incarnate blessing must be evaluated as two different armies: the army before awakening and the army after. A strategy that functions only if the god appears on the first legal turn has converted uncertainty into an unpriced risk.

The useful question is not "Is awake or imprisoned stronger?" It is:

> At what turn does each design overtake the other, and what must remain true for that crossover to occur?

If the game's first decisive war happens before the crossover, deferred power may never be collected. If the awake god cannot produce territory, research, or deterrence worth its opportunity cost, immediate availability is being wasted.

Time is not another statistic on the design. It is the dimension in which every statistic is realised.

Essay V: The Religious Logistics of War

Armies require supply, commanders, reinforcement routes, and retreat provinces. Sacred armies require a parallel chain: temples, priests, candles, and an active god where Incarnate effects matter.

The chain begins in recruitment. Holy Points determine how many sacreds leave the queue. Dominion and temple thresholds shape that capacity. Priests must then accompany the army or meet it before battle. Their map movement must match the force. Their scripting must bless the right squads before contact. Their survival must be protected against assassination, arrows, flyers, and battlefield spells.

Dominion determines the environment in which the force operates. Friendly candles provide morale and may automatically bless sacreds alongside the Pretender. They strengthen the god and Prophet. They carry selected scales and special national effects. Enemy candles reverse some of those advantages and may turn a dominion-immortal advance into a permanent death risk.

Temples are logistical nodes. A forward temple does more than increase a global religious score: it adds checks, supports preaching, permits blood sacrifice where eligible, contributes to maximum-dominion thresholds, and may accelerate sacred recruitment or special effects. Like a laboratory or fort, it has a position and a vulnerability.

Religious logistics can be attacked. Priests can be assassinated. Temples can be raided. Candle chains can be contested. A throne can be unclaimed by capture. A god can be killed to disable Incarnate effects. An army designed around automatic or battlefield blessing can be forced into a fight before its religious support arrives.

An expert sacred army is more than a roster with a blessing. It is a supported formation whose religious supply line has been planned as carefully as its food and reinforcements.

Essay VI: The Death of a God

Dominions makes gods powerful by making their death national.

An ordinary commander's death removes a body, equipment, leadership, and perhaps magic. A Pretender's death can additionally remove an Incarnate blessing, path access, dominion strength, ritual timing, expansion capacity, and the nation's central strategic threat. Priests must abandon other work to call the god back. The returned god may be weaker.

This creates a risk budget. A combat Pretender should not be asked merely whether it wins a battle. The correct question is whether the probability and consequence of failure are acceptable relative to the battle's strategic value.

Immortality changes the budget but does not erase it. A dominion-immortal god needs friendly candles at death. An Immortal can still face soul destruction or remote-plane failure. Reform takes time. Equipment and operational tempo remain exposed. A supposedly safe attack can become unsafe when enemy preaching or temple checks reverse the province before combat.

Call God turns priest-months into recovery. The cost can be enormous. The same priests might bless armies, preach a threatened capital, sacrifice blood, or claim a throne. A nation with few priests may own a theoretically recoverable god and lack the practical capacity to recover it before the war ends.

Pretender risk is justified when it creates disproportionate value: a decisive throne, the destruction of an irreplaceable army, the relief of a capital, or a timing window no ordinary force can exploit. It is poorly justified when the god fights a battle that mundane troops could win or raids a province worth less than the risk imposed on the entire national plan.

A god is not preserved by refusing every battle. A god is preserved by spending divine risk only where divine power is necessary.

Part XVI: Reference Checklists

One-page Pretender worksheet

Section	Decision
Nation and ruleset	
Lobby assumptions	
First military state	
Expansion method	
Chassis and role	
Awakening	
Initial and maximum dominion plan	
Scale package	
Paths and exact purposes	
Bless package	
Sacred recipients per month	
Blessing access	
First research breakpoints	
First three god orders	
Temple schedule	
God-death and recall plan	
Principal counters	
Test results	

Monthly dominion audit

- Current maximum dominion.
- Temples until next threshold.
- Friendly-candle core.
- Enemy candle fronts.
- Capitals or Thrones at religious risk.
- Preachers and Inquisitors assigned.
- Blood-sacrifice sites and slave budget.
- Special-dominion damage or benefit.
- Incarnate blessing active or inactive.
- Dominion-immortal safe operating area.

Bless battle audit

- Sacred units began blessed?
- Which round did Blessing or Divine Blessing resolve?
- Which effects were innate?
- Which effects were Incarnate?
- Was the Pretender alive and present as required?
- Did damage riders require a damaging hit?
- Which effects faced MR?
- Which resistances or sight abilities countered the package?

- Did fatigue, morale, or formation fail first?
- Were the casualties economically replaceable?

Publication checklist

- State base patch and manual revision.
- State mods and load order.
- Separate manual, current-data, and modded values.
- Name every current-value conflict.
- State awakening assumptions as ranges.
- State sacred throughput.
- State Incarnate dependence.
- State priest and blessing access.
- State god-death consequences.
- Link tests when an edge case decides the recommendation.

Sources and Open Questions

Principal sources

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, especially Pretender design, Dominion, Divine Magic, Bless Effects, scale effects, Thrones, and Call God.
- Illwinter Dominions 6 documentation.
- Illwinter Dominions 6 changes.
- Illwinter current release record.
- Official 6.08 Steam announcement.
- Official Dominions 6.36 announcement.
- Current Dominions 6 blessing reference.
- Current Dominions 6 scales reference.
- Current Dominions 6 Pretender reference.
- Current Dominions 6 Pretender-design reference, including the 16 June 2026 republication of the awakening model.
- Loggy's miscellaneous reverse-engineering notes, used to trace the awakening formula's pre-Dominions 6 provenance.
- Current Dominions 6 Elegist reference.
- Published Call God research notes.
- Current Dominions 6 Throne reference.
- Published same-turn Throne claim report.
- Legacy Pretender and awakening mechanics page, retained only as a historical test hypothesis where it identifies an older game baseline.
- Dominions 6 Modding Manual 6.34.
- Dominions 6 Inspector, 6.35 data commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbc036ba9bd5dc`.
- Supplied `DomEnhanced2_16.dm`.
- Supplied `Divinitus_1.15.3_DE.dm`.

Open questions

Cross-source stacking, shape inheritance, mount-transfer lifetime, Order/Turmoil event frequency, economic rounding, awakening distributions, simultaneous-victory ties, and special-dominion inheritance remain assigned to their research registers or controlled tests. Same-turn Throne ownership and the practical Call God model are resolved at their stated mixed evidence tiers. Modded blessing costs and chassis definitions should be taken from Book IX rather than from older copies of this chapter.

DOCUMENT 6 OF 16

Foundation Book IV: Armies and Battle

Why battles need a systems view

Dominions 6 battles are not decided by a single comparison between two armies. They are decided by a sequence of contacts, checks, delays, target choices, damage rolls, fatigue thresholds, morale failures, and retreat outcomes. A force can possess more gold value, more bodies, and more nominal damage yet still lose because it reaches the wrong part of the field, exhausts itself, exposes its commanders, or begins routing before its strength can be applied.

> Foundation rule: An army is not a collection of units. It is a timed delivery system for damage, control, morale pressure, and magic.

The early chapters make the Army Setup screen and battle replay readable. Later chapters deal with formation timing, combat arithmetic, counter design, and the difference between winning one battle and preserving a force for the next. The manual explains much of the arithmetic unusually well, but it does not expose every targeting weight, pathfinding choice, cooldown, or rounding step. Hidden values stay labelled as such.

Edition note

The ruleset and evidence terms come from Book I. Book IV owns battlefield resolution: hit checks, damage, protection, fatigue, morale, retreat, and the combat side of spellcasting. Book V uses those rules to build magical strategy rather than printing them again. Exact DE and Divinitus object changes belong to Book IX and the later nation dossiers.

Current-version corrections that matter

Several post-manual changes materially affect battle analysis:

Version	Current rule or correction	Practical consequence
6.23	Fear can reduce morale by no more than the Fear value, with an absolute maximum reduction of 10	Older descriptions can overstate rapid morale collapse
6.23	Floating mounts are no longer impeded by non-floating riders	Mixed rider-and-mount movement should be judged from the current unit
6.23	Spellcasters do not receive the multiple-weapon fatigue penalty	Armed mages should not be analysed with the ordinary extra-weapon fatigue rule
6.25	Fatigue from flying and trampling was corrected for non-mounted units	Old replays or tests may understate the cost of repeated mobility and trampling
6.25	Battlefield-wide spells cannot normally be cast indoors; holy spells are excepted	Fort interiors and many assassination fields require different spell plans
6.31	Regeneration now follows its percentage accurately rather than old hit-point brackets	Current healing estimates should use the displayed percentage
6.34	Temporary battle effects are correctly removed from Twiceborn units	Persistent-state assumptions from older replays can be wrong
6.35	Innate spellcasters no longer skip their script after recovering from unconsciousness	Script evaluation for innate casters must use current behaviour

Version	Current rule or correction	Practical consequence
6.35	Units that automatically regain mounts now do so at the end of the turn	Post-battle mount recovery affects the next turn's readiness
6.36	Rust now takes effect even when the attack causes no HP damage	Zero final damage does not prove that an equipment-degrading rider failed

Patch corrections do not invalidate the manual's combat structure. They identify the places where an otherwise sound model produces the wrong current result.

Finding the right section

For the first few battles, concentrate on reading unit cards, forming squads, protecting commanders, placing the line, understanding fatigue and morale, and reviewing the replay. The deeper combat chapters become valuable when a matchup turns on shields, repel, trampling, magic resistance, contact geometry, or a precise rout threshold.

Part I: What a Battle Decides

Victory is normally a rout

A Dominions battle is generally fought until one side leaves the field. It is not necessary to kill every enemy. Squads rout when they fail morale checks, all eligible troops rout when their eligible commanders are gone, and an army automatically routs after losing 75% of its weighted total hit points.

This produces four different outcomes that the word "win" can conceal:

Outcome	Field result	Strategic result
Clean victory	Enemy routs with few friendly losses	Force remains ready to expand, raid, or fight again
Pyrrhic victory	Enemy routs after severe friendly losses	Province gained, campaign tempo lost
Productive defeat	Friendly force routs after destroying valuable enemy assets	Field lost, exchange may still improve the war
Catastrophic defeat	Command, mages, or retreat routes fail	Army value is destroyed rather than merely displaced

Kills are an incomplete measure. A spell that causes no direct kills may still win by exhausting, immobilising, frightening, or separating an army. A cheap line can succeed by holding long enough for decisive magic, even if it dies. A killer with an impressive summary can still fail strategically by chasing irrelevant bodies while the centre collapses.

The five layers of battle

Every battle can be read through five layers:

1. Delivery: whether a unit, weapon, spell, or aura reaches a relevant target.
2. Conversion: whether contact becomes a hit, failed resistance check, damage, fatigue, or control effect.

3. Persistence: whether the effect survives protection, resistance, regeneration, recovery, or replacement.
4. Cohesion: whether squads and command remain functional under casualties, fear, fatigue, and displacement.
5. Preservation: whether the surviving force retreats safely, retains mounts and commanders, and can fight again.

Most poor diagnoses stop at conversion: "the weapon could not hurt the armour." Expert diagnosis starts earlier and ends later. The weapon may never have reached the armoured target. The armour may have worked until fatigue enabled armour-defeating hits. The troops may have routed while still physically healthy. The retreat may have converted a recoverable loss into annihilation.

The open-ended random roll

Dominions commonly uses a DRN, an open-ended two-die roll:

```
DRN = 2d6, open-ended
```

When a die shows 6, one is subtracted, the die is rolled again, and the new result is added. Another 6 continues the process. Extreme results are rare, but they remain possible.

The actor normally has to exceed the opposing value. At equal listed values, the actor's chance is about 46%, not 50%, because a tied result fails unless the particular rule awards ties differently.

Acting value minus opposing value	Approximate success
-10	3%
-8	6%
-6	11%
-4	18%
-2	30%
0	46%
+2	62%
+4	76%
+6	86%
+8	92%
+10	95%

This curve creates three lessons:

- small statistical advantages matter;
- no ordinary advantage produces certainty;
- repetition turns modest probability into reliable pressure.

An extra point of Attack, Defence, morale, penetration, or resistance is not a decorative improvement. Its value depends on the current difference and on how many times the comparison occurs.

Long battles

The ordinary expectation is that one force breaks well before the hard limit. When it does not:

Battle turn	Event
100	Twilight: battle enchantments and temporary magic effects end; berserk ends; Precision suffers -2; Glamour magic receives +1
150	Attacker routs; Darkness imposes -3 Attack, Defence, and Precision, or daylight replaces it in a night battle
170	Defender routs
200	All remaining units are killed

The attacker carries a long-battle clock. Stall plans, fatigue traps, regeneration contests, and endless summoning must be judged against role and side. A plan that "cannot lose" in ordinary exchanges can still lose to that clock.

Part II: Reading a Unit

A stat line is a conditional promise

A unit's displayed statistics describe what it can do before formation, fatigue, leadership, terrain, blesses, spells, injuries, and the enemy intervene. The useful question is not "Is this unit good?" It is:

> Under the expected battlefield conditions, which job can this unit perform repeatedly and at acceptable cost?

The first-pass unit card

For a first evaluation, record:

Field	Main question
Hit Points	How much damage can the body absorb, and how does HP weighting affect rout?
Size	How many fit in a square, what can be reached, displaced, mounted, or trampled?
Strength	How much melee damage, carrying capacity, siege force, and trample damage is available?
Attack	How reliably do directed melee attacks beat Defence?
Defence	How reliably are directed melee attacks avoided before harassment and fatigue?
Protection	How much physical damage is removed, and where are helmet and armour coverage weak?
Precision	How tightly do missiles and spells cluster around the target square?
Morale	How long does the squad remain coherent under losses and fear?
Magic Resistance	How well are binary magical effects resisted?
Encumbrance	How quickly do attacks and spellcasting degrade the unit?
Combat Speed	How quickly does the unit cross the field and finish movement cooldowns?
Map Move	How useful is the unit in the campaign rather than one isolated battle?
Resistances	Which elemental, poison, sleep, or other damage families are reduced?
Weapons	Reach, attack and defence modifiers, damage type, number of attacks, and special effects

Field	Main question
Armour and shield	Body and head protection, Defence penalties, Parry, and shield Protection
Abilities	The rules that may dominate the ordinary statistics

Build the effective line

The displayed line should be converted into an effective line for the planned battle:

```
effective Attack
= displayed Attack
+ weapon and spell modifiers
- fatigue penalty
- underwater or injury penalties
- multiple-weapon penalty

effective Defence
= displayed Defence
+ weapon and spell modifiers
- armour and shield penalties already represented where displayed
- fatigue penalty
- harassment
- rout penalty
```

The same method applies to morale, protection, speed, and resistance. A Defence 16 unit that expects to reach 60 fatigue and receive six rapid attacks is not a Defence 16 problem. A Protection 20 unit facing armour-negating shock is not a Protection 20 target. A Morale 15 squad led badly, mixed improperly, and placed in a sparse line may begin the battle far below the headline value.

Roles rather than tiers

Common battlefield roles include:

Role	Primary success condition	Common failure
Line holder	Occupies contact space long enough for the plan to mature	Dies or routs before support resolves
Damage dealer	Converts attacks into relevant damage quickly	Attacks the wrong defence layer or cannot reach
Flanker	Reaches exposed sides or rear	Targeting, zones of control, or congestion redirects it
Screen	Absorbs arrows, charges, spells, or first contact cheaply	Causes friendly obstruction or premature army rout
Missile unit	Applies damage or effects before melee contact	Range, Precision, shields, armour, or friendly fire
Tramper	Converts size, speed, and mass into repeated displacement and AP damage	Fatigue, high Defence, anti-large damage, or friendly congestion
Bodyguard	Prevents assassination or rear access to a commander	Too few, badly placed, or inappropriate against area effects
Buffer	Raises friendly effective statistics before contact	Casts too late, wrong targets, or is interrupted
Controller	Restricts movement, actions, morale, or targeting	Resistance, immunity, range, or poor spell selection
Finisher	Exploits fatigue, rout, or broken protection	Arrives before the target is softened
Summoner	Adds bodies, time, and replacement HP during battle	Exhausts, summons too slowly, or feeds rout weighting
Commander	Maintains leadership, formation, morale, and orders	Exposed command death collapses the army

A unit can occupy several roles, but every additional assumption increases the ways the plan can fail.

Cost must include the campaign

Gold, resources, Recruitment Points, Holy Points, Commander Points, fort access, mage turns, gems, and map mobility all belong in unit valuation. A body that is exceptionally efficient in one battle may still be a poor campaign unit if it is capital-limited, slow to recruit, unable to reach the front, or dependent on a scarce mage package.

Part III: Command, Squads, and Army Construction

Squads are the unit of morale and orders

A commander can lead up to five squads. Each squad receives its own formation, position, and order, and calculates morale separately. Dividing an army into squads is a tactical choice, not clerical organisation.

Splitting troops can:

- produce different target orders;
- stagger contact;
- protect specialised troops behind a screen;
- create flank or rear starting positions;
- prevent one local morale failure from routing every similar unit;
- allow a standard or inspirational commander to support the intended group.

Splitting also carries costs:

- leadership morale bonuses can fall when too many squads are assigned;
- small squads make special morale conditions more relevant;
- more scripts and positions create more opportunities for error;
- a commander's death can still remove every squad under that command from coherent control.

Leadership and squad morale

The manual defines leadership bands:

Base Leadership	Squad allowance before penalty	Morale effect
10	One squad already penalised	-1 with one squad; another -1 to all squads for each extra squad
50	Two squads	0 for one or two; -1 to all for each further squad
100	Three squads	+1 for up to three; each squad above three reduces the bonus by 1
150	Four squads	+2 for up to four; a fifth reduces all to +1
200	Five squads	+3 to all five

These morale effects use the commander's base leadership band. Experience can increase capacity without moving the commander into a better morale band.

Experience modifies leadership capacity:

Experience level	Normal leadership bonus	Poor leader bonus
1	+25	+5
2	+50	+10
3	+50	+10
4	+50	+10
5	+50	+10

This distinction matters when a veteran commander can physically hold a large force but still supplies the original weak morale environment.

Special leadership

Undead and demons require undead leadership. Magic beings require magic leadership. A unit that is both undead and magical uses undead leadership for command.

Mixing categories can reduce morale:

- one undisciplined unit makes the squad undisciplined and imposes -1 morale;
- mixing undead and living units imposes -1 morale;
- mixing demons with ordinary units imposes -1 morale.

An army can fit under the displayed numeric capacity while still being illegally or badly commanded.

Command redundancy

If every eligible commander is killed or routed, the troops rout. A large army under one fragile commander has a single structural hit point.

Command redundancy asks:

- How many eligible commanders can remain if the front commander dies?
- Are they protected from arrows, flyers, assassins, remote damage, and area effects?
- Are magical, undead, and ordinary troops each backed by the correct leadership?
- If a commander retreats, will its troops have a safe route?
- Does a redundant commander carry enough leadership to prevent an immediate secondary failure?

Redundancy is not obtained merely by adding an unrelated scout. The replacement must be eligible to command the affected units and must survive in a relevant position.

Standards, inspiration, and taskmasters

Squad morale can receive:

- home-province bonus;
- friendly-dominion bonus;
- leadership-band modifier;
- Inspiration;
- the highest applicable Standard;
- +1 while blessed.

Standards and Inspiration are not substitutes for correct formation and command. They improve the morale comparison after the triggering condition occurs. They do not prevent command death, excessive fatigue, paralysis, or an automatic 75% army rout.

Taskmasters are primarily relevant to slave leadership and the specific units they govern. A label such as "slave", "undisciplined", "mindless", or "magic being" must be read as an engine category with its own command implications, not as flavour text.

The command audit

Before every important battle:

1. Count squads under every commander.
2. Check the commander's base leadership band.
3. Check ordinary, magic, and undead capacity separately.
4. Remove harmful mixing unless it serves a deliberate purpose.
5. Confirm at least one practical command backup.
6. Protect the commanders whose loss triggers the widest collapse.
7. Verify that retreating commanders have friendly destinations.

Part IV: Formation, Density, and Placement

The square

A battlefield square normally holds ten size points. Three size-3 humans fit because nine size points are used. Formation Fighter permits greater density.

Density changes:

- the number of melee attacks that can be delivered from a square;
- vulnerability to area effects, trampling, clouds, and missiles;
- the amount of space occupied by the line;
- congestion behind the line;
- the rate at which replacements reach contact;
- missile hit probability through size points in the target square.

There is no universally best density. Dense troops convert frontage into attacks; sparse troops convert frontage into area coverage and reduced clustering.

Formation types

Formation	Shape	Requirement	Morale effect	Main use
Box	Compact block	Any disciplined squad	0	Depth, compact defence, concentrated movement
Line	One rank	Good commander	0	Maximum frontage and simultaneous contact
Double line	Two ranks	Good commander	0	Balance of frontage and replacement depth

Formation	Shape	Requirement	Morale effect	Main use
Sparse line	Line with empty squares	Good commander	-1	Wide screen, reduced clustering
Skirmish	Checkerboard	Any; forced for undisciplined	-1	Separation, missile or area-risk management

Skirmisher removes the -1 morale penalty from skirmish and sparse line. Tight Rein allows a commander's undisciplined units to use disciplined formations and specific orders.

Frontage and depth

A wide line places more weapons into early contact, which is valuable when:

- the squad wins individual exchanges;
- weapon reach or repel rewards simultaneous coverage;
- the plan needs to envelop a smaller formation;
- the enemy relies on a narrow, high-value centre.

Depth is valuable when:

- the front rank will die or fatigue;
- replacements must sustain a holding action;
- the force is protecting a compact magical core;
- the enemy uses flyers or rearward pressure;
- the formation must absorb displacement.

The trade is temporal. Width spends bodies early. Depth reserves bodies for later.

Placement is a timing instruction

The Army Setup position determines where a squad begins, not where it is guaranteed to fight. A rear squad on Attack Rear may meet a screening unit. A forward mage can still spend several actions preparing a spell. A fast unit behind a slow block can waste its speed in congestion.

Placement should answer:

- Which squad should make first contact?
- Which should still be unengaged on turns three, five, or ten?
- Which friendly square blocks another unit's path?
- Which commander is visible to flyers or missiles?
- Where will a summoned unit appear relative to the line?
- If the enemy deploys at the opposite extreme, does the timing still work?

Staggered contact

Staggering is created through position, speed, formation, and Hold orders. It can:

- let buffs resolve before the valuable line enters danger;
- make a cheap screen absorb the first charge;
- prevent every squad from suffering the same opening area spell;
- create fresh troops against an already fatigued enemy;
- keep a finisher away from the initial harassment.

It can also fail by feeding squads separately into a stronger enemy. A stagger is useful only if the earlier wave creates time or degradation that the later wave can exploit.

Formation checklist

- Does width or depth serve the unit's actual weapon and role?
- Does the chosen formation impose a morale penalty?
- Can the commander legally provide that formation?
- Is friendly congestion likely?
- Does density worsen the expected enemy counter?
- Will rear or flank placement expose command?
- Is the contact schedule robust to enemy deployment on either side?

Part V: Orders and Scripting

Squad orders

General squad orders include:

Order	Behaviour
None	The combat AI decides
Attack	Advance and fight toward the selected target category
Fire	Use missile weapons against the selected target category
Guard Commander	Remain near and protect the commander; eligible guards may appear in assassination battles
Hold and Attack	Hold for two rounds, firing if able, then attack
Hold and Fire	Hold for two rounds, then fire and move into range as required
Fire and Keep Distance	Fire while attempting to preserve distance
Retreat	Behave as routing and attempt to leave

The common target categories are:

- none or random;
- Archers;
- Cavalry or fast units;
- Fliers;
- Large Monsters, normally size 7 or greater and otherwise size 6;
- Closest;
- Rearmost.

Target orders express preference rather than a teleporting command. Zones of control, blocked paths, range, target availability, and the unit's current contact can prevent the preferred target from being reached.

"Rear" is not a destination

Attack Rear selects a rearward target according to the engine's targeting and pathing. It does not guarantee commander assassination. The squad can:

- collide with a screen;
- be caught by zones of control;
- choose a rear troop block rather than a commander;
- take a path altered by obstacles;
- lose its target and retarget.

Rear pressure is a system made from mobility, placement, survival, and target access. The order is one component.

Hold is exactly two rounds

Hold and Attack and Hold and Fire delay for two rounds. They do not create an indefinite wait. A plan requiring a longer delay must use starting distance, speed, obstacles, spell timing, or a different unit rather than assuming that repeated holding exists for squads.

Commander scripts

A commander can receive five specific orders followed by a general order.

Specific orders include:

- Hold one turn;
- Hold or Fire a weapon;
- Hold or Cast an AI-selected spell;
- Cast a named spell;
- Attack one turn;
- Fly Attack one turn.

General orders include:

- Stay Behind Troops;
- Attack;
- Cast Spells;
- Advance and Cast;
- Retreat.

If a named spell lacks the required gems or a valid target in range, the caster can fall back to an AI-selected spell. A script is a preferred branch, not an infallible playback.

Conservative gem use

Conservative gem use makes a mage spend gems sparingly and primarily on scripted spells. It can prevent waste in routine fights, but it can also withhold power from an unscripted emergency. The setting belongs in the battle plan:

- scripted gem expenditure;
- intended post-script behaviour;
- expected enemy strength;
- value of gems compared with the force at risk.

"Save gems" is not automatically conservative when the result is the loss of the mage carrying them.

Script construction

A robust script is built in this order:

1. State the battle objective. Hold, kill, rout, delay, break a siege, extract a raider, or destroy a specific asset.
2. State the enemy defence layers. Protection, Defence, shields, resistance, MR, regeneration, size, morale, mobility.
3. Assign answers. Each important defence layer needs a delivery mechanism.
4. Create the contact schedule. Decide which friendly element meets the enemy first.
5. Place enabling effects before dependent effects. Accuracy, resistance, mobility, protection, path boosts, and battlefield conditions often need sequencing.
6. Write failure branches. Named spell unavailable, target out of range, caster interrupted, screen destroyed, enemy deploys elsewhere.
7. Set gem policy.
8. Protect command and retreat.
9. Test both attacker and defender sides.

Timing templates

Screen and strike

- cheap or resistant screen forward;
- decisive troops delayed or placed behind;
- buffers script enabling effects;
- damage package begins as contact fixes the enemy.

Failure: the screen routs so early that morale or pathing disrupts the strike.

Armour break

- hold the line;
- apply armour-piercing, armour-negating, rust, Strength, or fatigue pressure;
- commit ordinary damage after the protection layer has been weakened.

Failure: the anti-armour component targets the wrong bodies or arrives after the line collapses.

Fatigue collapse

- survive early damage;
- impose heat, cold, shock, spell fatigue, trampling cost, repeated attack cost, or exhaustion;
- exploit falling Attack and Defence;
- finish unconscious targets.

Failure: the enemy kills faster than fatigue accumulates or possesses sufficient resistance and reinvigoration.

Morale break

- cause heavy losses or fear near selected squads;
- remove leadership or standards;

- force repeated checks;
- preserve enough mobile pressure to turn rout into strategic loss.

Failure: mindless, berserk, high-morale, or well-led troops ignore the intended pressure.

Rear disruption

- occupy the main line;
- send suitable mobile units around or over it;
- threaten fragile command and casters;
- prevent the rear force from being intercepted or stranded.

Failure: Attack Rear is treated as a guarantee rather than a pathfinding preference.

Script audit

- Are all named spells researched?
- Does each caster have the correct gems?
- Are path boosts active before the spell that requires them?
- Is the target likely to exist and be in range?
- Does the spell work underwater, indoors, in a storm, or in the current plane?
- What does the mage do after the fifth order?
- Will fatigue make the final scripted spell impossible or suicidal?
- Are duplicated battlefield enchantments wasting actions?
- Is every commander protected during preparation time?
- Does the plan survive an enemy Hold, flank deployment, or fast charge?

Part VI: Movement, Contact, and Time

Combat speed and cooldown

A move of one square costs roughly one point of combat speed; diagonal movement costs about 50% more. Units act individually. After moving or striking they receive a cooldown. A strike generally creates a long cooldown of about a round; movement creates a shorter cooldown influenced mainly by combat speed with some randomness.

When adjacent units are ready, the one whose cooldown finishes first attacks. Combat speed affects more than time to contact. It influences:

- path crossing;
- replacement into gaps;
- disengaged movement;
- how quickly a unit acts after a step;
- whether a fast unit can exploit a displaced or newly exposed square.

It does not multiply melee attacks as though every point were an attack-speed statistic.

Zones of control

An adjacent enemy creates a zone of control that normally halts movement. Routing units ignore zones of control.

Zones of control turn screens into spatial tools. A cheap body can stop or redirect a more valuable unit even if it cannot defeat that unit. Conversely, a fast flanker that touches the wrong enemy may lose its strategic role.

Displacement

A unit at least three size points larger than each displaced unit can enter an otherwise full square by displacing smaller occupants, at an additional cost of one combat-speed point. Non-routing tramplers avoid displacing friendly units because doing so would harm them.

Displacement can:

- break a neat line;
- expose units behind it;
- create congestion;
- change targeting and adjacency;
- move victims even when trample damage is avoided.

Obstacles and battlefield terrain

Obstacles, gates, walls, caves, water, storms, darkness, and indoor battlefields can alter legal movement and spell use. The manual establishes the large rules but not every pathfinding weight. Exact obstacle navigation belongs to map-specific observation and tests.

Treat battlefield terrain as a component of the script:

- Can the wide line physically deploy?
- Will large units fit through a gate?
- Can flyers operate under the current condition?
- Is the battle indoors, preventing most battlefield-wide magic?
- Does darkness penalise the army more than its opponent?
- Is the weather changing fire, cold, Precision, or storm-dependent abilities?

Part VII: Melee Resolution

The hit check

For a directed melee attack:

```
Attack roll = Attack + DRN - fatigue penalty
Defence roll = Defence + DRN - fatigue penalty
```

The attacker must exceed the defender. The defender wins ties.

Fatigue penalties are:

```
Defence penalty = floor(Fatigue / 10)
Attack penalty = floor(Fatigue / 20)
```

Defence collapses twice as quickly as Attack. This asymmetry is one reason fatigue turns stable lines into sudden massacres.

Damage and protection

After a hit:

```
Damage roll = Strength + weapon Damage + DRN
Protection roll = relevant Protection + DRN
+ shield Protection on a shield hit
```

Damage is inflicted only when the damage roll exceeds the protection roll.

The displayed damage figure for a weapon may already incorporate Strength and weapon rules in the interface. The formula explains resolution; it should not be used to add Strength twice to a value already presented as final damage.

Shields: avoidance and absorption

A shield has:

- Defence implications included in the unit's effective Defence;
- a Parry value;
- a Protection value.

If the attack beats Defence but not Defence plus Parry, it is a shield hit and shield Protection is added to the protection roll. If it also beats Defence plus Parry, it is a clean hit and the shield does not add Protection.

Shields create two defensive layers:

1. a wider band in which an attack strikes the shield;
2. added protection when that occurs.

They are not a flat chance to cancel all attacks.

Armour-defeating protection rolls

An unusually low protection die can produce an armour-defeating hit that bypasses 25% of protection:

Target state	Protection die results that qualify
Below 50 fatigue	2
50 or more fatigue	2-3
100 or more fatigue	2-4
Immobilised or unconscious	Treated as 100 fatigue

Protection remains valuable, but fatigue increases the tail risk that heavy armour is partly bypassed. This is another mechanism by which fatigue converts time into lethality.

Shield damage

Shield resistance is:

```
shield resistance = shield Protection + 5 if magical
```

Break force uses the incoming damage before ordinary protection:

- slashing attacks receive +50% for shield breaking;

- blunt attacks receive +25%;
- at three times resistance, the shield is damaged;
- at five times resistance, it breaks;
- a damaged shield hit again has a 25% chance to break.

A damaged shield loses 20% of its Protection; a broken shield loses 50%. Damaged magical shields repair after battle, but a broken magical shield is permanently destroyed. Mundane shields require spare provincial resources for repair.

Hit locations and reach

The ordinary hit-location distribution is:

Location	Chance
Torso	50%
Arms	20%
Legs	20%
Head	10%

Reach limits which locations can be struck:

- head requires attacker size plus weapon length at least target size;
- torso requires one less;
- arms require two less.

Some low-bodied monsters are easier to reach. An attacker significantly larger than the target shifts the normal distribution toward head hits: head rises to 20% and legs fall to 10%. For mounted attackers, mount size is used for this comparison.

Damage to an arm, leg, or non-essential head is capped at half the target's maximum HP during melee resolution. Location still matters greatly because affliction type and armour coverage depend on it.

Weapon damage types

Type	Effect
Blunt	+25% damage on head hits before protection; +25% shield-breaking force
Slashing	+25% damage after protection; +50% shield-breaking force; can sever a struck limb or head when the hit costs at least half maximum HP
Piercing	Reduces protection by 15%
Armour Piercing	Reduces protection by 50%
Piercing plus Armour Piercing	Total protection reduction of 65%
Armour Negating	Ignores ordinary protection entirely

Two-handed weapons add 125% of Strength rather than the ordinary Strength contribution to damage.

Weapons with several damage types can select among them according to the weapon definition. A label such as slash/pierce should not be analysed as if both protection modifications always apply simultaneously.

Underwater weapon penalties

Underwater:

- slashing and blunt attacks receive an Attack penalty equal to weapon length;
- piercing attacks receive no such penalty;
- mixed piercing weapons halve the penalty;
- flails receive another -1.

A weapon that works well on land can become a liability underwater even when the unit itself can breathe.

Multiple weapons and attacks

A unit wielding several ordinary weapons suffers an Attack penalty equal to the sum of their lengths. Ambidextrous offsets this penalty. Bonus and natural weapons do not create the ordinary multiple-weapon penalty.

Each additional wielded weapon after the first adds one Encumbrance. Current official rules exempt spellcasters from the multiple-weapon fatigue penalty, but not from every possible attack interaction of the weapons themselves.

Multiple attacks matter because they:

- create more hit checks;
- create more harassment;
- can threaten multiple units;
- trigger more defensive and strikeback effects;
- spend fatigue and expose the attacker to repel interactions.

Harassment

Every directed melee attack against a unit gives one point of harassment penalty. Each point reduces Defence by one. The penalty decays over time by a percentage rather than disappearing all at once.

- a weapon with multiple attacks gives harassment per attack;
- ranged and area-effect attacks do not;
- rider and mount are separate harassment targets.

Harassment is why a crowd of weak attackers can make a high-Defence elite vulnerable to the attack that matters. The weak attacks need not cause damage to create value.

The precise decay function is not stated in the manual and remains test pending for this library.

Repel

When the defender's weapon is longer, it automatically attempts to repel the directed melee attack.

The sequence is:

1. a repel attack-and-defence comparison occurs;
2. if the repel attack would hit, the attacker makes a morale comparison;
3. failure aborts the attack;
4. success permits a repel damage roll;
5. if the repel causes any damage, it is capped at one and the original attack then continues.

The morale comparison is:

```
attacker = Morale + DRN - weapon-length difference
repeller = 10 + DRN + half the margin by which the repel attack won
```

The repelling unit acquires a lingering -2 repel penalty after repeated repel attempts; it decays with time. Size-6 or larger giants count their weapons as one length longer for repel.

Repel combines Attack, weapon length, morale, and tempo. A long weapon on an inaccurate, exhausted unit is not automatically good at repelling attacks.

Melee resolution order

The manual gives this useful order:

1. Determine target, including rider or mount.
2. Resolve early strikeback effects such as Awe or petrifying gaze; abort if the attacker becomes immobilised.
3. Resolve repel.
4. Resolve later strikeback effects such as Slimer, Sight Vengeance, or Horror Mark Attacker; abort if immobilised.
5. Resolve Attack against Defence.
6. Resolve damage against protection.
7. Resolve defensive abilities such as Mirror Image, Protective Force, Luck, or Mossbody.
8. Apply limb damage cap.
9. Apply redistribution such as Damage Reversal, Blood Bond, or Vengeance.
10. Deal damage, including shield consequences.

If damage redistribution kills the attacker at step nine, the attack is not retroactively cancelled.

Part VIII: Missiles and Ranged Delivery

Deviation

A projectile begins to deviate when range exceeds roughly half Precision minus two.

The manual gives:

```
deviation = range x 1.25 / Precision
```

Precision above 10 receives double value for the excess: Precision 12 is treated as 14 for this purpose.

The formula is best read as expected scatter around a targeted square rather than a direct chance to hit one individual.

The square hit check

After a projectile reaches a square, a target is selected with size weighting. The hit comparison is:

```
attacker = DRN + half the size points in the square + 2 if the weapon is magical
defender = DRN + twice shield Parry - Fatigue / 20
```

The attacker must exceed the defender.

This produces several non-obvious results:

- crowded squares are easier to hit;
- large bodies attract more hits within a square;
- shields are central missile defence;
- fatigue reduces missile defence;
- magical missiles gain accuracy at the square-hit stage.

Ranged damage

Missile damage then uses the ordinary damage-versus-protection structure. Many missiles add half Strength rather than full Strength. Crossbows and similar weapons often gain armour-piercing properties. Lightning is commonly armour negating; fire is commonly armour piercing. The actual weapon definition controls the result.

Missiles can hit friendly units. Screens, line width, range, and the timing of melee contact all affect friendly-fire risk.

Evaluating archery

Archery value is the product of:

```
number of shots
x probability of relevant square delivery
x probability of hitting a body
x probability of defeating protection
x strategic value of the target
```

"Many arrows" can be useful without many kills if they:

- damage shields;
- interrupt casters;
- inflict poison or elemental effects;
- remove fragile command;
- force the enemy into a resistant but less efficient composition.

They can also be almost irrelevant against the wrong armour and shield layer.

Ranged audit

- Is the target category likely to select the intended units?
- Is range beyond the accurate envelope?
- Are friendly troops about to enter the target squares?
- Are shields, Air Shield, protection, resistance, or mist negating the package?
- Does ammunition last long enough?
- Does Hold and Fire change the contact schedule usefully?
- Would a wider or sparser formation improve delivery or survival?

Part IX: Mounts, Trampling, and Size

Rider and mount are separate

Dominions 6 treats rider and mount as separate targets with separate HP, statistics, attacks, morale interactions, and afflictions. Area effects and lightning can hit both.

An evaluation of cavalry asks:

- what protects the rider;
- what protects the mount;
- which attacks each performs;
- what happens if one component routs or dies;
- whether equipment affects one or both;
- how replacement and mount recovery work after battle.

Hitting mounted units

The mount becomes more likely to be targeted when much larger than the rider:

Mount size advantage	Additional mount targeting rule
3	25%
4	50%
5 or more	75%

Otherwise:

- missiles have a 50% chance to target the mount;
- if mount size is at least reach plus two, the mount is targeted;
- otherwise mount chance is `30% + 10% x mount size - 10% x reach`, with a 10% minimum.

Trample always targets the mount. Area effects and lightning hit both components.

Mounted combat

Both rider and mount can attack. A rider using a two-handed weapon while mounted receives -3 Attack. Skilled Rider improves the mount's morale and Defence; the amount of usable Defence is affected by mount armour Encumbrance.

Magic items on the rider do not automatically apply every effect to the mount. The item or effect must say so. Mount armour uses the barding slot where available.

Mounted morale

Fear can affect rider and mount. If the rider routs, the mount leaves with the rider. If only the mount breaks, the rider can be thrown and the mount routs. Falling damage is an open-ended armour-negating comparison based on size difference; chariots avoid ordinary falling damage.

A normal riderless mount routs. A mount with the relevant bravery can remain. The battle summary and replay should be inspected at component level because "cavalry loss" may mean a dead rider, lost mount, or temporary separation.

Mount recovery

A surviving rider without a mount can claim a matching riderless mount. Otherwise the rider returns home and can be recruited again at half cost while retaining identity, experience, and afflictions. Suitable intelligent mounts can return in a similar fashion.

Mounted commanders remain and can use Reclaim Mount or claim a suitable unit. Some units automatically regain mounts. As of 6.35, automatic recovery occurs at the end of the turn, ensuring the new turn begins mounted.

Trampling

A trampler entering a square displaces the smaller units to adjacent squares. Each victim checks:

```
Defence - floor(Fatigue / 10) against 3d6
```

On failure:

```
trample damage = 7 + trampler Size
```

The damage is armour piercing. An ethereal trampler deals half normal trample damage. A victim that passes the Defence check is still displaced and takes one damage. A trampled unit always takes at least one damage regardless of protection.

Trampling is simultaneously:

- movement;
- displacement;
- repeated Defence pressure;
- armour-piercing damage;
- fatigue expenditure;
- formation disruption.

Trample failure modes

Tramplers are vulnerable to:

- high Defence before fatigue;
- targets too large to trample;
- anti-large weapons and concentrated damage;
- cold, shock, and other fatigue pressure;
- poor morale;
- congestion around friendly troops;
- repeated trampling cost;
- mount targeting when the trampler is a mount.

Trampling weak units can look dominant while exhausting the trampler for the decisive contact.

Part X: Fatigue, Recovery, and Collapse

The hidden battle economy

Fatigue is a stock accumulated by actions and effects. It reduces combat performance before it causes unconsciousness:

```
Defence penalty = floor(Fatigue / 10)
Attack penalty = floor(Fatigue / 20)
```

At 50 fatigue, Defence has fallen by 5 and Attack by 2. At 90, the penalties are 9 and 4. A unit can remain upright while its original stat line has ceased to exist.

Gaining fatigue

Ordinary melee attacks add current Encumbrance. Spellcasting adds:

```
listed spell fatigue / (1 + path skill above minimum)
+ base Encumbrance
+ twice armour Encumbrance
```

The listed spell component is divided by excess path skill. The Encumbrance component is not.

Other sources include:

- flying and trampling;
- heat or cold effects;
- shock and fatigue damage;
- bleeding;
- special weapons, spells, and auras;
- extreme battlefield conditions.

Thresholds

Fatigue	Consequence
Every 10	-1 Defence
Every 20	-1 Attack
50+	More protection rolls can become armour defeating
100	Unit falls unconscious
Below 100 again	Unit can regain consciousness
200	Additional fatigue damage begins converting to HP damage

An unconscious unit recovers five fatigue per turn until it falls below 100. Reinvigoration and battle effects can accelerate recovery according to their rules. The manual does not fully specify every ordinary recovery interaction while active; any claim beyond the stated five-point unconscious recovery should be verified in the current executable.

At 200 fatigue, each further 50 fatigue damage produces one HP damage. A smaller remainder produces a chance equal to two percent per fatigue point.

Fatigue as offence

Fatigue warfare can defeat protection without directly ignoring it:

1. Defence falls.
2. More attacks hit.
3. Armour-defeating protection results become more frequent.
4. The unit falls unconscious.
5. Further fatigue converts into damage.
6. The stationary target receives concentrated attacks.

This is why reinvigoration, low Encumbrance, resistance, and relief effects are offensive enablers as well as defensive statistics.

Fatigue budget

For a key unit, estimate:

```
starting fatigue
+ scripted action costs
+ expected contact costs
+ environmental and enemy pressure
- recovery
= fatigue at decisive turn
```

The number need not be exact to expose a bad plan. A mage expected to cast five expensive spells in heavy armour or a trampler expected to cross the field and overrun many squares may already be committed past useful performance.

Part XI: Morale, Fear, Rout, and Retreat

Squad morale

Squad morale begins from the members' average and receives applicable modifiers:

- +1 in the home province;
- +1 in friendly dominion;
- leadership-band modifier;
- Inspiration;
- the highest applicable Standard;
- +1 while blessed;
- temporary magic morale.

Magic morale can range from -10 to +1. Negative magic morale recovers gradually, approximately one point every two rounds; positive magic morale persists.

When squads check

A squad can check morale when:

- it suffers heavy losses since its last check and has at least 20% overall casualties;
- it has four or fewer members and any member is damaged that round;
- it is exposed to nearby Fear;
- Terror or a similar effect forces a check;
- the army has lost at least 50% of its weighted total HP, causing checks each turn thereafter.

At most one ordinary morale check occurs for a squad in a round.

For this purpose, a wound is a damage event that leaves a unit at no more than 80% of normal HP. Heavy losses are one wound per two squad members.

The morale comparison

The manual gives:

```
morale roll = squad Morale + DRN + survivor bonus from 0 to 5
fear roll = 14 + DRN
```

The squad routs when the fear roll is greater. Under this wording, a tie is safe.

The exact calculation of the 0-5 survivor bonus is not fully exposed and remains test pending.

Army-level rout

At 50% weighted army HP loss, surviving squads begin checking every turn. At 75%, the army automatically routs.

The army total weights some bodies differently:

Body type	HP weight
Ordinary unit	100%
Mount	25%
Province Defence	25%
Slave	50%

This weighting affects how a screen, summon, mount, or PD contingent contributes to army-wide collapse. It does not tell whether that body is tactically useful.

Fear

Fear can reduce magic morale and force squad or individual checks. Current official rules cap morale reduction at the Fear effect's value and at an absolute ten points.

Fear is strongest when combined with:

- existing casualties;
- command loss;
- fatigue;
- weak leadership;
- small squads;

- blocked or dangerous retreat.

It is weaker against mindless units, berserk behaviour, high morale, strong leadership, and effects that prevent or mitigate fear.

Frighten-like limited effects can reduce morale by no more than their stated amount and do not automatically create every broader Fear interaction. Exact effect text matters.

Routing units

A routing unit suffers -4 Defence and spends its activity moving toward a friendly battlefield edge. It ignores zones of control. Poison, burning, bleeding, and similar pending damage can still kill it after it leaves.

Mindless units do not rout normally. Without eligible leadership, they can become immobile, attack adjacent enemies, and have a one-third chance per turn to dissolve. Magic or undead troops without the required leadership rout.

Retreat destination

Each commander has a 75% chance to make a smart retreat. A commander in native terrain receives a second 50% chance after failure.

A smart commander:

- retreats into a friendly fort in the same province if available;
- otherwise chooses a random friendly adjacent province.

A failed smart retreat chooses a random adjacent province, including an enemy province. A unit retreating into enemy territory is killed.

Troops attempt to follow their commander with a morale check:

- squad morale bonus counts double;
- undisciplined units suffer -3;
- skirmish morale penalty applies.

Leaderless troops or troops that fail to follow make individual smart checks at 50%, with the native-terrain second chance still applying.

Retreat while defending a fort

Units retreating while defending their fort hide inside if the battle is won and they made a smart retreat. If the battle is lost, all such units are killed. Non-smart defenders are killed. Commanders are always smart in this special case, and lone units gain another 50% opportunity.

Preservation audit

Before committing:

- Which adjacent provinces are friendly?
- Is a friendly fort available?
- Are retreat provinces likely to be cut this turn?
- Are commanders native to the terrain?

- Are undisciplined troops likely to follow?
- Will poison, burning, or bleeding kill retreaters?
- Is a fort defence an all-or-nothing trap?
- Does a nominal victory preserve the force for the next operation?

Part XII: Resistances and Special Damage

Resistance

Elemental resistance works like an additional protection layer against its damage family, followed by percentage reduction. Each point corresponds to twice that percentage; resistance 50 gives immunity.

For elemental fatigue effects, resistance counts at double strength when reducing the fatigue component.

Resistance is not interchangeable with protection:

- armour negation can ignore protection but not the relevant resistance;
- poison resistance reduces initial poison application but not the later duration of poison already received;
- immunity thresholds and special interactions differ by damage family.

Fire and burning

Fire is commonly armour piercing. The chance to catch fire is:

```
pre-protection fire damage x 4%
```

Fire fatigue counts as one-third for this ignition calculation.

A burning unit suffers `(1dSize) / 2` damage, rounded up, each round: a size-8 unit rolls `1d8`, then halves the result. Fire Resistance 5 halves burning damage. The chance to extinguish is:

```
25% + Fire Resistance + 5% per Cold scale + 100% in rain
```

with a minimum of 1%. Fire vulnerability is negative resistance. Fire Resistance 10 or more, chill aura, Mistform, and Ethereal prevent burning.

Cold and freezing

A freezing unit suffers 2d6 additional fatigue each round until it thaws.

The thaw chance is:

```
25% + Cold Resistance + 5% per Heat scale
```

with a minimum of 1%. Cold Resistance 10 or more, heat aura, and Ethereal prevent freezing.

Fire and cold affect both damage and fatigue.

Bleeding

Profuse bleeding inflicts:

```
10 fatigue + 5% of maximum HP per round
```

The chance to stop is 10% plus regeneration. Underwater combat halves the chance that bleeding stops; it does not halve the listed damage.

Poison

Poison is stored and then applied over time, approximately ten percent of the remaining total per round as evenly as possible.

Poison also reduces Attack and Defence by 25% for each full maximum-HP dose currently stored, capped at 50%. The penalty falls as stored poison is consumed.

Poison Resistance reduces the initial amount. It does not shorten poison already received.

This delay makes poison strategically unusual:

- the victim may win the immediate exchange and die afterward;
- battle summaries can conceal post-contact lethality;
- retreating poison victims can be lost after leaving;
- regeneration and healing do not simply erase the stored schedule.

Shock and stun

Shock can stun. The chance is:

```
5% + half the percentage of maximum HP lost to the hit
```

Shock Resistance protects against shock damage and receives the elemental-resistance treatment against fatigue effects. Twist Fate and similar effects must be evaluated with current patch behaviour rather than old assumptions.

Acid and rust

Iron equipment can rust:

- rust chance is pre-protection acid damage times 4%;
- armour can be damaged based on damage before armour after shield interaction;
- rusty weapons have a chance to become damaged when used.

A damaged weapon suffers -2 damage, or -1 if blunt. Rust converts repeated minor exposure into declining equipment quality. Since 6.36, the rust effect can apply even when the attack causes no HP damage; inspect equipment state rather than using the health bar as a proxy for the secondary effect.

Life drain

Full life drain:

- heals half the damage;
- removes fatigue equal to twice the damage;
- can raise HP to 150% of maximum plus ten.

Weapons with partial life drain treat only the first five points of damage as drain; further damage is ordinary. Lifeless targets take only 25% of the post-protection drain result and do not heal the attacker. A lifeless attacker can still receive the ordinary benefit of its own life-draining attack.

Paralysis

Paralysis duration is:

```
(damage - Size) / 2
```

Repeated paralysis uses the larger duration and can add limited damage from the overlap. Size acts as a defence even when ordinary protection is not the main check.

False damage

Illusions and many Glamour effects cause false damage. It:

- can kill when real plus false damage reaches HP;
- causes no ordinary afflictions except death;
- is not healed by regeneration, life drain, or ordinary healing;
- does not trigger Damage Reversal, Blood Vengeance, or Blood Bond;
- dissipates at two per round if all enemy Glamour mages are dead.

Current official rules make false damage count toward HP-based rout. A force can be routed by damage that later disappears.

Clouds and auras

Cloud effects are armour negating and decay by roughly one level per round. Clouds of the same type do not ordinarily overlap; they spread and can increase level only within their limits. Heat and frost clouds cancel one another.

Monster auras commonly create level-one clouds that can accumulate to level two. Spells and items can create stronger clouds.

Clouds transform position and time into damage. The important questions are:

- who occupies the square;
- how long they remain;
- what resistance applies;
- whether the cloud moves, spreads, cancels, or decays;
- whether friendly troops are also exposed.

Part XIII: Afflictions, Regeneration, and Lasting Loss

Affliction chance

When a hit causes damage, the basic chance of an affliction equals the percentage of maximum HP lost to that blow. A hit taking 20% of maximum HP produces a 20% base chance. Damage beyond 100% can produce several affliction opportunities.

The chance that an affliction is major is:

```
affliction chance / 1.5
```

capped at 33%.

Regeneration reduces affliction risk. Since 6.31, regeneration follows its displayed percentage accurately rather than the older HP brackets.

Location pools

Location	Minor examples	Major examples
Any	Battle Fright, Profuse Bleeding	-
Head	Eye Loss, Mute	Dementia, Feebleminded, Blind
Chest	Chest Wound, Never-Healing Wound	Diseased
Arm	Weakened	Lost Arm
Leg	Limp	Crippled

Profuse Bleeding is temporary. Most other afflictions persist until an eligible healing mechanism succeeds.

Campaign consequences

Affliction valuation depends on the unit:

- lost limbs can remove weapons or slots;
- lost eyes impair Precision and combat;
- feeblemindedness can destroy a mage's strategic value;
- battle fright undermines command and morale;
- limp and cripple reduce map movement;
- disease creates ongoing attrition.

Troops with a limp can become crippled during long marches. Crippled troops can die while marching. An army that wins but accumulates movement injuries may cease to be an operational army.

Healing categories

Recuperation, healer abilities, immortality interactions, transformation, and specific sites or spells do not all heal the same afflictions under the same conditions. Undead and lifeless beings are commonly excluded from ordinary affliction healing. Item-caused afflictions can require removal of the item.

The safe method is to inspect the exact ability and target category rather than use "healing" as one universal mechanic.

Part XIV: Battle Magic within the Army

Scope

The complete spell, communion, ritual, and research system belongs in Foundation Book V. This part establishes the combat mechanics required to understand an army that includes mages.

Preparation and recovery

Most spells have a casting time of about one round:

- approximately half is preparation;
- approximately half is recovery.

Battle enchantments and gem-costing spells often take longer. If the caster is damaged during preparation, interruption chance is:

```
percentage of maximum HP lost + 25%
```

Combat Caster and Mindless halve this chance. Innate spellcasters require no preparation and ignore ordinary casting-time differences. As of 6.35, an innate caster that falls unconscious and later recovers continues its script correctly.

Spell accuracy

Spell delivery resembles missile delivery:

```
spell aiming Precision = caster Precision + spell Precision
```

Range, scatter, target-square density, area, and friendly position all matter. A spell with excellent listed damage can be a poor answer if it arrives late, lands unpredictably, or covers the wrong area.

Magic resistance

When "Magic resistance negates" applies:

```
caster penetration
= 11 + DRN + half additional skill above the spell requirement

target resistance
= Magic Resistance + DRN + half target skill in the spell path
```

The caster wins ties.

"Easily negates" gives the caster -4 penetration. "Hard to resist" gives +4.

Excess path skill and relevant boosters improve penetration, while path-skilled targets can receive extra resistance against effects in that path.

Spell fatigue

For a spell with listed fatigue:

```
path fatigue
= listed fatigue / (1 + caster skill - minimum required skill)

casting encumbrance
= base Encumbrance + 2 x armour Encumbrance
```

The Encumbrance cost is paid per cast and is not reduced by excess skill. Heavy armour can make a high-path mage collapse even when the printed spell cost appears manageable.

Battle enchantments

Battle enchantments can affect the whole battlefield or continuously alter the battle. They end when their caster dies. At Twilight, all battle enchantments and temporary magical effects are removed.

Current indoor rules prevent most battlefield-wide spells from being cast indoors; holy battlefield-wide spells are excepted. A fort-storming plan must distinguish gate, exterior, and interior conditions.

Magic as a package

A useful battlefield-magic package identifies:

Component	Question
Research	Is every required spell available now?
Access	Which mages can cast it without hypothetical boosters?
Gems	How many battles can the package sustain?
Timing	On which turn does each effect resolve?
Delivery	Which square or target category receives it?
Protection	How does the caster survive preparation?
Fatigue	What remains after the script?
Redundancy	What happens if one caster dies or is interrupted?
Counter	Which resistance, battlefield condition, or enemy script defeats it?

The fifth-order problem

After five specific orders, the general order governs. Many battle plans are excellent for five actions and incoherent thereafter. The post-script state must be designed:

- should the mage remain behind troops;
- advance to reach targets;
- continue casting;
- conserve gems;
- retreat after a task;
- avoid walking into melee?

The sixth action is often where a nominal support mage becomes an expensive casualty.

Part XV: Sieges, Storming, and Battle Context

Siege arithmetic

The wall-reduction formulas, repair modifiers, and supply progression belong to Book II and the field reference. Book IV begins where the battle problem starts: only the correct siege orders contribute, and reaching zero wall integrity makes storming available on the next relevant order.

Storm sequence

Storming occurs after any other battle in the province. A relieving or intercepting battle can weaken or destroy the besieger before the fort assault.

If a commander ordered to Storm Castle is killed before the storming battle, troops under that commander do not participate in the storm.

This creates a two-battle problem:

- preserve storm commanders through the exterior battle;
- retain enough force and scripting for the fort battle;
- account for changed gems, fatigue resets, casualties, and command structure;
- respect indoor restrictions.

Gates and constrained contact

Fort battles compress frontage and change pathing. Large formations can be delayed by gates, while concentrated area effects can gain value. Exact fort layouts vary and should be inspected in the replay or test game.

A storm script copied from an open field is suspect until it answers:

- which units pass through the gate first;
- where the command core begins;
- whether battlefield-wide magic is legal;
- how defenders exploit interior depth;
- where retreating defenders go.

Siege supply

A fort's storage is divided by the number of consecutive siege turns. Storage 300 yields 300, 150, 100, 75, then 60 supply in the first five months. Starvation and disease can weaken a garrison before the storm without changing its roster.

The battle card should include starvation, disease, fatigue-related afflictions, and any shortage of replacement equipment.

Part XVI: Counter Construction

Counters are layered

A counter should state which layer it attacks:

Enemy layer	Candidate answers
High Defence	Harassment, area effects, trampling, immobilisation, fatigue
High Protection	Armour piercing, armour negating, Strength, rust, fatigue, MR effects
Shields	High Attack for clean hits, shield breaking, area effects, armour negation
Regeneration	Burst damage, decay, disease where applicable, paralysis, control, morale
High MR	More penetration, non-MR damage, fatigue, mundane control
Elemental resistance	Different damage family, physical damage, MR effects, morale
Massed low-HP troops	Area damage, clouds, trampling, fear
Giants	Anti-large damage, repeated attacks, control, poison where relevant
Flyers and rear pressure	Bodyguards, rear screens, protected redundancy, anti-air or area control
Mages	Fast contact, missiles, interruption, assassins, battlefield conditions, resistance
Summon spam	Area damage, fatigue control, source elimination, long-battle clock
Fear	Morale, leadership, standards, mindless or berserk counters, source removal
Tramplers	Defence, size, fatigue, anti-large damage, spacing

The counter must then pass four tests:

1. Access: the nation can produce it in time.
2. Delivery: it reaches the intended target.
3. Scale: enough instances exist for the enemy force.
4. Survival: it remains functional until its work is done.

Avoid nominal counters

An armour-negating spell is not a counter to armour if:

- research is not complete;
- only one fragile caster can use it;
- the caster lacks range;
- the target resists or kills the caster first;
- the gem cost cannot be sustained;
- the spell AI selects something else;
- indoor conditions prohibit the package.

The correct unit of strategy is the delivered package, not the tooltip.

Counter-counter planning

After selecting the answer, ask how the opponent adapts:

- changes formation;
- adds resistance;
- changes deployment;
- attacks the caster;
- uses decoys;
- splits the army;
- changes battlefield conditions;

- refuses the battle.

An expert plan is not one unbeatable script. It is a branch with a tolerable response to the most likely counter.

Part XVII: Battle Replay as Evidence

Why the summary is insufficient

The summary reports numbers present, kills, and losses. It does not by itself explain:

- who made first contact;
- which spells were interrupted;
- where fatigue crossed a threshold;
- whether a shield or resistance worked;
- which squad failed morale first;
- why a target order redirected;
- whether a commander or mount died before the apparent collapse;
- which damage occurred after retreat.

Kills reward the last damaging event, not every enabling action.

First replay method

For a new player:

1. Pause at deployment.
2. Use F1 to inspect all units and commanders.
3. Use F2 to inspect weather and dominion.
4. Identify the first-contact squads.
5. Watch once at normal speed without chasing individuals.
6. Watch again with battle-log detail increased.
7. Select a key unit and use its combat log.
8. Record the first irreversible failure.

Useful replay controls include pause, speed changes, grid display, F1 unit list, F2 weather and dominion, and battle-log detail levels one through four.

The first irreversible failure

The decisive event is often earlier than the visible rout:

- a buff was interrupted;
- a screen made contact one round early;
- a commander stood inside an area effect;
- tramplers became exhausted on decoys;
- missiles stopped when melee geometry changed;
- an MR spell failed repeatedly;
- a squad's leadership penalty lowered its margin;
- a retreat province was enemy-controlled.

Finding the earliest event that made later failure likely produces a reusable lesson. Recording only the final kill does not.

Replay worksheet

Stage	Record
Deployment	Side, positions, formations, squad sizes, command
Conditions	Weather, scales, darkness, storm, indoor or underwater
Opening	First spells, first shots, first movement
Contact	Turn and location of each squad's contact
Degradation	Fatigue, poison, rust, afflictions, lost mounts, shield damage
Cohesion	First morale check, first rout, commander loss
Resolution	Automatic rout, long-battle event, or decisive destruction
Retreat	Destinations, post-retreat deaths, trapped units
Strategic result	Province, gems, mages, commanders, readiness next turn

Do not learn from one roll

Open-ended dice produce tails. A controlled comparison should be repeated enough times to distinguish a structural advantage from one improbable result. The goal is not to eliminate randomness. It is to learn whether the plan remains acceptable across it.

Part XVIII: Active Mod Ruleset

What the supplied files establish

The frozen combined ruleset loads:

1. `DomEnhanced2_16.dm`;
2. `Divinitus_1.15.3_DE.dm`.

Direct source counts demonstrate the scale of object-level battle changes.

Command family	DE 2.16	Divinitus 1.15.3 DE
New monsters	3,553	346
Selected existing monsters	4,227	373
New weapons	389	34
Selected existing weapons	142	0
Selected spells	2,816	17
New spell blocks	0	26
Attack edits	2,038	276
Defence edits	2,114	278
Protection edits	1,612	238

Command family	DE 2.16	Divinitus 1.15.3 DE
Morale edits	1,692	229
Encumbrance edits	1,186	163
Mount assignments	178	9
Skilled Rider edits	437	1
Trample assignments	39	12

Counts are syntactic occurrences, not numbers of distinct final objects. Repeated selections, copied statistics, inherited fields, and later load-order edits can change the effective count.

What the files do not establish

The supplied `.dm` files create and alter monsters, weapons, spells, items, sites, nations, blessings, and object abilities. They do not present a global rewrite of the engine's DRN, ordinary Attack-versus-Defence equation, ten-size-point square capacity, 75% army-rout rule, or general retreat algorithm.

Accordingly:

- the foundation mechanics remain the starting model;
- every unit, weapon, spell, mount, and Pretender must be read from the effective combined data;
- unmodded balance conclusions cannot be transferred merely because the core formula is unchanged;
- Divinitus loads second and can overwrite shared selections made by DE.

Modded battle-analysis rule

For a combined guide:

```
engine mechanic
+ effective DE object
+ later Divinitus overwrite
+ national availability
+ current patch correction
= claim that can be published
```

The name of an object is not enough. A DE or Divinitus version may share a familiar name while changing damage, paths, fatigue, attack count, resistances, abilities, or recruitment.

Foundation versus faction work

Book IV does not declare any specific modded faction or god optimal. It supplies the method used later:

1. extract the final combined roster;
2. classify roles;
3. calculate effective combat lines;
4. build packages;
5. test scripts;
6. record match-ups and counters.

Part XIX: Controlled-Test Programme

Test standard

Every test record should include:

- Dominions version;
- exact mod list and load order;
- map and province;
- attacker and defender;
- unit IDs and quantities;
- commander statistics and orders;
- formations and positions;
- gems and items;
- weather, scales, dominion, terrain, and indoor state;
- random seed if available;
- number of repetitions;
- result distribution;
- replay or log notes.

Change one important variable at a time.

Test 1: DRN tie direction

Purpose: verify tie behaviour in Attack, MR, and morale checks.

Method:

- create equal-value opposed cases;
- use the highest battle-log detail;
- record explicit equal totals;
- confirm which side wins each rule's tie.

Test 2: Harassment decay

Purpose: measure the hidden decay rate.

Method:

- expose one high-Defence unit to a known burst of harmless directed attacks;
- stop new attacks through controlled spacing;
- inspect Defence or logs over time;
- repeat across different initial penalties.

Test 3: Cooldown and combat speed

Purpose: distinguish movement time, recovery, and attack cadence.

Method:

- compare otherwise identical units with controlled Combat Speed;
- record timestamps for steps and attacks;

- repeat with diagonal movement and no movement.

Test 4: Formation Fighter density

Purpose: document exact square capacity at several ability values and sizes.

Method:

- deploy uniform squads in each formation;
- count bodies per square;
- repeat with mixed sizes.

Test 5: Repel sequence

Purpose: confirm current repel bonuses, lingering penalty, giant length, and magic-weapon interaction.

Method:

- use non-damaging or highly protected targets;
- vary weapon length, Attack, morale, size, and interval between attacks;
- record repel rolls at log level four.

Test 6: Shield damage and repair

Purpose: verify current rounding and post-battle repair.

Method:

- strike known mundane and magical shields with controlled slash and blunt damage;
- record damaged and broken thresholds;
- vary available provincial resources;
- inspect the next turn.

Test 7: Mounted targeting

Purpose: reproduce target weights for rider, mount, reach, missiles, and area effects.

Method:

- use fixed rider size and several mount sizes;
- count hundreds of directed attacks;
- repeat with different weapon lengths and missiles.

Test 8: Trample fatigue

Purpose: measure current flying and trampling fatigue after the 6.25 correction.

Method:

- compare mounted and non-mounted tramplers;
- control Encumbrance, distance, number of victims, and resistance;
- record fatigue per displacement.

Test 9: Morale survivor bonus

Purpose: derive the manual's 0-5 survivor bonus.

Method:

- create squads at controlled original and remaining sizes;
- force identical checks;
- extract morale totals from detailed logs;
- test whether the bonus depends on count, fraction, or another condition.

Test 10: Army HP rout weights

Purpose: verify mounts, slaves, and PD weighting in mixed armies.

Method:

- construct armies with one weighted category at a time;
- cause controlled casualties;
- record the first 50% checks and 75% automatic rout.

Test 11: Retreat intelligence

Purpose: confirm smart-retreat rates and priority.

Method:

- provide a fort, friendly province, and enemy province;
- repeat commander retreats in native and non-native terrain;
- separately test leaderless troops and undisciplined followers.

Test 12: Ordinary fatigue recovery

Purpose: resolve active-unit recovery not fully specified by the manual.

Method:

- give controlled fatigue without further actions;
- compare active, unconscious, reinvigorated, and spellcasting units;
- log fatigue every round.

Test 13: Regeneration and rounding

Purpose: reproduce the post-6.31 percentage rule.

Method:

- use several maximum HP values and regeneration percentages;
- inflict constant damage;
- record healing across many rounds.

Test 14: False damage and rout

Purpose: verify current HP-rout contribution and dissipation.

Method:

- apply only false damage;
- kill all hostile Glamour mages at controlled times;
- record morale triggers and two-per-round removal.

Test 15: Indoor battlefield magic

Purpose: catalogue which whole-field effects remain legal.

Method:

- attempt ordinary, holy, start-of-battle, innate, and item-created field effects in fort interiors and assassination maps;
- record script fallback and gem use.

Test 16: Modded regression suite

Purpose: detect future DE or Divinitus changes that invalidate published packages.

Method:

- preserve a small set of representative battles;
- rerun after each mod update;
- compare unit IDs, final fields, scripts, and outcomes;
- classify differences as source edits, load-order overwrites, or engine changes.

Part XX: Operational Checklists

Pre-battle audit

Objective

- What must the battle accomplish?
- Is taking the province enough?
- Which enemy assets matter most?
- What friendly losses are acceptable?

Command

- Are all troop categories legally led?
- Are squad-count morale penalties understood?
- Is there useful command redundancy?
- Are key commanders protected?

Formation

- Which squad contacts first?
- Is width, depth, or spacing appropriate?
- Are undisciplined restrictions active?
- Will friendly units obstruct one another?

Script

- Are spells researched and gems carried?
- Are targets in range?
- What happens after five orders?
- What happens if the named spell fails?
- Are indoor, underwater, storm, or darkness restrictions checked?

Defence layers

- What answers Protection?
- What answers Defence?
- What answers shields?
- What answers resistance and MR?
- What answers regeneration, size, flight, fear, or mindlessness?

Persistence

- When does fatigue become dangerous?
- Can the line survive until the decisive turn?
- Are poison, bleeding, clouds, or rust cumulative threats?

Preservation

- Where will the army retreat?
- Are routes friendly after simultaneous movement?
- Is the fort battle an annihilation risk?
- Can the force fight again next turn?

Post-battle audit

1. What was the first irreversible failure?
2. Did placement produce the intended contact order?
3. Which scripts completed?
4. Which spells were interrupted or replaced by AI choices?
5. When did key units cross 50 or 100 fatigue?
6. Which squad routed first and why?
7. Did command loss trigger a general collapse?
8. Did the counter attack the correct defence layer?
9. Which losses occurred during retreat or from delayed damage?
10. What is the smallest change likely to improve the result?

New-player minimum

Before ending a turn with an important army:

- assign every troop to a legal commander;
- separate units that need different orders;
- choose formations deliberately;
- protect commanders;
- check mage gems and scripts;
- inspect likely retreat provinces;
- view the replay even after an easy victory.

Part XXI: Essays

Essay I: Morale and the Shape of Defeat

Dominions gives armies bodies, weapons, armour, and magic, but it ends most battles through cohesion. This is not a cosmetic concession to realism. It is the mechanism that connects local violence to army-level outcomes.

A soldier's HP asks whether the body can continue. Squad morale asks whether a group still accepts the battle. Command asks whether that group remains part of an army. Army HP asks whether the whole force has absorbed so much destruction that continued resistance is no longer possible. Retreat then asks whether defeat remains recoverable.

These layers explain why two identical casualty totals can have different results. Ten losses spread among several large, well-led squads may be tolerable. The same losses concentrated in a small forward squad can trigger a rout, expose a flank, and place fear next to another squad. The second squad then checks under worse conditions. Once movement turns away from the enemy, Defence falls, zones of control no longer matter, and the enemy converts retreat into further damage.

Morale has geometry. A fear aura beside one squad is not the same as a global numerical debuff. A standard supports a particular command structure. A commander killed behind the line can matter more than a warrior killed at the front. A sparse formation's -1 seems modest until it moves an already marginal squad down the DRN curve.

The strategic conclusion is not as simple as "buy morale." The army needs a controlled way to fail. Squads can be divided so that one rout stays local. Command can be duplicated. Valuable troops can be kept from taking the first casualty threshold. Fear can be attacked at its source. Retreat provinces can be preserved so a rout displaces the army instead of destroying it.

The strongest armies are not those that never fail a morale check. Random rolls and extreme effects make that impossible. They are armies whose first failure does not automatically become total defeat.

Essay II: Fatigue, the Hidden Battle Economy

Gold buys the unit and resources equip it, but fatigue determines how long the purchased statistics remain real.

A fresh high-Defence unit can look nearly untouchable. Every ten fatigue removes one Defence. Directed attacks add harassment. At fifty fatigue, the same body suffers five less Defence and a broader range of armour-defeating protection results. At one hundred it falls unconscious. The transition is not gradual in battlefield effect: a stable formation can appear to hold, then collapse rapidly as many members cross the same thresholds.

Fatigue also binds ordinary troops and mages into one system. Heavy armour protects a caster from arrows but charges twice its armour Encumbrance on every spell. A trampler destroys light infantry but pays for movement and trampling. A berserker produces more offence but continues accumulating cost. Fire, cold, shock, bleeding, and spell effects can attack the fatigue stock even when direct HP damage is unimpressive.

This makes time a resource. A cheap screen may buy three rounds for buffs, or force the enemy to spend three rounds attacking and building Encumbrance fatigue. A resistant line does not need an immediate kill if every exchange makes the next one more favourable. Reinvigoration does more than extend endurance; it preserves Attack, Defence, casting, and the reliability of protection.

A proper comparison between two units includes their fatigue over time. "Who wins the first attack?" is often less important than "Who still has a functioning stat line on the tenth?"

Essay III: Formation Is the Management of Time

Formation appears spatial, but its principal strategic effect is temporal. It decides how many bodies enter contact now, how many wait, which square receives area damage, how long replacements take to arrive, and when a fast unit becomes trapped behind a slow one.

A line spends frontage early. It seeks simultaneous contact and converts many weapons into immediate checks. A box stores bodies behind the first rank. It may accept less initial damage output in exchange for depth and protection of the centre. A sparse line spreads risk and coverage but pays morale and density costs. A skirmish pattern gives each square room yet can allow enemies to penetrate or surround.

Placement adds another time instruction. Forward deployment advances the squad's personal clock. Hold adds two rounds. Combat speed changes travel and cooldown. The enemy's placement changes the actual meeting point. The resulting schedule determines whether a buff precedes contact, whether arrows receive three volleys or one, and whether a finisher arrives against fresh or fatigued targets.

This is why copying a formation without copying its purpose fails. "Put infantry in a line" is not a rule. A line is correct when early frontage is worth more than depth and clustering risk. "Put mages at the rear" is incomplete. The rear can be exposed to flyers, and excessive distance can place spells out of range.

Formation is best designed as a timeline: first contact, second contact, decisive effect, expected rout. The map is the clock face.

Essay IV: Protection Is a Probability Distribution

Protection is often treated as subtraction: damage fifteen against protection twenty should do nothing. Dominions instead rolls both sides, permits open-ended results, distinguishes body and head, applies weapon types, includes shield hits, and allows low protection rolls to become armour defeating.

Protection changes the damage distribution. It reduces ordinary damage and makes severe results rarer, but it does not create a hard wall. The tail can still contain clean shield bypasses, head hits, high damage rolls, armour-piercing reductions, and armour defeat caused by fatigue.

This perspective improves both defence and offence. Adding protection to an already protected unit may still matter if it removes many ordinary wounds and their affliction chances. Against that unit, a large number of weak attacks may be poor at direct damage but valuable for harassment and fatigue.

A smaller number of armour-negating attacks may attack the correct layer but fail if their delivery is unreliable.

The important question becomes: which part of the distribution must change? If ordinary hits are killing the line, more protection or shields may work. If rare head hits kill expensive sacreds, helmet coverage, Luck, body count, or regeneration may matter. If fatigue is widening the armour-defeating tail, reinvigoration may preserve effective protection better than another armour point.

The defence layer is never just the number printed beside the shield icon.

Essay V: Scripting under Uncertainty

A Dominions script is neither direct control nor a prophecy. It is a commitment made before seeing exact enemy deployment and resolved through range, targets, pathing, fatigue, damage, and AI fallback.

This makes scripting a form of robust planning. A brittle script succeeds brilliantly in one anticipated battle and fails when the enemy deploys one formation-width away. A robust script may sacrifice theoretical perfection to retain useful behaviour across several plausible enemy plans.

Robustness begins with dependencies. If spell four requires spell one to boost a path, the caster must survive the preparation time, spend the correct fatigue, and still have a legal target. If a screen must hold for three rounds, its morale and matchup must support that duration. If a flier must kill commanders, the path must remain open and the flier must ignore irrelevant rear targets.

Failure branches should be written deliberately. When the target is absent, what will the AI cast? When the caster is interrupted, does the army still have resistance? When the enemy holds, do friendly damage spells fire into empty space or remain useful? After five orders, does the mage stay safe?

The ideal script is not the one with the most exact sequence. It is the one whose likely deviations remain acceptable.

Essay VI: Winning the Battle, Saving the Army

Field victory is one event in a campaign. The surviving commanders, mages, mounts, gems, afflictions, and retreat routes determine whether the event creates lasting advantage.

An army that wins with its commanders dead can become stranded or badly organised. A force that routs into friendly territory may remain a strategic asset. A cavalry army can retain riders while losing mounts and tempo. Poison and bleeding can kill units after their visible escape. A failed fort defence can annihilate every unit that had nowhere to retreat.

Preservation begins before battle. Friendly adjacent provinces are part of army design. Command redundancy protects against battlefield collapse and the reorganisation that follows. Gem expenditure should reflect the value at risk. A commander carrying a laboratory's worth of gems is a caster and a moving treasury.

There are moments when preservation should be sacrificed. Destroying a unique enemy global caster, breaking a throne defence, or exhausting the only relief army may justify severe losses. The decision should be explicit. "The replay said victory" is not a strategic valuation.

The useful post-battle question is: how much future action did this result purchase? Provinces, siege turns, mage survival, research continuity, and readiness belong in the answer.

Essay VII: Combined Arms as Counter Architecture

Combined arms is sometimes described as variety for its own sake. In Dominions it is better understood as a set of linked answers to layered defences.

A conventional line may hold space but fail against heavy armour. Mages may negate armour but require time and protection. Archers may interrupt the enemy's mages but fail against shields. Flyers may threaten command but need the centre fixed in place. Fear may rout ordinary troops but do little to mindless bodies. Each component covers a failure mode of another.

Combined arms works when every component follows the same timing plan. A screen that dies before the debuff resolves has not supported the mage. A flanker that arrives before the centre engages can be surrounded. An armour-breaking effect cast after the damage line routs is irrelevant.

Combined arms also imposes organisational costs: more commander types, more scripts, more recruitment gates, more research branches, and more ways to misdeploy. Variety becomes strength only when every component has a named job and a dependency it satisfies.

The aim is not maximum variety. We want the smallest useful combination: enough distinct mechanisms to answer the expected defences, all delivered on one coherent clock.

Sources and Open Questions

Principal sources

- Illwinter, Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, especially the statistics, special abilities, Army Setup, Combat, afflictions, sieges, retreats, and Battle Magic sections.
- Illwinter, Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34.
- Illwinter Dominions 6 documentation.
- Illwinter Dominions 6 changes.
- Dominions 6 official Steam page.
- Supplied `DomEnhanced2_16.dm`.
- Supplied `Divinitus_1.15.3_DE.dm`.

Current community references are used to identify test questions and terminology, not to override the manual or current official corrections without evidence.

Open questions

The following still require controlled current-game tests:

- exact harassment decay;
- complete cooldown constants;
- Formation Fighter capacity at every value and mixed size;
- the exact survivor bonus in morale checks;
- active-unit fatigue recovery outside the manual's explicit unconscious rule;
- some obstacle and targeting weights;
- full mounted carry and movement arithmetic;
- precise current rounding in shield damage, regeneration, paralysis, and several special effects;
- effective combined data for every DE and Divinitus object.

Until then, they remain research tasks rather than confident approximations.

DOCUMENT 7 OF 16

Foundation Book V: Magic

What magic asks of a nation

Magic is the system by which Dominions turns knowledge into force. Research changes what a nation can attempt. Paths determine who can attempt it. Gems, blood slaves, laboratories, turns, and mage actions determine whether the attempt is affordable. Formation, timing, fatigue, targets, resistance, and counters determine whether it works.

> Foundation rule: Magic is not a list of powerful spells. It is a conversion chain from mage-turns and magical income into effects delivered at the right place and time.

Book V follows that chain from research and path access through gems, battlefield packages, communions, rituals, globals, forging, and late-game magic. It is meant to answer both the beginner's question-"What can this mage actually do?"-and the harder one: "Can the nation deliver that effect repeatedly, in time, and against resistance?"

Edition note

Book I defines the common baseline and evidence labels. Book IV owns the arithmetic of battlefield resolution. Book V uses those results to deal with magical planning, while Book IX catalogues exact spell, item, site, and mage changes in the active mods.

Current-version corrections that matter

The printed manual remains the structural baseline, but current play must include later official changes:

Version	Current rule or correction	Practical consequence
6.25	Battlefield-wide spells cannot normally be cast indoors; holy spells are excepted	Fort interiors and many assassination fields need separate scripts
6.29	Several spell, item, ritual, and nation-specific errors were corrected	Old object data must not be treated as current merely because the engine formula is unchanged
6.30	Communion masters using conservative gem use no longer attempt inappropriate higher-level spells	Old reports of this spell-AI failure are historical
6.32	Spell AI became less likely to cast invisibility late in battle; several remote and single-target choices were improved	Script fallbacks and unscripted casting should be assessed on the current version
6.34	Domes can protect against Astral Disruption; ritual messages and several spell-AI choices were corrected	Strategic magic defence and report interpretation changed
6.35	Innate spellcasters resume their scripts after recovering from unconsciousness	Current innate-caster scripts are more reliable than older replays imply

Patch notes contain many object-specific balance changes. A current spell dossier needs current game data as well as the manual's rule text. This foundation preserves the rules needed to make sense of those objects.

Ways into the book

The shortest route runs through the conversion chain, paths and schools, research, gems, battlefield jobs, rituals, forging, and the first magic audit. Communions, domes, global contests, booster ladders, counter construction, and legendary spells can be added as the national game develops. The controlled tests are kept for questions that genuinely depend on hidden AI choices, rounding, or version-sensitive interactions.

Part I: Magic as a Conversion System

The complete chain

A magical effect normally depends on every link below:

```
mage recruitment
-> laboratory access
-> mage-turns assigned to research
-> required school level
-> required path access
-> gems, slaves, or items
-> a legal order or battle script
-> survival, range, target, and timing
-> penetration, damage, or control
-> strategic exploitation
```

A broken link invalidates the rest. Researching a decisive spell without a caster is stored knowledge without delivery. Forging a booster without the path needed to wear it is dead capital. Sending the correct mage without gems can reduce a battle plan to ordinary AI casting. Winning the resistance check after the line has routed is too late.

Six magical resources

Magic is paid for with more than gems:

Resource	What it purchases	Common failure
Research points	Access to schools and spells	Researching attractive levels with no operational deadline
Mage-turns	Research, rituals, forging, site searching, movement, and combat	Counting one mage as if all roles can be performed simultaneously
Paths	Eligibility, efficiency, range of effects, and forging access	Confusing national theoretical access with repeatable field access
Gems or slaves	Rituals, items, combat boosts, fatigue relief, and some summons	Treating the treasury as income rather than a finite stock
Laboratories	Research, rituals, forging, pooling, and logistics	Losing the network that turns sites and mages into national power
Time and position	Delivery before the strategic window closes	Finishing research after the war has already been decided

The strongest magical economy is not always the one with the most gems. It is the one that can turn its available paths, researchers, laboratories, and stocks into the required effects with the fewest broken dependencies.

Stock, flow, and capacity

The library's economic model applies directly:

- Stock: current gems, slaves, forged items, accumulated research, and prepared casters.
- Flow: monthly gem income, blood-hunting output, research points, and repeatable summon production.
- Capacity: laboratories, mage recruitment, path distribution, forge access, communion bodies, and ritual range.
- Position: where mages, labs, gems, armies, and legal targets are located.

Research is cumulative stock generated by a flow of mage-turns. A booster is stored path access. A global is a large stock expenditure converted into an ongoing flow or worldwide rule. A battle gem converts stock into immediate tempo.

The three horizons

Every research or forging decision belongs to a horizon:

Horizon	Typical question	Planning standard
Immediate	What can prevent defeat this turn or next?	Legal casters, carried gems, exact scripts, and battlefield timing
Campaign	What wins the next war or siege cycle?	Research breakpoint, item queue, summon mass, and lab movement
Strategic	What changes the nation's path access or world position?	Boosters, globals, remote movement, legendary spells, and unique artifacts

The common error is buying strategic possibility while losing the immediate war. The opposite error is repeatedly spending gems on emergency combat without building the research and access that end the emergency.

Part II: Paths, Schools, and Access

The nine paths

Dominions has nine ordinary paths of magical power:

Family	Path	Broad tendencies
Elemental	Fire	Heat, burning, direct damage, offensive enhancement, destructive globals
Elemental	Air	Lightning, storms, flight, precision, mobility, battlefield reach
Elemental	Water	Cold, quickness, underwater power, frost, fluid defence
Elemental	Earth	Protection, strength, fatigue control, constructs, forging
Sorcery	Astral	Resistance contests, communions, teleportation, information, global control
Sorcery	Death	Undead, decay, fear, souls, attrition, powerful summons
Sorcery	Nature	Life, poison, regeneration, animals, plants, supply, growth
Sorcery	Glamour	Illusion, false damage, concealment, bewilderment, perception
Neither	Blood	Blood slaves, sacrifice, demons, Sabbaths, corruption, high action cost

This table describes tendencies, not hard borders. Schools are thematic rather than perfectly rigorous, national spells break general expectations, and multi-path requirements deliberately combine toolsets.

Holy is separate. Divine spells depend on Holy skill rather than ordinary paths and research. Common divine magic is available from the beginning. Some Banishment and Smite replacements are determined by the Pretender's paths, as detailed in Book III.

The seven schools

School	Central study	Frequent output
Conjuration	Bringing beings or powers into the world	Summons, elemental or otherworldly forces, some searches
Alteration	Changing physical properties and conditions	Protection, strength, resistance, weather, transformation
Evocation	Projecting magical force	Direct battle damage, area attacks, battlefield destruction
Construction	Making items and artificial beings	Equipment, boosters, matrices, constructs, artifacts
Enchantment	Imbuing units, objects, land, or the world	Persistent buffs, domes, globals, battlefield enchantments
Thaumaturgy	Manipulating minds, souls, information, and space	Resistance-based control, remote vision, movement, sorcery
Blood Magic	Unlocking spells that use Blood magic	Demons, Sabbaths, sacrifice, blood rituals, world corruption

The Blood school is not the Blood path. The school is a research category; the path is a caster statistic. A spell can sit in Blood Magic and have multi-path requirements.

The three access gates

A mage can cast a spell only when:

1. the nation has researched the spell's school to the required level;
2. the mage meets every listed path requirement;
3. any required gems or blood slaves are available in the correct place.

Battle spells require carried resources before battle. Rituals draw automatically from the national treasury but require a friendly laboratory. Research level alone never grants a path to a mage.

Primary and secondary paths

Multi-path spells require every listed path. The first listed path is the primary path:

- only excess skill in the primary path improves the ordinary spell-fatigue divisor;
- resistance penetration uses excess skill in the spell path identified by the rule;
- dual-path spells and rituals consume gems of the primary path unless the spell specifies otherwise;
- forging a multi-path item charges each required gem type.

This makes ordering consequential. Two requirements with the same numbers are not necessarily interchangeable if the primary path differs.

Excess skill

Having more skill than the minimum can:

- reduce the listed fatigue cost;
- contribute to resistance penetration;
- increase the maximum gems usable in a ritual;
- enable stronger overcasting of a global;
- meet a higher item or spell threshold;
- improve path-derived indirect bonuses.

Higher skill gives more than access to extra icons. It increases endurance and sometimes contest strength. That value still needs to be weighed against the booster, communion, empowerment, or rare mage needed to reach it.

Acquiring and increasing paths

The principal methods are:

Method	New path from zero?	Duration	Main use
Native or random path	Yes	Permanent	National base access
Empowerment	Yes	Permanent	Opening a missing path or climbing without another route
Path booster item	No	While worn	Efficient repeatable threshold access
Battlefield path-boost spell	No	Battle	Combat thresholds and fatigue reduction
One combat gem	No	One spell	Temporary +1 and/or fatigue management
Communion/Sabbath/Chorus	No	Battle	Shared battlefield escalation
Grand Communion	No	One strategic casting	Add same-path strength to a global or dispel
Transformation or special effect	Sometimes	Object-specific	Must be verified separately

Only Empowerment is the general method that grants the first level of an absent path. A booster or Power of the Spheres requires at least level 1 already. A gem can raise a known path by one for one spell but cannot create it or raise it by more than one.

Empowerment costs

Official costs are:

```
first level in an absent path = 50 gems of that path
later increase = 15 x target level
```

Examples:

Change	Cost
F0 -> F1	50 Fire gems
F1 -> F2	30 Fire gems
F2 -> F3	45 Fire gems
F3 -> F4	60 Fire gems

Empowerment is expensive because it buys permanent access on one commander. It is justified when the new level unlocks a repeatable ladder: a booster, critical ritual, national summon, global, or item that creates further access. Empowering for a one-off effect should be compared with alchemy, a communion, recruiting a rarer mage, trading for an item, or choosing a different solution.

Indirect magic

Path knowledge grants side benefits:

Path	Level 1 and scaling benefits	Level 3	Level 4
Fire	+10 Leadership and +10 Magic Leadership per level; shorter life	+5 Fire Resistance	another +5 Fire Resistance
Air	+10 Magic Leadership per level	+5 Shock Resistance	another +5 Shock Resistance
Water	+10 Magic Leadership per level	+5 Cold Resistance	another +5 Cold Resistance
Earth	+10 Magic Leadership per level	+3 natural Protection	+1 Affliction Resistance
Astral	+20 Magic Leadership per level	-	+1 Magic Resistance
Death	+50 Undead Leadership per level	rarely dies from old age	+10 Morale
Nature	+10 Magic Leadership and +10 supplies per level; longer life	+5 Poison Resistance	another +5 Poison Resistance
Glamour	+10 Magic Leadership per level	false-damage regeneration 1 per combat round	True Sight
Blood	+10 Undead and +10 Magic Leadership per level	+5 Hit Points	another +5 Hit Points

Level-one benefits scale with the path level. Threshold benefits are cumulative. These effects can change command capacity, longevity, supplies, resistance, and survivability even when the mage never casts a spell from that path.

Part III: Research as Strategic Planning

The research formula

An ordinary magical researcher produces:

```
Research = 5 + (2 x total magic levels) +/- research bonuses or penalties
minimum = 1
```

Magic and Drain scales modify magical research. Dementia halves research ability. The displayed value should be treated as authoritative for the current object after all abilities, scales, afflictions, items, and mod edits.

Some special researchers do not follow the ordinary path requirement:

- philosophers can research without magical paths, gain from Sloth, and ignore Magic and Drain;
- Divine Insights supplies limited research, but no more such researchers in one laboratory contribute than the dominion candles in that province;
- nation- and object-specific abilities can add or alter research.

Research resolves early

Research is hosting step 2. A researcher contributes for the month even if killed later during hosting. This does not make exposed researchers safe; it means the current month's points can survive a later raid while the future research flow does not.

Research is a queue of responses

A weak plan says:

> "Research Evocation because the nation has Fire mages."

A useful plan says:

> "Reach the precise area-damage spell before the first war, with enough F2 casters and carried gems to cast it after the line has engaged, while retaining an Alteration branch if the opponent fields fire resistance."

Every breakpoint should record:

Field	Question
Deadline	On which turn or war must the spell exist?
Caster	How many mages can cast it without rare randoms?
Resource	What does one battle, ritual cycle, or item batch cost?
Delivery	What range, timing, formation, lab, or ritual range is needed?
Counter	What common defence defeats it?
Branch	What is researched if scouting disproves the original threat?
Afterlife	Does the school level remain useful after the first purpose?

Breakpoints, not school completion

Research should be measured by useful breakpoints rather than equal bars. A school level can unlock:

- a defensive self-buff that makes thugs viable;
- an army-wide resistance answer;
- an efficient battlefield damage spell;
- a site-search ritual;
- a national summon;
- a path booster;
- a dome;
- a remote attack;
- a global;
- an artifact tier.

The next level is valuable only through the spells or items the nation can actually use. High school level does not imply high path requirement; low-path utility can appear late and high-path effects can appear earlier.

Research portfolios

A robust research plan contains four functions:

1. Immediate survival: expansion, early war, resistance, protection, or fatigue tools.
2. Efficient repetition: spells many recruitable mages can cast.
3. Access development: boosters, summons, or rituals that widen the path graph.
4. Strategic leverage: movement, remote warfare, globals, artifacts, and legendary effects.

Overconcentration creates brittle excellence. Excessive breadth creates many half-finished answers. The correct portfolio is shaped by national mage distribution and the next opponent, not by a universal school order.

Research efficiency

Useful measures include:

```
RP per gold = monthly research / recruitment gold
RP per upkeep = monthly research / monthly upkeep
breakpoint time = remaining RP / current monthly RP
field opportunity cost = RP lost when researchers leave laboratories
```

These ratios answer different questions. Cheap research may have poor commander-point efficiency. A high-RP capital mage may be needed for battlefield duty. A sacred researcher may have low upkeep. A foreign or summoned mage may open a path worth far more than its raw RP.

Mage-turn accounting

One mage can normally perform only one monthly strategic job:

- research;
- forge;
- cast a ritual;
- empower;
- search manually;
- move;
- preach or perform another order;
- accompany an army.

The full cost of a ritual is:

```
gem or slave cost
+ one mage-turn
+ foregone alternative output
+ position and exposure
```

A "free" summon paid only in gems still consumes a caster's month. A cheap item can be expensive if the only qualified mage is the nation's research engine or unique global caster.

Legendary research

Level 9 of every school except Construction consists of legendary spells. Reaching level 9 does not automatically grant the entire level:

- one legendary spell is selected and researched at a time;
- the level can be researched repeatedly to learn additional legendary spells;

- the default limited-legendary setting restricts how quickly this catalogue is acquired;
- Construction 9 instead unlocks unique artifacts.

The decision is spell-specific. "Reach Thaumaturgy 9" is incomplete; the plan must name the first legendary spell, the caster and gems that make it real, and the reason its effect is worth delaying every other branch.

Research audit

At the start of a major plan:

1. list the next two wars and likely counters;
2. identify exact spell breakpoints;
3. count common, uncommon, and unique casters;
4. reserve the gems required for one decisive battle;
5. identify the item or summon ladder that changes access;
6. estimate turns to the breakpoint after fielding losses;
7. name the branch if the opponent changes plan;
8. avoid counting a Pretender or unique mage in two distant places.

Part IV: Gems, Slaves, and Magical Logistics

Gem production

Magic sites send gems to the national treasury when their province is connected through friendly territory to a province with a laboratory. Ownership alone is not enough. Raiding, isolation, or laboratory loss can interrupt collection without destroying the site.

The treasury records both current stock and monthly income. These must not be confused:

- income supports a sustainable rate;
- stock allows bursts, emergency defence, globals, artifacts, and path development;
- committed stock is already promised to a forge queue, ritual, or field army even if still visible in the total.

Blood slaves

Blood has no ordinary gem. Blood slaves are acquired principally through Blood Hunting and are physical units/resources that must be moved and pooled. Their economy includes:

- gold and commander points for hunters;
- unrest and population damage;
- patrol or tax consequences;
- laboratory and transport logistics;
- the opportunity cost of hunter mage-turns;
- battlefield and ritual consumption.

The correct comparison is not "slaves are free." It is the total provincial and organisational cost per useful blood effect. Book II gives the hunting and unrest foundation; this book treats the magical expenditure.

Pooling and distribution

The pool command gathers gems carried by commanders in a laboratory province into the national treasury. Direct transfer equips field mages. A reliable monthly process is:

1. pool slaves and unused gems at laboratories;
2. reserve strategic stocks;
3. issue ritual and forge orders;
4. assign exact battle loads;
5. leave an explicit contingency reserve;
6. check that moving armies carry neither too few nor treasury-sized excesses.

Carried gems are exposed to battle loss and may be unavailable to rituals. Treasury gems cannot help a mage in battle unless transferred before combat.

Combat gem rules

A mage may use gems in combat to:

- raise a known path by one for one spell;
- reduce a spell's fatigue;
- satisfy a spell's gem requirement.

Limits:

- a mage cannot spend more gems in one combat turn than the current skill in that path;
- gems cannot grant the first level of an absent path;
- gem use cannot increase the path by more than one;
- the computer controls optional fatigue spending;
- conservative gem use makes the mage spend sparingly and on scripted spells only.

"How many gems does the spell cost?" is only the beginning. The full question is:

```
required spell gems
+ any path-boost gem
+ optional fatigue gems selected by the AI
<= gems legally spendable this combat turn
```

Because current skill is part of the spending limit, a battlefield boost or communion may change what can be spent. Exact spell-AI decisions remain object- and situation-sensitive.

A battle-gem budget

For each mage, record:

Field	Meaning
Scripted minimum	Resources required to execute the intended five orders
Likely AI spend	Additional gems that may be used to control fatigue
Emergency reserve	Gems retained for later rounds or a second battle
Capture exposure	Maximum acceptable value if the army is destroyed

Field	Meaning
Conservative setting	Whether unscripted or optional spending is restricted

Underloading produces failed scripts. Overloading converts a rout into a treasury loss. The right load depends on the value of the battle, expected duration, retreat route, and likelihood of a second engagement before resupply.

Gems as fatigue control

Many combat gems are spent not to meet the printed requirement but to keep the caster conscious. This can be decisive because fatigue changes:

- whether later scripted spells are attempted;
- the risk of unconsciousness;
- communion-slave survival;
- vulnerability to critical and armour-defeating hits;
- the number of useful casts before collapse.

The effect should be valued in additional useful actions, not only fatigue removed. A gem that permits the decisive fourth cast may be more valuable than one that merely makes an already won battle cleaner.

Alchemy

Any magically skilled commander in a friendly laboratory can use the Alchemy order:

```
2 non-Astral gems -> 1 Astral pearl
2 Astral pearls -> 1 gem of another type
```

Converting one non-Astral type to another through pearls is effectively 4:1. This is a severe exchange rate. It is rational when the receiving gem crosses a binding threshold: a decisive ritual, booster, dome, global, or emergency defence.

The ordinary conversion should not be confused with alchemical spells that convert gems into gold. The Modding Manual's Alchemy Bonus ability applies to the latter category, not automatically to the treasury's pearl conversion.

Gem valuation

The value of a gem depends on access and timing:

```
strategic gem value
= effect unlocked
x probability of timely delivery
x scarcity of substitutes
- opportunity cost
```

A Nature gem may be common nationally but priceless at the exact army that needs a resistance spell. Astral pearls are flexible but are also consumed by communions, teleportation, dispels, and powerful late rituals. A surplus path can fund a repeatable summon; an apparent shortage may be caused by idle forge queues rather than low income.

Reserve doctrine

Useful reserve categories are:

- battle reserve: one or more decisive engagements;
- counter reserve: domes, dispels, emergency movement, or resistance;
- access reserve: empowerment or a booster chain;
- strategic reserve: a named global, artifact, or legendary ritual;
- trade reserve: gems whose diplomatic value exceeds immediate conversion.

An unlabelled treasury is easily spent twice in planning.

Part V: The Anatomy of Battle Magic

Spell classes by battlefield job

A battle-magic package normally combines several jobs:

Job	Desired effect
Preparation	Path boosts, personal defence, reinvigoration, or communion formation
Protection	Resistances, armour, Luck, regeneration, mist, concealment, or anti-magic
Control	Immobilisation, confusion, sleep, fear, fatigue, displacement, or terrain conditions
Attrition	Repeated efficient damage or summons
Breakthrough	Large area, armour-negating, high-penetration, or battlefield-wide effect
Sustain	Fatigue relief, healing, replacement bodies, or continuous enchantment
Counter	Removal or neutralisation of the enemy's named mechanism
Preservation	Escape, protection of commanders, or reduced gem exposure

No spell is "good" independently of delivery. A superb damage effect at the wrong range or damage type is a poor answer. A minor resistance buff applied before the relevant area attack can decide the battle.

The battle-resolution boundary

Book IV is the authoritative home for preparation, interruption, spell accuracy, Magic Resistance contests, casting fatigue, damage families, and the lifetime of battlefield enchantments. Reprinting those formulas here created two places that could drift after a patch.

For magical planning, the essential questions are:

1. Can the caster complete preparation before contact or interruption?
2. Will the spell reach the intended target at an acceptable risk to friendly troops?
3. Which defensive layer does it test: Protection, resistance, Magic Resistance, fatigue, morale, or position?
4. Can the caster afford the fatigue and repeat the effect?
5. Does the plan still work indoors or under a different battlefield condition?
6. Is the caster's survival part of maintaining the effect?

The exact arithmetic and current patch corrections are in Book IV, Part XIV. This chapter uses their result to build the package.

Scripting and spell AI

A five-order script is a preferred sequence, not complete control. A scripted spell may fail because:

- research or a path was misread;
- the required resource is absent;
- range or target is illegal;
- fatigue is too high;
- the caster was interrupted, stunned, or unconscious;
- the battlefield condition is wrong;
- a target no longer exists;
- the spell AI chooses a fallback after the script.

Robust scripts name their failure branches. If the critical buff is skipped, can the army still survive? If an enemy resistance appears, what does the mage cast after order five? If communion slaves drop below a threshold, which masters become illegal or exhausted?

Battlefield package worksheet

Layer	Question
Threat	What exact damage, control, or defence must be answered?
Preparation	Which boosts and communion orders occur first?
Screen	What buys the required casting time?
Main effect	Which repeated spell performs most work?
Breakthrough	Which spell changes the battle state?
Sustain	How are fatigue and losses controlled?
Counter-counter	What happens against resistance, antimagic, flyers, or assassins?
Gem budget	What is the cost per expected battle and per war?
Retreat	Which casters and gems survive a failed plan?

Part VI: The Nine Paths in Practice

How to read a path

Each path should be evaluated through six questions:

1. What protection does it create?
2. What defence does it attack?
3. How does it control movement, fatigue, or cohesion?
4. What does it summon or forge?
5. How does it project power on the map?
6. Which other path covers its principal failure?

The summaries below are functional maps, not spell lists. National spells and the active mods can substantially alter them.

Fire

Fire commonly converts research and gems into immediate destructive tempo:

- direct and area fire damage;
- burning and Heat;
- offensive weapon or strength enhancement;
- Fire Resistance;
- battlefield-wide destructive conditions;
- gem-to-gold alchemy;
- late world effects tied to fire and heat.

Fire's strengths are efficient damage against dense, insufficiently resistant armies and the ability to turn an ordinary line into a more lethal one. Its weaknesses are resistance, friendly fire, fatigue, limited control, and the possibility that high damage is wasted on dispersed or expendable targets.

Fire packages need:

- a reason targets will remain clustered;
- screening or range;
- a non-fire answer;
- protection from their own area effects;
- a gem budget for high-impact casts.

Air

Air commonly supplies:

- armour-negating shock damage;
- precision and ranged support;
- storms and anti-flight conditions;
- flight and strategic mobility;
- concealment, mist, or displacement;
- strong remote reach.

Shock damage attacks a different defensive layer from ordinary physical damage. Storms can define the whole battlefield, but may also obstruct friendly flyers, missile plans, or spell requirements. Air mages are often high-value because the path combines battlefield damage with movement and information.

Air planning must distinguish:

- storm-compatible and storm-dependent effects;
- friendly flying requirements;
- shock-resistant targets;
- whether strategic movement resolves into a magic battle or later ordinary battle;
- whether a remote effect is blocked by a dome.

Water

Water commonly provides:

- Cold Resistance and cold damage;
- quickness and action-tempo changes;
- defence and fluid physical alteration;
- water-elemental and aquatic tools;
- underwater access;
- frost-based battlefield control.

Quickness multiplies both output and fatigue exposure. Cold effects are strongest when resistance and friendly exposure are managed. Water's ability to operate underwater can be strategically decisive because many ordinary armies and rituals have restrictions there.

Water packages should audit:

- fatigue after additional actions;
- friendly cold resistance;
- underwater legality;
- the difference between temporary battle acceleration and monthly map movement;
- whether the target's high Protection matters to the chosen cold effect.

Earth

Earth commonly supplies:

- Protection and natural armour;
- strength and physical enhancement;
- reinvigoration and fatigue control;
- armour damage or earth control;
- constructs and siege power;
- many foundational forging tools.

Earth often wins indirectly by making an army's existing bodies harder, stronger, and more sustainable. It is also central to path escalation because Construction and Earth forging frequently create the infrastructure for other schools.

Earth packages fail when:

- armour-negating or resistance-based effects bypass the added Protection;
- heavy armour raises casting encumbrance;
- slow preparation loses to early contact;
- transformed or buffed units still lack delivery;
- a forging plan consumes the only field-capable Earth mages.

Astral

Astral commonly provides:

- communions;
- Magic Resistance contests and penetration;
- antimagic and resistance support;
- teleportation and remote projection;
- information and detection;

- global control, dispels, and late strategic effects.

Astral's central advantage is leverage: many modest mages can combine, and high Astral can contest units or globals through exact arithmetic. Its central danger is that the same infrastructure can be fragile. Communion slaves can collapse; high-value casters can be exposed; Astral duels or hostile soul effects can punish path-heavy mages.

Astral planning requires:

- MR and penetration estimates;
- slave and master path ratios;
- pearl supply;
- protection of communion infrastructure;
- a clear distinction between battlefield communions and Grand Communion orders.

Death

Death commonly supplies:

- undead creation and command;
- skeleton-based battlefield attrition;
- fear, decay, disease, and fatigue;
- soul and death effects;
- powerful summons and transformed commanders;
- late rituals involving the dead and Titans.

Death can convert gems into bodies without ordinary upkeep assumptions, but those bodies may be Mindless, vulnerable to Banishment, or dependent on Undead Leadership. Reanimation and battlefield summoning can absorb time while decisive casters work.

Death packages should audit:

- priestly counters;
- Undead Leadership;
- battlefield turn limits;
- friendly morale and disease exposure;
- whether summoned bodies are an objective or only a screen;
- the risk profile of late summons whose minds or forms are uncertain.

Nature

Nature commonly supplies:

- regeneration, healing, and life enhancement;
- poison resistance and poison offence;
- entanglement and movement control;
- animals, plants, and living summons;
- supplies and longevity;
- growth- and dominion-linked world effects.

Nature often creates persistence rather than immediate lethality. Regeneration is strongest on sufficiently large and protected bodies; it is not a substitute for surviving the initial hit. Poison plans require protection for friendly units and enough battle duration for delayed damage to matter.

Nature packages should distinguish:

- healing from affliction removal;
- regeneration from one-time healing;
- supply generation from battlefield value;
- poison damage from immediate rout pressure;
- living summons from mindless or undead logistics.

Glamour

Glamour commonly supplies:

- illusions and false damage;
- concealment and misdirection;
- confusion, bewilderment, and perception attacks;
- defence through appearance rather than armour;
- remote or strategic deception;
- True Sight at high indirect path skill.

False damage can disable or rout without ordinary wounds, but it interacts differently with false-damage regeneration and True Sight. Glamour defence can be powerful until the opponent brings the correct perception or wide-area answer.

Glamour packages need:

- an answer to True Sight;
- a plan for Mindless or otherwise inappropriate targets;
- real damage or control when illusion is insufficient;
- awareness that late-battle spell AI and current patches affect invisibility choices;
- protection against area effects that do not care which apparent body is real.

Blood

Blood commonly supplies:

- demons and blood summons;
- Sabbaths;
- sacrifice and dominion interaction;
- severe single-target or battlefield effects;
- horror and corruption mechanics;
- world enchantments that punish ordinary magic.

Blood converts provincial population, unrest tolerance, patrols, hunters, laboratories, and transport into a magical economy. Its scale can be enormous, but its logistics are unusually visible and disruptive.

Blood packages should audit:

- slaves at the caster rather than only in the treasury;
- hunter, patrol, and laboratory capacity;
- Sabbath fatigue modifiers;
- living-only or underwater restrictions;
- enemy raids on hunting provinces;
- whether blood investment is delaying conventional research and defence.

Cross-path architecture

Paths become more useful when paired by function:

Need	First layer	Complementary layer
Armoured mass	Fire, Air, Death, or resistance-based attack	Earth or Nature screen
High MR elites	Physical or elemental pressure	Astral penetration only where efficient
Dense low-resistance army	Area elemental damage	Control that holds density
Fast rush	Early protection and control	Later breakthrough damage
Long attrition	Death or summons	Nature/Earth sustain and fatigue control
Remote threat	Air/Astral/Glamour movement or attack	Domes, scouts, and local response
Global war	Astral dispel and high ritual strength	Gem income, caster security, diplomacy

The purpose of a secondary path is not variety. It is to cover the principal failure of the first mechanism.

Part VII: Communions, Sabbaths, Choruses, and Grand Communions

What a battlefield communion does

A communion combines mages during battle to:

- raise every master's already-known paths;
- distribute each master's spell fatigue among that master and all friendly slaves;
- pass certain personal buffs from masters to slaves;
- concentrate the actions of many mages into stronger casting.

A valid communion requires at least one master effect and one slave effect. Astral uses Communion Master and Communion Slave. Blood uses Sabbath Master and Sabbath Slave. MA Man's Spellsingers can use Chorus Master and Chorus Slave.

These are separate communion types. One Astral Communion, one Sabbath, and one Chorus may coexist, each with its own masters, slaves, and bonuses. An Astral master does not gain the slaves of a simultaneous Sabbath.

The level bonus

A master gains `n` levels in every path the master already knows when the communion has at least `2^n` slaves:

Active slaves	Master bonus
1	+0
2-3	+1
4-7	+2
8-15	+3

Active slaves	Master bonus
16-31	+4
32-63	+5
64-127	+6

The first slave makes the communion valid but grants no level. Bonus levels do not create an absent path. If slave casualties reduce the total below a threshold, every master's bonus drops immediately.

The threshold structure makes "spare" slaves strategically useful. Four slaves produce +2, but the loss or unconsciousness of one reduces the group to three and +1. Five or six retain +2 after some attrition.

Participants in one spell

For a single master's spell, participants are:

- the master casting that spell;
- all friendly slaves in that communion.

Other masters are not participants in that cast. They gain the path bonus, but they do not share another master's fatigue as participants.

If there are four slaves and three masters, a spell cast by one master has five participants, not eight. Each master's separate spell creates its own fatigue event over that master plus the same slave pool.

Base fatigue distribution

For one master's spell:

```
base fatigue per participant
= spell fatigue after path calculations
/ number of participants
```

The slave's share is then modified by the slave's skill relative to the casting master in the relevant path:

Slave path relative to master	Slave fatigue modifier
higher than master	x 0.5
equal to master	x 1
lower, but at least half the master	x 2
lower than half the master	x 4

Skill gained from the communion and all other sources is included when calculating spell fatigue. Exact rounding at each step is assigned to controlled testing.

Worked comparison

Suppose one master and four slaves participate, so the divisor is five.

If the resolved spell fatigue before distribution is 100:

```
base participant share = 100 / 5 = 20
```

The caster receives the master share according to the communion rules. Each slave then receives:

Relative skill	Fatigue per slave before type-specific modifiers
Slave higher	10
Equal	20
Lower but at least half	40
Lower than half	80

Four weak slaves do not automatically make high-path casting safe. The path bonus can raise the master far above the slaves, turning the x4 bracket into the dominant risk.

Master count and slave load

Adding masters increases output but not the number of participants in each cast. If two masters cast 100-fatigue spells into the same four equal-path slaves:

- each event has five participants;
- each slave receives a share from the first cast;
- each slave receives another share from the second cast;
- total slave load approximately doubles.

The correct design ratio depends on:

- master casting frequency;
- spell fatigue after boosted skill;
- slave path relation;
- slave encumbrance and reinvigoration;
- buffs transmitted to slaves;
- expected battle length;
- whether slaves leave at unconsciousness;
- how many threshold casualties can be tolerated.

"Four slaves per master" is not an engine rule.

Slaves cannot act

While in the communion, slaves perform no independent actions. Their mage-turn in the battle is converted into:

- master path access;
- fatigue capacity;
- receipt of qualifying self-buffs;
- risk.

A slave's opportunity cost includes the spells that mage could otherwise have cast. High-path slaves may be safer fatigue sinks, but they can be too valuable to immobilise.

Shared personal buffs

Slaves benefit from self-buffs cast by communion masters when those spells are single-target, range 0 personal effects. This can create powerful shared protection, resistance, regeneration, reinvigoration, or other effects.

The important details are:

- the buff is produced by the particular master's cast;
- legal qualifying effects must be checked from current spell data;
- timing matters-slaves may already have received fatigue before the protection arrives;
- some buffs can be harmful to particular slave bodies;
- a master's personal path access and script determine what is transmitted.

Communion buffing is an army-design problem, not an arithmetic trick. Slave chassis, resistances, and encumbrance must suit the intended shared effects.

Collapse

The communion ends when no masters or no slaves remain.

If all masters die or flee, every slave suffers:

- approximately one combat round of stun;
- `3d50` fatigue damage.

This backlash can disable or kill an already exhausted slave block. Keeping the masters alive is part of keeping the slaves alive. Redundant masters can prevent sudden collapse, but every additional active master can also increase fatigue throughput.

Automatic participation

Items such as matrices, Slave's Hearts, and Master's Athames can make bearers join automatically. The bearer:

- must be a mage, meaning at least one non-Holy magic path;
- need not have Astral or Blood;
- must still be analysed for item slot, cost, timing, and survivability.

Automatic participation can bring foreign paths into a communion without spending the first scripted round joining. It also creates fragile item dependencies and may expose expensive gear to battlefield loss.

The three battlefield types

Type	Special rule
Communion	Spells take 25% longer to cast
Sabbath	Master suffers half fatigue; slaves suffer 20% extra fatigue
Chorus	Spells take 25% longer; a slave leaves on losing consciousness

The Sabbath improves master endurance by transferring a harsher burden to slaves. Chorus slaves avoid later damage once unconscious, but every departure can reduce the master's path bonus immediately.

Designing a safe communion

Proceed in this order:

1. name the highest-path spell each master must cast;
2. calculate master path after the intended slave threshold;
3. estimate spell fatigue at that path;
4. count participants for each cast;
5. place each slave in the relative-path multiplier bracket;
6. add type-specific Sabbath or casting-time effects;
7. estimate simultaneous master throughput;
8. include transmitted buffs and reinvigoration;
9. provide threshold redundancy;
10. protect masters from assassination, flyers, missiles, and early area damage;
11. write a useful plan for masters after the scripted sequence;
12. decide what a controlled collapse looks like.

Common communion failures

The threshold cliff

Exactly four slaves produce +2. One casualty produces only +1, invalidating later spells or sharply raising fatigue.

Weak-slave multiplication

Masters rise several path levels while slaves remain far below half the master. Every cast sends four times the base share to each weak slave.

Too many masters

The slave pool receives overlapping fatigue from many masters. The communion appears efficient because every master has high paths, then the shared battery collapses at once.

Harmful self-buffs

A master distributes an effect incompatible with slave physiology, resistance, or role.

Preparation without contact timing

The army needs several rounds to join, boost, and buff, but the enemy reaches the mages before the package activates.

No post-script policy

Masters complete five orders and begin casting high-fatigue or inappropriate spells into the same slave pool.

Master annihilation

All masters are placed together and die to one flanking or area effect, causing backlash.

Grand Communions are different

Grand Communion is a strategic monthly order used by certain nations. When one eligible mage casts or dispels a global, other eligible mages in the same context can use Grand Communion to add their relevant path skill to the power of the attempt.

It does not:

- create a battlefield communion;
- distribute battlefield fatigue;
- grant every path;
- make participating mages available for research or other orders that month.

For a Dispel, joining Astral skill adds directly to the attempt described by the manual's example. Grand Communions let a nation convert several mage-turns into ritual contest strength.

Communion audit

Before a battle:

- identify communion type;
- count slaves at every threshold;
- record each master's boosted paths;
- calculate every critical spell's participants and slave brackets;
- check shared self-buffs;
- set gem policy;
- separate or protect masters;
- decide how slaves recover;
- plan for one slave loss, one master loss, and early contact;
- test the exact package in the current ruleset.

Part VIII: Rituals and Strategic Magic

Ritual fundamentals

Rituals are map spells that take one entire monthly order. They normally require:

- a friendly laboratory;
- the researched school level;
- a caster with all required paths;
- sufficient gems or slaves in the national treasury;
- a legal target and range.

The treasury supplies ritual gems automatically. A field commander carrying gems elsewhere does not increase the national pool.

Hosting position

Important magic timing from the official hosting sequence:

Step	Resolution
2	Research
4	Empowerment
5	Forging
10	Magic rituals, in random caster order
11	Remote army attacks
12	Magic battles, including relevant teleports and movement
14	Site-search ritual results
28	Global enchantments take effect on the world
31	Item and monster special effects
62	Artifacts may become yearning

This timing has strategic consequences:

- current research can unlock knowledge before later events, but orders were submitted with the pre-host state;
- forging and empowerment complete before ordinary rituals;
- remote attacks and magic movement can precede ordinary movement battles;
- a global is cast at the ritual step but its world effect begins at step 28;
- a new global does not retroactively change movement battles or storming that already resolved in the same host;
- yearning occurs near the end of the turn.

Ritual order is random

Rituals at step 10 resolve in random caster order across relevant mages. Plans that require ritual A to precede ritual B in the same month are unsafe unless the engine or objects provide a specific guarantee.

This affects:

- opening and using gateways;
- competing globals;
- sequential remote attacks;
- global-slot contests;
- casting a protection before a hostile action;
- using a summon as a same-turn caster.

Range and legality

Ritual range is measured in provinces where shown. No listed range normally means a local ritual. Markers include:

- NUW: cannot be cast underwater;
- UW: can be cast only underwater.

Ritual-range abilities and sites can change reach. Range should be measured from the actual casting laboratory after movement orders, not from the capital or army being supported.

Local enchantments

Local enchantments affect a province and may persist. Many are linked to their caster:

- caster death ends the effect;
- most also end when the province is conquered;
- limited-duration enchantments can often be extended with extra gems;
- most gain one month per extra gem, while some gain three.

The shortcut `Shift+M` repeats a ritual monthly while the caster remains eligible and resources exist. Repetition is operationally convenient but can drain a treasury silently if the strategic need changes.

Anonymous and limited rituals

Some rituals are:

- Anonymous: caster or origin information is concealed by the effect's reporting rules;
- Limited: only one instance can affect the target province.

Anonymous is not synonymous with undetectable. Scouting, diplomatic inference, target selection, and repeated patterns can still reveal responsibility.

Ritual categories

Category	Strategic use	Main counter
Site search	Convert map ownership into gem income or special access	Raiding, lab isolation, opportunity cost
Summon	Convert gems and a mage-turn into units or commanders	Banishment, resistance, upkeep or leadership limits
Remote attack	Damage or invade a distant province	Domes, defence, decoys, retaliation
Magic movement	Relocate forces outside ordinary movement	Domes, traps, interception, wrong timing
Information	Reveal provinces, armies, sites, or magic	Concealment, misinformation, opportunity cost
Local enchantment	Protect or transform one province	Dispel, conquest, caster assassination
Economy	Produce gems, gold, units, scales, or other flow	Caster loss, global contest, raids
Global	Change rules across the world	Dispel, replacement, assassination, dominion pressure

Site-search rituals

Remote searches can:

- cover territory faster than manual movement;
- search dangerous provinces without exposing a mage;
- use otherwise idle path access;
- convert gems into future income.

They are investments, not automatic profit. The expected return depends on site frequency, province type, previous searches, ritual cost, and time remaining. A search that pays back in ten turns can be poor during an existential war and excellent during stable expansion.

Summoning

A summon should be valued by role:

Summon output	Main value
Combat bodies	Frontage, attrition, special attack, resistance, or siege
Commander	New path, leadership, forging, ritual, or thug chassis
Sacred unit	Bless interaction and Holy Point independence where applicable
Undead or demon	Different upkeep and leadership system, specific counters
Elemental or temporary force	Immediate battlefield conversion

The cost includes the summoner's month. A mediocre combat unit can be a great summon if it opens a path, commands a new troop family, or relieves a commander-point bottleneck.

Remote attacks

Remote attacks resolve before ordinary movement battles. Their purposes include:

- stripping Province Defence;
- killing commanders or laboratories;
- testing a dome;
- exhausting defenders;
- cutting retreat routes;
- creating a magic battle before the main invasion;
- forcing the enemy to distribute defence.

A remote attack should be coordinated with the ordinary campaign. Damage without exploitation may only warn the target. Repeated attacks can also disclose path access and spending.

Magic movement

Teleportation and related movement create unusual timing. A movement ritual may produce a magic battle at step 12, before ordinary army movement. The arriving force must be self-contained:

- correct leadership;
- gems and slaves;
- a legal survival or retreat plan;
- enough force if the target is stronger than intelligence suggested;
- awareness of domes and redirection.

Strategic mobility is valuable because it compresses distance, but it can also separate mages from laboratories, armies, and friendly retreat provinces.

Repeat-ritual discipline

For every repeated ritual, record:

- monthly cost;
- assigned caster;
- cancellation condition;
- minimum reserve;

- target rotation;
- lab and range requirement;
- whether a new patch or mod changes the object.

Automation should preserve judgment, not replace it.

Part IX: Domes and Remote-Magic Defence

What a dome protects

Domes are local enchantments that interact with hostile ritual effects targeting the province. Their exact chance and consequence are object-specific. Some block, some redirect, and some retaliate.

They do not replace:

- scouts and intelligence;
- conventional defenders;
- protection against assassination;
- laboratory redundancy;
- dispersal of unique casters;
- diplomatic deterrence.

Major manual examples

Dome	Listed behaviour in the manual	Friendly-magic consequence
Dome of Solid Air	80% protection; destroyed when it fails	Blocks friendly targeted magic as well
Frost Dome	30% protection and a cold trap	Blocks friendly targeted magic as well
Forest Dome	30%; absorbed fire destroys it	Blocks friendly targeted magic as well
Dome of Misdirection	70%; redirects a ritual to a neighbouring province	Can redirect friendly targeted magic
Seven Seals	Perfect hostile protection until seven blocks crack it; caster-linked	Friendly Astral magic can pass
Dome of Arcane Warding	50% protection	Check current object text for exact scope

Strikeback or trap domes may retaliate without blocking. Against global enchantments, strikeback does not hit the global caster. As of 6.34, domes may also protect against Astral Disruption according to the official update.

Layering domes

When several domes exist, exact ordering and interaction must be tested for the current version and object set. Strategic evaluation should include:

- probability of at least one block;
- whether a failure destroys a dome;
- whether redirection can hit a friendly or valuable neighbour;
- whether friendly rituals are impeded;

- caster dependency;
- recurring gem and mage-turn cost;
- what the hostile caster learns from the result.

Do not multiply listed percentages without confirming resolution order and independence.

Dome strategy

A dome is best when it protects concentrated value:

- a capital research core;
- an artifact or global caster;
- a gateway;
- a throne;
- a major laboratory and gem stock;
- a predictable army staging province.

Concentration also makes the target predictable. A strong defence can invite repeated cheap probes, assassinations, ordinary invasion, or attacks on the dome caster.

Remote-defence audit

- Which provinces are worth enemy gems?
- Which hostile paths and ranges are known?
- Is the dome compatible with friendly rituals?
- Can the caster survive old age, raids, and assassinations?
- Is there a second laboratory or alternate staging point?
- What happens after one block, one failure, or redirection?
- Can the enemy simply attack the logistics outside the dome?

Part X: Global Enchantments and Dispel Wars

Global slots

Global enchantments are worldwide rituals. Game setup permits 3, 5, 7, or 9 global slots; five is the common default. The slot limit makes globals a shared political resource. Casting one changes not only the world but also what every other nation can maintain.

Casting cases

When a global is cast:

1. if the same named global already exists, the new casting attempts to replace it through the dispel contest;
2. if an empty slot exists and that name is absent, the new global occupies a slot;
3. if all slots are full and the name is different, the new global contests a randomly selected existing global, including possibly one cast by the same nation.

Global casting order among mages is random. A plan that assumes an open slot at the beginning of hosting may fail after other nations cast first.

Overcasting

The caster can add gems above the printed minimum. Ritual spending is capped by:

```
maximum ritual gems = caster path level x 100
```

The dispel strength of a global includes:

```
+1 per extra gem above minimum
+5 per caster path level above the spell requirement
+DRN
```

The challenger must beat the incumbent's result. The ordinary lesson is that one extra caster path level is worth five overcast gems in the contest, before considering other abilities or Grand Communion support.

Dispel

The common Dispel ritual directly challenges a selected global. The same comparison framework applies:

- extra gems add one each;
- excess relevant path adds five each;
- both sides receive a DRN;
- the higher result wins;
- the challenger must overcome the existing enchantment.

Because the roll is open-ended, no finite ordinary advantage is absolute. Large margins produce reliability, not certainty.

Caster dependency

Most globals end if the caster dies. Immortality does not preserve the enchantment through death while the body reforms. Some globals are also tied to an origin province and end if that province is conquered.

Counterplay includes:

- Dispel;
- same-name replacement;
- slot-pressure casting;
- assassination;
- remote attacks;
- old-age pressure;
- conquest of the origin;
- forcing the caster to take another risk;
- pushing out hostile dominion when the effect is dominion-limited.

A huge overcast protects against magical contest, not against a knife.

Protection against globals

Domes can protect units against many global effects in the same general way as local rituals. Strikeback domes do not retaliate against global casters. For globals restricted to or strengthened by dominion, removing hostile dominion from a province can function as protection.

The exact protected unit, province, and event scope is global-specific and should be read from current spell text.

Global categories

Category	Strategic effect
Gem engine	Creates monthly magical income
Economic engine	Changes gold, resources, supplies, or population
Battlefield rule	Adds storms, darkness, scales, or other conditions
Summoning or attack engine	Produces units or recurring hostile actions
Research or forging engine	Changes item cost, skill, or knowledge economy
Punishment global	Taxes rituals, forging, empowerment, or ordinary activity
Dominion global	Scales with or operates inside religious territory
Information or control global	Changes vision, detection, travel, or global slots

The printed benefit is only the first-order effect. A world storm, darkness, or ritual tax changes every rival's research choices and diplomacy.

Selected strategic examples

The following revision-2 manual values are a reference set; current object data must be checked before a live-game order:

Global	Requirement and base cost	Principal function
Eternal Pyre	Enchantment 6, F6, 80 Fire	+20 Fire gems per month; heat and darkness interaction at origin
Mother Oak	Alteration 5, N5, 50 Nature	+10 Nature gems per month
Well of Misery	Conjuration 8, D6, 80 Death	+21 Death gems per month and world growth interaction
Stellar Focus	Enchantment 7, S5, 60 Astral	+10 Astral pearls per month; world Drain and origin Magic effects
Gale Gate	Thaumaturgy 8, A5, 60 Air	+20 Air gems per month, stronger Air Elementals, hurricanes
Gates of Horn and Ivory	Thaumaturgy 7, G5, 60 Glamour	+15 Glamour gems per month and increased Glamour ritual range
Forge of the Ancients	Construction 6, E5, 80 Earth	Item cost reduction and Master Smith bonus
Perpetual Storm	Evocation 6, A5, 70 Air	Storms in battles, land-income and movement/range pressure
Burden of Time	Thaumaturgy 7, D7, 70 Death	Population, unrest, Death scales, and accelerated aging pressure
Eternal Twilight	Alteration 8, G8, 90 Glamour	Worldwide Magic/Twilight and economic pressure outside friendly dominion

Examples with more extreme late-game effects appear in Part XIII. These values are object data, not engine formulas; patches and active mods can change them.

Payback

For a pure gem global:

```
nominal payback time
= total gems spent / monthly gems produced
```

This is incomplete. A proper valuation adds:

- probability of being dispelled or losing the caster;
- value of the global slot;
- diplomacy and coalition response;
- same-path gem scarcity;
- caster and research opportunity cost;
- time remaining in the game;
- benefit from non-income side effects.

An 80-gem global producing 20 per month has a nominal four-month payback before overcast. It can still be poor if it provokes immediate war or exposes the only F6 caster.

Global diplomacy

Globals change incentives:

- a private gem engine is visible wealth;
- a world penalty creates a coalition even if its caster is hard to identify politically;
- a slot-filling global can block several nations' plans;
- a defensive overcast can signal a long-term commitment;
- an origin province becomes a public strategic target.

Before casting, assess:

1. who gains;
2. who loses;
3. who can dispel;
4. who can reach the caster or origin;
5. who benefits from helping either side;
6. what explanation or bargain is available.

Global-war audit

- Confirm the current spell object.
- Name the caster and backup.
- Calculate minimum, overcast, excess-path bonus, and maximum spend.
- Decide whether a Grand Communion applies.
- Verify slot state but assume other casts can precede it.
- Protect the caster and any origin province.
- Reserve a response to replacement or Dispel.
- Model diplomatic reaction.
- Set a minimum number of productive months.

- Do not place every strategic asset in the same protected province.

Part XI: Forging, Items, and Artifacts

Forging requirements

Forge Item requires:

- a mage in a friendly laboratory;
- the relevant Construction level;
- all item path requirements;
- the required gems;
- an appropriate item slot on the eventual bearer.

Forging resolves at hosting step 5. `Shift+0` repeats the selected item each month while requirements remain satisfied.

Construction tiers

Construction level	Item tier
1	Magical trinkets
3	Lesser magical items
5	Greater magical items
7	Very powerful magical items
9	Unique magical artifacts

Construction also contains spells and constructs. Its strategic value cannot be reduced to equipment alone.

Base item cost by path requirement

For each required path:

Required level	Base gems of that path
1	5
2	10
3	15
4	20
5	30
6	40
7	55
8	70

Multi-path items charge each path component. Current object data, national discounts, Forge Bonus, Forge of the Ancients, yearning, and mod commands can alter effective cost.

Item value

An item can provide:

- a path threshold;
- reinvigoration or resistance;
- protection, defence, attacks, or mobility;
- automatic communion membership;
- ritual range or special orders;
- leadership;
- monthly gem generation;
- survival or transformation;
- a chassis-specific thug or supercombatant package.

The correct unit of analysis is the package:

```
item gems
+ forge mage-turn
+ Construction research
+ bearer opportunity cost
+ risk of loss
```

A cheap item can be strategically expensive on the wrong bearer. A costly booster can be excellent if it unlocks a global or a new repeatable booster ladder.

Slots and package conflicts

Commanders have limited equipment slots. A booster competes with:

- protection;
- reinvigoration;
- a weapon or shield;
- penetration gear;
- mobility;
- anti-assassination equipment;
- another booster.

Path-access plans must be built on the actual chassis. "Wear three boosters" fails if they occupy the same miscellaneous, head, body, or hand slot.

Mounted units and unusual chassis can have different slot or item restrictions. Strength requirements and two-handed weapons can also invalidate theoretical loadouts.

National items

Some items are:

- restricted: only qualifying nations see and forge them, displayed with a dark blue forge background;
- discounted: available at reduced cost for particular nations, displayed in grey.

National items may alter a nation's access curve earlier than generic tables imply. They belong in every later nation dossier.

Forge bonuses

Forge Bonus and Master Smith are not identical:

- Master Smith raises paths for forging only;
- Forge Bonus reduces cost according to the ability or source;
- Forge of the Ancients gives a world-effect discount and Master Smith bonus to the caster's nation;
- national discounts and object-specific commands can also apply.

Exact stacking order and rounding among fixed and percentage effects are assigned to controlled tests. The displayed forge cost is the operational authority.

Forge of the Ancients

The revision-2 manual lists:

```
Construction 6
Earth 5
80 Earth gems
-20% item gem cost
Master Smith +1
```

This global changes both price and eligibility. Its strategic value is highest when:

- many item batches are planned;
- the +1 creates new forge thresholds;
- Construction research is already deep;
- the caster and global can be protected;
- the new efficiency will be realised before Dispel or war.

Artifacts

Construction 9 items are unique artifacts: only one copy of each can exist in the world. The default limited-unique-artifact rule limits each player to one unique artifact forged per turn.

Artifacts create:

- race conditions;
- intelligence from failed availability;
- concentration of power and loss risk;
- global strategic targets;
- an incentive to reach Construction 9 before others.

An artifact is more than an improved item. Its uniqueness changes timing and diplomacy.

Yearning

An artifact can become yearning, allowing it to be forged at half usual cost. Yearning can begin once at least one of these has occurred:

- any nation researches Construction 9;
- Forge of the Ancients is active;
- the Throne of Creation is claimed;
- the Throne of the Artificer is claimed.

Each condition increases the monthly yearning rate by 50 percentage points according to the manual. The check occurs at hosting step 62.

Yearning creates an information problem. Waiting can halve price but lose the artifact race. Forging immediately secures the object but pays full cost.

Booster reference

The following manual items form the core generic access map. Values are path requirements, not effective gem prices after bonuses.

Construction 5

Item	Forge requirement	Boost
Skull Staff	D2	+1 Death
Thistle Mace	N2	+1 Nature
Flame Helmet	F4	+1 Fire
Winged Helmet	A4	+1 Air
Gossamer Veil	G3	+1 Glamour
Robe of the Sea	W3	+1 Water
Armour of Souls	B5	+1 Blood
Earth Boots	E2	+1 Earth
Coin of Meteoritic Iron	S2E2	+1 Astral
Horn of Storms	A5	+1 Air
Brazen Vessel	B5	+1 Blood
Blood Stone	B3E2	+1 Earth
Armour of Twisting Thorns	B3N2	+1 Nature and +1 Blood

Construction 7

Item	Forge requirement	Boost
Staff of Elemental Mastery	F4W4 or A4E4 variant	+1 Fire, Air, Water, and Earth
Treelord's Staff	N5	+2 Nature
Blood Thorn	B3	+1 Blood
Starshine Skullcap	S2	+1 Astral
Skullface	D5	+1 Death
Robe of the Magi	A5B5	+1 all nine ordinary paths
Skull of Fire	F1D1	+1 Fire
Water Bracelet	W1	+1 Water
Ring of Wizardry	S7	+1 all nine ordinary paths
Ring of Sorcery	S6	+1 Astral, Death, Nature, and Glamour
Moonvine Bracelet	N3S1	+1 Nature
Mirage Crystal	G3E2	+1 Glamour

The table is a threshold map, not a recommendation to forge every item. It must be combined with slots, national paths, rare randoms, and active-mod data.

Booster ladders

A ladder begins with actual access and applies legal steps in order:

```
native path
-> low-tier booster
-> higher forge threshold
-> multi-path booster
-> summon or empowerment
-> global or legendary threshold
```

Example structure:

```
E2 mage
-> forge Earth Boots
-> operate as E3 while worn
-> cast or forge an E3 threshold
```

This does not create Earth on an E0 mage. It also does not allow one physical item to be worn simultaneously by two casters.

Forge queue

For each planned item:

Field	Record
Purpose	Exact spell, ritual, battle, or chassis unlocked
Qualified forger	Common, rare, unique, or Pretender
Research	Construction deadline
Cost	Displayed current cost after bonuses
Slot	Conflict with other equipment
Bearer	Where and when the item is needed
Reuse	Whether it returns to a laboratory or remains deployed
Loss risk	Capture, death, assassination, or artifact uniqueness

Part XII: Path Access and Bootstrapping

National access is a distribution

"The nation has Astral 3" can mean:

- every fort recruits S3;
- a capital-only mage has S3;
- a 10% random reaches S3;
- the Pretender alone has S3;

- a summon can eventually reach S3;
- one empowered commander reaches S3;
- a communion temporarily produces S3.

These are strategically different. Every nation dossier should separate:

- common repeatable paths;
- capital or terrain restrictions;
- random probability;
- foreign recruitment;
- summons;
- Pretender access;
- item-dependent access;
- communion-only combat access;
- empowerment.

The access graph

Represent each threshold as a node:

```
recruitable mage
-> booster forger
-> boosted ritual caster
-> summoned new-path commander
-> cross-path item
-> global or legendary caster
```

Every arrow needs:

- research;
- path;
- gems;
- a mage-turn;
- a slot or laboratory;
- correct load order under mods.

If any arrow depends on a rare random, calculate recruitment probability and delay rather than calling the ladder "reliable."

Probability of random access

For an independent probability `p` per recruitment, the chance of at least one success after `n` recruits is:

```
P(at least one) = 1 - (1 - p)^n
```

Examples:

Random chance	Recruits	Chance of at least one
10%	5	41%
10%	10	65%
10%	20	88%
20%	5	67%
20%	10	89%

This assumes independent rolls and the stated probability. Multi-pick random systems and linked randoms require their actual object definition.

Access quality

Evaluate a path threshold on:

Dimension	Question
Reliability	How often can the caster be obtained?
Scale	How many can be fielded?
Location	Capital, fort, terrain, summon site, or Pretender?
Timing	When do research and gems make it operational?
Sustainability	Can the effect be repeated each month or battle?
Replaceability	What happens if the caster dies?
Competing role	Is the caster also the only forger, researcher, or global anchor?

Empowerment as a bridge

Empowerment is most efficient when it creates an access loop. Examples:

- path 0 -> 1 permits a booster to function;
- a new cross-path combination forges a unique enabler;
- a permanent ritual caster summons replaceable mages;
- a global generates more of the gem type used;
- a new path makes an existing rare random unnecessary.

The fifty-gem first level is poor if it ends at level 1 with no useful threshold.

Pretender as access

A Pretender can:

- forge initial boosters;
- cast a national or global ritual;
- provide a missing cross-path;
- summon new-path commanders;
- establish a communion or item ladder.

This access is delayed by dormancy or imprisonment and endangered by death, Call God delay, and positional commitments. A Pretender path that exists only on the design screen is not operational until the chassis can reach a laboratory and spend the required turns.

Trading and diplomacy

Items and gems can move path access between nations:

- trade for a booster;
- hire another player to forge;
- exchange surplus gems for a binding shortage;
- coordinate a global or Dispel;

- use allied movement and laboratories where game rules permit.

Trade can be cheaper than empowerment, but it creates dependency and reveals strategic intent. A request for a Starshine Skullcap or Ring of Sorcery tells informed rivals which threshold may be approaching.

Hidden costs of path escalation

- rare mages stop researching;
- boosters occupy survival slots;
- a ladder concentrates unique items;
- the caster becomes an assassination target;
- alchemy destroys four gems for one off-path gem;
- the required global occupies a contested slot;
- the access arrives too late for the named war.

The correct endpoint is the cheapest timely and repeatable access, not the highest theoretical path.

Part XIII: Legendary and Late-Game Magic

The level-nine decision

Legendary research is a strategic commitment:

- level 9 has a large research cost;
- one spell is selected at a time;
- required paths are often rare;
- gem costs can consume several months of income;
- the spell can change global diplomacy;
- the caster becomes a critical asset.

The selection should answer:

1. What changes immediately after the spell is learned?
2. Is the caster already operational?
3. Are the gems reserved?
4. What is the counter?
5. Is a second legendary spell worth repeating the level?
6. Would another school's lower breakpoint win sooner?

Wish

The revision-2 manual lists Wish as:

```
Alteration 9
Astral 9
100 Astral pearls
```

Wish can produce extraordinary outcomes and can also harm the caster or nation. The manual suggests that wishing for gems or an artifact is safer than many ambitious requests.

Folklore is not enough to establish the accepted commands, aliases, random results, restricted units, or mod interactions. The library treats a complete Wish catalogue as test pending. The controlled suite records exact strings, messages, treasury changes, units, items, afflictions, horror marks, and repeat variation for each ruleset.

Nexus Gate

The manual lists Nexus Gate as:

```
Thaumaturgy 9
Astral 5, Earth 3
40 Astral pearls
```

It establishes a permanent gate to the Nexus. The network is shared and creates opportunities for rapid movement as well as exposure to other users and void-related danger. It cannot be evaluated as "forty pearls for movement" alone; it changes map topology.

Questions before opening it:

- who else can use the network;
- which laboratories and armies become connected;
- whether entry provinces can be held;
- what happens if an enemy learns or controls a node;
- which commanders can survive the destination.

Tartarian Gate

The manual lists Tartarian Gate as:

```
Conjuration 9
Death 7
7 Death gems
```

It releases a dead Titan or Monstrum from Tartarus. The body can be extraordinarily powerful, but the mind may be destroyed or otherwise impaired. The ritual's low printed gem cost is balanced by uncertainty, caster requirements, research, leadership, equipment, and remediation.

Tartarians should be classified after arrival:

- fully capable commander;
- impaired commander requiring healing or transformation;
- combat body;
- unusable or dangerous result.

The expected value depends on the nation's ability to repair minds, equip chassis, command units, and absorb failures.

Arcane Nexus

The revision-2 manual lists Arcane Nexus as:

```
Enchantment 9
Astral 8
150 Astral pearls
```

It gathers Astral pearls equal to one quarter of non-Astral, non-Blood gems spent on rituals, forging, and empowerment, along with its ambient collection described by the spell. It does not simply take a percentage of all magic income.

Arcane Nexus changes the world's incentives:

- rivals may delay forging and rituals;
- gem spending indirectly funds the caster;
- the caster becomes a coalition target;
- Dispel strength and overcast become geopolitical questions;
- Blood activity is comparatively less taxed by the stated collection rule.

Utterdark

The revision-2 manual lists Utterdark as:

```
Alteration 9
Death 9
100 Death gems
```

Its world darkness and severe income/resource reduction restructure military and economic play; caves and deep seas receive stated exemptions. Its value is relative. A nation prepared for darkness, nonliving armies, summons, or reduced conventional income may gain while ordinary gold-and-resource nations collapse.

The diplomatic effect is immediate: even nations not at war with the caster have reason to remove it.

Gift of Nature's Bounty

The manual's legendary Nature global improves income inside friendly dominion in proportion to candles and adds Growth. Its effect links:

- dominion strength;
- population economy;
- temple and preaching infrastructure;
- global protection;
- the ability to hold productive territory.

It does more than produce income. It turns religious map control into a fiscal multiplier.

Astral Corruption

The legendary Blood/Astral global punishes non-Blood rituals, forging, and empowerment with horror-related danger scaling with expenditure. It changes the comparative price of every magical action and can make ordinary path development lethal.

The caster should expect:

- coalition pressure;
- reduced rival forging and ritual tempo;
- greater relative value of Blood magic;
- attacks on the global caster;
- opponents shifting to armies, priests, or already forged assets.

Cataclysm and slot disruption

Some late rituals affect multiple globals, local enchantments, world magic, horror marks, or even the global-slot environment. Such effects should be treated as regime changes, not isolated spell casts.

Before using one:

- record which friendly enchantments will also be lost;
- estimate who benefits from a cleared global board;
- identify the order in which replacement globals can be cast later;
- protect against the new horror or magic environment;
- recognise that apparent neutrality can still favour one roster.

Late-game transition

A nation is not in the late game merely because it has researched level 9. A functional late-game magical state includes:

- several protected high-path casters;
- a deep treasury with named reserves;
- repeatable battlefield packages;
- remote response and movement;
- global defence;
- forged and summoned access;
- laboratories and retreat routes;
- intelligence about rival legendary choices.

Research without delivery is a catalogue. Delivery without preservation is a spectacle.

Part XIV: Countering Magic

Counter the chain

Every magical plan has dependencies. It can be attacked at:

```
research
-> caster
-> path boost
-> gems
-> lab
-> range
-> preparation
-> target
-> effect
-> persistence
```

The cheapest counter is often not the one printed opposite the damage type.

Counter layers

Enemy mechanism	Possible counter layers
Fire area damage	Fire Resistance, dispersion, faster contact, caster interruption, dome if remote
MR-based control	Higher MR, path skill, antimagic, fewer valuable targets, physical pressure

Enemy mechanism	Possible counter layers
Communion	Kill or scatter masters, exhaust slaves, force threshold loss, early contact, extended battle
Skeleton spam	Priests, fatigue pressure, kill summoners, long-battle clock, commander targeting
Heavy buffs	Attack before activation, bypass Protection, remove caster-linked enchantment
Remote attack	Dome, decoy province, distributed labs, conventional defence, retaliation
Global	Dispel, replacement, assassination, origin conquest, dominion removal, diplomacy
Artifact chassis	Disarm through killing bearer, fatigue, MR attack, battlefield control, assassination
Gem-heavy script	Cheap probes, sequential battles, retreat denial, treasury pressure

Resistance is not a complete counter

Resistance reduces one damage family. It does not necessarily answer:

- physical secondary effects;
- fatigue;
- control;
- armour-negating non-elemental damage;
- summons;
- morale pressure;
- battlefield conditions;
- a complementary second path.

A good counter preserves function after the opponent changes one spell.

Attack timing

Many magical packages are weakest:

- before research completes;
- while boosters are being forged;
- during the first preparation rounds;
- after gems are spent in a probe;
- when casters move away from laboratories;
- after a communion loses one threshold slave;
- when a global caster becomes publicly identifiable.

Tempo can be a stronger antimagic tool than Magic Resistance.

Targeting the organisation

Magic concentrates value in commanders. Countermeasures include:

- flyers or rear attacks;
- assassins;
- precision missiles;
- remote strikes;
- fast flanks;
- fear or morale pressure on ordinary mage chassis;
- cutting friendly retreat provinces;
- raiding laboratories and gem connections.

This must be balanced against decoys, bodyguards, traps, and expendable casters.

Gem denial

Force the enemy to spend resources inefficiently:

- attack twice before resupply;
- threaten multiple fronts;
- use cheap forces that look valuable enough to trigger scripted gems;
- retreat from the expected main battle where legal;
- raid gem-producing sites and laboratories;
- occupy the route that connects sites to labs.

Exact spell-AI gem thresholds are not fully public, so sacrificial-probe doctrine must be tested rather than treated as automatic.

Counter-counter planning

Every package should answer:

> If the opponent knows the plan, what is the cheapest adjustment that defeats it?

Then add one response:

- alternative damage;
- different formation;
- a faster script;
- a lower-gem mode;
- extra slave redundancy;
- a second route;
- conventional troops that exploit the magical counter.

The aim is not an uncounterable spell. It is a package whose counters create exploitable costs.

Part XV: Active Mod Ruleset

Keep the engine and object layers separate

Book IX owns the exact spell, item, site, mage, and command inventories for DE 2.16 followed by Divinitus 1.15.3 DE. Those files can change schools, paths, costs, range, area, effects, boosters, research, forging, ritual mastery, and gem income on thousands of individual objects. An unmodded spell table cannot safely be copied into the combined game.

The object edits do not automatically replace the engine's general research process, communion participant rules, ritual timing, laboratory requirements, global-slot process, or ordinary alchemy. Those rules remain the starting point until an exact command, patch correction, or controlled test changes them.

Resolving modded magic

For every important spell or item:

1. identify the unmodded object;
2. apply every DE selection or copy in source order;
3. apply Divinitus afterward;
4. resolve linked units, effects, weapons, sites, and shapes;
5. record final school, paths, cost, range, area, effect, and restrictions;
6. verify in game;
7. test AI, communion, and edge behaviour if strategically important.

The published explanation can remain readable, but its source record must retain the full provenance.

Part XVI: Controlled-Test Programme

Test standard

Every test records:

- game version;
- ruleset and load order;
- map and province;
- research and global settings;
- exact commander and object IDs where available;
- paths, items, gems, fatigue, and scripts;
- screenshots or turn files;
- number of repetitions;
- observed distribution;
- conclusion and remaining uncertainty.

One replay can demonstrate possibility. It rarely establishes probability or exact rounding.

Test 1: Research arithmetic

Create researchers with known total paths, bonuses, Magic/Drain, Dementia, philosopher status, and Divine Insights. Verify displayed and contributed RP, minimum 1, halving order, and dominion-candle caps.

Test 2: Research hosting timing

Have researchers contribute and then die at later hosting steps. Confirm current-month contribution and future loss. Test laboratory loss and site-income connectivity separately.

Test 3: Combat gem spending

For paths 1-4, script spells requiring zero, one, and several gems. Vary fatigue, conservative use, communion bonus, and carried stock. Record maximum gems spent per combat turn and AI fatigue spending.

Test 4: Spell-fatigue rounding

Use listed fatigue values not divisible by the excess-skill divisor. Vary base and armour Encumbrance. Record fatigue after each cast and locate every rounding step.

Test 5: Penetration

Use fixed caster path, excess skill, target MR, and target same-path skill. Run enough trials for baseline, easy, and hard resistance. Confirm tie direction and half-skill rounding.

Test 6: Communion thresholds

Run 1, 2, 3, 4, 7, 8, and 9 slaves. Remove one slave during battle and record immediate master path changes and spell legality.

Test 7: Communion fatigue

Vary:

- equal-path slaves;
- higher-path slaves;
- lower but half-path slaves;
- below-half slaves;
- one or several masters;
- odd fatigue totals;
- reinvigoration;
- Communion, Sabbath, and Chorus.

Record master and every slave after each spell.

Test 8: Communion self-buffs

Cast range-0 single-target buffs before and after joining. Use several masters and incompatible slave types. Record exactly which effects pass, timing, stacking, and harmful interactions.

Test 9: Communion collapse

Kill or rout all masters at different slave-fatigue levels. Measure stun and `3d50` fatigue distribution. Separately eliminate all slaves and compare.

Test 10: Automatic communion items

Test matrices, hearts, and athames on:

- non-Astral mages;
- non-Blood mages;
- priests with and without another path;
- innate casters;
- multi-form commanders.

Verify joining time, type, and slot behaviour.

Test 11: Ritual order

Construct same-turn rituals whose results reveal order. Repeat across nations and casters. Test dependencies involving summons, gateways, domes, and competing globals.

Test 12: Dome interaction

For each dome:

- friendly and hostile remote spells;
- anonymous and limited rituals;
- global unit effects;
- Astral Disruption;
- multiple layered domes;
- redirection at map edges;
- caster death and province capture.

Test 13: Global contest

Vary extra gems, excess path, same-name replacement, full slots, and Grand Communion. Confirm challenger tie behaviour, random incumbent selection, and self-replacement risk.

Test 14: Forge-cost stacking

Combine national discounts, fixed and percentage Forge Bonus, Master Smith, Forge of the Ancients, yearning, and multi-path items. Record eligibility and displayed cost at each step.

Test 15: Booster access

Verify that boosters fail at path 0 and activate at path 1. Test multi-path and all-path boosters, forms, item loss, and battlefield boost interactions.

Test 16: Artifact race and yearning

Trigger each yearning condition alone and in combination. Record monthly checks, half-cost display, simultaneous forging, unique-item failure, and limited-unique-artifact settings.

Test 17: Legendary research

Under limited and unlimited settings, record:

- first level-9 completion;
- spell-selection interface;
- repeated level-9 cost;
- simultaneous schools;
- Construction 9 differences.

Test 18: Wish

For every ruleset:

1. prepare an S9 caster and turn backup;
2. enter exact candidate strings;
3. record message, treasury, units, items, afflictions, horror marks, and caster status;
4. test aliases separately;
5. repeat random outcomes;
6. inspect mod restrictions such as `NO_WISH`.

Priority requests include gems, gold, slaves, artifact/artefact, weapon, power, strength, experience, dominion, population, exact unit names, commander or hero, and dangerous wishes.

Test 19: Indoor magic

Repeat battlefield-wide, ordinary area, personal, holy, and innate spells in open fields, caves, fort interiors, and assassination arenas. Confirm current 6.36 legality and AI fallback.

Test 20: Combined-mod regression

Build fixed battle and ritual fixtures for:

- school and requirement changes;
- damage, area, range, and fatigue;
- boosters and forge costs;
- communions and `#masterrit`;
- sites and gem income;
- Divinitus overwrites after DE.

Re-run whenever either file changes.

Part XVII: Operational Checklists

First magic audit

For a new nation:

1. list every recruitable mage and path distribution;
2. separate common, capital-only, terrain, foreign, sacred, and random access;
3. record research per gold, commander point, and upkeep;
4. identify the first battlefield protection, damage, and control breakpoints;
5. list generic and national boosters;
6. identify summon-based path expansion;
7. map gem income and unsearched paths;
8. name the first war's battle package;
9. set battle and strategic reserves;
10. identify the Pretender's unique magical jobs.

Research-turn checklist

- Did scouting change the next threat?
- What exact breakpoint is being bought?
- Which common mage casts it?
- Are the necessary gems already available?
- Is a critical forger or ritualist still counted as a researcher?
- Does one additional school level produce a usable spell?
- Is the plan overdependent on one rare random?
- What is the branch if war begins early?

Battle-magic checklist

- legal research and path;
- carried gems or slaves;
- current skill and per-turn spend limit;
- fatigue after excess skill and Encumbrance;
- range and likely target;
- battlefield indoor or underwater status;
- resistance and friendly exposure;
- preparation and interruption risk;
- communion threshold and slave load;
- orders after script completion;
- retreat and gem preservation.

Ritual checklist

- laboratory;
- treasury stock after other commitments;
- caster path and maximum ritual spend;
- range and UW/NUW legality;
- hosting order;
- dome risk;
- anonymous or limited status;
- repeat-order cancellation condition;
- caster and origin protection;
- exploitation after success.

Forging checklist

- current Construction;
- current object and mod overwrite;
- actual qualified forger;
- displayed cost;
- national, global, bonus, and yearning modifiers;
- item slot;
- bearer and delivery location;
- forge mage-turn;
- alternative booster or trade;
- loss risk.

Global checklist

- empty-slot uncertainty;
- minimum and overcast;
- excess-path bonus;
- Grand Communion;
- caster and origin;
- Dispel opposition;
- same-name contest;
- diplomatic coalition;
- payback time;
- world effect begins at step 28.

Post-battle magic audit

After every important replay:

- Which scripted spell first failed or changed target?
- Did contact occur before the package activated?
- How many gems were consumed and why?
- Which casters were interrupted?
- What was master and slave fatigue after each major cast?
- Did resistance, Protection, dispersion, or summons decide conversion?
- Did the army exploit the effect?
- Which caster, item, or gem stock was permanently lost?
- What single change most improves the next battle?

Part XVIII: Essays

Essay I: Research as a Response Tree

Research is often imagined as a ladder: climb one school, take the strongest spell at each level, then begin another. That image is convenient and strategically misleading. A ladder has only one direction. A real research plan is a response tree whose branches depend on enemy armies, geography, Pretender timing, gems, and the distribution of national mages.

The root is the nation's repeatable access. If most forts can recruit E2 mages, an Earth spell cast by E2 is not one option among many; it is a scalable transformation of the roster. If S3 appears only on a rare random, the same research level may provide a spectacular but unreliable trick. Research points do not distinguish between them. Strategy must.

The branches are deadlines. A spell that finishes two turns after an invasion is not an answer to that invasion. A defensive level reached one turn early may preserve laboratories and researchers, increasing every later branch. This is why research value cannot be reduced to spell efficiency. Timing changes the quantity of future research that exists.

Scouting prunes the tree. Fire Resistance becomes urgent against mass fire damage and largely idle against an enemy who changes to poison or fatigue. A wide portfolio protects against uncertainty, but each unfinished branch delays every completed answer. The best plan is neither a straight rush nor equal investment. It maintains one main branch and one affordable pivot.

Access development creates new branches. A Construction level can forge a booster; the booster permits a summon; the summon carries a new path; that path unlocks a ritual. The original research may produce far more than its first item. A high-level spell with no caster is the opposite: knowledge with no route into the world.

An expert research screen should be read as a decision map. Every allocated point says which future is being prepared for and which is being delayed. The useful question is not "Which school is best?" It is "Which branch leaves the nation with a timely answer and the strongest next choice?"

Essay II: Gems as Stored Time

A gem is condensed magical power, but strategically it is also stored time. It represents a site found, territory held, a connection maintained to a laboratory, and several turns during which the resource was not spent elsewhere.

This explains why equal gem costs are not equal. Five gems from a path producing twenty each month are a small slice of current flow. Five gems in an absent or scarce path may represent alchemy at four to one, diplomatic trade, or the entire stock accumulated since expansion. The spell interface displays cost; it does not display replacement time.

Combat converts stored time into immediate tempo. A path-boosting gem can bring a spell forward by one threshold. Fatigue spending can buy an additional useful cast before unconsciousness. A battlefield enchantment can make one battle occur under conditions that would otherwise require an entirely different army. The gem is efficient when the time purchased now is worth more than the time stored for later.

Forging converts gems into persistent access. A booster may be moved between mages, reused across wars, and become the first rung of a larger ladder. A summon converts them into a body or commander. A global converts a large stock into continuing flow or a new worldwide rule. These forms have different exposure: items can be captured, summons can die, and globals depend on casters and contested slots.

The gem treasury is also a calendar. A reserve for Dispel protects future turns. A forge queue promises gems to a coming threshold. Battle loads prepay the chance to survive an invasion. If every gem remains in one unlabelled total, future plans are silently sold to the first attractive order.

The mature question is not whether to spend or save. It is which future action the stock is preserving, and whether the current crisis is more valuable than that future. Hoarding without a named endpoint is wasted time. Spending without an opportunity-cost ledger is borrowed defeat.

Essay III: From Mage to Army

A nation does not possess battlefield magic merely because its mage can cast a spell. The effect becomes military power only when it is delivered through an army structure.

The first requirement is time. Buffs, communion formation, and battlefield enchantments occupy preparation rounds. The line must hold without routing or pushing the fight outside spell range. Formation is part of the magical plan. A cheap screen may be the piece that makes an expensive spell work.

The second requirement is scale. One powerful caster can influence a battle, but repeatable mages define doctrine. If every fort supplies the required path, losses can be replaced and several armies can carry the package. If the Pretender or one rare random is essential, the effect is a strategic reserve, not standard army equipment.

The third requirement is conversion. Protection must answer the actual damage family. Evocations need legal targets and acceptable friendly exposure. Resistance spells must activate before the hostile effect. Summoned bodies must appear where their frontage and morale matter. A spell cast successfully but converted into irrelevant damage has consumed time and perhaps gems without becoming force.

The fourth requirement is exploitation. Immobilising an enemy matters if missiles, flankers, or heavy infantry can use the delay. Darkness matters if the friendly roster functions better inside it. A storm matters if it disables more hostile systems than friendly ones. Magic is strongest when it changes the exchange in favour of bodies already prepared to exploit it.

The final requirement is preservation. Mages, boosters, slaves, and gems are campaign assets. A victorious army that loses its magical core may not fight again. The full magical package includes retreat routes, commander protection, spare laboratories, and a resupply plan.

Turning a mage into part of an army is an organisational job. The spell is only one component. Screen, formation, script, gem load, counter, and post-battle survival complete the weapon.

Essay IV: Communions Without Myths

Communions attract rules of thumb because their exact arithmetic feels cumbersome. "Use four slaves," "one master per four," or "communions share buffs" are memorable. None is a sufficient design rule.

Four slaves do create +2 paths, but they also stand on a cliff. One loss reduces every master to +1. Whether they survive depends on the spell's fatigue, the master's boosted path, each slave's relative path, the number of masters casting, the communion type, and shared buffs. The visible slave count is only the beginning of the calculation.

The participant definition corrects another common assumption. Other masters do not help divide one master's spell. One casting master and all slaves participate. Adding masters increases the number of fatigue events sent into the same pool, so an impressive casting roster can make the communion less stable.

The path comparison is equally important. Communion bonuses lift the master. If weak slaves remain below half that boosted skill, their fatigue share is multiplied by four. A spell that looks cheap after the master's excess-skill reduction can still crush every slave when repeated by several masters.

Shared self-buffs are the creative centre of communion design. A master can transmit qualifying personal protection, resistance, regeneration, or other effects to the slave block. This can turn fragile researchers into a durable magical battery. It can also distribute an incompatible effect and kill them faster. The chassis matters as much as the paths.

The communion is best understood as a power grid. Slaves provide capacity, masters draw and transform it, thresholds govern voltage, and every spell creates load. Redundancy, compatible components, controlled demand, and protected control nodes make a grid reliable. A copied ratio does not.

Essay V: Rituals and Geopolitics

Battle spells act inside one encounter. Rituals act on a map shared with other players and intentions. A remote attack, dome, teleport, or global is both a mechanical action and a political signal.

Range compresses geography. A nation with remote search and attack can turn distant laboratories into forward influence. Magic movement can ignore ordinary fronts. Domes create protected capitals and staging provinces. None abolishes position: every effect still begins from a caster, laboratory, origin, range, or gateway that can be scouted and attacked.

Hosting order makes this influence simultaneous. Rituals resolve in random caster order. Remote attacks and magic battles precede ordinary movement. Globals take world effect after several military phases. The strategic map visible when orders are submitted is not the map on which every effect resolves.

An anonymous ritual conceals information but does not remove inference. Nations observe who has the path, range, motive, and gem economy. A repeated attack can unite several targets against the suspected caster. A global publicly changes every nation's incentives even if its direct benefit is private.

Protection also redistributes violence. A dome over the capital encourages enemies to raid gem sites, assassinate the dome caster, probe the percentage, redirect magic, or invade conventionally. Successful defence changes the cheapest hostile route; it does not end hostility.

Ritual planning must include the diplomatic aftermath. The effect, its likely attribution, the victims' alternatives, and the means of exploiting it all belong in the order. Strategic magic is geopolitics carried out through the hosting sequence.

Essay VI: Globals as Political Economy

A global enchantment is often evaluated by payback: cost divided by monthly income. This is necessary for gem engines and radically incomplete.

The global occupies a scarce public slot. It announces a caster with high path access and a treasury capable of overcasting. It may reveal an origin province. It changes which rivals gain from cooperation, Dispel, assassination, or slot pressure. Its true cost includes the coalition it creates.

World penalties demonstrate the point most clearly. Darkness, storms, aging, ritual corruption, or income collapse do not harm every roster equally. The caster has presumably prepared summons, resistances, dominion, or alternative income. Other nations assess not the absolute harm but the caster's relative gain. A spell that reduces everyone by half can be overwhelmingly aggressive if one nation loses only a quarter.

Gem globals also alter politics. Private income increases future Dispel and forging capacity. A rival may reasonably spend more than the global's nominal value to stop it compounding. The caster's payback calculation must include the chance that the global survives, not only its monthly output.

Overcasting buys resistance to one form of attack. It does not prevent assassination, old age, origin conquest, or a random full-slot replacement attempt. Every additional gem increases magical security while concentrating more value behind the same mortal dependency.

The strongest global plan is a state programme: caster security, reserve gems, dome and mundane defence, diplomatic preparation, origin protection, and a schedule for exploiting the new world. The enchantment is the public institution; the protected network behind it is the state that keeps it alive.

Essay VII: The Level-Nine Decision

Level-nine research is seductive because it promises the largest effects in the game. The cost is not only the research points shown on the bar. It is every lower branch delayed while the nation climbs, every mage-turn required to create the caster, and every gem reserved instead of winning earlier battles.

Legendary selection makes the trade sharper. Most schools do not grant a complete catalogue at level 9; one spell is selected at a time. The first choice needs a named caster, treasury, target, counter, and operational date.

Some legendary spells transform the map. Nexus Gate changes connectivity. Others transform magical economy: Arcane Nexus taxes world expenditure, and Astral Corruption punishes ordinary magical action. Utterdark or similar world effects change the value of entire rosters. Wish can cross conventional boundaries but carries uncertainty that must be tested rather than romanticised.

The best legendary spell is relative to preparation. Tartarian Gate is stronger for a nation that can repair, equip, and lead its results. A dominion-scaled economic global is stronger for a nation already winning religious territory. A punishment global is stronger when the caster's own economy is exempt or prepared.

Counterpressure begins before the cast. Rivals can observe research direction, boosters, rare path mages, pearl hoarding, and Construction races. A path to level 9 may invite attack precisely because its future is frightening. Reaching the threshold requires surviving the signal.

The level-nine decision should be worked backwards from the world it creates. Describe the position one turn after success, four turns after success, and after the obvious coalition response. If those positions are not favourable, the legendary spell is not yet a plan. It is only a possibility.

Sources and Open Questions

Principal sources

- Illwinter, Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, especially Magic, paths and schools, battle magic, rituals, global enchantments, communions, gems, research, legendary spells, items, Divine Magic, alchemy, and the spell and item appendices.
- Illwinter, Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34.
- Illwinter Dominions 6 documentation.
- Illwinter Dominions 6 changes.
- Official Dominions 6.30 announcement.
- Supplied `DomEnhanced2_16.dm`.
- Supplied `Divinitus_1.15.3_DE.dm`.

Community references are used to discover disputed questions and test candidates, not to override current official rules without reproducible evidence.

Open questions

Current-game tests or resolved object data are still needed for:

- exact optional combat-gem AI thresholds and all target-selection weights;
- every rounding step in spell fatigue, penetration, communions, forging, and ritual contests;

- complete ordering and independence of layered domes;
- every current object value altered after the revision-2 manual;
- exact Wish vocabulary, aliases, random distributions, and restrictions;
- all effective DE and Divinitus spell, item, site, mage, and summon records;
- mod-specific communion, Grand Communion, and forge interactions;
- simultaneous artifact and global edge cases.

Book IX now owns the exact mod command scope; this list is limited to behaviours that still need engine evidence.

DOCUMENT 8 OF 16

Foundation Book VI: Strategy and Campaign Conduct

From systems to campaign

Dominions is won on the map, but the map is only the visible surface of the contest. Armies occupy provinces; research changes what those armies can survive; laboratories turn gems into reach; scouts turn uncertainty into decisions; forts turn territory into replacement capacity; diplomacy changes how many fronts must be defended; and Thrones determine when strength becomes victory.

> Foundation rule: Strategy is the conversion of limited resources into a position that can force, survive, or prevent the next decisive event.

A nation does not win by collecting the largest abstract total of gold, gems, research, or territory. It wins by making those resources matter before rivals can answer, then turning the advantage into enough claimed Ascension Points. Every recommendation in Book VI has a context and a deadline.

Book VI is where the earlier rules meet the map. It assumes the mechanical foundations instead of teaching their formulas again. A spy revealing income is a rule. Recruiting one before the first war is advice whose value depends on access, cost, geography, and the information already available.

Edition note

The shared ruleset and evidence language remain in Book I. Books II-V own the detailed economy, religious, combat, and magic rules. Book VI brings them together for expansion, intelligence, logistics, diplomacy, defeat, and victory conversion. Book IX supplies exact modded changes whenever a campaign plan depends on DE or Divinitus.

Current-version corrections and additions that matter

Dominions 6 introduced strategic systems and interface changes that make some older-series advice incomplete:

Current feature or correction	Strategic consequence
Optional hidden maps require exploration	Map knowledge is acquired rather than assumed; scouts can reveal routes as well as armies
Maps may contain multiple planes	Adjacency, sanctuary, invasion routes, and throne access can cross a plane boundary
Formal diplomacy supports binding NAPs with humans and AI	Treaty terms may be enforced by the engine, but the game setting and agreed social doctrine still matter
Raid is movement followed by pillaging, without an automatic return	Pillager units now seize and damage the destination rather than performing an abstract round trip
Scrying inside dominion can detect glamoured units	Glamour conceals information but does not guarantee operational surprise
Thrones become visibly lit after being claimed	Claimed victory progress is easier to read from the map
Many globals depend on an origin province that must be held	Strategic enchantment defence includes territorial defence

Current feature or correction	Strategic consequence
Score graphs incorporate more sources accurately	Threat estimates using graphs are stronger than in early releases, though still incomplete
AI builds forts, recruits better national troops, and plans high-level rituals, globals, and dispels	Old descriptions of a purely passive or magically incapable AI are obsolete
Magic-phase movers can be included in moving-army setup	Teleporting and ordinary elements can be prepared as one operation
Cataclysm is harder to counter	Late games with Cataclysm enabled must treat the victory threshold as a moving clock
Large games host faster and allied site information was corrected in 6.34	Operational coordination is more reliable than in affected older versions

Object balance still changes through patches. A current nation plan must be rebuilt when its roster, spell access, Pretender options, or mod layer changes, even if the campaign principles remain valid.

Using the campaign sections

Expansion, scouting, borders, research signals, war planning, sieges, Thrones, and the turn checklist form the main route. Raiding, remote warfare, deterrence, coalition politics, recovery, and after-action review become more useful once those basics are familiar. The single-player chapter explains what AI games teach well and where multiplayer creates a different strategic problem.

Part I: Strategy as Conversion

Position, force, and deadline

A strategic position has three parts:

1. Assets: provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, armies, mages, gems, research, Pretender, and diplomatic relationships.
2. Access: which assets can affect which places and at what time.
3. Deadline: the next event that changes the value of the position.

Deadlines include an enemy research breakpoint, a dormant Pretender awakening, a fort cracking, a treaty expiring, a global taking effect, a claim-capable priest reaching a Throne, or the arrival of Cataclysm. The same assets can be sufficient before a deadline and worthless after it.

This yields a practical model:

```
strategic value
= usable assets
x probability of correct delivery
x value before the deadline
- exposure and opportunity cost
```

This is not an engine formula. It is a way to compare plans. A large army has little current value if it cannot cross the terrain in time. A research lead has little war value if the mages carrying it are trapped in a sieged capital. A cheap raider has high value if it pulls an expensive counter-mage away from the decisive front.

The six conversions

Most campaigns turn on six conversions:

Conversion	Example	Failure mode
Economy into capacity	Gold builds forts and recruits mages	Infrastructure delays necessary defence
Capacity into knowledge	Mages spend turns researching	The nation researches effects it cannot field
Knowledge into force	Mages, gems, troops, and scripts form an army package	A spell list is mistaken for a deployable force
Force into position	Armies take routes, labs, forts, sites, and Thrones	Victories occur in strategically empty provinces
Position into constraint	Raids, forts, threats, and treaties narrow enemy choices	Gains are too diffuse to force a response
Constraint into victory	The nation cracks, storms, and claims enough Thrones	Dominance is enjoyed but never converted

Strong play moves deliberately from one conversion to the next. Weak play often becomes trapped between them: rich but unable to recruit, researched but unable to cast, victorious but unable to siege, or dominant but unable to claim.

Tempo and initiative

Tempo is the amount of useful change achieved before an opponent can respond. Initiative is the ability to present threats that determine where and how the opponent must spend the next turn.

Tempo is not speed alone. A fast raid that loses a unique commander may surrender more future tempo than it gains. A month spent combining armies may be correct if the merged force can remove a capital and every smaller force would bounce.

Initiative is strongest when threats are:

- credible: enough force or hidden capacity exists to execute them;
- multiple: the defender cannot cover every target;
- asymmetric: the attacker spends less than the defender must reserve;
- timed: the threats mature together;
- convertible: at least one successful branch leads to a fort, lab, army destruction, or Throne.

The objective is not perpetual aggression. It is the ability to decide which problem becomes urgent.

The strategic horizons

Horizon	Typical distance	Central question
Turn	Current hosting cycle	Which orders can fail, collide, or become illegal?
Operation	Several turns	Which target can be isolated, reached, cracked, and exploited?
War	Research and reinforcement cycle	Which exchange rate and breakpoint can the enemy not sustain?
Game	Victory threshold	Which route produces enough claimed Ascension Points?

Good decisions align all four. A tactically excellent battle can damage the operation by consuming gems needed for the storm. A successful operation can damage the war if it exposes two unforted borders. A winning war can lose the game if another nation claims the last required Throne.

The cost of attention

Dominions has an unpriced resource: player attention. Every additional raider, scout network, forge route, blood-hunting transfer, communion, or diplomatic promise creates orders that must be checked. A system that is theoretically optimal but routinely misordered has a lower practical value than a robust system.

Attention costs grow sharply in war because each turn adds:

- battle reports and script diagnosis;
- enemy movement estimates;
- gem and item transfers;
- recruitment replacement;
- route and retreat checks;
- diplomacy;
- throne arithmetic.

Simple habits such as renaming commanders, marking armies, keeping standard scripts, using repeatable gem loads, and following a fixed turn audit are strategic tools. They lower the chance that a mature position dies to an omitted order.

Part II: Expansion

What expansion is for

Expansion is the first time a Pretender design and national roster are turned into territory. The result is more than a province count. Good expansion produces:

- gold and resource flow;
- room and population for forts;
- magic sites and independent recruits;
- defensible boundaries;
- routes toward or around Thrones;
- enough surviving troops and commanders to discourage an early war;
- an infrastructure schedule that does not stop recruitment.

A player can finish the first year with many poor, exposed provinces and a hollow army. Another can hold slightly fewer provinces but own two strong fort sites, a narrow border, and intact expansion parties. The second position may be stronger.

Expansion testing

Expansion should be tested under the actual game assumptions:

Variable	Why it must match
Nation and age	Starting army, roster, independent composition, and resources differ

Variable	Why it must match
Pretender and awakening	An awake expander changes routes, risk, and recruitment
Scales and dominion	Gold, resources, supplies, bless, and Pretender safety change
Independent strength	Required party size and acceptable targets change
Map or map type	Terrain, connectivity, caves, water, and start density change
Active mods and load order	Costs, units, blessings, spells, and Pretenders may differ
House rules	Expansion diplomacy, mercenaries, and early attack restrictions may differ

A useful test protocol is:

1. Create the intended ruleset and game settings.
2. Record the Pretender design.
3. Play through turn 12, including realistic recruitment, Province Defence, site searching, and fort construction.
4. Record every fight, loss, province type, treasury level, fort start, and remaining army.
5. Repeat on several starts.
6. Change only one major element at a time.
7. Keep the reliable build, not the one with the luckiest maximum.

The community practice of testing to turn 12 is valuable because one in-game year includes route variation, attrition, winter or summer conditions, and the first infrastructure decision. A benchmark is meaningful only if its accounting includes what the real game will buy. Tests that omit PD, forts, researchers, or required temples create an imaginary expansion economy.

The first expansion audit

Before the first attack:

- What troop or Pretender package is the expansion engine?
- Which independent types can it defeat cheaply?
- Which types can kill it through lances, high damage, mass missiles, magic, poison, fear, or surround penalties?
- Does it need a bless, prophet, priest, mage, screen, or specific formation?
- How many losses can be replaced without delaying the second party?
- What is the retreat route?
- Which adjacent province improves capital recruitment through resources?
- Which route reveals the most map or claims the most valuable boundary?

The first attack should normally be selected after scouting reports arrive. Independent armies do not change merely because the estimate changes; the report contains uncertainty. The correct response to uncertain numbers is margin, not false precision.

Expansion party archetypes

Archetype	Strength	Main risk
Armoured line	Absorbs low-damage infantry and missiles	High-damage barbarians, lances, fatigue, slow killing
Defence or glamour line	Avoids many ordinary attacks	Surround penalties, high attack, area damage, magic weapons

Archetype	Strength	Main risk
Missile mass	Damages before contact and exploits low protection	Shields, armour, weather, ammunition, fast contact
Lance or impact force	Powerful first contact	Wasted charge, attrition after impact, missile exposure
Giant or elite squad	High individual durability and damage	Low numbers, surrounding, expensive casualties
Sacred party	Bless creates an efficient specialist package	Holy-point limits, priest dependency, wrong matchup
Awake monster	Independent commander with rapid early tempo	Irreplaceable loss, hostile dominion, fatigue, specialist independents
Awake Titan	Expansion plus later slots and strategic magic	Complex scripting, afflictions, insufficient early damage
Thug pair or small commander team	Mobile, low troop demand, scalable later	Gem or bless dependency, counter matchups
Mage-supported troops	Solves hard types and reduces attrition	Lost research, stray death, gem consumption, script failure

These are roles, not strict categories. A sacred giant line may belong to three at once. The purpose is to identify why the party wins and which target will break it.

Target selection

Target value has at least five dimensions:

1. Win probability.
2. Expected permanent loss.
3. Economic value.
4. Positional value.
5. Information value.

The weakest visible province is not automatically the best target. A resource-rich cap-ring forest can unlock a second party. A low-income mountain may secure a choke point or later fort. A province on the wrong side of the intended boundary may create a diplomatic dispute. A throne province may reveal valuable effects but contain mage support far beyond ordinary independents.

An expansion route should prefer:

- targets the party counters;
- cap-ring terrain that improves recruitment;
- rich farmlands and high population for economy and forts;
- strategic connectors and plane gates;
- provinces that cut off a safe interior;
- independent mages or special recruits;
- routes that can be reinforced rather than isolated.

Minimum force and acceptable loss

The ideal party is not the smallest one that can win once. It is the smallest one that wins with enough reliability and survivors to keep tempo. A party that takes a province with 55% probability is not efficient merely because it is cheap.

Expansion losses have compounding cost:

- replacement gold and resources;
- commander turns spent collecting troops;
- delayed second and third parties;
- lost veteran experience;
- exposed routes;
- weaker deterrence at first contact.

Overbuilding also compounds. A single enormous party may win every fight but captures only one province per turn. Two parties with safe matchups normally create more map tempo, reveal more land, and deny more provinces.

Use three margins:

- combat margin: enough strength to survive report error and random battle outcomes;
- attrition margin: enough survivors to take the next scheduled target;
- strategic margin: enough reserve or recruitment that one bad fight does not collapse the opening.

Routing and branch points

An expansion party should rarely be sent to the far edge without a return plan. Every route should mark:

- the next two intended targets;
- a branch if the preferred target is too dangerous;
- a rendezvous province for reinforcements;
- the future border;
- the nearest fort site;
- the path home or toward a threatened neighbour.

Interior provinces can be deliberately left for a later party if the outer route encloses them safely. This increases frontier speed without surrendering the eventual income. The risk is that an unscouted connector, cave, water route, or rival cuts into the pocket.

First contact

First contact turns expansion into diplomacy. The first border message should settle practical facts before fear fills the gap:

- which provinces each side believes are natural claims;
- whether a disputed province contains a Throne, special site, or critical route;
- whether formal or social NAPs are in use;
- how countdowns are counted;
- whether scouts and stealth units are permitted;
- how accidental bumps will be handled.

The best border is not always equal by province count. A stable border that preserves a rich interior can be worth conceding one weak province. A narrow, fortifiable line is often stronger than a long geometrically "fair" boundary.

When expansion ends

Independent expansion ends when profitable unclaimed targets disappear or when continuing exposes the nation to an unacceptable first-war position. The transition signs are:

- neighbouring expansion parties can collide;
- taking the next province creates a disputed salient;
- armies must combine to take Thrones or hard independents;
- forts and researchers now return more than another marginal army;
- opponents have reached military breakpoints;
- the nation must choose a first-war target or defensive posture.

The correct transition does not stop all growth. Thrones, underwater access, caves, remote provinces, and independent pockets may remain. It changes the dominant problem from beating known neutral defenders to acting under human opposition.

Part III: Scouting, Intelligence, and Uncertainty

Information is a resource

Information changes which orders are rational. It does not directly kill troops, but it prevents armies from attacking the wrong counter, reveals undefended infrastructure, identifies a throne rush, and allows gems to be carried only where necessary.

The value of information depends on:

- accuracy: how close the report is to reality;
- coverage: how much of the relevant map or force is observed;
- timeliness: whether it arrives before orders are due;
- interpretation: whether the player understands what the evidence implies;
- denial: whether the opponent can be kept from obtaining the same advantage.

Old information decays. A capital report from six turns ago still identifies fort and terrain, but not the current army, research package, gem reserve, or commander movement.

Official information channels

Observer or condition	Information provided
Scout in province	Owner, military estimate, fort construction, province history, current temperature and neighbour temperature
Priest in province	Scout information plus dominion strength and owner
Spy in province	Scout information plus income, supplies, known sites, unrest, PD, and more accurate military information
Friendly dominion	Owner, income, temperature, neighbour dominion
Scrying	Owner, highly accurate military information, income, supplies, sites, PD, history, temperature, dominion, forts, and unrest
Province ownership	Full provincial information, with map-name exploration distance depending on age
Adjacent ownership	Neighbour owner, temperature, and unreliable military information
Spy in an enemy capital	Access to enemy score-graph data even when score graphs are disabled

These channels overlap but are not interchangeable. A scout can see construction; a spy can estimate state capacity; scrying can penetrate heavily patrolled areas without risking a physical scout. Dominion vision is broad but does not reveal every military fact.

The intelligence cycle

Use a five-step cycle:

1. Question: what decision must be made?
2. Collection: which scout, spy, scry, battle probe, graph, or diplomatic inquiry can answer it?
3. Assessment: which facts are observed, inferred, stale, or possibly deceptive?
4. Action: what order changes because of the result?
5. Review: after hosting, which assumption was correct and which source failed?

"Scout the enemy" is too broad. Better questions include:

- Can the border fort be cracked in one turn?
- Which province contains the enemy's research mass?
- Does the army have poison resistance, magic weapons, or battlefield mobility?
- Which commander is likely carrying gems?
- How many Ascension Points can the nation claim within three turns?
- Which route is outside ordinary reinforcement range?

Collection without a decision produces clutter.

Reading partial evidence

No single clue proves a full plan. Combine indicators:

Indicator	Possible meaning	Alternative explanation
Research graph rises sharply	Research infrastructure matured	Site, event, Pretender, or graph uncertainty
Gem income appears high	Wide site-search coverage or rich territory	Throne income, globals, events, or hidden alchemy
Army disappears from border	Withdrawal or magic-movement staging	Glamour, stealth, transfer, or report failure
Construction mages stop researching	Forge cycle or army deployment	Rituals, site searching, illness, lab loss
H3 unit moves toward a front	Throne claim preparation	Bless support, preaching, or ordinary movement
Large cheap-unit recruitment	Siege preparation or mass screen	Patrol, freespawn organisation, or replacement
NAPs requested on several borders	Consolidation for war elsewhere	Genuine insecurity or throne preparation

An estimate should carry a confidence statement: observed, likely, possible, or unknown. This prevents one attractive story from becoming the only story.

Scouting density

A useful network has layers:

- border screen: current armies, construction, and route changes;
- operational depth: forts, labs, reinforcement roads, and reserve armies;
- strategic nodes: capitals, Thrones, globals' origin provinces, blood centres, major laboratories;

- rear warning: stealth raiders, plane gates, underwater exits, and indirect routes.

One scout on each border province is not a network. Scouts should leapfrog or overlap so the loss of one does not blind an entire front. Spare scouts can travel with armies to loot gear, hold transferred gems, or preserve observation after a province changes hands.

Patrol and concealment

Official detection compares:

```
Patrol Strength + 2d25 open-ended
versus
Stealth Strength + 2d25 open-ended
```

Stealth strength is based on the commander and is reduced by troops in the party. Patrol strength combines unit contributions, is reduced by unrest, and gains from PD at 15 or more. Flying, map movement, Precision, Patrol Bonus, commander status, Mindless, and Undisciplined affect individual patrol contribution.

Consequences:

- detection is probabilistic, not guaranteed;
- repeated exposure raises cumulative risk;
- adding troops makes many stealth parties easier to detect;
- high unrest weakens patrols;
- PD 15+ changes a province from a token garrison into part of an intelligence screen;
- a discovered stealth force fights the outside defenders, while ordinary fort defenders not patrolling remain inside.

Movement and patrol timing also matters. Move and Patrol lets an arriving army fight outside a friendly fort, but it does not have time to search for stealth units during that same turn. The order becomes ordinary Patrol on the following turn.

Information denial and deception

Denial measures include:

- killing or patrolling out scouts;
- avoiding unnecessary army concentration near observed borders;
- moving gems and items at the last practical moment;
- hiding capable commanders among ordinary researchers;
- keeping several plausible research branches;
- protecting capital and throne interiors from spies;
- using domes, stealth, glamour, or magic movement where appropriate;
- displaying false or incomplete threats.

Deception should create a plausible wrong decision. A visible army near an irrelevant Throne matters only if the enemy must reserve a force against it. A false weak border is useful only if the actual counter can arrive. Deception that requires the opponent to act irrationally is hope.

Battle probes and pings

A probe can reveal:

- troop and commander identities;

- positions, formations, and orders;
- bless effects;
- scripted spells;
- carried gems through observed casting;
- throne independent mages and their spell repertoire;
- fort or field context.

The cost includes the probing commander, information given to the opponent, possible treaty implications, and the chance that the probe changes the target before the real attack. A retreat script does not guarantee survival when routes are hostile, a commander is trapped, or combat reaches it too quickly.

Score graphs

Graphs are strategic indicators, not inventories. They can show trends in provinces, forts, income, research, army size, dominion, or resources according to game settings. Current versions incorporate more event-derived changes accurately, and a spy in an enemy capital can expose that enemy's graph information even if ordinary graphs are disabled.

Graphs should answer comparative questions:

- Who is compounding fastest?
- Who suffered a sudden army or territory loss?
- Whose research curve implies a breakpoint?
- Which apparent victim remains economically dangerous?
- Which leader can reach a throne threshold?

Graphs cannot show scripts, exact counters, hidden gem stock, diplomatic obligations, or the quality of units behind an army-size number.

Since version 6.35, victory reveals all score graphs and the hidden map to the players who remain until the game ends. Elimination still reveals neither, so a defeated player removed before the final result does not receive the same post-game intelligence. This is a review and learning tool, not information available for the decisions that produced the victory.

Part IV: Map Structure, Borders, and Infrastructure

Strategic geography

Every province has at least four geographic meanings:

- economic: income, population, resources, supplies, and sites;
- network: which provinces and planes it connects;
- military: terrain, movement cost, fort and battlefield context;
- political: border, Throne, buffer, treaty claim, or coalition route.

A low-income connector may be more valuable than a rich dead end. A cave entrance, water crossing, or plane gate can create an invasion route that ordinary border counting misses.

Interior lines and exterior pressure

A nation has interior lines when its forces can move between threatened fronts faster than enemies can coordinate around the outside. Forts, roads, labs, central terrain, sailing, flight, and magic movement strengthen interior lines. Long tendrils, mountain or swamp barriers, and isolated underwater pockets weaken them.

Interior lines permit one reserve to answer several threats, but simultaneous hosting limits reaction. A reserve must be placed where its legal next-turn destinations are known before the enemy commits. "It can respond eventually" is not the same as "it can intercept next turn."

Exterior pressure becomes decisive when several enemies attack different nodes at once. Diplomacy is part of geography: a neutral border can shorten the defended perimeter more effectively than any fort.

Border shapes

Shape	Advantage	Risk
Narrow choke	Easy to fortify and scout	One lost node may open the interior
Broad line	Many routes for offence	High scouting and reserve demand
Salient	Threatens several enemy provinces	Can be cut off from reinforcement
Pocket	Safe later expansion and recruitment	Hidden routes or rivals may steal it
Corridor	Connects separated holdings	Vulnerable to a single raid or fort
Island or underwater enclave	Difficult for some rivals to reach	Limited exits and specialised counters
Plane gate network	Strategic mobility and surprise	Gate provinces become decisive nodes

The strongest border is the one the nation can actually observe, reinforce, and politically maintain.

Fort placement

Fort decisions should be evaluated across five roles:

1. Recruitment: population, resources, terrain recruits, and national restrictions.
2. Research: repeatable mage production and safe laboratories.
3. Control: sealing routes and forcing enemies into sieges.
4. Logistics: resupply, gem pooling, forging, ritual origins, and army assembly.
5. Victory: protecting Thrones and claim-capable commanders.

An early fort that produces the key mage may be worth more than a richer province. A border fort with no recruitable value may still impose a siege clock. A fort adjacent to a resource-hungry capital can reduce the capital's resource draw and should be tested before construction.

Laboratories as strategic nodes

Labs do more than recruit mages:

- collect site income into the national treasury;
- permit research, forging, rituals, and empowerment;
- pool and transfer gems;
- support magic movement and remote operations;

- allow rapid equipment changes;
- become targets for raiders and teleporters.

A forward lab increases force projection but also exposes stored gems and mages. A laboratory network should include redundancy. If one captured lab disconnects the whole front from gem supply and ritual access, the network has a single point of failure.

Temples and religious infrastructure

Temples:

- generate temple checks;
- support sacred and priest recruitment where national rules allow;
- raise maximum dominion according to the temple rule;
- enable Blood Sacrifice where available;
- protect dominion and help make Pretenders safer;
- turn Throne and border provinces into religious anchors.

Temple value rises near enemy dominion, special dominions, Thrones, and awakening or immortality operations. A temple is also visible intent. Building one in a disputed province can be read as territorial commitment.

Province Defence as delay and information

PD should be bought for a purpose:

- defeating scout captures or tiny raiders;
- adding patrol strength at 15+;
- forcing larger raids and revealing their composition;
- joining an outside field battle;
- buying time for a counter-raider;
- exploiting unusually strong national PD;
- maintaining a low-cost tripwire.

PD is not a substitute for a mobile defence because the buyer cannot move it, preserve it through retreat, or customise it like a field army. Excessive uniform PD converts liquid gold into local strength that an enemy can bypass or counter once.

Map annotation

A serious strategic map should mark:

- every known Throne and Ascension Point value;
- claimed and unclaimed status;
- forts under construction and their completion turns;
- laboratories, temples, and major sites;
- routes by movement class;
- water, river, mountain-pass, cave, and plane restrictions;
- likely enemy research and army positions;
- treaty borders and expiry dates;
- rally points, gem depots, and retreat routes;
- provinces whose loss breaks a corridor or global origin.

The map should show commitments as well as ownership.

Part V: Research as a Strategic Response Tree

From queue to campaign plan

Book V establishes the mechanics of research. Strategy asks when each breakpoint must enter the field. A research plan should contain:

- a main line that creates the nation's preferred army package;
- an expansion line if early magic materially changes neutral conquest;
- a defensive branch for the most likely early invader;
- a mobility or raiding branch;
- a forging and access branch;
- a late-game transition;
- an explicit rule for when to pivot.

A fixed queue ignores evidence. Constantly changing schools wastes accumulated progress and never reaches a threshold. The solution is a response tree with preselected branch points.

Breakpoint records

For each important level, record:

Field	Question
Effect	What new battle, ritual, item, or summon becomes possible?
Caster	Which repeatable or unique commander delivers it?
Resources	Which gems, slaves, items, communion bodies, or labs are required?
Scale	Can one army use it, or every army?
Deadline	On which turn or before which enemy event must it arrive?
Counter	What obvious answer reduces its value?
Pivot	Which adjacent research provides the next answer?

The result is useful operational knowledge, not a list of admired spells.

Research signals

Research is partly observable through graphs, deployed spells, forged gear, summoned units, and mage movement. A rapid rush can surprise once; repeated use reveals the level. Rivals can then infer adjacent capabilities.

Information denial methods include:

- delaying public use until the decisive battle;
- researching a cheap supporting branch after the main threshold;
- fielding a lower-level package that conceals the real peak;
- avoiding recognisable booster staging at exposed labs;
- maintaining several mages capable of different path packages.

The cost of secrecy must be real. Refusing to use a completed answer and losing territory to preserve surprise is normally poor conversion.

Timing attacks as temporary advantage

A timing attack begins when relative power is temporarily highest. Common windows include:

- an awake expander surviving expansion while neighbours' imprisoned designs remain absent;
- a dormant Pretender awakening;
- a mass bless reaching sustainable sacred recruitment;
- a key battlefield enchantment or resistance spell;
- the first reliable communion;
- a Construction level that produces thugs or path boosters;
- a summon mass reaching operational scale;
- a mobility ritual opening unexpected targets;
- a hostile global changing the world's exchange rates;
- an opponent exhausting gems or elite recruitment in another war.

The attack needs preparation before the breakpoint:

- troops and commanders recruited;
- gems moved;
- items forged;
- scouts positioned;
- treaty countdown started;
- routes cleared;
- siege strength assembled.

Research finishing is the last dependency, not the first planning step.

Portfolio depth

A nation with one exceptional package can force opponents to buy one exceptional counter. Portfolio depth adds a second axis:

- physical protection plus elemental resistance;
- battlefield army plus mobile raiders;
- troops plus MR-negates control;
- field strength plus remote attacks;
- glamour or stealth plus conventional pressure;
- army wipes plus fort-cracking capacity.

The purpose is not variety for its own sake. Each branch should punish the answer to another branch. If all packages fail to the same resistance, mobility, or commander kill, the portfolio is visually diverse but strategically narrow.

Research under invasion

When invaded, divide research into:

- survival threshold: the cheapest completed answer that prevents immediate collapse;
- stabilisation threshold: the package that can win or deter field battles;
- reversal threshold: mobility, summons, or scale that turns defence into counteroffence.

Do not abandon a nearly complete decisive level for a weaker emergency spell without calculating completion time. Do not continue a grand late-game rush while the laboratories generating it are about to fall. The correct pivot is measured in turns, legal casters, and delivery-not anxiety.

Part VI: Movement, Logistics, and Force Projection

The official movement model

Army movement is limited by the slowest unit. Only commanders move independently; troops require leadership. Ground movement is calculated in half-steps: leaving the origin and entering the destination each have a terrain cost.

Terrain	Ground half-step cost
Plains	3
Forest	5
Waste	5
Highlands	6
Swamp	7
Sea	5
Cave	4
Cave Forest	6
Crystal Cave	6
Drip Cave	7

Modifiers include:

- entering or leaving a province with enemy non-stealthy forces: +4;
- enemy stealthy forces: +3;
- snow: +1;
- road: -2, with a minimum cost of 2;
- matching survival ability: -2 for the relevant terrain.

Forest Survival also helps in Cave Forest, Mountain Survival in Crystal Cave, and Swamp Survival in Drip Cave. Flying normally costs 3 per half-step, 5 in caves, and +1 for enemy presence.

Common Map Move parameters provide a scale:

Example	Map Move
Heavy infantry	8
Light infantry	14
Light cavalry	20
Unicorn	26
Slow flier	14
Ordinary flier	20

Example	Map Move
Fast flier	26

Commanders normally receive +2 to the general parameter. Object values and special abilities still control the actual unit.

Barriers and army composition

Rivers require Cold +1 on both sides unless the army can fly, float, swim, or otherwise cross amphibiously. Mountain passes require Heat +1 on both sides unless the army flies, floats, or has Mountain Survival.

For special movement, every troop in the relevant army normally needs the required ability. Sailing and granted water breathing have their own exceptions. One slow, non-surviving, or non-amphibious squad can invalidate the intended route for the whole commander.

Version 6.36 establishes three current exceptions or extensions worth recording in route plans:

- a swimming mount is sufficient for its mounted unit to cross a river;
- Perpetual Storm increases movement cost in caves and underwater provinces as well as the previously affected environments;
- Gift of Water Breathing can protect against Lost Land.

Each statement is narrow. A suitable mount does not grant swimming to unrelated troops, and protection from one underwater disaster does not prove general underwater legality.

Every movement order should be checked against the actual slowest and least capable component, not the commander icon or the majority of the force.

Friendly, hostile, and intercepting movement

Friendly movement resolves before hostile movement. In contested situations:

- more than two sides may fight sequential battles in a determined entry order;
- allied defenders fight in sequence, with defender order random;
- hostile armies attempting to swap provinces may meet in either province or miss and exchange positions;
- relative army size and terrain influence interception;
- entering a friendly fortified province normally places the army inside the fort;
- Move and Patrol is required to arrive and fight outside.

An arrow remaining on the map does not prove that a movement order is still legal. If conditions change before hosting-such as a river, pass, leadership, or destination issue-the unit may remain in place.

Operational reach

Operational reach is the set of provinces that a force can influence within a deadline. It includes:

- ordinary legal movement;
- sailing, flight, stealth, amphibious movement, and plane access;
- magic-phase movement;
- reinforcement and gem routes;

- the ability to survive after arrival;
- the ability to retreat.

A province "in range" of a teleporting thug may still be strategically unsafe if it has no laboratory for escape, no friendly retreat route, or a counter-mage can arrive in the same phase. Reach must include extraction.

The logistics chain

Every serious army consumes:

- troops and replacements;
- commanders and appropriate leadership;
- food and supplies;
- gems and blood slaves;
- forged items;
- research-capable mage turns;
- scouts and reports;
- retreat routes;
- siege time.

A logistics chain can be represented as:

```
recruitment fort
-> rally and command
-> route and supply
-> forward lab or gem mule
-> battle package
-> replacement and retreat
```

The chain is only as strong as its most exposed node. A frontier army with no replacement commander can become immobile after one assassination. A communion with no additional slaves may win once and disappear. A giant force without supplies can accumulate fatigue and disease before the decisive battle.

Gem logistics

Gems are national stock in laboratories but physical carried resources in battle. A campaign needs:

- a load standard for each mage role;
- reserve gems for multiple battles;
- mules or a forward lab for reloads;
- a method to prevent optional gem use from draining the storm budget;
- decoys and bodyguards against assassinations;
- an evacuation plan if the lab is threatened.

Late-game throne operations may require several battles in one hosting cycle: magic-phase attacks, move-phase relief or interception, and a storm. The same script and carried stock may have to survive all of them.

Supply and attrition

Supply is a campaign constraint, not a seasonal footnote. It affects:

- the size and route of living armies;

- how long a siege force can remain concentrated;
- the safety of capital or cave interiors;
- the usefulness of supply items and Nature magic;
- whether an opponent can force disease without winning a battle.

Book II contains the exact supply and starvation rules. At campaign level, the important point is that besieged storage falls as the siege continues and repeated starvation can lead to disease. A defender may gain time while quietly losing irreplaceable mages.

Reserves

A reserve is not an army without orders. It is a force positioned to alter several likely enemy branches.

Good reserves:

- sit on a lab or movement hub;
- have compatible movement;
- carry counters rather than generic excess;
- can protect a Throne, fort, or retreat route;
- are hidden or ambiguous when possible;
- remain cheap enough that holding them back does not lose the main front.

The reserve's deterrent value depends on what the opponent believes it can reach. Scouting and information denial can change the value of the same force.

Part VII: Raiding and Counter-Raiding

What a raid is

Strategically, a raid is a limited force sent to take or threaten assets without joining the main battle. Its purpose may be:

- provincial income denial;
- capture of sites, labs, and temples;
- interruption of recruitment or gem collection;
- destruction of PD and patrollers;
- cutting retreat or reinforcement routes;
- forcing expensive defenders away from the main front;
- creating unrest or population loss;
- revealing counter capabilities;
- surrounding a fort;
- changing throne access.

The ordinary Raid order is a specific mechanic, not a synonym for every small attack. Officially, only a commander with Pillager can issue it, the army must have Map Move 20 or more, and only Pillager units contribute to the pillage at half strength. The force moves to the province, wins any battle, and then pillages. It does not automatically return.

Pillaging

Pillaging:

- kills population;
- raises unrest;
- reduces supplies;
- yields temporary gold and food.

Fast and large units pillage better, and some unit types such as barbarians or fear-causing forces are particularly effective. The resulting supplies last one month. Pillaging converts long-term provincial value into short-term campaign resources and damage.

This is often rational in enemy land and often self-defeating in territory intended for immediate annexation. A player should distinguish:

- seizure: capture intact value;
- denial: prevent the enemy using it;
- destruction: reduce future value for everyone;
- foraging: support a force for one more month.

Raider classes

Raider	Strength	Typical answer
Cheap commander with small troop squad	Low cost, repeatable	Modest PD, local troops, fast commander
Stealth army	Hidden approach and broad threat	Patrol network, scrying, chokepoints
Light thug	Defeats PD and weak local troops	Counter-thug, mage, specialised PD
Heavy thug	Beats larger troop-only responses	Magic weapons, fatigue, control, tailored damage
Supercombatant	Threatens armies and critical nodes	Layered specialist response, army magic, denial
Flying or sailing force	Crosses ordinary front geometry	Coverage of landing nodes, mobile reserve
Magic-phase attacker	Arrives before ordinary movement	Dome, trap, counter-teleporter, protected nodes
Assassin or seducer network	Removes command and specialist mages	Bodyguards, decoys, patrols, redundant command
Remote army or spell	Projects force without exposing a route	Domes, dispersed assets, retaliation

Raider value depends on the defender's replacement cost. A ten-gem thug that forces a twenty-gem counter to remain idle can be valuable even before taking a province. The same thug is poor if it walks into a cheap armour-piercing weapon and transfers its equipment to the enemy.

Raider efficiency

Evaluate a raider by:

```
value denied
+ response cost imposed
+ positional gain
+ information gained
```

```
- expected permanent loss
- attention and opportunity cost
```

The captured province's income is only one term. Cutting a laboratory may strand ritual mages. Taking a corridor can kill retreats. Threatening three provinces can make the enemy divide an army. Conversely, repeatedly trading expensive raiders for low-income provinces can lose the gem war while the map colour appears active.

Raider design

A raider needs:

- a target class;
- sufficient movement;
- enough offence to end the fight;
- enough defence to survive that target;
- fatigue stability;
- morale or mindlessness appropriate to the task;
- a retreat or escape plan;
- a price ceiling.

Thugs should layer different defences rather than maximise one statistic. Protection alone eventually fails to armour-defeating results, high damage, fatigue, or armour-piercing and armour-negating attacks. Defence alone fails under repeated attacks and surrounding. Regeneration alone fails to burst damage or conditions that prevent recovery.

Minimalism is central. Every additional item must change a relevant matchup or survival probability. Decorative gear increases the reward for the counter-thug.

Creating a raiding front

A raiding front works when several threats mature together:

1. Scouts identify low-PD, high-value, and weakly connected provinces.
2. Raiders enter from different routes.
3. The main army threatens a fort or decisive battle.
4. Remote or magic-phase attacks threaten the reserve.
5. Captured provinces cut retreat and reinforcement paths.
6. Raiders withdraw, regroup, or join a siege before tailored answers arrive.

One raider is a puzzle. Several raiders plus a main army are a resource-allocation crisis.

Counter-raiding as a system

Counter-raiding should not chase every loss with the main army. Build layers:

Layer	Function
Scouts and scrying	Identify raider type, movement, and equipment
PD tripwires	Defeat the smallest raids and reveal larger ones
Patrol nodes	Restrict stealth routes and protect critical labs
Local recruits	Reclaim undefended provinces cheaply

Layer	Function
Mobile counters	Catch or threaten expensive raiders
Magic-phase response	Intercept forces that ordinary movement cannot catch
Fort network	Preserve recruitment and force raiders to stop
Strategic reserve	Prevent several raids from becoming a capital or Throne attack

The defender should calculate which provinces are worth defending. A poor border province may be allowed to change hands while the counter waits at the lab, Throne, or route the raider actually needs.

Counter-thugs

A counter-thug is usually cheaper and more specialised than the target. It may need only:

- a weapon that bypasses the target's principal defence;
- sufficient attack or precision to connect;
- resistance to the target's damage;
- enough speed or magic movement to catch it;
- a scout or spare commander to loot gear.

Specialisation creates efficiency but reduces general usefulness. Do not send the counter at a different chassis merely because both are called thugs.

Raid recovery

After losing provinces:

1. Preserve the force that can defeat the raider.
2. Identify its legal next destinations.
3. Protect the high-value nodes among them.
4. Retake empty provinces with cheap commanders.
5. Rebuild a continuous retreat and supply route.
6. Do not overinvest in PD everywhere after one frightening loss.
7. Use the revealed gear and script to construct the cheapest repeatable answer.

The aim is to reduce future response cost. A defender who spends a major mage and ten gems on every raid may technically win each battle and still lose the campaign.

Part VIII: War Planning, Timing, and Decision

Reasons to go to war

War is justified when it improves the route to victory more than the alternatives. Common reasons include:

- an opponent can be defeated before its breakpoint;
- a critical Throne, fort, gate, or path recruit is accessible;
- a neighbour is committed elsewhere;

- a hostile position will become unanswerable if left alone;
- a treaty network creates a temporary safe front;
- defensive war is already unavoidable and initiative can be seized;
- the war prevents an imminent victory.

"The neighbour is weak" is incomplete. The relevant questions are what can be taken, how long it takes, who benefits, and what other nations can do during the commitment.

War aims

Define the minimum successful outcome:

- destroy a specific army;
- seize a border fort or capital;
- capture or neutralise a Throne;
- remove a global origin;
- secure a corridor or plane gate;
- force a treaty or transfer;
- eliminate the nation;
- delay it while another operation succeeds.

Unlimited conquest causes strategic drift. A war that has achieved its aim may be ended or frozen before the winner's armies become trapped in low-value territory.

The invasion ledger

Before ending a NAP or submitting attack orders, record:

Requirement	Minimum answer
Enemy strength	Main army, mobile reserve, Pretender, known thugs, magic phase
Friendly package	Troops, mages, scripts, gems, counters, leadership
Target sequence	Border battle, fort, lab, Throne, capital
Siege	Expected wall strength, reduction per turn, defence and relief
Logistics	Route, supplies, reload, reinforcements, replacement commanders
Diplomacy	Legal attack date, other borders, coalition reaction
Research	Current package and next breakpoint
Failure branch	Retreat route, fallback fort, diplomatic exit
Victory conversion	Claim unit, AP count, post-capture defence

If the plan ends at "win the battle," it is tactical preparation rather than a campaign.

Back-planning the attack date

The attack date should be derived backwards:

```
desired decisive battle
<- arrival turn
<- treaty expiry
<- final recruitment and rally
<- item and gem preparation
```

```
<- research completion
<- scouting confirmation
```

Because hosting is simultaneous, a force one province away may arrive into a different position than expected. Every route needs a branch for enemy movement, interception, or a changed barrier.

Concentration and dispersion

Concentration wins difficult battles and cracks forts. Dispersion captures provinces and imposes attention. The campaign should alternate:

1. disperse for expansion or raiding;
2. concentrate for the decisive army or siege;
3. disperse after victory to cut retreats and take infrastructure;
4. reconcentrate before the opponent's new package arrives.

Permanent doomstacks waste map tempo. Permanent dispersion invites defeat in detail.

Forcing battles

An opponent can often decline an unfavourable field battle. Force commitment by threatening:

- a capital;
- a high-output mage fort;
- a Throne;
- a laboratory with rare commanders;
- a global origin;
- a corridor whose loss traps an army;
- multiple forts whose siege clocks mature together.

The best target is sometimes the one the enemy must defend, not the one with the most immediate income.

Gem burning

Battle magic consumes carried resources. A weak or sacrificial force may trigger expensive scripts before the decisive battle. This can be achieved through:

- magic-phase attacks before move-phase combat;
- sequential allied or multi-party battles;
- remote attacks;
- probes against an army expected to storm;
- assassinations that cause individual gem use.

Gem burning is not free. The probe may die, reveal information, or fail to trigger the intended spells. Conservative gem-use settings and spell AI affect results. The attacker should compare the expected hostile gems consumed with the permanent cost of the probe.

Deterrence

Deterrence depends on credible punishment. It can come from:

- a visible army;

- hidden teleporters or thugs;
- a known battlefield wipe;
- a treaty partner;
- a fort that imposes delay;
- the ability to raid an attacker's undefended rear;
- a Pretender whose commitment changes the battle;
- the diplomatic cost of creating a runaway elsewhere.

Purely hidden capacity may not deter because the opponent does not know it exists. Selective disclosure-one demonstration, a truthful warning, or visible staging-can preserve peace more cheaply than actual battle.

Ending wars

A rational peace assessment asks:

- Has the original aim been achieved?
- Which side's reinforcement and research curve is improving?
- Are forts about to crack?
- Can either party win the game elsewhere?
- Are new enemies entering?
- What border can actually be held?
- Which terms are enforceable?

Continuing from anger is a strategic expenditure. Reputation and justice matter in multiplayer, but they should be pursued through explicit objectives rather than unbounded attrition.

Part IX: Thugs, Supercombatants, Assassins, and Remote Force

Campaign roles

Single commanders and remote effects should be classified by what they change:

Asset	Campaign role
Light thug	PD raiding, province recovery, bottleneck pressure
Heavy thug	Defeat troop-heavy, mage-light forces
Supercombatant	Threaten armies, capitals, or decisive nodes
Army thug	Hold, kill elites, or add concentrated damage inside a line
Counter-thug	Trade cheaply into a known chassis
Assassin	Remove commanders, priests, mages, or gem carriers
Seducer or corrupter	Remove or acquire commanders through a special duel
Remote attacker	Damage, probe, distract, or burn gems without ordinary movement
Magic-phase mover	Intercept, surprise, reinforce, or open a storm operation

The label does not guarantee performance. A heavy thug against troops may die instantly to the first prepared mage. A supercombatant without the correct resistance may be a very expensive target.

The defensive onion

Durable commanders combine layers:

- avoidance: defence, glamour, awe, ethereal, displacement;
- mitigation: protection, invulnerability, resistances;
- recovery: regeneration, life drain, recuperation;
- control resistance: MR, mindlessness, morale, elemental and status immunity;
- endurance: reinvigoration, low encumbrance, fatigue management;
- offence: enough killing speed to avoid the turn limit and cumulative random failure;
- escape: returning, immortality, retreat, stealth, or magic movement.

Every layer must be checked against the intended target and the likely counter. The DRN makes absolute safety rare.

Assassin rules

An assassin selects a random enemy commander in the province. Each assigned bodyguard has a base 50% chance of being present, modified by Bodyguard and Patience. The target is unprepared and does not use its ordinary battle script. Province context may add guards or bystanders.

An assassin cannot normally operate into or out of a besieged fort without Scale Walls, flight, teleportation, or equivalent access. Similar access restrictions apply to related orders such as seduction or infiltration. Mounted targets are often dismounted; when the assassin wins, the mount may also be killed.

Strategic consequences:

- commander redundancy reduces assassination leverage;
- bodyguards must be assigned before the attack;
- decoy commanders dilute random targeting;
- vital H3 claimants and communion masters require special protection;
- killing a leader may immobilise troops even if the army survives;
- assassinations inside a throne fort can disrupt both battle and claim timing.

Remote operations

Remote force can:

- kill or afflict armies;
- summon attackers;
- change weather or scales;
- attack commanders;
- scry;
- damage walls;
- move units or armies;
- establish or protect local enchantments.

Remote operations should be combined with a physical exploitation plan. Damaging an army without contesting its fort or route may merely spend gems. A remote that removes PD immediately before a fast raider arrives converts more cleanly.

Domes reduce probability or redirect certain hostile rituals, but no dome is universal. Current official notes state that domes may protect against Astral Disruption. Exact layering and object interaction must be verified for the current spell set.

Counter construction

Build answers from the enemy's dependency:

- high protection -> armour-piercing or armour-negating damage, fatigue, control;
- high defence -> area effects, multiple attacks, attack boosts, unavoidable effects;
- regeneration -> burst, decay, disease, or prevention of recovery;
- ethereal or glamour -> magic weapons and appropriate perception;
- elemental damage -> specific resistance;
- life drain -> lifeless targets or denial of contact;
- Phoenix Pyre -> fatigue and soul or battlefield control;
- high MR -> non-MR effects or penetration investment;
- magic movement -> protected nodes, domes, traps, distributed assets;
- stealth -> patrol, scrying, route control;
- item dependency -> counter-thug and looting plan.

The cheapest sufficient answer is normally superior to building a more expensive mirror.

Part X: Sieges and Fort Operations

Siege arithmetic

Book II owns the wall-reduction formula and repair modifiers; Book IV owns the storm battle. Strategy begins with the operational consequence: only commanders ordered to Maintain Siege and their eligible forces work on the walls. A commander preaching, forging, or performing another order is not also reducing the fort.

The siege clock

A fort creates delay by requiring:

1. entry into the province;
2. one or more turns of wall reduction;
3. a legal Storm Fortress order after walls reach zero;
4. victory in the storm battle;
5. occupation, repair, and exploitation.

Each added turn permits:

- relief movement;
- remote attacks;
- recruitment elsewhere;
- diplomatic intervention;
- research completion;
- throne counterattacks.

Siege strength is tempo. An army that wins the field but needs six months to crack the fort may lose the strategic race to one that brought specialised siege bodies.

Information asymmetry

The defender sees wall condition. The besieger receives qualitative messages:

Message	Approximate wall state
Lightly damaged	High remaining integrity
Moderately damaged	About 51-85% remaining
Severely damaged	About 11-50% remaining
Critically damaged	About 1-10% remaining

"Work is going very slowly" indicates less than roughly 15% of wall integrity was removed that turn according to the community reference. Because the besieger lacks exact totals, plans should include a safety margin and scouting of likely repair bodies.

Inside and outside

At a friendly fort:

- Defend places the commander and troops inside;
- Patrol keeps them outside and able to fight field battles;
- an arriving ordinary move normally enters the fort;
- Move and Patrol arrives outside.

Version 6.35 adds one narrow escape route: a commander with teleport movement can move out of a besieged fort. This does not release an ordinary army, legalise every teleport ritual, or change the movement phase for other units. The order-entry exception is recorded in Book X's siege orders, while Book I retains the hosting sequence.

This distinction determines whether a unit joins a relief battle, remains protected, contributes to wall repair, or can be attacked by the besieger.

Relief, break siege, and storm

A relief battle occurs before a scheduled storm. If relief succeeds, the storm does not occur. If relief fails, the besieger may still have to storm with losses, fatigue, expended gems, or altered scripts.

The defender can also Break Siege. A retreating defender may return inside the fort or move to an adjacent friendly province; where both are available, the manual gives a 50/50 selection. Fort context and later battles can change the ultimate retreat result.

When storming:

- the gate creates a narrow and dangerous battle context;
- intrinsic fort guards aid the defender;
- if a storming commander dies before the gate battle, its squads do not participate;
- besieged commanders that retreat from the storm die;
- relief and storm may force one attacker script through several battles;
- battlefield-wide magic may be restricted indoors under the current indoor rule.

Starvation and trapped value

Besieged recruitment stops. Provincial income is divided between besieger and defender according to the siege rules, while site gems continue to the besieged side if a laboratory can connect them to the treasury. Declining fort supply can starve and eventually disease the garrison.

The defender should classify trapped units:

- irreplaceable mages that justify early relief;
- cheap repair bodies that justify delay;
- troops suitable for a break-siege battle;
- claim-capable priests on a Throne;
- stealth or special-access units able to leave;
- Pretender or immortal assets with separate risk.

Saving the fort while permanently diseasing the research core may be a strategic loss.

One-turn cracks

A one-turn crack denies the defender most of the siege clock. It is especially important in throne operations. Calculate:

- fort wall strength;
- expected defending repair;
- flying and siege bonuses;
- Mindless, Animal, and Undisciplined penalties;
- remote wall damage;
- loss of siege contribution if commanders fight or perform other orders;
- possible Iron Walls or equivalent increases.

The one-turn crack force must also fight. Siege bodies that contribute enormous reduction but collapse in relief can become a liability unless protected.

Multi-fort operations

Besieging several forts at once can exceed the defender's relief capacity. The attacker should stagger clocks so:

- at least one fort becomes stormable each turn;
- the main army can move between decisive storms;
- raiders cut reinforcement routes;
- enough force remains on each fort to prevent repair;
- gem reserves survive repeated battles.

The defender should repair, reinforce, and sally selectively. Preserving a key mage fort or Throne can justify abandoning a peripheral castle.

Part XI: Diplomacy, Treaties, and Reputation

Diplomacy changes force ratios

A treaty can remove an entire front from the immediate defence problem. A trade can create a path booster that research cannot. Intelligence from an ally can prevent a surprise. A coalition can turn a leading nation's local superiority into global inferiority.

Diplomacy is an exchange of:

- time;
- information;
- territorial certainty;
- resources and items;
- military access;
- threats and commitments;
- reputation.

The resource is not the message. It is the changed set of legal and expected actions.

Formal and social NAPs

Dominions 6 can use formal in-game diplomacy. Depending on settings, a formal NAP may be binding: the game blocks offensive actions that violate it. Games can also use nonbinding settings or social treaties negotiated outside the engine.

These systems should not be silently mixed:

Doctrine	Authority	Main benefit	Main risk
Strict formal NAP	Game engine	Clear mechanical enforcement	Edge cases may permit conduct players consider hostile
Written social NAP	Agreed text and host rules	Can cover remotes, stealth, globals, access, and victory	Requires shared interpretation and reputation
Hybrid	Formal pact plus written additions	Enforcement plus broader expectations	Conflicts between engine legality and social meaning
No NAP	No non-aggression commitment	Maximum freedom and fewer countdown disputes	Higher uncertainty and defence cost

Before a game begins, players should know which doctrine governs conflicts.

Minimum treaty terms

A useful NAP states:

- the parties;
- whether it is formal, social, or both;
- the notice period;
- exactly how turns are counted;
- the first legal turn for hostile orders and for hostile contact;
- treatment of scouts and stealth armies;
- remotes, assassinations, seduction, heretics, disease spreaders, and unrest effects;
- dominion and temple pressure;
- province trades and accidental bumps;
- harmful globals;
- third-party access;

- whether imminent victory suspends the pact;
- how mistakes are repaired.

Without these terms, both parties may act in good faith under incompatible definitions.

Countdown arithmetic

Community conventions differ. One explicit convention treats an N-turn NAP ended on turn T as permitting contact on turn T+N. Under that convention, ending NAP3 on turn 10 permits attack orders on turn 12 that make contact during hosting into turn 13. Other groups count differently.

Never rely on the label alone. State the first legal order-submission turn and the first legal contact turn in plain numbers.

Treaty edge cases

Potential disputes include:

- a scout being discovered;
- a stealth army positioned before expiry;
- an accidental movement bump;
- a remote attack with uncertain attribution;
- a harmful global;
- selling a corridor to a third party;
- cutting off agreed spoils;
- dominion pressure;
- independent or event armies taking border provinces;
- a throne rush while formal NAPs remain binding.

Engine legality does not settle social legitimacy unless the group agreed that it would. A written doctrine protects both strategic freedom and the community from avoidable arguments.

Trade

Trades can exchange:

- gems and blood slaves;
- forged items;
- provinces;
- mercenary noncompetition;
- intelligence;
- ritual or global contributions;
- military access;
- coordinated timing.

Good trade messages specify item, gem type, quantity, delivery turn, sender, recipient, and contingency if forging or delivery becomes impossible. Trades are generally treated as binding in community practice because simultaneous turns expose one party to opportunistic default.

Assess the strategic effect, not only nominal gem equality. A five-gem booster that opens a new path can be worth far more than five surplus gems. A trade that enables an enemy's throne rush may be profitable and fatal.

Reputation

Reputation changes future transaction costs. Reliable players receive information, trades, and treaties with less suspicion. Deceptive or rules-lawyering play may win one exchange while forcing expensive hostility in later games.

Reputation is not a demand for passivity. A treaty can be ended, a rival can be threatened, and a surprise attack after legal expiry is ordinary strategy. The core distinction is between hard bargaining within clear terms and exploiting ambiguity that the other party reasonably believed was settled.

Threat communication

A useful threat states:

- the behaviour that must change;
- the consequence;
- the deadline;
- an achievable off-ramp.

Vague outrage does not deter. Impossible demands turn the threat into a declaration of war. Excessive detail can reveal exact capacity. The objective is credible constraint with minimal disclosure.

Coalition politics

Coalitions form around relative threat. Indicators that create coalitions include:

- rapid province, fort, research, or gem growth;
- oppressive globals;
- visible throne progress;
- elimination of neighbours;
- treaty networks that appear permanent;
- unique late-game access;
- refusal to communicate.

A leader can reduce coalition pressure by:

- leaving other players with meaningful autonomy;
- sharing limited intelligence or trade;
- avoiding unnecessary worldwide harm;
- framing war aims as bounded;
- preventing a rival from appearing harmless while compounding;
- keeping the true throne conversion window short.

Coalition management is not concealment of all strength. If the position is obviously dominant, implausible denials destroy credibility.

Part XII: Thrones, Cataclysm, and Endgame Conversion

Victory by Ascension Points

By default, Thrones of Ascension provide the victory structure. A Throne's level equals its Ascension Point value:

Throne level	Ascension Points	General defence
1	1	Stronger than ordinary independents but often early-accessible
2	2	Substantial army and magic support
3	3	Extremely strong defence, often including Pretender-class commanders

The host sets the total points present and the number required. Conquer-all is an alternative, but throne settings define most campaign deadlines.

Finding and identifying Thrones

The presence of a Throne becomes visible when the province is observed through ordinary means such as scouting, dominion, or neighbouring ownership. Exact identity requires stronger information, such as a spy or direct control, according to the current community reference. When a Pretender awakens, unrevealed Thrones are sensed; an awake Pretender receives this information on turn 2.

Throne identity matters because effects vary widely: gems, gold, scales, bless changes, recruitment, research access, unrest, dominion spread, or world events. Treat community tables as object references to verify against current game data before committing a design.

Claiming

A Throne can be claimed by:

- the Pretender;
- the Prophet;
- a priest with Holy 3 or more.

The nation must own the province. If a fort exists, a besieger cannot claim through the walls, while the besieged owner can still claim. Claiming is a turn action and resolves during hosting at the throne-claim step. Conquest makes the Throne unclaimed until a legal claimant acts.

Book III owns the exact same-turn state matrix. For campaign planning, remember the operational result: killing a claimant after the step-8 claim does not undo it; conquering an unfortified Throne or successfully storming its fort removes the claim before the step-57 victory check; a siege that has not taken the fort does not. Once the claim resolves, counterplay must attack the ownership state and not only the claimant.

A claimed Throne:

- supplies Ascension Points;
- spreads dominion through its throne checks;
- activates its claimed effects;
- visibly lights on the map.

The campaign must include the claimant. A victorious army without an H3, Pretender, or Disciple is at least one turn farther from victory.

Throne arithmetic

Every turn, record for each living nation:

- claimed points;
- unclaimed controlled points;
- points under siege;
- points reachable within one ordinary move;
- points reachable in the magic phase;
- claim-capable units in range;
- forts that can be cracked in one turn;
- points required to win.

Also record the maximum plausible claim, not only current points. A nation on five of eight required points that controls an unclaimed three-point Throne can win with one claim order.

The throne-rush sequence

A common fortified one-Throne rush follows this timing:

Turn	Attacker	Defender and bystanders
T+0 orders	Move enough army and siege power onto the Throne	Detect approach, reinforce, remote, or prepare relief
T+1 orders	Walls are cracked; order storm; move H3 or Pretender into position	Break siege, relieve, attack other attacker Thrones, burn gems
T+2 orders	After successful storm, claim	Last chance is normally to remove another claimed Throne or prevent the claim
T+3 hosting	Claim resolves and victory occurs if threshold is met	Counter must already have changed the AP total or ownership

Exact battle sequence, magic movement, wall state, and claim position can alter this schedule. The important lesson is that bystanders do not have "several turns" merely because the fort has not yet fallen. A one-turn crack compresses the coalition's response into one hosting cycle.

Requirements for a credible rush

The attacker needs:

- enough siege power to crack on schedule;
- enough combat power for relief, sequential battles, and the storm;
- scripts that function across those battle contexts;
- gems for repeated combat;
- resilience against remotes and assassins;
- claimant access;
- defence of existing claimed Thrones;
- secrecy or deception;
- a response to Iron Walls and emergency reinforcement.

A throne rush is an operation, not a large army walking toward a victory icon.

Defending against a rush

Defence can attack any dependency:

- reinforce or increase wall strength;
- kill the siege bodies;
- force extra battles to consume gems;
- assassinate commanders or the claimant;
- use magic-phase attacks before relief and storm;
- break siege;
- capture or unclaim one of the attacker's existing Thrones;
- cut the claimant's route;
- form a coalition and share exact timing;
- exploit binding-NAP limitations through pre-agreed victory clauses.

Counterattacking another claimed Throne may be more reliable than saving the target. Victory arithmetic, not pride of ownership, decides.

Information warfare

Surprise is especially valuable because every visible turn permits specialised counter-scripts and coalition formation. Methods include:

- stealthy elements staged near or on the target;
- flying, sailing, underwater, or plane routes;
- magic-phase mage delivery;
- high Map Move and movement items;
- false army displays and secondary throne threats;
- ordinary wars used as cover;
- keeping the H3 claimant separate until required.

The attacker must balance concealment against siege. Stealth forces on the fort do not contribute while sneaking. The operation needs a turn when hidden potential becomes actual wall reduction.

Defence of owned Thrones

Throne defence should be layered:

- fort and wall strength;
- enough repair to defeat casual siege;
- patrols and anti-assassin measures;
- a claimant or priest plan;
- a mobile relief force;
- remote and magic-phase support;
- gem reserves;
- alternate victory arithmetic if one Throne falls.

Not every Throne requires the same force. Concentrate on the points whose loss changes the victory threshold, the routes opponents can reach, and the forts vulnerable to one-turn cracking.

Cataclysm

If enabled, Cataclysm begins after the configured turn. Horrors attack and destroy Thrones. Each destroyed Throne reduces the Ascension Points required to win, so the threshold moves as the world collapses. Current official changes make Cataclysm harder to counter.

The manual states that if no one owns a Throne when the last is destroyed, the horrors win. Current community reference describes all Thrones destroyed as a draw; this wording conflict must be reproduced under current 6.36 before being stated more narrowly. Operationally, neither result is a player victory.

Cataclysm strategy:

- track turns to arrival;
- fort and defend key Thrones;
- prepare to kill or dislodge horrors;
- recalculate required points after every destruction;
- avoid plans that mature after the relevant Thrones cease to exist;
- treat every surviving point as increasingly decisive.

Cataclysm is more than late-game flavour. It shrinks the objective map.

Part XIII: Recovery, Elastic Defence, and Defeat Management

A lost battle is not automatically a lost war

After a major defeat, the strategic position contains several different losses:

- force loss: troops, mages, Pretender, items, and gems;
- capacity loss: forts, laboratories, sacred recruitment, and researchers;
- position loss: routes, sites, Thrones, dominion, and borders;
- information loss: scouts, known enemy scripts, and hidden alternatives;
- diplomatic loss: confidence, allies, and deterrence;
- tempo loss: the opponent chooses the next urgent event.

Recovery begins by separating them. A nation may have lost its main army but retained every mage fort and a superior research curve. Another may win the field but lose its only laboratory and retreat corridor. Battle animation does not rank these consequences.

The first post-defeat turn

Perform this audit before issuing revenge orders:

1. Count surviving mages, commanders, items, and gem stocks.
2. Identify where every routed force went.
3. Check leadership and whether troops are stranded.
4. Mark the enemy's legal next destinations.
5. Protect the capital, key mage forts, labs, Thrones, and corridors.
6. Determine whether the enemy can crack each fort in one turn.
7. Read the replay for spent hostile gems, fatigue, casualties, and revealed scripts.

8. Ask neighbours for information, trade, pressure, or coalition action.
9. Select the cheapest research or recruitment stabiliser.
10. Preserve a retreat path for the next battle.

The instinct to recreate the destroyed army exactly is often wrong. The opponent has already demonstrated an answer to it.

Elastic defence

Elastic defence exchanges low-value territory for time while preserving the force needed for a counterstroke. It uses:

- forts as delay;
- scouts to track the attacker;
- PD and cheap units as tripwires;
- raiders against the attacker's rear;
- mobile reserves;
- selective relief;
- research completed behind the line;
- diplomacy that makes further advance expensive.

The defence is not passive. It forces the attacker to choose between:

- concentrating and losing provinces to raids;
- dispersing and risking defeat;
- storming and spending gems;
- waiting and allowing research or coalition response.

What to hold

Rank provinces:

Priority	Examples
Existential	Capital, last candle sources, victory-critical Throne
Capacity	Major mage fort, rare recruit site, blood centre, global origin
Network	Corridor, plane gate, only lab chain, retreat hub
Economic	Rich province, strong gem site
Disposable	Poor border land that does not open the interior

The list changes with the position. A one-income cave can be existential if it is the only route to a plane or underwater enclave.

Preserving cadres

Troops are often easier to replace than:

- high-path mages;
- experienced communion leaders;
- H3 priests;
- item carriers;
- rare randoms;

- prophet;
- Pretender;
- specialised commanders.

A small surviving cadre can rebuild a battlefield package if given forts and time. Protect command redundancy, retreat routes, and extraction items. Do not place every rare path in the same army unless the battle is truly decisive.

Counteroffence

The attacker is most exposed when:

- concentrated on a fort;
- low on gems after several battles;
- beyond reinforcement range;
- dependent on one lab;
- holding provinces with token PD;
- using a revealed script;
- committed under expiring treaties elsewhere.

Counteroffence does not require retaking every lost province. It may destroy the siege army, cut its retreat, take its staging lab, threaten its capital, or force a peace by opening a second front.

Negotiating from weakness

A weakened nation still possesses:

- information;
- remaining army or raiders;
- forts that consume time;
- gems and items;
- a vote in coalition politics;
- the ability to make another nation the beneficiary of its collapse.

Useful offers are concrete: a stable border, a province transfer, gem payment, joint war, intelligence, or permission to disengage. Empty threats weaken reputation; credible kingmaking threats can change the attacker's calculation but may also unite the table against the speaker.

Elimination, handover, and meaningful play

When recovery is impossible, distinguish:

- a nation still capable of affecting victory;
- a position that can be handed to a substitute;
- an agreed concession under host rules;
- a player leaving without setting AI or notifying the host.

Long multiplayer games depend on continuity. A defeated player should follow the game's substitution, AI, and concession rules rather than silently stale. The host's master password can set a dropped player to AI, but it also grants access to positions and should be controlled accordingly.

Part XIV: Single-Player Strategy and the AI

What the AI receives

Difficulty modifies AI bonuses to gold, resources, recruitment points, and magic income:

Difficulty	Bonus or penalty
Easy	-30%
Normal	0%
Difficult	+30%
Mighty	+60%
Master	+100%
Impossible	+150%

These modifiers do not increase commander recruitment rate or Holy Points. The AI also has omniscient knowledge of province ownership, which removes one information problem human players face.

Current AI capabilities

Dominions 6 AI is improved over earlier descriptions. It:

- builds forts;
- recruits better national troops;
- plans high-level rituals;
- uses global enchantments;
- attempts Dispels;
- participates in formal diplomacy.

Current patches also corrected behaviours such as trying rituals without a laboratory, researching when unable, and preaching with non-priests. The AI still operates through programmed evaluation rather than human political judgment and long-form deception.

Version 6.35 also improved the AI's protection of important mages. This should be read as a narrower targeting and preservation improvement, not as evidence that the AI now values mage-turns, research concentration, retreat routes, or political risk with human reliability.

Learning games

A useful first learning environment uses:

- a small or medium map;
- one plane unless plane travel is the lesson;
- Normal AI before large economic bonuses;
- ordinary independent strength;
- visible score graphs;

- Thrones as the victory condition;
- a nation with understandable troops and broad enough magic;
- no mods for the first rules-learning game.

Then add difficulty or complexity one variable at a time. High AI bonuses teach crisis management but can hide whether the player's economy and expansion are fundamentally sound.

Productive self-imposed constraints

To learn transferable strategy:

- do not rely on repeated reloads except for controlled testing;
- avoid exploiting a predictable movement loop indefinitely;
- track Throne arithmetic even when the AI does not punish mistakes;
- practise scouts, reserves, forts, and gem budgets as if facing humans;
- watch important battles and diagnose mechanisms;
- use formal diplomacy if it is part of the intended multiplayer environment;
- compare turn-12 expansion across repeated starts.

The objective of practice is not only to beat the AI. It is to create habits that survive a human opponent.

What AI games teach well

- interface and turn execution;
- national recruitment and expansion;
- battle scripting;
- economy and infrastructure;
- research pacing;
- siege and movement rules;
- army composition against varied rosters;
- surviving numerical pressure;
- late-game spell and global operation.

What requires multiplayer experience

- credible deception;
- negotiated borders;
- reputation;
- coalition timing;
- adaptive counter-research;
- human throne-rush detection;
- trades built around path scarcity;
- restraint and threat communication;
- opponents deliberately burning gems or hiding scripts.

Single-player mastery is a foundation, not a complete substitute for diplomacy and adversarial uncertainty.

Part XV: Turn Discipline and Multiplayer Operations

The strategic turn order

The complete engine hosting sequence appears in Book I. A player-facing strategic turn should be reviewed in this order:

1. Victory: Can anyone win during the coming hosting?
2. Messages: Battles, events, rituals, construction, diplomacy, and throne changes.
3. Map change: Ownership, forts, labs, dominion, routes, and enemy movement.
4. Threats: Every hostile force's legal destinations and phase.
5. Battles: Replay decisive and surprising results.
6. Research: Completion, caster access, and pivot.
7. Economy: Treasury, upkeep, recruitment queues, forts, and PD.
8. Magic: Rituals, forging, site search, gem movement, globals, and domes.
9. Armies: Leadership, squads, scripts, supplies, movement, and retreats.
10. Diplomacy: Treaties, countdowns, trades, warnings, and coalition information.
11. Verification: Illegal arrows, idle commanders, empty labs, unclaimed Thrones, and unsubmitted turn.

Victory comes first because every other optimisation is irrelevant if the game ends.

Commander roles and naming

Names should expose function:

- `RCH F2A1` for a researcher's relevant paths;
- `FORGE E3` for a forge specialist;
- `ARMY N` for a field group;
- `CLAIM H3` for a throne claimant;
- `RAID A` for a raider;
- `MULE 20F` for carried gems;
- `SCOUT EAST` for coverage;
- `NAP3 T24` in notes for a treaty deadline.

The exact scheme matters less than consistency. A late-game turn should not require reopening every commander to remember why it exists.

Army package records

For each major army, record:

- commander roster and redundancy;
- troop roles and formations;
- five-order scripts;
- expected unscripted behaviour;
- gem load and optional spending policy;
- communion or Sabbath structure;
- target matchups;
- known counters;

- movement class;
- supply;
- retreat provinces;
- siege contribution;
- next reinforcement.

This converts battle preparation into a repeatable system and makes after-action review possible.

Diplomacy records

Keep:

- exact treaty text;
- agreement turn;
- expiry notice turn;
- first legal order and contact turns;
- trades owed and delivered;
- disputed province settlement;
- promises to third parties;
- public and private victory commitments according to house rules.

Memory becomes unreliable over games lasting months. Written terms protect strategy and relationships.

Submitting safely

Before ending the turn:

- use the warning system but do not assume it catches every strategic error;
- confirm commanders who must remain hidden are Sneaking, not moving normally;
- confirm an army entering its own fort uses Move and Patrol if it must fight outside;
- confirm all special-movement troops qualify;
- confirm rivers and passes are open;
- confirm claimant and siege orders;
- confirm commanders expected to reduce walls are maintaining siege;
- confirm gems and slaves are on the correct bodies;
- confirm no forge, ritual, or research order unintentionally replaced a military task;
- save and submit according to server practice.

Stales, extensions, and substitutes

House rules should define:

- when extensions are granted;
- how requests are made;
- what counts as repeated staling;
- when a substitute may be found;
- when the host may set AI;
- how concessions are handled;
- whether private information can be shared with a substitute.

Reliable scheduling is part of multiplayer skill. A brilliant plan that repeatedly stales damages the game more than an imperfect plan submitted on time.

Part XVI: The Active Modded Ruleset

What carries across

Book IX defines the exact combined ruleset and its load order. The durable strategic ideas still include simultaneous planning, movement timing, information, concentration, siege clocks, treaty clarity, Throne arithmetic, conversion, logistics, and attention. Their numbers and available tools may change, so their application must be recalculated.

Recruitment, sacred throughput, paths, Pretenders, blessings, spells, items, summons, sites, siege bodies, national mechanics, and AI priorities may all differ. An unmodded expansion party, research queue, thug kit, or counter is evidence for a method, not a ready-made combined-mod plan.

The strategic rule

> Mod compatibility is part of force estimation. If load order changes an object that a plan depends on, the plan is a different plan even when its name remains the same.

Combined strategy test

Every nation package will later require four snapshots:

1. unmodded;
2. DE only;
3. Divinitus only where applicable;
4. DE then Divinitus.

Diff the roster, Pretenders, paths, blessings, spells, items, sites, summons, and strategic special abilities. Then repeat expansion, research, battle, raid, and throne tests.

Part XVII: Controlled Strategy Tests

Test record format

Every controlled test should record:

- game version;
- exact map and settings;
- nation and age;
- Pretender design;
- active mods, hashes, and load order;
- turn;
- province and terrain;
- units, commanders, items, gems, orders, and scripts;
- expected result;
- actual messages and replays;
- repetition count;
- conclusion and confidence.

Strategy tests differ from formula tests because the objective is often robustness. Record distributions and failure types rather than only the best result.

S1: Expansion reliability

Run the intended opening to turn 12 on at least ten starts.

Record:

- provinces and forts;
- treasury and income;
- army survivors;
- commander and mage production;
- PD spending;
- target types;
- defeats and causes;
- ability to fight a first war.

Compare median and worst credible outcomes, not only maximum provinces.

S2: Expansion matchup matrix

Create representative independent provinces for:

- militia and ordinary infantry;
- archers;
- barbarians and high-damage infantry;
- light and heavy cavalry;
- tribes;
- giants or elephants;
- undead;
- Amazons and mage-supported defenders;
- Throne defenders.

Test party size, formation, script, bless, attrition, and retreat.

S3: Map movement boundaries

Test armies at exact Map Move limits across:

- every surface terrain;
- snow;
- roads;
- friendly and enemy presence;
- survival abilities;
- rivers and mountain passes;
- caves;
- flying;
- mixed armies.

Record when the arrow remains but movement fails.

S4: Hostile swaps and interception

On several terrains and army-size ratios, order hostile armies to swap provinces.

Record:

- battle province;
- whether they miss;
- sequential-battle order;
- retreat results;
- effect of stealth and allied forces.

S5: Patrol detection

At controlled Stealth and Patrol strengths, repeat detection trials with:

- zero and high unrest;
- PD below and above 15;
- commanders and ordinary units;
- flying, Mindless, and Undisciplined patrollers;
- stealth troops with ordinary and +50 or greater stealth.

Compare observed rates with the official opposed open-ended rolls.

S6: Raid and pillage

Verify:

- the Map Move 20 requirement;
- Pillager commander legality;
- which units contribute;
- half-strength contribution;
- sequence after battle;
- population, unrest, supplies, gold, and food;
- one-month supply duration;
- interaction with forts and retreat.

S7: Intelligence channels

For the same province, compare:

- neighbour report;
- scout;
- priest;
- spy;
- dominion;
- scrying;
- ownership.

Record every displayed field, error range, glamour detection, and update timing.

S8: Siege arithmetic

Test Strength values around square and rounding boundaries with:

- flying;
- Mindless;
- Animal;
- Undisciplined;
- combinations;
- siege and castle-defence bonuses;
- intrinsic fort guards.

Verify reduction, repair, qualitative messages, and the effect of non-siege orders.

S9: Relief and storm order

Create a cracked fort with:

- outside relief;
- Break Siege;
- magic-phase reinforcements;
- a scheduled storm;
- multiple allied attackers;
- commander deaths before the gate.

Record battle sequence, scripts, gem consumption, participant squads, and retreat.

S10: Fort starvation

Record supplies and disease risk for at least ten siege turns with:

- ordinary living units;
- survival abilities;
- supply items and spells;
- commanders and mounts;
- large and small forts.

Verify the printed declining supply sequence and two-turn disease condition.

S11: Assassination and bodyguards

Repeat assassination against:

- zero to five bodyguards;
- different Bodyguard and Patience values;
- mounted targets;
- fort interior and exterior;
- besieged forts;
- special-access assassins;
- multiple decoy commanders.

Record target distribution, bodyguard presence, surprise context, mount survival, and retreat.

S12: Formal NAP edge cases

Under binding and nonbinding settings, test:

- direct movement attack;
- magic-phase attack;
- remote damage;
- assassination and seduction;
- stealth positioning;
- accidental bumps;
- independent recapture;
- harmful globals;
- throne-rush response.

Distinguish engine blocking, warnings, legal execution, and social doctrine.

S13: Throne claim timing

Treat the established claim-loss matrix as a regression target and test claims by:

- Pretender;
- Disciple;
- H3;
- H2 boosted or transformed by relevant effects;
- besieged owner;
- besieger;
- claimant arriving by ordinary and magic movement;
- simultaneous capture and claim attempts.

Record hosting messages, claimant survival, full or partial ownership, fort state, AP immediately before victory, and dominion spread. A current test should reproduce claimant death, unfortified conquest, siege without storming, and successful storming separately. Exact simultaneous winning-AP ties remain an unresolved adjacent branch.

S14: One-turn throne operation

Build a T+0 to T+3 scenario with:

- one-turn wall crack;
- relief;
- remotes;
- assassins;
- claimant movement;
- counterattack on an owned Throne.

Repeat with different event and movement branches to validate the operational timeline.

S15: Cataclysm

In 6.36, record:

- first Cataclysm turn;
- horror target selection;
- fort interaction;

- throne destruction;
- required AP after each destruction;
- final result when all Thrones disappear;
- effect of current countermeasures.

This test resolves the manual/community wording conflict.

S16: AI difficulty economy

Use identical nations and provinces at each difficulty.

Measure:

- gold;
- resources;
- recruitment points;
- magic income;
- commander recruitment;
- Holy Points;
- fort timing;
- ritual, global, and Dispel behaviour.

Confirm which modifiers apply and which do not.

S17: Raider response exchange

For each standard thug or stealth package:

1. price the raider in gold, gems, and mage-turns;
2. price each defender;
3. run repeated battles;
4. include capture and looting;
5. measure provinces taken before interception;
6. compare attention and map impact.

The output is a campaign exchange table, not only a duel result.

S18: Recovery scenario

Begin from a saved position after a main-army loss. Compare:

- immediate reconstruction;
- fort-based elastic defence;
- raiding counteroffence;
- emergency research pivot;
- negotiated peace.

Measure survival of capacity, territory after six turns, research, gem stock, and opponent advance.

S19: Information-deception scenario

Present opponents with:

- visible false mass;

- hidden magic movers;
- multiple target routes;
- manipulated gem loads;
- staged claimants.

Record which observations actually change rational defence. Reject deception that works only because the defender ignores available evidence.

S20: Combined-mod campaign regression

For the frozen DE + Divinitus load order, repeat:

- turn-12 expansion;
- key movement;
- first-war package;
- representative raider and counter;
- siege arithmetic;
- throne operation;
- AI practice game.

Any difference must be linked to a mod command or recorded as test-only evidence.

Part XVIII: Operational Checklists

New-game settings

- Patch and manual revision recorded.
- Map, planes, and start density understood.
- Independent strength recorded.
- Research and magic-site settings recorded.
- Throne levels, total points, required points, and Cataclysm recorded.
- Score-graph settings recorded.
- Diplomacy mode and NAP doctrine recorded.
- Story events and special rules recorded.
- Mods, hashes, and load order recorded.
- Extension, substitution, and concession rules recorded.

Turn-12 expansion audit

- Provinces, forts, and claimed routes.
- Income, treasury, upkeep, and resources.
- Surviving expansion parties.
- Capital recruitment unlocked.
- Researchers and site search.
- First fort start or reason for delay.
- Known neighbours and border settlements.
- Thrones located and inspected.
- First-war deterrence.
- Opening variance across tests.

Pre-war audit

- War aim and stopping condition.
- Legal treaty date.
- Enemy main army and reserve.
- Known research, paths, Pretender, and counters.
- Friendly package, scripts, gems, and replacements.
- Siege strength and fort sequence.
- Scout coverage and deception plan.
- Other borders and coalition reaction.
- Failure route and peace terms.
- Throne conversion.

Army departure

- Every troop has legal leadership.
- Slowest movement and survival checked.
- Rivers, passes, caves, water, and planes checked.
- Supply checked.
- Scripts and formations checked.
- Gems and slaves checked.
- Bodyguards checked.
- Spare commander and retreat route checked.
- Siege contribution checked.
- Claimant included if required.

Raider

- Target class and likely PD.
- Legal route and movement.
- Counter locations.
- Minimal equipment.
- Fatigue stability.
- Retreat or escape.
- Replacement cost.
- Captured province exploitation.
- Loot carrier.
- Recall condition.

Counter-raider

- Exact raider observed or inferred.
- Cheapest relevant counter.
- Interception destinations.
- High-value nodes covered.
- Empty provinces reclaimed cheaply.
- Gear-looting plan.
- Main army not distracted unnecessarily.
- PD raised only where it changes the matchup.

Siege attacker

- Wall strength and one-turn crack estimate.
- Repair estimate.
- Maintain Siege orders.
- Relief routes.
- Sequential battle and gem budget.
- Storm script suitable for gate and indoor context.
- Commander survival and redundancy.
- Supplies.
- Claimant and post-storm defence.

Siege defender

- Wall condition.
- Repair bodies.
- Interior supply and disease.
- Break Siege package.
- Outside relief and phase timing.
- Remote and assassination options.
- Irreplaceable cadre extraction.
- Alternate fort or Throne defence.
- Counterattack on attacker's strategic assets.

Diplomacy

- Exact parties and terms.
- Formal, social, or hybrid.
- Notice and first legal turns.
- Scout, stealth, remote, dominion, global, and access terms.
- Trade quantities and delivery.
- Victory emergency clause.
- Mistake procedure.
- Written record.

Throne watch

- Current and plausible AP for every nation.
- Controlled but unclaimed Thrones.
- Claim-capable units and movement.
- One-turn-crack forts.
- Magic-phase access.
- Existing claimed-Throne defence.
- Cataclysm threshold.
- Coalition contacts.
- Counterattack targets.

Recovery

- Surviving cadres, gems, and items.
- Enemy next destinations.
- Existential, capacity, network, economic, and disposable provinces.
- Cheap stabilisation research.
- Fort and retreat line.
- Raider counteroffence.
- Diplomatic options.
- New army package rather than blind replacement.

Final submission

- No immediate opponent victory.
- All messages read.
- All decisive replays watched.
- Treasury and queues checked.
- Research allocated.
- Forts, labs, temples, and PD intentional.
- Rituals and forging intentional.
- Gems, items, and troops transferred.
- Movement remains legal.
- Siege, patrol, sneak, defend, and claim orders correct.
- Treaty and trade obligations fulfilled.
- Turn saved and submitted.

Part XIX: Essays

Essay I: The Expansion Problem

Expansion is often measured by a turn-12 province count because the number is visible, easy to compare, and strongly connected to early income. It is useful and incomplete. The real expansion problem is to acquire enough valuable and defensible territory while preserving the capacity to survive first contact.

The opening begins before the map appears. Pretender design decides whether an awake monster supplies a second army, a bless turns sacreds into a specialist expansion force, or scales finance ordinary troops and early infrastructure. These choices do not buy abstract power. They buy particular expansion matchups at particular times. An awake monster that clears militia but dies to the first heavy cavalry province has not solved expansion; it has created a route constraint with catastrophic failure.

The first skill is classification. Independents are not a ladder from small to large. They are a collection of damage, armour, morale, missile, lance, formation, and magic problems. Heavy national infantry may walk through ordinary weapons and bleed out against barbarians. High-defence sacreds may dominate low-attack infantry and collapse when surrounded. Archers may erase unarmoured tribes but waste months against shielded heavy troops. A party becomes reliable when its player knows what it is designed to fight.

The second skill is routing. Each province changes future options. A cap-ring forest can release resources into capital recruitment. Rich farmland can finance a fort. A choke point can define a border. A route around an interior pocket can reserve easy provinces for a third party. Province value is not just the income shown this turn; it is the chain of recruitment, movement, and diplomacy that ownership makes possible.

The third skill is force sizing. Too little force creates losses whose true cost includes replacement, delayed parties, commander transport, and deterrence. Too much force concentrates strength that can conquer only one province per month. The efficient party is not the mathematical minimum that can win under average rolls. It carries enough margin to survive uncertain reports, unlucky combat, and the next target.

The fourth skill is transition. Independent expansion offers largely static opponents. Human contact introduces adaptation, deception, and simultaneous movement. A nation that continues driving small parties outward after borders are settled may present each one for defeat. A nation that combines too early may surrender unclaimed land. The transition occurs when the next neutral gain is worth less than the fort, research, reserve, or diplomatic stability it delays.

Expansion testing works because it turns these judgments into experience before the game begins. The test must include realistic PD, recruitment, site search, and infrastructure or it rewards a position that cannot exist in the real campaign. Repetition matters more than one ideal map. The goal is a procedure that produces a resilient median and an acceptable bad start.

The final measure is the first-war position. Territory is valuable when it has become income, resources, forts, mages, sites, routes, and political claims. Expansion is complete only when the nation can defend or exploit what it has taken.

Essay II: Information as a Resource

Information has no treasury icon, yet it changes the value of every other resource. Ten gems carried into the correct battle are a weapon; ten gems carried by a mage who is intercepted by the wrong counter are loot. A fort one turn from cracking is a crisis if observed and a surprise defeat if not. A Throne held by an opponent is ordinary territory until its claim changes the victory arithmetic.

Dominions distributes information unevenly. Ownership gives one view, adjacency another, scouts another, spies another, dominion another, and scrying another. Score graphs show trends without scripts or stocks. Battle replays reveal exact deployed tools but only after contact. Diplomacy supplies claims whose reliability must be judged. The strategic task is not to obtain perfect knowledge. It is to combine imperfect channels before the decision deadline.

This begins with questions. "What does the enemy have?" has no practical stopping point. "Can the border fort be cracked next turn?" directs collection toward army size, siege bodies, wall modifiers, and nearby movement. "Can the army survive Foul Vapors?" directs attention toward Nature paths, research evidence, poison resistance, and gem carriers. Intelligence has value when it changes an order.

Uncertainty must remain visible. A missing army may have withdrawn, hidden through glamour, moved through another route, or prepared a magic-phase attack. A research spike may indicate a new threshold, an event, or simply accumulated infrastructure. Experts are not those who always guess correctly. They assign confidence, retain alternative explanations, and choose orders that remain tolerable under several branches.

Denial is the other half. Patrolling out scouts reduces enemy coverage. Concealing item transfers delays counter construction. Holding a magic mover on a central lab creates several possible targets.

Hiding everything also sacrifices deterrence: an enemy cannot fear a capability it does not believe exists. Selective revelation can preserve a border while the decisive package stays concealed.

Deception is useful only when it changes rational allocation. A false army near an irrelevant province is theatre. A displayed force near one Throne while a stealth and magic-movement package can reach another may force the defender to split. The false story must fit observed paths, movement, and incentives. Good opponents do not need certainty to respond; they need a threat whose expected cost is high enough.

Information also imposes attention costs. A hundred unlabelled scouts and reports can make a position harder to understand rather than easier. Networks need roles: border screen, operational depth, strategic nodes, and rear warning. Reports need dates. Old observations must be marked stale. The player must know which provinces going dark matter.

The final advantage is learning speed. Each battle answers questions about scripts, gem use, target selection, and counters. A player who reviews those answers converts losses into future efficiency. A player who watches only whether the green bar won receives almost no information from the same event.

Information is not omniscience. It is the reduction of expensive surprise.

Essay III: Raiding and Counter-Raiding

Raiding is often described as taking low-defence provinces with small forces. Its deeper purpose is to create an unfavourable allocation problem. A raider costs less than the force that must remain available to stop it, threatens more provinces than the defender can cover, and moves while the main army creates a separate emergency.

The provincial income is only the simplest return. A raider can cut a reinforcement route, stop a lab from pooling gems, interrupt recruitment, isolate a fort, remove a temple, expose retreat into hostile land, or force a combat mage away from the field army. These gains are positional and temporal. A poor province can be the most valuable raid if it breaks a corridor on the decisive turn.

Raider design begins with a target class. A small troop squad may defeat token PD. A light thug may defeat stronger PD and ordinary local recruits. A heavy thug may punish troop-only responses. A stealth army may bypass the line. A teleporter may strike a lab before normal movement. Each class has a ceiling. Calling every geared commander a thug hides the question that matters: what can it beat at its price?

Minimalism creates the favourable exchange. A protection item that changes the PD matchup can be efficient. A fifth defensive item that does not change the likely counter turns the unit into loot. Equipment keeps its value only while the carrier survives; when captured, the swing includes the attacker's loss and the defender's gain. Expected target value, escape probability, and available counters should set the item budget.

Counter-raiding fails when the defender treats every lost province as equally urgent. Chasing a fast raider with the main army abandons the decisive front. Raising heavy PD everywhere can cost more than the raids. Sending an expensive mage after incomplete information can donate another asset.

A layered defence is cheaper. Scouts predict routes. PD tripwires defeat the smallest attacks and reveal larger ones. Forts preserve recruitment. Local commanders retake empty land. Mobile specialists cover labs, Thrones, and junctions. Magic-phase counters threaten raiders that ordinary armies cannot catch. The strategic reserve does not chase; it occupies a node from which several valuable provinces are protected.

The defender should also attack the raid's support. A stealth force may need a commander route, a laboratory for magic escape, or a predictable safe province. A thug may depend on one irreplaceable item factory. A remote attacker may expose a high-path caster and gem stock. Counter-raiding becomes counteroffence when it removes the infrastructure that makes repeated raids possible.

Raiding succeeds when it is connected to the campaign. Provinces taken at random are noise. Provinces taken while a fort is being cracked can prevent relief. A raider that forces the only counter-mage away may let the main army win. A raid that captures a Throne can change the victory threshold without destroying an army.

The mature contest is not province against province. It is response cost against threat cost, repeated until one side can no longer cover the map.

Essay IV: Siege as a Strategic Clock

A fort does not make a province invulnerable. It buys time, preserves an interior, and changes the sequence required to convert field victory into ownership. That sequence is the siege clock.

The attacker first has to reach the province and defeat whatever remains outside. Wall reduction then compares Strength-squared contribution against repair. Only armies maintaining the siege contribute. Once walls reach zero, the attacker must issue a storm order and win the gate battle. Relief can occur first. The same mages may fight several times, spend gems, lose commanders, and enter the storm with a script designed for a different battlefield.

Each turn of delay creates room to act. The defender can finish research, move relief, cast remotes, recruit elsewhere, negotiate assistance, or counterattack another Throne. The attacker pays upkeep, supply, attention, and exposure. A fort's value is not only its wall number. It is also the number of hostile deadlines that pass while the walls remain.

Siege strength converts troop composition into tempo. High-Strength and flying units can reduce enormous walls quickly. Mindless, Animal, and Undisciplined penalties can make a visually vast army unexpectedly slow. An army optimised only for field battle may spend months outside a cheap fort. A smaller army with specialised siege bodies may convert victories before the political situation changes.

The defender also converts bodies into time. Cheap units can repair. Intrinsic guards strengthen the storm. Mages inside remain able to research or prepare while the fort holds, but declining supplies create an attrition clock in the opposite direction. A capital packed with irreplaceable living mages cannot wait indefinitely if starvation and disease begin.

Relief creates the siege's most dangerous turn. If the defender breaks the besieger outside, the storm is cancelled. If relief fails, it may still consume attack gems and kill siege commanders before the gate. The attacker must decide whether one script can survive several combats and whether gem loads cover the full chain. The defender must decide whether the relief force is buying victory, delay, or merely a cheap gem burn.

Throne forts expose the clock's endgame importance. A one-turn crack can reduce coalition reaction to a single cycle. A force that requires two turns may allow every surviving nation to move, forge, assassinate, and attack the rusher's existing points. Wall strength is then not local defence; it is world reaction time.

Siege strategy should be planned backwards from the storm and forward from the relief. How many turns can the larger game afford? Which assets are trapped? What counterstroke becomes possible during delay? A fort has fulfilled its role when the time it creates is converted, even if the walls eventually fall.

Essay V: Timing Attacks and Power Spikes

Power is relative and temporary. A nation may have a stronger endgame and still die before reaching it. Another may dominate the first year with an awake expander and lose once opponents acquire armour-negating magic. Strategy identifies the interval when a package produces more usable force than rivals can answer and converts that interval before it closes.

A power spike can come from awakening, research, recruitment scale, a forged booster, a summon, a global, a treaty expiry, or an opponent's losses. The visible event is rarely sufficient by itself. Completing a battlefield enchantment does nothing if troops have not assembled, gems remain in the capital, and mages need three turns to walk to the front.

Preparation must begin before research completes. Recruit the line that the spell will protect. Forge the boosters that create legal casters. Place scouts on the target. Begin the NAP countdown. Move siege bodies and claimants. Accumulate enough gems for the operation and the response. The spike begins when the whole package can act, not when one school reaches a number.

Relative timing also includes counters. A mass protection spell may dominate mundane armies for several turns and become ordinary once armour-piercing evocations or battlefield control appear. A sacred rush may exploit neighbours who spent design points on scales and imprisonment, then face awake gods and deeper research later. The attack's deadline is the earliest likely answer, not the player's preferred calendar.

Good timing attacks produce a conversion that persists after the window. They take forts, destroy irreplaceable cadres, seize Thrones, or force treaties. Merely winning peripheral battles allows the defender to survive until the counter arrives. The objective should be the asset whose loss prevents recovery.

There is also a defensive spike. A nation under attack may be two turns from a cheap resistance spell, a communion threshold, or an awakened Pretender. Elastic defence can surrender land to preserve those turns. The invader's strongest play is often to force the decisive battle before the threshold; the defender's strongest is to make every route consume time.

Not every spike should be used for war. Visible capacity can deter and create favourable treaties. A global or research lead can improve economy more safely than conquest. The comparison is between what the window can gain through attack and what it can compound through peace.

The essential habit is to date power. "This army is strong" is not a plan. "This package can crack the border fort on turn 25, before the likely counter on turn 28, and hold the captured lab" is strategic reasoning.

Essay VI: The Diplomacy of Threat

Diplomacy in Dominions is not separate from military power. It determines how much power must be held idle, where armies can move, which gems become accessible through trade, and how quickly a leader faces a coalition. The central diplomatic object is the credible threat.

A threat has capacity, communication, and an off-ramp. Capacity means the stated consequence can actually occur. Communication means the target understands the condition and deadline. The off-ramp gives the target a cheaper action than defiance. Without capacity, the threat is noise. Without clarity, it produces fear without control. Without an achievable exit, it becomes war.

NAPs formalise some of this uncertainty. Dominions 6 can mechanically enforce them, but engine enforcement cannot answer every social question. Remotes, stealth staging, dominion pressure, harmful globals, third-party access, and victory emergencies create conduct that may be legal in code and unacceptable under a group's expectations. Clear doctrine prevents disagreement from becoming the most destructive event in a months-long game.

Treaties purchase time. That time should have a named use: research, a war on another front, fort construction, recovery, or a throne operation. A NAP with no purpose can allow a stronger neighbour to compound more efficiently than the beneficiary. Long commitments also reduce the table's ability to respond to victory. Their duration must be compared with plausible throne windows.

Reputation is stored diplomatic capacity. A player known to deliver trades and follow written countdowns can create agreements with fewer guarantees. A player known for exploiting ambiguity forces neighbours to hold armies and refuse valuable exchanges. Betrayal may occasionally be strategically decisive, but its full price includes future games and coalition response, not only the current province.

Leaders face a different problem. Strength attracts balancing. Oppressive globals, rapid eliminations, hidden throne progress, or permanent treaty blocs can make every other nation safer by cooperating. A leader should convert strength quickly enough that the coalition cannot form, or behave in ways that keep rivals divided without making promises that destroy credibility.

Weaker nations possess leverage because their collapse redistributes territory, Thrones, and fronts. They can offer information, gems, access, or coordinated resistance. They can also choose which rival benefits from conquest. This is not unlimited power, but it means diplomacy does not end when the army graph falls.

The diplomacy of threat is ultimately the management of expected futures. Every treaty, warning, trade, and coalition message changes what other players believe will happen if they choose one branch. The most efficient military victory is the one a credible threat secures without spending the army.

Essay VII: Recovery and Elastic Defence

Defeat creates a dangerous illusion of total collapse. The missing army is immediately visible; surviving research, forts, gems, diplomatic value, and enemy exposure are less vivid. Recovery begins by measuring what remains.

The first objective is capacity. Territory can be retaken if forts still recruit the mages that define the nation. Troops can be rebuilt if command survives. Gems can become a new counter if laboratories remain. A panicked counterattack that loses the surviving cadre turns a reversible battle loss into structural defeat.

Elastic defence uses space to buy the time needed for a different exchange. Poor provinces are allowed to fall. PD reveals movement. Forts interrupt advance. Scouts identify whether the attacker concentrates or disperses. Raiders enter the rear. A research pivot matures behind the line. The defender chooses a shorter perimeter while the attacker acquires a longer supply and reinforcement problem.

This approach works because field victory creates commitments. The attacker must siege or bypass forts, protect captured labs, cover retreats, and decide how much force to leave behind. If it concentrates, raiders can recover provinces. If it disperses, a surviving reserve can defeat pieces. If it storms repeatedly, gems and commanders are exposed. The defender's purpose is to make every further gain cost more time than the attacker budgeted.

Recovery also changes diplomacy. Neighbours may fear the attacker more after a major victory. Exact reports of the winning army, its spent gems, and revealed scripts are valuable coalition information. A weakened nation can offer access or intelligence that a bystander could not obtain alone. The diplomatic position may improve while the military graph worsens.

The counterstroke should target dependency rather than colour. Destroy the army's lab, cut its retreat, assassinate the leader carrying most troops, relieve the key mage fort, or take a Throne elsewhere. Retaking every low-value province can wait. The goal is to remove the opponent's initiative.

Some positions cannot recover. The same discipline still matters. A final defence can delay a throne leader, transfer useful information under the rules, or create time for a substitute. Silent staling damages the competitive structure and removes strategic choices from everyone.

Elastic defence is not an excuse for indecision. It is a controlled exchange of land for the one resource a defeated nation most needs: a future turn in which the answer exists.

Essay VIII: The Throne Race

Thrones transform Dominions from a war of unlimited conquest into a contest of conversion. A nation does not need to defeat every army or own most provinces. It needs to own and claim the configured number of Ascension Points at the relevant hosting step.

This makes arithmetic a strategic skill. Current claimed points are only the visible baseline. Controlled but unclaimed Thrones, H3 movement, one-turn-crack forts, magic-phase reach, and Cataclysm can change the threshold within several turns. A nation that appears three points short may already control a three-point Throne. A nation at the threshold can be stopped by unclaiming one existing point before the new claim resolves.

Throne defence differs from ordinary border defence. A Throne province has discontinuous value because losing the wrong one can end the game. Its fort walls measure coalition reaction time. A one-turn crack may leave only one cycle for remote attacks, relief, claimant assassination, or a counterattack on another Throne.

The attacker must prepare for more than the storm. Bystanders who ignored a conventional war may unite when victory becomes visible. Magic-phase probes can consume gems before the relief and gate battle. Assassins can remove the claimant or commanders whose squads are needed to storm. Existing Thrones become counterattack targets. The winning operation needs redundancy, secrecy, siege, combat, claimant access, and defence at once.

The defender should resist local fixation. Saving the targeted Throne may be impossible. Cracking one of the attacker's owned Throne forts can change the arithmetic faster. Killing the claimant can buy a turn. Cutting a route can strand H3 access after the army wins. Coalition members should assign tasks by reach rather than all sending armies toward the same province too late.

Diplomacy changes near victory. Many communities treat an imminent throne win as superseding ordinary NAP expectations; formal binding systems may still constrain actions unless a victory clause was agreed. Games should resolve this before play, because a rule intended to create peace can otherwise make a legal response impossible.

Cataclysm adds a moving target. As Thrones disappear, required points decline and surviving points gain value. A long plan can become irrelevant between order and resolution. Endgame arithmetic must be recalculated every turn.

The throne race rewards preparation disguised as ordinary strength. The best rush becomes obvious only when the response window is already closing.

Essay IX: Why the AI Behaves as It Does

The Dominions AI plays the same fundamental economy, recruitment, movement, battle, magic, and victory systems, but it does not possess human political reasoning. It receives programmed priorities, complete province-ownership knowledge, and difficulty bonuses rather than intuition or social memory.

This distinction explains both pressure and predictability. At high difficulty, large bonuses to gold, resources, recruitment points, and magic income can create armies and magical output that a human position could not match from the same land. The AI can build forts, recruit national troops, cast high-level rituals and globals, and Dispel. It is not passive. Its threat comes from production and broad action.

What it lacks is the full human model of intention. A human may conceal a research spike, accept a poor local exchange to win a Throne elsewhere, or maintain a treaty because reputation across future games matters. Human coalitions can distribute tasks and share exact enemy scripts. The AI's decisions are bounded by the behaviours its evaluation can express.

Patch corrections matter. An old report that the AI repeatedly attempts rituals without a lab or assigns non-priests to preach no longer describes current 6.36 behaviour where those errors have been corrected. AI strategy must be evaluated by version rather than inherited folklore.

Difficulty also changes what a practice game teaches. Impossible pressure trains emergency defence and efficient battle magic, but its economic ratios are not a fair benchmark for human expansion. Normal difficulty better exposes whether the player's first fort, recruitment, and research produce a sound state. Both have value when their purpose is explicit.

Players can defeat predictable behaviour through loops that teach little. Better practice keeps scouts, legal Throne arithmetic, layered defence, gem budgets, and realistic no-reload consequences. The aim is to rehearse a full national campaign, not only discover one weakness in target selection.

The AI is best understood as an active strategic environment with asymmetric advantages and bounded judgment. It is capable enough to punish weak fundamentals and broad enough to expose players to many spells and rosters. It is not a substitute for the social, deceptive, and adaptive layer of multiplayer.

Sources and Open Questions

Principal sources

- Illwinter, Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, especially game settings, scouting, movement, patrol, stealth, raid, pillage, assassination, siege, diplomacy, Thrones, Cataclysm, AI, and hosting sequence.
- Illwinter Dominions 6 documentation.
- Illwinter Dominions 6 changes and new features.
- Illwinter home page and current release record.
- Official Dominions 6.36 announcement.
- Official Dominions 6.35 release note.
- Official Dominions 6.30 announcement.

- Supplied `DomEnhanced2_16.dm`.
- Supplied `Divinitus_1.15.3_DE.dm`.

Community doctrine and test references

- Naaira's Expansion Guide, used for the repeat-to-turn-12 expansion-testing method.
- Cybertron2's Guide to Expansion, Part 1, used for current Dominions 6 expansion-role and mage-support discussion.
- Cybertron2's Guide to Expansion, Part 3, used for frontage and expansion analysis.
- Building Thugs and Supercombatants, used for contemporary role, efficiency, defensive-layer, and counter-thug doctrine.
- NAPS: a rundown and two formal doctrines, used to document community ambiguity and explicit treaty conventions.
- Siege, used for community-documented messages and operational edge cases that remain assigned to tests.
- Owl's Mini-Guide to Throne Rushes, used for the T+0 to T+3 operational model and coalition-response doctrine.
- Dominions 6 Thrones, used as a current community object reference and to identify Cataclysm and identity questions requiring current-game verification.

Community sources supply doctrine, hypotheses, and test candidates. They do not override the current manual or official update notes. Where a community page is inherited from Dominions 5, only system-level reasoning consistent with Dominions 6 is retained, and exact claims remain marked for reproduction.

Open questions

Current-game tests or resolved data are still needed for:

- exact movement-interception probability and battle location in hostile swaps;
- full rounding and combination rules for movement and siege modifiers;
- current patrol-detection distributions under every unit modifier;
- all Raid and pillage output functions;
- exact bodyguard, Patience, surprise, and mounted-assassination distributions;
- every binding-NAP edge case under all diplomacy settings;
- complete current Throne identity and object-effect data;
- final Cataclysm outcome wording and current horror interaction;
- AI decision weights, target priorities, and diplomacy evaluation;
- current effective strategy objects under the DE 2.16 then Divinitus 1.15.3 DE layer;
- nation-specific expansion, research, war, raid, and throne packages.

These remain explicit research tasks. Nation dossiers can still use the campaign method as long as their local assumptions are stated.

DOCUMENT 9 OF 16

Foundation Book VII: Nations

The Nation Dossier Method and Middle Age Arcoscephale

What a nation dossier should do

A nation guide should do more than name strong units and recommend a research queue. It should explain how a nation turns its starting roster into a functioning state, how that state changes when research arrives, how its plans fail, and how to rebuild those plans when the ruleset changes.

This first volume of the nation library does two jobs:

- establish a reproducible method for every later nation dossier;
- apply that method to Middle Age Arcoscephale, the Old Kingdom.

It offers a safe first route through the roster and opening, but it also follows the harder questions of mage probability, force packages, path access, counters, logistics, and opportunity cost. There is no single build detached from map, opponents, settings, and patch. The dossier instead presents several coherent strategic families and the conditions that favour each one.

Edition note

Book I defines the common 6.36 live baseline and evidence terms. The dossier's large structured object comparisons remain pinned to their stated 6.35 snapshot. Unmodded Arcoscephale, DE 2.16, Divinitus 1.15.3 DE, and the combined load order stay visibly separate. Book IX owns the general mod catalogue; Book VII applies it to Arcoscephale.

How to use this dossier

The one-page brief, roster, expansion plan, mage roles, research branches, army packages, and turn checklists form the practical core. Probability portfolios, communion failure analysis, access ladders, matchups, reserves, and controlled tests provide the expert layer. For the modded game, read the unmodded dossier first, then the DE, Divinitus, and combined sections in that order.

Part I: The Nation Dossier Method

What a complete nation guide must answer

A useful dossier answers twelve questions.

Question	Required evidence
What is the nation trying to convert?	National summary, roster, magic, economy
What wins neutral expansion?	Unit statistics, formations, repeated tests
What prevents an early defeat?	Neighbour analysis, reachable research, reserve plan

Question	Required evidence
What does each fort recruit?	Commander costs, recruitment points, role demand
What does each mage random actually enable?	Exact random scheme and probability
Which research creates deployable packages?	Spells, paths, gems, mage-turns, delivery
Which paths are native, bootstrapped, or Pretender-dependent?	Access ladder with every step named
How does the nation fight different defence classes?	Armour, numbers, elites, giants, ethereal, undead, magic resistance
How does it raid, defend, siege, and claim?	Movement, leadership, magic, siege strength, priests
What information does it possess or lack?	Scouts, spies, scrying, remote spells, battle evidence
Which Pretender family solves the actual constraint?	Legal design, scales, timing, bless and ritual jobs
What changes under each mod?	Source diff, load order, combined test

If one answer is missing, the guide should say so. Concealing uncertainty creates a brittle strategy.

The four layers of a nation

Every nation should be analysed in four layers.

Layer	Contents	Common mistake
Rules	Roster, paths, costs, sites, spells, dominion, buildings	Repeating obsolete data
Capacity	What can be recruited, researched, forged, and delivered	Treating theoretical access as immediate access
Doctrine	How the capacities can be combined	Presenting one context-dependent plan as law
Evidence	Tests, replays, probability, and source records	Treating an anecdotal win as proof

The rules layer is descriptive. Capacity is conditional: an E2S1 mage does not automatically equal an E2S2 ritual caster; the necessary item, gems, laboratory, and forge turn must exist. Doctrine is comparative: one package is chosen because it fits an enemy, a deadline, and an economy. Evidence determines confidence.

The national conversion chain

The central dossier model is:

```
scales and starting assets
-> expansion and borders
-> forts and recruitment
-> mage distribution
-> research and gems
-> battlefield or ritual packages
-> positional gains
-> siege, Throne claim, and victory
```

A nation can fail at any arrow. Strong troops may expand but consume so many resources that the second fort cannot recruit. Broad magic may remain a collection of low paths if no communion or booster plan exists. A devastating battlefield spell may arrive without the troops, gems, or movement needed to exploit it. A winning army may lack siege or claim capacity.

Each nation chapter records both assets and conversions.

The national identity statement

A national identity statement should be one paragraph, not a slogan. It should name:

- the reliable early force;
- the recruitment bottleneck;
- the magic engine;
- the information advantage;
- the main strategic transition;
- the principal vulnerabilities.

An identity statement is a starting hypothesis. It must be revised when a patch or mod changes one of those elements.

Roster analysis by job

Units should first be grouped by job, then compared by statistics.

Job	Questions
Screen	How cheaply can it absorb missiles, charges, and first contact?
Line	What ordinary damage can it resist, and how long before fatigue defeats it?
Damage	What armour, size, defence, or resistance class can it kill?
Flank	Can it reach exposed mages or force the enemy to deploy wider?
Trampler	What sizes can it trample, and how are morale and magic resistance protected?
Sacred	Is the unit scarce, cap-only, resource-heavy, or massable?
Siege body	What wall damage, supply use, and opportunity cost does it impose?
Raider	Which Province Defence and local recruits can it beat reliably?
Bodyguard	What assassination, arrow, or flying threat does it prevent?

"Elite" is not a job. "High protection" is not a complete evaluation. A high-protection unit with low combat speed, high encumbrance, and ordinary damage may be an excellent anvil and a poor pursuit force.

Commander analysis by constrained turn

Commanders compete for recruitment capacity. Their gold cost is only one part of the decision.

For every commander, record:

- commander recruitment-point cost;
- fort and terrain restrictions;
- leadership types and limits;
- research;
- priest level;
- magic and randoms;
- strategic abilities;
- likely monthly orders;
- what is delayed when this commander is recruited.

A capital-only four-point mage has a different strategic cost from a one-point scout even if sufficient gold exists for both. Nation plans should budget fort-turns, capital-turns, and commander points as explicitly as gold.

Magic access as a probability portfolio

Random paths are not a list of possible maxima. They are a distribution.

For every random mage, the dossier should record:

- fixed paths;
- each random roll and its probability;
- maximum natural paths;
- probability of each important threshold;
- mutually impossible combinations;
- expected recruits needed for a role;
- the effect of bad variance;
- what a Pretender or independent mage can replace.

If a required result occurs with probability p, the probability of seeing at least one result after n independent recruits is:

$$P(\text{at least one}) = 1-(1-p)^n$$

The expected count $1/p$ is not a guarantee. A one-in-eight specialist has about a 65.6% chance to appear within eight recruits, not certainty. It takes twenty-three recruits to exceed a 95% chance:

$$1-(7/8)^{23} \approx 95.4\%$$

This distinction matters when the first war arrives before the desired random.

Native, bootstrapped, and imported access

Every path claim belongs in one of four classes.

Class	Meaning
Native	A normal national recruit can perform the job without external help
Boosted native	A national recruit can perform it with named items or self-buffs
Bootstrapped	An earlier summon, transformation, empowerment, or national event creates access
Imported	A Pretender, hero, independent, mercenary, Throne, site, or ally provides access

The access ledger must name every bridge. "Arcoscephale can cast a Death ritual" is incomplete if it actually means "a rare Nature hero forges or casts into a summon chain that eventually produces Death."

Research as response trees

A fixed research queue assumes the enemy and map will cooperate. A response tree has:

- a trunk of broadly useful early research;
- branches for observed threats;
- conversion nodes where research becomes a fieldable package;
- rejoin points so emergency research does not permanently destroy the long plan.

Every node should specify:

- school and level;
- spell or item obtained;
- eligible caster;
- required communion, booster, or self-buff;
- gem load;
- troop or target interaction;
- operational delivery;
- counters;
- what the research delays.

Army packages, not spell lists

An army package is:

```
troops + commanders + mages + scripts + gems + formation
+ movement route + retreat route + replacement plan
```

A spell becomes strategy only when the nation can put the correct caster, protection, gems, and targets in the same battle.

Each package should have:

- purpose: what defence or target it defeats;
- minimum core: the smallest robust version;
- scaling rule: what to add as the enemy grows;
- failure branch: what happens if the script is interrupted;
- counter warning: the most economical answer available to the enemy;
- replacement cost: how quickly the nation can field another.

Matchup classification

Nation-versus-nation memorisation becomes obsolete quickly. Defence classes are more durable.

Enemy class	Questions
Massed light troops	Can the nation kill squares faster than it is surrounded?
Heavy armour	Is damage high enough, or is armour destruction available?
High defence and glamour	Are attack buffs, area effects, or sight effects available?
Giants and elite sacreds	Can control, fatigue, armour-negating damage, or mass be delivered?
Undead and demons	Are priests, magic weapons, banishment, morale, and resistance adequate?
Flyers and cavalry	Is the rear protected and the line deep enough?
Tramplers	Can size, body-blocking, control, and morale attacks stop them?
Battle-mage mass	Can the nation disperse, interrupt, resist, or strike first?
Thugs and supercombatants	Can the chassis be controlled, exhausted, penetrated, or ignored?
Remote and stealth warfare	Are domes, patrols, redundant labs, and reserves in place?

Specific opponents can then be placed into one or more classes.

Pretender families

A dossier should present families, not copied designs:

- awake expansion: buys early territory and deterrence;
- dormant intervention: appears for the first war or path bridge;
- imprisoned scales: maximises the recruitable state;
- bless support: improves a sacred unit that can be recruited in relevant numbers;
- ritual bridge: supplies paths the national roster cannot reach;
- hybrid: deliberately performs two of these jobs at a real cost to each.

Every proposed build must pass five audits:

1. legality in the exact version and mod order;
2. expansion or survival job;
3. scales and recruitment compatibility;
4. mid-game job on awakening;
5. unique late-game access that cannot be bought more cheaply elsewhere.

Verification standard

Nation claims are verified in this order:

1. official manual or current official data;
2. current structured object data;
3. supplied mod source;
4. controlled game test;
5. detailed community evidence;
6. strategic inference.

The source hierarchy does not make community strategy unimportant. It prevents strategic experience from being confused with engine definition.

Minimum controlled-test suite

Every nation eventually receives:

- three or more turn-12 expansion runs for each serious Pretender family;
- controlled battles against the main independent types;
- random-mage sampling large enough to detect transcription errors;
- communion fatigue and script tests;
- a research timing test with realistic infrastructure;
- siege and storm tests;
- representative matchups against armour, elites, undead, flyers, tramplers, and magic;
- modded repetitions under each supported load order;
- a save, turn number, settings record, result table, and replay note.

Until those tests are recorded, precise party sizes and timing claims remain hypotheses.

Part II: Middle Age Arcoscephale, the Old Kingdom

The one-page national brief

Middle Age Arcoscephale is a human combined-arms nation whose ordinary military is old-fashioned but broad: inexpensive formation infantry, armoured spear lines, chariots, elephants, and a small capital sacred. Its strategic engine is a network of recruit-anywhere Mystics backed by capital Astrologers, priestess-healers, and automatic scrying inside friendly dominion.

The nation converts gold into versatile S1 elemental mages, those mages into communions or independent specialist casters, and research into an adaptable battlefield. It is strongest when intelligence identifies the defence to defeat before the army is scripted. It is weakest when expensive human mages are caught unprotected, when tramplers are exposed to morale or magic-resistance attacks, when heavy infantry is exhausted, or when random-path variance prevents a required specialist from arriving on time.

National profile

Feature	Unmodded Dominions 6.35
Race	Humans
Military	Heavy spear infantry, chariots, elephants
Recruitable magic	Astral, Fire, Water, Earth; some Nature
Priests	H1 and H2 priestess-healers
Dominion	Accurate automatic military reports inside dominion
Scale limit	Order limit +1
Forts	Standard
Laboratories	300 gold
Capital income	1 Nature gem and 4 Astral pearls per month
Central constraint	Gold- and mage-turn-intensive magical state
Central advantage	Information plus highly adaptable recruit-anywhere magic

Lore and strategic meaning

The Old Kingdom is intentionally archaic. Its armies retain cumbersome armour, long spears, chariots, and war elephants while ancient Astrologers return to guide the realm. This is not only flavour. The roster juxtaposes slow, reliable formation troops with volatile tramplers, while the mage corps juxtaposes broad low-level access with capital astral depth.

Three strategic themes follow.

First, knowledge precedes commitment. Automatic scrying inside dominion and Astrologers who read the heavens support a nation that should know what is approaching before choosing a script.

Second, the old army needs magical renewal. The troops can expand and hold ground, but armour, fatigue, morale, large targets, and elite opposition eventually require tailored magic.

Third, restoration is cumulative. Arcoscephale becomes stronger as forts produce Mystics, research broadens, boosters accumulate, and communions scale. Losing a mage core or capital does more than remove units; it breaks the conversion chain.

National special features

Automatic dominion scrying

Official: provinces inside Arcoscephale's dominion receive accurate automatic military reports. Current structured data also identifies this scrying as capable of revealing glamoured units, and disciple partners receive the information.

This is a strategic advantage, not omniscience.

It helps with:

- army size and composition near the interior;
- early warning against ordinary movement;
- more informed deployment of elephants, communions, and counters;
- identifying when a border force has split;
- tracking glamoured forces that ordinary reports may conceal.

It does not replace:

- scouts beyond dominion;
- spies for income, unrest, Province Defence, and deeper provincial information;
- battle replays for scripts, gems, and exact spell use;
- patrols against stealth;
- caution against magic movement, assassinations, remote attacks, and simultaneous orders.

The correct doctrine is a layered network:

1. scouts beyond the border;
2. dominion scrying across owned approaches;
3. reserve mages at central laboratories;
4. battle reports converted into response scripts.

Order limit +1

The nation can take one more step toward Order than an ordinary nation. This is not an instruction to maximise Order in every design. It is an option to support:

- expensive Mystics and Astrologers;
- fort and laboratory construction;
- elephant and chariot recruitment;
- larger mundane armies;
- reduced dependence on risky event income.

The scale must be evaluated against the Pretender family and opportunity cost. A high-Order scales design and an awake expander solve different problems.

Healing

Hiereiai have Healing 1. Archousai have Healing 3.

Official rule: a healer automatically attempts to cure a number of afflictions up to the value of the ability in the same province each turn. Healing is a provincial capacity. It does not guarantee that the exact desired affliction on the exact desired unit disappears immediately.

Healing improves the expected service life of:

- expensive commanders;

- Astrologers;
- battle-wounded Mystics;
- a combat Pretender that can be healed;
- surviving elephants and sacreds;
- thugs and summoned commanders without healing restrictions.

Healing does not make reckless attacks efficient. Dead units cannot be healed, some beings have special restrictions, and cursed-item afflictions require removal of the item first.

Recruitable commander roster

The following table is the official revision-2 unmodded roster. `Rec` is commander recruitment-point cost.

Commander	Gold	Res	Rec	Principal attributes and role
Scout	35	5	1	Stealth 50, Forest and Mountain Survival; forward intelligence
Mounted Commander	70	9	1	Leadership 75, Map Move 16; fast transport for compatible forces
Hypaspist Commander	95	25	1	Leadership 100, Protection 15, Defence 14; armoured line commander
Hoplite Commander	105	31	1	Leadership 100, Protection 18; slow heavy commander
Strategos	150	30	2	Leadership 150, Morale 15; large formations and army command
Hiereia	155	1	2	N1H1, Sacred, Healing 1; recruitable outside forts
Mystic	190	1	2	S1 plus elemental/astral randoms, Research +1; main national mage
Archousa	235	1	2	N1H2, Sacred, Healing 3, Leadership 50
Astrologer	270	1	4	Capital only, S3 plus randoms, Fortune Teller 10; astral specialist

Recruitment doctrine

No commander is "free" merely because the treasury can pay for it.

- A Scout competes with a leader or mage for the local commander queue.
- A Strategos is valuable when leadership quality and army size justify the extra recruitment cost.
- A Hiereia can be recruited outside forts, preserving fort mage production while extending temples, healing, supplies, and H1 support.
- A Mystic is normally the default fort investment because it produces research and future battlefield flexibility.
- An Archousa is a healing and H2 capacity purchase, not a generic researcher.
- An Astrologer consumes scarce capital recruitment capacity and should have a defined astral job.

The recurring question is:

> Which missing capacity causes the next failure: intelligence, transport, leadership, religion, healing, research, or high Astral?

Recruitable troop roster

The official revision-2 values below describe the unmodded units. Mounts and coriders are separate combat entities where applicable.

Unit	Gold	Res	Rec	Protection	Morale	Combat / map move	Primary role
Slinger	7	2	3	5	7	12 / 14	Cheap ranged harassment and screening
Cardaces	10	8	9	9	10	11 / 16	Cheap formation infantry
Peltast	10	5	9	5	10	11 / 16	Mobile spear and javelin screen
Hoplite	13	31	16	18	11	7 / 14	Resource-heavy armoured anvil
Hypaspist	16	25	23	15	13	10 / 16	Higher-defence, higher-morale heavy infantry
Charioteer	40	7	9	9	10	Rider 12 / 16	Chariot trampling and mobile missile pressure
Elephant Rider	100	3	9	5	8	Rider 12 / 16	War-elephant trampling with two archers
Heart Companion	20	31	23	18	13	8 / 14	Capital-only sacred heavy spear infantry

Mounts

Mount	HP	Prot	MR	Morale	Combat / map move	Role and risk
Riding Horse	18	3	5	7	26 / 22	Gives the Mounted Commander strategic and tactical speed
Chariot	20	3	5	9	20 / 20	Trampling platform; vulnerable if stopped or controlled
War Elephant	64	11	6	9	18 / 22	Large trampler; powerful against smaller bodies, vulnerable to MR and morale pressure

Troop roles and comparisons

Slingers

Slingers are cheap bodies and ranged nuisance fire. Their morale, protection, attack, and defence are poor. They are useful when:

- an inexpensive screen protects a more valuable line;
- mass missiles can punish unshielded or low-protection enemies;
- recruitment resources are scarce;
- siege bodies are urgently required.

They should not be treated as a reliable melee line. A routed slinger mass can contribute to wider morale problems.

Cardaces

Cardaces are the economical formation body. Protection 9 and Defence 13 are respectable for ten gold and eight resources, but their damage remains that of ordinary human spear infantry.

Use them to:

- add square density and bodies;
- hold ordinary light troops;
- screen elephants or mages;
- fill lines when resources cannot support Hoplites;
- absorb attacks whose damage would waste expensive armour anyway.

Do not ask Cardaces to solve high protection, giants, or elite sacreds without magic.

Peltasts

Peltasts exchange armour for javelins and low resource cost. They support early contact by throwing before melee and are less resource-constrained than the heavy line.

They are preferable when:

- the target is lightly protected;
- mobility and replacement matter;
- a sacrificial screen is needed;
- a province has gold but poor resources.

They are vulnerable to sustained missiles and decisive melee contact.

Hoplites

Hoplites bring Protection 18 and long spears at only thirteen gold, but cost thirty-one resources and carry Encumbrance 8, Combat Speed 7, and Map Move 14.

Their favourable fight is a direct clash against ordinary, low- or moderate-damage infantry that must spend time cutting through armour. Their unfavourable fight includes:

- armour-negating or armour-piercing attacks;
- high-strength giants;
- armour destruction;
- prolonged fatigue environments;
- enemies that refuse the front and reach the mages;
- operational races where Map Move 14 is too slow.

Hoplites are an anvil. They need a hammer or a magical answer.

Hypaspists

Hypaspists cost more gold and recruitment points than Hoplites but save six resources, gain Defence 13, Morale 13, Combat Speed 10, and Map Move 16 while retaining Protection 15.

They are generally better when:

- enemy damage already threatens to penetrate Protection 18;
- defence, morale, and mobility matter more than three protection;
- the army must keep pace with faster elements;
- gold is available but capital or local resources are constrained.

Hoplites are better at absorbing repeated ordinary hits. Hypaspists are a more flexible high-quality line. The choice should be made against an enemy damage profile and the province's resource economy, not by declaring one universally superior.

Chariots

The chariot package supplies mobility, a trampling mount, and a corider archer. It threatens flanks and lighter units but is less decisive than the elephant against dense small bodies.

Chariots benefit from:

- a screen that prevents premature pinning;
- flank deployment;
- targets lacking large body-blockers;
- magic that improves survival or disrupts the enemy line.

They suffer when:

- surrounded after the charge;
- confronted by large units;
- controlled by magic;
- committed into weapons and buffs designed to punish mounts.

War elephants

The elephant is Arcoscephale's most dramatic early force and its easiest trap.

Its 64 HP, Protection 11, Size, Combat Speed 18, Map Move 22, and trample can collapse ordinary human formations. The rider and two elephant archers add bodies and attacks, but the elephant's MR 6 and Morale 9 create explicit counter surfaces.

Use elephants as a package:

- a disciplined line or screen absorbs lances and delays contact;
- elephants begin behind or beside the screen rather than alone in front;
- leadership and standards support morale where available;
- the target has been scouted for size, anti-large damage, fear, paralysis, and MR-negates effects;
- a retreat route exists;
- the number committed is large enough to decide contact but not so large that one panic destroys the treasury.

Avoid treating elephants as an answer to:

- giants and other large bodies that cannot be trampled efficiently;
- high-defence elite troops that stop and surround them;
- concentrated fear or morale attacks;
- cheap MR-negates control or killing;
- poison, fatigue, and effects that exploit a large valuable target;
- narrow deployment where they cannot reach useful targets.

Heart Companions

Heart Companions are capital-only, sacred, heavily armoured spear infantry. They are individually better than Hoplites, but remain Map Move 14 and consume scarce capital resources.

Their scarcity changes bless economics. A bless that exists only to improve a slow, capital-only sacred must be compared with:

- more scales for the entire economy;
- an awake expander;
- missing Death, Air, Glamour, or Blood access;
- a combat or ritual Pretender.

A light incidental bless can add value. A major bless needs a campaign plan that proves the capital can recruit enough Companions without delaying other essential forces.

Formation doctrine

Arcoscephale's infantry benefits from formation-fighter density, but density has two faces.

It improves:

- concentration of melee attacks;
- the number of armoured bodies holding a frontage;
- the ability to protect mages behind a compact line;
- efficient buff coverage.

It increases exposure to:

- area damage;
- fatigue clouds;
- battlefield-wide debuffs;
- trampling if the enemy is large enough;
- mass routing when a dense formation loses many units quickly.

The default army should not be one dense block. It needs separate functional elements:

- a central anvil;
- one or two flank or trample groups;
- a rear guard against flyers and attack-rear orders;
- mages separated enough to reduce common-area losses;
- spare commanders so one casualty does not strand the army.

Part III: The Mage State

Why the Mystic defines the nation

The Mystic is the repeatable national engine:

- recruitable in any fort;
- guaranteed Astral 1;
- one guaranteed random from Fire, Water, Earth, or Astral;
- an independent 50% Fire random;
- an independent 50% Water random;
- an independent 50% Earth random;
- Research +1;
- able to enter Astral communions;
- capable of independent low-level magic even when no communion is appropriate.

The important word is independent. The three 50% rolls are separate from the guaranteed four-path random and from each other.

Mystic random structure

Let:

- R be one guaranteed uniform roll among F, W, E, and S;
- F_b, W_b, and E_b be independent 50% bonus rolls.

The final paths are:

```
S1
+ one level from R
+ F1 if Fb succeeds
+ W1 if Wb succeeds
+ E1 if Eb succeeds
```

There are thirty-two equally likely combinations before any other game effects: four values of R multiplied by eight combinations of the three binary bonus rolls.

Mystic threshold probabilities

Result	Probability	Interpretation
F0 / W0 / E0	37.5% each	No level in that element
F1 / W1 / E1 exactly	50% each	Useful low-level elemental caster
F2 / W2 / E2	12.5% each	One-in-eight natural specialist
S1 exactly	75%	Ordinary communion-capable Mystic
S2	25%	Stronger Astral caster or master
Any named element at 1+	62.5%	Five in eight
Any named pair of elements at 1+	37.5%	Example: F1+ and E1+
F, W, and E all at 1+	21.875%	Seven in thirty-two
Two elemental paths at level 2	0%	Mutually impossible from this random scheme
E2 and S2	0%	Both require the single guaranteed roll

The last two rows are strategically important. A Mystic can be broad, but the same guaranteed roll cannot create two doubled paths. Plans requiring E2S2 or F2E2 need boosters, empowerment, a Pretender, a hero, or another access source.

Probability of obtaining a specialist

For a one-in-eight F2, W2, or E2 Mystic:

Recruits	Chance of at least one
1	12.5%
4	41.4%
8	65.6%
12	79.9%
16	88.2%
23	95.4%

Derived: the table assumes independent recruitment rolls and uses $1-(7/8)^n$.

This produces a recruitment rule:

> A one-in-eight random is a portfolio capability, not a deadline-safe capability.

If a war plan requires E2 by a fixed turn, build redundancy, recruit from multiple forts, or provide another route.

Mystic role classification

Rename or otherwise record Mystics when recruited. A practical classification is:

Tag	Minimum path	Principal jobs
S2	S2	Astral master, penetration and Astral scaling
F2	F2	Fire specialist, Fire self-buff route, high-damage evocation
W2	W2	Water specialist, cold damage, Water buffs, elemental summons
E2	E2	Earth specialist, protection, armour destruction, forging and Dragon Teeth
FWE	F1W1E1	Broad point buffs, site search, cross-path utility
FE	F1E1+	Fire/Earth cross-path and forging candidate
WE	W1E1+	Water/Earth cross-path and protection/control candidate
FW	F1W1+	Elemental resistance and mixed evocation candidate
S1 utility	No doubled path	Communion slave, research, low-level Astral and random-specific support

This is not a permanent caste system. A war can change priorities. The point is to prevent an E2 specialist from spending twenty turns as an anonymous researcher and then being unavailable when armour destruction is required.

The Astrologer

The capital-only Astrologer has:

- fixed S3;
- one guaranteed random among F, W, E, and S;
- a further 10% random among F, W, E, and S;
- Fortune Teller 10;
- commander recruitment cost 4;
- Research 13 in the current structured data;
- high magical leadership.

Astrologer probability

Assuming the 10% roll independently chooses one of the four listed paths:

Astral result	Probability
S3	73.125%
S4	26.25%
S5	0.625%
S4 or higher	26.875%

For any one element:

Elemental result	Probability
No level	73.125%
Level 1	26.25%
Level 2	0.625%

Derived: these values include the rare 10% random instead of rounding the unit to "one in four S4."

Astrologer roles

Astrologers are recruited for jobs that justify capital scarcity:

- reliable S3 master casting;
- S4 or rare S5 ritual and remote-magic thresholds;
- high-Astral penetration;
- a capital communion anchor;
- Fortune Teller concentration;
- eventual high-end Astral rituals and battlefield magic;
- an elemental random that opens a specific Astral cross-path.

An Astrologer should not automatically replace a Mystic as a generic researcher. The capital turn, gold, and recruitment points are the real comparison.

Priestess-healers

Hiereia

The Hiereia is N1H1, Healing 1, sacred, and recruitable outside forts.

Her roles include:

- building temples without consuming a fort mage turn;
- blessing sacreds;
- Sermon of Courage and other low-priest support;
- low Nature support;
- provincial healing;
- supply assistance;
- accompanying expansion or siege forces where one affliction recovered matters.

Outside-fort recruitment is a state-building advantage. Provinces without forts can produce religious infrastructure and healing while the forts continue producing Mystics.

Archousa

The unmodded Archousa is N1H2 with Healing 3 and Leadership 50.

Her roles include:

- stronger healing concentration;
- H2 battle and ritual duties;
- leading a modest army while providing priest support;
- protecting the long-term value of expensive units and commanders.

She is not a substitute for broad Nature magic. Unmodded Arcoscephale's normal recruitable Nature ceiling is N1.

Recruitment portfolios

The research-first portfolio

Use when:

- borders are stable;
- the mundane army can deter a rush;
- no urgent H2 or healing deficit exists;
- an early research breakpoint creates the next advantage.

Default:

- most new forts recruit Mystics;
- capital alternates Astrologers and whatever national need is genuinely scarce;
- Hiereiai come from non-fort provinces;
- scouts are scheduled rather than forgotten.

Risk:

- too little mundane leadership;
- mages accumulated in one vulnerable laboratory;
- no reserve army;
- specialist variance arriving late.

The healing-and-expander portfolio

Use with an awake or dormant combat Pretender and expensive surviving troops.

Add:

- one or more Archousai at recovery hubs;
- Hiereiai following army groups;
- a safe path from battlefront to healing province;
- explicit checks for beings or afflictions that cannot be healed normally.

Risk:

- buying more healing than the casualty pattern warrants;
- delaying the research or Astral depth that prevents the next wounds.

The communion portfolio

Use when the first war requires path elevation.

Recruit:

- enough Mystics to separate slaves, masters, independent casters, and research;
- S2 or desired elemental masters;
- reserve slaves;
- ordinary leaders and screens that keep mages alive.

Risk:

- every master is counted but slaves are treated as expendable;

- slaves are also required for independent spells;
- shared self-buffs or fatigue kill the slave line;
- one battlefield clear destroys years of research investment.

The dispersed-reserve portfolio

Use against remote attacks, flyers, raiders, assassins, or fast fronts.

Maintain:

- small mage cells in several laboratories;
- spare pearls and elemental gems at operational hubs;
- scouts on approach routes;
- a mobile ordinary reserve;
- a protected capital core.

Risk:

- insufficient concentration for the decisive battle;
- gems and items stranded in isolated labs;
- scattered mages defeated in detail.

Part IV: Unmodded Magic Access

Native access summary

Path	Repeatable native ceiling	Main source	Important limitation
Fire	F2	One-in-eight Mystic	No native high Fire without communion or boosters
Air	None	Hero only at A1	Normal roster cannot use Air
Water	W2	One-in-eight Mystic	High Water requires communion or access chain
Earth	E2	One-in-eight Mystic	E2 and S2 do not occur on the same Mystic
Astral	S4 common peak; rare S5	Astrologer	Capital-only high Astral
Death	None	Summons, hero/Pretender routes	Several national rituals are inaccessible initially
Nature	N1	Hiereia and Archousa	N3 hero is chance-dependent
Glamour	None	Summon or imported route	No normal national access
Blood	None	Deep summon or imported route	No normal Blood economy
Holy	H2	Archousa	H3 normally requires prophet/Pretender or imported access

"Ceiling" here means a recruitable unit before boosters, empowerment, heroes, or communions. It does not mean that every spell at that level is strategically available; school, gems, range, and battlefield conditions still apply.

Native battlefield strengths

Astral

Astral is the stable spine:

- every Mystic can join a communion;
- S2 Mystics and S3+ Astrologers can serve as stronger masters;
- low-level Astral offers ethereal, luck, fatigue, mind, and resistance tools;
- high Astral creates remote and battlefield threats;
- capital pearl income supports early Astral use.

Astral also creates vulnerabilities:

- enemy Astral mages can threaten Magic Duel dynamics;
- communion clusters attract area attacks;
- pearls have competing uses in combat, forging, remote magic, and legendary rituals;
- an Astral plan without penetration can fail against high MR.

Fire

Fire supplies direct damage and morale pressure. F2 Mystics are natural specialists; F1 Mystics can reach higher levels through a communion or self-buff where available.

Fire is strongest against:

- dense ordinary troops;
- cold-aligned or fire-vulnerable targets;
- formations whose protection is less relevant to the chosen spell.

It is weaker against:

- fire resistance;
- dispersed targets;
- friendly formations too close to inaccurate area fire;
- battles where fatigue and gem use outrun protection.

Water

Water supplies cold damage, control, quickness and resistance effects, and elemental summons. W2 specialists are one in eight; W1 is common enough to support mixed packages.

Water is especially valuable when:

- the enemy lacks Cold Resistance;
- control and slowing matter more than raw kills;
- a Water/Earth Mystic can combine defensive and fatigue tools;
- summoned elementals can exploit enemy size or formation.

Earth

Earth renews Arcoscephale's old infantry:

- protection;
- strength;
- armour destruction;
- battlefield control;

- reinvigoration and path elevation;
- constructs and national summons;
- forging.

E2 specialists are among the most important randoms because they can use national Sow Dragon Teeth without ritual access problems and can anchor Earth communions. Earth still does not solve every high-protection fight: the chosen package must specify whether it raises friendly durability, lowers enemy armour, deals high damage, or controls movement.

Nature

N1 is support, not broad Nature dominance. It provides selected protection, entanglement, poison-related, healing, supply, and small-summon options as research permits.

Without a hero, Pretender, independent, empowerment, or summon chain, the nation does not naturally reach the powerful N3-N5 ritual tier. A guide that assumes easy high Nature is using another age, a mod, or an unrecorded access source.

Communions

Why Arcoscephale uses them

Mystics combine guaranteed S1 with heterogeneous elements. A communion:

- raises each master's known paths according to the number of slaves;
- distributes spell fatigue across participants;
- lets low elemental randoms reach battlefield thresholds;
- makes a roster of modest mages behave like a high-path school.

The official level thresholds are:

Slaves	Master bonus
2	+1
4	+2
8	+3
16	+4
32	+5

The bonus applies only to paths the master already knows.

The smallest useful communion

Two slaves are enough to raise paths by one. This can turn:

- F2 into F3;
- W2 into W3;
- E2 into E3;
- S2 into S3;
- an Astrologer S3 into S4.

The small communion is efficient for a limited script, but brittle:

- one slave loss can remove the bonus;

- fatigue per slave is higher;
- an overambitious master script can collapse it;
- the master may choose an unintended expensive spell after scripted orders.

Four- and eight-slave communions

Four slaves provide +2 and are the first general-purpose threshold for turning common F1/W1/E1 Mystics into level 3 casters.

Eight slaves provide +3 and support high-end battlefield effects, but create a large concentration of expensive mages. The cost includes:

- eight researchers leaving laboratories;
- pearls or scripting needed to establish the communion;
- bodyguards and formation space;
- fatigue management;
- risk of battlefield-wide or rear attacks;
- the loss of those mages if the army is trapped.

Master selection

Choose masters by spell package:

- F2 master for Fire;
- W2 master for Water;
- E2 master for Earth;
- S2 Mystic or S3+ Astrologer for Astral;
- cross-path Mystic when the spell or shared buff genuinely requires it.

Avoid adding masters merely because they can join. Every additional master:

- increases total fatigue placed into the slave pool;
- expands spell-selection variance after scripts;
- raises the value of the target presented to the enemy.

Slave selection

The cheapest-looking S1 Mystic may still carry a valuable cross-path. Slave selection should preserve:

- rare E2, W2, and F2 specialists;
- S2 masters;
- cross-paths needed for forging or point buffs;
- battlefield-independent casters.

If every Mystic costs the same, "slave" is a temporary assignment, not a low-value unit type.

Fatigue failure

Official communion fatigue depends on:

- the spell's fatigue cost;
- the number of participants;
- the slave's relevant effective path compared with the master's;
- bonuses and effects included in effective skill;
- the continued number of living slaves.

The dangerous cascade is:

```
slave becomes exhausted
-> slave stops contributing or dies
-> remaining slaves receive more fatigue
-> master bonus can fall below a threshold
-> later spells become more expensive or illegal
-> communion collapses
```

The package must be tested with the actual master scripts, gems, self-buffs, enemy pressure, and expected battle length.

When not to use a communion

Communions are not mandatory.

Independent casting is often better when:

- many Mystics can each cast a useful low-level spell;
- the spell does not need path elevation;
- the enemy can punish a mage cluster;
- the battle is small;
- slaves would cost more mage-turns than the target is worth;
- one pearl per independent caster produces more total useful actions;
- the desired mix of spells is easier to control without shared fatigue.

Community discussion of MA Arcoscephale correctly highlights this tradeoff: a Mystic assigned as a slave is not a cheap acolyte; it is a 190-gold researcher and possible specialist that no longer casts independently.

National spells and rituals

The official unmodded national list contains one battlefield summon and seven rituals.

Spell or ritual	School	Requirement	Cost	Result	Native access
Sow Dragon Teeth	Enchantment 6	E2	1 Earth gem	10 Spartae in battle	Yes: E2 Mystic
Forge Brass Bull	Construction 6	F3E3	25 Fire gems	1 Khalkotauros	Not on an unboosted recruit
Summon Hound of Twilight	Conjuration 5	E2D1	3 Earth gems	1 Hound of Twilight	No native Death
Craft Keledone	Construction 6	E2S2	5 Earth gems	1 Keledone	No natural E2S2 Mystic
Bind Keres	Conjuration 6	D2	12 Death gems	3 Keres	No native Death
Procession of the Underworld	Conjuration 5	D3	13 Death gems	15 Lampads	No native Death
Awaken Hamadryad	Enchantment 5	N4	25 Nature gems	1 N3 Hamadryad	Hero or imported path route
Monster Boar	Conjuration 5	N3	10 Nature gems	Remote unrest monster, range 5	Hero or imported path route

National access is not castability

Five of the eight entries are not immediately castable by the normal recruitable roster. This is deliberate strategic terrain.

- Sow Dragon Teeth is the clean native national tool.
- Craft Keledone requires bridging the missing point on an E2S1 or another caster.
- Forge Brass Bull requires substantial dual-path elevation.
- the Death rituals require imported or bootstrapped Death;
- high Nature depends on a hero, Pretender, independent, empowerment, or another chain.

The dossier separates "the nation owns this ritual" from "the present game can cast it."

Path-access ladder

Fire

1. Recruit Mystics until F1 and F2 roles are available.
2. Use communion bonuses or a Fire self-buff to reach battlefield thresholds.
3. Forge only after confirming the current item path and Construction level.
4. Use Pretender Fire when a ritual requires a dual path the Mystic distribution cannot produce.

Water

1. Recruit W1 and W2 Mystics.
2. Use Water self-buffs and communions for battlefield scaling.
3. Use booster chains when ritual thresholds require them.
4. Treat very high Water as a deliberate project rather than normal roster access.

Earth

1. Preserve E2 Mystics.
2. Use Earth self-buffs in battle.
3. Forge Earth boosters when current research and item paths allow.
4. Use E2 to cast Sow Dragon Teeth.
5. Bridge E2S1 to E2S2 for Craft Keledone through a named Astral booster or another caster.

Astral

1. Every Mystic provides S1.
2. S2 Mystics become stronger masters and forgers.
3. Astrologers provide S3, commonly S4, and rarely S5.
4. Astral boosters extend high rituals and penetration.
5. Communions reach extreme battlefield levels but do not cast ordinary rituals.

Nature

1. Hiereiai and Archousai provide N1.
2. The national hero Axieros provides N3 if he appears.
3. A single Nature booster can bring N3 to N4 for Awaken Hamadryad, subject to current item legality.
4. Pretender or independent access can make the route reliable.

Death

1. There is no recruitable national Death.
2. A Pretender is the reliable pregame bridge.
3. Suitable independent mages, sites, heroes, empowerment, or summons can create a later bridge.

4. Once D2 or D3 exists, the national Keres and Lampad rituals can produce units with further magic potential if made commanders by an appropriate current spell.

Air, Glamour, and Blood

These are absent from the ordinary national roster.

- Air appears on Orokestes at A1, if the hero arrives.
- Glamour and Blood require imported or summon-chain access.
- A Pretender taking one of these paths should have a clear job beyond merely making the national summary look broad.

Part V: Expansion and the First Year

Expansion objectives

Arcoscephalian expansion is successful when it produces:

- enough provinces to finance multiple forts and laboratories;
- resource provinces that let those forts recruit the intended line;
- surviving elephants, infantry, and commanders;
- a border that automatic scrying can help cover;
- an early fort schedule that begins multiplying Mystics;
- a credible force against opportunistic neighbours.

Province count alone is insufficient. Eight disconnected or exposed provinces with no second fort can be weaker than six provinces with a defensible boundary and a fort already building.

Starting force

Unmodded Arcoscephale begins with:

- a Hypaspist Commander;
- a Scout;
- twenty Peltasts;
- twenty Hoplites.

The starting army already contains a screen and an armoured line. It can take suitable human infantry provinces, but the correct first target depends on the actual report. Heavy cavalry, barbarians, crossbows, large numbers, and other high-damage independents can convert the expensive Hoplite line into an early setback.

Starting formation hypothesis

Strategic doctrine, test pending:

- Hoplites form the central or forward anvil.
- Peltasts begin slightly behind or on a flank so javelins do not disrupt the first contact.
- The commander remains protected and away from the most likely projectile path.
- Orders and distance are adjusted to make the two lines contact in a useful sequence.

This is a starting point for testing, not a universal script. Battlefield terrain, enemy placement, and projectile range alter the timing.

Expansion engines

Heavy-infantry expansion

Core: Hoplites or Hypaspists with a proper commander and a cheaper supporting line.

Strengths:

- little dependence on Pretender awakening;
- good against ordinary low-damage infantry;
- survivors retain value in the first war;
- predictable morale and formation.

Weaknesses:

- high resource demand;
- slow map movement for Hoplites;
- attrition from high-damage attacks;
- limited killing speed against dense or armoured enemies;
- replacement can delay infrastructure.

Elephant expansion

Core: a small number of elephants behind or beside an infantry screen.

Strengths:

- high shock and trample output against smaller human troops;
- fast strategic movement from the mount;
- low resource cost on the rider listing;
- strong deterrent against opponents without prepared counters.

Weaknesses:

- 100 gold per recruit;
- low mount MR and ordinary morale;
- catastrophic losses against control, fear, giants, and anti-large force;
- routs can trample friendly troops;
- a single bad expansion can delay a fort.

The correct number is empirical. It varies with independent strength, screen size, bless, leadership, target composition, and map. The library will not print a "safe" elephant count until repeated tests establish a range under the frozen settings.

Chariot expansion

Core: chariots on a flank with a centre that holds the enemy.

Strengths:

- cheaper than elephants;
- multiple package elements through rider, corider, and mount;
- mobile ranged and trample pressure;
- useful against light troops.

Weaknesses:

- smaller and easier to stop than elephants;

- less decisive against dense or large targets;
- vulnerable if pinned.

Awake-expander expansion

An awake combat Pretender can:

- take difficult provinces;
- establish a second route;
- reduce mundane losses;
- deter a first-year attack;
- bring missing magic.

The cost is paid in:

- scales;
- dominion or bless;
- design paths;
- risk to the Pretender;
- healing and support turns;
- the possibility that the chosen chassis cannot safely fight the actual independent.

Arcoscephalian healing makes a recoverable combat Pretender more attractive, but does not make it immortal or immune to lethal counters.

Target classification

Before each neutral attack, classify the province.

Independent feature	Arcoscephalian concern
Large low-damage infantry	Heavy line usually favourable; check total numbers and fatigue
Barbarians or high-strength weapons	Protection can be penetrated; use margin and missiles
Heavy cavalry	Lance impact can kill expensive infantry or riders
Crossbows	Heavy armour helps, but concentrated armour-piercing fire still matters
Archers and slingers	Shields and armour help; exposed Peltasts and Slingers suffer
Elephants or other tramplers	Body size, morale, and formation require a specific plan
Heavy infantry	Killing speed may be too low without elephants or magic
Sacred or unusual independents	Inspect weapons, paths, morale, and special abilities
Many commanders or mages	Assassination, morale, or magic can change the expected fight

Expansion losses and stop rules

An expansion party should stop when:

- its next target is outside the package's favourable class;
- losses would delay a fort or second party;
- the retreat province is unsafe;
- enemy borders make the party easy to trap;
- an elephant or commander has accumulated a material affliction;
- consolidation produces more value than one more exposed province.

The real cost of a dead Hoplite is not thirteen gold. It includes thirty-one resources, recruitment capacity, transport, and the effect of a thinner line on the next battle.

First-year infrastructure

A robust first year normally needs:

- continued expansion;
- a second expansion party or awake Pretender route;
- a second fort site chosen for population, resources, geometry, and safety;
- a laboratory where the first new Mystic production matters;
- temples where dominion, priest recruitment, or sacred production justify them;
- enough scouts to find neighbours before armies do;
- a treasury reserve against bad events, defence, and fort completion.

The 300-gold laboratory surcharge changes timing. A fort that cannot receive a laboratory on schedule is not yet a Mystic factory.

Turn-12 test record

Every serious design should be tested through turn 12 with:

- exact scales and awakening;
- exact independent strength;
- map type or seed;
- active mod list and order;
- recruitment by turn;
- Province Defence purchases;
- fort, lab, and temple starts;
- site searching;
- expansion route;
- every battle and loss;
- treasury and gem stock;
- surviving army;
- research level;
- contact and border geometry.

Minimum comparison metrics

Metric	Why it matters
Provinces owned	Gross territorial result
Income	Ability to sustain Mystics and infrastructure
Forts completed / building	Future mage throughput
Labs completed / planned	Actual conversion of forts into magic
Mage count and randoms	Research and access
Expansion-party survivors	Deterrence and replacement burden
Pretender state	Wounds, afflictions, location, fatigue and risk
Border length	Defence demand
Neighbour contact	First-war pressure

Metric	Why it matters
Research reached	Whether the proposed timing is real

Expansion test hypotheses

The first Arcoscephale test suite should compare:

1. scales plus starting heavy infantry;
2. scales plus early elephants;
3. mixed infantry, chariots, and elephants;
4. awake combat Pretender;
5. dormant intervention Pretender with stronger scales.

For each, test at least:

- ordinary infantry;
- barbarians;
- heavy cavalry;
- crossbows;
- heavy infantry;
- enemy tramplers.

Precise party sizes remain test pending until those runs are saved.

Part VI: Research Response Trees

The research trunk

Arcoscephale wants many schools. The solution is not to research every school evenly. It is to reach small conversion nodes that make the present army better, then branch.

A broadly useful trunk is:

1. Thaumaturgy 1 for Communion Master and Communion Slave.
2. Alteration 3 for Earth Meld, Body Ethereal, Mossbody where the cross-path exists, and a cluster of defensive or control tools.
3. Conjuration 3 for Phoenix Power, Summon Earthpower, Power of the Spheres, and early elemental options.
4. A branch chosen from the observed enemy.

This is doctrine, not a mandatory order. An immediate rush can require Evocation, Thaumaturgy 2, Construction, or another emergency branch first.

Exact early and middle conversion nodes

The manual confirms the following relevant spells:

Node	Requirement	Effect and Arcoscephalian use
Communion Master / Slave, Thaumaturgy 1	S1	Creates the national path-elevation system

Node	Requirement	Effect and Arcoscephalian use
Mind Burn, Thaumaturgy 2	S2	12+ armour-negating damage, MR negates; early single-target Astral threat
Body Ethereal, Alteration 3	S1	Point protection against nonmagical attacks
Earth Meld, Alteration 3	E2	Area movement control
Phoenix Power, Conjuration 3	F2	Raises Fire on the caster
Summon Earthpower, Conjuration 3	E2	Raises Earth and supplies reinvigoration
Power of the Spheres, Conjuration 3	S1	Raises the caster's known magic paths
Strength of Giants, Enchantment 1	E2	Point Strength support
Destruction, Alteration 4	E3	Armour-negating armour damage over area
Paralyze, Thaumaturgy 4	S2	MR-negates control against non-mindless targets
Light of the Northern Star, Conjuration 4	S3	Battlefield enchantment raising Astral
Falling Fires, Evocation 5	F3	Area armour-piercing Fire damage
Falling Frost, Evocation 5	W3	Area armour-piercing Cold damage
Gifts from Heaven, Evocation 5	E3S1	Very high damage with low precision; dangerous near friendly troops
Stellar Cascades, Evocation 5	S2	Area armour-piercing fatigue damage
Soul Slay, Thaumaturgy 5	S3	MR-negates death against a single non-mindless target
Mind Hunt, Evocation 6	S4	Remote commander attack; detection and feeblemind risk matter
Sow Dragon Teeth, Enchantment 6	E2 + 1 gem	Ten national Spartae in battle
Marble Warriors, Alteration 7	E3	Large-area protection for non-spirit targets
Will of the Fates, Alteration 7	S5	Battlefield-wide Luck
Legions of Steel, Construction 6	E4	Battlefield-wide armour improvement
Army of Lead, Alteration 9	E5S1	Battlefield-wide major protection
Army of Gold, Alteration 9	E5F1	Battlefield-wide major protection
Master Enslave, Thaumaturgy 9	S8	Battlefield-wide MR-negates enslavement against eligible minds

The table gives capabilities, not recommended scripts. Friendly-fire risk, magic resistance, fatigue, gem cost, battlefield range, and enemy resistance still determine value.

Branch A: anti-armour

Problem

Enemy protection makes mundane spears and tramplers trade poorly.

Early answer

- Destruction at Alteration 4 from an E3 caster.
- An E2 Mystic reaches E3 through Summon Earthpower or a two-slave communion.
- Ordinary infantry and tramplers exploit the reduced armour.

Middle answer

- combine armour destruction with Falling Fires, Gifts from Heaven, elementals, or strengthened troops;
- use Stellar Cascades if fatigue rather than immediate kills is the better axis;
- avoid concentrating expensive magic into a battle the enemy can decline.

Failure branch

If Destruction misses the relevant squares, or if raw HP and size matter more than Magic Resistance, add control, high damage, or more attacks. Repeating armour reduction will not solve that problem.

Branch B: anti-elite and anti-giant

Problem

Few high-stat or giant troops defeat ordinary lines and cannot be trampled efficiently.

Tools

- Earth Meld to hold targets;
- Body Ethereal on critical blockers;
- Mind Burn, Paralyze, and Soul Slay where MR permits;
- Gifts from Heaven for extreme physical damage at accepted accuracy risk;
- elementals to create size and disruption;
- Destruction if armour is the main defence;
- fatigue through Stellar Cascades or prolonged combat;
- a properly chosen Pretender or thug.

Doctrine

Do not ask one spell to do every job. A complete anti-elite package needs:

1. a line that survives initial contact;
2. control or distraction;
3. damage that attacks the correct defence;
4. mage protection;
5. a plan if the elite force attacks the rear or refuses the centre.

Branch C: anti-mass

Problem

Large numbers surround the line and exhaust killing capacity.

Tools

- elephants and chariots against eligible sizes;
- Falling Fires or Falling Frost against low resistance;
- area control;
- summoned elementals;
- dense formation infantry to hold frontage;
- Fire or Cold resistance on friendly forces when using hazardous battlefield conditions.

Failure branch

If the enemy mass is mindless, do not rely on mind effects. If it is undead, add priests and check the exact banishment environment. If it contains sacrificial chaff protecting dangerous mages, rear pressure or remote commander attacks may matter more than killing every body.

Branch D: anti-undead and anti-demon

Assets

- H1 and H2 priestesses;
- a prophet or Pretender;
- Astral, Fire, and national summoned options;
- morale support;
- precise information from dominion scrying.

Requirements

- enough priests to matter at battlefield scale;
- bodyguards against undead flyers or assassins;
- protection against fear and fatigue;
- Spirit Sight or another answer when darkness, invisibility, or special sight is relevant;
- an answer to the enemy mages rather than only the undead screen.

The ordinary infantry may hold skeletons but can be exhausted by endless replacement. The strategic target is often the summoning engine.

Branch E: anti-rush

The emergency branch is selected after reading the neighbour.

Rush feature	Candidate response
High protection	Alteration 4 for Destruction
Few elite sacreds	Thaumaturgy 2/4, control, elementals, body-blocking
Giants	Control, high damage, fatigue, avoid elephant dependence
Flyers	Rear guards, dispersed mages, bodyguards, wider deployment
Fire or Cold aura	Resistance, spacing, ranged damage, suitable element
Glamour and high defence	Spirit Sight where available, area effects, attack improvement
Regeneration	Concentrated damage, decay or disease where accessible, control
Undead mass	Priests, morale, engine-killing

Construction can be an anti-rush branch if a combat Pretender or thug is the fastest viable answer. It is not automatically useful merely because items are permanent.

Branch F: remote Astral control

Mind Hunt

Mind Hunt is Evocation 6, S4, two Astral pearls, range six.

Arcoscephale can obtain S4 on capital Astrologers without boosters, though not every Astrologer is S4. Healing reduces the long-term cost of some recoverable afflictions, but does not remove detection risk or make indiscriminate hunting sound.

Targets should be chosen from:

- commanders outside Astral protection;
- siege leaders;
- critical priests;
- isolated thugs;
- laboratory mages exposed by scrying and scouts.

The package includes:

- target intelligence;
- several S4 casters if the objective justifies them;
- a safe laboratory;
- pearls;
- healing capacity;
- a plan for enemy Astral detection or domes.

Soul Slay and Master Enslave

Soul Slay is a battlefield precision tool against eligible high-value units. Master Enslave is an endgame operation, not a research aspiration in isolation.

A Master Enslave operation needs:

- S8 effective skill;
- a robust communion;
- penetration;
- protection from interruption;
- enough fatigue support;
- a plan for mindless and high-MR enemies;
- commanders able to control any captured units;
- an exploitation plan if the enemy army is stolen.

Branch G: battlefield renewal

Arcoscephale's mundane army scales when research makes old soldiers survive modern magic.

Key transformations include:

- point ethereal and protection effects on the contact line;
- Destruction making ordinary spears relevant against armour;
- Marble Warriors improving a broad formation;
- Will of the Fates reducing casualties across the army;
- Legions of Steel improving worn armour;
- Army of Lead or Gold creating a late-game protected mass.

The more expensive the buff package, the more important it is to ask whether the troops are the right recipients. A battlefield-wide spell does not make a routed, immobile, poisoned, or bypassed army successful by itself.

Research rejoin points

Emergency branches should rejoin a larger plan.

Examples:

- Thaumaturgy 2 anti-elite -> Thaumaturgy 5 for Soul Slay -> Evocation 6 for Mind Hunt;
- Alteration 4 anti-armour -> Alteration 7 for Marble Warriors and Will of the Fates -> Alteration 9;
- Evocation 5 damage -> Evocation 6 remote Astral -> later battlefield offence;
- Conjuration 3 self-buffs -> Conjuration 4 Northern Star -> national and elemental summons;
- Construction branch for a Pretender -> boosters -> ritual access.

The rejoin point should be recorded before emergency research begins, preventing a permanent drift across half-finished schools.

Part VII: Army Packages

Package 1: The old line

Purpose: defeat ordinary human troops and hold ground cheaply.

Core:

- Hoplite or Hypaspist centre;
- Cardaces or Peltasts as screen or flank;
- one reliable commander;
- optional Hiereia;
- scouts on the operational route.

Scaling:

- add a Strategos for a larger army;
- add elephants or chariots for killing power;
- add a small Mystic cell once research provides a specific effect.

Failure modes:

- high-damage weapons penetrate the line;
- fatigue breaks Hoplites;
- flyers reach the rear;
- the army cannot kill high protection;
- slow movement cedes operational initiative.

Package 2: The elephant hammer

Purpose: break large formations of smaller ordinary troops.

Core:

- infantry screen;
- elephant group on a flank or behind the line;
- commander with adequate leadership and morale support;
- rear guard;
- scouting of size, morale attacks, and MR-negates magic.

Scaling:

- add enough elephants to create simultaneous contact;
- add point buffs to the screen;
- add area damage or control so elephants are not stopped by elites;
- add Hiereia/Archousa support and a post-battle healing route.

Failure modes:

- panic or control;
- giants;
- rear attack on commanders;
- a narrow battlefield;
- friendly trampling during rout;
- overinvestment in a countered chassis.

Package 3: Independent Mystic battery

Purpose: obtain many useful casts without communion concentration.

Core:

- several Mystics selected for the same low-level effect;
- one pearl or relevant elemental gems where needed;
- heavy infantry screen;
- separation and bodyguards;
- strict scripts whose unscripted continuation is acceptable.

Examples:

- repeated Body Ethereal;
- Mind Burn from S2 casters;
- Power of the Spheres followed by elemental effects;
- small elemental summons;
- repeated point buffs.

Strength: every mage acts.

Failure: individual path and gem use may be less powerful than a communion; spell-selection variance can scatter effects.

Package 4: Four-slave elemental communion

Purpose: turn common elemental randoms into level-three battlefield casters.

Core:

- four Communion Slaves;
- one or two chosen masters;
- screen and rear guard;
- gem load calculated from the exact script;
- no unnecessary masters.

Candidate master outcomes:

- F1 -> F3;
- W1 -> W3;

- E1 -> E3;
- S1 -> S3.

Self-buffs can raise paths further, but also change fatigue relationships and must be tested.

Failure: slave fatigue, lost threshold, massed mage casualties, or masters improvising expensive spells.

Package 5: Astral elimination cell

Purpose: remove a few high-value eligible targets.

Core:

- Astrologers or appropriate masters;
- Soul Slay or another current Astral killing spell;
- penetration where available;
- a line long enough to permit repeated casts;
- target selection based on MR and mind status.

Failure: high MR, mindlessness, enemy Magic Duel threat, insufficient range, or line collapse.

Package 6: Armour-break combined arms

Purpose: let ordinary troops and tramplers defeat armour.

Core:

- E3 effective caster for Destruction;
- resilient screen;
- Hypaspists, elephants, chariots, or summoned bodies ready to exploit;
- secondary magic if armour destruction lands unevenly.

Failure: the enemy disperses, kills the Earth caster, relies on innate protection, or counters the exploitation force.

Package 7: Fort storm and Throne claim

Purpose: convert field advantage into victory position.

Core:

- sufficient siege bodies;
- a storming line;
- an anti-commander or anti-mage plan;
- H2 or H3 claim capacity as required by the Throne;
- supply and laboratory support;
- a relief interception force;
- replacement commanders.

Arcoscephale's strength in field magic does not automatically crack walls or claim Thrones. The claim-capable priest and army must arrive together after the fort falls.

Package 8: Distributed counter-raiding

Purpose: prevent fast or stealth forces from turning a slow main army into territorial collapse.

Core:

- dominion scrying on approaches;
- scouts outside dominion;
- small Mystic cells in protected labs;
- cheap commanders and local troops;
- mobile elephants, chariots, or a Pretender where suitable;
- fort and laboratory redundancy.

Failure: every cell is too weak, pearls are absent, or the main army cannot exploit the enemy's dispersion.

Part VIII: Pretender Families

Family A: Awake expansion and missing path

Job

- take difficult neutral provinces;
- preserve national troops;
- deter an early rush;
- bring one or two missing paths, commonly Death, Air, Glamour, or another ritual bridge.

Good fit

- crowded maps;
- dangerous neighbours;
- weak starting terrain;
- a design whose chassis can reliably expand under the actual settings.

Costs

- weaker scales;
- Pretender risk;
- fewer design points for broad ritual access;
- possible overlap with elephants.

Audit

The chassis must be tested against heavy cavalry, barbarians, poison, magic weapons, and MR attacks. Healing is a recovery advantage, not a licence to attack unknown targets.

Family B: Dormant intervention platform

Job

- stronger scales than an awake expander;
- arrive near the first serious war;
- carry missing paths;
- serve as thug, battlefield caster, forger, or ritual bridge.

Good fit

- national troops can expand;
- the likely danger begins after contact;
- the nation wants a high-impact mid-game path package.

Costs

- no help during the first expansion turns;
- the planned battlefield role can be invalidated by the actual neighbour;
- a dormant chassis that cannot move or fight as expected may become an expensive researcher.

Family C: Imprisoned scales and research

Job

- maximise gold, resources, growth, and research scales;
- multiply forts and Mystics;
- emerge as a late ritual platform.

Good fit

- spacious map;
- reliable troop expansion;
- diplomatic room;
- a plan that uses the additional economic throughput before awakening.

Costs

- no Pretender during expansion or first war;
- greater vulnerability to rush;
- high-path ritual promises may arrive after the decisive period.

The design succeeds only if the recruitable state survives long enough to compound.

Family D: Sacred-support hybrid

Job

- provide an incidental or moderate bless to Heart Companions;
- remain useful as an expander, battlefield caster, or ritual bridge.

Good fit

- the capital can recruit Companions without sacrificing the rest of the plan;
- the bless also improves sacred commanders, summons, or the Pretender;

- the sacred unit fills a clear tactical role.

Costs

- capital-only recruitment;
- heavy resources;
- slow map movement;
- bless points that could solve wider national constraints.

Family E: Ritual bridge

Job

Provide paths missing from the national roster.

Priority candidates:

- Death for the national Underworld summons and wider Death economy;
- Air for mobility, lightning, forging, and storm tools;
- Glamour for sight, illusion, and control options;
- Blood only if the design includes a credible way to create and sustain a Blood economy;
- high Nature for national N3/N4 rituals and global access.

Audit

For every promised ritual, write the complete route:

```
Pretender base path
+ named booster
+ empowerment if any
+ research level
+ gem cost
+ laboratory and province requirement
= legal caster
```

If one step is missing, the ritual is not part of the build.

Historical builds and current legality

Earlier project discussions proposed:

- an imprisoned Astral-Earth Titan;
- a dormant Great Enchantress with Astral, Earth, Nature, and Death;
- a later Grand Hierophant with Fire, Air, Astral, and Blood under the combined mod set.

These are retained as historical design families, not copied as current legal builds. Chassis paths, design costs, scale limits, blesses, and mod abilities must be rebuilt in the current Pretender screen before publication as finished designs.

Scale priorities

Order

Supports:

- expensive mage recruitment;
- fort and laboratory construction;
- elephants and ordinary armies.

The national +1 limit makes high Order available, but the final value depends on the design-point curve and map economy.

Production

Supports:

- Hoplites;
- Hypaspists;
- Heart Companions;
- fort provinces with strong local resources.

Elephants themselves are not resource-intensive on the rider listing, so an elephant-heavy opening can use gold faster than resources.

Growth

Supports:

- long-run income;
- population resilience;
- supplies;
- Blood resistance if Blood Hunting occurs nearby;
- campaigns expected to last.

Magic

Supports:

- Research Points;
- spell performance through the scale's ordinary effects;
- the national plan of reaching several response nodes.

It also affects enemy magic in the same province and may interact with events. It is not an uncontested bonus.

Luck

Interacts with events and the concentration of Astrologer Fortune Tellers. It should be evaluated as part of the whole event policy, not only because the nation uses Astrologers.

Temperature

Choose after checking:

- national preference;
- design points;
- income and supplies;
- expected battlefield effects;
- mod changes.

Sloth

Sloth purchases design points by taxing a roster that contains resource-heavy infantry and sacreds. It is more plausible in an elephant- or magic-heavy design than in one promising massed Hoplites and Heart Companions.

Part IX: Campaign Doctrine

Early game

Objectives

- expand without crippling attrition;
- identify neighbours before contact becomes war;
- begin the second fort and its 300-gold laboratory;
- recruit the first Mystic portfolio;
- retain enough mundane force to deter a rush;
- choose research from observed threats.

Questions each turn

- Which independent class is the next target?
- Is a valuable elephant or commander entering an uncertain battle?
- Does the treasury still meet the fort and laboratory schedule?
- Which Mystic random appeared, and has it been recorded?
- Which neighbour can reach the capital fastest?
- Does the research branch produce a complete package before that attack?

Common early failure

Arcoscephale can spend on everything:

- 190-gold Mystics;
- 270-gold Astrologers;
- 100-gold elephants;
- forts;
- 300-gold labs;
- ordinary armies.

The nation risks buying one of each and completing none of its conversions. A plan should state the current priority:

```
expansion force
or infrastructure
or mage throughput
or emergency defence
```

The other categories receive maintenance, not equal spending.

First war

War aim

The first war should have a positional aim:

- remove a dangerous rush neighbour;
- seize a fort cluster;
- secure a Throne corridor;
- take a high-income or high-gem region;
- shorten the border;
- destroy an exposed mage core.

"Use the research lead" is not a war aim.

Preparation

Record:

- enemy troop defence classes;
- known magic paths and school evidence;
- likely battlefield enchantments;
- routes and retreat provinces;
- fort wall strength and relief distance;
- required gems by battle;
- replacement Mystic production;
- the branch if the first army is countered.

First-war strengths

- heavy infantry can anchor;
- elephants punish unprepared human formations;
- Mystics can tailor several low- and middle-level packages;
- automatic scrying improves defence inside dominion;
- healing preserves expensive survivors;
- Astrologers threaten high Astral.

First-war weaknesses

- most mages are expensive human bodies;
- a large communion risks a national research disaster;
- no normal Death, Air, Glamour, or Blood limits adaptation;
- tramplers have clear morale and MR counters;
- heavy infantry can be bypassed or fatigued;
- the 300-gold lab cost slows replacement infrastructure.

Middle game

The middle game begins when the nation has several forts, multiple Mystic cohorts, and enough research that the opponent must respect several branches.

Objectives

- turn random-mage breadth into repeatable packages;
- establish booster and gem logistics;
- create at least one remote or mobile threat;
- defend the capital Astrologer pipeline;
- convert won battles into forts and labs;
- begin a Throne claim plan.

Portfolio doctrine

Do not send the entire mage corps with one army. Divide it into:

- research reserve;
- main field package;
- counter-raiding cells;
- ritual and forging specialists;
- capital Astral core;
- healing and recovery hubs.

The exact proportions change during war. The distinction prevents the same mage from being promised simultaneously to research, forge, cast a ritual, and fight.

Late game

National late-game strengths

- accumulated Astral;
- communions capable of high battlefield paths;
- broad elemental response;
- strong research if the fort network survived;
- information across friendly dominion;
- healing of valuable commanders;
- access to high-end Astral rituals and battlefield magic.

National late-game limits

- low innate non-Astral path ceilings;
- absent Death, Air, Glamour, and Blood unless bridged;
- mortal human mage core;
- expensive fort and lab replacement;
- capital dependence for Astrologers;
- greater enemy ability to clear dense armies and communions.

Late-game transition

The old army should become one of several shells around the magic:

- protected mass;
- siege and Throne body;
- screen for remote or high-Astral operations;
- distributed defence;
- disposable frontage for summons.

If every late-game battle still depends on unmodified Hoplites and elephants reaching melee, research has not been converted.

Endgame and Thrones

An endgame plan states:

- current Ascension Points;
- claimable Thrones and required priest levels;
- forts and walls on each target;
- enemy relief routes;
- magic-phase threats;
- claim timing;
- the army that survives after the storm;
- the diplomatic response to visible victory progress.

Arcoscephale's H2 Archousa can claim Thrones that require H2. Higher requirements need a prophet, Pretender, hero, or imported priest.

Automatic scrying helps defend claimed territory inside dominion, but the victory turn may depend on simultaneous attacks beyond that information umbrella.

Raiding

Native raiders

Unmodded Arcoscephale is not defined by stealth thugs or flying sacreds. Native options are modest:

- small conventional troop groups;
- chariot or elephant detachments against known weak defence;
- a combat Pretender;
- a geared commander when Construction and target class justify it;
- remote Astral attacks against commanders rather than province capture.

Raiding doctrine

The nation should raid to:

- cut reinforcement routes;
- take laboratories;
- force counters away from the decisive siege;
- break a dominion or temple corridor;
- isolate a fort;
- punish an enemy who concentrated against the main line.

Slow heavy infantry should not chase fast raiders province by province. Scrying, forts, Mystic cells, mobile tramplers, and prediction form the counter-raiding system.

Sieges

The roster supplies many human siege bodies but no automatic siege miracle.

Before besieging:

- calculate whether the army can breach on the required deadline;
- protect the lab and gem route;
- keep enough field power to defeat relief;
- preserve a storming package distinct from wall damage;
- move a claim-capable priest toward any Throne;
- scout every adjacent retreat.

Mystics researching inside a siege army are not free value if a relief battle destroys them.

Diplomacy

Arcoscephale presents two political images.

The visible image is a conventional human kingdom with slow infantry and elephants. The hidden image is a rapidly compounding Astral state capable of communions, remote attacks, and high research.

This creates predictable diplomacy:

- neighbours may seek an early war before the mage network matures;
- others may value Arcoscephale as a stable border or anti-elite partner;
- Mind Hunt and Master Enslave potential can make later coalitions wary;
- scrying makes covert movement inside dominion less reliable;
- broad but shallow paths create useful gem and item trades.

Good diplomacy communicates enough strength to deter without advertising every random and research branch.

Matchup framework

Against heavy armour

Prefer:

- Destruction;
- high-damage or armour-negating magic;
- fatigue;
- elementals;
- a protected line that buys casting time.

Avoid:

- relying on ordinary spear damage alone;
- sending elephants into elite armour without disruption.

Against giants

Prefer:

- Earth Meld and other control;
- Gifts from Heaven or other high-damage effects;
- fatigue and MR pressure;
- enough line depth to prevent immediate mage contact.

Avoid:

- treating trample as the primary answer;
- spending heavily on protection that giant damage easily penetrates without another plan.

Against high-MR elites

Prefer:

- physical control and damage;
- armour destruction;
- fatigue that does not depend on one MR check;
- penetration only when the arithmetic is credible.

Avoid:

- a pure Soul Slay plan without enough attempts and penetration.

Against undead mass

Prefer:

- priest support;
- engine killing;
- morale protection;
- fire, area damage, and fatigue tools appropriate to the exact undead;
- sustained lines that do not exhaust before the summoners.

Avoid:

- counting skeleton kills without measuring mage fatigue and replacement.

Against flyers and attack-rear forces

Prefer:

- rear guards;
- mage bodyguards;
- wider or staggered deployment;
- separated mage cells;
- predictive interception through scrying.

Avoid:

- a single unguarded communion block.

Against glamour and stealth

Prefer:

- dominion scrying;
- Spirit Sight or other current sight tools;
- area effects;
- patrol networks;
- redundant defence.

Avoid:

- assuming a missing army is absent.

Against enemy Astral

Prefer:

- explicit Magic Duel policy;
- non-Astral damage where possible;
- protecting high-S Astrologers;
- decoy and target-priority planning;
- assessing enemy penetration and remote threat.

Avoid:

- exposing irreplaceable high-S casters to cheap duellists without need.

Heroes

The unmodded national hero pool includes:

Hero	Strategic contribution
Anthromachus	Inspirational military leadership
Orokestes, Hierophant	F1A1W1E1S2H2; unique Air and broad cross-path access
Pathos, Son of Titans	Durable inspirational hero with Awe and Invulnerability
Axieros, Kabeiride	W1N3H2, Healing 3, Sailing, recuperation and support abilities

Heroes are opportunities, not foundations. A plan that requires Axieros for N3 or Orokestes for Air has no deadline guarantee unless the hero is already present.

When a hero appears:

1. record the exact paths and abilities in the current version;
2. identify unique items, rituals, or movement unlocked;
3. protect the hero according to replacement impossibility;
4. avoid forcing the hero into a role a repeatable recruit can perform.

Gem economy

The capital produces four Astral pearls and one Nature gem per month.

Astral pearls compete among:

- communions and Power of the Spheres;
- battlefield Astral;
- forging;
- remote magic;
- boosters;
- globals;
- high-end rituals;
- reserve against an unexpected war.

Nature gems compete among:

- support summons;
- boosters;
- national Monster Boar or Hamadryad routes after access exists;

- later globals;
- trades that buy missing Death, Air, or other resources.

An Astral-rich nation can still run out of pearls if every Mystic receives one for every battle. Gem budgets should be assigned by operation, not distributed by habit.

Laboratory and item security

Because labs cost 300 gold and pool gems:

- do not leave the only forward laboratory exposed;
- keep irreplaceable boosters off commanders taking uncertain routes;
- maintain a rear laboratory for recovery;
- transfer operation gems shortly before commitment;
- record item ownership;
- include retreats and laboratory capture in the invasion ledger.

New-player turn checklist

Recruitment

- Is every fort recruiting the commander it needs?
- Was a rare Mystic random identified?
- Is the capital buying an Astrologer for a defined job?
- Can a Hiereia be recruited outside a fort instead?
- Does troop recruitment match local gold and resources?

Research

- What enemy problem does the current school solve?
- Which mage can cast the spell?
- Does the caster need a communion, self-buff, gem, or item?
- Will the army and caster reach the same battle?

Armies

- Are elephants screened?
- Is the rear protected?
- Is the commander safe?
- Are retreat provinces friendly?
- Are slow Hoplites delaying an urgent operation?

Economy

- Is the next fort still affordable?
- Has the 300-gold lab been budgeted?
- Are pearls reserved for the next operation?
- Is a mage promised to both research and fight?

Information

- What is seen by scouts?
- What is seen only by dominion scrying?

- Which report is stale?
- Could the missing force use stealth or magic movement?

Expert turn audit

- Recalculate specialist probabilities against current recruitment.
- Separate native, boosted, bootstrapped, and imported path claims.
- Compare independent casting with communion opportunity cost.
- Check every master/slave path and fatigue relationship.
- Audit post-script spell-selection risk.
- Check Magic Duel exposure.
- Recalculate siege and relief clocks.
- Mark every S4+ Astrologer and rare dual-path asset.
- Protect capital recruitment and laboratory continuity.
- Update Throne claim capacity and simultaneous victory threats.

Part X: Dominions Enhanced 2.16

Scope of the overhaul

Dominions Enhanced 2.16 genuinely overhauls MA Arcoscephale. The changes go well beyond one adjusted cost.

Source-confirmed changes include:

- a rebuilt ordinary troop roster;
- new phalangite and cavalry units;
- a new mounted commander;
- revised Hoplites, Hypaspists, Heart Companions, Archousai, Mystics, and Astrologers;
- paired Heart Companion recruitment at national sites;
- capital Hetairoi;
- a different hero pool and multihero;
- a large national spell and summon suite;
- national items;
- new late-game Titans, nymphs, heroes, and constellation magic.

The strategic identity changes from "broad low-elemental Astral nation with several inaccessible nationals" to "Astral combined arms with a geography-dependent summon ladder capable of opening most missing paths."

Recruitment rewrite

The nation block clears ordinary recruitment and then rebuilds access.

Fort commanders

All listed terrain forts receive:

- Scout;
- Lokhagos;
- Hipparchus;

- Strategos;
- Mystic;
- Archousa;
- Hiereia.

The Hiereia is also added outside forts in plains, forests, mountains, swamps, wastes, farms, and caves.

Capital Astrologer access remains tied to the Tower of a Thousand Stars rather than the rebuilt ordinary fort list.

Ordinary troops

The rebuilt list contains:

- Slinger;
- Peltast;
- Cardaces;
- Hoplite;
- Phalangite;
- Hypaspist;
- Prodromoi;
- Chariot;
- Elephant.

Hetairoi are defined but commented out of the ordinary list. They are instead placed at the Tower of a Thousand Stars. Paired Heart Companions are placed at that site and at the Gymnasium.

Starting army

The mod sets:

- Lokhagos as starting commander;
- Scout as starting scout;
- twenty Peltasts;
- twenty Hoplites.

Revised and new units

Hoplite

Source-confirmed delta:

- Defence 11;
- effective gold setting 11 in the mod source;
- new sprites.

Compared with the unmodded 13-gold Defence-9 Hoplite, this is a substantial efficiency and survival improvement.

Hypaspist

Source-confirmed delta:

- Attack 12;

- Defence 13;
- Combat Speed 14;
- effective gold setting 12.

The source contains two consecutive Defence assignments, 11 then 13; the later value controls. The unit becomes a faster and cheaper elite line rather than merely the flexible alternative to a Hoplite.

Phalangite, unit 9316

The new MA Phalangite:

- uses half plate, Hoplite helmet, and buckler;
- wields a Sarissa;
- has HP 11, Strength 11, Attack 12, Defence 12;
- costs 16 recruitment points;
- uses the source's effective 13-gold setting.

The long Sarissa and lighter armour define a more offensive formation unit than the old Hoplite.

Prodromoi, unit 9317

The Prodromoi are light cavalry:

- Xyston, broad sword, and javelin;
- ring-mail hauberk, half helmet, and buckler;
- Skilled Rider 3;
- leather-barding horse;
- HP 11, Attack 11, Defence 11, Morale 12;
- 13 recruitment points;
- effective 10-gold setting.

They add cheap mobile flank and skirmish pressure that vanilla MA Arcoscephale lacks.

Hetairoi, unit 9318

The Hetairoi are capital-site heavy cavalry:

- half plate, half helmet, and buckler;
- Xyston, broad sword, and javelin;
- Skilled Rider 5;
- light scale-barding horse;
- HP 13, Strength 12, Attack 12, Defence 12, Morale 12.

Their cost and recruitment values are inherited from the copied Agema Companion because the proposed explicit overrides are commented out. The exact final in-game card remains a combined-object verification item.

Hipparchus, unit 9319

The Hipparchus is the matching cavalry commander:

- same main equipment family as the Hetairoi;
- Skilled Rider 6;
- light scale-barding horse;
- HP 13, Attack 12, Defence 12, Morale 12;
- inherited leadership and costs from the Agema Commander.

The final inherited values should be captured from the live modded unit card before publication of a numeric quick-reference.

Heart Companions in pairs

Unit 9322 represents paired recruitment:

- source cost 50 gold;
- recruitment-point cost 46;
- resource cost 28;
- Plate Hauberk, Hoplite Helmet, Buckler, Sarissa;
- Morale 14, Strength 12, Attack 12;
- description explicitly states that two are recruited at once.

Seasonal shapes and nation events convert the paired representation into two ordinary Heart Companions. The ordinary Heart Companion is also rewritten with the same equipment family and improved Morale, Strength, and Attack.

This changes sacred economics:

- the recruitment purchase is indivisible;
- the effective body cost is nominally half the pair cost;
- capital and Gymnasium access matters;
- bless value must be recalculated against two-at-a-time production;
- the transformation/event timing should be reproduced before assuming both bodies are immediately available in every interface.

Archousa

The Archousa becomes:

- N2 rather than N1;
- 265 gold rather than 235.

This single path increase is strategically central. It turns high Nature from a hero-dependent hope into a booster and summon-ladder project.

Mystic

The Mystic gains Poor Magic Leadership.

The magic random structure is not cleared or rewritten in the inspected source, so the unmodded path distribution remains unless another loaded layer changes it. Poor Magic Leadership matters when summoned magic beings are moved with Mystic armies.

Astrologer

The Astrologer gains permission to use restricted-item group 10, enabling the national Zodiac item. The base path structure is not rewritten in the inspected source.

Site recruitment

Tower of a Thousand Stars

Dominions Enhanced clears and rewrites the site:

- 4 Astral pearls per month;
- 1 Nature gem per month;
- Astrologer as home commander;
- paired Heart Companions;
- Hetairoi.

Gymnasium

The Gymnasium is rewritten to provide paired Heart Companions.

This creates two sacred-production cases:

- capital production from the Tower;
- any obtained Gymnasium site.

The frequency and map availability of Gymnasia are not a guaranteed national resource and should not be assumed at Pretender design.

Hero rewrite

The MA national hero line becomes:

- Aleksandros, the Conqueror;
- Orokestes;
- Pathos;
- Axieros;
- Muse as multihero.

Aleksandros

Aleksandros replaces Anthromachus in the era's primary hero slot. The source defines:

- mounted movement;
- Awe and Fear;
- Inspirational 2;
- high leadership;
- sacred status;
- enchanted equipment;
- events that rally local population types when he is present.

The rally events can generate troops and commanders from horse tribes, Raptorians, several Amazon types, elephant populations, Atavi, and other local groups. These are opportunity effects dependent on both the hero and province population type.

Muses

Muses are repeatable multiheroes with:

- Glamour 3;
- two random picks from a Fire/Air/Astral/Nature mask in the source;
- Awe, stealth, seduction, Inspirational 2, and Inspiring Research 1;
- sacred and magic-being status.

They can open valuable paths, but hero arrival remains non-deterministic. A deadline-safe plan cannot require a Muse.

Adventurers and Divine Heroes

The nation receives future-site pools for:

- adventurer heroes;
- Divine Heroes;
- ordinary national heroes;
- a broad summon catalogue.

These pools support national spells. They are not ordinary recruits.

National spell suite

The source-confirmed DE suite is grouped below by strategic function. Fields inherited through `#copyspell` should be checked on the final in-game spell card; explicit overridden values are reliable source claims.

Immediate and battlefield magic

Spell	Research	Explicit requirement	Cost	Effect
Zodiac Cascades	0	S1	0	Modified Stellar Cascades, AoE 3, Precision +5; unavailable in caves
Light of the Aries Constellation	4	S4F1	Inherits Northern Star cost	Fire +1 and Astral +1 to eligible casters; Fire Resistance 5 to battlefield
Light of the Cetus Constellation	5	S4W1	Inherits Northern Star cost	Astral +1; battlefield speed -25%, +3 encumbrance, d4 fatigue per square moved
Light of the Taurus Constellation	6	S4E1	Inherits Northern Star cost	Earth +1, Astral +1, Reinvigoration 4
Dissolve into Atoms	7	Inherits Soul Slay path	20 fatigue	AoE 1, MR negates, soul slay; ethereal targets are harder to affect
Light of the Libra Constellation	7	S6	Inherits Northern Star cost	Spirit Sight to battlefield and Astral +1
Summon Daimones	7	S4	3 pearls	Twelve sacred ethereal Daimones; secondary effect gives Luck to 25% of friendly soldiers

The four constellation lights are mutually incompatible with each other and with an Arcoscephalian Light of the Northern Star. They are a strategic choice, not cumulative path stacking.

Astral economy and events

Spell	Research	Requirement	Cost	Effect
Power of the Zodiac	5	Inherited from Stellar Focus	25 pearls	Produces five Astral pearls per month; attempts to override Stellar Focus; not in caves

Spell	Research	Requirement	Cost	Effect
Call to Adventure	Thaumaturgy 4	S4	15 pearls	Summons a band drawn from the national adventurer montage
Baleful Conjunction	Inherits Baleful Star	Inherited	4 pearls	Mountain cast; +30 unrest, Misfortune +3, 10% of units cursed through event
Beneficent Conjunction	Inherits Baleful Star	Inherited	4 pearls	Mountain cast; -30 unrest, Luck +3, 10% tax boost through event
Cursed Omen	6	Inherited	5 pearls	Mountain cast; event intended to curse half the target army

Event-based ritual outcomes and temporary scale duration should be reproduced under the combined mods.

Nature and elemental summon ladder

Summon	Research	Requirement	Cost	Geography	Summoned magic
Contact Karyatid	4	N3	20 Nature	Forest	N3 in forest, N2 outside
Contact Oceanid	5	W3	25 Water	Not restricted in shown block	W3 plus three random picks from A/E/D/N/G
Contact Oreiad	6	N4	30 Nature	Mountain or border mountain	N3A2E1
Contact Eleionomae	6	W3	35 Water	Swamp	W3D2A1
Contact Nephelae	7	W3A1	30 Water	Not caves	A3W3
Daughter of the Evening	8	S4	38 pearls	Ordinary land conditions	S3A2, immortal
Summon Boread	8	A3W2	45 Air	Ordinary valid province	Winged giant commander

This is the heart of the overhaul. Geography becomes magic access.

Unique and late summons

Summon	Research	Requirement	Cost	Notes
The Guardian of Hades	Conjuration 6	D4	20 Death	Unique Kerberos
Summon Divine Hero	Conjuration 7	S5	40 pearls	One Divine Hero from national pool
Titan of War & Wisdom	Conjuration 8	S4E2	40 pearls	Unique Athena
Titan of the Seas	Conjuration 8	W4E2	40 Water	Underwater only; unique Poseidon
Titan of the Underworld	Conjuration 8	D5	40 Death	Unique Hades
The Scourge of the Deeps	Conjuration 9	W5N3	60 Water	Underwater only; unique Cetus

Other national summons

- Headless Men: N2, seven Nature gems, ten-plus Blemmyes; the school and research level are inherited from Summon Ogres.
- Sow Dragon Teeth and the unmodded Arcoscephalian national rituals remain relevant unless specifically overwritten elsewhere.

- The future-site lists also identify Spartae, Blemmyes, Lampads, Hound of Twilight, Keres, Keledone, Khalkotauros, Daimones, nymph commanders, Kerberos, and the three Titans as national summon products.

National items

Bag of Dragons Teeth

Source-confirmed:

- Construction 5;
- Earth level 2 through the copied Earth item;
- reduced item cost;
- summons three Spartae at battle start;
- grants one point of magic leadership;
- restricted to a group of appropriate nations including MA Arcoscephale.

It converts an E2 forge turn and Earth gems into a repeatable battlefield screen or reinforcement. The exact inherited base cost should be read from the final item card.

Horoskopos

Source-confirmed:

- S2;
- cursed and not normally forgeable/found in the ordinary way;
- Luck;
- Morale +2;
- Inspirational 1;
- effects apply to the mount where relevant.

Its acquisition route is not established by the inspected item block. It should not be included in a routine forge plan until reproduced.

Zodiac

Source-confirmed:

- Construction 5;
- S2;
- Astrologer-restricted item group;
- 50 points of bad-event prevention;
- Twist Fate;
- effects extend to mount.

The mod explicitly authorises Astrologers to use its restricted group. This turns selected Astrologers into provincial event-control assets without changing their magic.

DE access ladders

Reliable Nature-to-Air ladder

1. Recruit an N2 Archousa.
2. Obtain a named Nature booster to N3.

3. Cast Contact Karyatid in a forest.
4. Use the N3 Karyatid in forest, with a booster to N4 if required.
5. Cast Contact Oreiad on a mountain.
6. Receive an N3A2E1 Oreiad.
7. Use Air boosters, empowerment, or another summon to reach higher Air.

Every step requires the relevant research, gems, item, and geography. The ladder is powerful because it is reproducible; it is not instantaneous.

Water-to-Death ladder

1. Preserve a W2 Mystic.
2. Add a named Water booster to reach W3 for ritual casting.
3. Cast Contact Eleionomae in a swamp.
4. Receive W3D2A1.
5. Use Death boosters, empowerment, or further summons to reach D4.
6. Cast The Guardian of Hades or other Death nationals.

Contact Oceanid is an alternate W3 route with random Death, Glamour, Nature, Air, or Earth outcomes. Because the Oceanid randoms are variable, it is a portfolio rather than deadline guarantee.

Astral-to-Air ladder

1. Recruit an S4 Astrologer or boost S3.
2. At Conjuration 8, cast Daughter of the Evening.
3. Receive an immortal S3A2 commander.
4. Use Air boosters or combine with Water access.
5. Reach A3W2 for Summon Boread or other Air operations.

Constellation ladder

Astrologer randoms can naturally provide:

- S4F1 for Aries;
- S4W1 for Cetus;
- S4E1 for Taurus.

Because the fixed and rare randoms interact, exact probabilities should be computed from the current Astrologer distribution and verified after the mod is loaded. S6 for Libra requires boosters or another high-Astral route.

DE research priorities

The mod creates two new trunks.

Constellation trunk

- immediate Zodiac Cascades provides an early fatigue tool;
- Conjuration 4 gives the ordinary Northern Star and the research neighbourhood for Aries if the copied school remains;
- levels 5-7 progressively add Cetus, Taurus, and Libra;
- the chosen constellation must fit the army and enemy because only one light can operate.

Nymph trunk

- level 4 Karyatid begins the Nature ladder;
- level 5 Oceanid begins the Water-random ladder;
- level 6 Oreiad and Eleionomae open Air and Death;
- level 7 Nephelae and Divine Heroes expand force;
- level 8 Daughter of Evening and Titans establish late magic.

The best branch depends on gems and terrain. Researching Contact Oreiad without an N4 caster and a mountain produces no immediate capacity.

DE army identity

The new roster supports a more mobile combined-arms formation:

- cheaper improved Hoplites;
- fast Hypaspists;
- offensive Phalangites;
- cheap Prodromoi;
- capital Hetairoi;
- paired sacreds;
- elephants and chariots;
- constellation-enhanced Mystics.

The nation can now create:

- a mobile Map Move 16 cavalry and infantry wing;
- a slower sacred or Hoplite core;
- Astral fatigue operations;
- nature-spirit and elemental commander support;
- late unique-summon armies.

Mixed movement must still be audited. One slow unit can reduce the route of an otherwise mobile force.

Part XI: Divinitus 1.15.3 DE and the Grand Hierophant

Layer boundary

Divinitus does not rewrite MA Arcoscephale's ordinary national roster in the inspected source. It rewrites Pretenders and adds event-driven powers.

The relevant national interaction is:

```
Dominions Enhanced national overhaul
+ Divinitus Pretender choice
= combined MA Arcoscephale
```

The strongest documented interaction is the Grand Hierophant, monster 3053.

Combined object inheritance

Dominions Enhanced first rewrites the Grand Hierophant with:

- S2;
- path cost 20;
- base Pretender cost 30;
- HP 10, MR 18, and human item slots;
- 50 points of bad-event prevention;
- Disease Resistance 100.

Divinitus loads afterward and sets:

- base Pretender cost 150;
- all known non-priest magic paths +1 through `#magicboost 53 1`;
- bad-event prevention 75;
- Disease Resistance 100;
- the anointing, teaching, and site-search description and events.

Because Divinitus does not clear magic or reset the path cost in this block, the earlier DE S2 and path-cost values remain in the combined object unless another later command changes them. This is a load-order conclusion and should be confirmed in the Pretender screen.

Paths known +1

The Grand Hierophant adds one effective level to known non-priest paths.

Strategic consequences:

- purchased path thresholds may be one level easier;
- battlefield and ritual access must be calculated from effective, not merely purchased, paths;
- bless path requirements and design costs must still use the Pretender interface's actual rules;
- path loss, transformation, and boosters require live verification.

The phrase does not mean the Pretender knows every path. It boosts paths that are known.

Mystic anointing

The source event:

- requires the Grand Hierophant as god;
- targets a Mystic or Erytheian Mystic;
- requires a temple;
- adds Holy;
- transforms the target into monster 382, the Mystic Prophet;
- is hidden from the event log.

The mod description states that one Mystic at a temple is anointed each month, becoming H1 and sacred.

Strategic uses

Anointed Mystics can potentially provide:

- sacred researchers;
- H1 communion participants;

- temple builders and preachers;
- bless access in battle;
- priest support without Archousa recruitment;
- targets for the teaching event.

Operational requirement

Maintain:

- at least one eligible Mystic in a temple province;
- enough temple coverage to place trainees without disrupting the front;
- a record of which Mystic random is being transformed;
- a protected training hub.

Test pending

The exact preservation of:

- random magic paths;
- experience;
- items;
- age;
- orders;
- recruitment identity;
- prophet interactions

must be reproduced through the transformation.

Teaching deeper mysteries

The source event for Mystic Prophets:

- requires the Grand Hierophant in the same province;
- requires positive dominion;
- uses `#req_domchance 5`;
- checks the target's Astral threshold through `#req_targnopath3 4`;
- adds +1 Fire, Water, Earth, and Astral simultaneously.

The description expresses this as candles times 5% chance and a maximum of three.

Probability

If `#req_domchance 5` behaves as described, the monthly success chance at c friendly candles is:

$$p = 0.05c$$

Candles	Monthly chance
1	5%
3	15%
5	25%
7	35%
10	50%

The probability of at least one success after n eligible months is:

$$1-(1-0.05c)^n$$

At five candles, six eligible months give:

$$1-0.75^6 \approx 82.2\%$$

Path consequence

One success turns a typical Mystic Prophet into a much broader caster. Repeated success can create:

- multi-element communion masters;
- ritual cross-paths otherwise impossible in vanilla;
- high independent casters;
- forgers who compress several national roles.

Source discrepancy

The prose says paths rise to a maximum of three. The event block visibly gates on an Astral-path condition and then boosts all four paths. A Mystic beginning at F2S1 could, under a literal reading of the commands, receive two successful boosts before Astral reaches three, potentially producing F4.

This is not asserted as engine behaviour. It is a high-priority controlled test because:

- command semantics may cap the other paths;
- transformation may alter the starting paths;
- the event requirement may behave differently from the literal reading;
- another hidden engine rule may enforce the prose maximum.

Until tested, the public doctrine uses the stated cap of three and records elemental over-cap as test pending.

Site-search treasure

The source event:

- requires the Grand Hierophant;
- requires the Site Searching order on land;
- requires positive dominion;
- uses candles times 5% chance;
- grants 150 gold;
- grants 1d6 of each elemental gem.

"Elemental" means Fire, Air, Water, and Earth in the mod description.

Conditional value

On success, expected gem gain is:

$$4 \times E(1d6) = 4 \times 3.5 = 14$$

At c candles, ignoring caps or event interactions, expected monthly value is:

$$E(\text{gold}) = 150(0.05c)=7.5c$$

$$E(\text{total elemental gems}) = 14(0.05c)=0.7c$$

Candles	Expected gold / search month	Expected total elemental gems / search month
1	7.5	0.7
3	22.5	2.1
5	37.5	3.5
7	52.5	4.9
10	75	7

These are expected values, not guaranteed yields.

Opportunity cost

The Grand Hierophant's search month could instead be:

- researching;
- forging;
- casting a ritual;
- moving;
- joining a battle;
- teaching at a different hub;
- preaching or performing another Pretender task.

Site searching is attractive when:

- friendly dominion is high;
- unsearched provinces remain;
- elemental gems unlock immediate DE summon or battle packages;
- the Pretender is not needed on the front.

It is unattractive when the expected treasure does not beat the deadline value of another order.

Training-hub doctrine

A Grand Hierophant training province should contain:

- temple;
- laboratory;
- strong friendly dominion;
- eligible Mystic Prophet;
- guards and fortification;
- no unnecessary exposed gem stock;
- access to the front through a safe route.

The hub converts time into exceptional mages. It also concentrates the Pretender and valuable Mystics into an obvious remote and conventional target.

Security includes:

- dome consideration;
- patrols;
- scouts on adjacent provinces;
- reserve troops;
- an evacuation route;
- alternate laboratories;
- avoiding the capital if that creates one catastrophic target.

Grand Hierophant strategic families

Research-and-training family

Prioritises:

- high Magic scale;
- early Mystic production;
- temple network;
- protected training hub;
- ritual paths that trained Mystics can complement.

Risk:

- too much stationary investment;
- delayed first-war force;
- Pretender time consumed by teaching and searching.

Elemental-treasure family

Prioritises:

- high dominion candles;
- systematic site searching;
- DE elemental summon ladder;
- rapid conversion of found gems.

Risk:

- expected-value variance;
- Pretender absent from critical operations;
- gathering gems without research or casters to spend them.

Battlefield-hierophant family

Prioritises:

- combat paths and survivability;
- trained Mystics as battlefield masters;
- healing support;
- an awakening timed for war.

Risk:

- sacrificing the mod's unique economic and training effects;
- exposing the central Pretender and training engine.

Ritual-platform family

Prioritises:

- paths missing after accounting for DE summon ladders;
- legendary ritual thresholds;
- booster and forge plan;
- imprisoned or dormant timing if the recruitable state can survive.

Risk:

- paying for paths the DE nymph ladder would have supplied more cheaply;
- planning rituals before the gem economy exists.

Part XII: Combined-Mod Strategy

What the combined ruleset changes

The combined nation has three compounding engines:

1. cheaper and broader combined-arms recruitment;
2. DE's national constellation and nymph summon ladder;
3. Divinitus Grand Hierophant training and treasure.

This creates exceptional upside but also severe attention demands.

The player must track:

- Mystic randoms;
- anointed status;
- training history;
- geography for summons;
- national spell research;
- constellation compatibility;
- multiple gem colours;
- hero and unique availability;
- ordinary fronts and Thrones.

Combined opening priorities

A coherent opening selects one primary engine.

Military opening

- use improved Hoplites, Hypaspists, Phalangites, cavalry, and elephants;
- build forts;
- keep Grand Hierophant support secondary until borders stabilise.

Mystic training opening

- prioritise temple and Mystic production;
- accept a slower mundane expansion only if tests prove it;
- protect the training centre;
- research spells that make the first enhanced Mystics immediately useful.

Summon-ladder opening

- secure forest, mountain, and swamp provinces;
- reach the relevant Conjuration levels;
- preserve N2 and W2 specialists;
- use Grand Hierophant treasure to finance elemental bottlenecks.

Attempting all three at maximum speed is likely to produce too few troops, too few forts, and half-completed research.

Combined magic compression

A trained Mystic can receive simultaneous F/W/E/S growth. DE then offers:

- constellation spells requiring S plus an element;
- elemental and Nature summons;
- national items;
- high Astral hero and Titan rituals.

This compresses jobs that would otherwise require several masters.

Potential trained roles include:

- S4F1 Aries caster;
- S4W1 Cetus caster;
- S4E1 Taurus caster;
- E2S2 Keledone ritual caster;
- F3E3 Brass Bull caster;
- W3 ritual caster for Oceanid or Eleionomae;
- broad independent Power of the Spheres caster.

Each role must be checked against:

- actual post-training paths;
- ritual versus battle restrictions;
- boosters;
- research;
- gem stock;
- whether using the mage consumes an irreplaceable training product.

Combined path priorities

The Pretender should avoid buying paths that the nation can obtain reliably and cheaply through DE unless timing justifies them.

More valuable Pretender paths

- paths required before summon ladders mature;
- paths that unlock national rituals with no cheap bridge;
- paths supporting an awake expansion role;
- paths needed for a specific global or legendary ritual;
- paths that improve blesses used by a meaningful sacred roster.

Less valuable redundant purchases

- high Nature bought solely to reach N3 when N2 Archousai plus a booster can begin the ladder;
- high Air bought solely for eventual access when Oreiads and Daughters can supply it in time;
- broad elements bought without a ritual, battlefield, bless, or forging job.

Redundancy can still be worth paying for when it removes a deadline or geography dependency.

Combined counter surfaces

The combined nation can be attacked through:

- temple and training-hub destruction;
- capital pressure against Astrologers and unique site troops;
- raids on forests, mountains, and swamps required for summons;
- gem denial;
- assassination of trained Mystics;
- communion clears;
- anti-Astral Magic Duel tactics;
- resistance to the chosen constellation;
- simultaneous fronts that overload attention.

The correct defence is not a larger single army. It is redundancy across:

- temples;
- labs;
- trained casters;
- access routes;
- gem stores;
- battlefield packages.

Part XIII: Controlled Tests

Test standard

Every test record should include:

- Dominions version;
- mod names, versions, and load order;
- game settings;
- nation and Pretender;
- turn and province;
- relevant units, paths, items, gems, and scripts;
- expected result;
- observed result;
- replay or save identifier;
- whether the result was repeated;
- conclusion and confidence.

Change one major variable at a time.

Test 1: Mystic random distribution

Question: Does the current unmodded and modded Mystic use the documented guaranteed FWES roll plus independent 50% F/W/E rolls?

Method:

1. Recruit at least 128 Mystics under unmodded 6.35.
2. Record exact F/W/E/S paths.
3. Compare F2, W2, E2, and S2 frequencies with 12.5%, 12.5%, 12.5%, and 25%.

4. Confirm no E2S2 or double-elemental-2 result appears.
5. Repeat with DE 2.16.
6. Repeat with both mods.

Purpose: detect current-data or mod inheritance errors, not prove random fairness from a small sample.

Test 2: Astrologer rare random

Question: Does the 10% extra random operate independently and can it produce S5 or an elemental level 2?

Method:

1. Recruit a large Astrologer sample in a debug or long test.
2. Record S3/S4/S5 and elemental results.
3. Compare with the derived 73.125%, 26.25%, and 0.625% Astral distribution.
4. Repeat under DE.

Test 3: Starting-army expansion

Question: Which independent classes can the starting twenty Peltasts and twenty Hoplites defeat with acceptable losses?

Method:

1. Use fixed settings and no combat Pretender.
2. Test ordinary infantry, barbarians, heavy cavalry, crossbows, and heavy infantry.
3. Vary only formation and orders.
4. Record body losses, commander safety, battle duration, and next-turn readiness.

Test 4: Elephant package sizing

Question: How many elephants and screening bodies produce reliable expansion under the chosen independent strength?

Method:

1. Test several small counts rather than one large army.
2. Use identical target classes.
3. Record routs, friendly trample, elephant wounds, and economic replacement.
4. Compare screen types.
5. Repeat under DE because ordinary troop performance changes.

Test 5: Chariot versus elephant

Question: Against which targets does the cheaper chariot produce a better gold and attrition result than the elephant?

Method:

- compare equal gold values;
- test light infantry, archers, heavy infantry, and large units;
- record total package survival, not only mounts.

Test 6: Hoplite versus Hypaspist

Question: When do three extra Protection points outperform Defence, Morale, movement, and lower resources?

Method:

- equal gold;
- equal resources;
- equal frontage;
- low-damage swarm;
- high-damage infantry;
- giants;
- armour-destruction support;
- long fatigue battle.

Repeat under vanilla and DE, where both units change materially.

Test 7: Formation density

Question: How do formation fighters perform under area damage and frontage pressure?

Method:

- dense versus ordinary formation;
- equal troop count;
- melee-only opponent;
- area evocation opponent;
- fatigue-cloud opponent;
- trample opponent.

Record contact timing, attacks delivered, casualties by square, and rout timing.

Test 8: Independent casting versus communion

Question: At what battle size does a communion outperform the same number of independent Mystics?

Method:

1. Select a single enemy army and research level.
2. Test eight independent Mystics.
3. Test four slaves and four masters.
4. Test six slaves and two masters.
5. Equalise gems.
6. Record useful casts, fatigue, slave wounds, enemy kills, and mage survival.

Test 9: Communion collapse

Question: Which master scripts overload two-, four-, and eight-slave communions?

Method:

- record each master path before and after communion;
- use exact five-spell scripts;

- test battle lengths beyond the script;
- remove one slave through controlled damage;
- observe threshold loss and fatigue cascade.

Test 10: Shared self-buffs

Question: Which Mystic master self-buffs are shared with slaves and how do they change fatigue relationships?

Method:

- Power of the Spheres;
- Phoenix Power;
- Summon Earthpower;
- personal resistance and protection spells;
- compare slave effective paths and fatigue before and after.

Test 11: Magic Duel policy

Question: How does enemy low-S duel pressure affect S2 Mystics and S3-S5 Astrologers?

Method:

- one opposing duellist per target class;
- repeated trials;
- record deaths and surviving caster value;
- compare independent deployment and communion.

Test 12: Mind Hunt and healing

Question: How valuable is national healing after failed or detected Mind Hunts?

Method:

- S4 Astrologer against provinces with and without enemy Astral;
- record feeblemind, death, and other outcomes;
- move survivors to Hiereia and Archousa provinces;
- record recovery time and failures.

Test 13: Scrying and glamour

Question: What exact information does automatic dominion scrying reveal in 6.35?

Method:

- ordinary army;
- glamoured units;
- stealth units;
- hidden commander;
- fort construction;
- adjacent and same-province dominion states;
- disciple partner view.

Compare with scout, spy, and ritual scrying reports.

Test 14: Hiereia outside-fort recruitment

Question: Which province types and structures allow Hiereia recruitment under vanilla and DE?

Method:

- every land terrain;
- with and without fort;
- with and without lab;
- with and without temple;
- record recruitment interface and requirements.

Test 15: Healing allocation

Question: How are Healing 1 and Healing 3 attempts allocated among multiple afflicted units?

Method:

- identical afflicted units;
- mixed affliction severity;
- ordinary, sacred, mounted, magic-being, undead, and inanimate cases;
- repeat over enough months to distinguish impossibility from variance.

Test 16: DE paired Heart Companions

Question: When and how does one 9322 recruitment become two unit-747 Heart Companions?

Method:

- recruit at Tower and Gymnasium;
- observe recruitment queue, arrival, seasonal shape, event timing, upkeep, experience, and squad assignment;
- verify whether both bodies receive bless and equipment changes;
- test losses before and after transformation.

Test 17: DE inherited unit cards

Question: What are the final costs and inherited attributes of Hetairoi, Hipparchus, and other copied objects?

Method:

- capture full live unit cards;
- compare with copied vanilla source object;
- record every explicit override;
- verify rider and mount separately.

Test 18: DE constellation exclusivity

Question: How do Aries, Cetus, Taurus, Libra, and Light of the Northern Star replace or block each other?

Method:

- cast each alone;

- cast two in both orders;
- use opposing Arcoscephalian casters;
- inspect path boosts, battlefield effects, duration, and message log.

Test 19: DE summon geography

Question: Which terrain flags satisfy forest, swamp, mountain, border mountain, cave, and underwater restrictions?

Method:

- test every nymph ritual in each plausible terrain combination;
- test forted and unforted provinces;
- test alternate planes;
- record ritual availability before spending gems.

Test 20: Oceanid randoms

Question: Does `#custommagic 29952 300` produce three independent picks from Air, Earth, Death, Nature, and Glamour as expected?

Method:

- summon a statistically useful sample;
- record duplicates and maxima;
- compare access probabilities;
- identify deadline-safe and portfolio-only outcomes.

Test 21: Grand Hierophant inheritance

Question: Under DE then Divinitus, what are the final S path, path cost, base cost, item slots, bad-event prevention, and magic boost?

Method:

- inspect the Pretender selection screen;
- buy one level in several paths;
- create the Pretender;
- compare design display and in-game unit card;
- reverse the load order in a separate test to demonstrate why the supported order matters.

Test 22: Mystic anointing

Question: Is an eligible Mystic anointed every month, and what survives transformation?

Method:

- one target at a temple;
- several targets at one temple;
- targets at several temples;
- no target;
- target carrying items;
- target with experience and a rare random;
- record selection, timing, and preserved attributes.

Test 23: Grand Hierophant teaching cap

Question: Can an elemental path exceed three when an S1 Mystic begins with F2, W2, or E2?

Method:

1. Anoint a known F2S1 Mystic.
2. Place it with the Grand Hierophant in high dominion.
3. Repeat until two training successes or the event stops.
4. Record F and S after each success.
5. Repeat with S2 and ordinary elemental starting paths.

This directly resolves the prose-versus-event ambiguity.

Test 24: Site-search treasure

Question: Does the event chance equal candles times 5%, and does `1d6vis 51` grant one separate d6 of F/A/W/E?

Method:

- repeat searches at several candle values;
- record ordinary discovered sites separately;
- record event gold and each gem colour;
- compare success frequencies and conditional dice distribution;
- test provinces already fully searched.

Test 25: Combined trained caster roles

Question: Which trained Mystic thresholds can be reached before a realistic first or second war?

Method:

- run full turn-20 and turn-30 economies;
- include temples, forts, labs, research, troop recruitment, and Pretender orders;
- record number and quality of trained Mystics;
- field one complete constellation or ritual package;
- compare against a military-first opening.

Part XIV: Essays

Essay I: The Nation Dossier as a Reproducible Argument

A nation guide is an argument about conversion. It begins with rules, claims that certain capacities follow, and recommends decisions intended to turn those capacities into victory. Like any argument, it can fail because a premise is false, a step is missing, or the conclusion exceeds the evidence.

The most common false premise is stale data. A guide remembers a gold cost, random path, spell level, or bless from another patch or another age. The prose may remain persuasive because the strategic vocabulary still sounds familiar. Yet the actual nation now recruits a different unit, pays a different opportunity cost, or cannot reach the claimed path. Version labels are not editorial decoration. They define the object being discussed.

The most common missing step is access. A national ritual is listed, so the writer says the nation can cast it. A mage reaches one of its paths, so the other path is assumed to appear through "boosters." A communion reaches a battlefield threshold, so the same elevated mage is imagined casting a ritual next month. These statements collapse distinct systems. Rituals do not ordinarily borrow battlefield communion levels. Boosters require research, paths, gems, item slots, and forge turns. A hero may never arrive. A summon may require terrain the nation does not own.

The most common excessive conclusion is the universal build. A design succeeds on one map against one field and becomes "best." But an awake expander, imprisoned scales build, and ritual platform purchase time in different currencies. One survives a rush, one compounds behind space, and one accesses effects after research. None can be evaluated without the expected deadline.

A reproducible dossier exposes every bridge. It says which unit casts the spell, which random produces the unit, how likely the random is, which item supplies the missing level, when the item can be forged, where the army assembles, which gem carrier accompanies it, and what happens if the opponent presents another defence.

This precision does not eliminate judgment. It improves judgment by showing where it enters. "The manual gives the Hoplite Protection 18" is a rule claim. "Hoplites are preferable to Hypaspists here" is doctrine based on enemy damage, resources, movement, and morale. Another player can disagree with the choice while accepting the data. That is productive disagreement.

Tests complete the argument. Expansion claims are played to turn 12 with real infrastructure. Communion scripts are allowed to continue after the fifth spell. Random distributions are sampled. Modded objects are read after load order. A battle replay is not used merely to announce victory; it is used to see contact timing, target selection, fatigue, and the first point of failure.

The finished dossier is neither a recipe nor a plain encyclopaedia entry. It connects verified facts to conditional plans, with a method for correcting each one when the situation changes.

Essay II: Arcoscephale and the Conversion of Knowledge

Arcoscephale's most distinctive resource is not Astral pearls or heavy infantry. It is the ability to turn information into tailored force.

Automatic scrying inside dominion gives the kingdom unusually good reports where it is politically strongest. Mystics then provide a probabilistic library of Fire, Water, Earth, and Astral tools. Astrologers deepen Astral. The combination invites a particular form of play: observe the approaching force, classify its defences, and assemble the appropriate package.

This promise is easy to exaggerate. Seeing an army does not defeat it. A report can reveal heavy infantry, but the E2 Mystic needed for Destruction may be in another laboratory. The research may be one level short. The Earth gems may be carried by a commander marching elsewhere. The only road may be blocked. Knowledge has strategic value only when the state can deliver the response before the deadline.

This is why fort distribution matters. Each fort supplies Research Points, another draw from the Mystic distribution, and another place from which a response cell can move. A larger mage portfolio reduces variance. A distributed laboratory network reduces distance. A gem reserve cuts preparation time. Scouts beyond dominion extend the warning horizon.

The same system explains the danger of losing a field army. An Arcoscephalian army often carries years of stored options: rare randoms, Astral pearls, boosters, and communion slaves that were also researchers. When destroyed, the loss is not measured only in battlefield gold. The nation loses response branches. An opponent who kills the E2 and S4 specialists may invalidate spells that remain fully researched.

Knowledge also has diplomatic value. Accurate reports discourage weak raids and reveal concentration. They allow credible warnings to allies and more reliable estimates of whether a neighbour is honouring a border. Yet information can make a player overconfident. Scrying inside dominion creates a sharp boundary: the interior feels visible, the exterior does not. Stealth, magic movement, and remote attacks exploit that comfort.

A mature Arcoscephalian state treats information as a chain:

```
report
-> classification
-> response choice
-> caster and gem assignment
-> movement
-> battle evidence
-> revised classification
```

The final step matters. A report predicts. A battle replay teaches. The nation that learns faster eventually needs fewer mages and gems to solve the same problem.

Essay III: Mystics, Probability, and Doctrine

The Mystic appears broad because any recruit can display several paths. The strategic reality is more exact. Every Mystic begins with S1, gains one guaranteed roll among Fire, Water, Earth, and Astral, then receives separate fifty-percent chances in each element. This creates abundance and constraint at the same time.

The abundance is obvious. Five of eight Mystics know any named element. More than one in five know all three. Every one can participate in an Astral communion. Several forts quickly produce a catalogue of point buffs, self-buffs, evocations, control spells, and forging cross-paths.

The constraint lies in doubled paths. F2, W2, and E2 each appear only one time in eight. E2S2 cannot occur naturally because the same guaranteed roll would have to be both Earth and Astral. Two elements cannot both reach level two on the same recruit. A strategy that remembers only the broad catalogue will eventually promise an impossible mage.

Probability changes recruitment doctrine. A one-in-eight result has an expected waiting time of eight recruits, but expectation is not a delivery date. After eight recruits there remains more than a one-third chance that no such specialist has appeared. A state that needs E2 for the first war must recruit from several forts, maintain an alternate branch, or use another access route.

Probability also changes the meaning of an individual mage. An F2 Mystic is more than a stronger F1. It is one of the nation's limited natural bridges to Phoenix Power, high Fire evocation, and particular forging paths. Assigning it as a communion slave may be correct, but the decision should be deliberate. The same body can serve as a researcher, master, ritual candidate, or battlefield caster, and those roles compete.

This competition explains why communions should be designed from spell packages rather than habit. Four slaves can raise a common F1 master to F3, but those four slaves could also have cast four independent Astral or elemental spells. The communion wins when path elevation and fatigue distribution produce effects that the independent group cannot match. It loses when the battle is small, the target can be solved by low magic, or enemy area attacks make concentration fatal.

The expert skill is not memorising every possible Mystic. It is managing a portfolio:

- label rare results;
- protect deadline-critical specialists;
- keep alternate branches;
- calculate at-least-one probabilities;
- compare independent and communal output;
- preserve enough researchers that victory today does not erase research tomorrow.

Under Divinitus, the Grand Hierophant can change the distribution after recruitment by teaching several paths at once. Portfolio thinking still matters because training introduces another scarce resource: time in high dominion with the Pretender present. The question is not only which Mystic arrived, but which one deserves the next training opportunity.

Essay IV: Healing, Intelligence, and the Preservation of Force

Arcoscephale possesses two advantages that are easy to undervalue because neither directly kills an enemy: healing and automatic scrying. Together they improve force preservation.

Healing converts survivors into future capacity. A wounded elephant, Astrologer, combat Pretender, or thug may carry an affliction whose cost exceeds the hit points already restored. A damaged eye reduces precision. A crippled leg ruins movement. Feeblemind can remove a mage from useful service. Concentrated healers create a place where those losses can sometimes be reversed.

The useful economic comparison is not the healer's monthly wage against one cured affliction. It is the value of the unit's remaining lifetime. Restoring a rare S4 Astrologer may recover remote-magic and ritual access that would take many capital turns to replace. Restoring an ordinary Peltast is worth less. Healing allocation still has a strategic side even when the engine selects targets automatically, because players decide which units gather in the province and how long they remain.

Scrying reduces the wounds that need healing. Seeing the enemy approach allows the nation to avoid presenting elephants to fear, Mystics to flyers, or Hoplites to armour destruction. It permits the correct reserve to move before contact. It also allows damaged units to withdraw through safer routes.

Neither system eliminates risk. Healing cannot restore the dead and may not cure the desired affliction immediately. Scrying does not reveal every stealth or magic-phase threat and only functions where dominion supplies the view. Overreliance produces predictable failures: the combat Pretender attacks because "the priestesses will heal it," or the capital is left open because "scrying sees everything."

Preservation requires a full cycle:

```
observe threat
-> choose favourable engagement
-> protect valuable bodies
-> win with survivors
-> withdraw damaged assets
-> heal and reassign
```

The final word is reassign. A recovered unit should return to the role its current body and strategic value justify. A once-wounded elephant may rejoin expansion. A recovered Mind Hunter may return to a rear laboratory. A Pretender healed after a narrow victory may be more valuable forging or deterring than repeating the same gamble.

Essay V: From Classical Army to Astral State

The visual identity of Middle Age Arcoscephale is classical warfare: spear lines, bronze, chariots, and elephants. The strategic identity is a transition away from dependence on those bodies.

In the first year, ordinary troops seize the economy. Hoplites absorb common weapons. Hypaspists move and defend. Peltasts and Cardaces provide affordable frontage. Elephants transform favourable size matchups into rapid routs. The army is not obsolete; it is the instrument that buys time and provinces.

Research changes what the army means. Earth magic can harden it or destroy the enemy's armour. Astral can make key squares ethereal, paralyse elites, or attack minds. Fire and Water can kill dense formations. Communions turn modest randoms into specialists. At this stage the troops are still combatants, but their greater function is to create time and targets for magic.

Later, the relation reverses. The mage state is the scarce offensive core. Troops screen it, hold forts, absorb attacks, provide siege bodies, and claim territory after remote or battlefield magic has broken resistance. A player who continues measuring strength only by the number of elephants will misread the nation.

This transition creates a tension. The old army is expensive in resources and attention; the Astral state is expensive in gold, laboratories, pearls, and mage-turns. Investing too early in magic produces a small realm that can research but not survive. Investing too long in troops produces a large realm that cannot answer modern counters.

The transition point is not a turn number. It arrives when:

- the next troop purchase adds less capability than the next Mystic;
- a research node defeats a class the army cannot;
- borders stabilise enough for forts to compound;
- enemy magic begins invalidating unbuffed troops;
- a siege or Throne operation requires more than field bodies.

Dominions Enhanced makes the transition richer rather than removing it. Cheaper and more mobile troops extend mundane relevance, while constellations, nymph summons, and Titans create a larger magical destination. Divinitus adds trained Mystics who can embody several elements at once. The classical army does not disappear. It becomes the territorial shell of an increasingly supernatural state.

Essay VI: Geography as a Magic Path

Under Dominions Enhanced, forest, mountain, swamp, and water access become part of Arcoscephale's mage roster.

An N2 Archousa is not yet an Oreiad caster. She needs a Nature booster and a forest to contact a Karyatid. The Karyatid is strongest in forest and can help reach N4. N4 plus a mountain produces an Oreiad, which opens Air and Earth. A W3 caster in a swamp produces an Eleionomae with Death and Air. An S4 Astrologer eventually calls an immortal Daughter of Evening with Air.

The map contains latent paths. A nearby forest may be worth more than its income because it begins the Nature ladder. A swamp can become the nation's first reliable Death bridge. A mountain supports Oreiad contact and conjunction rituals. An underwater foothold enables Titans and the Scourge of the Deeps.

This changes expansion and diplomacy. Terrain is no longer valued only by income, resources, and fort geometry. A treaty that cedes the only safe swamp may also cede Death access. A raid that interrupts the mountain laboratory can delay the entire constellation or nymph programme. A fort built on the correct terrain protects a magical production node.

Geographic access has a cost: it is visible and contestable. A Pretender path travels with the Pretender. A terrain ladder depends on holding the province, building or preserving a laboratory, moving the caster, and surviving the ritual month. Opponents can read the same map and attack the bridge.

The expert response is to record terrain in the access ledger:

```
N2 Archousa
+ Nature booster
+ forest laboratory
+ Conjuration 4
+ 20 Nature gems
= Karyatid
```

This notation makes two things clear. First, the access is real. Second, every component can be delayed or denied.

Part XV: Reference Checklists

Vanilla quick doctrine

- Expand with tested infantry, elephant, chariot, or Pretender packages.
- Budget the 300-gold laboratory with every fort.
- Recruit Mystics widely; record every random.
- Treat E2, W2, F2, and S4+ as portfolio assets.
- Use communions only when path elevation beats independent casting.
- Preserve the capital Astrologer pipeline.
- Use scrying as one layer of intelligence.
- Use Hiereiai outside forts and Archousai for concentrated healing.
- Bridge missing paths deliberately.
- Convert field victories into forts, laboratories, and Thrones.

DE quick doctrine

- Recalculate the entire roster; do not use vanilla cost assumptions.
- Use cheaper improved infantry and new cavalry for mobility.
- Treat paired Heart Companions as a separate sacred economy.
- Exploit N2 Archousai.
- Secure forest, mountain, swamp, and water nodes.
- Choose one constellation per battle.
- Plan the nymph ladder from caster, booster, gem, research, and terrain.
- Protect unique summons and heroes.
- Capture live cards for inherited mod objects.

Divinitus quick doctrine

- Confirm the final Grand Hierophant in the Pretender screen.
- Build temples where anointing can occur safely.
- Record which Mystic is transformed.
- Train in strong dominion.
- Compare teaching, site searching, research, forging, and war orders.
- Do not assume the stated path cap until tested.
- Convert elemental treasure into immediate packages.
- Protect the training hub without concentrating every irreplaceable asset there.

Source register

Official

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2:
- Scouting and Scrying;
- Healing and afflictions;
- Communions;
- spell and ritual tables;
- MA Arcoscephale national summary and roster;
- national spells and rituals.

Supplied mod sources

- `DomEnhanced2_16.dm`
- MA Arcoscephale unit definitions 9316-9323;
- vanilla monster rewrites;
- national sites;
- nation 50 recruitment block;
- national spells, items, heroes, and events.
- `Divinitus_1.15.3_DE.dm`
- Grand Hierophant rewrite;
- Mystic anointing;
- teaching events;
- site-search treasure event.

Current structured and community cross-checks

- Dominions 6 Mod Inspector, maintained by larzm42;
- Illwiki Dominions 6 MA Arcoscephale page;
- current and historical community discussion used only for doctrine and hypothesis.

Community claims are not used to override official or source-confirmed object definitions without a recorded current test.

Open research ledger

The highest-priority unresolved questions are:

1. current live Mystic and Astrologer random display under 6.36;
2. exact scrying interaction with glamour and stealth;

3. reliable expansion party ranges;
4. independent casting versus communion break-even;
5. DE inherited unit and spell-card values;
6. paired Heart Companion timing;
7. constellation replacement behaviour;
8. nymph custom-magic distributions;
9. Grand Hierophant combined inheritance;
10. Mystic Prophet transformation preservation;
11. teaching cap semantics;
12. treasure-event probability and gem colours.

These questions are deliberately visible. The dossier is already usable, but it should become more precise as controlled evidence replaces provisional labels.

DOCUMENT 10 OF 16

Foundation Book VIII: Modding and Scenario Design

Building Reliable Dominions 6 Rulesets, Events, AI Scaffolds, and Worlds

The job of this volume

Dominions 6 modding begins with text commands, but reliable modding is not primarily a matter of remembering commands. It is a matter of controlling state.

A mod changes a shared registry of weapons, armour, monsters, sites, nations, spells, items, population types, mercenaries, AI templates, and events. Those objects refer to one another. Several mods may alter the same object. Updates can change legal commands or object numbers. Events retain codes and variables across turns. Maps establish the topology on which every strategic system operates.

The job is larger than writing a `.dm` file. A dependable project must answer:

- which game version and manual revision define the rules;
- which object is being selected;
- which attributes are inherited, cleared, or overwritten;
- when the parser processes each category;
- which identifiers belong to the project;
- how multiple mods interact;
- what changes are safe for an ongoing game;
- what the AI can be encouraged to do;
- what requires an event system rather than an AI command;
- how a map changes strategic value before a nation is chosen;
- how every claim will be checked.

Book VIII begins with the smallest safe patch, then moves through events, maps, AI hints, compatibility work, and release testing. Illwinter's manuals remain the authority for commands. The aim here is to show how individual commands become a mod that survives other mods, game updates, and actual play.

Technical baseline

Game baseline: Dominions 6.36. Official Modding Manual: version 6.34, 65 pages. Official Event Modding Manual: labelled version 6.29, 20 pages. Official Map Making Manual: version 6.26, 11 pages. Official File Formats document: current one-page `d6m` specification. Source case studies: Dominions Enhanced 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE. Intended combined order: Dominions Enhanced first, Divinitus DE second. Last verified: 31 July 2026.

The manuals do not all carry the same version number, and that is not an error in the archive. The official documentation page currently distributes a 6.34 modding manual, a 6.29-labelled event manual, and a 6.26 map manual while the public game is 6.36. Patch notes published after those revisions form part of the technical baseline. Book XIV marks five event commands introduced in 6.36 as official patch-only because the announcement does not supply their full syntax.

Book I's evidence labels remain in force. Source syntax appears only when the command itself matters; the surrounding explanation is independent of the manuals.

Suggested paths

The first-mod path runs from the parser model through project structure, selection, copying, clearing, error isolation, and validation. Content creators can then move into objects, nations, spells, items, and blessings. Event and diplomacy work begins with state, eligibility, codes, variables, targets, and anti-loop safeguards. Mapmakers can go directly to topology and scenario packaging, while compatibility work depends on the parser chapters, identifier registries, object reconstruction, and regression testing. Book IX now holds the detailed DE and Divinitus case study.

Part I: The Object-and-Parser Model

The most useful mental model

A `.dm` file is a sequence of instructions that changes a collection of global object tables. It is not a complete database and it is not a conventional program with private objects.

The basic unit of work is a stateful block:

```
#select... or #new...
commands that alter the active object
#end
```

The selector establishes the active object. Commands after it belong to that object until `#end`. A missing selector, a missing `#end`, an accidental `#clear`, or an unexpected later mod can change the meaning of an otherwise correct line.

Five operations explain most mod source:

Operation	Purpose	Principal risk
Select	Open an existing object for alteration	Wrong name or number
Create	Allocate a new object	Collision or unstable automatic number
Copy	Inherit an existing object's properties	Hidden attributes come with the copy
Clear	Remove some or all inherited properties	Required defaults vanish
Set	Replace or add a property	Later source may overwrite it

The central expert question is not, "What commands appear in this block?" It is, "What is the final object after every inherited value, clear operation, setter, parser phase, and later mod has been applied?"

Commands are stateful

Consider the pattern:

```
#selectmonster 311
#gcost 180
#poorleader
#end
```

This does not define a new monster. It alters monster 311. Attributes not addressed by the block continue to come from the base game or an earlier mod. The resulting monster is the old object plus the specified changes.

Now consider:

```
#newmonster 7200
#copystats 311
#name "Example Adept"
#gcost 200
#end
```

This creates a new identity, inherits a source object's characteristics, and then changes selected fields. The copy is economical, but it also carries properties that may be easy to overlook: leadership, item slots, movement, age, path cost, recruitment limits, stealth, shape relationships, and hidden flags can all matter.

The safe method is:

1. name the source object and version;
2. state why it is being copied;
3. list inherited systems that must be audited;
4. override deliberately;
5. inspect the final in-game detail card;
6. test any behaviour not visible on the card.

Text order and parser order are different

Within each mod, Dominions processes object categories in a fixed order:

Parser phase	Category
1	Mod information
2	Weapons
3	Armour
4	Units and monsters
5	Names
6	Blessings
7	Sites
8	Nations
9	Spells
10	Magic items
11	General rules
12	Population types
13	Mercenaries
14	Events

This has two consequences.

First, physical placement in the file does not create an ordinary top-to-bottom dependency between categories. A weapon definition may be written after a monster block in the text, yet the weapon phase is processed before the monster phase.

Second, entire mods are loaded separately. One mod is processed through its phases, then another mod is processed. A reference by name to an object created in another mod is not reliable merely because the other mod is listed first. The official manual warns that cross-mod name references cannot be trusted.

For compatibility work:

- use numbers when a known shared identity is intentionally targeted;
- avoid assuming that another mod's names form a stable public interface;
- treat two mods altering the same object as a conflict requiring inspection;
- record combined load order;
- reconstruct the final object rather than describing either source in isolation.

Overlap does not create a clean merge contract

It is tempting to assume that two mods "merge" because each changes different fields on the same monster. Sometimes the observed final object resembles such a merge. That is not a safe general contract.

The official warning is stronger: two mods should not try to modify the same thing because the result may be unpredictable. A dependable compatibility patch cannot rely on accidental non-overlap. It explicitly reasserts the intended final state after both parent mods.

The source-level rule is:

```
shared selector
-> enumerate every parent modification
-> identify clears and copies
-> determine final setters
-> create explicit compatibility block
-> verify final object
```

Names are convenient; numbers are identities

Many selectors accept either a quoted name or a numeric identifier. Names are readable, but they are not always unique and can be changed. Numbers are less readable, but they identify a specific registry entry.

Use names when:

- working entirely within one self-contained project;
- the object is a stable base-game object with a unique name;
- readability outweighs cross-mod coupling;
- a command only accepts a name.

Use numbers when:

- diagnosing an existing unit through `ctrl+i`;
- modifying a known base-game identity;
- two objects share a name;
- creating explicit monsters, sites, weapons, or armour;
- a compatibility patch deliberately targets another mod's object.

Always comment numbers:

```
#selectmonster 311 -- Mystic, MA Arcoscephale
```

A number without provenance becomes technical debt.

Bitmasks are sets represented as integers

A bitmask combines several independent flags by addition. It should be read as a set, not as an unexplained large number.

For a custom magic random, the documented path-mask values begin:

Path	Mask
Fire	128
Air	256
Water	512
Earth	1024
Astral	2048
Death	4096
Nature	8192
Glamour	16384
Blood	32768
Priest	65536

Thus `384` is `128 + 256`, meaning a Fire-or-Air random. The source should retain the decomposition:

```
#custommagic 384 100 -- F/A, one guaranteed pick
```

For every bitmask:

- keep the human-readable components in a comment;
- do not reuse a terrain bitmask in a site command;
- do not assume similarly named masks share values across manuals;
- calculate the sum twice or generate it from a small table;
- inspect the result in game.

The Map Making Manual explicitly warns that its terrain masks are not the same as the terrain masks used for site modding.

Object numbers and the manual's internal boundaries

The final "Modding Number Limits" table in the 6.34 manual gives:

Object	Total documented range	Recommended mod range
Sound	0-248	150+
Weapon	0-3999	1000+
Armour	0-1999	400+
Monster	0-19999	5000+
Nametype	100-399	170+

Object	Total documented range	Recommended mod range
Spell	0-7999	2000+
Enchantment	0-9999	200+
Item	0-1999	700+
Magic site	0-3999	1700+
Nation	0-499	150+
Population type	0-249	125+

The same manual contains older-looking local limits in individual sections. Examples include monsters described as 5000-8999, armour as 300-999, spells as 1300-3999, and items as beginning at 400. These statements cannot all describe the same final ceiling.

The evidence-based policy for 6.36 is:

- treat the final consolidated limits table as the current broad capacity;
- recognize that older projects may occupy lower legacy mod ranges;
- allocate from a written project registry rather than "the next number that looks free";
- prefer the narrower historical range when broad portability matters;
- verify numbers above an older local ceiling in the target game version;
- do not silently rewrite another mod's allocation.

Dominions Enhanced demonstrates that current mods can use monster numbers above 8999. That source evidence resolves current parser capacity for the supplied ruleset, but it does not remove collision risk.

Automatic allocation is convenient but fragile

Some `#new...` commands accept explicit numbers; others allocate automatically.

Object	Explicit identity available in documented command?	Safe update policy
Weapon	Yes	Allocate from project registry
Armour	Yes	Allocate from project registry
Monster	Optional explicit number	Use explicit number
Site	Optional explicit number	Use explicit number
Nation	Automatic free nation number	Avoid relying on order outside project
Spell	Automatic	Append-only or reserved placeholders
Item	Automatic	Append-only or reserved placeholders

The official manual specifically warns that inserting new automatically numbered monsters, sites, or spells into the middle of a released mod can change later identities and break ongoing games. Explicit numbering solves part of the problem. For automatically allocated categories, the practical protection is:

- append new objects;
- never reorder released objects casually;
- reserve inert placeholders when future expansion is likely;
- record generated identities from `ctrl+i`;
- make save compatibility an explicit release decision.

A mod can change an ongoing game

When the source used by a saved game changes, object modifications can apply when the game is loaded again. Existing militia can acquire a changed weapon; existing commanders can acquire new statistics. This is useful for testing and dangerous for releases.

Changes fall into three classes:

Class	Example	Ongoing-game risk
Presentation	Description correction	Usually low
Existing-object mutation	Cost, weapon, path, shape, spell effect	Immediate and potentially strategic
Registry mutation	Inserted new monster, spell, site, or item	Identity shift and possible corruption

Every release should state one of:

- safe for new games only;
- expected to be compatible with existing games;
- compatibility not guaranteed;
- migration release with exact host instructions.

Part II: Project Structure and the First Working Mod

Locating the user data directory

The safest method is the in-game Game Tools -> Open User Data Directory action. Default locations are:

Platform	Default user data directory
Windows	`%APPDATA%\dominions6\`
Linux	`~/.dominions6/`
macOS	`~/.dominions6/`

Relevant subdirectories include:

- `mods`
- `maps`
- `savedgames`

The in-game button should take precedence over assumptions about operating-system paths.

The Dominions 6 mod folder rule

Every mod must reside in its own folder. The folder and `.dm` file should share a simple filename:

```
mods/
example_balance/
example_balance.dm
banner.png
```

```
sprites/
example_unit.png
```

The 6.34 manual requires the `.dm` file to be inside a folder with the same name, excluding the extension. Files used by the mod should remain within that folder or its subdirectories.

Network-safe filenames:

- contain no spaces;
- avoid special characters;
- use consistent case;
- use forward slashes inside mod references, including on Windows.

Case matters for mod and image filenames.

Image and sound formats

Mod graphics may use PNG or Targa images. Targa files must be uncompressed or RLE and use 24- or 32-bit colour. For 24-bit Targa graphics, the manual describes black as transparent and magenta as a half-transparent shadow colour.

The dedicated mod banner used by `#icon` should be 128x32 or 256x64 pixels.

Sound sources use:

- `.sw`: mono, signed 16-bit, 22 kHz;
- `.sw2`: stereo, signed 16-bit, 22 kHz.

Sound effects should be mono. Music may use either form. New sound slots are documented from 150 upward, with 248 as the maximum.

The minimum useful metadata block

```
#modname "Example Balance Patch"
#description "Small, versioned adjustments for Dominions 6.36."
#version 0.10
#domversion 6.36
```

`#icon` is optional. `#domversion` is also optional, but it is valuable once the project depends on commands or fixes added after release.

A good description states:

- what the mod changes;
- which game version it targets;
- whether it requires another mod;
- required load order;
- whether it is intended for new games only.

The smallest safe first project

The first project should modify one visible property of one existing object. It should not begin with a new nation, a multi-stage event chain, or a custom global enchantment.

Example:

```
#modname "Mystic Cost Test"
#description "Controlled test for MA Arcoscephale Mystic cost."
#version 0.01
#domversion 6.35

#selectmonster 311 -- Mystic
#gcost 185
#end
```

The trailing blank line is deliberate. Current community troubleshooting repeatedly identifies a missing final newline as a cause of the last command, often `#end`, not being parsed. This behaviour is not stated in the official 6.34 manual, so it remains a community-tested compatibility precaution. It is cheap and should be standard.

Verification:

1. enable only the test mod;
2. start a fresh MA Arcoscephale game;
3. inspect the Mystic's recruitment card;
4. press `ctrl+i` where useful;
5. confirm no unrelated property changed;
6. disable the mod and confirm the baseline returns.

The patch-before-creation progression

A safe learning ladder is:

1. change an existing monster's gold cost;
2. change an existing weapon's damage;
3. copy a monster into a new fixed ID;
4. give the copy a copied or existing weapon;
5. add the new monster to one nation's recruitment;
6. create one site that recruits it;
7. create one spell or item;
8. create one bounded event;
9. build a complete nation;
10. add compatibility and AI layers.

Each step introduces one new category of failure.

Selector discipline

Every block should visibly contain:

- selector or creator;
- identity comment;
- copy or clear operation, if any;
- grouped setters;
- `#end`;
- blank separation from the next block.

Example:

```
-- Unit 7200: Bronze Sentinel
#newmonster 7200
#copystats 118 -- chosen source recorded in registry
#name "Bronze Sentinel"
#clearweapons
```

```
#weapon 8 -- Broad Sword
#gcost 22
#rcost 2
#end
```

The comment does not change behaviour. It preserves the reason behind a number.

Copy-first and clear-first are different designs

Copy-first

Copy-first preserves a coherent base object:

```
#newmonster 7201
#copystats 311
#name "Senior Mystic"
#magicskill 4 2
#gcost 260
#end
```

Advantages:

- fast;
- inherits functional defaults;
- good for variants.

Risks:

- inherits hidden or irrelevant properties;
- a parent modification can change the copy's starting point;
- can produce accidental Pretender, recruitment, leadership, or shape behaviour.

Clear-first

Clear-first creates a more explicit object:

```
#newmonster 7202
#clear
#name "Test Construct"
#hp 20
#size 4
#str 16
#att 10
#def 8
#prec 8
#mr 14
#mor 30
#mapmove 12
#ap 10
#end
```

Advantages:

- makes the intended state visible;
- reduces inherited surprises.

Risks:

- easy to omit a required or sensible default;
- more work;
- may produce a technically valid but unusable object.

Use copy-first for a close variant and clear-first for a genuinely new body. In both cases the final card, movement, recruitment, leadership, and combat behaviour must be checked.

Error isolation

When a mod fails to appear or load:

1. verify it is inside its own correctly named folder;
2. verify the file extension is really `.dm`, not `.dm.txt`;
3. verify `#modname`;
4. remove or comment out `#icon`;
5. confirm filenames contain no spaces or special characters;
6. confirm case and forward slashes;
7. confirm every stateful block ends;
8. add a final blank line;
9. reduce the source to metadata plus one known-safe block;
10. restore sections by binary search.

Binary search is faster than rereading a five-thousand-line file:

- disable half the source;
- load;
- choose the failing half;
- repeat until the minimal failing block remains.

When the mod loads but an object does not appear:

- inspect its selector and number;
- check recruitment or site assignment;
- check era and nation;
- for Pretenders, check Pretender-defining attributes and nation or home-realm assignment;
- check whether a later mod clears recruitment or gods;
- inspect the combined final object, not only the definition.

Reloading source during development

Officially, changing a mod can affect a saved test game. If Dominions remains open, the documented reload method is:

1. load a game using different mods or no mods;
2. return to the main menu;
3. load the test game again.

This forces the target mod to reload. For registry changes and anything involving new game setup, a fresh game is still the safer test.

Part III: Weapons, Armour, and Combat Effects

Design from combat role

A weapon is not balanced by damage alone. Relevant dimensions include:

- number of attacks;
- attack and defence modifiers;
- length;
- strength contribution;
- damage type;
- armour interaction;
- magic and resistance flags;
- range, precision contribution, and ammunition;
- secondary effects;
- clouds and after-effects;
- interactions with size, morale, defence, or magic resistance.

A unit carrying a weapon adds another layer:

- wielder strength and attack;
- number of arms;
- ambidexterity;
- fatigue and encumbrance;
- formation density;
- recruitment cost;
- mount attacks;
- blesses and battlefield buffs.

Balance the delivered attack package, not the isolated weapon card.

Selecting and creating weapons

Core patterns:

```
#selectweapon 8
...changes...
#end
```

```
#newweapon 1200
#name "Test Falx"
#dmg 8
#att 1
#def -1
#len 2
#slash
#armorpiercing
#sound 8
#end
```

For new weapons:

- allocate an explicit ID;
- set the name first;
- use `#copyweapon` first when inheriting;
- remember that `#clear` removes the copied properties;
- use `#range` only when the weapon is meant to become missile-only;
- inspect all derived text in game.

Damage and armour interaction

The important distinction goes beyond physical versus magical.

Layer	Examples
Damage family	Slash, pierce, blunt, fire, cold, shock, poison, fatigue
Armour rule	Normal, armour piercing, armour negating
Resistance rule	Resistance applies, MR negates, size or strength interaction
Delivery	Melee, missile, area, beam, cloud, after-effect
Conditional effect	On hit, on damage, against demon, undead, magic being, or illusion

A high base-damage attack with ordinary armour interaction may be a poor anti-elite tool. A lower attack with armour negation can invalidate protection. An after-effect may bypass the intended counter class. Every weapon design should state the defence class it is intended to defeat.

Range and ammunition

`#range` converts a weapon into a missile weapon that cannot be used in melee. `#ammo` controls the ordinary shot count; current patch notes also record later support for fatigue-based ammunition behaviour.

Missile testing should record:

- actual maximum range;
- precision at several distances;
- firing cadence;
- ammunition exhaustion;
- behaviour after ammunition;
- friendly fire and area;
- interaction with shields and Air Shield;
- underwater legality;
- spell-created versus recruited use.

Secondary and after-effects

Weapon after-effects can create some of the most severe balance errors because one attack can deliver several independent tests.

For each effect, record:

- trigger: swing, hit, or damage;
- target: original square, target, wielder, area, or cloud;
- defence: armour, resistance, MR, size, strength, or none;
- stacking behaviour;
- duration;
- whether a killed target still produces the effect;
- whether a mount, rider, secondary shape, or illusion is separately affected.

Official updates have repeatedly fixed weapon and cloud edge cases. Patch history is part of a weapon's evidence, not background trivia.

Armour and barding

Armour types documented by the manual include:

Type value	Use
4	Shield
5	Body armour
6	Helmet
9	Barding

New armour uses an explicit number. The consolidated current mod range begins at 400, while the local armour section still mentions a legacy starting point of 300. A project registry should use a range that does not overlap enabled mods.

Armour evaluation includes:

- protection by body location;
- defence penalty;
- encumbrance;
- resource cost;
- magic-item consequences;
- mounted interaction;
- whether a form retains legal slots;
- whether copied armour contains unexpected type or sprite data.

Combat-effect audit

Before releasing a weapon or armour change:

Test	Minimum comparison
Baseline damage	Unarmoured human
Armour performance	Light, medium, and heavy protection
Defence interaction	Low and high Defence Skill
Size interaction	Human and giant
Resistance	Relevant resistance 0, partial, and high
Mount interaction	Rider hit and mount hit
Shape interaction	Primary and secondary form
Buff interaction	Strength, weapon, protection, and resistance buffs
Scale	One attacker and massed formation

The purpose is not to prove that a weapon can kill. It is to identify which battlefield class it makes obsolete.

Part IV: Monsters, Mounts, Shapes, and Commanders

A monster is a bundle of systems

"Monster" is the modding category for ordinary troops, commanders, mages, heroes, Pretenders, mounts, animals, constructs, undead, and many summoned beings.

A complete monster audit covers:

1. identity and visuals;
2. body statistics;
3. weapons and armour;
4. item slots;
5. movement;
6. creature type and tags;
7. leadership;
8. magic;
9. recruitment rules and costs;
10. shape and mount relationships;
11. special abilities;
12. AI recruitment instructions;
13. death, rebirth, and transformation behaviour.

Base statistics are not independent

Changing Size can affect:

- square occupancy;
- repel and weapon length interactions;
- trampling eligibility;
- strength and hit expectations;
- mount and rider geometry;
- item and shape assumptions.

Changing action points affects how rapidly a unit crosses a battlefield and may interact with weapon timing. Changing encumbrance affects fatigue, which in turn changes Defence Skill, attack performance, spellcasting, and eventual collapse. Changing morale affects rout timing and formation stability.

The final role must be tested as a system.

Cost has three distinct channels

Monster cost is not one number:

- gold cost controls treasury and upkeep;
- resource cost reflects base body plus equipment;
- recruitment-point cost controls throughput.

A unit can be cheap in gold but impossible to mass from one fort because of recruitment points. A mage can be affordable but consume several commander points. A heavily equipped unit may be limited by resources even when gold is abundant.

Cost doctrine:

- compare per fort-turn, not only per unit;
- include upkeep;

- include commander support;
- include resource scales and terrain;
- compare battlefield role against the nearest national alternative;
- test massed availability.

Automatic gold-cost calculation

Dominions can calculate parts of monster cost from attributes. Manual cost setters and automatic components can interact. A displayed final recruitment price is more authoritative than a single source line.

When modifying a copied unit:

- record the displayed parent price;
- record every cost-related source command;
- record the displayed child price;
- do not label an isolated `#gcost` argument as the final cost without inspection.

This rule was necessary in the Arcoscephale DE dossier, where copied or selected objects could not be safely summarized from one cost line.

Recruitment flags are strategic rules

Recruitment commands can constrain a monster by:

- capital status;
- terrain;
- fort or no fort;
- coast or sea;
- season;
- commander points;
- recruitment points;
- holy or sacred limits;
- nation lists and sites.

The unit card does not by itself answer where and how often the unit can be produced. Nation and site source must also be read.

Leadership is typed

Normal, magic, and undead leadership are separate capacities. Morale modifiers, taskmaster-like abilities, formation permissions, and undisciplined-unit control can alter the practical command package.

For each commander, test:

- maximum normal troops;
- maximum magic beings;
- maximum undead;
- squad morale effect;
- formation options;
- bodyguard capacity;
- movement of the slowest assigned unit;
- behaviour after shapechange or dismount.

Magic paths and randoms

Fixed paths use path numbers:

Number	Path
0	Fire
1	Air
2	Water
3	Earth
4	Astral
5	Death
6	Nature
7	Glamour
8	Blood
9	Priest
50	Random
51	Elemental
52	Sorcery
53	All

`#magicskill` assigns a fixed path. Holy magic also requires the monster to be made a priest through the appropriate priest attribute.

`#custommagic` uses path masks and a percentage. Multiple `#custommagic` lines represent multiple rolls. They do not automatically describe one combined roll.

For every random mage:

- write each roll separately;
- state whether its chance is 100%, 50%, 10%, or another value;
- identify which paths share one mask;
- calculate threshold probability;
- check impossible combinations;
- distinguish source probability from observed distribution.

The manual warns that a custom random containing only Priest can crash the mod. Random holy levels should not be used casually.

Ritual mastery and range

`#masterrit` changes effective paths for ritual casting without simply granting an ordinary path level. Path-specific range commands increase ritual reach by provinces and battlefield range in percentage steps.

These abilities can create access that an ordinary path list misses. A mage audit asks:

- displayed path;
- effective ritual path;
- range modifiers;
- research bonus;

- gem production;
- path boosts;
- item restrictions;
- automatic spells;
- communion or chorus role.

Mounts are separate monsters

Dominions 6 models the mount separately from the rider. A mounted design may involve:

- rider monster;
- mount monster;
- mount assignment;
- rider placement;
- mount statistics;
- mount weapons;
- barding;
- size and item-slot interaction;
- dismounted continuation;
- remount or mount-regeneration behaviour.

A mounted unit can fail in several distinct ways:

- the mount dies and leaves a functioning rider;
- the rider dies while the mount is hit separately;
- an area effect hits both;
- a gateway or movement effect interacts with the mounted state;
- a shapechange loses or duplicates mount state;
- event-created unique riders behave differently.

Patch notes have repeatedly addressed mounted crashes and inconsistencies. Mounted content needs its own regression suite.

Shape relationships form graphs

Shapechanging changes far more than the sprite. It can affect:

- statistics;
- magic;
- items and disabled slots;
- age;
- afflictions;
- mount state;
- death and rebirth;
- battle-only changes;
- seasonal changes;
- bug or swarm forms;
- Pretender recognition.

Represent the relationship as a graph:

```
strategic form
-> battle form
-> wounded or death form
-> restored form
```

Then test each edge and what state survives it:

- experience;
- afflictions;
- heroic ability;
- prophet status;
- magic paths and boosts;
- items;
- name;
- orders;
- mount;
- event target eligibility.

The Arcoscephale Grand Hierophant case demonstrates why this matters: an event transforms an ordinary Mystic into a Mystic Prophet and later events may boost that transformed object. The relevant question is not only which unit appears, but which state is preserved through transformation.

Pretender qualification

A monster does not become an available Pretender merely because it has impressive statistics. Relevant design elements include:

- starting dominion;
- new-path cost;
- initial paths;
- chassis status and slots;
- home realm;
- explicit addition to nation god lists;
- awakening restrictions;
- nation availability.

When a custom Pretender exists but does not appear:

- verify Pretender-defining attributes;
- verify home realm;
- verify `#addgod` or equivalent national inclusion;
- verify era and nation;
- verify later `#cleargods`;
- verify the final `#end` was parsed.

Part V: Sites, Nations, and Recruitment Architecture

Sites are content containers

Magic sites can provide:

- gem income;
- gold, resources, supply, scales, or unrest effects;
- recruitable units and commanders;
- conjuration or ritual access;

- scrying and ritual range;
- path or research effects;
- Throne effects;
- unique national infrastructure.

This makes sites a powerful compatibility technique. A site can add recruitment without rebuilding a nation's ordinary recruit list. It can also scope content to a capital, terrain, or discovered location.

Site identity and discovery

Sites can be hidden or known. Event requirements distinguish:

- site present;
- discovered;
- hidden;
- nearby;
- claimed or unclaimed Throne;
- free site slots.

An event that adds a site should normally require a free site slot. An event referring to a site by name may require the exact site name embedded in brackets at the end of its message, depending on the command. The Event Manual's bracket convention is easy to miss and should be copied exactly when relevant.

Current official correction: Dominions 6.35 fixed `#revealsite` and `#removesite` so they work when several sites share the same name. Earlier behaviour should not be assumed when reading old reports.

Nation blocks define conversion rules

A nation is not only a list of troops. It defines:

- name, epithet, era, colours, flag, and description;
- preferred and hated terrain;
- capital and start sites;
- recruitment lists;
- terrain and fort recruitment;
- starting commander and armies;
- province defence;
- forts, laboratories, and temples;
- dominion and scale modifiers;
- Pretender list and realms;
- undead reanimation;
- AI hints;
- national spells and items through references elsewhere.

Changing recruitment can alter the entire national economy.

`#clearrec` is a major operation

`#clearrec` removes the nation's ordinary recruitable units and commanders, but not its gods. It should be treated like a schema migration.

After clearing, reconstruct:

- ordinary units;
- ordinary commanders;
- fort and foreign recruitment;
- terrain-specific recruitment;
- capital-site recruitment;
- starting commander and troops;
- commander-point coverage;
- scouts and priests;
- siege and leadership access.

Dominions Enhanced uses this kind of recruitment rewrite for MA Arcoscephale. The final roster cannot be inferred from the base game plus a list of new units; it must be rebuilt from the post-clear additions and site recruitment.

Ordinary, foreign, terrain, fort, and site recruitment

Recruitment sources should be recorded separately:

Source	Strategic meaning
Ordinary national recruit	Available through normal national recruitment rules
Foreign recruit	Available without a fort where permitted
Fort-terrain recruit	Depends on both fort and terrain
Site recruit	Depends on owning a specific site
Capital-site recruit	Capital-only even if not in ordinary list
Event-added recruit	Depends on event state

A complete nation diff names both the object and its source.

Starting armies are their own system

Changing `#startcom` removes old starting troops and establishes a new starting-command context. Starting squads and counts must then be restored explicitly.

The manual recommends increasing Dominions 5 starting armies by roughly half when converting to Dominions 6 because army scale increased. This is guidance, not a universal balance formula. The new army must still be tested against current neutral provinces.

Province defence

Province defence has:

- commanders;
- troop types;
- thresholds;
- quantities per defence points;
- separate underwater definitions.

PD is part of national strategic identity. A cheap raiding unit becomes much stronger if opposing modded nations have brittle PD; an event attack becomes oppressive if it repeatedly strikes a nation with no suitable PD answer.

Test:

- PD 1;
- first threshold;
- second threshold;
- PD 10 and 20;
- commander survival;
- patrol and siege interaction;
- underwater version;
- gold efficiency against common raiders.

Buildings and infrastructure

National fort, laboratory, and temple commands change:

- construction cost;
- construction time;
- defence;
- recruitment;
- economic conversion;
- research spread;
- dominion spread.

The strategic unit is not "a cheap fort." It is:

```
gold and commander turns
-> completed infrastructure
-> recruitment and research throughput
-> defended territory
```

Balance should compare the whole conversion.

Dominion is a rules engine

Nation modding can change:

- scale limits;
- scale spread;
- automatic effects;
- population and income interactions;
- special dominion;
- bless availability;
- temple and priest behaviour.

Dominion effects can reach every friendly or hostile province, giving them far greater reach than a unit adjustment. Every special dominion should specify:

- eligible provinces;
- dominion threshold;
- frequency;
- stacking;
- effect on allies and enemies;
- event interaction;
- siege behaviour;
- counterplay;
- performance cost.

Home realms and god lists

Home realms allow Pretenders belonging to a realm to enter a nation's default god pool. A nation can also add or clear gods explicitly.

Compatibility risk:

- one mod adds a Pretender;
- a later nation block clears gods;
- the Pretender remains defined but disappears from selection.

The final nation block determines availability.

Nation design audit

A new nation is not ready when the roster appears. It is ready when it can complete the game's strategic conversions.

System	Minimum question
Expansion	Can at least two coherent parties take normal independents?
Leadership	Can starting and recruited armies legally move?
Siege	Can the nation take and hold forts?
Research	Can it build a functioning research economy?
Magic	Are path randoms, gems, and national rituals coherent?
Priests	Can it bless, preach, claim, and recover its god?
Infrastructure	Do forts, labs, and temples fit costs and roster?
Defence	Does PD resist trivial raiding without becoming oppressive?
Water	Is water access intentionally absent, partial, or native?
AI	Can the AI recruit and research a usable subset?
Pretenders	Are several legal strategic families possible?
Counterplay	Which common tools defeat its strongest package?

Part VI: Spells, Items, Blessings, and Supporting Objects

Spell design begins with delivery

A spell definition combines:

- name, description, and detail text;
- research school and level;
- one or two path requirements;
- fatigue and gem or blood-slave cost;
- combat or ritual effect;
- damage or effect argument;
- area;

- range and precision;
- number of effects;
- targeting restrictions;
- environmental restrictions;
- global-enchantment identity;
- national access;
- AI preference.

A strategically meaningful spell description must answer:

1. Who can cast it naturally?
2. Who can cast it after ordinary boosters?
3. When does the research arrive?
4. What gem, slave, fatigue, or mage-turn cost is paid?
5. How is the effect delivered?
6. What resists it?
7. What battlefield or map condition invalidates it?
8. Will the AI cast it sensibly?

Schools and path numbers

Spell schools are:

Number	School
-1	Not researchable
0	Conjuration
1	Alteration
2	Evocation
3	Construction
4	Enchantment
5	Thaumaturgy
6	Blood
7	Divine

Spell path values are:

Number	Path
-1	None
0	Fire
1	Air
2	Water
3	Earth
4	Astral
5	Death
6	Nature
7	Glamour
8	Blood

Number	Path
9	Priest

The required level applies to the corresponding requirement slot. A two-path spell must set the path and level for each intended slot.

Fatigue cost also encodes ritual cost

The manual states that each full 100 points of fatigue cost raises the gem or slave requirement by one. Rituals also use `#fatiguecost` to establish their cost.

This makes fatigue a dual-purpose design field:

- in combat, it affects whether and how often the caster can act;
- for rituals, it establishes gem or slave expenditure.

A copied spell can retain an unexpected economic cost even after its effect has been changed.

Area notation

Spell area supports special values. The manual documents:

- ordinary square counts;
- values above 1000 that scale area with caster level;
- `666` for the entire battlefield;
- special fractional-battlefield values.

Large-area effects must be tested for:

- performance;
- friendly fire;
- resistance density;
- interaction with obstacles;
- repeated casting;
- whether stronger casters scale the area;
- whether an AI preference creates spell spam.

Effects are an engine interface

`#effect` selects an internal effect family. The manual documents many useful values but explicitly does not present every internal possibility. `ctrl+i` on an existing spell can expose modding information.

The safest creation method is:

1. find a base-game spell with the closest delivery and resolution;
2. copy it;
3. rename before writing the new description;
4. change one dimension at a time;
5. retain a source note identifying the parent;
6. test target selection and resistance;
7. compare battle logs.

Changing a copied spell's name removes its description, so the order of name and description commands matters.

A spell's access may be more important than its effect

Balance errors frequently come from access:

- research too early;
- path too common;
- gem cost too low;
- battlefield range too long;
- ritual range bypassing borders;
- national restriction omitted;
- item casting bypassing the intended mage requirement;
- communion or path-master interaction;
- AI casting in every marginal situation.

Spell balance should compare total delivery cost:

```
research + mage recruitment + path access + gems + laboratory + travel + script slot
```

National and restricted spells

National restriction commands can allow or forbid particular nations. A restriction using the last manipulated nation is convenient inside a self-contained file and fragile when source is reorganized.

For maintainability:

- comment every numeric nation;
- avoid relying on "last manipulated nation" across distant blocks;
- keep nation creation and its restricted content in a controlled order;
- include restrictions in the public spell card audit;
- verify the spell under every intended ruleset.

Spell AI hints

Three central controls are:

Command	Function
`#ainocast`	Prevents ordinary AI selection while allowing a scripted cast
`#aibadlvl`	Stops AI selection at or above a specified required path level
`#aispellmod`	Raises or lowers AI preference

The documented `#aispellmod` scale includes:

- `-50`: roughly half as attractive;
- `100`: roughly twice as attractive;
- `-100`: never cast, even if scripted;
- values up to `1000`.

These are hints, not a full targeting language. They cannot make a spell understand a diplomatic plan, reserve gems for a specific future war, or evaluate a bespoke combined-arms doctrine.

AI spell testing needs:

- unscripted independent caster;
- scripted caster;
- high-path caster;
- communion;
- low and high fatigue;
- friendly and hostile target mixes;
- early and late battle;
- routing side;
- gem availability;
- several map contexts for rituals.

Global enchantments require an event layer

A custom global enchantment is usually a spell plus events that check its enchantment identity.

The structure is:

```
global ritual
-> enchantment identity becomes active
-> recurring global or provincial events check identity
-> effects occur under bounded requirements
-> events stop when the enchantment disappears
```

This separates the act of casting from the monthly consequences.

Every custom global requires:

- unique enchantment number;
- owner and hostile checks;
- province eligibility;
- per-month cap;
- message policy;
- dispel and replacement behaviour;
- performance estimate;
- end-state test.

Items are persistent force multipliers

Magic items can change:

- paths and spell access;
- resistances and statistics;
- movement;
- leadership;
- ritual range;
- automatic spells;
- summoning;
- curses and afflictions;
- shape and mount interaction;
- national cost or availability.

Unlike a battlefield spell, an item can persist across many battles and move between commanders. A small numerical bonus may have a large campaign value.

Item creation and automatic identity

`#newitem` automatically creates an item. The consolidated manual places modded items at 700 and above, while older local text may describe a lower legacy boundary.

The stable-release policy is:

- append items rather than insert;
- record observed item numbers;
- preserve object order;
- reserve placeholders if the project expects expansion;
- test save compatibility after any registry change.

Construction level has special values

The manual documents ordinary Construction levels and special unforgeable values:

Value	Meaning
1, 3, 5, 7, 9	Forgeable tiers
11	Unforgeable item
13	Unforgeable unique artifact
15	Unforgeable unique-per-nation artifact

Item type and slot must also match the intended user. Barding is a distinct item type and depends on a legal mount slot.

Item access audit

For every item:

- main and secondary paths;
- Construction tier;
- nominal gem cost;
- forge bonuses and rebates;
- national restrictions;
- slot;
- legal bodies;
- whether it is recoverable after battle;
- whether it is unique;
- whether the AI forges it;
- whether a spell or event creates it;
- whether it grants another ritual or summon.

An item can collapse a path-access ladder. If a nation gains a low-tier booster, every ritual above it must be reconsidered.

Blessing design

Blessing modding changes the Pretender-design economy and every sacred unit that can receive the effect.

A blessing needs:

- path and point requirements;
- scale requirements;
- incarnate status where relevant;
- effect text;
- interaction with mounts;
- interaction with weapons;
- passive versus blessed-state behaviour;
- AI suitability;
- nation-specific exclusion or access.

Test at least:

- ordinary sacred troop;
- sacred commander;
- sacred mount;
- shapeshifter;
- undead or inanimate sacred;
- ranged sacred;
- communion mage if applicable;
- global enchantment and battlefield-buff interactions.

The nation-level AI hints `#aigoodbless`, `#aicheapholy`, and `#aiholyranged` can encourage an appropriate Pretender family, but they do not evaluate the full roster as a human designer would.

Names, population types, mercenaries, and general rules

These categories are smaller than monsters or spells but still global.

Nametypes

Custom nametypes give cultural coherence to commanders. Allocate them from the documented mod range, avoid collision, and verify pluralization and generated forms.

Population types

Population types affect independent recruitment and the character of a province. They can change the strategic value of terrain, so they need a scenario-wide review.

Mercenaries

A mercenary band defines:

- arrival tier;
- commander;
- unit type;
- unit count;
- names and price-related behaviour.

Mercenaries are globally available content. A nation-specific balance patch should not create a universally dominant mercenary without intending to alter every game.

General commands

General modding affects shared game rules. It has the widest compatibility surface. Every general command should be treated as an explicit ruleset dependency and placed in the mod's description and change log.

Part VII: Event Modding as a State Machine

Events are advanced modding

Event modding uses the same `.dm` file but adds:

- probabilistic selection;
- province eligibility;
- nation eligibility;
- commander targeting;
- persistent province codes;
- global variables;
- delayed and global execution;
- world effects;
- event chains.

An event is best understood as a state transition:

```
current game state
+ event eligibility
+ event selection
-> effects
-> new state
```

The source block must answer three questions:

1. When can this event be considered?
2. Who or what does it target?
3. Which persistent state changes after it fires?

Event anatomy

```
#newevent
#rarity ...
#req_...
#req_...
#msg "..."
#effect...
#code ...
#end
```

Requirements are combined unless a command explicitly allows several alternatives. Adding more requirements narrows eligibility; it does not necessarily make the event less frequent after eligibility unless rarity or probability also changes.

Event rarity classes

Value	Class	Practical use
0	Always	One ordinary always event per province per month
1	Common bad	Random bad event pool
2	Uncommon bad	Rarer bad event
5	Always, unlimited	Several can occur in one province; use carefully
-1	Common good	Random good event pool
-2	Uncommon good	Rarer good event
10	Always global	Planned global processing
11	Common global	Global random event
12	Uncommon global	Rarer global event
13	Always immediate global	Immediate global processing

The official manual states that most global events are planned seven months before execution so fortune tellers can foresee them. Rarity 13 is immediate.

Rarity 5 is powerful and dangerous. An unrestricted rarity-5 event can be considered across many provinces every month and can create event storms or hosting cost.

Probability is conditional

`#req_rare 20` does not mean a 20% monthly chance for a nation in isolation. It means the event has a 20% validity chance when considered, after the event system and other requirements bring it into scope.

Similarly:

```
#req_domchance 5
```

multiplies eligibility by dominion strength: at c candles the documented chance factor is 5c%, provided the event would otherwise occur.

Probability statements should specify:

- event rarity;
- eligible province count;
- per-month limits;
- dominion or turn factor;
- uniqueness;
- owner and target conditions.

Requirements are filters

Major requirement families include:

Family	Examples of questions
Generic	Era, turn, month, season, story events, AI
Nation	In play, recipient, excluded nation or ally

Family	Examples of questions
Treasury	Gold, gem type, active-path gems
Research	School and minimum level
Province	Population, unrest, PD, terrain, plane, fort, lab, temple
Site	Present, hidden, discovered, nearby, Throne, free slots
Dominion	Owner, candle strength, god form, awake state
Scales	Order, Productivity, Heat, Growth, Luck, Magic
Monster	Monster present or absent
Mage	Paths, type, order, characteristics
Target	Legal commander selected for effect
Code	Province and world event-chain state
Enchantment	Global active, owner, hostile, target
Variable	Global integer state

The safest event begins with the narrowest stable identity:

- intended nation;
- intended terrain or site;
- intended turn window;
- intended target order;
- uniqueness or variable gate.

Province event codes

Events can place numeric codes on provinces. Later events can require, forbid, locate, or remove those codes.

The official manual recommends negative codes from `-300` to `-5000`, with `0` as the default/reset state. Two mods using the same code can scramble chains.

Create a code registry:

Range	System
-300 to -399	Tutorial and introduction
-400 to -499	Diplomacy warnings
-500 to -599	Grudges and sanctions
-600 to -699	Coalition escalation
-700 to -799	Scenario objectives

The exact allocation is project-specific. What matters is that it is written, checked against dependencies, and never recycled casually.

Event variables

Event variables are global integers numbered 0-9999. They begin at zero and can be checked or altered.

Special negative references are translated:

Reference	Documented interpretation
-1	Nation receiving the event
-2	500 + player number
-3	1000 + province number
-4	3000 + province number

These mappings reserve broad portions of the variable space implicitly. The manual warns that `-1` can alter variables up to 499, while province-derived forms can reach higher blocks.

Use variables for:

- once-per-player events;
- relationship scores;
- warning stages;
- global objectives;
- cooldowns;
- campaign chapters;
- counted thresholds.

Use province codes for:

- local state;
- marked borders;
- regional event chains;
- site or province transformations.

Do not substitute one for the other without considering scope.

Once-per-player pattern

A reliable conceptual pattern is:

```
require the recipient's variable to be zero
apply the event
increment that recipient's variable
```

Using the special nation variable reference provides one state cell per recipient. A public community explanation by experienced modder Sombre confirms this interpretation and matches the Event Manual's stated purpose.

Targets are not automatically "any mage"

Many effects require a valid target commander. Requirements can filter:

- monster type;
- humanoid or other body class;
- path levels;
- sight or gem possession;
- current order;
- positive or absent paths;
- properties such as Pretender, prophet, or special status.

An event intended to affect a site-searching mage should require the site-search order. An event intended for a temple-based teacher should require the appropriate province and target class.

Target testing records:

- no eligible commander;
- one eligible commander;
- several eligible commanders;
- same commander with different orders;
- commander in and outside fort;
- prophet, Pretender, mounted, transformed, and disguised cases;
- ally or disciple where relevant.

Messages can carry required object names

Some site and item commands read the exact object name from square brackets at the end of the event message.

Consequences:

- spelling and capitalization must match;
- a localization-like prose edit can break mechanics;
- renaming an object requires an event-message audit;
- brackets should be treated as data, not decoration.

Keep the required name on a dedicated final line in source comments even if the public message is rewritten.

Event chains

A bounded chain has:

1. initial eligibility;
2. first effect;
3. state marker;
4. follow-up eligibility;
5. follow-up effect;
6. reset or terminal marker.

Conceptual example:

```
Stage 0: no warning
-> expansion threshold crossed
Stage 1: warning code or variable
-> threshold remains crossed after cooldown
Stage 2: grievance and local penalties
-> repeated violation or war state
Stage 3: coalition invitation
-> resolution
Terminal: reset, peace, victory, or permanent hostility
```

Every chain needs:

- terminal state;
- re-entry policy;
- cooldown;
- uniqueness scope;
- recovery path;

- compatibility namespace.

Without a terminal state, an event chain becomes an accidental recurring tax.

Delays and the global event calendar

Events can be delayed or added to the global calendar. The calendar holds planned global events for the coming seven months.

Delayed systems must answer:

- can the initiating condition cease before execution?
- should the delayed event recheck ownership or war?
- can the target die?
- can the province change owner?
- can several copies queue?
- is there a purge or cancellation path?

The most common narrative error is treating delayed execution as if the original state were frozen.

Global-enchantment events

The Event Manual provides a simple pattern in which an enchantment identity enables immediate or recurring events. A robust global uses separate events for:

- owner income or boon;
- hostile-province effect;
- terrain-specific effect;
- dominion-scaled effect;
- messaging;
- cleanup or cessation.

Every recurring event should use the narrowest rarity and a per-month cap where possible.

Event effects and transactional thinking

Effects include:

- gold, gems, items, and treasure;
- scales, population, unrest, defence, terrain, and sites;
- commanders and units;
- afflictions, healing, path boosts, transformation, and items;
- enchantment and world effects;
- event codes and variables;
- delays and calendar manipulation;
- victory requirements.

Treat a multi-effect event as a transaction:

```
validate all prerequisites
-> alter local state
-> grant or remove assets
-> write chain state last
```

Although the engine does not provide database rollback, this order makes the design easier to reason about and reduces half-complete chains.

Event performance

An event system can be logically correct and operationally expensive.

Cost rises with:

- rarity-5 checks across every province;
- broad monster requirements;
- several global scans;
- repeated nearby-code checks;
- many always events;
- unbounded spawning;
- event chains that never terminate.

The 6.29 update reported a major performance improvement for events using monster-presence requirements, which confirms that event-query cost is material.

Performance doctrine:

- filter by nation and terrain early;
- avoid worldwide checks where a per-player variable is sufficient;
- cap monthly executions;
- make dormant stages ineligible;
- use one scheduler event to enable narrower local events;
- measure hosting time on a large map.

Part VIII: Simulating Diplomacy and Strategic Reaction

What event modding can accomplish

An event system can create:

- warnings after expansion thresholds;
- consequences for dominion pressure;
- responses to claimed Thrones;
- retaliation against repeated raiding;
- defensive reinforcements;
- temporary sanctions;
- border unrest;
- hostile summons;
- coalition-themed messages;
- gifts or concessions after restraint;
- campaign reputation;
- AI-only bonuses triggered by a human threat.

This can make the world react coherently.

What it cannot honestly claim

Ordinary modding does not expose a general rewrite of the AI's strategic mind. It does not provide an open-ended diplomatic planner capable of:

- understanding free-form promises;
- evaluating arbitrary treaties;
- remembering nuanced betrayal;
- planning coalition manoeuvres as a human group;
- reasoning about every modded unit and spell;
- negotiating outside the supported diplomacy systems.

Events can simulate consequences and staged attitudes. AI hints can influence recruitment, Pretender design, research, rituals, and spell preference. That combination can create convincing strategic theatre, but it should not be described as a new general intelligence.

The reaction-layer architecture

A practical diplomacy overhaul has five layers:

Layer	Responsibility
Observation	Detect measurable state such as Thrones, borders, dominion, wars, ownership, or turn
Memory	Store province codes and player variables
Interpretation	Convert thresholds into warning, grievance, hostility, or coalition stage
Response	Apply messages, troops, resources, attacks, or restrictions
Recovery	Reduce hostility, expire sanctions, or reset after peace

The structure is deliberately finite. Each grievance is a state machine with explicit inputs and outputs.

Observable proxies

When the desired concept is not directly exposed, use a measurable proxy.

Desired concept	Possible proxy
Rapid expansion	Province ownership checked over staged turn windows
Border pressure	Codes in neighbouring provinces
Religious aggression	Dominion ownership and candle thresholds
Throne threat	Claimed Throne requirements and Ascension Point state
Warmonger	War-related state combined with repeat counters
Broken warning	Prior warning variable plus continued trigger
Coalition concern	Several nations independently reaching hostility stage
Restraint	Cooldown without further violations

The proxy must be disclosed in design notes. A player should be able to understand why the world reacted.

Warning before punishment

A believable system escalates:

1. observation;

2. warning;
3. opportunity to change;
4. limited response;
5. severe response;
6. recovery or permanent feud.

Immediate punishment teaches the trigger but does not feel diplomatic. A warning creates agency.

Avoiding hidden rubber-banding

AI assistance should be legible and bounded.

Good assistance:

- named emergency levy after a capital threat;
- temporary resources after a formal warning;
- faction-specific defenders;
- one coalition response after a Throne threshold.

Poor assistance:

- silent monthly gold;
- infinite unannounced armies;
- bonuses that remain after the threat disappears;
- punishment aimed only at the leading human regardless of cause.

Scenario difficulty should arise from declared rules.

Relationship-state registry

With N nations, pairwise relationship storage can become expensive. A full directed matrix requires N(N-1) cells. For 20 nations that is 380 directional relationships.

Event variables are limited and shared. A first design should avoid a full matrix.

Prefer:

- one reputation score per player;
- one global threat stage per player;
- province-local border markers;
- specific scripted rivalries only where necessary;
- separate coalition flags for major objectives.

Pairwise state should be reserved for campaign scenarios with a controlled roster.

Anti-loop rules

Every diplomacy response needs:

- once-per-stage gating;
- cooldown;
- maximum reinforcements;
- owner recheck;
- game-alive recheck;
- target recheck;
- terminal resolution;

- no valid-target behaviour.

A coalition event that summons troops every month until a province is recaptured can become an infinite unit generator if the target becomes unreachable.

Fairness matrix

Question	Acceptable design
Is the trigger visible?	Message, rule sheet, or inspectable threshold
Can the response be avoided?	At least one strategic alternative
Is the response proportional?	Escalation matches offence stage
Does the AI receive value?	Enough to act, not infinite replacement
Can hostility fall?	Cooldown, concession, peace, or objective change
Can the system target allies incorrectly?	Ally exclusions and ownership rechecks
Does it work for AI offenders?	Explicit AI/human scope
Does it scale with map size?	Thresholds tied to settings or scenario

A recommended first diplomacy module

Begin with one grievance: early Throne pressure.

State:

- player threat variable;
- one warning-fired variable;
- one sanction-fired variable.

Inputs:

- turn window;
- claimed Throne requirement;
- Ascension threshold;
- whether story events are enabled.

Responses:

- warning message;
- temporary unrest or diplomatic penalty in marked border provinces;
- one defensive grant to threatened AI nations;
- final coalition-themed global message.

Recovery:

- fixed expiry;
- no recurring unit creation;
- no hidden permanent income.

This module is small enough to prove the structure before adding expansion, dominion, and raiding grievances.

Part IX: Maps and Scenario Design

The map is a ruleset

A map decides:

- who can meet;
- how quickly capitals can be reached;
- where armies can retreat;
- which terrain recruits and rituals are available;
- how valuable sailing, flying, mountain movement, and amphibious access become;
- how many fronts a nation must defend;
- whether caves and the Nexus matter;
- how difficult a Throne is to contest;
- whether remote spells can reach strategic centres.

Visual beauty matters, but topology and strategic distribution matter first.

Hand-drawn map assets

The Map Making Manual requires a Targa image for the principal hand-drawn map:

- at least 256x256 pixels;
- 24- or 32-bit colour;
- a practical example size around 1600x1200;
- no problematic alpha channel;
- legal filename without spaces or special characters.

Province centres are defined by individual pure-white pixels with RGB `255,255,255`. Ordinary white artwork should use a near-white such as `253,253,253` so it is not mistaken for an extra province.

Province pixels should be:

- one pixel;
- on a separate image layer during creation;
- merged only for export;
- counted before import.

An accidental white pixel is an accidental province.

Province borders and areas

Visible borders are not technically required, but they communicate adjacency. Keep them on a separate layer so the map editor can use a border-only image.

Province areas matter for:

- mouse selection;
- dominion overlay;
- terrain-change graphics;
- readable map feedback.

The editor supports an area workflow:

1. switch to Province Area mode;
2. import or paint border areas;
3. expand areas to fill gaps;
4. remove stray pixels;

5. inspect every province;
6. test dominion overlay.

Connections are strategic edges

The map editor can create:

- ordinary connections;
- mountain passes;
- river borders;
- bridges;
- impassable connections;
- roads.

The manual's special-border values are:

Value	Border
0	Standard
1	Mountain pass
2	River
4	Impassable
8	Road

An impassable connection can still matter for spell targeting. A line that appears decorative may affect range or adjacency.

Connection audit:

- every visual border matches mechanical adjacency;
- every non-visual connection is intentionally signalled;
- capitals have comparable exit counts;
- no province is accidentally isolated;
- retreats do not create one-way traps;
- wrap connections are readable;
- bridge and pass effects match the artwork.

Required map commands

Every hand-drawn map file needs:

```
#dom2title "Map Title"
#imagefile "mapname.tga"
#mapsize <width> <height>
```

The historical command name `#dom2title` remains in use.

Useful metadata includes:

- `#domversion`;
- `#description`;
- plane name;
- hidden-map behaviour;
- cave-plane controls.

Terrain masks

Common terrain-mask components include:

Value	Terrain or property
0	Plains
1	Small province
2	Large province
4	Sea
8	Freshwater
16	Highlands or gorge
32	Swamp
64	Waste
128	Forest or kelp forest
256	Farm
512	No random start
1024	Many sites
2048	Deep, combined with sea
4096	Cave
8388608	Mountains
33554432	Good Throne location
67108864	Good start location
134217728	Bad Throne location
1073741824	Warmer
2147483648	Colder
68719476736	Cave wall

Values are added. The official example `1601` is:

$$1 + 64 + 512 + 1024$$

meaning small, waste, no-start, and many-sites.

Rare site-bias components include Fire through Holy site biases. These are advanced and must be added to the map-editor mask manually.

Do not hand-calculate terrain masks without retaining the decomposition.

Terrain density

The official manual advises that a province generally contain only one adverse terrain type, or at most two. Forest, waste, highland, swamp, and cave combinations slow movement. Too many mixed provinces can make a beautiful map strategically inert.

Terrain audit:

- percentage of provinces by terrain;
- mixed-adverse percentage;

- capital-ring terrain;
- chokepoint terrain;
- recruit and summon access;
- supply;
- underwater distribution;
- national start preferences;
- seasonal and extreme-scale changes.

Starts

Starting fairness is not equal distance alone.

For every start, record:

- adjacent province count;
- adjacent income and population;
- adjacent resources;
- terrain;
- water access;
- cave access;
- nearest neighbour distance;
- nearest Throne distance;
- number of defensible approaches;
- expansion dead ends;
- nearby high-site provinces.

`#nostart` and the terrain mask value 512 exclude random starts. If a province is marked as both a start and no-start, no-start wins.

`#specstart` assigns a particular nation to a particular start. Scripted maps must use current Dominions 6 nation numbers.

Thrones

Throne placement shapes diplomacy and victory timing.

Audit:

- total Ascension Points;
- central versus peripheral Thrones;
- level distribution;
- capital proximity;
- underwater Thrones;
- plane distribution;
- chokepoint control;
- ability to attack and retreat;
- whether one start can claim safely without revealing itself.

Good and bad Throne-location terrain masks guide placement but do not replace manual review.

Province contents

After selecting an active land, map commands can set:

- ownership;
- name;
- population;
- defence;
- unrest;
- fort;
- laboratory;
- temple;
- sites;
- commanders;
- units;
- commander equipment and magic.

This allows designed independents, campaign characters, guarded objectives, and asymmetrical starts.

A placed commander can be altered with map-specific commands for:

- name;
- bodyguards;
- units;
- experience;
- random equipment;
- exact item;
- magic paths.

If the commander is a modded monster, the map may need to refer to it by name rather than number. This creates a dependency on the mod and should be documented.

Scenario gods and scales

Maps can force a Pretender, dominion strength, and scales for a nation. Human-controlled nations that violate ordinary design-point limits can trigger cheat detection.

Use forced designs for:

- campaigns;
- puzzle scenarios;
- historical rematches;
- AI bosses;
- controlled test maps.

Do not use them casually in an ordinary multiplayer map.

Multiple planes

Dominions 6 maps can contain up to eight planes: the main plane and seven additional planes.

Each plane requires its own map and image files using the documented naming pattern such as `_plane2`. The map editor should be opened through the first plane so related planes are loaded together.

Event plane requirements can refer to:

- default plane;
- numbered extra planes;

- cave plane;
- Nexus plane.

Plane design questions:

- how is entry obtained?
- can a nation begin there?
- which gates connect it?
- can remote rituals cross?
- what happens if the gate province falls?
- are objectives distributed across planes?
- does the AI understand the route well enough?

Gates

Map gates connect provinces that share a gate number. A gate network can:

- bypass distance;
- create a contested hub;
- link planes;
- support a campaign chapter;
- undermine ordinary chokepoints.

Every gate needs:

- visible explanation;
- reciprocal test;
- ownership test;
- siege test;
- AI pathing test;
- remote-spell adjacency review.

Terrain graphics

Dominions 6 can display altered terrain using additional image layers:

```
mymap.tga
mymap_winter.tga
mymap_forest.tga
mymap_waste.tga
mymap_farm.tga
mymap_swamp.tga
mymap_highland.tga
mymap_plain.tga
mymap_kelp.tga
mymap_water.tga
```

Winter variants can add `w`. Multiple-plane filenames place the plane component before the terrain component.

Missing terrain images do not necessarily prevent play; the default look is used. They do reduce visual accuracy when terrain changes.

Random map generator

The RMG creates a playable starting point and stores geography in `.d6m` files. It does not remove the need for human inspection.

After generation:

- inspect connection logic;
- inspect capital spacing;
- inspect lakes and cave relationships;
- inspect wrap edges;
- inspect Throne candidates;
- inspect provinces whose artwork implies a connection that does not exist;
- inspect strategic islands.

The binary `d6m` format stores the shape of lands, capital coordinates, a height field, and province ownership pixels. Terrain and other game information remain in the map file. The file-format document is mainly relevant to automated map generators.

Workshop packaging

A Workshop map folder contains:

```
maps/
Antworld/
Antworld.map
Antworld.tga
banner.png
dom6ws.txt
```

The folder, map, and main image should share the same name.

The Workshop banner is 256x256 or 512x512 PNG. `dom6ws.txt` sets visibility to Public, Friends, or Private. The platform creates an additional persistent ID file after first upload; deleting it can create a new Workshop entry rather than updating the old one.

Scenario-design ladder

Symmetric competitive map

Focus:

- start equivalence;
- comparable expansion;
- Throne fairness;
- readable connections.

Asymmetric cooperative map

Focus:

- declared role differences;
- shared enemy pressure;
- comeback routes;
- objective pacing.

Campaign map

Focus:

- placed forces;
- scripted chapters;
- persistent event state;
- named characters;
- narrative gates.

AI challenge map

Focus:

- AI-compatible routes;
- controlled advantages;
- reinforcements with limits;
- clear victory condition;
- no reliance on human-like diplomacy.

Test harness map

Focus:

- minimum provinces;
- deterministic contents;
- short travel;
- exact terrain;
- isolated experiments;
- reproducible turn-one setup.

Part X: AI Modding

Three different AIs

It is useful to separate:

1. Strategic AI: recruitment, expansion, forts, armies, rituals, and research.
2. Spell AI: battlefield spell selection and targeting.
3. Scripted event response: bonuses, attacks, warnings, and scenario state.

They interact, but they are not one system.

Nation-level AI hints

The Modding Manual exposes several nation hints:

Hint	Purpose
Elemental or sorcery path nation hints	Encourage a Pretender with that path
`#bloodnation`	Encourage Blood research and hunting
`#aigoodbless`	Raise chance of a powerful bless

Hint	Purpose
`#aimusthavemag`	Require at least level 3 in one specified path
`#aicheapholy`	Signal cheap expendable sacreds
`#aiholyranged`	Signal sacred ranged troops
`#aiheavyrec`	Encourage resource-heavy troop recruitment
`#aimagerec`	Encourage mage recruitment
`#aiholdgod`	Keep the Pretender in the home province
`#aiawake`	Raise the chance of an awake Pretender

These commands alter preferences. They do not prove that the resulting strategy is coherent.

Unit-level recruitment hints

`#ainorec` tells the AI not to recruit a monster. `#aisinglerec` tells it to recruit only one in a batch.

Use `#ainorec` when a unit:

- requires a human-only trick;
- is a trap for the AI;
- is a ceremonial or transformation object not intended for ordinary recruitment;
- consumes resources without filling a usable AI role.

Use `#aisinglerec` for:

- expensive support;
- rare specialists;
- units whose value does not scale linearly;
- commanders or troop-like objects that should not fill a queue.

AI Pretender templates

AI templates can specify:

- nation;
- chassis;
- awakening;
- paths;
- dominion strength;
- scales;
- blessings;
- research targets;
- favourite rituals or items.

The game can export a designed Pretender template with `ctrl+shift+s`. This is safer than hand-authoring a complex legal build.

Template design should include several viable plans rather than one brittle script:

- awake expander;
- dormant scales;
- bless;
- access or ritual chassis.

If several templates exist for one nation, the AI can choose among them.

Research goals

`#researchgoal` names a spell or item the AI should work toward. Several goals are pursued in order, although the manual warns that research will not follow the list perfectly.

A research sequence should:

- contain reachable goals;
- match national paths;
- alternate survival and power;
- avoid an item the AI cannot forge;
- avoid a ritual the AI cannot fund;
- account for national spells.

Bad goal:

```
late legendary spell
```

with no earlier battlefield package.

Better sequence:

```
early defensive spell
-> first national summon
-> battlefield damage package
-> booster or key item
-> strategic ritual
```

Favourite rituals and items

`#favrit` can encourage a ritual or item. It includes a research school and level after which the favourite is disabled, or a persistent setting.

Favourite design must consider:

- gem income;
- path availability;
- laboratory access;
- target availability;
- whether repeated casting is useful;
- whether the result has leadership;
- whether the AI will strand expensive summons.

AI testing is behavioural sampling

An AI instruction is not validated by one game.

Record over several seeds:

- Pretender family;
- scales;
- first twenty commander recruits;
- troop mix;
- first three research targets reached;
- first forged items;

- first national rituals;
- expansion count;
- forts by turn;
- gem stockpiles;
- whether key mages enter combat;
- whether special units accumulate unused.

The goal is not identical behaviour. It is the absence of catastrophic patterns.

AI bonuses versus AI competence

An AI can be made harder by:

- game difficulty settings;
- better roster;
- better template;
- better research goals;
- targeted event resources;
- scripted reinforcements;
- scenario terrain.

These are different interventions. A report should not attribute victory to "better AI" if the main change was an unannounced resource grant.

Part XI: Compatibility Engineering

A mod has dependencies even when it declares none

Dependencies include:

- game version;
- object numbers;
- copied parent objects;
- object names;
- parser phase;
- load order;
- event-code ranges;
- variable ranges;
- map names;
- Workshop identity;
- assumed base-game balance.

A compatibility record should name all of them.

Freeze exact source

For every dependency, retain:

- filename;
- internal version;
- file size;
- cryptographic hash;

- acquisition date;
- intended order;
- known patch baseline.

"Latest DE" is not reproducible. `DomEnhanced2_16.dm` with a recorded hash is.

Build an object-overlap matrix

Parse each source for selectors and new-object allocations:

Object type	Mod A changes	Mod B changes	Overlap
Monsters	Count	Count	Shared identities
Weapons	Count	Count	Shared identities
Armour	Count	Count	Shared identities
Sites	Count	Count	Shared identities
Spells	Count	Count	Shared identities
Items	Count	Count	Shared identities
Nations	Count	Count	Shared identities
Events	Count	Count	Code and variable collisions

Book IX applies this matrix to the supplied DE and Divinitus files. Keeping the exact totals there prevents the modding method and the live compatibility record from drifting apart. The lesson retained here is that overlap marks an integration surface, not a proven bug count.

Reconstruct a shared object

For one shared identity:

1. begin with base-game state;
2. apply the first mod's copy, clear, and setters;
3. apply the second mod's copy, clear, and setters;
4. include source invoked through shapes, mounts, items, sites, and events;
5. list visible final fields;
6. list invisible or behavioural fields;
7. mark uncertain engine interactions;
8. inspect and test.

Worked examples

The Grand Hierophant reconstruction now lives with the Arcoscephale dossier in Book VII, while the broader DE/Divinitus identity and collision analysis lives in Book IX. Book VIII keeps the method so it can be reused with any pair of mods.

Compatibility patch structure

A compatibility patch should:

```
declare both dependencies and order
-> reselect every shared object that needs resolution
```

```
-> clear only when rebuilding completely
-> set the intended final fields explicitly
-> repair recruitment, sites, spells, items, and events
-> reserve its own codes and variables
-> provide a combined change log
```

Avoid copying an entire parent mod into the patch. That creates an unauthorized fork, obscures provenance, and makes updates harder.

Conflict classes

Class	Example	Resolution
Direct setter conflict	Two costs on same monster	Choose and document final value
Clear conflict	Later `#clearrec` removes additions	Re-add intended recruitment
Identity collision	Two new weapons use same ID	Reallocate and repair references
Name dependency	Spell referenced by renamed name	Replace with stable identity where possible
Event code collision	Two chains use `-509`	Allocate new range and update chain
Variable collision	Both use player variable block	Registry and remap
Shape conflict	Parent form changed by one mod	Rebuild graph
Site conflict	Same recruitment site altered	Explicit combined site
AI conflict	One forbids a spell another favours	Combined AI policy
Map dependency	Scenario names a missing unit	Declare required mod and verify

Patch-aware command ledger

The public game can advance beyond the manual. Important current examples include:

- 6.24: new item, event, monster, weapon, and site commands plus fixes;
- 6.25: new spell, item, and event controls;
- 6.27: fort-terrain recruitment, battle summons, enchanted blood, and AI fixes;
- 6.29: `#copysite`, new weapon rolls, unseen, event realm checks, and performance work;
- 6.30: event-variable unit counts, optional site additions, new spell-cost controls, and new monster abilities;
- 6.33: spell home-realm command;
- 6.35: multiple-same-name site reveal and removal fix.

The ledger should record:

Field	Meaning
Command or fix	Exact technical subject
Introduced	First official version
Manual present	Yes, no, or ambiguous
Project use	Files and blocks using it
Minimum version	Required `#domversion`
Regression	Test that proves current behaviour

Converting Dominions 5 projects

The official manual identifies changed numbers for:

- nations;
- magic items;
- sites;
- spells;
- forts;
- random events.

Dominions 6 also changes:

- mounted-unit architecture;
- Glamour and former Air illusion themes;
- army scale;
- mod folder layout;
- map start and mountain-border values;
- terrain-change imagery;
- new planes and systems.

Conversion order:

1. make the project load;
2. replace object numbers;
3. rebuild mounts;
4. review paths and Glamour;
5. review recruitment and starting armies;
6. review spells, items, sites, and events;
7. rebuild maps in the current editor;
8. add current metadata and folders;
9. conduct a full balance pass.

Compatibility is not proven by the absence of a load error.

Part XII: Testing, Validation, and Release Engineering

Four validation layers

Layer	Question
Static	Is the source structurally plausible?
Load	Does the game parse and enable it?
Object	Do final cards and recruit lists match intent?
Behaviour	Does the system act correctly in battle, ritual, event, AI, and campaign play?

No one layer replaces another.

Static validation

Automated or manual checks should detect:

- missing final newline;
- unmatched object blocks;
- duplicate explicit IDs;
- duplicate event codes;
- variable-range overlap;
- illegal filenames;
- missing referenced images;
- mixed path separators;
- references to undeclared dependencies;
- accidental tabs or smart quotes where tools mishandle them;
- selectors without identity comments;
- source blocks inserted into a released automatic-ID sequence.

Static validation cannot prove engine semantics.

Load validation

Test configurations:

1. project alone;
2. dependency alone;
3. project plus each dependency;
4. full intended order;
5. reversed order where diagnosis matters;
6. dedicated/network-lobby path;
7. text-only or headless host path where relevant.

Record exact error text and the minimal failing source.

Object validation

For every changed object:

- inspect `ctrl+i`;
- record final number;
- record visible stats;
- record recruit source;
- record spell or item restriction;
- compare against baseline;
- capture a screenshot or exported record;
- mark hidden behaviour for live testing.

Behaviour validation

Unit

- attack, defence, fatigue, route;
- equipment;
- mount;

- shapes;
- leadership;
- recruitment;
- upkeep;
- death and retreat.

Spell

- legal caster;
- cost;
- targeting;
- resistance;
- AI;
- range;
- environment;
- ritual result;
- global identity.

Event

- eligibility;
- probability conditions;
- target;
- state write;
- follow-up;
- duplication;
- no-target case;
- ownership change;
- game-alive check;
- performance.

Map

- provinces;
- areas;
- connections;
- starts;
- Thrones;
- planes;
- gates;
- terrain visuals;
- AI travel.

Minimal reproduction mods

When a behaviour is uncertain, create a mod containing:

- metadata;
- one copied or selected object;
- one changed command;
- one test event or map;
- no unrelated dependency.

Then compare:

- command absent;
- command present with low value;
- command present with high value;
- interaction case.

A full overhaul is evidence of a bug only after the problem survives reduction.

Test harness maps

Maintain small maps for:

- melee and missile damage;
- mounts and area effects;
- shapechanges;
- ritual range;
- site events;
- dominion events;
- global enchantments;
- gates and planes;
- AI recruitment;
- siege and fort recruitment.

Each harness should specify:

- game version;
- enabled mods and order;
- exact nations;
- start province;
- seed if available;
- commands;
- expected result;
- observed result.

Regression matrix

Test ID	System	Baseline	Changed	Combined	Status
MNT-01	Mount death	Base game	Project	Full mod stack	Pass/fail
EVT-01	Once per player	No event	Project	Full mod stack	Pass/fail
MAP-01	Gate link	No gate	Scenario	Dependencies	Pass/fail
AI-01	Mage recruitment	Vanilla AI	Template	Full stack	Distribution

Every fixed bug receives a regression test. Otherwise the same defect returns during unrelated work.

Balance records

Balance notes should distinguish:

- observed fact;
- intended role;
- comparison object;

- economic cost;
- counter class;
- problem;
- change;
- expected consequence;
- retest result.

"Too strong" is not a diagnosis. Better:

> At 18 gold and 9 recruitment points, the unit replaces both the national line holder and damage dealer, wins the heavy-infantry comparison without mage support, and remains more mobile. Raise throughput cost or narrow its damage class.

Versioning

Use a predictable scheme:

- major: save-breaking redesign or dependency shift;
- minor: new compatible content or important balance revision;
- patch: corrections that preserve object order and intended play.

Each release records:

- game version;
- dependency versions;
- load order;
- save compatibility;
- new object IDs;
- new event-code and variable ranges;
- balance changes;
- fixed defects;
- known issues.

Release candidates

A release candidate is frozen except for fixes.

Checklist:

- source hash recorded;
- no placeholder descriptions;
- all filenames legal;
- dependencies declared;
- standalone and combined load tests complete;
- network test complete;
- new-game requirement stated;
- change log complete;
- Workshop visibility correct;
- regression suite complete;
- public guide updated.

Research questions that can be resolved without the project owner

Questions are suitable for independent resolution when they can be answered through:

- current official manuals;
- official patch notes;
- exact supplied source;
- a reliable published reproduction with version and method;
- a locally available game executable and controlled harness.

Questions remain pending when:

- source describes intent but engine resolution is ambiguous;
- community statements lack version or procedure;
- the result depends on the user's private save or settings;
- the game executable is unavailable;
- several current sources conflict.

No user action is needed merely to preserve a pending label.

Part XIII: Complete Project Workflows

Workflow A: A one-object balance patch

Objective

Change one existing object's role without altering unrelated systems.

Research

Record:

- game and mod version;
- object number and name;
- current final card;
- recruitment source;
- comparison objects;
- reason for change.

Source

```
#modname "Example Role Patch"
#description "Versioned adjustment for Dominions 6.36."
#version 0.10
#domversion 6.36

#selectmonster <number> -- name and provenance
#gcost <value>
#rpcost <value>
#end
```

Validation

- loads alone;
- loads with intended mod stack;
- final cost appears;
- no equipment or magic changed;
- recruitment source remains;
- AI still recruits a sensible quantity;
- ongoing-game policy stated.

Release record

> Reduced or increased throughput to preserve the unit's battlefield role while preventing it from replacing the nearest alternatives.

This is more useful than "nerfed unit."

Workflow B: A new national troop

Objective

Add one unit that fills a missing role rather than duplicating a superior version of an existing unit.

Design statement

Name:

- role;
- intended target;
- intended counter;
- gold, resource, and recruitment-point constraint;
- recruitment location;
- national theme.

Source architecture

```
new or copied weapon
-> new fixed-ID monster
-> equipment and cost
-> nation or site recruitment
-> AI hint
```

Audit

Question	Evidence
Does it replace an existing troop?	Fort-turn and battle comparison
Does it erase a counter?	Defence-class tests
Is it recruitable at intended scale?	Resource and recruitment calculations
Can the AI use it?	Recruitment samples
Does it affect starting armies or PD?	Nation-source check
Does it require a dependency?	Copy and equipment provenance

Failure signs

- best damage, protection, and mobility in one body;
- lower cost than the unit it replaces;
- no resource or recruitment bottleneck;
- AI fills every queue with it;
- national magic makes its designed counter irrelevant.

Workflow C: A new mage

Objective

Create access without accidentally giving a nation every threshold in a path.

Magic portfolio

Write the mage as rolls:

```
fixed paths
+ guaranteed random
+ independent partial random
+ rare random
```

Calculate:

- probability of each path at level 1;
- probability of important level-2 or level-3 thresholds;
- probability of crosspath combinations;
- expected recruits;
- 90% and 95% acquisition points;
- impossible combinations.

Strategic audit

Check:

- new boosters;
- new site-search levels;
- new national rituals;
- new globals;
- new battlefield packages;
- communion or chorus role;
- research-to-gold ratio;
- capital or terrain restriction;
- commander-point pressure.

A single rare crosspath can be more important than the mage's common paths.

Workflow D: A national spell-and-item ladder

Objective

Give a nation a themed progression without creating a self-contained ladder that bypasses all external constraints.

Ladder

```
early spell
-> first battlefield role
-> construction item
-> higher path access
-> national summon or ritual
-> late strategic payoff
```

For each step:

- school and level;
- native caster probability;
- item requirement;
- gem source;
- mage-turn cost;
- effect;
- counter;
- AI goal.

Test

- first legal turn in an ordinary game;
- earliest plausible rush;
- worst random-path delay;
- item-loss recovery;
- gem scarcity;
- counter-research timing;
- AI access.

Workflow E: A bounded national event

Objective

Grant one thematic effect under conditions that can be understood and tested.

Pattern

```
#newevent
#rarity 0
#req_fornation <nation>
#req_turn <minimum>
#req_unique 1
#req_rare <percent>
#req_... <stable condition>
#msg "Visible explanation."
#effect...
#end
```

This is a pattern, not a universal template. Rarity and requirements must match the intended scope.

Required tests

- correct nation;
- wrong nation;
- before minimum turn;
- after minimum turn;

- condition absent;
- condition present;
- second attempted occurrence;
- multiplayer and disciple scope;
- no valid target.

Workflow F: A three-stage grievance

Objective

Make an AI nation respond to a visible strategic action.

State

Stage	Variable	Meaning
0	0	No grievance
1	1	Warning issued
2	2	Sanction active
3	3	Hostile response

Transition table

Current	Trigger	Next	Effect
0	Threshold crossed	1	Warning
1	Trigger persists after cooldown	2	Limited sanction
1	Trigger clears	0	De-escalation
2	Repeated violation	3	Hostile response
2	Long restraint	1 or 0	Sanction expires
3	Objective resolved	Terminal	Stop reinforcements

Safeguards

- one transition per month;
- no response after recipient elimination;
- owner and ally checks;
- fixed reinforcement cap;
- no full pairwise relationship matrix;
- visible messages;
- permanent hostility only when declared.

Workflow G: A custom global enchantment

Objective

Create one ritual whose ongoing effects remain bounded and dispellable.

Components

1. spell with unique enchantment identity;
2. owner-benefit event;
3. hostile-effect event;
4. terrain or dominion requirements;
5. per-month cap;
6. no-text internal events where appropriate;
7. cleanup verification.

Load test

- first cast;
- second caster contest;
- dispel;
- caster death;
- owner elimination;
- target ownership changes;
- independent provinces;
- cave and Nexus planes;
- several simultaneous globals.

Workflow H: A competitive map

Objective

Produce a map that is strategically fair without making every start identical.

Build

1. draw art and province centres;
2. import into map editor;
3. set connections;
4. paint areas;
5. assign terrain;
6. mark starts and Throne preferences;
7. generate or place sites and contents;
8. inspect capital rings;
9. run nation-start samples;
10. package and version.

Start report

For each start:

Metric	Value
Neighbours	Count
Land income potential	Estimate
Resources	Estimate
Adverse terrain	Count
Nearest capital	Steps

Metric	Value
Nearest Throne	Steps
Water or cave access	Yes/no
Chokepoint exits	Count

Outliers are then reviewed, not automatically erased. Some asymmetry is desirable; compound disadvantage is not.

Workflow I: A campaign scenario

Objective

Combine a designed map, forced starts, named commanders, and event chapters.

Chapter architecture

```
pregame setup
-> chapter variable
-> objective code
-> completion event
-> next chapter
-> terminal victory change or final event
```

Failure handling

Campaign events need alternatives when:

- a named commander dies;
- an objective province changes hands early;
- a player is eliminated;
- a site is removed;
- a gate becomes inaccessible;
- an unexpected nation receives the event.

Do not let one missing narrative object stop the campaign forever.

Workflow J: A compatibility patch

Objective

Create one explicit final ruleset from two changing parents.

Procedure

1. freeze exact parent files;
2. parse selected and new identities;
3. allocate compatibility codes and variables;
4. produce overlap matrix;
5. prioritize clears, recruitment, Pretenders, shapes, events, and globals;
6. reconstruct shared objects;
7. write the smallest explicit repair;
8. test parent A, parent B, A+B, and A+B+patch;

9. publish supported order;
10. repeat after either parent updates.

Compatibility statement

> Supports Dominions Enhanced 2.16 followed by Divinitus 1.15.3 DE on the last tested baseline. Compatibility with Dominions 6.36 remains unverified until the combined files are loaded and exercised under that executable; other orders and versions are outside the verified ruleset.

That sentence is more valuable than a broad claim of compatibility.

Part XIV: Design Essays

Essay I: Load Order Is Part of Game Design

Load order is often treated as installation trivia: place one file before another until the game stops reporting an error. In Dominions it is part of the rules.

A selected monster is usually a partial modification. One mod may change cost, another paths, another recruitment, and an event may later transform the unit. The final object exists only after every layer has been applied. Reversing two layers may change the object without either source becoming invalid.

This means a guide tied to several mods cannot discuss them as independent add-ons. "DE gives this" and "Divinitus gives that" do not automatically describe the combined game. The relevant object is the combined final state.

Load order also determines strategic value. A later `#clearrec` can remove a unit that justified an earlier balance change. A later path adjustment can unlock a ritual. A later item restriction can close it again. A later event can create the same mage with additional paths. None of these changes are cosmetic.

The design response is not to fear overlap. It is to make overlap explicit. Dependencies are frozen. Shared selectors are inventoried. Clears are treated as destructive. Final objects are written into evidence records. Compatibility patches become small declarations of intended state.

Once load order is documented this way, it stops being a mysterious source of bugs. It becomes a versioned design decision.

Essay II: An Event System Is a Small Political Engine

Dominions events are often introduced as random rewards and disasters. Their deeper value lies in memory and transition.

A province code remembers that something happened in one place. A variable remembers that something happened to a nation or the world. Requirements observe present conditions. Effects move the state forward. Together these create a finite political engine.

The engine does not understand betrayal as a human concept. It can understand that a warning was issued, a threshold remains crossed, a Throne was claimed, a border province bears a marker, and a sanction has not yet expired. That is enough to produce an intelligible sequence:

```
action
-> warning
```

```
-> choice
-> response
-> recovery or escalation
```

Believability comes from causation, not unlimited complexity. A short chain with visible triggers can feel more political than a large table of random punishments.

The main design danger is memory without decay. If every offence creates a permanent counter, the game trends towards universal hostility. Recovery is essential. Grievances need cooldowns, concessions, terminal states, or deliberate permanent-feud rules.

The second danger is hidden compensation. If an AI receives armies whenever a player succeeds, the system becomes rubber-banding. If threatened nations receive one declared levy after a warning, the same mechanical assistance becomes part of the world's politics.

Event modding cannot create unrestricted diplomatic intelligence. It can create a political grammar: actions have legible meanings and bounded consequences.

Essay III: AI Scaffolding Is Not an AI Rewrite

The exposed AI controls are meaningful. Pretender templates can prevent disastrous designs. Research goals can lead toward usable spells. Recruitment hints can reduce trap purchases. Favourite rituals can help a nation express its theme. Spell preferences can suppress destructive casting.

Yet these controls remain scaffolding around an existing decision-maker.

This distinction matters because design claims determine expectations. A mod advertised as "smarter AI" should be evaluated on decisions. A mod that grants gold, troops, and scripted attacks may be an excellent challenge system, but its difficulty comes partly from resources and scenario rules.

The strongest design uses all three AI layers honestly:

- templates make the starting plan coherent;
- hints reduce recurrent tactical and economic mistakes;
- events create strategic pressure when the ordinary AI cannot model a bespoke objective.

The result can feel much more capable. It is still important to record why.

This honesty also improves balancing. If the AI fails because it recruits the wrong unit, change the hint or roster. If it fails because it cannot understand a gate network, change the scenario. If it fails because it lacks economy, decide whether a visible subsidy fits. Calling every remedy "intelligence" hides the actual lever and makes later refinement harder.

Essay IV: Map Topology Precedes Army Balance

Two armies with identical statistics can have different value on different maps.

Sailing is ordinary on a dense landmass and decisive across chains of sea provinces. Slow heavy infantry can dominate a compact front and fail on a wide wraparound map. Remote rituals gain value when chokepoints hold armies in predictable provinces. Cave access can be a curiosity or an entire second theatre.

The map establishes the exchange rate between movement and force.

Topology also determines diplomacy. A nation with two neighbours can sustain stable borders. A central nation with five exits cannot treat the same army count as equivalent security. A nearby Throne creates conflict before a message is sent. An isolated Throne invites concealed accumulation.

For this reason competitive map testing should not begin with decorative polish. It begins with edges, starts, rings, routes, planes, and objectives. Art then communicates those rules clearly.

The same principle applies to scenarios. A scripted coalition is less important than whether coalition armies can reach the threat. A narrative gate is not meaningful if the AI cannot use it. A fortress is not a defence if every approach bypasses it.

Mapmaking is not the container around game design. It is the first layer of game design.

Essay V: Balance Is a Conversion Rate

Individual statistics are attractive because they are easy to compare. Dominions balance emerges from conversion.

Gold becomes troops. Resources determine equipment throughput. Recruitment points determine bodies per fort. Commander points become mages, scouts, and leaders. Research becomes packages. Gems become battlefield or ritual effects. Movement converts force into presence. Siege converts victory into ownership.

A unit is overpowered when it converts one or more inputs into strategic effect too efficiently, especially when it replaces several alternatives. A mage may be too efficient even with ordinary paths if research, recruitment points, and randoms combine favourably. A spell may be too efficient because its native caster is common, not because the text is spectacular.

This suggests a better balance note:

```
input
-> throughput
-> delivered role
-> counter
-> campaign consequence
```

It also explains why copying a cost from a similar unit is insufficient. The new nation may have different forts, scales, buffs, leaders, or magic. The same body enters a different conversion chain.

Good balance preserves decisions. If one recruit, research target, or item dominates every nearby alternative, the game has fewer decisions even if win rates remain uncertain.

Essay VI: Compatibility Is a Public Interface

Large mods become platforms. Other projects refer to their monsters, spells, sites, and nations even when no formal interface exists.

The moment another project depends on an object number, allocation order becomes public. The moment a compatibility file selects a monster, that monster's identity becomes shared. The moment an event uses a common code, the code occupies global namespace.

This creates responsibility:

- do not reorder automatic objects casually;
- publish dependency versions;
- reserve identifiers;
- document breaking changes;

- retain deprecated placeholders when practical;
- provide migration notes;
- make load order visible.

The objective is not permanent backward compatibility. Some redesigns justify a break. The objective is an intentional break rather than an accidental one.

Compatibility habits also help solo work. Six months later, the original author is another developer trying to remember why monster 9322 exists.

Essay VII: A Test Harness Turns Modding into Knowledge

Without a harness, modding knowledge remains anecdotal.

A battle was won, but the seed changed. An event occurred, but its rarity and eligible-province count were unknown. A combined Pretender displayed a path, but the source of that path was not traced. An AI cast a spell once, but no comparison existed.

A harness removes irrelevant variation. One unit faces one defence class. One event has one eligible province. One map has one gate pair. One AI receives one template. Expected results are written before observation.

The harness also protects future work. When a patch changes mounts, the mount suite is rerun. When a dependency updates, the overlap and regression matrix show what to inspect. When an argument becomes disputed, the library can point to conditions and results rather than confidence.

Not every question requires live testing. Official text, source, and arithmetic resolve many. The test harness is for the boundary between documented intent and engine resolution.

Part XV: Quick References and Checklists

New-mod preflight

- separate mod folder;
- matching folder and `.dm` basename;
- legal filenames;
- correct case;
- forward-slash paths;
- metadata block;
- minimum game version;
- every object block ended;
- final newline;
- identifier registry;
- no undeclared dependency.

Object-block preflight

- correct selector or creator;
- object identity comment;

- copy source recorded;
- clear scope understood;
- fields grouped;
- cost channels reviewed;
- references valid;
- `#end`;
- final card inspected.

Event preflight

- rarity;
- recipient nation;
- province and plane;
- target and order;
- turn or month window;
- probability;
- uniqueness;
- code range;
- variable range;
- effect;
- state transition;
- cooldown;
- terminal state;
- no-target behaviour;
- per-month cap;
- ally and ownership checks.

Map preflight

- legal filename;
- image mode and alpha;
- one white pixel per province;
- required commands;
- province areas;
- connections;
- special borders;
- terrain decomposition;
- start audit;
- Throne audit;
- plane and gate audit;
- AI-route audit;
- Workshop package.

AI preflight

- at least one legal Pretender template;
- scale and bless logic;
- reachable research goals;
- forgeable favourite items;
- castable favourite rituals;
- trap units suppressed;

- mage recruitment sampled;
- spell preferences tested;
- bonuses disclosed;
- several seeds observed.

Compatibility preflight

- exact parent versions;
- hashes;
- supported load order;
- object overlap;
- ID collision;
- event-code collision;
- variable collision;
- clear operations;
- recruitment reconstruction;
- shape and mount graph;
- final object cards;
- regression suite;
- save policy.

Troubleshooting decision tree

Mod absent from list

Check folder, extension, metadata, filename, final newline.

Mod reports parse error

Reduce by binary search; check quotes, arguments, selectors, and `#end`.

Object exists but is unavailable

Check nation, site, terrain, era, god list, and later clears.

Object has wrong statistics

Trace copy, clear, automatic cost, equipment, and later selectors.

Combined mods behave differently

Freeze order; build overlap matrix; reconstruct shared objects.

Event never fires

Check rarity, every requirement, recipient, target order, codes, variables, uniqueness, and eligible province count.

Event fires repeatedly

Check rarity 5, uniqueness, state write, reset, and per-month limit.

AI ignores content

Check legal access, path, gems, research goal, recruitment hint, and whether the desired reasoning is exposed at all.

Map looks right but plays wrong

Check mechanical connections, province areas, terrain mask, starts, and gates.

Project registries

Maintain:

- object IDs;
- event codes;
- event variables;
- enchantment numbers;
- map gate numbers;
- copied parent objects;
- dependency names and hashes;
- test IDs;
- known unresolved behaviours.

Open research register

The following questions remain suitable for controlled verification:

1. exact automatic allocation behaviour at the current high object ceilings;
2. parser treatment of every cross-mod name reference category;
3. which copied hidden attributes are absent from `ctrl+i`;
4. event-variable overflow and negative-value edge cases;
5. event execution order when several rarity-5 systems alter the same state;
6. performance curves for large always-event libraries;
7. AI use of multi-plane gates in varied scenarios;
8. AI template selection distributions;
9. save compatibility for inserted automatic spell and item objects;
10. combined transformation preservation for prophet, mount, heroic, and item state;
11. exact event targeting when several equally eligible commanders exist;
12. network-lobby behaviour for every filename and dependency edge case.

These remain visible rather than being converted into unsupported claims.

Part XVI: Source Register

Official sources

1. Dominions 6 documentation page - current official manual index.
2. Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34 - primary command authority for objects, nations, AI templates, and limits.
3. Dominions 6 Event Modding Manual, labelled version 6.29 - event requirements, effects, codes, variables, and examples.

4. Dominions 6 Map Making Manual, version 6.26 - map images, editor, commands, terrain, planes, and Workshop packaging.
5. Dominions 6 File Formats - binary `d6m` structure.
6. Dominions 6 official update announcements - commands and fixes introduced after earlier manual revisions.
7. Illwinter Dominions 6 changes - major system changes from Dominions 5.

Supplied source files

Dominions Enhanced 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE serve as the running compatibility examples. Their hashes, exact sizes, object counts, overlap matrix, and live findings are maintained in Book IX so that this methods volume does not become a second, stale inventory.

Community evidence

Community material is used only where:

- the version is identifiable;
- the source states a procedure or exact syntax;
- the finding is consistent with official documentation;
- the claim is labelled community-tested when not reproduced.

The once-per-player variable explanation and final-newline troubleshooting pattern meet that limited use. Unversioned recollections, wish-list commands, and isolated outcome reports are not promoted to confirmed mechanics.

Revision policy

Book VIII should be revised when:

- the public game version changes;
- any official modding manual changes;
- a relied-upon command is fixed;
- DE or Divinitus changes;
- a pending behaviour is reproduced;
- the diplomacy project allocates live code and variable ranges;
- a real compatibility patch is created.

Every revision must retain the prior ruleset label so published scenarios and saved games can still be interpreted.

DOCUMENT 11 OF 16

Foundation Book IX - Dominions Enhanced and Divinitus

The Technical Encyclopaedia of the Frozen Combined Ruleset

Dominions 6.35 Dominions Enhanced 2.16 Divinitus 1.15.3 DE edition Frozen load order: Dominions Enhanced first, Divinitus second Research edition: 31 July 2026

This is a frozen source-defined ruleset built against the recorded 6.35 baseline. The live unmodded game is now 6.36; combined runtime compatibility remains unverified and is not implied by the source analysis.

1. Purpose

Dominions Enhanced and Divinitus reach into almost every major system in Dominions 6: Pretender design, scales, battle gems, blessings, recruitment, research, underwater play, items, spells, sites, events, and dominion. Together they behave less like a pair of optional add-ons and more like a distinct edition of the game.

Book IX turns 238,821 lines of source into something that can be consulted during play and reused in later nation dossiers. It does this by following a few strict boundaries:

- the two mods are described separately before their combined result;
- every rule is tied to the exact supplied release;
- explicit definitions are distinguished from inherited vanilla fields;
- the loader and load order are treated as part of the ruleset;
- support spells, sites, items, and event variables are separated from ordinary player-facing content;
- source collisions and unresolved runtime questions remain visible;
- strategic consequences are stated as doctrine rather than disguised as facts;
- machine-readable indices support later website search and exact object pages.

The summaries and checklists provide the practical route. Command inventories, ID registries, event structure, collision analysis, and provenance records are there for deeper investigation.

2. Frozen Baseline and Evidence

2.1 Exact files

Layer	Exact file	Declared version
First mod	`DomEnhanced2_16.dm`	2.16
Second mod	`Divinitus_1.15.3_DE.dm`	1.15.3

The file fingerprints are:

- Dominions Enhanced: `72558697f8dae3a1fccf8fb57b3faccde56c7fe6c05dac6403cefe153faf6c1b`

- Divinitus DE: `cf7f21900a3812b66edddd831df779743eaf33080aef983f9bdea8ec47642809`

These hashes define the ruleset more precisely than a Workshop title. A guide written for another DE or Divinitus release is historical evidence, not automatic evidence for this game.

2.2 Authority order

Claims in Book IX use the following practical hierarchy:

1. the exact supplied source files for what the mods command;
2. Illwinter's official manuals for what those commands mean;
3. the active load order for which later command has the final opportunity to change a field;
4. the mod authors' repositories and release descriptions for stated design intention;
5. current reproducible public tests where engine behaviour is not completely documented;
6. strategic derivation from confirmed inputs.

Source code proves that a command is present. It does not always prove the final in-game card. A selected object inherits every vanilla or earlier-mod field that is not cleared or replaced. A repeated `#newmonster` on an occupied ID is especially important: the official manual warns that two mods should not modify the same object because the result can be unpredictable. The correct label for such a case is source collision until a reliable resolved card or live reproduction exists.

2.3 Public author sources

The principal public project pages are:

- Dominions Enhanced repository: https://github.com/BlueFeuer/DominionsEnhanced6
- Divinitus repository: https://github.com/RonhulMaggot/Divinitus
- Illwinter documentation index: https://illwinter.com/dom6/docs.html

The current DE repository describes the project as a DLC-sized overhaul with thousands of spells, items, and monsters; new nations; changes to almost every vanilla nation; cheaper and expanded Pretender design; broad cavalry and underwater revisions; and a large national-magic programme. The supplied file confirms that scope at command level.

Public load-order wording has not been perfectly consistent. The public Divinitus 1.15.2 DE file contains the words "Load first," while the project description and version 1.15.0 changelog instruct players to enable the DE edition after Dominions Enhanced. The supplied 1.15.3 DE header no longer states either instruction. The later project-level wording settles the intended order for this ruleset: DE first, Divinitus second. The older contradictory header remains in the historical record because it can still mislead anyone using an archived file without the release context.

3. Finding What Is Needed

3.1 First game with both mods

For a first game, read Sections 4, 7, 8, 14-16, and 22, then use the pregame checklist in Section 26. That covers the rules that change ordinary decisions without requiring a full reading of the source structure.

3.2 Pretender design

Read Sections 8, 11, 14-18, 21-22, and Essay II. A chassis may now act as an economic institution, temple network, seasonal engine, recruitment programme, or global-risk mechanism. The visible card is only the beginning.

3.3 Mod compatibility or debugging

Read Sections 5, 6, 19-21, 24, and 25. Consult the machine-readable summary and object catalogue before drawing a conclusion from a name search.

3.4 Website construction

Read Sections 23-25 and Appendix B. The website should preserve separate vanilla, DE, Divinitus, and combined layers. It should never flatten them into one unversioned card.

4. What the Combined Modpack Changes

4.1 Dominions Enhanced is the broad ruleset

DE is the foundation layer. It changes global economic constants, blessings, units, mounts, weapons, armour, Pretenders, sites, nations, spells, items, poptypes, name lists, and events. It also supplies extensive national content and several new nations.

Its strategic effect goes beyond adding more content. It changes the density of useful options:

- more national research branches compete for early research;
- more summons convert gems into nation-specific force;
- low-path mages gain more battlefield and ritual jobs;
- underwater entry and underwater warfare become less isolated;
- cavalry and mounts become more credible;
- new and revised Pretenders enlarge design space;
- hidden future sites reveal national summons and heroes;
- informative site-search events reduce uncertainty;
- scale choices carry altered economic and event consequences.

4.2 Divinitus is the divine-system layer

Divinitus concentrates on Pretender identity. It modifies or rebuilds hundreds of chassis and supplies the machinery needed to make their descriptions operational:

- pregame starting armies and capital sites;
- automatic items;
- temple-generated units, commanders, gems, gold, and sites;
- dominion-scaled effects;
- seasonal and terrain-dependent effects;
- order-dependent abilities;
- national priesthood changes;
- battlefield spells and summoned escorts;
- global event chains;
- ownership-state variables;
- punishments when an immobile god leaves its appointed place;
- relationships with global enchantments, heroes, or unique units.

Divinitus changes what "the Pretender" means. A god may become a distributed part of the state whose effects continue across dozens of provinces. The physical chassis may be only the control key for that larger presence.

4.3 Combined result

Under the frozen order, DE establishes the world and Divinitus has the later word on the fields it changes. This produces three classes of final object:

1. DE-only object: created or selected by DE and untouched by Divinitus.
2. Divinitus-only object: introduced or changed only by Divinitus.
3. Combined object: inherited from vanilla, changed by DE, then changed or rebuilt by Divinitus.

The Grand Hierophant is the clearest example of the third class. DE supplies its revised foundation. Divinitus later changes cost, magic, event protection, description, and monthly event systems. Neither source alone describes the combined god.

5. How the Dominions Loader Must Be Read

Book VIII owns the general loader explanation: whole mods load separately, command categories have an internal parser order, selected objects inherit unstated fields, numeric identities matter across files, and descriptions are not executable specifications. Four consequences matter here:

1. DE is the first object layer and Divinitus the second.
2. A Divinitus block may inherit vanilla and DE fields that it never restates.
3. Source adjacency does not override parser-category order.
4. A divine description may summarize an event family without listing every gate, delay, or cleanup step.

A complete divine system is traced as:

```
chassis -> support item/site/spell -> event requirement -> event effect -> delay or variable ->
cleanup event
```

5.1 Allocation profile

Fixed IDs improve stability inside a coordinated project but create collision risk between projects. Automatic IDs depend on the engine's occupied range and cannot be resolved from these two text files alone.

The supplied DE file uses fixed IDs for every new weapon, armour, monster, and site. Divinitus uses a mixture:

- all 34 new-weapon blocks use a fixed number, though ID 3034 appears twice;
- both new armour blocks use fixed IDs;
- 277 of 346 new-monster blocks use fixed IDs and 69 use automatic allocation;
- all 112 new sites use fixed IDs;
- 4 of 26 new spells use fixed IDs and 22 use automatic allocation;
- its one new item uses fixed ID 1072.

This mix is a source fact, not a defect by itself. It simply marks which identities can be checked statically and which require a resolved game state.

6. Exact Source Inventory

6.1 File scale

File	Lines	Bytes	Active commands
DE 2.16	194,385	5,675,140	173,499
Divinitus 1.15.3 DE	44,436	1,348,538	38,834

6.2 Object-block inventory

Object action	DE blocks	Divinitus blocks
New weapon	389	34
Selected weapon	142	0
New armour	81	2
Selected armour	39	0
New monster	3,553	346
Selected monster	4,227	373
New site	504	112
Selected site	684	5
New spell	0	26
Selected spell	2,816	17
New item	0	1
Selected item	631	75
Selected nation	132	0
Selected blessing	46	0
New event	1,564	1,514

These are active block occurrences, not unique final identities. DE selects 3,185 distinct monster identities, 2,737 distinct spell identities, 629 distinct item identities, 572 distinct site identities, and 128 distinct nations. Repeated blocks are common and often intentional.

6.3 Fixed ranges

Object	DE fixed range	Divinitus fixed range
Weapon	1501-1925	3001-3035
Armour	501-581	998-999
Monster	6510-13571	5018-10001
Site	2101-2917	1885-2005
Spell	selected IDs 1-4365	fixed new IDs 183, 197-199
Item	selected IDs 1-899	new ID 1072

Ranges are bounds, not proof that every number inside is used.

6.4 Important implementation facts

- DE contains no active `#newspell` block. It builds its spell layer through 2,816 `#selectspell` blocks, including high numbered slots.
- DE contains no active `#newitem` block. It builds its item layer through selected slots.
- DE explicit monster IDs exceed the 5000-8999 recommendation printed in the 6.34 Modding Manual, reaching 13,571. The source proves that the active game accepts or at least parses a wider contemporary space than that older recommendation describes.
- Divinitus uses 1,492 rarity-5 events, 12 rarity-13 events, and 9 rarity-0 events. One event lacks an explicit rarity.
- DE and Divinitus each contain a small number of adjacent event blocks without an intervening `#end`. The next `#newevent` implicitly begins a new block in source analysis, but this remains a lint finding.
- Divinitus defines weapon ID 3034 twice. The later definition copies Stellar Bolt and is the effective intended source for the Stellar Staff references. The earlier Gaze of Death definition does not survive as an independent fixed identity.

7. The Six Global DE Rules

DE issues six active general commands outside object blocks.

Command	DE value	Official meaning
`#gemlongevity`	2	battle gems last for the entire month
`#slothincome`	4	each Productivity/Sloth step changes income by 4%
`#turmoilincome`	4	each Order/Turmoil step changes income by 4%
`#deathincome`	2	each Growth/Death step changes income by 2%
`#deathdeath`	25	Growth/Death population effect uses 0.25% units
`#luckevents`	7	Luck/Misfortune changes event frequency by 7% per step

The official defaults printed in the Modding Manual are 3 for Sloth income, 3 for Turmoil income, 2 for Death income, 20 for the population constant, and 5 for Luck event frequency. `#deathincome 2` pins the existing default; it does not change it.

7.1 Gem longevity

This is the most operationally important global change. Under level 2, combat gems last for the entire month rather than only their ordinary single use. The practical value of a gem-bearing mage now depends on the number of battles the mage can survive and enter during that month.

Consequences include:

- a single gem allocation can support several engagements;
- counter-raiding and sequential defence become more gem-efficient;
- teleporters and other multi-battle pieces gain endurance;
- killing or routing the mage before later battles becomes more important;
- battle-gem accounting must be conducted by mage-month, not only by battle;
- scripts that assume a gem was consumed in an earlier battle require revision.

This rule does not eliminate the need for reserve policy. A mage without the necessary gems at the beginning of the month still lacks them, and a dead, routed, or isolated mage cannot exploit persistence.

7.2 Order and Productivity

Order and Productivity each move income by 4% per step instead of 3%. Their combined influence on income is stronger before national modifiers and rounding. The scales keep their other effects, so the change does not reduce them to simple gold choices.

At symmetric extremes, the direct trace differs substantially:

- Order 3 contributes a nominal +12% instead of +9%;
- Turmoil 3 contributes a nominal -12% instead of -9%;
- Productivity 3 contributes a nominal +12% instead of +9%;
- Sloth 3 contributes a nominal -12% instead of -9%.

These percentages are inputs to the engine's provincial economy, not guarantees of an exact treasury difference in every province. Population, terrain, unrest, national rules, taxation, rounding, and special income modifiers remain relevant.

7.3 Growth and Death

The gold-income constant remains 2%, while the population-change constant rises from 20 to 25 hundredths of a percent. Death destroys the tax base more quickly and Growth compounds it more quickly, subject to the engine's sign and rounding implementation.

The strategic lesson is temporal:

> Growth and Death do more than alter current income. They change the future base to which many other modifiers apply.

7.4 Luck and Misfortune

The event-frequency influence rises from 5% to 7% per scale step. This does not guarantee a particular event result. It changes the number of opportunities, while event quality, rarity, national event sets, and special event mechanics determine what those opportunities become.

Luck becomes more valuable to nations and Pretenders that add strong good-event pools. Misfortune becomes more dangerous where a modded nation or divine system adds harmful events or already has fragile infrastructure.

8. Complete DE Blessing Revision

DE modifies 38 distinct blessings through 46 blocks. Eight blessings are selected twice because one block changes path or scale requirements and another changes cost.

Path letters are F Fire, A Air, W Water, E Earth, S Astral, D Death, N Nature, G Glamour, and B Blood.

Blessing	DE cost	Additional change
Wasteland Survival	1	reduced from 2
Death Explosion	F4+D2	crosspath; non-Incarnate structure
Fire Shield	F5	reduced from 6
Flaming Weapons	F4	Heat 1 required; non-Incarnate
Farshot	1	reduced from 2
Awareness	2	reduced from 3
Swiftness	3	reduced from 4

Blessing	DE cost	Additional change
Storm Flight	3	reduced from 4
Wind Walker	A4+S2	crosspath; non-Incarnate
Weightlessness	4	reduced from 6; primary requirement becomes 3
Air Shield	5	reduced from 6
Charged Bodies	7	reduced from 8
Flight	6	reduced from 9
Swamp Survival	1	reduced from 2
Swimming	1	reduced from 2
Slowing Weapons	W4+G2	crosspath; non-Incarnate
Vitriol Weapons	6	reduced from 8; primary requirement becomes 4
Water Breathing	2	non-Incarnate
Frost Mist Weapons	W4+A1	crosspath; non-Incarnate
Unbreakable	3	reduced from 4
Resilience of the Earth	5	reduced from 6
Solar Weapons	3	reduced from 4; primary requirement becomes 2
Twist Fate	5	reduced from 6
Fateweaving	6	reduced from 7
Withering Weapons	3	reduced from 4
Reanimators	D4+E2	crosspath; non-Incarnate
Death Weapons	5	reduced from 8
Fear	8	reduced from 9
Forest Survival	1	reduced from 2
Poison Weapons	3	reduced from 4
Recuperation	4	non-Incarnate
Berserker	N4+B1	crosspath; non-Incarnate
Barkskin	N4+N2	Growth 1 required; non-Incarnate structure
Obfuscate	5	reduced from 6
Awe	7	reduced from 8; primary requirement becomes 5
Displacement	6	reduced from 7
Dread	7	reduced from 8
Vampiric Weapons	6+3	two-path total 9, reduced from 12

8.1 How to read the cost fields

The modding commands store primary and optional secondary path requirements. The minimum path skill and blessing-point cost use the same numbers. Thus `#cost0 4` and `#cost1 2` produce a six-point crosspath blessing requiring the stated levels in both paths.

Some source comments describe a blessing as "no longer Incarnate" without a separate `#incarnate` command. The new path-cost structure places the requirements below the threshold that made the older single-path version Incarnate. The effect follows the rewritten requirements rather than a standalone toggle.

8.2 Strategic families

The revisions create five broad families.

Cheap mobility and survival. Terrain survival, Swimming, Water Breathing, Farshot, Awareness, Swiftness, and Weightlessness become easier to add to a broader design.

Accessible weapon blessings. Flaming, Slowing, Frost Mist, Solar, Withering, Death, Poison, and Vitriol effects become cheaper or crosspath. A design can purchase a functional weapon effect without committing its entire budget to one extreme path.

Lower Incarnate dependence. Several effects remain available while the Pretender is dormant, imprisoned, dead, or otherwise absent. This increases the viability of delayed chassis and reduces the all-or-nothing cost of divine death.

Crosspath identity. Death Explosion, Wind Walker, Slowing Weapons, Frost Mist Weapons, Reanimators, Berserker, Barkskin, and Vampiric Weapons require a more specific magical identity. Their nominal cost is only part of the design cost; path entry and opportunity cost matter.

Scale contracts. Flaming Weapons requires Heat 1 and Barkskin requires Growth 1. The blessing is tied to national scales and cannot be purchased in isolation.

8.3 Bless evaluation method

A blessing should be valued against five quantities:

1. the number of sacred bodies affected;
2. the number and importance of sacred attacks;
3. the turns on which sacred recruitment is constrained;
4. the probability that the effect changes an actual matchup;
5. the design points and paths displaced.

A cheap blessing is not automatically efficient. A one-point terrain blessing may be decisive for a mobility plan and worthless in another. A nine-point Vampiric Weapons package may be extraordinary on durable multi-attacking sacreds and extravagant on fragile, recruitment-limited elites.

9. Dominions Enhanced as an Object Ecosystem

9.1 Weapons, armour, mounts, and units

DE adds 389 fixed-ID weapons and modifies 142 existing weapons. It adds 81 armours and modifies 39 armour blocks. It creates 3,553 monster blocks and selects 4,227 more.

This density supports connected programmes, not isolated novelties:

- bows gain damage and precision and use 24 ammunition in the stated DE design;
- slings use full strength, gain damage at ordinary human strength, and use 30 ammunition;
- javelins receive underwater rules;
- horse Magic Resistance rises on average;
- weak barding improves and formerly unbarded horses gain barding;
- Skilled Rider increases across riders;
- forgeable barding becomes cheaper and broader;
- many units gain DE-specific shapes, mounts, equipment, or supporting spells.

A unit must be read through its relationships. A rider card belongs with its mount. A weapon belongs with its secondary effects and ammunition. A unit belongs with its national recruitment site, spell support, and cost commands.

9.2 Sites

DE creates 504 sites and selects 684 site blocks. Sites perform several different jobs:

- national capital and terrain recruitment;
- future-site documentation;
- summon and hero previews;
- hidden national mechanics;
- event and ritual anchors;
- gem, gold, resource, and supply production;
- fort and defence units;
- divine or scripted transformation infrastructure.

A source count of "504 new sites" does not mean 504 ordinary searchable magic sites. Many are rarity 5, level 0, national, hidden, or event-managed support objects.

9.3 Spells

DE's 2,816 selected spell blocks cover IDs from 1 to 4,365. They include:

- ordinary researchable spells;
- national rituals and summons;
- hidden effect spells;
- item-granted spells;
- transformation chains;
- battlefield wrappers;
- temporary buffs and helper effects;
- prayer families;
- underwater access and water-breathing systems;
- fort damage and siege support;
- national late-game capstones.

The source uses high selected slots instead of active `#newspell` commands. A catalogue must classify each spell by its final school, research level, path, restriction, and visibility. Whether the source keyword says "new" does not settle the question.

9.4 Items

DE selects 631 item blocks covering 629 distinct identities. The programme includes repricing, path changes, national rebates, underwater tools, barding, temporary gem effects, auto-spells, restricted items, and new high-slot definitions.

Item value changes twice:

1. the forge cost and path gate may change;
2. the environment contains more reasons to want the item.

Cheaper water-breathing equipment matters more because underwater entry is a central DE project. Cheaper barding matters more because mounts are stronger. Siege items matter more where magical fort pressure is deliberately expanded.

9.5 Nations

DE selects 128 distinct nations in 132 blocks. Its changes go well beyond recruit costs. Nation blocks can:

- clear and rebuild recruitment;
- change terrain recruitment;
- change capital and starting armies;
- add or remove Pretenders;
- replace heroes and multiheroes;
- set scale preferences or forced modifiers;
- change fort, temple, or dominion rules;
- add future sites;
- add AI hints;
- replace an entire nation in a reserved slot.

The current DE project summary identifies major or mild changes across all ages and several new nations. The supplied source includes complete custom nation definitions in slots 181-207 alongside extensive changes to vanilla nation IDs.

10. The DE Design Programme

10.1 Pretenders

The principal DE Pretender source region spans approximately lines 72,487-90,112 and contains 591 monster blocks:

- 266 new-monster blocks;
- 325 selected-monster blocks;
- 268 blocks with a `#startdom` command;
- 561 blocks with a `#pathcost` command.

The wider file also defines shapes, summons, divine servants, and later corrections. The region is a useful authorial boundary, not a complete resolved Pretender database.

The public project description states the main design direction:

- Pretenders are repriced from the ground up and are generally cheaper;
- Titans receive two more paths;
- monsters and rainbows receive one more path;
- monsters are broadly stronger;
- more scale modifiers appear;
- the roster of Pretenders is larger, especially underwater and in Polynesian realms;
- Pretenders can heal in the capital or while preaching outside it under the stated holy-level chance.

These changes mean that vanilla design heuristics cannot simply be carried across. Path-entry costs, chassis costs, built-in scales, and jobs must be read from DE data.

10.2 Magic

DE expands summons and national magic, shifts some effects into Glamour or crosspaths, enlarges many battlefield areas, improves the jobs available to level-one mages, and adds siege tools. The hostile battlefield-wide spell policy limits effects such as Wind of Death to one cast per round per side.

The strategic result is portfolio pressure. More viable spells make a fixed queue less reliable, not more. A nation should maintain:

- an expansion and first-war branch;
- an anti-armour branch;
- an anti-mass branch;
- a defensive and counter-raid branch;
- a path-access and forging branch;
- a national-summon branch;
- a water-access branch where geography requires it;
- a late-game transition.

10.3 Underwater play

DE treats the sea as a connected theatre:

- Gift of Water Breathing becomes cheaper and earlier;
- more items and spells grant water access;
- more monsters carry water-breathing support;
- underwater population rises;
- coastal and underwater independent mages improve;
- more spells work underwater;
- underwater-only spells expand;
- javelins function underwater under modified range and damage;
- many aquatic nations receive specific overhauls.

This reduces the old binary distinction between land and sea. It does not make amphibious war free. Command capacity, breathing capacity, hostile currents, poor amphibians, laboratory networks, fort access, and return routes remain logistical constraints.

10.4 Information

DE's informative site-search events report when a searching mage detects traces of a stronger hidden site in a path but lacks the level to reveal it. All nations also receive future sites in their overview to display summons and heroes.

These systems reduce memory and inspection burden, but they do not remove it. The player still needs to distinguish:

- a site that has been found;
- a clue that a stronger site remains;
- a future-site documentation entry;
- an event-managed support site;
- a national site that is present only under a specific ruleset.

11. Dominions Enhanced Pretender Analysis

11.1 Design cards must be rebuilt

The ordinary design screen remains useful, but a serious DE design record needs more fields:

Field	Question
Chassis price	What does the exact DE card cost?

Field	Question
Path entry	Which paths are built in, and what is each new level's marginal price?
Dominion	What is the starting dominion and cost of increasing it?
Scales	Which forced or bonus scales change the national plan?
Mobility	Can the god expand, raid, teleport, sail, or cross water?
Survival	Which threats defeat the chassis before research support?
Divine job	Is its main purpose expansion, blessing, access, research, ritual, combat, or scales?
National availability	Which nations or realms can choose it after DE's `#addgod` and `#delgod` changes?
Divinitus layer	Does the second mod add an economy, event, priesthood, site, or battle system?

The last two fields are mandatory under the combined ruleset. A strong generic chassis may not be legal for a nation. A mediocre-looking chassis may be the key to a powerful Divinitus infrastructure.

11.2 Chassis families

DE's large roster is best understood by job family.

Immobile monuments. These often exchange movement for high dominion, low design cost, strong paths, exceptional durability, or national effects. Divinitus frequently turns them into site and temple engines.

Monsters. DE's broad buffs make monsters more credible expanders and combatants. Their value still depends on attack density, protection, regeneration, resistances, item slots, affliction risk, and the first counter an opponent can deploy.

Titans. Additional paths and lower design prices make Titans more flexible. They can combine expansion with a serious blessing or late ritual access, but their size and investment make death costly.

Rainbows and sages. Cheaper designs and expanded paths improve access packages. Divinitus often adds libraries, apprentices, ritual range, items, or research-linked production.

Aquatic and amphibious gods. DE expands this roster and the strategic value of water access. A water god must still be assessed against the nation's starting theatre and ability to operate on land.

Transforming gods. Shape chains can separate map form, battle form, dominion form, death form, and ritual form. Every shape must be resolved; a source block for one form is not the complete god.

11.3 Expansion is an assignment, not a label

A chassis should be called an expander only after a repeatable test against the actual independent settings and terrain mix. DE changes weapons, mounts, and units as well as the Pretender, so a vanilla test result is not portable.

A minimum record includes:

- design and awakening;
- target province and defenders;
- script;
- hit points and afflictions after battle;
- fatigue at decisive moments;

- rout or morale incidents;
- number of provinces taken before support was required;
- first available counter;
- cost of losing one expansion turn.

11.4 Healing doctrine

The stated DE programme allows Pretenders to heal in the capital or to receive a 10% chance per Holy level while actively preaching outside the capital. This creates three recovery modes:

1. capital convalescence;
2. field preaching with probabilistic recovery;
3. magical or item-based healing.

The second is not free. Preaching consumes the monthly order and places the god in a predictable province. A wounded god that could forge, research, claim a Throne, cast a ritual, or fight is paying an opportunity cost to heal.

12. DE Magic, Items, and National Power

12.1 A spell is a delivery system

The expanded spell list should be indexed by function rather than memorized as one long sequence.

Function	Examples of the question to ask
Access	Does the spell raise paths, create a mage, or unlock a form?
Army creation	What body, commander, upkeep, and leadership does a summon provide?
Force multiplication	Which troops receive the buff, at what area, fatigue, and research?
Control	Does it disable by MR, defence, size, morale, or terrain?
Damage	What protection layer, resistance, and density does it attack?
Mobility	Does it solve land, water, plane, range, or fort access?
Siege	Does it damage walls, defenders, infrastructure, or relief timing?
Economy	Does it convert gems, gold, population, blood slaves, or mage-turns?
Transformation	Is the result reversible, unique, cursed, or tied to another object?

The same spell may occupy several rows. A summon can be path access, siege mass, and a combat package. An underwater ritual can be mobility and recruitment access.

12.2 National summons

DE generally raises the efficiency of national summons and updates older designs to Dominions 6 scale. A summon should be evaluated by:

```
total cost = gems + caster-turn + research delay + laboratory position + command burden
```

The result should be evaluated by:

```
total return = body value + magic access + strategic movement + siege value + future turns
```

A cheap body that requires a rare cap-only caster may be expensive. A moderate summon that creates a reusable mage can be an access breakthrough.

12.3 Items as logistics

The repriced item list changes the minimum infrastructure needed to execute a plan. The relevant categories are:

- path boosters and ritual access;
- reinvigoration and fatigue control;
- resistance packages;
- thug and supercombatant protection;
- underwater transport and breathing;
- mount and rider equipment;
- siege and wall pressure;
- temporary gems;
- battlefield auto-spells;
- restricted national or divine items.

An item catalogue should state the exact mod layer because the same named item may have different paths, costs, effects, or national rebates in vanilla and DE.

12.4 Future sites as an interface

Future sites are documentation objects embedded in the nation overview. They make national summons and heroes discoverable without revealing every tactical conclusion. For a website, these should be represented as overview records, not ordinary province sites.

13. DE Nations Without Nation Dossiers

Book IX does not replace the nation monographs. It establishes the questions each one must answer.

13.1 Recruitment reconstruction

DE can clear and rebuild a nation roster. A vanilla unit list may be only a historical starting point. The resolved recruitment table needs:

- capital, fort, unforted, coastal, underwater, cave, forest, mountain, swamp, waste, farm, and foreign recruitment;
- recruitment limits;
- command-point and resource gates;
- paired or event-created recruits;
- site-dependent commanders and troops;
- starting commander and army;
- province defence, walls, and fort defenders.

13.2 Magic reconstruction

The mage table needs:

- deterministic paths;
- random masks and probability distributions;
- temporary gems;
- path boosts and shape effects;
- cap-only and terrain limits;
- national spells and item rebates;
- communion, chorus, or other network roles;

- the cost of consuming a commander recruitment turn.

13.3 National strategic reconstruction

The public DE summary indicates four degrees of change:

1. light balance correction - costs, statistics, hero updates, or one new spell;
2. mild overhaul - roster or magic identity changes while the national concept remains;
3. systemic overhaul - new economy, recruitment, or dominion mechanics;
4. new or DEified nation - custom roster and full support package.

Advice should state the degree. A "mild overhaul" can still invalidate an opening if the old cap unit, random distribution, or sacred is gone.

13.4 New nations in the supplied source

The source contains full named nation blocks in reserved IDs 181-207, including Chaco, Ongtupqa, Sitecah, Albion, Zion, Bhöd, and later DE additions such as Bantay Tubig, Dirgen, and Houssa. Some public notes mark particular nations unfinished, removed, or pending. A source definition proves presence in the file; it does not prove current balance or recommended multiplayer inclusion.

14. Divinitus: Design Philosophy and Scope

14.1 The card becomes a constitution

Divinitus describes its purpose as making Pretender Gods more unique and lore-consistent without presumed excessive power creep. Its implementation gives a chassis rules that can affect the entire state.

The dominant patterns are:

- starting covenant: a capital site, item, army, commander, or scale package;
- living dominion: effects scale with candles or require positive dominion;
- temple network: each temple becomes a production or transformation node;
- priesthood: certain national mages or units gain Holy levels;
- divine presence: an effect requires the god alive, awake, present, preaching, searching, or performing another order;
- seasonal office: winter, summer, or another calendar condition changes production;
- terrain office: caves, forests, coasts, wastes, mountains, or water enable an effect;
- relationship state: control of a named unit or global enchantment unlocks a benefit;
- cosmic consequence: moving or losing a monument triggers a world event;
- battle manifestation: a spell, escort, blessing-site effect, or divine shape appears in combat.

14.2 The four source tiers

The main Pretender body is divided by starting dominion headings.

Source tier	Object blocks	Events	Monster blocks	Sites
Dominion 4	542	385	134	21
Dominion 3	768	510	217	40
Dominion 2	633	383	216	34
Dominion 1	401	236	143	22

Monster blocks combine selected and new definitions. Site totals include new and selected sites. The file then applies eight small DE-tail monster selections, principally home-realm compatibility.

These headings organize authorial work. The final starting dominion should still be read from the active object's fields because a selected block may not restate it and a shape may not be a selectable root.

14.3 Chassis scale

Among 320 Divinitus monster blocks carrying at least one Pretender-like field:

- 305 carry descriptions;
- 297 state a gold or design cost;
- 258 state a path cost;
- 201 state starting dominion;
- 181 state a home realm;
- 132 use `#magicboost`;
- 167 use healing;
- 66 use ordinary `#domsummon`;
- many add one-battle spells, start items, scale modifiers, or shape relationships.

This does not mean exactly 320 independently selectable gods. The set includes forms and support definitions. It proves the density of divine reconstruction.

15. The Divinitus Event Engine

15.1 Why 1,514 events exist

Dominions has no single command meaning "every temple in friendly dominion has a candle-scaled chance to recruit a special priest while the god is awake." Such a power is assembled from small declarative events.

A typical system needs:

1. an event identifying the correct Pretender;
2. a province, terrain, site, temple, fort, dominion, or order requirement;
3. a probability gate;
4. an effect;
5. sometimes a variable or event code;
6. sometimes a delayed cleanup;
7. often a silent message configuration.

The large event count is working infrastructure, not 1,514 ordinary random narratives.

15.2 Event profile

Command or pattern	Occurrences
New events	1,514
`#req_godismnr`	1,641
Province-owner events (`#nation -2`)	1,504
Silent log suppression (`#nolog`)	1,446

Command or pattern	Occurrences
Population-zero permitted	1,183
No displayed text	1,023
Dominion minimum	602
Candle-scaled chance	557
Land requirement	543
Target monster	434
Own capital	370
Temple	311
Pregame only	179
Fort	173
Free site slots	157
Site required	148

The multiple `#req_godismnr` commands in one event are alternatives: several related gods can share one effect.

15.3 Rarity 5

The official Event Manual states that rarity 5 is an unlimited always-event class: any number can occur in one province in the same month. It is suitable for global-enchantment and special-dominion machinery.

Divinitus uses rarity 5 for 1,492 events. This permits many independent divine checks to run without consuming an ordinary random-event slot.

15.4 Candle-scaled probability

The official meaning of `#req_domchance X` is:

```
chance = absolute dominion strength x X percent
```

The event must already satisfy its other requirements. The command itself does not care who owns the dominion, so correct systems combine it with ownership or Pretender requirements where friendly dominion is intended.

Examples:

- `#req_domchance 1` gives 1% per candle;
- `#req_domchance 5` gives 5% per candle;
- `#req_domchance 10` gives 10% per candle.

At ten candles these become 10%, 50%, and 100% respectively before other gates. A description that says "candles x 5%" has a direct mechanical basis.

15.5 Event probability is conditional

A 50% candle check is not a 50% monthly yield if the event also requires:

- the god to be awake;
- the god or target to be in the province;

- a temple or fort;
- a free site slot;
- a season;
- a particular order;
- a path threshold;
- a unique event not already used;
- a variable in the correct state.

Expected value should multiply the conditional probabilities or explicitly state that it is conditioned on every non-random gate being true.

15.6 Pregame events

The official manual states that `#req_pregame` events happen during game creation and appear in the first turn's messages. Divinitus uses 179 such events for starting armies, sites, items, commanders, and initial state.

Pregame content is part of Pretender design value even though it does not appear in the chassis statistics. Losing or duplicating one of these events can alter an opening materially.

16. Divinitus Power Families

16.1 Capital institutions

Many gods create a capital site or add one when awakening. Common returns include:

- gem income;
- gold and resources;
- recruitable mages;
- apprentices;
- divine servants;
- ritual discounts;
- a special bless effect;
- national path access.

A capital institution should be valued as a stream:

```
present value = starting grant + monthly income + recruitment options + strategic access -
site-slot and opportunity costs
```

The exact duration matters. A site present from game creation is more valuable than one appearing only when a dormant god awakens.

16.2 Temple networks

Temple events turn religious infrastructure into production infrastructure. A temple may:

- create units or commanders;
- produce gems, blood slaves, or gold;
- apply a blessing site;
- change scales or dominion;
- grant recruitment;
- transform or ordain priests;
- host a terrain-specific resource.

The value of one more temple becomes:

```
ordinary temple value + expected divine output + dominion projection + local strategic value
```

This can justify earlier and wider temple construction, but only if the expected output exceeds construction cost, opportunity cost, and capture risk.

16.3 Priesthood transformations

Divinitus uses 203 `#holyboost` effects and many target gates to ordain national mages, commanders, or thematic servants. A mage who becomes H1 or H3 changes:

- preaching;
- banishment;
- blessing access;
- temple construction eligibility;
- leadership in sacred armies;
- communion or spell interactions where Holy matters;
- upkeep and recruitment opportunity only indirectly.

The event may occur immediately after recruitment, require a temple, or depend on the god. The exact gate must be recorded.

16.4 Dominion summons

Built-in `#domsummon`, `#domsummon2`, `#domsummon20`, and rare dominion summons produce followers around the god. Event-based temple summons distribute production across the map.

The distinction matters:

- chassis dominion summons usually require the god's physical presence;
- temple events require qualifying provinces;
- capital events concentrate output;
- some systems require the god awake or alive;
- some descriptions cap production by candle count.

16.5 Scale ceilings and extreme scales

Some gods carry `#moreorder`, `#moreprod`, `#moregrowth`, `#moreluck`, `#moremagic`, or temperature modifiers. Divinitus descriptions sometimes attach additional effects to scales beyond the ordinary limit, such as income, unrest reduction, or special events.

The design value has two parts:

1. design-point and national-scale consequences;
2. event or province consequences once the higher scale exists.

16.6 Built-in battlefield policy

Divinitus uses one-battle spells and hidden support spells for effects such as:

- army blessing by creature type;
- battlefield-wide path boosts;
- Solar Brilliance;
- Relief;
- Wind Guide;
- animal blessing;

- mass regeneration;
- control or serenity effects;
- divine earthquakes;
- special summons.

These spells often use school -1 and research level 0. They are internal tools, not ordinary research targets.

16.7 Orders as divine labour

Some powers require the Pretender to:

- preach;
- search for sites;
- research;
- remain in the capital;
- occupy a fort;
- stand on a Throne;
- perform another target order.

The god's monthly order is a scarce resource. A power that pays 150 gold when site searching is not free income; it competes with every other use of the god.

17. Representative Divinitus Systems

17.1 Golden Pillar: geographic catastrophe

The Golden Pillar gains strong Earth magic, dominion summons, additional scale reach, and cave-temple production. The exceptional mechanic is triggered when the Pillar is absent from its own capital.

The source chain:

1. an immediate global rarity-13 event requires the Golden Pillar Pretender, its own capital, and the Pillar's absence;
2. a unique gate prevents repetition;
3. event code `-3333` is set;
4. world unrest rises by 15;
5. surface provinces receive follow-up earthquake checks;
6. population, temples, and laboratories can suffer;
7. troglodyte attacks and a capital force can appear;
8. a later global event resets the code to zero.

This is a strategic constraint, not flavour. Moving, teleporting, or otherwise displacing the god can impose worldwide costs.

17.2 Father of Winters: seasonal global state

The Father of Winters uses variables 329, 330, and 331 to track successive winter-month effects. Monthly events increment and decrement the correct variable, while follow-up events can kill population and worsen Cold outside the protected ownership state.

The design lesson is that a seasonal power may be implemented as several synchronized state machines. Reading only one event produces a false picture.

17.3 Kami of Storms: ownership relationship

The Kami of Storms checks whether the nation controls Aella, Queen of Storms. Event variable 325 records that state.

- control sets the variable;
- loss or defection clears it;
- while the variable is positive, temples in qualifying dominion can spawn large Air Elementals;
- a separate capital site grants the innate Air Shield blessing effect.

This power rewards a specific world-state rather than a fixed chassis statistic.

17.4 Divine Feathered Serpent: delayed global offensive

The Divine Feathered Serpent can initiate a hurricane state using variable 326. The source:

- makes a capital, dominion-scaled check;
- sets a global state in an immediate event;
- permits up to three enemy-fort hurricane events per month;
- applies population loss and unrest;
- ends and clears the state through later events.

This is strategic remote pressure. Its actual target distribution and engine event ordering still deserve live verification before exact expected-damage claims.

17.5 Great Stag: global enchantment relationship

The Great Stag interacts with The Wild Hunt:

- the active friendly enchantment can bring a Horned One;
- variable 328 tracks whether the state is active;
- the Horned One receives path and priest boosts;
- temple events produce Cu Sidhe;
- cleanup events kill the Horned One and clear the variable when the enchantment is absent.

The power has a research and global-enchantment dependency. It is not fully online at game creation.

17.6 Once and Future King: province quest chain

The Once and Future King uses event code `-513`:

1. a qualifying province receives rumours;
2. the province is flagged;
3. a Holy Knight can resolve the quest;
4. outcomes include combat, gold, gems, or a magic item;
5. successful resolution resets the code to zero.

The event code is province-local. A world or nation may have several quest provinces, subject to the event gates.

17.7 Grand Hierophant: divine labour and mage development

The combined Grand Hierophant:

- begins from DE's revised monster 3053;
- receives Divinitus cost 150;
- gains +1 to all non-priest magic paths through `#magicboost 53 1`;

- has 75 bad-event protection and disease resistance 100;
- can anoint a Mystic or Erytheian Mystic into a Mystic Prophet;
- can teach the transformed mage;
- can gain 150 gold and elemental gems while site searching under a candle-scaled event.

The site-search reward uses `#1d6vis 51`. Path group 51 is Elemental, so a successful event grants 1d6 each of Fire, Air, Water, and Earth gems: an expected 14 total elemental gems on success.

With `#req_domchance 5`, the conditional success chance at `c` candles is `0.05c`. Conditional expected output per eligible month is:

- gold: `150 x 0.05c = 7.5c`;
- total elemental gems: `14 x 0.05c = 0.7c`.

These values assume every other gate is satisfied and do not subtract the opportunity cost of the Site Search order.

The teaching event visibly gates the target's Astral threshold while increasing Astral, Fire, Water, and Earth. The broad description states a maximum of three. Whether an elemental path can pass the stated cap under all Mystic randoms remains unresolved without a reliable engine reproduction.

18. Divinitus Support Objects

18.1 Hidden spells

Divinitus contains 26 new-spell blocks and 17 selected-spell blocks. Almost all set school -1 and research level 0, showing that they are components of divine powers and not additions to the ordinary research tree.

Major families include:

Family	Examples
Permanent gifts	Gift of Rebirth, Forge Skill, Healing Power, Demonic Ascendance
Training rituals	Teachings of the Cyclops, Imbue with Medicine, Lore of Dreams
Divine control	Master Enslave Sacreds, Void Enslave, Demon Enslave
Army blessing	Master Magic Blessing, Master Demon Blessing, Master Beast Blessing
Battlefield policy	God Quake, Boar Frenzy, Desert Guidance, Honed Steel
Path and enchantment	Guidance of the Spheres, Power of the Northern Star, Star Power
Mind and creation	Divine Spark, Spark of Intellect, Imbue Astral Power
Item or chassis effects	Plague Arrow, Inhabit Grove, Judge of Life and Death

The 43 blocks include helper effects such as Major Insanity and Caster Confusion. A website should mark these as hidden or granted mechanics unless the resolved school and restrictions make them ordinarily accessible.

18.2 Divine items

Divinitus selects item slots 1000-1073 and creates item 1072. Most use Construction level 11. The official manual defines level 11 as unforgeable. Level 13 means an unforgeable unique artifact.

These items are commonly:

- start items carried by a specific god;
- event-created priesthood tools;
- cursed and non-transferable signatures;
- spell containers;
- unique expressions of divine lore;
- mechanisms for granting an ability that the chassis command set cannot express directly.

The family includes Void Pearl, Orb of the Nerid, Calathos, Kusanagi-no-Tsurugi, Feather of the Phoenix, Hammer of the Cyclops, Bowl of Blood, Medicine Bag, Fate Charm, Tome of Lore, Bow of Plagues, Golden Arm, Staff of Beasts, Windborne Sail, Rain Stick, Horn of Vanhalla, Staff of the Geyser, Mirror of Dreams, The Last Wish, and Fish Scale Mail.

The source also modifies Soul Contract and Lifelong Protection with `#undcommand 15`, supporting an Infernal Spirit priesthood system.

18.3 Divine sites

Divinitus adds 112 sites and selects 5 existing sites. They are predominantly level-0, rarity-5 support sites managed by events.

Functional groups include:

- blessing sites such as Blessing of Winter, Wind, Earth, Vitality, and Brilliance;
- temple sites such as Temple of the Warrior, Solar Temple, Temple of Storms, and Temple of the Sacred Band;
- recruitment sites such as Apprentice Quarters, Grove of Enchantment, Library of Lore, and Grand College;
- economic sites such as Riches of the Underworld, Jewelled Cavern, and The Crystal Cavern;
- state markers such as Ritual Aftermath, Empty Plinth, Empty Vault, and Unusual Crystal Formation;
- terrain institutions such as Coral Barracks, Deep Forest Clearing, Frozen Barrow, and Bottomless Lake.

A site can be player-facing, a hidden marker, a recruitment interface, or all three. The catalogue must record how it enters and leaves play.

18.4 Weapons and armour

Divinitus adds special weapons numbered 3001-3035 and two armours. These principally serve gods and their items. Examples include Kusanagi-no-Tsurugi, Magic Lariat, Caduceus, Golden Bow, Burning Ray, Lightning Blade, and Perfect Fist.

Weapon 3034 is defined twice. The later definition copies Stellar Bolt and is referenced as Stellar Bolt by the Stellar Staff and related units. Source references establish the later practical role.

19. Combined Load Order and Collision Matrix

19.1 Direct selected-object overlap

Type	DE distinct selected	Divinitus distinct selected	Shared
Monster	3,185	373	357
Item	629	75	2
Spell	2,737	17	0
Site	572	5	0

Type	DE distinct selected	Divinitus distinct selected	Shared
Nation	128	0	0
Weapon	142	0	0
Armour	38	0	0

The two shared selected items are Soul Contract 348 and Lifelong Protection 396.

19.2 Cross-action monster overlap

The earlier direct-selector table understated the integration because Divinitus frequently uses `#newmonster` on a fixed ID that DE also created or selected.

Relationship	Shared numeric IDs
DE new / Divinitus new	235
DE new / Divinitus selected	10
DE selected / Divinitus new	114
DE selected / Divinitus selected	357

These groups overlap with one another because DE may both create and later select the same monster. Divinitus touches 650 distinct fixed monster identities; 600 of them also appear in a DE monster action. In addition, Divinitus creates 69 automatically numbered monsters.

This proves that the DE edition is deeply integrated. It also creates a large compatibility surface.

19.3 Event codes and variables

Registry	DE	Divinitus	Shared
Event codes	-540, -312 to -308, -302 to -300, 0	-3333, -513, 0	0
Event variables	6001-6007, 6011	325, 326, 328-331	none

Code 0 is the official default and reset state, so its use in both mods is expected. No nonzero event-code collision and no variable collision were found.

19.4 Automatic allocation

Automatic events are ordinary because `#newevent` has no fixed event ID in the same sense as a monster. Automatic monsters and spells are a different concern. Divinitus contains:

- 69 numberless new monsters;
- 26 automatically allocated new spells under the current official `#newspell` syntax.

Their final IDs depend on the occupied space after earlier mods. The supplied text proves definition order and content but not resolved numeric identities. The independent integrity publication records one exact-version Data Inspector resolution for all 69 monsters and 26 spells; those numbers remain versioned secondary keys rather than permanent object identities.

20. The 8616 Collision

20.1 Exact source facts

DE creates monster 8616 as a hidden "Bulk crafting land depositer." It has a deliberately generic `inventory.` name, zero gold cost, two miscellaneous slots, extreme stealth, land damage 99, and DE water-overhaul graphics.

Divinitus later creates monster 8616 as "Crystal Priest," copying Crystal Mage 340, adding E2G2H2, commander-master status, and recruitment cost fields. The Crystal Cavern then recruits monster 8616.

This collision is not a parser inference. Both exact blocks explicitly claim the same fixed ID. The public Divinitus 1.15.2 DE source also used 8616 for Crystal Priest, so the pattern predates the supplied 1.15.3 file.

20.2 Likely consequence

Under the frozen order, the later Divinitus definition has the final opportunity to occupy or alter 8616. DE references intended to create or manipulate the hidden bulk-crafting depositer may resolve to the Crystal Priest or to an engine-dependent merged state.

The official manual warns that two mods changing the same object can behave unpredictably. Without a reliable in-engine reproduction, the library does not assert an exact runtime card. It classifies this as:

Source-confirmed high-risk compatibility collision; runtime resolution pending.

20.3 Practical policy

For the unmodified supplied files:

- do not assume DE bulk crafting that depends on monster 8616 is safe;
- do not remove or renumber the Divinitus Crystal Priest casually, because its site and events reference it;
- treat any unexpected land bulk-crafting inventory, Crystal Priest, or item-deposit behaviour as related evidence;
- preserve the exact two files when reproducing;
- record which mod the game actually loaded first.

20.4 Independent compatibility publication

After Progress Edition 17, the collision was taken into a separate technical publication rather than expanded into another encyclopedia chapter. The DE-Divinitus Compatibility and Integrity Report confirms the intended order, traces the complete 8616 dependency chain, records the 69 automatic monsters and 26 automatic spells under the pinned Data Inspector build, and classifies every active command token against the official manuals, patch history, and current parser.

A separate repaired edition, `Divinitus_1.15.3_DE_compat_8616.dm`, removes Crystal Priest's fixed claim on 8616 and changes The Crystal Cavern to recruit it by name. The two uploaded originals remain unchanged. The repair passed its static and Inspector validation suite, but live-engine acceptance remains pending and a new game is required.

That work is deliberately independent. Book IX continues to describe the original frozen files and points outward for the remediation record; it does not silently replace the original Divinitus layer or absorb the repair package as Foundation Book XV.

21. Combined Pretender Resolution

21.1 Field-by-field method

For a selected chassis:

1. extract the vanilla card;
2. apply every DE block for that identity in DE parse-category order;
3. follow shapes and copied statistics;
4. apply every Divinitus block;
5. attach Divinitus items, sites, spells, and events;
6. attach national legality from the DE nation blocks;
7. classify unresolved inherited or engine-dependent fields.

For a fixed new ID shared by both mods, add a collision warning before assuming a simple overwrite.

21.2 Final-card schema

Every combined Pretender page should contain:

- identity and all forms;
- ruleset and hashes;
- nations and realms;
- design cost, path cost, starting dominion, and awakening limits;
- paths and path boosts;
- forced scales;
- physical and leadership statistics;
- item slots and starting items;
- battle spells and escorts;
- dominion summons;
- pregame grants;
- temple, fort, terrain, season, and order powers;
- event codes and variables;
- failure and cleanup conditions;
- source provenance by layer;
- unresolved runtime questions;
- strategic jobs and counters.

21.3 Do not sum every line

Not every repeated numeric field is additive. A later `#gcost` replaces the prior value. A `#magicboost` adds or subtracts paths under its own semantics. A clear command erases inherited fields. A copied object imports a base before later edits. An event effect occurs conditionally in play rather than changing the design card.

Resolution is typed, not arithmetic.

22. Strategic Doctrine for the Combined Ruleset

22.1 Pretender value has four ledgers

Design ledger. Points, paths, dominion, awakening, and scales.

Body ledger. Expansion, combat, movement, survival, slots, and healing.

State ledger. Sites, units, commanders, gems, gold, priesthood, and temple output.

Risk ledger. Catastrophic triggers, dependence on divine life or location, event exposure, and counters.

A god that is mediocre in the body ledger can dominate the state ledger. A powerful expander can be a poor design if death disables a national engine.

22.2 Dominion is productive capacity

Divinitus turns candles into probabilities and thresholds. Dominion now influences:

- ordinary religious survival;
- blessing projection;
- temple-event frequency;
- commander and unit production;
- economic events;
- terrain conversion or settlement;
- global attacks;
- scale changes;
- divine relationships.

Dominion investment should be assessed by marginal output as well as religious security.

22.3 Temples are an industrial network

Where a god has temple powers, the optimal temple count may rise sharply. The calculation should use:

```
monthly expected output per temple x expected safe months
```

against:

```
temple gold + priest turn + defence cost + capture risk + alternative investment
```

The network also has geometry. A border temple may project dominion and produce troops but be easy to capture. An interior cave temple may be safer and satisfy terrain gates.

22.4 Awakening changes institution timing

An imprisoned god may provide a non-Incarnate blessing immediately but delay a Divinitus capital site, priesthood, or temple network. An awake god may start the institution early but consume design points and face battlefield risk.

The correct question is:

> On which turn does each part of the design begin paying?

22.5 Gems are monthly endurance

DE gem longevity changes battle planning. A gem stock on a mage is a reusable monthly combat allowance. This favours:

- mobile defensive casters;
- sequential fort relief;
- several small battles with the same mage;
- survival gear and retreat planning;
- intelligence about later battles in the same month.

It also rewards the opponent for forcing a poor early battle, routing the mage, blocking movement, or killing the gem carrier.

22.6 Research has more branches

DE expands viable national spells, summons, underwater tools, and siege options. Divinitus adds hidden chassis effects but usually not ordinary research goals. The queue should be built around national DE breakpoints and the Pretender's requirements, not the Divinitus helper-spell list.

22.7 Counter the system, not only the body

Possible counters include:

- killing or imprisoning the god;
- forcing it away from a required capital or terrain;
- raiding temple provinces;
- denying a key global enchantment or unique unit;
- occupying the site that grants recruitment;
- exhausting site slots;
- disrupting a specific monthly order;
- capturing high-dominion provinces;
- attacking before an awakening-gated institution appears;
- exploiting a catastrophic movement trigger.

23. Website Architecture

23.1 Core entities

The website should use typed entities rather than one undifferentiated text index:

- ruleset;
- source file;
- object block;
- resolved object;
- monster form;
- nation;
- spell;
- item;
- site;
- blessing;
- event;
- event code;
- event variable;

- relationship;
- claim;
- test;
- article.

23.2 Layered object identity

One visible object page should offer tabs:

1. vanilla 6.35;
2. DE 2.16;
3. Divinitus 1.15.3 on vanilla, where meaningful;
4. DE 2.16 plus Divinitus 1.15.3;
5. historical versions.

Each field needs provenance. A cost may come from Divinitus while item slots come from DE and base protection remains vanilla.

23.3 Event relationships

Events should not be displayed as 1,514 isolated cards. They should be grouped into systems:

```
Pretender -> event family -> gate -> effect -> state -> cleanup
```

The Once and Future King quest chain, Golden Pillar earthquake, Father of Winters calendar, and Great Stag Wild Hunt relationship are ideal graph views.

23.4 Search facets

Useful filters include:

- source layer and version;
- object type and ID;
- nation and age;
- path and school;
- research level;
- terrain;
- temple, fort, capital, and dominion requirements;
- awakening dependency;
- order dependency;
- starting dominion tier;
- scale modification;
- event code or variable;
- direct source, derived, or pending status;
- known collision.

23.5 Data already produced

This research edition includes:

- `mod-index-summary.json` - hashes, counts, ranges, overlaps, event registries, and warnings;
- `mod-object-catalogue.tsv` - one row per active source block;
- `mod-object-blocks.jsonl` - full command streams and source lines;
- `extract_mod_index.py` - reproducible extractor.

The JSONL is a source index, not a resolved database. That distinction should appear in the website interface.

24. Verification Protocol

Book VIII contains the reusable validation ladder. Applied to this ruleset, every source claim must capture the complete object history across vanilla, DE, and Divinitus, then follow support items, sites, spells, shapes, and events before a final card is asserted.

A collision-sensitive card is reliable only when it comes from the exact files and order through a current inspector, controlled game, or documented engine export. An unversioned screenshot is useful as a clue, not as resolution.

Divinitus event tests must also preserve the Pretender, nation, turn, season, terrain, dominion, sites, order, target, relevant code or variable state, eligible province-months, and delayed effects. Candle-scaled probability should be compared with eligible trials rather than with anecdotal successes.

25. Open and Resolved Compatibility Register

25.1 Resolved from source

- The exact file hashes and versions are fixed.
- DE's six global commands are known.
- The complete DE blessing change set is known.
- Event-code registries have no nonzero cross-mod collision.
- Event-variable registries do not collide.
- Shared selected items are IDs 348 and 396.
- DE and Divinitus share 235 fixed new-monster IDs.
- Divinitus touches 600 fixed monster identities also touched by DE.
- Divinitus weapon 3034 is assigned twice, with the later Stellar Bolt definition used by later references.
- Monster 8616 is claimed by incompatible-looking DE and Divinitus definitions.
- Later author-facing project wording establishes DE first and Divinitus second as the intended order.
- The source contains 69 automatic monster declarations and 26 automatic spell declarations under current documented syntax.
- The pinned Inspector resolves every original automatic monster and spell for the exact frozen order; those numbers remain structured-tool evidence rather than engine exports.
- The independent command audit separates officially documented tokens, later parser-recognised tokens, Inspector annotations, likely spelling errors, and genuinely unresolved commands.
- A separate compatibility edition removes the 8616 collision without altering either uploaded original.

25.2 Pending reliable resolution

- exact engine behaviour when a later mod issues `#newmonster` on an occupied fixed ID;
- engine confirmation of the Inspector-resolved 8616 behaviour in the unmodified stack;
- live-engine acceptance of Crystal Cavern recruitment and DE's Ring, Amulet, and Blood Vial helper chains under the repaired edition;
- engine confirmation of the Inspector-resolved automatic identities;
- the Mystic Prophet elemental-path cap edge case;
- exact event scheduling order for several global state machines;
- whether all broad description claims match every rare gate and cleanup path;
- runtime semantics for the small set of commands left unresolved by the independent command audit.

25.3 Deliberately not requested from the player

This project does not require the player to perform these tests. They remain pending until a reliable published reproduction, exact inspector export, or local Dominions executable is available.

26. Operational Checklists

26.1 Before creating a game

- Verify Dominions 6.35 or record the actual patch.
- Verify both exact mod filenames.
- Verify hashes where multiplayer reproducibility matters.
- Enable DE before Divinitus under this library's frozen ruleset.
- Do not add another overhaul without a collision screen.
- Record map, age, thrones, research, independents, event frequency, and diplomacy rules.
- Design Pretenders under the active mods, not vanilla.

26.2 Before finalizing a Pretender

- Confirm the chassis is legal for the nation after DE.
- Record every forced scale and path cost.
- Read every form.
- Read the full Divinitus description.
- Identify starting items, sites, armies, and commanders.
- Identify awakening gates.
- Identify temple, terrain, season, and order gates.
- Identify any catastrophe or cleanup condition.
- Recalculate blessing activation under DE.
- Check whether the design depends on a collision-marked object.

26.3 First twelve turns

- Confirm pregame grants arrived.
- Inspect capital sites and recruitment.
- Check starting items and commanders.
- Note which powers require the god awake.
- Build temples only after valuing their divine output.
- Track gem-bearing mages by month under gem longevity.
- Use DE's site-search clues.
- Record unexpected units, sites, or events with province and turn.

26.4 Multiplayer host

- Distribute exact versions, not only Workshop names.
- Publish load order.
- Prohibit silent midgame mod updates.
- Archive the `.dm` files.
- State whether known collisions are accepted.
- Record any house ruling for an exploit or broken divine chain.

27. Essays

Essay I - Dominions Enhanced Is a Ruleset, Not a Content Pack

Calling Dominions Enhanced a content mod understates it. Content can be added while the surrounding grammar remains stable; DE changes the grammar.

A stronger bow is not only another weapon. It changes how light infantry trade with armour, how shields are valued, how much battlefield space missile troops deserve, and when arrow protection becomes urgent. Better mounts do not only improve cavalry. They change charge exchanges, magical vulnerability, rider survival, and the value of barding. Cheaper water breathing does not only add convenience. It changes which borders are real.

The six global commands demonstrate the same point at the highest level. Order, Productivity, population change, Luck event frequency, and battle-gem persistence alter calculations that every nation makes. Even a nation with no special DE roster change lives under these laws.

The magic programme expands the number of credible research branches. That reduces the reliability of memorized queues. A player who knew the vanilla breakpoint for an opponent now faces additional summons, battlefield effects, transformations, and siege tools. Information becomes more valuable because the option tree is wider.

The nation programme confirms the scale. Some nations receive corrections; others receive new rosters, economies, dominion rules, or successors. New nations occupy the same world and participate in the same Pretender and spell ecosystem.

The useful way to read the combined game is:

> DE is an alternate edition of Dominions 6 built through the modding language.

That model produces better habits. Version numbers appear on guides. Vanilla and DE advice remain separate. Object pages show provenance. Multiplayer hosts freeze files. Strategy begins with the active rules rather than with memory.

Essay II - The Pretender as a Distributed Institution

In ordinary analysis, a Pretender has a body, paths, dominion, scales, and a blessing. Divinitus adds a fifth category: institutions.

A library that recruits sages is not part of the god's hit-point total, but it may generate more research than another path level. A temple that creates sacred units is not printed in attack density, but it can transform the nation's force structure. A priesthood event can give existing national mages a second strategic role. A seasonal engine can reshape population and scales across many provinces.

This changes the meaning of divine death. If a power requires only the chosen chassis identity and continues while the god is dead, the institution may be resilient. If every event requires `#req_pretawake`, physical presence, or a target order, death shuts down the state.

It changes the meaning of dominion. Candles become production multipliers. It changes the meaning of temples. They become factories and access nodes. It changes the meaning of awakening. Delayed arrival may postpone an entire economy.

A distributed institution can also be countered indirectly. Raiders can burn temples. A unique relationship unit can be killed. A global enchantment can be dispelled. A required terrain can be denied. A site can be captured. The god need not be defeated in battle to dismantle the system.

The best design analysis draws a network:

```
god -> dominion -> temples/sites -> output -> army/research/economy
```

and then marks every dependency. A body card shows power. A dependency graph shows resilience.

Essay III - Monthly Gem Persistence Changes Operational Art

In a one-battle accounting model, a combat gem is spent at the moment of use. Under DE's monthly longevity rule, the gem is better understood as a license to cast during all eligible battles that month.

This changes the unit of planning from battle to itinerary.

A mage defending a fort, teleporting to a second battle, and participating in a third interception may reuse the same initial allocation. Survival and position become part of gem efficiency. A two-gem script on a fragile mage is no longer only a two-gem risk; it is the potential loss of several battles of access.

The rule also changes how an opponent should apply pressure. Several battles do not necessarily exhaust the gem carrier. The effective counters are to kill, rout, immobilize, isolate, or force the wrong early script. Intelligence about movement order and likely sequential battles gains value.

Economically, the marginal value of a battle gem rises with the number of useful battles per month. Strategically, this favours interior lines and mobile casters. Tactically, it rewards scripts that remain useful across varied fights, or careful rescripting when the game permits it before hosting.

The rule does not make gems infinite. Ritual expenditure, forging, global enchantments, and treasury allocation remain real. It makes battlefield allocation persistent within a calendar boundary. That boundary belongs in every operational plan.

Essay IV - Versioned Knowledge Is the Real Encyclopaedia

An encyclopaedia is often imagined as one perfected description. Dominions does not permit that simplicity.

Patches change spells and units. DE changes the patch again. Divinitus changes DE. Load order changes the combination. A later release may repair an ID collision while adding a new event gate. A correct article can become wrong without any sentence changing.

The solution is not constant rewriting without history. It is versioned knowledge.

Each claim needs:

- a ruleset;
- a source date;
- an evidence label;
- object provenance;
- an optional supersession link.

The public article can remain easy to read. The complexity belongs in its metadata and source panel. A visitor choosing "DE 2.16 + Divinitus 1.15.3" should see the correct Grand Hierophant. A visitor choosing vanilla should not.

Versioned knowledge also improves strategy. Old tournament advice can remain valuable when its assumptions are visible. A build that failed under one blessing cost can be reconsidered under another. A nation overhaul can be studied as design history rather than erased.

The real encyclopaedia cannot be a book of static answers. It needs to answer:

Correct under which world?

Related essays kept in their original homes

Book III's "A Bless Is a Roster Contract" owns the blessing argument. Book VIII's essays on load order, event systems, and compatibility own the general modding arguments. Book IX applies those ideas to the exact DE/Divinitus ruleset without printing a second version of the same essay.

Appendix A - Source-Lint Findings

1. DE contains one extra `#rarity 5` and `#end` after site 2372 outside an active object block.
2. DE contains one adjacent event start without an intervening `#end`.
3. Divinitus contains four adjacent event starts without intervening `#end` commands in the Annunaki population chain.
4. Divinitus defines weapon 3034 twice.
5. Divinitus contains one event without an explicit rarity.
6. DE and Divinitus both create 235 of the same fixed monster IDs.
7. Monster 8616 has an especially divergent cross-mod purpose.

These are source observations. They do not by themselves prove a user-visible defect.

Appendix B - Data Schema Warning

The generated object catalogue stores source blocks. It does not:

- import vanilla object cards;
- execute clear and copy semantics into a final card;
- allocate numberless objects;
- simulate category parsing;
- evaluate event probability;
- follow every name reference;
- reproduce the engine.

It is a provenance and discovery layer. A resolved website database should be built on top of it, never silently substitute it for final game data. The source summary remains in Section 2, the compatibility checklist in Section 26, and the library-wide evidence key in Book I.

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Foundation Book X - Playing and Hosting Dominions 6

Interface, Game Setup, Orders, and the First Campaign

Baseline: Dominions 6.36; vanilla procedure unless a ruleset is named; research edition 20 August 2026.

1. Purpose

Dominions is not played only on the battlefield. It is played in setup screens, message lists, province windows, recruitment queues, army panels, item treasuries, order menus, network lobbies, and the short interval between finishing a turn and committing it to the host. A commander can have the correct statistics, the right troops, and a sound strategic purpose and still fail because one operational detail was missed.

Book X is the operating manual for the library. It explains how to create and join a game, read the interface, translate intentions into legal orders, submit a turn safely, host a fair campaign, recover from common mistakes, and guide a first nation through its opening months. It is written for two readers at once:

- the new player who needs a complete route from the title screen to the end of a campaign;
- the experienced player who needs an exact procedural reference when the interface, network, or order system becomes the binding constraint.

Book X does not repeat mechanics owned elsewhere. Book I owns hosting order and evidence; Book II owns the state economy; Book III owns Pretenders and dominion; Book IV owns battle; Book V owns magic; and Book VI owns campaign doctrine. Book X explains how players operate those rules.

2. Three Layers of Operational Knowledge

Every instruction belongs to one of three layers.

Layer	Question	Typical failure
Ruleset	What game is being played?	The wrong patch, map, mod stack, age, or setting is assumed.
Interface	What is the game showing, and where is the control?	Information is overlooked or a control is mistaken for the underlying rule.
Commitment	What will the host attempt to resolve?	An arrow, queue, script, or submitted file does not express the intended action.

The layers should be checked in that order. An unexplained result is rarely clarified by studying battle arithmetic if the game was created with a different mod list. A legal order cannot be inferred from an arrow alone. A completed local turn is not necessarily a received network submission.

2.1 The operational chain

A reliable turn follows one chain:

```
identify ruleset -> read new information -> inspect state -> choose priorities -> enter orders ->
audit dependencies -> submit -> confirm receipt
```

The chain is simple enough to memorize and strict enough to prevent most administrative losses. Expert play adds better judgment at each step; it does not remove the steps.

2.2 Interface facts and game facts

An interface fact describes what a control does. A game fact describes how the engine resolves the resulting order. The distinction matters:

- Clicking a province creates a movement instruction; Book I explains when movement resolves.
- Pressing Patrol assigns an order; Book II owns patrol strength and unrest consequences.
- Placing a spell in a script requests it; Books IV and V explain legality, targeting, gems, fatigue, and spellcasting behaviour.
- Pressing End Turn commits or hosts the local orders depending on game type; it does not certify that every planned action remains legal when hosting occurs.

The interface is a contract-writing system. It records requests to the host. Resolution belongs to the engine.

Part I: Ruleset, Installation, and Local Continuity

3. Establish the Exact Ruleset

Before creating a game or interpreting an old save, record:

1. Dominions version;
2. enabled mods and their versions;
3. mod load order where relevant;
4. map and map version;
5. age;
6. participating nations and teams;
7. game settings;
8. victory conditions;
9. hosting method and timetable.

The title of a mod or map is not a sufficient identifier. Workshop content can change while retaining its public name. A file name, declared version, release date, and hash provide a stronger frozen record. Book IX demonstrates that practice for the supplied Dominions Enhanced and Divinitus files.

3.1 Current official baseline

The current baseline is Dominions 6.36, released 17 August 2026 UTC. It includes interface and operational changes from the 6.2x-6.36 series: expanded order copying, gem-transfer shortcuts, treasury sorting, clearer province and message displays, lobby safeguards, touchscreen operation, research navigation, and the ability of teleport-moving commanders to leave a besieged fort.

The patch baseline is not decorative. A player returning from an older release may remember a limitation that no longer exists, while a guide written for a later patch may recommend a control unavailable to an older host.

4. Find the User Data Directory

The safest route is the in-game Game Tools menu and Open User Data Directory. This avoids guessing whether the operating system, storefront, or installation has placed personal files somewhere unexpected.

Common default locations are:

Platform	Usual user-data root
Windows	`%APPDATA%\dominions6\`
Linux	`~/.dominions6/`
macOS	`~/.dominions6/`

Important subdirectories commonly include `mods`, `maps`, and `savedgames`. These are user-data locations, not the installed game directory. The distinction matters during reinstalls and updates: personal game material should not depend on editing installation files.

Book VIII owns the full directory and packaging procedure. The practical rule here is narrower: open the directory from the game, confirm the exact folder before copying anything, and preserve original downloaded files separately from edited working copies.

5. Install and Freeze Mods Safely

5.1 A reproducible mod stack

A reproducible stack has four properties:

- every participant has the same files;
- every participant enables the same releases;
- the host records any meaningful load-order requirement;
- the stack is not changed after pretenders or turns have been created unless every participant accepts the consequences.

The modern lobby performs a safety check intended to ensure that required mods have been uploaded, but it cannot replace a written baseline. The lobby can distribute what the host provides; it cannot prove that a public guide, local source inspection, or remembered balance rule refers to that exact file.

5.2 Installation procedure

1. Close any game session that is using the files.
2. Place the mod's `.dm` file and required asset folders in the user-data `mods` directory.
3. Preserve the supplied directory structure. Image paths in a `.dm` file are relative and can fail if folders are flattened or renamed.
4. Start Dominions and open Game Tools to enable the required mods.
5. Confirm that each mod is listed without a load error.
6. Create a small disposable game if the stack is unfamiliar.

7. Record file versions and, for a long campaign, checksums.

The procedure for maps is similar: place the `.map` file and associated images under `maps`, preserve relative paths, and test the map before committing a multiplayer group.

5.3 Never repair the live baseline casually

An apparent spelling error, duplicate definition, broken image, or balance problem in a live mod is not permission to edit the campaign copy. A local change creates a distinct ruleset. Repair experiments belong in a separate working file with a new version label. Book VIII owns safe release engineering.

6. Backups and Campaign Continuity

Backups are useful before a version change, a computer migration, a host transfer, or any repair attempt. Copy the specific game or content directory to a clearly dated destination. Do not replace the only working copy while diagnosing a problem.

For an ordinary campaign, preserve:

- the frozen map and mod files;
- the game-creation settings;
- the current saved game or host state;
- any separately distributed pretender or turn material;
- the hosting schedule and player roster;
- a short incident log when a stale, rollback, substitution, or disputed resolution occurs.

A backup is not a sanctioned alternate timeline. Multiplayer hosts should state in advance when restoration is permitted. A rollback can expose hidden orders or battle information and alter the competitive game even when the technical state is restored perfectly.

7. The Pregame Record

The following compact record is sufficient for most private games:

Field	Record
Game name	Unique, filename-safe identifier
Dominions version	Host version and intended lock
Map	Exact title and release/file identity
Mods	Ordered list with versions
Age	Early, Middle, or Late
Nations	Player, nation, team, human/AI status
Pretender rules	Password requirement, disciples, design restrictions
Economy	Gold, sites, independents, research, special limits
Information	Scoregraph setting and diplomacy convention
Victory	Throne requirements, conquest, Cataclysm
Hosting	Lobby/private/PBEM/hotseat, timer, extensions, stale policy
Administration	Host, backup host, substitution and rollback policy

Experts often retain this record because it lets later analysis separate a game result from a ruleset mismatch. New players benefit for the same reason.

Part II: Creating the World

8. Create, Continue, or Join

The title screen divides three different acts:

- Create World establishes a new game's map, participants, settings, and victory conditions.
- Continue Old Game opens a local game that already exists.
- Network leads to multiplayer connections, including the official lobby.

Treat these as different workflows. Creating a world is an act of ruleset authorship. Continuing a game is a state-loading act. Joining a network game is a compatibility and identity check.

9. Choose the Map

A game can use a premade map or a generated world. The correct choice depends less on visual novelty than on whether the map supports the intended player count and game character.

Check at least:

- land and water province counts;
- required start positions and whether they are appropriate for the chosen age;
- wraparound behaviour;
- cave or plane structure;
- chokepoints, island isolation, and unusually dense water barriers;
- map-specific victory locations or scenario rules;
- whether every participant possesses the exact file and images.

A visually striking map may still be unsuitable for a competitive game if starting regions differ drastically or one nation begins without meaningful routes. Book VI owns map structure and strategic geography; Book VIII owns map-file construction.

10. Choose the Age and Participants

The age determines which nations are available and changes the broad magical and military environment. Early Age nations tend, as a general pattern rather than a universal law, to have stronger magical access and less developed mundane equipment or institutions. Later ages tend toward heavier conventional equipment, more organized states, and diminished magical abundance. Nation-specific exceptions are extensive.

On the participant screen:

1. add each nation;
2. set it to human or AI;
3. confirm that no nation is duplicated;
4. assign teams if using disciples;
5. verify that water nations and unusual starts are compatible with the map.

Do not use AI difficulty as a substitute for a stated learning purpose. A new player's test game, a balance test, and an expert's endurance game require different opposition.

11. Disciple Games

Enable the disciple option before assigning teams. Each team must contain exactly one Pretender and may contain disciples. Current releases support up to twenty teams.

The official rules create important design differences:

- a disciple receives 400 design points;
- a disciple does not choose dominion strength or scales;
- awakening time is half that of the team's Pretender;
- a team with disciples cannot appoint ordinary prophets.

Book III owns the divine mechanics. The setup obligation is to verify team composition before creation. A nation placed on the wrong team cannot be treated as a harmless lobby typo after designs and diplomacy have been built around it.

12. Create and Protect Pretenders

The Pretender-design screen supports saving and loading designs with Ctrl+S and Ctrl+L. Saving a tested design avoids reconstruction errors and gives the campaign a recoverable baseline.

For network play:

- use a player password where the workflow permits it;
- do not reuse an important real-world password;
- confirm the chosen nation, age, team, and active mods before submission;
- keep the local design file until the game has begun successfully.

Cheat prevention is useful but does not protect players from a malicious or careless host. The host necessarily holds privileged game state. Trust and administrative policy remain part of multiplayer security.

Pretender design itself belongs to Book III. Book X adds only the operational rule: save, label, verify, and submit the design that was actually tested.

13. Game Settings by Consequence

Game settings should be chosen by the experience they create, not by habit.

Setting	What it changes operationally	Questions for the host
Starting gold	Opening purchasing power	Is the game meant to accelerate first forts or preserve normal scarcity?
Magic-site frequency	Gem and site density	Will this support the intended map size and magic level?
Independent strength	Expansion danger	Are players expected to use tested expansion parties or learn against forgiving provinces?
Research or magic setting	Time to research thresholds	Does the timer match the intended campaign length?
Scoregraphs	Public strategic information	Are graphs visible, hidden, or recoverable through intelligence?

Setting	What it changes operationally	Questions for the host
Master password	Emergency administrative access	Who holds it, and under what written circumstances may it be used?
Limited artifact forging	Competition for unique artifacts	Is the default one unique artifact per game turn retained?
Limited legendary research	Competition at level nine	Is only one level-nine discovery permitted at a time, with repeat research required?
Commander renaming	Information organization and deception	Is renaming allowed, and are naming conventions restricted?
Cheat prevention	Detectable file manipulation	Is it enabled, and do players understand its limits?
Throne settings	Victory arithmetic	How many Ascension Points exist and how many are required?
Cataclysm	Endgame clock	When does it begin, and how will Throne loss alter the required total?

13.1 Scoregraphs

Scoregraphs change diplomacy because they change common knowledge. Visible army, income, research, fort, province, dominion, or gem trends allow coalitions to form around measurable growth. Hidden graphs place more weight on scouting and negotiation. Spies operating in an enemy capital can reveal graphs, so hidden does not mean unobtainable.

At victory, current versions reveal scoregraphs and the hidden map to players who remain until the end; an eliminated player does not receive that later revelation. This makes post-game review stronger than mid-game speculation. Book VI owns the strategic use of information.

13.2 Master password

A master password can rescue a game by allowing an absent player to be set to AI or by permitting necessary administration. It also provides broad access. It should be held by the host and, if desired, a trusted backup under a written policy. Its use should be logged.

13.3 Limited artifacts and legendary research

Under the usual limited-artifact setting, a particular unique artifact may be forged only once per game turn. Several players can race for it in the same month. Under limited legendary research, only one level-nine spell in a school can be completed at a time; the level can be researched again to reach another. These settings turn a menu choice into an initiative contest.

13.4 Renaming

When enabled, most commanders can be renamed by opening their statistics and pressing R. Pretenders, disciples, prophets, and famous heroes are exceptions. Good internal names encode function or theatre without exposing more than necessary in multiplayer screenshots or streams.

14. Victory Conditions

The standard route is control of enough Ascension Points from Thrones. The setup screen can use recommended/default Throne distributions or a custom arrangement. A conquest game instead requires elimination or control on the specified terms.

Cataclysm creates a hardening endgame. It destroys Thrones over time and reduces the Ascension Points required for victory. The finishing line moves while the map deteriorates. Record the starting turn and make sure every player understands the interaction before play begins.

Book VI owns Throne arithmetic and victory conversion. The setup standard is exactness: state the number and level of Thrones, total points, points required, and Cataclysm turn.

15. Host Setup Sheet

Before pressing the final creation control, the host should be able to answer every row:

Check	Pass condition
Version	Host is on the announced patch.
Content	Exact map and mod stack are installed and tested.
Participants	Nations, human/AI status, and teams match the roster.
Settings	Every non-default setting is written down.
Victory	Throne or conquest conditions are explicit.
Security	Player passwords, master-password custody, and host trust are addressed.
Schedule	First hosting time, regular timer, and extension channel are known.
Recovery	Backup and substitution policy exists.

Creating the world should feel like signing the campaign charter, because that is what it is.

Part III: Starting, Joining, and Hosting

16. Game Modes

Dominions supports several multiplayer patterns.

Mode	Best use	Principal operational risk
Single-player	Learning, testing, and private analysis	End Turn hosts immediately; there is no submission grace period.
Hotseat	Several players on one machine	Hidden information and passwords require disciplined handoff.
Official lobby	Most online groups	Identity, version, mod, password, and timer errors.
Private server	Controlled communities and persistent hosts	Server setup and maintenance depend on the current executable and network environment.
PBEM/file exchange	Asynchronous groups using external coordination	Wrong or missing files, weak confirmation, and manual version control.

The official lobby is the recommended online route for ordinary groups. Private servers and PBEM remain valid when the group has a reason to manage its own infrastructure, but exact command-line instructions are version-sensitive and should be taken from the current official documentation or executable help rather than copied uncritically from an older guide.

17. Official Lobby Workflow

17.1 Joining

1. Start the announced Dominions version.
2. Enable or install the required mods.
3. Select Network and Enter Game Lobby.
4. Locate the exact game name rather than a similar title.
5. Check nation, status, remaining time, and any displayed content requirements.
6. Enter the player password if required.
7. Inspect the loaded turn before issuing orders.

If the game cannot be entered, stop before changing local files at random. Compare version, mod list, mod file identity, map, password, and whether the game is awaiting pretenders, running, finished, or currently hosting.

17.2 Creating or administering a lobby game

The lobby host should keep the game name distinctive, publish the ruleset separately, and test the connection before the first real deadline. Current releases have improved lobby validation and handling of larger turn files, but administrative clarity remains necessary.

Do not change mods or the map to make one client connect unless the host has first confirmed the canonical campaign files. The correct repair is to bring the client to the baseline, not to create competing baselines.

18. Turn Submission and Revision

In network multiplayer, End Turn saves and submits the turn. The player can normally revise and resubmit before hosting. In single-player, End Turn immediately resolves the month.

That difference changes the safe habit:

- In single-player, perform the complete audit before ending the turn.
- In multiplayer, early submission can protect against a missed deadline, but a later revision still requires confirmation that the replacement was received.

A submitted marker is evidence of receipt, not evidence of strategic quality. The final pre-host check remains necessary.

18.1 Submission protocol

1. Save enough time before the deadline for a connection failure.
2. Finish a complete local audit.
3. Press End Turn and allow the transfer to finish.
4. Re-enter or refresh the game state if necessary to confirm the nation is marked submitted.
5. If revising, make the change, submit again, and confirm the new submission.
6. Notify the host immediately if the status is uncertain near the deadline.

18.2 Stales

A stale is a hosted turn without a valid new submission for that nation. The engine must continue the game from existing state and default order persistence. The result may preserve some standing behaviour but it does not replace active planning.

The host should distinguish:

- an ordinary missed deadline governed by the published stale policy;
- a platform or host failure affecting several players;
- an announced emergency for which an extension was requested;
- strategic regret after the player already had a fair opportunity to submit.

These are not ethically identical events, even if all can produce a missing turn file.

19. Hosting Policy

A healthy campaign states its administrative rules before they become politically useful.

19.1 Minimum charter

- regular hosting interval and timezone;
- how automatic hosting interacts with all turns being submitted;
- extension request channel and expected notice;
- maximum ordinary extension, if any;
- stale and consecutive-stale policy;
- substitution and AI-conversion procedure;
- rollback conditions;
- rules for diplomacy, trades, concessions, and coordinated victory;
- rules for bugs, exploits, and prohibited file inspection;
- who can administer the game if the host is unavailable.

19.2 Extensions

Extensions protect the quality of a long game when real life intervenes. They also delay every participant. A good rule is predictable and symmetric: ask as early as possible, give a new exact deadline, and record it in the common channel. Do not make the host infer that an unsubmitted nation wants more time.

19.3 Substitutions

A substitute needs the nation password, current turn access, public rules, diplomatic obligations, and enough strategic context to avoid accidental treaty breaches. Private intelligence should be transferred only as the game permits. The original player should not continue advising several sides after departure unless the group explicitly allows it.

19.4 Rollbacks

Rollback is a last resort for technical corruption or a clearly defined administrative failure. It is not a remedy for a forgotten script, a bad move, or a surprising battle. Once players have seen hosted information, replaying the month changes their knowledge. If a rollback is unavoidable, document the reason, restored point, affected submissions, and any required order-repetition rule.

20. Security and Trust

Use unique game passwords. Do not send credentials through public channels. The master password and host files deserve the same care as any private competitive record.

Cheat detection can identify some forms of manipulation, but it cannot make an untrusted host trustworthy. The host has privileged access by design. Choose a host who treats the role as custodial, preserve administrative logs, and settle disputes through evidence instead of speculation.

Part IV: The Main Interface

21. The Map as a Control Surface

The strategic map is simultaneously a world view, an order editor, and an information filter. The default interaction pattern is:

- right-click a province or object for information;
- left-click a commander to select it;
- left-click a destination to issue movement;
- use the province and nation controls for recruitment, messages, research, and overviews.

Mouse behaviour can be altered in preferences, so a player following instructions on another machine should confirm whether selection and information buttons have been swapped.

21.1 Selection discipline

Before entering an order, identify three things:

1. the selected province;
2. the selected commander or group of commanders;
3. the destination or target province.

Most accidental orders are selection failures. The map arrow can look plausible even when the wrong commander is carrying the order.

22. Province and Nation Controls

The standard controls include:

Control	Function	Operational use
E	End Turn	Save/submit in multiplayer; host immediately in single-player.
T	Army Setup	Organize commanders and troops in the selected province.
Y	Army Setup at Destination	Inspect or organize the destination context.
U	Patrolling Army Setup	Work with forces assigned to patrol.
R	Recruit Units	Open the local recruitment screen.
B	Mercenaries	Review and bid on available mercenaries.
I	Province Chronicles	Review the province's recorded history.
M	Read Messages	Open the month's messages.
S	Send Messages	Open diplomacy and transfer messaging.
F1	Nation Overview	Inspect commanders, provinces, and national administration.
F2	Scoregraphs	View information allowed by the game setting and intelligence.
F3	Hall of Fame	Inspect experience leaders and heroic abilities.

Control	Function	Operational use
F4	Pretenders	Review known divine players and status.
F5	Research	Set school priorities and inspect progress.
F6	Global Enchantments	Review active globals and available public information.
F7	Magic Item Treasury	Store, equip, and manage items where access permits.
F8	Magic Item Overview	Find items and their holders across the nation.
F9	Thrones	Review known Thrones and Ascension Point information.
Esc	Options/menu	Access preferences, save/quit controls, and other session options.

The letter shortcuts are efficient because they reduce navigation cost, but context still controls what can be done. R opens local recruitment only where the province and ownership permit it. F7 does not make a remote commander share a laboratory treasury.

23. Map Navigation Shortcuts

Key	Result
Arrow keys	Scroll the map.
Home	Centre on the home province.
Ctrl+Home	Centre on the Pretender or disciple.
G or #	Go to a province by number.
End	Set half-scale zoom.
Insert	Zoom to cover the screen.
Delete	Fit the whole map.
Page Up or Ctrl+Up	Zoom in.
Page Down or Ctrl+Down	Zoom out.
Ctrl+F	Open map filtering.
H	Hide interface buttons and commanders.
?	Show contextual shortcut help on supported screens.

The ? control deserves special emphasis. Dominions exposes more context-sensitive shortcuts than any static summary can comfortably hold. When a selection, army, recruitment, or treasury screen feels slow, open the contextual help before assuming the operation requires repeated clicking.

23.1 Touchscreen mode

Version 6.36 adds a touchscreen mode for play with little or no keyboard use. In that mode, a long-click is interpreted as a right-click and the map can be scrolled by dragging broadly rather than relying on a narrow scroll region. The settings popup remains the release-specific control reference. Because long-click changes the meaning of a press, practise opening and closing popups before entering time-sensitive orders.

24. Strategic Map Filters

Shortcut	Filter or overlay
Ctrl+1	Flags and forts
Ctrl+2	Armies
Ctrl+3	Dominion
Ctrl+4	Income
Ctrl+5	Thrones and events
Ctrl+6	Own troops in allied provinces
Ctrl+7	Allied troops in own provinces
Ctrl+8	Neighbour relationships
Ctrl+9	Province names
Ctrl+0	Remote rituals

A filter is an analytical lens. Income view finds economic discontinuities; dominion view finds religious fronts; army view finds exposed force; neighbour view tests movement assumptions. Use several filters in sequence rather than treating the default map as complete information.

24.1 Planes

Plane controls switch among accessible realms: the Pantokrator's realm, the realm beneath, and the Void. A control is grey when the nation lacks access. A plane is more than another zoom layer; it can have its own movement, access, provinces, and strategic relationships. Verify the active plane before issuing or diagnosing a movement order.

25. Right-Click, Tooltips, and Popups

Right-click is the first research tool inside the game. Use it on units, weapons, armour, abilities, provinces, paths, items, and other interface elements. Hover text and popups often expose the difference between a familiar name and the actual current ruleset.

Recent releases have expanded popups for areas of effect, movement destinations, Ascension Point information, ritual targets, and other state. Treat a tooltip as a current local clue, then distinguish three cases:

- the popup states an exact game value;
- the popup summarizes a mechanic owned by the manual;
- the popup describes an effect whose full result still depends on hidden state or hosting order.

The first can be recorded directly. The second should be linked to its canonical rule. The third requires evidence, not confident interpolation.

26. Current Operational Additions Worth Learning

Players returning from earlier Dominions 6 releases should learn these accumulated improvements:

- Ctrl+A can sort the item treasury automatically.

- Gem transfers have fast keyboard controls in several screens; for example, hovering a commander and using Alt+F adds a Fire gem, while Alt+Backspace removes the corresponding gem in the supported context.
- Order copying is available more broadly, including army positioning; 0 is used for order copy/paste in supported screens, while squad scripting also retains numbered script storage.
- The bless interface can repeat the last effect with X and remove an effect with Backspace.
- In version 6.35, the Nation Overview's L filter isolates commanders assigned to Pillage.
- Ritual messages and destination displays provide stronger province navigation.
- Teleport-moving commanders can leave a besieged fort in 6.35.
- In 6.36, right-clicking the supported Province Defence increase or decrease control changes PD by ten, and right-clicking the T Army Setup control invokes the Y destination form.
- The 6.36 Research screen uses Up and Down to swap research targets and includes ? help.
- In the 6.36 battle overview, S hides temporary summons; in spell selection, Space clears the active filter.
- Current victory review reveals scoregraphs and the hidden map for players who remain until the end.

Shortcuts are not all global. If a key does nothing, confirm the active screen and open ? rather than assuming the rule has failed.

Part V: Reading and Preparing a Turn

27. Begin with Messages, Not with Memory

Every hosted month can invalidate part of the plan made in the previous one. A border changed, a commander died, a site was discovered, a fort completed, a ritual failed, an enemy army appeared, or a diplomatic promise became due. Read the new state before continuing yesterday's intentions.

A strong review order follows causation:

1. hosting and administrative notices;
2. battles, assassinations, and movement outcomes;
3. province gains, losses, sieges, and unrest events;
4. new commanders, troops, construction, and recruitment;
5. research, spells, items, sites, and rituals;
6. dominion, Throne, and global changes;
7. diplomacy and transfers;
8. attrition, disease, desertion, and other end-state changes.

This mirrors the principle in Book I's hosting sequence: consequences should be read in the order that explains them. The message list is not always displayed as a complete causal proof, so province state, commander state, and the battle replay may need to be compared.

28. Message Triage

Classify each message before acting.

Class	Meaning	Immediate question
Fatal dependency	A commander, fort, laboratory, army, or route no longer exists	Which downstream orders are now impossible?
Strategic change	A war, Throne, global, border, or alliance changed	Does the monthly priority still hold?

Class	Meaning	Immediate question
Resource change	Gold, gems, research, recruitment, or items changed	Which queue or package is now underfunded?
Local exception	An event or isolated result needs attention	Is it urgent, or can it wait behind national priorities?
Informational	The message confirms an expected result	Can it be archived after verification?

The greatest danger is not the most dramatic message. It is the message that silently invalidates several orders: a laboratory loss that strands gem transfers, a dead ferry commander that leaves troops behind, or a captured province that breaks a movement chain.

28.1 Use message navigation

Where a message offers a province or unit link, use it. Current versions provide better destination and ritual-message navigation than early releases. After arriving at the province, inspect the surrounding map; a message's named location may be only one part of the consequence.

29. Battle Review as Evidence

A battle replay answers more than "who won?" Record:

- initial formation and whether expected squads appeared;
- actual scripts and whether requested spells were cast;
- first contact timing;
- important damage, fatigue, morale, and targeting failures;
- retreats and the provinces into which survivors escaped;
- commander and specialist losses;
- whether the result achieved the campaign purpose.

Book IV owns the post-battle audit, while Book VI owns conversion. The operational duty is to preserve enough evidence to tell a bad plan from a mis-entered plan.

29.1 Replay version awareness

Battle displays are interpretations of a hosted result. Version mismatches can create misleading replays. In supported versions, Ctrl+I during battle can display host and current version information. If the visible replay appears impossible, compare the host version before constructing a new theory of combat.

30. The Nation Overview as an Administrative Ledger

F1 is the broadest audit screen. It makes dispersed national state searchable without clicking every province. Use its columns, filters, and sorting to answer questions such as:

- Which commanders have no useful order?
- Which mages are researching, moving, forging, searching, or idle?
- Which provinces are recruiting commanders or troops?
- Where are unrest, low income, fortification, or siege problems developing?
- Which forces are pillaging, patrolling, or otherwise assigned to exceptional work?

The overview is most valuable near the end of the turn, after local plans have been entered. It reveals omissions that province-by-province work hides.

On version 6.35, press L within the Nation Overview to isolate Pillage orders. This is especially useful before submission: a commander left pillaging after an emergency can permanently damage a province that has already returned to ordinary economic use.

31. Establish the Monthly Priorities

Before issuing many orders, state the month in a few lines:

- primary strategic objective;
- threat that must be answered;
- research threshold being pursued;
- infrastructure or recruitment commitment;
- gem or item package that must be delivered;
- diplomatic obligation due this month;
- acceptable loss and reserve requirement.

The statement prevents locally attractive actions from consuming resources required by the national plan. It also makes the final audit intelligible: each essential order can be checked against a declared purpose.

32. Work from Dependencies Outward

Enter fragile, dependent orders before routine orders.

1. confirm irreplaceable commanders and movement leaders;
2. assign magic, gems, items, and ritual targets;
3. organize armies and scripts;
4. enter movement, stealth, patrol, siege, and special orders;
5. complete recruitment and construction;
6. adjust research and recurring administration;
7. send diplomacy and transfers;
8. audit the entire nation.

This is not the engine's hosting sequence. It is a human error-control sequence. A recruitment queue is easy to reconstruct; a multi-province communion package assembled after movement orders is easy to break.

33. The End-of-Turn Audit

Run four passes.

33.1 Commanders

- Every important commander has the intended order.
- Movement arrows belong to the intended units.
- Stealth, normal movement, and attack-current-province choices are distinguished.
- Researchers, site searchers, forgers, preachers, blood hunters, and builders are not accidentally idle.
- Besieged commanders have legal orders for their side of the walls.

33.2 Armies

- Troops are assigned to commanders rather than left unintentionally in the garrison.
- Leadership type and capacity are sufficient.

- Formation, orders, scripts, gems, and items belong to the correct commander.
- Retreat routes and supply are plausible.
- A moving commander is actually carrying the intended squads.

33.3 State

- Capital and fort recruitment queues are funded as intended.
- Commander Points, Recruitment Points, resources, Holy Points, and gold bind where expected.
- Forts, temples, laboratories, Province Defence, and repairs match the budget.
- Research is assigned to the intended schools.
- Treasury gems and items are where next month's plan expects them.

33.4 Campaign

- Border gaps, Throne approaches, and known raiders were inspected.
- Treaties, trades, warnings, and extension needs were communicated.
- The action creates a useful position if it succeeds and a survivable position if it fails.
- The turn is submitted and receipt confirmed.

Part VI: Recruitment, Army Setup, and Inventories

34. Recruitment Is Local

The recruitment screen converts local capacity into a future force. National troops are usually available in the capital and in forts, subject to nation and unit rules. Some troops are capital-only; some require terrain, a particular site, a foreign-recruitment condition, or recruitment outside a fort.

A unit or commander can be constrained by several independent resources:

- gold;
- local resources;
- Recruitment Points;
- Commander Points;
- Holy Points;
- a per-turn or per-location recruitment limit;
- a fort, site, terrain, dominion, or other prerequisite.

Book II owns recruitment constraints. The recruitment screen expresses those constraints locally.

35. Reading a Recruitment Queue

35.1 Immediate gold, later local capacity

The game will not queue a purchase that cannot be afforded with current gold. Some shortages in resources, Recruitment Points, or Holy Points can remain in a queue for later turns. A dimmed entry needs to be diagnosed: inspect every cost and prerequisite instead of assuming gold is the problem.

35.2 Queue behaviour

- Hold Shift while selecting a recruit to add ten at a time.
- A queue can hold up to 250 entries.
- Commanders are separately restricted by local Commander Points.
- Units with a limited recruitment rate cannot exceed that local monthly rate.
- Newly recruited units arrive early enough in the hosted month to defend the province.
- Recruits in a fort that becomes besieged are placed within the besieged fort.
- New units enter the unassigned garrison until deliberately organized.

35.3 Queue audit

For each recruiting centre, ask:

1. What role is being purchased?
2. Which resource is binding?
3. Will the queue complete this month or spill into the next?
4. Is a commander being produced to lead or use the troops?
5. Can the province survive long enough for the investment to matter?

An overflowing queue is not a plan. It is a claim on future capacity.

36. Army Setup

Open Army Setup with T. The screen is where troops are transferred, grouped, positioned, and given battle orders.

36.1 The unassigned garrison

Unassigned units are not attached to a commander.

- In a fort, they remain inside unless assigned or used in a relevant patrol or defensive arrangement.
- Outside a fort, unassigned defenders join a battle as a central squad.

Leaving troops in the garrison can be deliberate. Leaving the only troops meant to move there is an operational failure.

36.2 Forming squads

A commander can lead up to five squads, subject to leadership type and capacity. Select units and then a squad box to add them. Dropping selected units on a commander can create a new squad when a slot is available.

Useful selection controls include:

- double-click to select matching units;
- Shift-click to build a selection;
- hover a squad and press W to select afflicted units;
- E to select units with at least two experience stars in the supported context;
- M to select the slowest units;
- Enter to clear a selection;
- ? to display the complete contextual shortcut list.

Selection shortcuts are tools for preserving composition. They allow the wounded, experienced, or slowest part of a formation to be separated without checking every card.

36.3 Leadership audit

The army screen may permit a visually convincing group that performs poorly because the commander lacks appropriate ordinary, undead, magical, or special leadership. Before leaving the screen, compare:

- number and type of units;
- commander leadership categories;
- command penalties or bonuses;
- squad morale;
- movement compatibility.

Book IV owns leadership and army construction.

37. Positioning and Battle Orders

Each squad and commander has a placement box. Selected formations can be repositioned by right-clicking in the battlefield diagram. Colour and order indicators distinguish assigned behaviour, but the order text remains the authoritative check.

37.1 Squad orders

Assign orders based on delivery rather than theme. A missile squad, bodyguard group, flanking force, line holder, and attack squad have different contact problems. The detailed order and targeting analysis belongs to Book IV.

37.2 Commander scripts

A commander can receive up to five specific scripted orders before falling back to the standing order or spellcasting AI. In the army screen:

- Ctrl+number stores a script in the supported context;
- pressing the corresponding number pastes it;
- X can repeat the same requested order while constructing the script;
- current versions also support broader order copy/paste, including 0 in supported screens.

After copying a script, re-check gems, paths, equipment, range, fatigue, and spell availability. Copying transfers instructions; it does not make commanders interchangeable.

37.3 The script audit

For each important caster or specialist:

1. confirm the current unit, not merely its name;
2. confirm paths after items and modifiers;
3. confirm required gems are personal or otherwise accessible under the rule;
4. confirm the spell is researched and legal in the expected battle;
5. confirm the army will create the intended range and timing;
6. define acceptable fallback behaviour.

38. Items, Treasury, and Equipment

Clicking an empty item slot opens the treasury when the commander has laboratory access. Body form determines available slots. A mounted commander may have foot equipment disabled while mounted; barding belongs to the mount through the commander's mounted equipment relationship.

Some units have standard equipment that returns when a magical replacement is removed. This can make an inventory look as if an item appeared from nowhere. Inspect the unit's normal equipment before treating the result as duplication.

38.1 Treasury controls

- F7 opens the Magic Item Treasury.
- F8 opens the national Magic Item Overview.
- Ctrl+A sorts the treasury in current versions.
- Right-click items to inspect exact abilities and restrictions.
- Verify laboratory access before assuming an item can be equipped or returned.

Use the overview to locate a missing artifact before recreating it. An item on a remote or hidden commander is still part of national inventory but may not be transferable this month.

39. Gems and Gem Squiring

Any commander can carry up to forty gems. This permits non-mage commanders to transport gems as squires, even though they may not be able to spend them as a mage would.

Gem logistics has three distinct questions:

1. Does the nation possess the gems?
2. Can this commander access or carry them now?
3. Can the intended caster legally spend them for the order or battle?

The transfer interface and fast shortcuts answer the second question only. Book V owns gem spending and magical logistics.

39.1 Safe gem procedure

1. Open the relevant laboratory or transfer context.
2. Move the exact battle or ritual allocation.
3. Add a reserve only if the script and AI are permitted to spend it.
4. Check the commander's personal gem display.
5. Re-check after changing items, scripts, or movement.
6. Use the national overview or treasury controls to catch stranded stock.

Fast keys save time, but they can also create off-by-one errors. The final displayed count is authoritative.

40. Mounted Units and Reclaiming Mounts

Mounted units can lose or change their mounted state through battle and end-of-turn systems. Where the unit supports it, Reclaim Mount allows the rider to recover the appropriate mount relationship. Current versions also include end-of-turn handling for mounts.

Do not assume that a rider and mount remain a single unchanging card. Check movement, equipment slots, size, protection, and battlefield function after a mount loss or recovery. The combat consequences belong to Book IV's mount chapter.

Part VII: Strategic Order Reference

41. Orders Are Requests with Preconditions

An order is checked when entered, but some preconditions can change before hosting reaches it. A legal movement arrow may remain visible even if an item that enabled the movement is removed. A ritual can fail because the caster, gems, laboratory, target, or path state changed. An army can reach a destination without the troops that were left in the garrison.

Every important order needs two checks:

- entry legality: the interface accepted it now;
- resolution viability: the required commander, route, army, item, gem, building, and target are expected to exist when the engine reaches it.

42. Ordinary Movement

A movement arrow connects origin and destination. It is not a promise that the commander will follow a particular visible route. Entering an enemy province generally creates combat; entering a friendly province containing a fort normally places the force inside that fort.

Friendly movement and hostile movement have different resolution relationships. Opposing forces can meet on either side or pass into one another's provinces depending on orders and the hosting sequence. Use Book I for exact timing and Book VI for interception doctrine.

42.1 Movement audit

- movement mode is correct;
- commander and all squads can make the move;
- no item or shape change is providing a fragile movement entitlement;
- destination ownership is interpreted correctly;
- entering a friendly fort is intended;
- retreat and supply consequences are understood.

43. Sneak, Hide, and Attack Current Province

Sneak is the default movement mode for an eligible stealthy commander whose entire army can move stealthily. Holding Ctrl while selecting the destination can request normal movement instead. Removing the last non-stealth unit does not necessarily restore a previously changed defensive order to Sneak; inspect the displayed order.

Hide is the stationary default for a stealthy force in suitable circumstances. Hidden forces do not join an ordinary battle merely because friendly conventional troops fight there. If discovered, they can fight a separate detection battle.

Attack Current Province lets a hidden force in an enemy province emerge and attack without moving to another province. It can join friendly attackers arriving there. The distinction among Sneak, Hide, and Attack Current Province is operationally decisive:

Intent	Correct family
Move unseen to another province	Sneak
Remain concealed here	Hide
Reveal and fight in this province	Attack Current Province

44. Patrol and Move-and-Patrol

Patrol searches for hidden enemies and reduces unrest according to the patrolling force. A patroller outside a fort participates in exterior combat. Where there is no unrest, ordinary patrolling does not damage population merely for being performed.

Move and Patrol is assigned after entering movement into a friendly fort province. It can also be requested with the supported Shift+Ctrl destination shortcut. The force arrives outside the fort and is available to fight there; it becomes an ordinary Patrol order in the following month. It does not provide the same-turn stealth-search result that a stationary patrol would.

Use Move and Patrol when relief must arrive on the exterior rather than disappear inside a friendly fort. Verify the displayed compound order before leaving the province.

45. Defend

Defend means remain and fight without patrolling. In a friendly fort it generally concedes the exterior and places the force inside. A stealthy commander on Defend fights openly rather than remaining hidden.

This is one of the most common interface traps: "do nothing" is not a single order. Defend, Hide, Patrol, Research, and the relevant siege order have different participation in battle and control of the fort exterior.

46. Siege Orders

46.1 Maintain Siege

Only forces assigned to Maintain Siege contribute to breaking the walls. An army in the province performing another order should not be counted in the siege calculation.

46.2 Storm Castle

Storm Castle becomes available after fortification defence has been reduced to zero, and the assault occurs in the following hosted month. A relief battle or another exterior event can intervene before the storm. A zero-wall message gives permission to prepare an assault; it does not mean the fort has already fallen.

46.3 Break Siege

The besieged force uses Break Siege to sortie. Retreating survivors may return inside or escape to a legal adjacent friendly province according to the rules. If both sides try to force the decisive siege action at once, the relevant contest can determine which proceeds.

Book II owns siege calculation; Book IV owns the assault battle; Book VI owns the campaign clock.

46.4 Teleport movement from a siege

Since 6.35, commanders using teleport movement can move out of a besieged fort. Do not generalize this to ordinary strategic movement or to every ritual movement effect. Confirm the actual movement mode and current version.

47. Construction and Demolition Orders

The ordinary construction relationships are:

- a fort can be started by a commander allowed to construct it;
- a temple requires an eligible sacred commander;
- a laboratory requires an eligible mage.

Costs, nation modifiers, terrain, and completion timing belong to Book II and Book I.

Demolish takes one month for an eligible building. A temple cannot simply be voluntarily demolished under the ordinary rule; an enemy temple is destroyed when the province is captured. A fort cannot be demolished while it is under siege. Because demolition removes national infrastructure and can change access, it deserves the same audit as a movement order.

48. Religious and Divine Orders

48.1 Preach

An eligible priest can preach to strengthen friendly dominion, subject to Holy level and local limits. Book III owns the formula and strategic religious system.

48.2 Blood Sacrifice

An eligible national unit at a temple can sacrifice blood slaves where the nation permits it. Possessing slaves, priesthood, and a temple separately does not imply the order exists; the nation or unit must have the relevant ability.

48.3 Become Prophet

A nation can normally have one prophet. An eligible commander becomes a priest one level higher than before, or Holy 3 if that is higher, and gains prophet-related dominion effects. After a prophet dies, a six-turn interval applies before another can be appointed under the ordinary rule.

The order is both a religious investment and an opportunity cost for that commander during the appointment month. Book III owns the full consequences.

49. Research, Search, Forge, and Cast Ritual

These magic orders share a dependency pattern:

Order	Essential checks
Research	Mage can research; school allocation still serves the target; local events have not removed the mage.
Search	Correct province and search mode; caster paths are relevant; movement and stealth expectations are not confused with the order.
Forge	Laboratory, path, research, gems, item availability, and artifact race.
Cast Ritual	Laboratory or specific exception, path, research, gems, target legality, range, and hosting timing.

Ritual caster order is not a safe basis for precise informal sequencing. If two rituals depend on one another in the same month, verify the documented hosting relationship or separate them across months. Book I owns resolution order; Book V owns magical legality.

50. Pillage and Raid

Pillage converts local destruction into immediate gain. It raises unrest, kills population, damages supply conditions, and can produce gold and temporary provisions. Large, fast, frightening, barbarian, or otherwise suitable troops can be effective pillagers. The economic arithmetic belongs to Book II.

Raid is movement combined with pillaging under a commander with the Pillager ability and sufficient strategic army movement, ordinarily at least 20. Only units with the Pillager ability contribute to the pillaging component, and at half their ordinary pillage value. The force must win the province fight before the pillage occurs.

The order distinction is:

- Pillage destroys the province currently occupied.
- Raid attempts to move, win, and then damage the destination.

Both should be evaluated as campaign acts. Damage to a province that must soon be governed can cost more than the gold obtained.

51. Blood Hunt

An eligible blood hunter searches the province for blood slaves. The order risks unrest, population loss through subsequent enforcement conditions, and opportunity cost. High population and controlled unrest are operational considerations; exact hunting probability and economic doctrine belong to Book II.

Before assigning the order, confirm that patrol capacity, laboratory access for collection where needed, and a plan for transporting or spending slaves exist. Blood hunting without administration can immobilize the province that funds it.

52. Reanimate, Manikin, Contact Allies, and Capture Slaves

These are nation- or unit-specific orders rather than universal controls.

- Reanimate produces a permitted undead type. Ghouls consume population, Soulless draw on corpses, and Longdead can be raised without those two local stocks under the ordinary distinctions. Available forms depend on the reanimator.
- Manikin is associated with Asphodel's nature-death system and can depend on human population, corpses, and hostile dominion.
- Contact Allies occupies the commander for the month while gathering the defined allied troops.
- Capture Slaves is available to specific national actors, including ordinary manual examples in Mictlan and Nazca, and produces a small random group under the documented order.

The interface presence of one variant should never be generalized to every unit with similar lore. Right-click the actor and treat the exact ruleset as authoritative.

53. Espionage Orders

53.1 Instill Uprising

A Spy can increase unrest in an enemy province. This is an economic and administrative attack rather than a direct attempt to capture the province.

53.2 Infiltrate

Infiltration is performed in an enemy capital by a Spy. It can reveal mundane scoregraph information, with additional categories available when the infiltrator is a spellcaster or priest. The attempt can fail and expose the infiltrator; the official manual describes the ordinary success chance as roughly even before relevant conditions.

The order should be judged against the intelligence actually needed. Risking an established scout network to learn a graph already inferable from the map may be poor value.

54. Assassination and Abduction Orders

54.1 Assassinate

An assassin selects a random eligible enemy commander in the province. Bodyguards can accompany the victim when their individual checks succeed; the ordinary base is one chance in two per bodyguard before relevant modifiers. The victim is caught unprepared and does not follow an ordinary prepared battle script.

Assassination battlefields can include local features or bystanders. Fort walls block ordinary attempts into or out of a siege unless the actor has a relevant bypass such as Scale Walls, flight, or teleportation.

54.2 Seduction

Seduction targets an eligible commander of the opposite sex and tests morale. A successful target may escape toward a friendly adjacent province or, for some flying movement, toward the capital. Beauty improves the attempt. Failure can lead to an assassination battle.

54.3 Dream Seduction

Dream Seduction first confronts Magic Resistance and then morale. Penetration and Beauty can matter to the respective checks. Failure can create the special confrontation defined by the ability.

54.4 Corruption

Corruption resembles seduction in strategic purpose but Beauty does not improve it. Its exact actor and target restrictions remain ability-specific.

54.5 Lure of the Sirens

This coastal order tests resistance and morale without using Beauty. A successful victim can drown or face an underwater battle; failure does not create the same assassination response as ordinary seduction. Penetration can improve the magical component.

All five orders are asymmetric operations. The target pool, fort state, bodyguards, escape geography, actor survival, and information gained should be considered before the order is entered.

55. Strategic Order Quick Reference

Intended act	Order	Principal operational trap
Move openly	Move	Arrow survives a lost movement prerequisite or enters a friendly fort unexpectedly.
Move covertly	Sneak	A non-stealth unit prevents the army from sneaking.
Remain covert	Hide	Hidden force does not join an ordinary friendly battle.
Emerge here	Attack Current Province	Confused with movement to a neighbouring province.
Defend openly	Defend	Force inside a fort concedes the exterior.
Find hidden units/reduce unrest	Patrol	Not the same as Move and Patrol or Defend.
Arrive outside a friendly fort	Move and Patrol	Does not conduct a same-month stealth search on arrival.
Break walls	Maintain Siege	Other orders do not contribute siege strength.
Assault zero walls	Storm Castle	Relief and exterior battles can occur first.
Sortie	Break Siege	Retreat and concurrent siege action require careful interpretation.
Build	Construct Fort/Temple/Lab	Actor eligibility, cost, terrain, and timing differ.
Remove infrastructure	Demolish	Temples and besieged forts have special restrictions.
Produce research	Research	Mage-turn opportunity cost is easy to overlook.
Strategic magic	Cast Ritual	Lab, path, gems, range, target, and timing all bind.
Produce an item	Forge	Artifact competition and remote treasury access matter.
Find sites	Search	Search mode and paths may not match the province.
Strengthen dominion	Preach	Holy level and local dominion conditions govern effect.
Appoint religious leader	Become Prophet	One-prophet limit and six-turn replacement interval.
Extract blood slaves	Blood Hunt	Unrest and administrative support can bind.
Damage current province	Pillage	Permanent economic damage may exceed immediate return.

Intended act	Order	Principal operational trap
Move and damage	Raid	Requires Pillager commander, movement, qualifying units, and victory.
Raise special troops	Reanimate/Manikin/Contact Allies	Output and local inputs are unit-specific.
Attack administration	Instill Uprising/Infiltrate	Exposure risk and target value.
Remove or convert commanders	Assassin/Seduction family	Target pool, bodyguards, walls, escape, and actor survival.

Part VIII: A Guided First Campaign

56. The Learning Campaign

The first campaign should expose the whole game without hiding mistakes behind excessive advantages. A useful environment is:

- a small or medium land map with enough space for several expansion routes;
- a nation with understandable conventional troops and mages;
- ordinary or slightly forgiving independent strength;
- standard research and broadly standard economy;
- a clear Throne victory condition;
- few or no overhaul mods during the first pass;
- several AI opponents, followed by a second game against people.

The purpose is not to guarantee victory. It is to make every failure legible.

57. Before Turn One

Complete five preparations.

57.1 State the national idea

Write one paragraph covering:

- how the nation expands;
- what the capital produces every month;
- what the first non-capital fort contributes;
- the first two research objectives;
- how the Pretender supports the opening;
- what threatens the plan.

If the paragraph cannot be written, return to Books II, III, V, and VI. A list of strong units is not a national idea.

57.2 Test the expansion party

Use a disposable game to test the intended commander, troop count, formation, and orders against several independent types. Record losses rather than remembering only victories. Book VI owns expansion testing.

57.3 Save the Pretender

Save the actual design with Ctrl+S and label it with nation, age, ruleset, and purpose. A changed blessing, scale, or awakening state makes it a new design.

57.4 Prepare a simple turn record

Keep:

- province targets;
- recruitment plan;
- research target and expected arrival;
- fort and laboratory schedule;
- important gem and item commitments;
- contacts, borders, and treaty terms.

57.5 Learn the five screens

Before playing, open and close Army Setup, Recruitment, Nation Overview, Research, and Messages. The goal is familiarity, not optimization.

58. Turn One

Turn one is an allocation problem.

1. Read the starting messages and inspect the capital, commanders, troops, scales, sites, treasury, and neighbours.
2. Recruit the commander or mage required by the national plan.
3. Queue the tested expansion troops within the actual gold, resource, and Recruitment Point limits.
4. Set the first research target.
5. Organize the starting army. Confirm leadership, squad orders, formation, and commander script.
6. Decide whether the Pretender acts, researches, forges, searches, preaches, or remains unavailable according to awakening.
7. Inspect every adjacent province before choosing expansion direction.
8. Run the four-pass audit and end the turn.

The first turn should create a repeatable monthly process. Spending all gold can be correct; spending it without knowing which local constraint limited the queue is not.

59. Turns Two to Four: Establish the Expansion Cycle

The opening cycle is:

```
recruit -> assemble -> capture -> reinforce -> launch the next party
```

During these turns:

- review every expansion battle rather than accepting the flag change;
- separate recoverable attrition from a failed party design;
- keep capital commander production aligned with troop output;
- identify the first fort location from income, resources, recruitment purpose, geometry, and safety;
- start scouting beyond the immediate expansion ring;
- watch supply and movement compatibility;
- preserve enough gold to avoid delaying the first key infrastructure decision by accident.

59.1 When an expansion battle fails

Diagnose in order:

1. Was the province scouted accurately?
2. Did the intended troops and commander arrive?
3. Did formation and orders match the tested version?
4. Was the independent type a known bad matchup?
5. Was the loss statistical variation or a structural weakness?
6. Can the survivors retreat, regroup, or defend?
7. Does the recruitment cycle need revision?

Do not answer a formation failure by buying more of the same formation without review.

60. Turns Five to Eight: Build the Second Centre

By this stage, the nation should be converting expansion into administration.

60.1 First fort purpose

Choose the fort for a declared function:

- recruit a valuable non-capital mage or troop;
- collect regional resources;
- shorten reinforcement routes;
- secure a chokepoint or rich cluster;
- establish a laboratory and research centre;
- support a future border.

The fort is not finished strategy. It still needs the right laboratory, temple where required, commander recruitment, roads of movement, and defensible surroundings.

60.2 Research checkpoint

At the end of this interval, compare expected and actual research. A shortfall can result from:

- too few recruited mages;
- mages diverted to expansion or infrastructure;
- unexpected deaths;
- Drain or other ruleset consequences;
- the chosen fort not yet producing researchers;
- research points assigned across too many schools.

Book V owns the solution tree. Book X's contribution is to make the discrepancy visible early.

60.3 First magical package

Prepare one package that can actually be delivered: a small battlefield script, a site-search route, a useful item chain, or a ritual with a clear strategic purpose. Confirm research, path, gems, laboratory, caster turn, and destination.

61. Turns Nine to Twelve: Form the National Shape

The nation should now have:

- a capital role that is not constantly improvised;
- at least one expansion or security formation that can be reproduced;
- a second recruitment or research centre under construction or active;
- scouts watching likely borders;
- a research threshold with a force attached to it;
- a reserve plan for an unexpected neighbour.

This is also the moment to inspect inefficiency. Use F1 to find idle commanders, stalled queues, excessive garrisons, researchers carrying unused items, and provinces whose unrest or infrastructure does not match their purpose.

62. First Contact

On meeting another player, separate facts from stories.

Facts include visible provinces, army icons, dominion, fort locations, scouts lost, public graphs, and direct messages. Stories include guessed research, supposed weakness, claimed enemies, and implied peaceful intent.

A useful first-contact record states:

- exact border proposal by province number or unmistakable landmark;
- whether movement, scouting, preaching, raiding, and remote magic are addressed;
- duration and cancellation terms of any non-aggression pact;
- communication channel and timing convention;
- unresolved provinces or Thrones.

Book VI owns diplomacy and intelligence. The operational standard is that the agreement can be read later without reconstructing tone.

63. Preparing the First War

Do not begin with "attack the neighbour." Define:

1. the political purpose;
2. the first-turn objectives;
3. the enemy response most likely to break the plan;
4. the research and magic package available on the attack turn;
5. the routes for main force, raiders, scouts, and reinforcements;
6. the siege force and assault plan;
7. the point at which the war is no longer worth its cost.

Then translate the plan into interface commitments:

- commanders selected correctly;
- squads transferred and led;
- movement arrows checked;
- stealth forces using the intended mode;
- gems and items delivered;
- scripts legal;
- recruitment continuing behind the front;
- diplomacy sent before the deadline;
- turn submitted and confirmed.

The last list is deliberately mundane. Wars are lost by mundane omissions.

64. The First Siege

When a hostile fort is reached:

1. confirm which units are assigned to Maintain Siege;
2. estimate wall-breaking strength using Book II;
3. screen the exterior against relief and raiding;
4. preserve supply and reinforcement routes;
5. prepare the storming formation before the walls fall;
6. monitor enemy movement, magic, and possible break-siege force;
7. when defence reaches zero, assign Storm Castle and re-check for relief sequencing;
8. after capture, decide immediately whether the fort is a front, a recruitment centre, a trap, or a demolition candidate.

A siege is not a pause between real battles. It is an administrative contest conducted under threat.

65. Entering the Midgame

The learning campaign has reached the midgame when decisions are governed by interacting systems rather than a single expansion loop. Typical signs are:

- several forts and laboratories compete for gold;
- research opens multiple viable packages;
- gems must be allocated among battle, ritual, forging, and reserve;
- more than one border can become active;
- diplomacy changes which military move is safe;
- Thrones become practical objectives;
- specialist commanders require items, gems, and transport.

At this point, use the Reader's Guide by live problem. The foundation has succeeded when the next question can be located precisely.

66. Ending the First Game Well

Play through the endgame if possible. Dominions changes when armies become magically dense, globals alter the world, Thrones can be claimed in combinations, and research approaches its final tiers. A player who restarts every imperfect opening never learns conversion.

After victory or defeat, review:

- revealed scoregraphs and map;
- first divergence between plan and result;
- recruitment and research bottlenecks;
- battles whose replay contradicted expectations;
- wasted gems, items, forts, or commander turns;
- diplomatic predictions that proved wrong;
- the final opportunity to contest or secure victory.

Write three changes for the next game. More than three often turns evidence into a wish list.

Part IX: Troubleshooting by Symptom

67. Cannot Find or Join the Game

Check in this order:

1. exact game name and lobby/server;
2. network connection and lobby availability;
3. game status: pretender collection, running, hosting, or finished;
4. Dominions version;
5. required mod files and activation;
6. map availability where locally required;
7. player or game password;
8. whether the nation is already claimed or was set to AI;
9. host announcements or maintenance.

Preserve the error text. "It does not work" discards the best evidence.

68. Mod or Map Mismatch

Symptoms include refusal to load, missing graphics, different unit cards, checksum complaints, or impossible replay behaviour.

Repair procedure:

1. stop changing files;
2. obtain the host's exact file identity;
3. compare names, versions, sizes, and hashes where available;
4. remove only the incorrect campaign copy from active use without destroying the archive;
5. install the canonical file with its directory structure;
6. restart Dominions;
7. test in a disposable game if the error persists.

Do not download "the latest" unless the latest is the frozen campaign version.

69. A Commander Will Not Move

Inspect:

- commander is selected and has not been given another order;
- destination is a legal neighbour or special-movement target;
- strategic movement allowance and terrain costs;
- all assigned troops and mounts can accompany the commander;
- stealth mode and non-stealth units;
- immobility, shape, item, disease, or other status;
- siege restrictions and the exact movement method;
- plane and map layer;
- whether the visible arrow depends on an item already removed.

If the interface accepted an arrow but hosting did not move the force, compare entry legality with resolution viability.

70. A Force Entered a Fort or Missed the Exterior Battle

Ordinary movement into a friendly fort commonly enters it. To arrive outside for immediate exterior duty, use Move and Patrol where legal. A force on Defend inside the fort concedes the exterior. A hidden force does not automatically join conventional allies.

Diagnose by displayed order, fort ownership, stealth state, and hosting phase-not by where the arrow seemed to end.

71. An Order Disappeared or Changed

Common causes include:

- another order was entered afterward;
- army composition changed the legality of Sneak or movement;
- the commander changed shape, mount, item, or path state;
- a copied order was not legal for the recipient;
- the commander became besieged or changed sides;
- the order completed and returned to a default state;
- a stale preserved or replaced behaviour differently than expected.

Use F1, inspect the commander, and reconstruct the last legal state. Do not infer an engine bug before checking the dependency that disappeared.

72. Recruitment Is Dimmed or Stalled

Check gold first, then local resources, Recruitment Points, Commander Points, Holy Points, recruitment limits, fort/site/terrain prerequisites, and whether the unit is capital-only. Inspect the queue order: an expensive earlier unit can consume capacity needed by later entries.

If the province has changed ownership or become besieged, re-evaluate where recruits appear and whether the national roster remains available.

73. Troops Did Not Move with the Commander

Open Army Setup and confirm that the units were in that commander's squads rather than in the unassigned garrison or under another commander. Then check leadership type, leadership capacity, movement compatibility, and whether the commander survived an earlier hosting event.

An army icon in the same province does not prove command attachment.

74. An Item or Gem Cannot Be Used

Check:

- laboratory access for treasury transfers;
- body slots and mounted slot restrictions;
- item ownership and unique status;
- path and research requirements;
- commander's personal gem allocation;
- maximum carried gems;
- whether the resource is national stock, local treasury access, or personal inventory;
- whether the relevant order permits that gem or item effect.

Use F8 to find items nationally. For gems, inspect both national totals and the actual commander.

75. A Ritual or Forge Order Is Unavailable

Confirm laboratory, research school and level, path after current items and shapes, gem stock, target range and type, ritual or item restrictions, artifact availability, and current ruleset. A commander who moved, was sieged, or lost laboratory access may no longer meet the order's conditions.

If several rituals were intended to enable one another in one month, revisit Book I's hosting sequence.

76. A Siege Is Not Progressing

Check that the relevant force is on Maintain Siege, not Defend, Patrol, Research, Pillage, or another order. Compare siege strength with fortification repair and defender strength. Confirm whether a battle, movement, relief, or supply problem removed key siegers.

Zero wall defence does not capture the fort. Storming is a separate order for the next resolution.

77. Scoregraphs Are Missing or Incomplete

The game may have hidden graphs. Intelligence may reveal only some categories. A Spy in an enemy capital can infiltrate, while spellcaster or priest qualities can broaden obtainable information. Confirm the game setting and current intelligence before treating an empty graph as a display fault.

78. A Turn Staled

Preserve the submission status, deadline, host messages, and any connection error. Notify the host without editing files. The response depends on the published policy: continuation, extension before hosting, substitution, or a rare rollback for verified technical failure.

Afterward, reduce recurrence:

- submit an early complete version;
- confirm receipt;
- request extensions earlier;
- avoid making the only final submission in the last minutes;
- maintain a backup connection method if the campaign warrants it.

79. A Battle Replay Looks Impossible

Compare host and client versions, mod identity, and whether the replay is being viewed under the ruleset that generated it. Inspect messages and final unit state. Visual playback can diverge from the hosted result when versions differ. Preserve the turn and replay evidence before updating or replacing files.

80. Performance or Large-Turn Problems

Current versions have improved handling of larger network turns, but late games can still be demanding. Close unnecessary applications, preserve disk space, avoid repeatedly interrupting transfers, and allow the client to finish processing. If a file appears corrupt, retain it and compare with a fresh host download rather than overwriting the only copy.

Performance diagnosis should separate:

- slow local interface;
- slow battle replay;
- network transfer delay;
- lobby or server availability;
- hosting computation;
- a genuinely damaged file.

81. Recovery Principle

Use the least destructive repair:

```
observe -> record -> compare baseline -> copy/backup -> test separately -> replace only the
confirmed faulty component
```

Random reinstallations, live mod edits, and broad deletion destroy evidence. Recovery should make the campaign more reproducible, not only make the current error disappear.

Part X: Hosting as a Competitive Institution

82. The Host Is Custodian, Not Author of Outcomes

The host establishes procedure, keeps the service available, applies announced rules consistently, and preserves recoverability. The host should not use privileged knowledge or flexible administration to shape the strategic result.

A host decision is strongest when it can be explained as:

1. the published rule;
2. the observed event;
3. the evidence preserved;
4. the same remedy that would apply to any player.

83. Hosting Runbook

83.1 Before launch

- freeze version, map, and mods;
- publish settings and victory conditions;
- test lobby/server and content distribution;
- collect pretenders with passwords;

- verify roster and teams;
- publish timer, extension, stale, substitution, and rollback policy;
- establish a backup host or continuity plan.

83.2 During the campaign

- announce deadline changes with an exact date, time, and timezone;
- check that hosting completed and clients can receive the new turn;
- preserve periodic backups appropriate to the hosting system;
- record stales, substitutions, rollbacks, and version incidents;
- avoid inspecting privileged player information except when technically required and allowed;
- resolve disputes from the charter and evidence.

83.3 At campaign end

- preserve final state long enough for review;
- publish result and any shared post-game materials;
- permit scoregraph and map analysis;
- record ruleset and notable administrative incidents;
- archive or remove credentials securely.

84. Tournament and Expert Records

Serious competitive play benefits from a more exact record:

- file hashes for map and mods;
- host executable and operating environment;
- creation settings captured in text or screenshots;
- player/nation/team roster;
- every hosting timestamp;
- stales, extensions, substitutions, and connection incidents;
- mod or patch deviation, even if accidental;
- final victory state.

This is not bureaucracy for its own sake. It permits later rulings and analysis without relying on the memory of interested parties.

85. Dispute Handling

When a dispute occurs:

1. pause any irreversible administrative action if the schedule permits;
2. identify the exact claim;
3. preserve messages, timestamps, versions, files, and settings;
4. consult the charter and official rule source;
5. distinguish interface misunderstanding, engine behaviour, technical failure, and conduct;
6. apply the narrowest consistent remedy;
7. record the decision.

Not every bug justifies a rollback. Not every surprising result is a bug. Not every policy omission can be repaired fairly after hidden information has changed hands.

Part XI: Operational Checklists

86. New Installation

- Launch the game and confirm version.
- Open the user data directory from Game Tools.
- Install required maps and mods with directory structure intact.
- Enable the exact stack.
- Test a disposable world.
- Save a labelled Pretender design.
- Learn Messages, Recruitment, Army Setup, Nation Overview, and Research.

87. Create World

- Confirm map and player count.
- Choose age.
- Add every participant and set human/AI status.
- Verify disciple teams if used.
- Record all non-default settings.
- Record scoregraph, security, artifact, and legendary-research rules.
- Set and verify victory conditions and Cataclysm.
- Protect Pretenders and administrative access.
- Publish hosting policy before launch.

88. Join a Lobby Game

- Match Dominions version.
- Match map and mod files.
- Enter Network, then the official lobby.
- Select the exact game.
- Confirm nation and status.
- Use the game password securely.
- Inspect the current turn before entering orders.
- Confirm submission after End Turn.

89. Build an Army

- Choose role and campaign purpose.
- Recruit within all local constraints.
- Provide suitable leadership.
- Transfer troops from the garrison.
- Divide no more than five squads per commander.
- Position squads and commanders.
- Assign squad orders and scripts.
- Equip items and gems.
- Confirm movement and supply compatibility.
- Re-open the screen after major transfers.

90. Issue a Special Order

- Confirm actor has the ability.
- Confirm province and target.
- Confirm building, terrain, path, gem, population, corpse, or other input.
- Check siege and fort-wall restrictions.
- Check hosting timing and opportunity cost.
- Enter the order.
- Inspect the displayed result.
- Re-check after changing movement, army, items, or infrastructure.

91. Submit a Turn

- Read all new messages.
- Review battles and changed provinces.
- State monthly priorities.
- Enter fragile dependent orders first.
- Audit commanders, armies, state, and campaign.
- Submit before the deadline margin disappears.
- Confirm receipt.
- If revising, resubmit and confirm again.

92. Host a Campaign

- Freeze and publish ruleset.
- Test creation and connection.
- Publish timer and policies.
- Protect passwords and host state.
- Announce exact deadline changes.
- Back up without creating unapproved alternate histories.
- Apply rules symmetrically.
- Preserve incident evidence.
- Arrange substitution or AI conversion according to policy.
- Archive the final game for review.

Part XII: Essays

Essay I: Interface Literacy Is Strategic Power

The interface is often treated as a transparent layer between a player and the "real" game. In Dominions it is closer to a language. Province filters determine which relationships become visible. Army Setup determines whether a force exists as an army or as unrelated bodies in one province. A movement arrow records an intention but carries hidden dependence on leadership, terrain, items, stealth, siege state, and hosting order. The Nation Overview converts a sprawling realm into an administrative object that can actually be governed.

This creates a form of power that is easy to undervalue because it does not appear on a unit card: the ability to ask the game the right question quickly. Where are the idle mages? Which forts are producing commanders? Which province changed income? Which movement depends on one item?

Which caster holds the gems? Which squad was left unassigned? Each answer recovers a little national capacity.

For a new player, interface literacy reduces cognitive load. Shortcuts and filters stop ten provinces from feeling like ten separate games. For an expert, the same literacy increases strategic bandwidth. Less time spent finding information means more time comparing lines, testing assumptions, communicating, and auditing adversarial possibilities.

There is no need to memorise every key. What matters is building reliable routes through the interface. Messages begin the month. F1 surveys the nation. Map filters expose one strategic concern at a time. Army Setup proves attachment and command. F7 and F8 prove equipment location. The final audit proves commitment. Once those routes become habitual, the game's complexity becomes searchable instead of overwhelming.

Essay II: Administrative Failure Is Still Strategic Failure

Dominions rewards elaborate plans, which makes clerical errors feel somehow beneath strategy. They are not. If a commander moved without the intended squad, the nation did not possess that army at the decisive place. If a caster lacked one gem, the spell package did not exist. If a turn was not received, the plan was absent from the shared game. The reason may be administrative, but the strategic world contains only the result.

This does not mean every mistake deserves punishment without context. Technical services fail, emergencies happen, and hosts need humane policies. It means that personal preparation should treat operational reliability as part of force design. A formation includes its transfer procedure. A ritual includes laboratory access and target selection. A timing attack includes submission before the timer. A long campaign includes passwords, backups, and substitution rules.

The best control is a short, repeatable audit, not constant anxiety: important commanders, armies, state, campaign, receipt. It turns a vague fear of forgetting something into a bounded procedure. It also improves analysis after failure. When the submitted orders are known, tactical and strategic theories can be tested against evidence instead of reconstructed from regret.

Essay III: The Host as Custodian

The host occupies an unusual position. The role is technically powerful but should be strategically neutral. A host determines deadlines, operates the game state, holds recovery tools, and may be able to access information unavailable to ordinary players. The campaign remains legitimate only when that power is exercised as custody rather than ownership.

Custody begins before turn one. Rules are published while no one knows whom they will favour. Extension and rollback standards exist before a leading army is at risk. A backup host is chosen before absence becomes leverage. Version and mod records are frozen before an update offers convenient ambiguity.

During play, good administration is conspicuously exact: a deadline includes date, time, and timezone; an extension is visible to everyone; a stale is recorded; a substitute receives the same access process another substitute would receive; a rollback requires a narrow technical reason. The host does not need to eliminate judgment, which is impossible. The host needs to make judgment reviewable.

That standard protects the host as much as the players. Evidence replaces accusation. A charter replaces improvised favour. A campaign can survive mistakes because its continuity does not depend on one person's memory or goodwill.

Part XIII: Authority, Version Notes, and Research Boundaries

93. Sources Used

Book X is based primarily on:

- the official Dominions 6 Manual for creation, interface, multiplayer modes, recruitment, army setup, inventories, movement, and strategic orders;
- Illwinter's official Dominions 6 documentation index;
- Illwinter's official Steam announcements through Dominions 6.36 for current interface, lobby, network, mount, siege-movement, and post-game changes;
- the official modding and file-format manuals where local data structure is relevant;
- the verified foundation books in this library for mechanics whose canonical explanations already exist.

Official documentation:

- https://www.illwinter.com/dom6/docs.html
- https://www.illwinter.com/dom6/dom6manual.pdf
- https://steamcommunity.com/app/2511500/announcements/

94. Version-Sensitive Boundaries

Exact private-server command lines, unattended host options, and external PBEM automation are not frozen here. They depend on the current executable, platform, and hosting environment. The official manual itself refers some private-server and PBEM detail to earlier documentation. Copying old commands into a current operational encyclopaedia would create false certainty.

Keyboard shortcuts are context-sensitive and continue to evolve. Book X records verified high-value controls, but ? in the active screen and current official patch notes remain the authority for a specific release.

95. Evidence Labels for Operational Reports

When a result differs from Book X, record it as one of:

- confirmed interface fact: reproduced on the named version and screen;
- confirmed engine result: reproduced through hosting under a frozen ruleset;
- version divergence: host and client or guide and executable differ;
- mod divergence: a mod changes or replaces the ordinary control or order;
- unresolved report: evidence is incomplete or reproduction has not succeeded.

This protects the library from turning a single surprising turn into a universal rule.

96. Closing Principle

Dominions becomes manageable when intentions are converted into inspectable commitments. Freeze the ruleset. Read the new state. Use the interface as an analytical instrument. Enter orders with their dependencies. Audit the nation. Confirm submission. Preserve evidence when reality disagrees.

The process is not separate from mastery. It is the structure that allows mastery to survive contact with a live game.

DOCUMENT 13 OF 16

Foundation Book XI - Units, Abilities, Experience, and Conditions

A Systematic Reference for Reading Every Unit

Baseline: Dominions 6.36; vanilla rules unless a ruleset is named; research edition 20 August 2026. Structured object examples remain pinned to the auditable 6.35 Inspector snapshot.

1. Purpose

A Dominions unit is not defined by its attack, defence, protection, and hit points alone. Its type determines who can command it, which spells can affect it, whether it consumes supplies, how it heals, what happens when leadership disappears, and sometimes whether it can cross a border at all. Its special abilities add another layer of exceptions. Experience changes the same body over time. Afflictions and other conditions may then change it again.

Book XI is where unit facts are looked up and interpreted. It should answer five questions quickly:

1. What kind of being is this?
2. What does this icon or named ability change?
3. Does the effect matter on the strategic map, in battle, or both?
4. What normally counters, suppresses, or invalidates it?
5. How certain is the explanation under the current version?

The official manual says that Dominions contains roughly five hundred special abilities and explains only a selection. The Modding Manual exposes a wider technical vocabulary, but a mod command is not always a complete player-facing specification. The unit window remains the final current description of a particular unit, while patch notes can supersede older manual language.

It combines three kinds of reference:

- interpretive chapters that explain families of abilities and the questions they raise;
- compact records for the most consequential classes, abilities, and conditions;
- an evidence boundary that keeps official statements, current corrections, derived implications, and community reverse engineering visibly separate.

Book IV remains the authority for combat arithmetic, battle order, morale resolution, fatigue, damage, affliction chance, and counter construction. Book XI explains what a label means and where its consequences appear. It links to Book IV when a full resolution procedure would otherwise be repeated.

2. Evidence Key and Version Discipline

Code	Meaning in this volume	Proper use
OM	Official main manual, revision 2	Stated rules, definitions, thresholds, and broad exceptions
MM	Official Modding Manual, version 6.34	Engine-facing ability names, parameters, categories, and technical relationships

Code	Meaning in this volume	Proper use
OP	Official patch announcement through 6.36	Current changes that correct or supersede older behaviour
UI	Current in-game unit or ability description	The live description for a particular object; not independently captured for every record here
CT	Community-tested or reverse-engineered	Useful evidence that is not an official specification and may be version-sensitive
D	Derived	A stated consequence derived from confirmed inputs
TP	Test pending	A disputed, hidden, or version-sensitive detail that still lacks reliable current confirmation

An evidence label applies to the defined fact, not to every possible consequence. For example, the official manual defines Ethereal as causing three quarters of nonmagical strikes to miss. The recommendation to use inexpensive magical weapons against an ethereal raider is doctrine derived from that fact, not an additional official rule.

The public baseline is Dominions 6.36, released on 17 August 2026 UTC. The main manual is older than several current changes. Notable ability-facing corrections include exact percentage regeneration in 6.31; Spiritform protection from bleeding, frozen, and burning conditions in 6.30; Disease Resistance applying to disease spells in 6.27; restored script continuity for innate spellcasters after temporary unconsciousness in 6.35; and corrected swimming-mount river crossing, charm allegiance, and mounted recruitment state in 6.36. These corrections are integrated where relevant and retained in the version notes near the end.

Part I: How to Read an Ability

3. Begin with the Body, Not the Icon

The fastest reliable reading order is:

```
body and type -> leadership requirement -> movement environment -> defences and recovery -> offence
and auras -> conditional modifiers -> experience and conditions
```

This order prevents a common failure. An impressive offensive ability can draw attention away from the fact that its unit cannot be led by the available commander, cannot enter the intended terrain, dissolves without leadership, or cannot recover from the damage expected along the route.

The body layer includes size, living or nonliving status, unit classes, shape, mount, and environments in which the unit can exist. The command layer determines whether the unit can join the proposed army at all. The recovery layer determines whether a favourable exchange can be repeated. Only then should an ability's immediate battle output dominate evaluation.

3.1 A seven-question unit audit

For an unfamiliar unit, record:

Question	What to inspect	Why it changes the decision
What is it?	All type tags, body, shape, size, mount	Targeting, leadership, healing, supplies, and immunity can follow from class.

Question	What to inspect	Why it changes the decision
Who can command it?	Normal, magic, and undead leadership; special squad limits	A legal recruitment or summon can still create an unusable army.
Where can it go?	Water status, flight, floating, survival, sailing, teleport restrictions	Strategic reach and retreat routes can matter more than raw statistics.
How does it stay functional?	Regeneration family, recuperation, immortality, disease and age	Recovery determines repeatable force, not merely survival in one battle.
What changes contact?	Awe, fear, auras, shields, stealth, vision, trample, swallow	These effects alter who can engage and what happens before ordinary damage decides the exchange.
When are the numbers conditional?	Seasonal, scale, dominion, darkness, storm, and shape modifiers	A unit card seen in one province may not describe the intended battlefield.
What has changed since recruitment?	Experience, heroic abilities, afflictions, curse, horror mark, disease, items	Two units with the same name can have materially different current value.

4. Tags, Values, and Descriptions

Some abilities are binary: a unit is Aquatic or it is not. Others carry a value. The meaning of that value is ability-specific. It may represent points, a percentage, an area, a bonus, capacity, range, number of creatures, or a threshold modifier. A value of 5 on Fear is not interpreted in the same way as 5 on Regeneration, Reinvigoration, Standard, or Sailing.

Three checks are mandatory:

- read the ability's own description rather than inferring a universal scale;
- distinguish a displayed total from an innate contribution or item contribution;
- verify whether the number is applied directly, converted by a formula, or used to choose a tier.

The Modding Manual is particularly useful for discovering whether an ability has a parameter, but its command value may be transformed before it reaches the unit card. Player-facing records should preserve the displayed meaning where verified and avoid pretending that every mod parameter is the final battle number.

5. Innate, Granted, Shape-Bound, and Contextual Effects

An ability may come from the unit's base form, a mount, an item, a bless, a spell, a heroic trait, a province, dominion, a season, or a temporary battle effect. These sources do not have identical lifetimes.

Source	Persistence question	Typical trap
Base form	Does shapechanging replace the form?	Assuming a tag survives every alternate shape.
Mount	Does dismounting or mount death remove it?	Reading the combined card as one indivisible creature.
Item	Is the effect active only while equipped, and is the item cursed?	Treating an item-caused affliction as healable while its cause remains.
Bless	Is the unit sacred and currently blessed; is the effect Incarnate?	Pricing a sacred as if every battle begins blessed.
Spell	What is the duration and can it be resisted, dispelled, or interrupted?	Confusing a scripted plan with a permanent statistic.
Heroic ability	Is the commander still in the Hall of Fame, and how has the value grown?	Treating a community-derived formula as an official guarantee.

Source	Persistence question	Typical trap
Environment	Which scale, season, dominion, terrain, light, storm, or plane is checked?	Testing in favourable conditions and deploying elsewhere.

Shape changes deserve special care. A unit name may remain familiar while weapons, armour, size, hit points, movement, leadership, magic, or type tags change. When a strategy depends on an ability, verify the form that will actually be present at the relevant hosting step and battle round.

6. Stacking, Precedence, and the Best-Only Rule

There is no single universal stacking law. Effects fall into several patterns:

- best only: the official manual states that only the best Standard in a squad applies;
- additive or cumulative: experience gains build across thresholds, and horror marks can deepen through repeated marking;
- source-limited: an item or form may supply the effect only while that source remains;
- mutually exclusive state: a unit cannot simultaneously be asleep and acting normally, or mounted and voluntarily dismounted in the same form;
- layered defence: multiple defences may apply at different resolution steps rather than adding into one value;
- unknown or object-specific: the interface or a controlled test is required.

When a stacking rule is not explicit, the safe record is not "stacks" or "does not stack." The safe record is "stacking unverified." This matters because many expensive designs fail not from weak ingredients but from buying the same non-stacking benefit twice.

7. Counters Are Usually Gate Removal

An ability creates value by imposing a gate. Ethereal asks for magical attacks. Awe asks attackers to pass a morale check. Regeneration asks for enough damage, disablement, or attrition to overcome recovery. Flying asks for protection of vulnerable rear areas and attention to storm interaction. Stealth asks for patrol coverage and information discipline.

The cleanest counter normally removes the gate at an acceptable cost. It does not need to destroy the target in isolation. A counter record should identify:

1. the gate the ability imposes;
2. the cheapest broad class of answer;
3. the conditions that make that answer unreliable;
4. the operational cost of delivering it.

This is why Book XI does not assign a universal power score. An ability's value is the price of the question it asks in the position where it appears.

Part II: Unit Classes and Status Tags

8. Classes Can Overlap

Dominions uses overlapping tags rather than one exclusive biological taxonomy. A being can be both Undead and Magic Being, Demon and Magic Being, Animal and Sacred, or Inanimate and Mindless. Each relevant tag can alter leadership, spell targeting, supplies, morale, healing, or special interactions.

The official manuals explicitly resolve one important overlap: a unit that is both Undead and Magic Being, or Demon and Magic Being, requires undead leadership rather than magic leadership. More generally, a tag should not be erased merely because another tag seems more descriptive. The correct question is what each tag contributes.

9. The Ordinary Living Baseline

An ordinary living unit without a special command tag can be led by normal leadership. It consumes supplies according to size, can suffer disease and ordinary afflictions, and can normally benefit from living regeneration and appropriate healing. This baseline is not itself an icon; it is the background against which exceptional types are read.

The absence of a tag is still information. A human soldier lacking Spiritform, Inanimate, Undead, Demon, Animal, Mindless, or Magic Being avoids the special command burdens and immunities attached to those tags. Ordinary does not mean weak. It often means logistically compatible.

10. Animal

Animals can be led by normal commanders. They use half as many supplies as a humanoid of the same size. The manual states that animals without arms contribute only half their normal value to siege and fort defence; monkeys are the named exception to the armless-animal reduction.

Animal is also a targeting class. Animal-affecting magic and Animal Awe can distinguish it from an ordinary soldier. Beast Mastery or Beast Master leadership can improve the practical command of animal-heavy forces, but the exact benefit belongs to the displayed leadership effect rather than to the Animal tag itself.

Operational reading:

- reduced supply use supports large formations and long routes;
- weak siege contribution can make a victorious animal army poor at converting a field win into a fort;
- animal-specific control and fear effects can create sharp counters;
- normal leadership makes integration easier than for undead or magical beings.

11. Magic Being

Magic Beings require magic leadership. Without suitable leadership they rout, and the manual describes leaderless magical beings as dissolving on the battlefield. The tag also makes them valid or invalid targets for effects that distinguish magical beings.

Magic leadership is not ordinary leadership with a different colour. A commander may have ample normal capacity and still be unable to command one magic being. Path-based indirect bonuses can grant magic leadership, especially through Earth and Blood, but the displayed value should be checked before assigning squads.

When a magic-being army is evaluated, include command redundancy. A force whose only magic leader can be assassinated, swallowed, routed, or killed may collapse even while most bodies remain intact.

12. Mindless

Mindless units have morale 50 and do not rout while a suitable commander controls them. Without that control they dissolve on the battlefield. They cannot share a squad with non-mindless units. The tag also produces numerous immunities or targeting exclusions because the unit has no ordinary mind.

Mindless does not mean independent. It means exceptionally stable under command and exceptionally fragile when command is lost. The army exchanges ordinary squad morale problems for a leadership problem.

Important consequences:

- mind-affecting effects often fail or treat them differently;
- the squad cannot be padded with ordinary troops;
- leader protection is part of the unit's effective defence;
- their morale value should not be read as a promise that the army survives army-wide rout or loss of control under every circumstance; Book IV owns battle-wide resolution.

13. Undead

Undead units require undead leadership and are subject to banishment. They are immune to disease and ordinary affliction-healing effects, and they rout if suitable leadership is absent. Mixing living and undead troops in the same squad causes a morale penalty according to the official manual.

Undead is both a logistical advantage and a recovery constraint. Many undead do not need to eat, but the exact supply property should still be read separately. Their immunity to ordinary disease prevents one attrition channel, while their inability to use ordinary healing makes battle damage and accumulated afflictions harder to repair. Corporeal undead can have special exceptions such as a Corpse Stitcher.

The class attracts dedicated counters: banishment, anti-undead weapons, and effects restricted to undead. The existence of a counter is not the same as its availability. An undead army can be oppressive when the opponent cannot deliver sufficient priests or specialised damage in the relevant theatre.

14. Demon

Demons require undead leadership, are subject to banishment, and are immune to disease. They are not undead under another name. Demon and Undead are distinct tags with different targeting lists, national interactions, and spell families, even though their command requirement overlaps.

Many demons also possess Need Not Eat, elemental resistances, fear, flight, dark power, or spirit sight, but none of those should be inferred from Demon alone. The correct record lists each separately.

15. Inanimate and Lifeless

The main manual describes Lifeless beings as immune to disease, ordinary regeneration, life drain, and ordinary affliction healing. The Modding Manual exposes Inanimate as the technical creature-status command used for bodies such as constructs. In player-facing analysis, the displayed class and its actual immunities should be recorded rather than assuming every stony or mechanical-looking body behaves identically.

Ordinary regeneration does not repair inanimate bodies. Reconstruction is the corresponding regeneration family for inanimate units. A powerful construct with no Reconstruction or specialised repair may survive a battle yet lose long-term value through unhealed afflictions.

Life-drain immunity has two sides: the target avoids the ordinary effect, but an attacker that relies on draining to recover receives no normal healing from the lifeless victim. This can reverse a matchup that appears favourable from weapon damage alone.

16. Spiritform

Spiritform beings are immune to transformation, disease, and ordinary affliction healing. Current 6.30 patch notes also state that Spiritform, like non-ethereal protection in that change, prevents bleeding, frozen, and burning conditions. Spiritform is not synonymous with Ethereal. A unit can possess one without the other, and each must be read independently.

Spiritform affects both target eligibility and recovery. It can shut down several condition-based plans while leaving magical damage, specialised spirit effects, or ordinary attrition available. Check the exact spell or weapon; "ghost" is not a complete rules category.

17. Plant, Stone Being, Illusion, Horror, and Divine Status

Several further tags primarily matter through targeting and exceptions.

17.1 Plant

Plant marks a plant-type being. It can change eligibility for plant-specific spells and effects. It does not by itself state every resistance, supply rule, or mind status; a vine creature may also be Mindless or Magic Being, but those are separate facts.

17.2 Stone Being

Stone Being identifies creatures that interact with stone-specific effects. It should not be used as a shorthand for Inanimate unless both are displayed or confirmed. Material appearance is not a reliable substitute for tags.

17.3 Illusion

Illusion marks an illusory being and can affect how specialised sight or anti-illusion effects interact with it. The tag is distinct from Glamour, Invisibility, and Ethereal. Glamour creates a defensive mirror-image effect and strategic concealment; an Illusion is a creature type.

17.4 Horror

Lesser Horror, Greater Horror, and Doom Horror identify horror classes. They influence horror-related targeting and behaviour. Horror Mark does not turn its bearer into a Horror; it makes the bearer a preferred future victim of horror attacks.

17.5 Sacred, Holy, Divine Being, Pretender, and Prophet

Sacred determines eligibility for blessing and Holy recruitment limits. Holy levels belong to priestly or divine capability. Divine Being, Pretender, and Prophet carry further rules and targeting consequences. These terms overlap but are not interchangeable. A sacred troop is not automatically a priest; a priest is not automatically sacred; and a Pretender's divine continuity belongs to Book III.

18. Cold Blood, Blindness, Sex, and Other Body Tags

Cold Blooded creatures suffer additional fatigue in cold environments. Blind units depend on special senses or effects that do not require ordinary sight. Sex and body-form tags can affect seduction, transformation, item eligibility, and events. Polyimmune bodies resist transformations that would otherwise replace their shape.

These tags are easy to dismiss because they do not always add a visible combat number. They frequently become decisive only when another system asks a categorical question. A sound database retains them even when a current strategy does not use them.

Part III: Movement, Terrain, Water, and Position

19. Water Status Is a Permission System

The water tags answer different questions:

Tag	Core permission	Principal caution
Aquatic	Lives and operates underwater	Ordinarily cannot operate on land without a separate exception or form.
Amphibian	Operates on land and underwater	Underwater performance may still be altered by weapons, spells, mounts, or other tags.
Poor Amphibian	Can cross the land-water boundary with penalties	Treat the penalty as part of the unit, not a cosmetic label.
Swimming	Can move through water under its defined rules	Does not automatically grant every underwater combat permission.
Gift of Water	Can support or convey water access according to its value	Capacity and persistence must be checked.

Water access is not one binary "amphibious" property. An army's legal route depends on the commander, every unit, mounts, items, spells, and available capacity. Book VI owns the operational route and interception problem; Book XI identifies the permissions that must be present.

20. Flying, Floating, and Storms

Flying changes strategic movement and battlefield contact. It can bypass many terrain constraints, reach rear areas quickly, and alter which opponents can intercept or screen. It does not make a unit immune to storms. Storm Immunity is a separate ability.

Floating is also distinct. A floating body may pass certain terrain or battlefield obstacles and may interact differently with mounts and current patch rules. It should not be read as full flight.

Current practice requires four checks:

1. Can the commander use the movement mode?
2. Can every assigned unit and mount accompany it?
3. Does a storm or other environmental effect suppress the mode?
4. Where can the force retreat if the destination battle is lost?

21. Terrain Survival and Snow Movement

Forest, mountain, swamp, and wasteland survival reduce the strategic burden of their matching terrain and can affect which movement routes are legal or efficient. Snow movement supports travel in snowy conditions. These tags are most valuable as an army-level property: one incompatible unit can constrain a formation that is otherwise highly mobile.

Terrain survival does not mean immunity to every environmental effect in that terrain. It is a movement and survival permission with a specific engine meaning, not a general declaration that the unit is "at home" there.

21A. Riders and mounts are linked records

A mounted unit combines a rider record with a mount record. The two components can carry different movement, sacred, shape, and condition data; the combined unit card should not be treated as proof that every property belongs to both. Version 6.36 establishes three current boundaries:

- a swimming mount is sufficient for the mounted unit to cross rivers;
- when a knight is charmed in the corrected tavern encounter, the mount changes side as well;
- removing a repeated mounted-commander recruitment from the queue no longer incurs the corrected gold charge.

These are specific movement, allegiance, and queue rules. They do not establish a universal rule that every blessing, item effect, affliction, experience value, or transformed state automatically transfers between rider and mount. Book III owns blessing eligibility; the unresolved lifetime sequence remains R-052.

22. Sailing

Sailing lets a commander carry a force across water according to ship size and maximum passenger size. The official manual notes that sailing permits crossing water but not remaining in a water province. Capacity, commander ownership of the ability, passenger size, start and destination, and the exact route must all be legal.

Sailing is best treated as transport, not only as a troop trait. Its value comes from turning water barriers into possible attack lanes. Counterplay includes coastal scouting, route denial, and defence of landing provinces as well as battle strength.

23. Teleportation, Blink, and Immobility

Teleport and map teleport grant unusual movement that can ignore ordinary routes. Blink is a battlefield displacement effect. Unteleportable blocks relevant movement magic. Immobile units cannot use ordinary strategic movement. No River Pass forbids a class of crossings even where a normal unit could pass.

Current rules permit commanders with teleport movement to leave a besieged fort. That 6.35 operational exception remains in force under 6.36 and should not be inferred for every ritual or movement effect. The order and hosting timing remain in Book X and Book I.

Part IV: Leadership, Squads, and Command Support

24. Three Leadership Pools

Dominions separates normal, magic, and undead leadership. A commander can have different capacity in each pool.

Leadership	Primary followers	Failure if absent
Normal	Ordinary living troops and animals	Units cannot be assigned beyond valid capacity; squad quality may suffer with weak leaders.
Magic	Magic Beings	Uncontrolled magical beings rout or dissolve in battle.
Undead	Undead and demons; also the precedence case for undead/demon plus magic	Uncontrolled units rout or dissolve; banishment vulnerability remains.

The displayed capacity is only the first question. Leadership quality also changes squad morale, and special abilities can modify particular followers. Experience increases command capacity. Poor leaders receive reduced experience increments: the manual's leadership chapter gives a base-10 poor leader +5 at the first star and +10 for later thresholds, rather than the ordinary +25 and then +50 sequence.

25. Standard and Inspirational

Standard raises the morale of the squad. Only the best Standard in the squad applies; multiple standards do not add. This makes distribution more important than concentration. A spare standard bearer may provide redundancy, but it does not normally double the current bonus.

Inspirational modifies the morale of troops commanded by that commander. Its value can be positive or negative. Because Standard belongs to the squad and Inspirational belongs to command, they should not be collapsed into one label even when both affect morale.

26. Taskmaster, Beast Master, and Special Followers

Taskmaster improves the command of slaves and changes their morale treatment. Beast Master improves command of animals. Similar special-leadership effects exist for particular classes. These abilities should be evaluated against the actual roster rather than as free generic leadership.

A commander with narrow but powerful command support can be more valuable than a higher ordinary leadership number when the army is composed of the matching followers. The reverse is also true: special leadership attached to the wrong roster is unused capacity.

27. Formation Fighter, Tight Reins, and Undisciplined Units

Formation Fighter changes how densely units can occupy and fight within battlefield squares. Its value is formation-wide only if enough bodies in the relevant line possess it. Book IV owns square capacity, placement, and contact consequences.

Tight Reins concerns control of mounts. Undisciplined units cannot follow the full ordinary order set and can undermine carefully scripted squad behaviour. A red squad marker in Army Setup is a command warning, not an aesthetic category.

28. Bodyguards and Warning

Units ordered to Guard Commander may appear in assassination battles according to the bodyguard system. Warning improves protection against assassination and related surprise. The bodyguard value must be treated as a chance or capacity within that system, not as a promise that the commander cannot be reached.

Patch 6.35 fixed an exploit in which bodyguards assigned to a distant commander could be used improperly. Current procedures should not rely on the older behaviour.

Part V: Concealment, Perception, and Covert Action

29. Stealth Is a Contest, Not Invisibility

Stealth allows units and commanders to sneak in hostile territory. Discovery depends on patrol pressure and relevant modifiers. A stealth value grants movement permission and contributes to concealment. It does not make the unit absent from every information source or immune to every patrol.

Army stealth is constrained by composition. A stealthy commander cannot carry ordinary visible troops while sneaking unless another effect makes the whole group eligible. Size, number, terrain, patrols, and specialised abilities can all matter.

30. Spy, Assassin, and Infiltration Families

Spy permits intelligence and unrest-oriented covert work. Assassin creates assassination attempts. Seduction, Corruption, Dream Seduction, and related abilities use distinct target restrictions, events, checks, and failure battles. They should not be generalised from the word "assassin."

The operational procedure is in Book X's strategic-order reference; strategic use and patrol counterplay are in Book VI. Book XI supplies the reading rule: check the exact ability, target class, location, patience requirement, and consequence of failure.

31. Glamour, Invisibility, Unseen, and Illusion

Glamour produces a mirror-image defence in combat and conceals a unit in friendly provinces. The official manual states that ordinary attacks can remove images, while magical or specialised perception changes the interaction. Invisibility and Unseen are separate concealment abilities. Illusion is a creature class. None should be substituted for another merely because the sprite is hard to see.

The correct counter family is perception plus suitable attacks, but exact eligibility matters. Spirit Sight, True Sight, and other specialised senses do not necessarily answer every concealment effect in exactly the same way.

32. Darkvision, Spirit Sight, True Sight, and Blindness

Darkvision reduces or avoids darkness penalties according to its value. Spirit Sight detects or interacts with spiritual and ethereal threats. True Sight counters specified forms of deception. Blind units lack normal vision but may possess compensating senses.

Sight is an attack-enabling system. A unit can have an excellent nominal Attack or Precision score and still deliver poorly when darkness or concealment denies reliable contact. Conversely, specialised sight has little value when the opponent offers no corresponding gate. Its price belongs to the matchup.

Part VI: Defence, Recovery, and Persistence

33. Resistances Are Typed Defences

Fire, cold, shock, poison, acid, disease, and other resistances answer matching effects. Physical resistance families such as pierce, slash, and blunt resistance reduce their relevant damage classes. Invulnerability supplies protection under its defined restrictions. Air Shield reduces the chance of relevant missiles hitting.

A resistance value should always be paired with the incoming effect's type and penetration rule. "Has resistance" is not enough. A force may resist the primary damage while remaining vulnerable to fatigue, armour damage, secondary conditions, Magic Resistance effects, morale pressure, or a different damage type.

Book IV owns exact damage and protection resolution. The retrieval rule here is to inventory layers rather than add unlike numbers together.

34. Ethereal, Twist Fate, Luck, and Glamour

These are separate defensive gates.

- Ethereal: the official manual gives a 75 percent miss chance to nonmagical strikes and permits passage through fort walls while storming.
- Twist Fate: negates a qualifying damaging event and is then expended.
- Luck: creates its own chance-based survival layer.
- Glamour: supplies mirror images that attacks can remove.

Magical attacks answer Ethereal directly, but not every other defence. A high volume of attacks may clear images and one-use protection, while accurate high-value attacks can still be wasted on decoys. A counter plan should list the order in which the defences are expected to be consumed.

35. Regeneration Families

Regeneration heals a percentage of maximum hit points during battle and reduces the chance of affliction from damage. Since patch 6.31, regeneration is calculated to the exact percentage rather than older bracket behaviour. Ordinary regeneration does not work on inanimate bodies. Reconstruction is the corresponding inanimate form, while Reforming Flesh or undead regeneration supports eligible undead bodies.

The displayed percentage is not a complete survival estimate. Regeneration is strongest when incoming damage arrives in survivable packets and combat lasts long enough for repeated healing. It is weaker against overwhelming single hits, disablement, soul destruction, swallowing, routes, or damage that exceeds recovery tempo.

False regeneration and enchanted-blood effects are specialised variants and should be read from their current descriptions. Patch 6.35 improved the printed Magic Resistance bonus from Enchanted Blood; older guides may omit or misstate it.

36. Reinvigoration

Reinvigoration removes fatigue over time. It increases the sustainable rate of attacks, spellcasting, and other exertion, but it does not erase the consequences of already becoming unconscious or critically fatigued. A low-encumbrance unit with modest reinvigoration may outperform a nominally stronger body in a long fight; a short decisive fight may make the same investment nearly irrelevant.

Fatigue thresholds and critical-hit consequences remain in Book IV.

37. Recuperation and Healers

Recuperation attempts to heal battle afflictions over time, except those caused by old age. Ordinary Healer abilities assist eligible living units. Disease Healer addresses disease. Special bodies require special routes, and some item-caused afflictions cannot be removed while the item remains equipped.

The manual lists further recovery sources including Gift of Health, the Chalice, Miraculous Cure-all Elixir, rituals, sites, and Corpse Stitchers for eligible corporeal undead. Each route has eligibility limits and affliction difficulty. Recovery planning should record the damaged unit's body class, cause of affliction, and available healer type. Counting healer icons is not enough.

38. Immortality, Reformation, and Extra Lives

Immortality and dominion immortality return an eligible unit after death under their defined conditions and delay. Reformation abilities provide related return mechanics for particular bodies. Extra Lives permit a form of repeated survival or transformation.

Return is not the same as preventing defeat. A dead immortal may still surrender a battle, province, items, tempo, or access to the location from which it returns. Soul destruction, hostile dominion, remote planes, or ability-specific restrictions can bypass or delay the ordinary promise. Pretender death and Call God remain in Book III.

Part VII: Auras, Reactive Effects, and Contact Abilities

39. Awe, Sun Awe, Fear, and Dread

Awe makes an attacker pass a morale check before carrying out an attack. The official manual expresses the check against `10 + Awe`. Sun Awe follows the same family but is disabled in darkness or underground conditions. Awe is consequently strongest when it forces many low-quality attackers to make repeated checks and weakest against attackers with strong morale, immunity, or a way to avoid ordinary contact.

Fear affects morale in an area. The manual describes a base check of 10, a base area of 6, and increased area or difficulty from higher values. Current Fear behaviour has received patch corrections, so Book IV's morale chapter is the authority for the exact current battle procedure. Dread belongs to the same broad pressure family but must be read from its own description rather than treated as merely a larger Fear number.

These abilities win by changing participation. Awe may prevent attacks that were otherwise legal. Fear may make a squad or army leave before hit points are exhausted. Their counters are morale, leadership, mindless or other relevant immunity, range, fast killing, and the removal of the fear source.

40. Heat, Chill, Poison, Disease, Sleep, and Nightmare Auras

Combat auras create persistent local hazards around a unit.

Aura	Main pressure	Common answer family
Heat	Fatigue and fire-related attrition	Fire resistance, temperature planning, range, rapid removal
Chill	Fatigue and cold-related attrition	Cold resistance, temperature planning, range, rapid removal
Poison Cloud	Poison accumulation	Poison resistance, spacing, ranged removal, regeneration only as support
Disease or Plague	Persistent disease and battlefield spread	Disease Resistance, avoidance, cure capacity, expendable separation
Sleep Aura	Unconsciousness or lost action	Relevant resistance, range, rapid killing, immunity
Nightmare Aura	Fear or sleep-related disruption according to the ability	Morale, appropriate resistance, range, source removal

The manual gives a default aura size of 3 for Heat and Chill and explains their interaction with temperature scales. Poison clouds can persist and overlap. Patch 6.27 states that Disease Resistance applies against disease spells, including Plague. Check resistance even when disease arrives through magic instead of monthly attrition.

An aura's real value depends on time and density. A narrow crowded front can make a modest aura affect many bodies for many rounds. A dispersed missile battle may leave the same aura nearly unused.

41. Fire Shields, Acid, Spikes, Slime, and Entanglement

Reactive effects punish contact or successful strikes. Fire Shield damages qualifying attackers. Acid Shield and acid effects can damage or corrode. Spikes punish bodies that press into contact. Slime and entanglement can reduce mobility or prevent ordinary action. Some reactive effects require a hit; others require only an attack or adjacency.

This distinction changes the counter. High Defence may reduce on-hit retaliation but does not necessarily avoid a response that triggers on attack. Long weapons, missiles, spells, disposable attacks, resistance, or a different target order may remove the need for the vulnerable unit to touch the effect at all.

42. Damage Reversal, Blood Vengeance, Curses, and Horror Marks

Damage Reversal and Blood Vengeance return consequences to an attacker under their own resistance and trigger rules. They are particularly dangerous to high-output attackers whose own offence becomes the delivery mechanism. Small attacks may be inefficient if every trigger invokes a fixed test; enormous attacks may be catastrophic if the reflected consequence scales. The exact current description must decide which case applies.

Curse-on-contact and Horror Mark effects create consequences beyond the immediate exchange. A curse changes future misfortune and affliction risk. A horror mark creates a monthly chance of horror attack; repeated marks can increase its hidden severity, and horrors prefer marked targets. Stronger marks can attract stronger horrors.

These are persistence weapons. Killing the source does not necessarily remove a mark already applied. The value of an irreplaceable commander must include post-battle contamination, not only current hit points.

43. Petrification and Other Hard Stops

Petrification can stop or destroy attackers through a resistance interaction. Paralysis, stun, sleep, entanglement, frozen states, and swallowing can similarly remove action without first reducing hit points to zero.

Hard control is often the correct answer to regeneration, life drain, heroic defences, or other sustain because it attacks participation rather than the health pool. It is also unreliable when the target is immune, has high Magic Resistance, possesses specialised protection, or can reform after the relevant effect. A counter plan needs both a delivery mechanism and an answer to the target's class.

44. Ambidextrous, Clumsy, Berserker, and Multiweapon Bodies

Ambidextrous reduces the attack penalty from using multiple weapons by its value. It does not remove the additional weapon encumbrance. Clumsy imposes a corresponding handling problem. The value of Ambidextrous depends on the number and quality of actual attacks and on sustainable fatigue, not only the presence of the icon.

Berserker can activate when a wounded unit passes the specified morale test. While berserk, the unit gains its listed bonuses and continues fighting until dead rather than routing normally. Becoming unconscious ends the current berserk state, though the unit can enter it again after recovering and being wounded. Berserk is both a morale solution and a control cost: the unit cannot make ordinary retreat decisions after the state takes hold.

45. Trample

Trample lets a larger unit enter a square occupied by smaller units, displace them, and inflict armour-piercing damage through a Defence minus fatigue contest. The manual gives the failed-check damage as `7 + trampler Size`; an ethereal trampler deals half damage, and even a successful defence check still causes 1 point while displacement occurs.

The full procedure, square capacity, mount interaction, fatigue, and counter formation belong to Book IV. The ability record adds three interpretive warnings:

- trample output depends on reaching smaller bodies and on available squares;
- fatigue reduces the victims' defence in the check and also degrades the trampler over time;
- size is part of both offence and target eligibility, so transformation, mounts, and opposing body size can reverse the plan.

46. Swallow, Digest, and Incorporate

Swallow removes a target from the battlefield until the swallower dies or the ability releases it. Digest damages the swallowed target each round. Incorporate converts some of that process into benefit for the swallowing creature.

The manual warns that swallowing prevents many life-saving effects. It can bypass plans based on allies, immortality timing, transformation, regeneration, or escape. Size and target restrictions are central. Counterplay usually means killing or disabling the swallower quickly, preventing contact, or presenting bodies it cannot legally swallow.

47. Life Drain, Raise-on-Kill, and Kill-Dependent Effects

Life Drain converts suitable damage into recovery and fatigue relief under its defined rules. Lifeless targets greatly reduce the damage after protection and do not heal the attacker through ordinary life drain. Raise-on-kill and soul-collection effects transform casualties into new bodies, gems, or other resources.

Kill-dependent abilities are nonlinear. They are weak before the first suitable victim dies, then can accelerate as new bodies or recovery increase contact. Denying legal victims, using lifeless or resistant screens, maintaining range, and destroying the carrier before the first conversion are more effective than evaluating the final snowball at full strength.

Part VIII: Conditional, Economic, Magical, and Summoning Abilities

48. Seasonal Powers

Spring, Summer, Autumn, and Winter Power change a unit's statistics or capabilities with the season. A year-turn effect may transform forms or attributes as the calendar changes. The unit shown in one month is not necessarily stable across the year.

Seasonal units should be recorded as a schedule:

Field	Record
Strong season	The months in which the positive modifier applies
Weak season	The months in which output or survival declines
Form change	Whether the body, magic, items, or command changes
Campaign deadline	The last hosting turn on which the intended operation retains the favourable state
Opponent option	Whether waiting, delaying a siege, or forcing an early battle changes the matchup

Season is thus a strategic resource. It can create a predictable timing attack and an equally predictable window for avoidance.

49. Scale and Environmental Powers

Chaos, Cold, Fire, Death, Growth, Darkness, Storm, Magic, Sloth, and related powers change a unit in matching conditions. Dominion Power keys performance to dominion. These abilities mean the unit's statistics are partly provincial.

The correct comparison is not one card against another. It is the card in the likely battlefield province after forecast scale movement, dominion contest, storm creation, and light conditions. An enemy may counter the unit by changing the environment rather than fighting its favourable profile directly.

50. Supply, Siege, Patrol, Pillage, and Resource Effects

Need Not Eat removes ordinary supply consumption. Supply Bonus creates supplies. Siege Bonus, Siege Defence, Patrol Bonus, and Pillager modify state actions. Resource, gold, tax, gem, and unrest-related abilities convert a unit or commander into an economic object.

These abilities should be costed by use-month rather than by icon. A Supply Bonus on a commander who remains in the capital creates little value. The same commander on a long enemy route may preserve hundreds of troops. A Siege Bonus matters only when a fort is being converted or protected. A Patrol Bonus can be worth more than combat statistics in a blood economy or stealth war.

Book II owns the economic formulas; Book VI owns strategic conversion. Book XI records the permission and reminds the reader to count months of actual employment.

51. Research, Forge, Search, and Ritual Support

Research Bonus increases research output. Forge Bonus reduces eligible forging costs. Dousing and path-specific search bonuses improve Blood Hunting or site searching. Innate Spellcaster changes how a unit casts and can protect parts of its script from ordinary interruption rules.

Patch 6.35 corrected innate spellcasters that could skip their script after becoming temporarily unconscious. Current planning should use the restored behaviour and still account for the turns lost while unconscious.

Support abilities convert commander-turns. Their opportunity cost is central. A researcher moved to lead a patrol is not producing research. A forge specialist who spends every turn moving has no realised forge bonus. Book V owns the resulting magic economy.

52. Summoner, Retinue, Dominion Summoner, and Battle Summoner

Summoning abilities create followers on a schedule or at a trigger. Retinues accompany or regenerate around a commander. Dominion Summoners depend on dominion or local conditions. Battle Summoners add bodies during combat.

Every summoning record needs five fields:

1. what is created;
2. when creation occurs;
3. whether the result persists;
4. what leadership it requires;
5. what cap, condition, or random range applies.

The created unit's own class may impose a new command burden. A commander can generate troops faster than the army can legally organise or transport them.

Part IX: Experience and Veteran Units

53. How Experience Is Gained

The official manual states that units usually gain 1 experience point per month. A battle grants 4 experience if the unit does not retreat and 1 if it retreats, with battle experience awarded at most once in a month. A melee strike or trample action grants 1 experience. Community investigation adds finer descriptions for attack flurries, trampled squares, arena victories, events, and particular sites or items; those details are useful but remain version-sensitive unless reproduced against 6.36.

Mindless units are an important exception to ordinary monthly learning in community references, but the current official manual's general wording is not a full class-by-class specification. Where exact passive gain matters, inspect the live unit over controlled turns or use a current engine export.

Experience stays with the unit, not the unit type. Recruitment cost understates the replacement cost of a veteran formation.

54. Experience Thresholds

The official thresholds are 15, 50, 100, 200, and 400 experience points. Each threshold adds a star and a package of improvements.

Total XP	New star's official incremental gains
15	Attack +1, Defence +1, Precision +1, Morale +1, Leadership +25, Research +1

Total XP	New star's official incremental gains
50	Attack +1, Defence +1, Precision +1, Morale +1, Leadership +50, Research +1
100	Attack +1, Defence +1, Precision +1, Morale +1, Strength +1, Hit Points +1, Leadership +50, Research +1
200	Attack +1, Defence +1, Precision +1, Morale +1, Hit Points +1, Encumbrance -1, Leadership +50, Research +1
400	Attack +1, Defence +1, Precision +1, Morale +1, Strength +1, Hit Points +1, Magic Resistance +1, Leadership +50, Research +1

The official table appears to yield a cumulative +3 Hit Points at five stars, while a current community Dom6 experience table reports +2. This disagreement is preserved as a verification warning rather than silently harmonised. The incremental official table above is reproduced as printed. A current in-game five-star unit or engine export should decide the cumulative display before a public calculator is built.

Poor leadership receives smaller command gains. The official leadership section states that a base-10 poor leader receives +5 at the first star and +10 at each later threshold. For normal leadership, the displayed high-experience capacity can greatly exceed the commander's original value, while some morale-quality effects still refer to base leadership.

55. Experience Changes Roles Unevenly

The same star package has different value on different bodies.

- Attack and Defence compound the value of elite melee units that survive repeated contacts.
- Precision matters only when the unit delivers attacks or spells that use it.
- Morale improves formation reliability but adds little to a mindless body already using its special morale rule.
- Strength matters more for strength-scaled weapons and some siege or carrying interactions.
- Encumbrance reduction can change long-fight performance disproportionately.
- Magic Resistance is especially valuable on expensive targets that attract control magic.
- Research bonuses make surviving mage-commanders economically productive even when their paths do not change.
- Leadership gains can transform a marginal commander into a genuine army organiser.

Experience is not a flat percentage bonus. It changes the jobs a unit can perform.

56. Veteran Preservation

Veterans should be preserved when their added reliability is scarce and replaceable when preservation costs more than the advantage.

Factor	Preservation favoured when	Replacement favoured when
Recruitment	Slow, cap-only, sacred, or commander-point constrained	Cheap, local, and immediately replaceable
Star value	Attack, Defence, MR, Encumbrance, or Leadership crosses a functional threshold	Bonuses do not alter the current matchup
Afflictions	Healthy or recoverable	Limp, chest wound, feeblemind, or lost limbs remove the gained role
Position	A safe rotation route exists	Withdrawal exposes the army or abandons the objective

Factor	Preservation favoured when	Replacement favoured when
Time	Campaign is long enough to exploit future months	Victory deadline is immediate

The Army Setup experience filter supports separation of veterans. Mixing them indiscriminately with recruits can waste the opportunity to assign different risk, formation, or leadership.

Part X: Hall of Fame and Heroic Abilities

57. What Is Officially Established

The Hall of Fame ranks commanders that survive many battles or kill many enemies. Non-Pretender commanders in the Hall receive a heroic ability, shown by a yellow star in a red circle, and that ability improves while the commander remains listed. Unique beings such as Elemental Royalty cannot enter. Pretenders do not receive an ordinary heroic ability through this system.

The hosting sequence updates the Hall of Fame and graphs before heroic abilities improve. That timing can matter when a commander enters, leaves, or rises within the list.

The main manual does not publish the full current scoring formula, ability selection weights, or growth formulas. Exact heroic arithmetic circulating online is community reverse engineering, much of it inherited from Dominions 5. It should be used as a hypothesis and planning aid, not as a current official contract.

58. Community-Derived Heroic Families

Older reverse engineering identifies common heroic families such as Strength, Battle Prowess, Lightning Reflexes, Iron Will, Valor, Tough Skin, Heroic Toughness, Heroic Quickness, Precision, Endurance, Obesity, and Extraordinary Agility. Rarer reported families include Awesome Presence, Battle Bellow, Legendary Command of Undead, Adept Research, Third Eye, Daftness, Cruelty, Soul Butcher, Fast Casting, and Troll Blood.

The practical descriptions are safer than exact old formulas:

Family	Reported growth	Principal use
Enormous Strength	Strength	Damage, carrying, and strength-based tasks
Battle Prowess	Attack	More reliable melee contact
Lightning Reflexes	Defence	Avoiding ordinary attacks
Iron Will	Magic Resistance	Resisting hostile magic
Valor	Morale, leadership, inspiration	Army command and rout resistance
Tough Skin	Natural protection	Physical survival before armour interaction
Heroic Toughness	Percentage hit points	Larger health pool, especially on high-base-HP bodies
Heroic Quickness	Faster action interval and combat movement in community models	More actions and faster contact; exact 6.36 formula unverified

Family	Reported growth	Principal use
Heroic Precision	Precision	Ranged and spell delivery where Precision applies
Heroic Endurance	Reinvigoration	Sustainable action in long battles
Extraordinary Agility	Attack, Defence, ambidexterity	Multiweapon melee performance
Fast Casting	Casting speed	More spell actions; rare and version-sensitive
Troll Blood	Regeneration	Percentage recovery; rare and version-sensitive

Community formulas commonly model a hidden heroic value that begins near 100 and grows by random increments while the commander remains in the Hall. Because the best-known source predates Dominions 6 and current verification is incomplete, this edition does not promote those formulas into the official register.

59. Evaluating a Heroic Commander

A heroic ability should be evaluated as a new role constraint, not a trophy.

1. Record the commander's base job.
2. Identify whether the heroic gain strengthens that job or opens a different one.
3. Recalculate equipment, script, bodyguards, and retreat plan.
4. Price the loss of Hall growth if the commander leaves the ranking.
5. Separate a current displayed bonus from a projected community formula.

Heroic Toughness on a large body can create much more absolute health than on a human. Fast Casting on a battle mage may alter an entire script. Valor on a poor commander may create a new army leader. Conversely, melee heroics on a researcher do not automatically justify risking years of accumulated research output.

Part XI: Conditions and Lasting State

60. Conditions Are State, Not Flavour Text

A condition may alter statistics, action, targeting, recovery, loyalty, or future events. Some expire during battle. Others remain for months, survive shape changes, or cannot ordinarily be removed. A unit card reports the current state; it is not a permanent template.

The first distinction is duration:

Duration class	Examples	Audit question
Immediate or one-resolution	Stun, short paralysis, a consumed Twist Fate	Does the unit act before the next decisive event?
Battle-persistent	Poison, bleeding, burning, frozen, fatigue, entanglement	Can resistance, recovery, or battle end remove it?
Month-persistent	Disease, insanity, many afflictions	What happens during hosting and can treatment occur first?
Indefinite mark	Curse, Horror Mark, some taints	Is there any ordinary removal route?
Source-bound	Item-caused affliction, shape, mount state	Must the source be removed or changed before recovery?

61. Afflictions

An affliction is a lasting injury. The official manual gives the base chance as the percentage of normal maximum hit points lost to a damaging strike, with hit location determining what injuries are possible. Major and minor afflictions differ. A unit can accumulate several, shown by a red-heart icon.

Examples include lost eyes, lost arms, weakened limbs, chest wounds, never-healing wounds, battle fright, feeblemind, mute, crippled, and disease. The consequences vary from small statistic penalties to destruction of the unit's original role. A lost arm is far more serious for a two-handed weapon user than for a spellcaster that retains all required paths and casting faculties; feeblemind can reverse that evaluation.

Healing follows eligibility and difficulty, not sentiment. Recuperation excludes Old Age afflictions. Ordinary healers cannot repair many undead, inanimate, or spiritform bodies. Special recovery routes exist but must match the body. Cursed-item injuries may require item removal. Book IV owns the exact chance, hit-location table, and battle consequences.

62. Disease and Old Age

Disease causes continuing deterioration and may add afflictions. Undead, demons, lifeless beings, and spiritforms have relevant immunities according to their classes. Disease Resistance reduces eligible disease effects, and patch 6.27 extended its protection to disease spells such as Plague.

Old age is a separate risk process tied to current age and maximum age. Maximum age is modified by magic paths according to body: Death for undead, Earth for inanimate bodies, Blood for demons, and Nature for most ordinary beings. Fire can reduce maximum age for bodies whose age is Nature-modifiable. Recuperation does not heal afflictions whose cause is old age.

The operational lesson is to distinguish a diseased young commander, an old commander accumulating age afflictions, and a diseased old commander. They require different forecasts even when the red-heart display looks similar.

63. Curse and Horror Mark

Curse increases the chance of suffering afflictions from future wounds and is not ordinarily removed. Horror Mark creates a hidden accumulated severity and a monthly chance of attack by horrors. Horrors prioritise marked units, and stronger marks can attract more dangerous attackers.

Neither condition should be confused with an affliction. Ordinary healing is not the answer. Horror marks may lessen while a unit is dead in some return systems, but exact current reduction is ability-specific and should not be assumed as a universal cleansing method.

64. Insanity, Tainted, Yearning, and Homesickness

Insanity can cause a commander to take an unwanted monthly action instead of the assigned order. Tainted and Yearning impose their own recurring risks or location dependencies. Homesickness harms or pressures units away from their proper home or plane.

These conditions convert reliability into probability. The unit may look fully capable and still fail to perform the one strategic order on which a turn depends. Redundancy, safe roles, location planning, and command audits are their primary counters. A critical ritual should not be assigned to an insane commander without an accepted failure branch.

65. Poison, Burning, Bleeding, Frozen, and Corrosion

Poison accumulates delayed damage and, since patch 6.30, also reduces Precision. Burning and bleeding cause continuing harm under their rules. Frozen impairs the unit and can combine with cold pressure. Rust and acid can damage armour rather than merely the body.

Patch 6.30 clarified that Spiritform, rather than Ethereal, protects against bleeding, frozen, and burning states. A visual ghost or mist sprite is not enough; the actual tag must be present.

These conditions matter because resistance to the initial strike may not answer the secondary state. Battle review should inspect both damage numbers and icons.

66. Stun, Paralysis, Sleep, Entanglement, and Confusion

Stun and paralysis remove or delay actions. Sleep produces unconsciousness. Entanglement holds a unit in place until it escapes or the effect ends. Confusion disrupts normal behaviour. These conditions win time, and time converts into attacks, spell completions, fatigue recovery for one side, and aura exposure for the other.

The correct measure is not only duration. It is the number and value of actions denied before the unit recovers. A one-round stop on a fast caster or trampler may be worth more than a long disable on an irrelevant rear unit.

67. Charm, Enslave, Transformation, and Control Loss

Charm and enslavement can change ownership or control. Transformation changes the body and can replace important tags, magic, equipment eligibility, or movement. Polyimmune and other class immunities can prevent specified transformations.

Control effects attack the investment rather than the hit-point pool. Magic Resistance, penetration, body-class immunity, range, and killing the controller or target may all matter. Their strategic consequence includes information and item loss as well as battle output.

Part XII: Master Ability and Condition Register

68. How to Use the Register

The following records are deliberately concise. They identify the first-order rule, the main caveat or counter, and the strongest preserved evidence layer. They are not substitutes for the live description of a specific unit or for Book IV's combat procedures.

Evidence codes are defined in Section 2. "UI check" means that the current value or object-specific wording should be read in the game before committing a design.

Name	Category	Core function	Principal caveat or counter	Evidence	Primary anchor
Animal	Class	Normal-led creature; half ordinary supply use; reduced armless siege value except monkeys	Animal-specific control and awe; siege contribution	OM, MM	b11-10-animal
Magic Being	Class	Requires magic leadership	Leader loss; magic-being targeting; undead-plus-magic uses undead leadership	OM, MM	b11-11-magic-being
Mindless	Class	Morale 50 under control; many mind effects fail	Cannot mix with non-mindless; dissolves without suitable leader	OM, MM	b11-12-mindless
Undead	Class	Requires undead leadership; disease immune; banishable	Ordinary healing restrictions; anti-undead effects; harmful living mix	OM, MM	b11-13-undead
Demon	Class	Requires undead leadership; disease immune; banishable	Demon-specific effects; do not infer undead or elemental traits	OM, MM	b11-14-demon
Inanimate or Lifeless	Class	Nonliving body with disease, life-drain, and ordinary-healing immunities	Needs Reconstruction or specialised repair; class wording is object-specific	OM, MM	b11-15-inanimate-and-lifeless
Spiritform	Class	Spirit body; transformation, disease, and ordinary-healing immunity	Not identical to Ethereal; specialised spirit effects remain	OM, OP	b11-16-spiritform
Plant	Class	Plant-type target category	Does not imply Mindless, Inanimate, or resistances	MM	b11-17-1-plant
Stone Being	Class	Stone-specific target category	Do not infer Inanimate unless separately present	MM	b11-17-2-stone-being
Illusion	Class	Illusory creature category	Distinct from Glamour, Invisibility, and Ethereal	MM	b11-17-3-illusion
Horror	Class	Lesser, Greater, or Doom Horror category	Horror Mark does not grant this class	MM	b11-17-4-horror
Sacred	Religion	Eligible for blessing and Holy recruitment rules	Must be blessed; Incarnate effects require proper god state	OM	b11-17-5-sacred-holy-divine-being-pretender-and-prophet
Cold Blooded	Body	Suffers additional fatigue in cold	Cold scales and chill pressure; verify exact current modifier	OM, MM	b11-18-cold-blood-blindness-sex-and-other-body-tags
Aquatic	Movement	Operates underwater	Usually land-incompatible without another form or effect	OM, MM	b11-19-water-status-is-a-permission-system
Amphibian	Movement	Operates on land and underwater	Underwater weapons, mounts, and spells still matter	OM, MM	b11-19-water-status-is-a-permission-system
Poor Amphibian	Movement	Cross-environment permission with penalties	Penalties can make nominal access tactically poor	OM, MM	b11-19-water-status-is-a-permission-system
Flying	Movement	Strategic and battlefield flight	Storms, retreat routes, squad compatibility, anti-flyer screens	OM, MM	b11-20-flying-floating-and-storms

Name	Category	Core function	Principal caveat or counter	Evidence	Primary anchor
Floating	Movement	Passes relevant ground or terrain constraints	Not full flight; mount interaction is separate	MM, OP	b11-20-flying-floating-and-storms
Storm Immunity	Movement	Retains relevant function during storms	Does not grant flight by itself	MM	b11-20-flying-floating-and-storms
Terrain Survival	Movement	Reduces matching terrain movement burden	One incompatible army member can constrain route	OM, MM	b11-21-terrain-survival-and-snow-movement
Sailing	Movement	Carries eligible force across water	Capacity, passenger size, route, and no underwater stay	OM, MM	b11-22-sailing
Teleport	Movement	Unusual strategic movement	Unteleportable, legality, timing, and retreat; 6.35 siege exception is narrow	MM, OP	b11-23-teleportation-blink-and-immobility
Immobile	Movement	Cannot use ordinary strategic movement	Requires summons, remote influence, or special movement	MM	b11-23-teleportation-blink-and-immobility
Magic Leadership	Command	Commands Magic Beings	Capacity and leader survival; does not replace undead precedence	OM, MM	b11-24-three-leadership-pools
Undead Leadership	Command	Commands undead and demons	Capacity and leader survival; anti-leader attacks	OM, MM	b11-24-three-leadership-pools
Standard	Command	Raises squad morale	Only best Standard in squad applies	OM, MM	b11-25-standard-and-inspirational
Inspirational	Command	Modifies morale of commanded troops	Can be negative; commander-bound rather than squad item	OM, MM	b11-25-standard-and-inspirational
Taskmaster	Command	Improves slave command and morale	Valuable only with matching followers	OM, MM	b11-26-taskmaster-beast-master-and-special-followers
Beast Master	Command	Improves animal command	Animal-specific; ordinary roster gains little	OM, MM	b11-26-taskmaster-beast-master-and-special-followers
Formation Fighter	Command	Permits denser fighting formation	Needs formation-wide support; crowding and area effects remain	OM, MM	b11-27-formation-fighter-tight-reins-and-undisciplined-units
Undisciplined	Command	Restricts ordinary squad orders	Reduces script control; separate from low morale	OM, MM	b11-27-formation-fighter-tight-reins-and-undisciplined-units
Bodyguard	Command	Chance for guards to join assassination defence	Not certainty; current exploit fixed in 6.35	OM, OP	b11-28-bodyguards-and-warning
Stealthy	Covert	Permits sneaking and contributes concealment	Patrol contest, composition, terrain, and size	OM, MM	b11-29-stealth-is-a-contest-not-invisibility
Spy	Covert	Enables intelligence and covert unrest work	Patrols and order-specific exposure	OM, MM	b11-30-spy-assassin-and-infiltration-families
Assassin	Covert	Attempts assassination	Bodyguards, Warning, target restrictions, failure battle	OM, MM	b11-30-spy-assassin-and-infiltration-families
Seduction family	Covert	Attempts special recruitment, corruption, or assassination outcomes	Sex, target, patience, location, checks, and failure differ by ability	OM, MM	b11-30-spy-assassin-and-infiltration-families

Name	Category	Core function	Principal caveat or counter	Evidence	Primary anchor
Glamour	Concealment	Mirror images in battle; hidden in friendly provinces	Images can be stripped; specialised sight; not Illusion	OM, MM	b11-31-glamour-invisibility-unseen-and-illusion
Invisibility or Unseen	Concealment	Makes detection or targeting difficult	Exact perception counter is ability-specific	MM, UI	b11-31-glamour-invisibility-unseen-and-illusion
Darkvision	Perception	Reduces darkness penalties	Percentage or value matters; does not answer every concealment	OM, MM	b11-32-darkvision-spirit-sight-true-sight-and-blindness
Spirit Sight	Perception	Detects relevant spiritual or ethereal targets	Not a universal True Sight substitute	OM, MM	b11-32-darkvision-spirit-sight-true-sight-and-blindness
True Sight	Perception	Counters specified deception	Check exact effect; darkness may remain separate	MM, UI	b11-32-darkvision-spirit-sight-true-sight-and-blindness
Elemental Resistance	Defence	Reduces matching fire, cold, shock, poison, or acid pressure	Secondary effects and other damage types can bypass the plan	OM, MM	b11-33-resistances-are-typed-defences
Physical Resistance	Defence	Reduces matching pierce, slash, or blunt damage	Wrong weapon type bypasses; exact layer in Book IV	OM, MM	b11-33-resistances-are-typed-defences
Air Shield	Defence	Reduces chance of relevant missiles hitting	Spells and nonmissile delivery; exact percentage	OM, MM	b11-33-resistances-are-typed-defences
Ethereal	Defence	75 percent of nonmagical strikes miss; passes fort walls	Magical attacks; other layers still apply	OM	b11-34-ethereal-twist-fate-luck-and-glamour
Twist Fate	Defence	Negates a qualifying damaging event, then ends	Multiple attacks or prior expendable hit	OM, MM	b11-34-ethereal-twist-fate-luck-and-glamour
Luck	Defence	Chance-based survival layer	High attack volume; verify interaction order	OM, MM	b11-34-ethereal-twist-fate-luck-and-glamour
Regeneration	Recovery	Heals exact percentage of maximum HP per round and reduces affliction risk	Burst damage, disablement, inanimate immunity, soul effects	OM, OP	b11-35-regeneration-families
Reconstruction	Recovery	Regeneration for inanimate bodies	Verify percentage and body eligibility	OM, MM	b11-35-regeneration-families
Undead Regeneration	Recovery	Regeneration family for eligible undead	Not every undead has it; burst and control remain	OM, MM	b11-35-regeneration-families
Reinvigoration	Recovery	Removes fatigue over time	Cannot restore actions already lost; short fights may not use it	OM, MM	b11-36-reinvigoration
Recuperation	Recovery	Attempts to heal eligible battle afflictions over months	Excludes old age; class and affliction difficulty restrictions	OM, MM	b11-37-recuperation-and-healers
Healer	Recovery	Attempts to heal eligible units	Body and affliction eligibility; healer value and difficulty	OM, MM	b11-37-recuperation-and-healers
Immortality	Persistence	Returns after death under defined conditions	Delay, dominion, soul destruction, position, and lost battle	OM, MM	b11-38-immortality-reformation-and-extra-lives
Awe	Aura	Forces attacker morale check against 10 plus Awe	Morale, immunity, missiles, spells, rapid removal	OM, MM	b11-39-awe-sun-awe-fear-and-dread

Name	Category	Core function	Principal caveat or counter	Evidence	Primary anchor
Sun Awe	Aura	Awe family dependent on light	Disabled underground or in darkness	OM, MM	b11-39-awe-sun-awe-fear-and-dread
Fear	Aura	Applies local morale pressure	Leadership, morale, mindless, range, source removal; exact current procedure in Book IV	OM, OP	b11-39-awe-sun-awe-fear-and-dread
Heat or Chill Aura	Aura	Applies local fatigue and elemental pressure	Matching resistance, scales, spacing, range	OM, MM	b11-40-heat-chill-poison-disease-sleep-and-nightmare-auras
Poison Cloud	Aura	Accumulates poison in an area	Poison resistance, spacing, ranged removal	OM, MM	b11-40-heat-chill-poison-disease-sleep-and-nightmare-auras
Disease or Plague Aura	Aura	Applies persistent disease pressure	Disease Resistance, separation, cure capacity	OM, OP	b11-40-heat-chill-poison-disease-sleep-and-nightmare-auras
Sleep Aura	Aura	Causes nearby units to become unconscious	Resistance or immunity, range, rapid removal	MM, UI	b11-40-heat-chill-poison-disease-sleep-and-nightmare-auras
Fire Shield	Reactive	Damages qualifying attackers in contact	Fire resistance, range, long weapons, disposable attacks	OM, MM	b11-41-fire-shields-acid-spikes-slime-and-entanglement
Damage Reversal	Reactive	Returns a consequence to attacker	Exact trigger and resistance; nonqualifying attacks	OM, MM	b11-42-damage-reversal-blood-vengeance-curses-and-horror-marks
Blood Vengeance	Reactive	Punishes damage through a resistance interaction	Magic Resistance, attack selection, ranged or disposable delivery	OM, MM	b11-42-damage-reversal-blood-vengeance-curses-and-horror-marks
Petrification	Reactive	Hard-stop effect against qualifying attackers	Magic Resistance, immunity, noncontact delivery	OM, MM	b11-43-petrification-and-other-hard-stops
Ambidextrous	Combat	Reduces multiweapon attack penalty by value	Does not remove extra weapon encumbrance	OM, MM	b11-44-ambidextrous-clumsy-berserker-and-multiweapon-bodies
Berserker	Combat	Wounded morale check can enter no-rout combat state with bonuses	Loss of control; unconsciousness ends current state	OM, MM	b11-44-ambidextrous-clumsy-berserker-and-multiweapon-bodies
Trample	Combat	Displaces smaller units and deals size-based armour-piercing damage	Large targets, fatigue, formation, space, ranged disablement	OM, MM	b11-45-trample
Swallow or Digest	Combat	Removes and damages eligible target inside swallower	Size restriction; kill or disable swallower; blocks many life-saving effects	OM, MM	b11-46-swallow-digest-and-incorporate
Life Drain	Combat	Converts suitable damage into recovery	Lifeless targets; range; resistance; rapid killing	OM, MM	b11-47-life-drain-raise-on-kill-and-kill-dependent-effects
Seasonal Power	Conditional	Changes attributes in a matching season	Predictable weak months; year-turn or form changes	MM	b11-48-seasonal-powers
Scale Power	Conditional	Changes attributes in matching scales or environment	Change scales, light, storm, or battlefield location	MM	b11-49-scale-and-environmental-powers
Need Not Eat	Economy	Consumes no ordinary supplies	Does not imply disease, undead, or inanimate status	OM, MM	b11-50-supply-siege-patrol-pillage-and-resource-effects

Name	Category	Core function	Principal caveat or counter	Evidence	Primary anchor
Supply Bonus	Economy	Produces supplies	Value realised only where supply is binding	OM, MM	b11-50-supply-siege-patrol-pillage-and-resource-effects
Siege or Patrol Bonus	Economy	Improves matching province action	No value while action is unused; exact formula elsewhere	OM, MM	b11-50-supply-siege-patrol-pillage-and-resource-effects
Research Bonus	Magic support	Adds research output	Commander-turn opportunity cost	OM, MM	b11-51-research-forge-search-and-ritual-support
Forge Bonus	Magic support	Reduces eligible forge cost	Item and path eligibility and rounding; only while forging	OM, MM	b11-51-research-forge-search-and-ritual-support
Innate Spellcaster	Magic support	Uses innate casting rules	Current 6.35 script fix; fatigue and unconsciousness still matter	OM, OP	b11-51-research-forge-search-and-ritual-support
Summoner or Retinue	Summoning	Creates or restores followers on a trigger or schedule	Leadership, cap, persistence, and created class	MM, UI	b11-52-summoner-retinue-dominion-summoner-and-battle-summoner
Experience	Development	Adds star packages at 15, 50, 100, 200, and 400 XP	Role-specific value; official and community cumulative HP discrepancy	OM, CT	b11-54-experience-thresholds
Heroic Ability	Development	Hall-of-Fame commander gains a growing special trait	Exact formula and rarity are community-derived and version-sensitive	OM, CT	b11-57-what-is-officially-established
Affliction	Condition	Lasting injury with body-part and difficulty rules	Correct healer and body eligibility; role can be lost	OM	b11-61-afflictions
Disease	Condition	Continuing deterioration and affliction risk	Disease Resistance, immunity, Disease Healer; distinct from old age	OM, OP	b11-62-disease-and-old-age
Curse	Condition	Persistent increased misfortune and affliction exposure	Not ordinarily removable; avoid contamination	OM	b11-63-curse-and-horror-mark
Horror Mark	Condition	Hidden stacked severity and monthly horror-attack chance	Not ordinary affliction; conceal, protect, or accept long risk	OM	b11-63-curse-and-horror-mark
Insanity	Condition	Chance of unwanted monthly behaviour	Redundancy and noncritical assignments	OM, MM	b11-64-insanity-tainted-yearning-and-homesickness
Old Age	Condition	Age-driven deterioration beyond body-adjusted maximum age	Recuperation does not heal age afflictions	OM	b11-62-disease-and-old-age
Poison	Condition	Delayed accumulating damage; also reduces Precision since 6.30	Poison resistance, recovery, battle duration	OM, OP	b11-65-poison-burning-bleeding-frozen-and-corrosion
Burning, Bleeding, or Frozen	Condition	Persistent battle impairment or damage	Relevant immunity or resistance; Spiritform protected in 6.30	OP, UI	b11-65-poison-burning-bleeding-frozen-and-corrosion
Stun, Paralysis, or Sleep	Condition	Denies actions	Resistance, immunity, recovery time, source removal	OM, MM	b11-66-stun-paralysis-sleep-entanglement-and-confusion
Entanglement	Condition	Prevents movement or action until escape	Strength or ability-specific escape; ranged support	OM, MM	b11-66-stun-paralysis-sleep-entanglement-and-confusion

Name	Category	Core function	Principal caveat or counter	Evidence	Primary anchor
Charm or Enslave	Condition	Changes control or ownership	Magic Resistance, immunity, range, killing target or caster	OM, MM	b11-67-charm-enslave-transformation-and-control-loss
Transformation	Condition	Replaces body or form	Polyimmune, targeting immunity, form-specific loss	OM, MM	b11-67-charm-enslave-transformation-and-control-loss

Part XIII: Retrieval and Audit Tools

69. The Unit-Card Translation Sheet

For important commanders, sacreds, summons, and unusual independents, use one compact record:

Field	Entry
Ruleset and version	Patch, mod stack, object source
Current form	Unit ID or name, mount, alternate shapes
Classes	Every displayed or confirmed type tag
Leadership need	Normal, magic, undead; capacity and redundancy
Movement permissions	Land, water, air, terrain, teleport, sailing
Defensive gates	Protection, resistance, Ethereal, Glamour, Luck, recovery
Offensive gates	Range, magic weapon, aura, trample, swallow, control
Conditional values	Scale, season, dominion, darkness, storm, bless
Development	XP, stars, Hall position, heroic ability
Current damage	Afflictions, disease, curse, horror mark, age, insanity
Evidence	OM, MM, OP, UI, CT, D, TP
Links	Canonical Book IV, V, or VI section and object record

This sheet makes a unit comparable across turns. It also exposes when a conclusion came from a favourable form or environment rather than the permanent object.

70. Army Compatibility Audit

Before movement or battle scripting, verify:

1. Every unit has the correct leadership type and capacity.
2. Mindless and non-mindless bodies are not assigned to an illegal shared squad.
3. Water, flight, sailing, teleport, and terrain permissions cover the entire force.
4. Supply demand includes riders and mounts and accounts for animal reductions and Need Not Eat.
5. Darkness, storm, temperature, season, scale, and dominion assumptions match the destination.
6. Recovery routes match actual body classes.
7. Standard distribution uses best-only stacking rather than redundant concentration.
8. Veteran and afflicted units occupy formations appropriate to their current statistics.
9. A leader-loss branch exists for magical beings, undead, demons, and mindless troops.
10. A retreat route exists for every movement mode and plane involved.

71. Counter-Construction Matrix

Enemy gate	First answer family	Secondary check	Frequent false answer
Ethereal	Magical attacks	Accuracy, damage, other defence layers	More nonmagical elite attacks
Glamour or Invisibility	Image-clearing volume and suitable perception	Darkness and target eligibility	Treating every concealment tag as Illusion
Awe	Morale, leadership, immunity, range	Attack count and fear support	Raw damage on attackers that never complete attacks
Fear	Morale system, mindless where suitable, source removal	Army-rout weight and commander survival	Only increasing individual hit points
Regeneration	Burst, disablement, sustained damage above recovery	Affliction resistance and immortality	Slow chip damage into favourable sustain
Trample	Comparable size, formation depth, fatigue, or ranged control	Displacement space and mount form	A thin line of high-Defence small units
Swallow	Ineligible size, range, rapid swallower removal	Life-saving effects blocked inside	Relying on the swallowed unit's ordinary sustain
Auras	Matching resistance, spacing, range, source removal	Duration and density	Buying resistance to only the initial weapon
Life Drain	Lifeless screen, range, burst	Weapon type and target selection	Feeding weak living bodies one at a time
Mindless army	Kill or disable command, exploit army-rout structure	Redundant leaders	Ordinary morale damage aimed only at troops
Immortality	Win position, deny return conditions, soul effects where available	Delay and item loss	Treating one kill as permanent strategic removal
Stealth	Patrol coverage and intelligence	Terrain, size, false-army effects	Province Defence alone without patrol plan
Seasonal or scale power	Delay, relocate, or change environment	Opponent's ability to restore condition	Evaluating only the favourable unit card
Heroic commander	Attack current role and retreat plan	Hidden value formulas unverified	Countering the heroic label instead of the actual bonuses

72. Battle Review Questions

After an unfamiliar interaction, preserve the battle and ask:

- Which tag made the target legal or illegal?
- Which layer acted first: perception, morale, avoidance, protection, resistance, recovery, or return?
- Was the displayed ability innate, item-granted, blessed, spell-granted, mounted, heroic, or environmental?
- Did a condition deny actions even though hit points remained?
- Did leader loss change morale or control?
- Did the battle occur under the expected scales, season, light, storm, and dominion?
- Did the replay show a current patch correction that an older guide lacks?
- Is the conclusion official, directly observed, derived, community-tested, or still pending?

The answer should be recorded at the narrowest reliable level. One battle can show that a particular interaction occurred; it cannot establish every probability or stacking rule.

Part XIV: Essays

Essay I: The Icon Is a Rule, Not Decoration

Dominions presents much of its complexity as small symbols and short descriptions. That presentation invites two opposite mistakes. A new player can ignore an icon because the basic statistics look understandable. An experienced player can recognise the icon's name and import a remembered rule from another version. Both mistakes replace the current object with an assumption.

An icon is best understood as a link to a rule family. Undead links a unit to leadership, banishment, disease immunity, recovery restrictions, and targeting. Flying links it to strategic reach, battlefield contact, storms, squad compatibility, and retreat. Recuperation links it to time, affliction cause, body eligibility, and healing difficulty. The symbol is small because the interface cannot print the whole dependency graph on every card.

Mastery does not mean memorising five hundred isolated definitions. It means learning the questions raised by each family. A class icon asks, "what can command and target this body?" A movement icon asks, "who can accompany it and where can it retreat?" A recovery icon asks, "which damage is actually permanent?" An aura asks, "how many bodies remain inside it, and for how many rounds?"

This approach scales. A new icon can be placed into a known family before every edge case is understood. The unknown details remain visible, but the largest category errors can already be avoided.

Essay II: Overlapping Classes Are the Grammar of Exceptions

Many games assign one creature type and let it explain the whole unit. Dominions instead permits several tags to overlap. This is not clutter. It is the grammar by which the engine expresses exceptions.

Consider an undead magic being. Undead determines banishment, disease, ordinary healing restrictions, and the relevant command precedence. Magic Being creates another targeting identity, but it does not replace the undead command rule. Add Mindless and the morale system changes again. Add Amphibian and the strategic theatre expands. Add Sacred and the same body can receive a blessing. No one adjective is a complete description.

This explains why visual intuition fails so often. A stone statue may be Inanimate, Stone Being, Mindless, Magic Being, Sacred, or only some of them. A ghost may be Spiritform, Ethereal, Undead, Magic Being, Invisible, or a different combination. Art suggests a fiction; tags define the interaction.

For nation design, overlapping classes are also an access problem. The army needs commanders that satisfy the strongest command requirement, magic that can support the body, movement that can transport it, and recovery that matches it. A roster containing individually powerful units can be strategically weak if its class infrastructure is incomplete.

Essay III: Experience Is Stored Reliability

Experience seems modest because each star adds small numbers. Those numbers sit on contested rolls that occur repeatedly. One Attack point can turn many near misses into hits. One Defence point can prevent many contacts. One Morale point can preserve a formation at the check that would otherwise break it. Encumbrance reduction can delay a critical-hit spiral. Magic Resistance can save the commander on whom the army's leadership depends.

The value is stored because the recruitment price has already been paid. Months, battles, and survived contacts have been converted into a unit that cannot be purchased directly from the queue. This does not make every veteran sacred. Afflictions can consume the role that the stars improved, and a victory deadline can make preservation irrational. It does mean that replacement should compare current function rather than printed recruitment cost.

Veteran management is a form of capital allocation. Elite squads can be rotated away from low-value attrition, assigned to the contact where their thresholds matter, or preserved for siege relief. Experienced commanders can become better leaders and researchers. An army that treats every survivor as interchangeable throws away a resource recorded by the interface but not priced by the treasury.

Essay IV: Conditions Turn Battles into Logistics

A battle report that ends with surviving units can conceal a strategic defeat. Disease, lost limbs, chest wounds, curses, horror marks, and insanity follow the survivors into later turns. Poison or fatigue may have decided who escaped. A unit that won while receiving a cursed item injury may remain damaged until equipment changes. A recuperating army may need months and a safe province before it becomes the same army again.

Conditions connect the battlefield to logistics. They create treatment routes, replacement decisions, staging requirements, and deadlines. Different bodies need different forms of repair. Living healers cannot mend every construct or ghost. Recuperation cannot undo old age. Immortality may restore the body while still losing the month's position and tempo.

The useful measure of victory is not bodies left on the final frame. It is force available for the next necessary action. Book IV explains how the damage occurred; Book XI explains why the icons remaining afterward are part of the campaign state.

Essay V: Evidence Boundaries Are Part of Expert Play

Dominions rewards exact knowledge, but an old formula printed confidently can imitate exactness. Heroic abilities are the clearest example. Community reverse engineering offers detailed scoring and growth models that are far more useful than vague folklore. The official manual confirms only the broad Hall-of-Fame process, and much of the detailed public work predates Dominions 6.

The correct response is neither to discard the investigation nor to publish it as current law. It is to label the layer. Official rules support the stable core. Current patch notes correct superseded behaviour. Community work supplies hypotheses and often excellent working estimates. Controlled tests decide the interactions that matter enough to verify.

This boundary improves play. A plan based on an official permission can be treated as reliable. A plan based on a community probability needs a failure branch. A plan based on a hidden heroic growth formula should not risk a campaign unless the current displayed value already justifies it. Uncertainty becomes an operational input rather than an embarrassment concealed by prose.

Part XV: Version Notes, Open Questions, and Sources

73. Current Ability-Facing Patch Notes

Version	Current correction relevant to this book
6.36	Swimming mounts suffice for river crossing; a tavern-charmed knight's mount changes side; repeated mounted-commander recruitment no longer creates the corrected removal charge; Gift of Water Breathing can protect against Lost Land.
6.35	Innate spellcasters no longer skip the script after temporary unconsciousness; units that automatically regain mounts do so at end of turn; a bodyguard exploit was fixed; supply use updates when items change; Enchanted Blood prints its Magic Resistance bonus; teleport-moving commanders can leave besieged forts.
6.31	Regeneration uses the exact displayed percentage rather than old percentage brackets.
6.30	Poison also reduces Precision; Spiritform rather than Ethereal prevents bleeding, frozen, and burning; mounted commanders gained strategic movement changes; gods and prophets cannot fail the ordinary retreat morale roll.
6.27	Disease Resistance protects against disease spells, including Plague; Enchanted Blood was added as a monster and item command.
6.25	Praise was added as an ability; battle version display was added for evidence capture.
6.23	Fear and several battle interactions were corrected; current combat details remain canonical in Book IV.

Patch notes are a correction layer, not a replacement for the manual. Records should name the version in which a behaviour changed and retain the older rule only when it helps diagnose historical guides or saved games.

74. Open Verification Queue

Priority	Question	Reliable resolution route	Publication status
P0	Does a current five-star unit display cumulative +2 or +3 Hit Points from experience?	Current 6.36 controlled unit or engine export	Exact official incremental table published; cumulative calculator blocked
P1	Which Hall-of-Fame scoring and heroic-growth formulas remain unchanged in 6.36?	Reproducible current tests or engine-backed reverse engineering	Community families described; formulas withheld from official register
P1	How do current perception abilities divide Glamour, Invisibility, Unseen, Illusion, and Spiritform targets?	Controlled matrix with one effect at a time	Family guidance only
P1	Which ability sources stack, use best-only, or replace one another across form, item, bless, and spell?	Targeted tests and live descriptions	Standard confirmed best-only; others record ability-specific caveats
P2	What are the exact current passive XP exceptions for Mindless units and special sites or items?	Controlled monthly observation and current data export	Official general gain and battle sources published
P2	Which condition immunities follow from each technical class versus a separate hidden tag?	Current object export plus controlled spell matrix	Only explicit official relationships published

Priority	Question	Reliable resolution route	Publication status
P2	How do mount loss, Reclaim Mount, automatic return, and shape changes transfer experience and conditions?	Controlled mounted commander series under 6.36	Cross-link and patch note only

75. Source Record

Official sources

- Illwinter's Dominions 6 documentation page
- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2
- Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34
- Official Dominions 6 announcements and change notes

Community references

- Illwiki: Dominions 6 unit abilities
- Illwiki: Dominions 6 experience
- Illwiki: Hall of Fame reverse engineering
- Dominions 6 Heroic Quickness discussion

The community sources are retained for taxonomy, test leads, and older reverse engineering. They do not override the current official manual, patch notes, or a reproducible 6.36 result.

76. Closing Reference

A complete unit reading has six layers:

```
class -> command -> movement -> ability -> development -> condition
```

Skipping a layer turns an apparent rule into a surprise. Reading all six turns the unit card into a compact map of permissions, gates, risks, and stored value. That method is the foundation on which later nation dossiers, object records, calculators, and matchup essays can be built without restating the same five hundred definitions every time.

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Foundation Book XII: Base-Game Objects and the Searchable Reference Layer

Ruleset, purpose, and evidence boundary

Book XII contains the unmodded Dominions 6 structured object snapshot pinned to version 6.35. The live rules baseline is 6.36, with its official announcement overlaid in the canonical books and patch ledger. A 6.36 object export has not replaced the auditable Inspector commit used here. Dominions Enhanced 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE are kept out of these records. Their exact source inventories remain in Book IX and can later be applied as overlays against the vanilla identities established here.

Book XII fills a different gap from the earlier foundation books. Books II-VI explain economy, religion, armies, magic, and campaign judgement. Book XI explains how to read units and abilities. None of them should become a thousand-page inventory of object cards, so the work is divided clearly:

- Book XII explains how to interpret, compare, verify, and maintain object records;
- `website/base-object-register.json` owns the filterable records;
- `website/base-object-register.schema.json` defines the publication contract;
- the earlier books retain the full rules and strategic consequences;
- nation dossiers will import shared objects by stable identity instead of researching them again.

The baseline data comes from the public Dominions 6 Data Inspector at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbc036ba9bd5dc`, dated 26 May 2026 and labelled by its maintainer as an update to 6.35. The Inspector is an extremely useful community extraction, but it is not an official rules document and its own documentation warns that errors may remain. A field drawn from it is labelled source-confirmed, not official. Statements from the official manuals receive the higher official label. Derived classifications, such as grouping a spell under remote attack or tagging a site as a Throne from its source rarity code, remain visibly derived even when the underlying values are source-confirmed.

The register does not reproduce the game's long descriptions or artwork. It records names, identities, mechanical fields, relationships, provenance, evidence status, canonical links, and stable hashes. This makes it useful for search and comparison without turning the website into an unattributed mirror of the game text.

The no-duplication delta

Book V already explains research, casting, rituals, global enchantments, forging, path access, gems, communions, and late-game magic. Book III owns Pretender design, dominion, scales, blessings, and divine continuity. Book VI owns strategic use of Thrones and mercenaries. Book XI owns the interpretation of unit abilities. The present volume does not replace any of those chapters.

Its new contribution is retrieval. It establishes stable object identities, versioned source lineage, cross-object relationships, filter fields, incomplete-data markers, and maintenance rules. A reader looking up what an object is should arrive here or at the register. A reader asking why and when it matters should follow the canonical link to the earlier foundation book.

What the first register contains

Record family	Current records	What is represented
Spells	1,474	All extracted spell rows, including 1,233 researchable or Divine rows and 241 unresearchable or internal rows
Magic items	529	Ordinary forgeable items, Construction 9 artifacts, barding, and special or engine-managed items
Summon relations	549	Spell-to-unit or spell-to-selection-group relationships, including chained effects
Pretender forms	298	Base forms with national availability, body statistics, paths, discounts, and shape links
Thrones	74	Thirty-six level-one, twenty-six level-two, and twelve level-three Thrones
Other magic sites	1,179	Random, capital, national, event, and other non-Throne sites
Mercenary companies	78	Company, leader, troop, era, starting strength, minimum bid, experience, and recovery fields
Independent recruitment	1 coverage marker	The missing population-type relation is documented without inventing an exhaustive catalogue
Special dominions	14	Official system families from the manual, linked to every applicable nation and age

These 4,196 records are not all equally player-facing. Internal spell rows, engine-managed items, and unresolved selection groups are retained because removing them would make version comparisons unreliable. Website defaults should hide such records from a beginner search while keeping them available to researchers and modders.

Part I: The Object-Reference Method

1. An object is an identity, not merely a name

Dominions contains many repeated names. Several forms may share a display name; different items may occupy the same apparent category; a spell may chain into a second hidden spell; a Pretender may transform into another monster record. Names are presentation fields, not primary keys.

Every record begins with three different identities:

- a stable publication ID such as `spell-0200` or `pretender-0109`;
- the engine-facing numeric ID supplied by the extracted data;
- the current display name.

The publication ID supplies durable website links. The engine ID allows comparison with mod commands, inspector entries, debug output, and later patch exports. The name remains essential for readers, but a rename does not have to break links or confuse a changed record with an entirely new one.

For a national guide, this distinction is decisive. A dossier may say that a nation can choose Dagon, but the underlying reference should point to Pretender form 109. If a later patch changes the name or statistics of that form, one object record changes and every dossier importing it receives the corrected fact.

2. Ruleset identity belongs inside every record

A record without a ruleset is unsafe. The same visible object can have different requirements, statistics, or secondary effects under vanilla play, Dominions Enhanced, Divinitus, another balance mod, or a different load order.

The first register uses one ruleset label throughout:

```
vanilla-6.35
```

Modded records will not overwrite that layer. They should later be expressed as additions, replacements, or field-level deltas with their own load-order identity. This preserves a clean answer to three different questions:

1. What does the object do in unmodded 6.35?
2. What does a named mod change?
3. What is the final value after the frozen mod order is applied?

Conflating those questions is one of the fastest ways to make an encyclopedia sound certain while returning the wrong rule.

3. Evidence status belongs beside the field

The register currently uses four public evidence states.

Status	Meaning	Proper use
Official	Directly supported by current official documentation	Special-dominion rules and manual classifications
Source-confirmed	Present in the pinned 6.35 extracted game data	IDs, names, requirements, statistics, site fields, and roster relations
Source-confirmed with unresolved selection	The effect is identified but the engine chooses from a group that is not completely resolved	Certain negative-tag or engine-selected summons
Test-pending	Available sources cannot support a complete current-version claim	Independent population-type recruitment

Source-confirmed does not mean infallible. It means that the value can be reproduced from a named source revision. A contentious value should still be checked against the 6.36 interface, a later official patch statement, or a second current extraction before it becomes the basis of a precise public claim.

4. Record hashes make silent change visible

Each record receives a SHA-256 hash calculated from its normalized fields. The hash is not a gameplay fact. It is an editorial control.

When a future source is imported, unchanged hashes identify stable records. Changed hashes identify objects requiring review. Added and removed IDs identify content changes. This permits a patch audit to concentrate on actual deltas instead of rereading thousands of cards.

A good update report can answer:

- which records changed;
- which fields changed;
- whether the change is official, extracted, or merely a new interpretation;
- which book sections and nation dossiers depend on those records;

- whether a website cache or search index must be rebuilt.

5. Raw fields and interpreted fields serve different readers

The register preserves selected source-native fields under names such as `mechanical_properties` and `extra_attributes`. These are valuable to researchers, but they are not always readable or fully decoded. The same record also carries interpreted fields such as `spell_kind`, `role_tags`, `throne_level`, `tier_class`, or a list of named national restrictions.

The two layers must remain separate. A raw field records what the source said. An interpreted field records what the publication concluded. When an interpretation changes, the source record should not be rewritten to match the conclusion.

6. A ninety-second lookup routine

A beginner need not read every field. Most practical lookups can follow the same order:

1. Confirm the ruleset and version.
2. Confirm the object type and engine ID.
3. Read its access fields: school, path, Construction level, nation, site, or era.
4. Read its cost and delivery fields.
5. Read the principal effect or relationship.
6. Open the canonical chapter for strategic consequences.
7. Check evidence status before relying on an edge case.

This order prevents two common mistakes: judging an object before confirming that the nation can access it, and treating a concise database field as though it contained the entire game rule.

7. The expert audit routine

An expert or editor should add five checks:

1. Inspect the engine ID and any chained or shaped identities.
2. Review source revision and file hash.
3. Distinguish explicit values from derived tags.
4. Compare unresolved attributes against the Modding Manual and current UI.
5. Record any correction as a new claim or revision, never as an undocumented overwrite.

The result is slower than reading a tooltip but much faster than rebuilding the same evidence for every guide.

Part II: Spells

8. Spell rows and player-facing spells are not the same thing

The source contains 1,474 spell rows. Of these, 1,233 belong to a research school or Divine magic and 241 are marked unresearchable or internal. Internal rows can represent helper effects, hidden chains, scenario functions, or other engine work. They should not appear in an ordinary player's search results unless an advanced filter requests them.

The register gives every spell a `public_status`:

- `researchable-or-divine` for schools zero through seven;
- `unresearchable-or-internal` for school minus one.

This is a visibility classification, not a guarantee that every public row is generically available to every nation. National restrictions, realm restrictions, unique casters, and special access still apply.

9. School and research level

School numbers are translated into the current names used by the game:

Source code	School
0	Conjuration
1	Alteration
2	Evocation
3	Construction
4	Enchantment
5	Thaumaturgy
6	Blood
7	Divine
-1	Unresearchable

Research level is preserved separately. A level is not a complete access statement. The real access question combines school level, path requirements, cost, caster availability, national restriction, and sometimes a source or destination condition.

Fifty-nine public rows are flagged at research level nine. The flag supports the game's legendary-spell research option and gives the website a direct filter for the final research tier. Book V remains the canonical home for late-game research planning.

10. Path requirements are thresholds

Each spell record contains zero, one, or two path requirements. A requirement such as Fire 3 means that the caster must reach that threshold at the moment of casting. It does not identify how the threshold is reached.

The access chain may include:

- innate paths;
- communion or sabbath levels;
- path boosters;

- temporary gems;
- empowerment;
- a site bonus;
- a national or Pretender-only caster;
- a transformation or shape with different magic.

Those mechanisms belong to Book V. The record supplies the threshold that the access analysis must meet.

11. Combat spell, ritual, and delivery context

The spell kind is derived from the attached effect record. A ritual and a combat spell can share superficially similar purposes while competing for entirely different resources and timing windows.

A spell record keeps:

- ritual status;
- fatigue cost as extracted;
- gem or slave cost as extracted;
- precision modifier;
- effect count;
- base and per-level range fields;
- base and per-level area fields;
- battlefield percentage where present;
- duration and modifier masks;
- province range attributes where exposed.

Several of these are source-native values rather than finished player prose. A website card should render the common cases clearly but preserve the raw value in an advanced panel. It should not guess how an unfamiliar mask is displayed.

12. Effects, roles, and the danger of one-label summaries

An effect record supplies an effect number and an extracted effect name. The register also adds restrained role tags, including:

- summon;
- damage or disable;
- buff or restoration;
- control;
- dispel;
- remote attack;
- remote assassination;
- strategic movement;
- site search;
- fort construction;
- transformation;
- enchantment;
- province enchantment.

These tags are search aids, not complete tactical judgments. A damaging spell may also create a cloud. A summon may be a battlefield screen, a path break, a raider, or a source of new recruitment. A global enchantment may primarily function as diplomacy rather than raw economy. The canonical chapter should receive the interpretive burden.

13. Chained spells

Some visible spells lead to another spell row through `next_spell`. The second row may hold an additional effect, a terrain-specific branch, or a helper operation. Searching only the first row can miss a summon or secondary consequence.

The importer follows each chain until it ends or repeats. Summon relationships are collected across the chain and attached to the visible root. The hidden rows remain independently addressable, making later patch comparisons possible.

A chain should be read as a graph:

```
visible spell -> effect row -> optional next spell -> optional further effect
```

The graph also explains why name-based scraping is unreliable. The second row may have an internal name that is never shown to a player.

14. National and realm restrictions

The extracted spell-attribute table identifies explicit national restrictions. The register resolves those numeric values into nation name and age where possible. A public website should display the restriction near the spell name rather than burying it below the effect.

Realm-based access is more difficult. The Inspector resolves some of it by comparing spell attributes with national home realms. The initial register preserves the extra attribute but does not claim that every realm rule has been translated into a complete national list. This is a deliberate conservative boundary.

15. Cost fields are not an efficiency verdict

Gem or slave cost is recorded because it is an access fact. It is not enough to rank spells. Efficiency also depends on:

- mage-turn cost;
- research timing;
- caster scarcity;
- battlefield survival;
- expected targets;
- repeatability;
- opportunity cost against forging, empowerment, or another ritual;
- whether the effect creates a reusable asset;
- whether the spell reveals strategic information.

Book V explains those conversions. The database should make them calculable without pretending that one universal score can replace the campaign state.

16. Useful spell queries

Beginner searches should ask one concrete question at a time:

- all public spells in a chosen school and level;
- all spells requiring no more than a nation's current path ceiling;
- all battle buffs for a known army problem;
- all rituals that produce a commander;

- all site-search spells by path;
- all spells marked national for the selected nation.

Expert searches can combine access and role:

- remote attacks that meet a precise province range;
- battlefield-wide effects with a gem cost;
- summons that produce commanders with new paths;
- level-nine spells changed since the previous source revision;
- spells whose effect number or modifier mask remains undecoded;
- visible spells whose hidden chain changed while the root row did not.

Part III: Magic Items, Artifacts, and Barding

17. Item identity and slot type

The first register contains 529 item records. Each one has a numeric ID, current name, slot type, Construction level, path requirements, attached weapon or armour ID where applicable, and a sparse set of mechanical properties.

Slot types include one-handed and two-handed weapons, missile weapons, shields, armour, helmets or crowns, boots, miscellaneous items, and barding. The slot is an equipment constraint, not a promise that every unit with an apparent body part can wear the object. Unit item slots, mount rules, minimum size, minimum strength, hand requirements, crown restrictions, and other item properties can still veto use.

Book XI owns the body and equipment-reading method. Book V owns forging and booster planning.

18. The Construction ladder and special records

The source uses the visible odd-numbered Construction tiers. The current distribution is:

Construction level	Records	Register classification
1, 3, 5, or 7	378	Ordinary forgeable
9	118	Unique artifact
11, 13, or 15	33	Special or engine-managed

The official manual identifies Construction 9 items as artifacts. Values above the ordinary ladder are retained as source facts but are not presented as ordinary forgeable tiers. They include special prizes and engine-managed objects whose acquisition rules must be learned from the relevant event, spell, or scenario.

19. Requirements and actual forge access

An item may list one or two path requirements. Those are necessary thresholds, not a complete forge plan. A nation still needs:

- an eligible commander with appropriate item slots and magic;

- the required Construction research;
- sufficient gems;
- any national or unit restriction to be satisfied;
- freedom from an artifact uniqueness conflict;
- a mage-turn that is worth spending.

The database intentionally does not fabricate forge costs from path levels. Explicit UI or engine-export costs should be added as their own fields when a reliable current source is available.

20. Mechanical properties

Item properties are sparse: only non-empty source fields are retained. This prevents hundreds of meaningless zeroes while preserving unusual effects. Common fields include:

- resistances and reinvigoration;
- path boosts and path-range increases;
- temporary gems or gem generation;
- leadership, research, supply, patrol, siege, and forging bonuses;
- flight, sailing, water breathing, stealth, or map movement;
- regeneration, luck, etherealness, quickness, or defensive skins;
- start-of-battle spells, automatic spells, and item rituals;
- bearer restrictions and minimum body requirements;
- transformations, afflictions, curses, or insanity costs;
- national rebates and special acquisition rules.

A raw property name is not automatically safe prose. Where Book XI or the Modding Manual supplies a dependable meaning, the site can render a human label and link to the canonical ability. Unknown or ambiguous properties should remain visible to expert users with a warning.

21. Boosters as access edges

The most strategically important item searches often concern path access rather than combat equipment. A booster can turn a caster into a node in a larger access graph:

```
native path -> first booster -> higher booster or summon -> ritual threshold
```

The item record provides the requirement and mechanical boost. A separate access calculator can then join it to national mage probabilities, summoned commanders, sites, and empowerment. That calculator should never assume that owning the gems is equivalent to owning the mage-turns or keeping the bearer alive.

22. Artifacts as a world-state race

Artifacts are unique. Their value includes denial, timing, and information. A static item score cannot capture the fact that another nation may forge the object first, that a holder may be killed, or that an artifact may begin yearning under the game's artifact rules.

The register marks artifact identity but leaves artifact-race doctrine in Book V. A future campaign tool can add availability state without modifying the underlying object record:

- uncreated;
- yearning;
- forged by a known nation;
- forged, holder unknown;

- recovered;
- destroyed or otherwise unavailable.

That state belongs to a specific game, not to the base object.

23. Comparing equipment packages

Items should rarely be compared in isolation. The relevant unit, opponent, and battlefield create the package.

A reliable comparison asks:

1. Can the intended bearer equip every piece?
2. Which defence is weakest before equipment?
3. Does the package solve fatigue as well as protection?
4. Does it preserve movement and script reliability?
5. Does it answer the expected damage types and control effects?
6. What is lost if the bearer dies?
7. Would the same gems produce more value as research access, summons, or army support?

The database supplies the object fields. Book IV owns the combat derivation.

Part IV: Summons

24. A summon record is a relationship

A summon is not adequately represented by a spell row or a unit row alone. It is the relationship between them.

Each summon relation currently records:

- the root spell ID and name;
- every directly resolved target unit;
- named selection groups for random, unique, or terrain-dependent results;
- unresolved engine selections;
- the extracted effect count;
- evidence status and source revision.

The target units continue to belong to the unit layer. Their abilities should be read through Book XI, and their battle performance through Book IV.

25. Direct, unique, terrain, and tag-based summons

The importer recognizes several broad forms.

Form	Meaning	Record treatment
Direct unit	Effect points to a positive unit ID	Unit ID and name are resolved
Direct commander	Effect identifies a commander summon	Commander ID and name are resolved
Unique group	One of a finite named group can answer	Every known candidate is listed
Terrain group	Result depends on terrain-specific table	Every known candidate is listed under the terrain group

Form	Meaning	Record treatment
Chained summon	A later spell row supplies an additional summon	Relation is attached to the root and chain retained
Negative monster tag	Engine chooses from a tagged group	Raw selector is retained and marked unresolved unless the current table is known

Twenty-five relations in the first build contain an unresolved selection note. They are not discarded. An incomplete relation with an honest warning is more useful than a neat but false list.

26. Quantity and scaling

The source carries an extracted effect count, but exact quantity can also depend on caster level, special effect rules, random selection, terrain, or a chained effect. The first register preserves the raw count and target relationship without converting every case into a prose formula.

A later verified quantity layer should distinguish:

- fixed base quantity;
- additional units per full path level;
- fractional scaling and rounding;
- commander plus retinue;
- one result selected from a unique pool;
- a variable or random composition;
- temporary battlefield summons;
- permanent strategic summons.

These are separate fields because a single number cannot describe them safely.

27. Summoned units as access and logistics

Summon evaluation begins with role, not statistics alone. Common roles include:

- path extension;
- site searching;
- forging access;
- leadership for magic, undead, or animals;
- siege mass;
- patrol strength;
- raiding and remote presence;
- sacred or bless-compatible force generation;
- amphibious or flying logistics;
- battlefield disruption;
- durable line combat;
- expendable screening.

The database can filter the result set by unit properties. The strategic conclusion still depends on a nation's shortages and timetable.

28. Unique summons are contested resources

Elemental royalty, Demon Lords, and other unique beings are not ordinary repeatable outputs. Their availability depends on what has already been summoned and, in some cases, what has died or returned.

The base register lists the candidate pool. A live-game overlay should track availability as mutable state. The object record should never be altered merely because one campaign has already consumed the unique target.

29. Shape graphs after summoning

A summoned commander may transform on land, underwater, in battle, on death, or through an activated ability. Looking only at the first form can conceal magic paths, item slots, movement permissions, or vulnerabilities.

The proper lookup follows shape links until the graph closes. Book XI explains shape-sensitive ability reading. The current Pretender records expose their major shape links; a later general unit graph should extend the same treatment to every summoned form.

Part V: Pretender Forms

30. Form records and design records

The register contains 298 Pretender forms derived from national availability, home-realm membership, explicit additions, and explicit removals in the pinned data. A form record is not a finished Pretender build. It is the chassis before design choices are applied.

The record includes:

- body statistics;
- starting dominion;
- cost for a new path where extracted;
- innate magic;
- random-magic source fields if present;
- equipment IDs and body properties;
- minimum imprisonment source field where present;
- availability by nation and age;
- nation-specific cheap-god adjustments;
- major shape relationships.

Book III remains the authoritative guide to design points, awakening, scales, blessings, and role construction.

31. Availability is a relation, not a chassis property

Dagon is not an abstract underwater Pretender. It is available to a particular set of nations. Another chassis may be supplied by a home realm, removed from one nation, or discounted for a small family.

The database stores availability as a list of nation records. This makes several questions directly searchable:

- every chassis available to a selected nation;
- every nation that can choose a selected chassis;
- chassis shared across all ages of one cultural line;
- chassis that disappear or appear between ages;
- national discounts on an otherwise shared form.

This relation will prevent future dossiers from repeating a complete chassis inventory in prose.

32. Starting dominion and path cost are only the opening geometry

Starting dominion affects the design-point curve and the chassis's relationship with dominion strength. New-path cost affects the marginal price of diversification. Neither value determines the best build on its own.

A complete design must still price:

- awakening state;
- desired blessing thresholds;
- scales and national economic interaction;
- expansion reliability;
- research and forging access;
- the risk of chassis death;
- whether the chassis must be mobile, stealthy, amphibious, or present on the battlefield;
- whether special dominion systems reward stronger candles.

The record supplies the immutable chassis facts. Book III supplies the engineering method.

33. Innate paths, purchased paths, and shape changes

Innate paths belong to the current form. Purchased paths belong to the designed god. Shape changes can alter the body and may change how paths or equipment are used. The reference keeps innate paths and shape links separate.

When a chassis has multiple forms, the design audit should inspect:

- which form appears on the strategic map;
- which form fights;
- whether items remain equipped;
- whether a form is aquatic or land-capable;
- whether protection, regeneration, or movement changes;
- whether death or transformation is reversible.

No single thumbnail can carry this information safely.

34. Cheap-god relations

Some nations receive a twenty- or forty-point adjustment for named chassis. These discounts are stored as nation relations on the chassis record, not baked into a universal chassis cost.

This matters because the same form can be ordinary for one nation and economically distinctive for another. A website Pretender planner should apply the discount only after nation selection and should display its source rather than silently changing the price.

35. Useful Pretender queries

Beginner filters:

- all chassis available to the selected nation;
- awake candidates with a desired body type;
- immobile candidates;
- chassis beginning with a required magic path;
- chassis capable of operating underwater.

Expert filters:

- national discounts combined with path-cost breakpoints;
- chassis whose shape graph changes equipment access;
- chassis shared by likely opponents;
- forms with a special dominion interaction;
- version deltas in availability or innate paths;
- designs whose required path thresholds can be met by fewer purchased levels.

Part VI: Thrones and Magic Sites

36. Thrones are sites with victory meaning

The extracted site table marks Thrones with rarity codes eleven, twelve, and thirteen. The register interprets these as Throne levels one, two, and three. The first build contains:

- 36 level-one Thrones;
- 26 level-two Thrones;
- 12 level-three Thrones.

They are removed from the ordinary site array and placed in their own Throne collection, so a website search does not double-count them. Their site identity remains intact.

Book VI owns Throne strategy, claiming, endgame conversion, and Cataclysm. The register owns the exact Throne objects and their effects.

37. Claimed and unclaimed fields

Site data can distinguish ordinary gem income from income granted after a Throne is claimed. It can also contain recruitment, scales, dominion effects, ritual modifiers, strength or resistance effects, unrest, population, supply, and other province changes.

A Throne card should visually separate:

- presence before claiming;
- effect after claiming;
- units or commanders available at the site;
- province or dominion changes;
- strategic risks created by the effect.

The database preserves the source fields but does not infer ownership timing for every unusual attribute. Where the manual or UI is required, the card should carry a verification note.

38. Site classes

The non-Throne collection contains 1,179 sites. The first classification uses the source rarity code:

- codes zero, one, or two: random discoverable sites;
- code five: special, capital, national, or event-managed sites;
- any other non-Throne code: retained as other until verified.

This classification helps search but should not be mistaken for a complete generation formula. Map terrain, site frequency, age, national starts, events, and scenario design can all shape actual presence.

39. Search level and path

Random sites commonly expose a path and search difficulty. Those fields answer two separate questions:

- which path can find the site;
- what search strength is required.

Site-search spells, remote search, and manual searching interact with those facts through rules explained in Book V. A site record should never imply that a nation can exploit it merely because the site exists. Access may still require a laboratory, a fort, a priest, a commander with suitable leadership, or control of the province.

40. Location masks

The register decodes known location bits into readable terrain labels:

- plain;
- forest;
- mountain;
- waste;
- farm;
- sea;
- coast;
- swamp;
- deep sea;
- cave;
- underwater mountain;
- underwater forest;
- underwater coastal;
- unique.

The raw mask is retained beside the decoded list. If a later source adds a bit that is not yet understood, the raw value survives the import and the decoder can be extended without losing evidence.

41. Site income is not the whole site value

Gem income is the easiest site effect to compare, but it is often not the most important. Sites can provide:

- commanders or troops;

- path access;
- laboratories or forts;
- research or ritual modifiers;
- supply, resources, gold, or recruitment points;
- unrest, disease, horror, or population effects;
- province defence;
- dominion or scale changes;
- unique summons or adventures.

The value of a site depends on who owns it and whether the nation can exploit the granted access. The database makes the fields visible; Book II and Book V explain the economic and magical conversions.

42. Duplicate names and site identity

Several sites share a display name. An Academy of Magic in one path or terrain is not safely identified by name alone. Engine ID, path, location mask, and mechanical properties distinguish the records.

Website URLs should use stable IDs. Search results may group matching names for readability, but opening the card must reveal the numeric identity and distinguishing fields.

43. Throne comparison queries

Useful Throne searches include:

- all Thrones at the selected game level;
- claimed gem income by path;
- effects that change scales, unrest, population, or dominion;
- Thrones granting recruitable commanders;
- effects that alter ritual levels or Call God;
- Thrones whose effect can harm the owner as well as rivals;
- Throne records changed by a patch.

The query result is an intelligence aid, not a prediction of which Thrones the map generator selected.

Part VII: Mercenaries and Independent Recruitment

44. Mercenary company records

The register contains 78 mercenary companies. Each record joins the company to current unit identities and retains:

- company and commander name;
- commander unit;
- troop unit;
- starting troop count;
- minimum surviving strength;
- minimum bid;
- starting experience;

- random and fixed equipment fields;
- recruitment recovery rate;
- era mask resolved to Early, Middle, and Late Age availability.

The minimum bid is not the expected winning bid. The strategic value depends on competition, timing, map position, morale, equipment, and the opportunity cost of gold. Book II owns the economic comparison and Book VI owns the tempo decision.

45. Mercenary attrition and continuity

A company is not equivalent to buying a permanent national production line. Losses, recovery rate, contract timing, and rebidding shape its value. The record preserves the source fields needed for that analysis.

A practical mercenary card should answer:

1. What does the company add immediately?
2. Which roles does the national roster lack?
3. How many casualties can the company sustain before it becomes strategically irrelevant?
4. Does the commander add a useful path, leadership type, or item?
5. Is the bid buying expansion tempo, emergency defence, siege mass, or denial?

46. Why independent recruitment remains a marked gap

Independent province recruitment is strategically important, but the pinned 6.35 Inspector extract does not expose a population-type membership table. It contains current unit records but cannot prove which units and commanders each independent population type makes recruitable.

Older community catalogues describe generic humans, tribes, Amazons, cave peoples, mages, and other independent families. Carrying those tables forward as though they were a complete 6.35 export would violate the project's evidence standard. The first register contains one coverage marker instead of a fabricated list.

The marker records:

- what is missing;
- why the available source cannot prove it;
- what reliable evidence would close the gap;
- where current unit statistics can be joined once membership is known.

This is unfinished work, but it is controlled unfinished work.

47. The acceptable route to a current independent catalogue

The gap can be closed by either:

- a version-matched engine export of population types and recruit lists; or
- a published 6.35 reproduction giving population type, terrain and age conditions, unit IDs, commander IDs, and a repeatable method.

Once available, the data should be stored as relationships:

```
population type -> terrain and age conditions -> recruitable units and commanders
```

The units themselves should remain in the shared unit layer. Independent records should not copy their full statistics.

48. Evaluating independent access without a complete catalogue

Until the table is verified, campaign analysis can still evaluate a discovered province from the in-game recruitment panel. The useful questions are:

- Does the province repair a national weapon, armour, missile, leadership, or priest gap?
- Is the unit gold-, resource-, or recruitment-point efficient for that role?
- Does the province need a fort, temple, or laboratory before the key unit appears?
- Can production continue under likely unrest or siege pressure?
- Is the province strategically defensible enough to justify infrastructure?

The observation belongs to the current game. It should not be generalized into a universal population-type record without evidence.

Part VIII: Special Dominion Systems

49. Why special dominions are database objects

Special dominions combine national identity with religious territory. They are neither ordinary unit abilities nor ordinary scale effects. The official manual gives them a dedicated section because they change what candles mean.

The register stores fourteen system families. Each record contains:

- a stable system identity;
- every applicable nation and age;
- a concise mechanical list paraphrased from the manual;
- the disciple inheritance rule;
- the official source locator;
- a canonical link to this volume and Book III.

Exact national strategy remains dossier work. The shared system should be written once.

50. Official system register

System	Nations or ages	Core effect	Disciple boundary
Dominion scrying	Arcoscephale, all ages	Accurate reports inside dominion, including Glamour detection	Information is shared with disciples
Dying dominion	EA and LA Mictlan	Ordinary passive spread fails; blood sacrifice becomes central	Dying dominion does not transfer
Temple Oni	EA Yomi	Temples generate Oni according to Turmoil, terrain, and temperature	Does not transfer
Dreamlands	LA R'lyeh	Insanity, madmen, and Void Dreamer development	Extends into disciple lands with only partial protection

System	Nations or ages	Core effect	Disciple boundary
Ashen Empire	MA Ermor	Population death, undead arising, and corpse awareness	Applies to disciples
Carrion Woods	MA Asphodel	Population death and Carrion animation	Applies to disciples
Miasma	MA C'tis	Rain, disease, terrain change, and asymmetric income pressure	Disciples are treated mostly as enemies; sacreds are immune
Golem Cult	MA Agartha	Constructs gain Hit Points	Helps allied and enemy constructs inside the dominion
Additional blood sacrifice	Seventeen named nation-age entries	Blood sacrifice supplements ordinary dominion spread	Does not transfer, but an innately capable disciple keeps the order
Dark Ships	MA Phaeacia	Commanders sail when origin and destination have friendly dominion	Does not transfer; disciple-led Phaeacia still uses it
Spectral dominion	EA Therodos	Population decline and fort-generated ghosts	Applies in disciple games
Dominion conflict	EA Mekone	Maximum dominion counts one higher when suppressing enemy faith	No transferred rule stated in the manual
Dominion unrest	MA and LA Phlegra	Covered provinces gain unrest, increasing with local strength	Operates through disciples only when Phlegra is the Pretender nation
Concealed provinces	Ubar, Na'Ba, Ind, and Feminie	Hides ownership and name behind a false independent appearance	Disciples benefit

51. Local strength, presence, and maximum dominion

Special systems depend on different religious variables. They must not be described with the vague phrase "stronger dominion helps" unless the source actually says so.

- Yomi needs the presence of at least one candle for temple generation, but the number of candles does not increase that generation; Turmoil does.
- Phlegra's unrest rises more with higher local dominion strength.
- Mekone modifies effective maximum dominion in a conflict calculation.
- Dark Ships tests whether origin and destination lie in friendly dominion.
- Miasma acts on covered provinces but treats ownership, sacred status, terrain, and underwater location differently.

The controlling variable must be an explicit record field in the next schema revision. Until then, it remains in the verified mechanic list.

52. Beneficiaries and victims

Special dominions often affect more than the owning nation. The manual explicitly describes cases involving disciples, enemies, allies, or every suitable object in the province.

The Golem Cult illustrates the danger. Constructs gain Hit Points in the dominion even when they belong to an enemy. A rule that sounds like a national bonus is actually a territorial modifier. The difference changes invasion planning and counter-selection.

Every future special-dominion record should expose four separate audiences:

- owner;

- disciple or ally;
- enemy;
- neutral or universal objects.

53. Permanent and reversible effects

Some systems change a province while it is covered. Others consume population, alter terrain, generate units, or accumulate insanity and unrest. Their consequences can outlast the candles that caused them.

A national dossier should distinguish:

- immediate reversible modifiers;
- accumulating but recoverable pressure;
- permanent terrain change;
- population conversion or destruction;
- generated units that persist after dominion changes;
- information effects that end when concealment ends.

This distinction belongs to the national application, not the shared one-line system record.

54. Disciples are an explicit field, not an afterthought

The official manual repeatedly states whether a special dominion transfers, partially transfers, or affects disciple lands without becoming the disciple nation's own ability. The register preserves that statement separately.

Team advice that ignores this field can recommend a pairing whose economy or armies are damaged by the master. MA Ermor, Asphodel, C'tis, R'lyeh, and Phlegra all require more than a generic "special dominion" warning.

Part IX: Website and Research Use

55. The publication contract

`base-object-register.schema.json` defines the top-level contract. Every build must contain:

- schema version;
- edition and generation date;
- vanilla 6.35 structured-snapshot declaration with a visible 6.36 live-baseline overlay;
- evidence key;
- scope and deliberate exclusions;
- source manifest;
- per-category counts;
- the nine record collections.

Core record fields include stable ID, object type, name where applicable, ruleset, evidence status, source IDs, canonical section, verification date, and record hash.

The schema is intentionally strict at the collection level and permissive inside the specialist records. The source contains hundreds of rare fields. Prematurely forbidding an unfamiliar property would encourage data loss. Later schema revisions can tighten well-understood object families while retaining an escape hatch for raw source fields.

56. Default search views

A public site should provide at least three views.

Guide view

Guide view hides internal spell rows, raw masks, unknown attributes, hashes, and source-file detail. It shows access, cost, principal effect, evidence badge, and a link to the canonical chapter.

Advanced view

Advanced view exposes engine IDs, effect numbers, chained records, raw selectors, unusual item properties, site masks, and record hashes. It is intended for expert play, modding, and research.

Change view

Change view compares two source revisions and lists added, removed, and changed records by field. It should also show which nation dossiers or canonical sections depend on the changed object.

57. Filters that should exist at launch

Family	Essential filters
Spells	Public status, school, level, paths, kind, role, cost, national restriction, legendary flag
Items	Slot, Construction level, artifact class, paths, path boost, movement, economy, restriction
Summons	Spell school, spell level, target type, unique group, resolved status, unit abilities
Pretenders	Nation, age, starting dominion, path cost, innate paths, discount, movement class, shape links
Thrones	Level, path income, claimed effect, recruitment, scales, dominion, population, unrest
Sites	Path, search level, terrain, rarity class, gem income, recruitment, ritual or research effect
Mercenaries	Age, troop type, commander, starting strength, minimum bid, experience
Special dominions	Nation, age, controlling variable, beneficiary, disciple transfer, permanent effect

58. Related-object links

The website should make object relationships visible without copying pages.

- A summon spell links to every possible unit.
- A summoned unit links back to every producing spell.
- A Pretender links to its available nations and shape forms.
- A site links to recruitable units and commanders.
- A mercenary links to its leader, troop, and fixed items.
- A special dominion links to each applicable nation dossier.
- A national spell links to the nation and its research branch.

These links turn the library into a graph rather than a stack of articles.

59. Example website questions

The object layer can answer questions that are awkward in prose:

- Which Nature rituals create commanders rather than troops?
- Which Construction 5 items increase path access?
- Which level-two Thrones grant commanders or research effects?
- Which Pretender chassis are shared by two selected nations?
- Which mercenary companies exist in the Middle Age and begin with experienced troops?
- Which sites can appear underwater and grant recruitable commanders?
- Which special dominions harm disciples or enemies as well as helping the owner?
- Which summon relations remain unresolved in the current evidence set?

The answer can then link to strategy rather than embedding a generic recommendation in every object card.

60. Nation dossier integration

A dossier should not print a complete copy of every national spell, Pretender, summon, and site. It should select the records that matter to the nation's plans and add only national analysis.

A clean dossier entry can contain:

- object ID and short name;
- why the nation can access it;
- the timing branch it enables;
- the national role it fills;
- likely counters or failure modes;
- links to the base record and canonical rule chapter;
- modded delta where relevant.

This is the foundation that allows nation work to resume without creating hundreds of duplicate fact paragraphs.

Part X: Verification and Maintenance

61. Import controls

The importer refuses an unexpected upstream commit unless an explicit refresh flag is supplied. This protects the frozen 6.35 baseline from a silent pull of later data.

The source manifest records:

- repository URL;
- commit and date;
- commit subject;
- source licence note;
- SHA-256 hashes for every imported table;
- official manual identity and hash.

The build also confirms category counts, stable ID uniqueness, required fields, record-hash length, and internal JSON validity.

62. Cross-source verification

The source hierarchy for object work is:

1. current official manual or patch statement;
2. current in-game UI or exact engine export;
3. pinned 6.35 extracted data;
4. a published reproduction with method and version;
5. community summary or strategic commentary.

Lower layers can discover a question. They do not silently overrule a higher layer. When the manual and extraction disagree, both values should be recorded and the public field marked unresolved until the current UI or patch history settles it.

63. Known limitations of the first build

The first build is deliberately incomplete in several places.

- Independent population-type membership is absent.
- Twenty-five summon relations contain an unresolved engine selection or monster-tag group.
- Some source-native item and site properties lack polished human labels.
- Realm-based spell access is preserved in attributes but not completely expanded into nation lists.
- Unit descriptions, spell descriptions, item descriptions, and artwork are excluded.
- The register does not yet contain every weapon, armour, unit, event, or nation record because those have separate ownership or future schemas.
- Source-confirmed values have not all received an independent UI check.

These limitations are part of the publication, not hidden production notes.

64. Correction workflow

When an error is found:

1. Record the object ID, field, current value, proposed value, and ruleset.
2. Attach the strongest available source and exact locator.
3. Decide whether the source extraction, importer, interpretation, or prose is wrong.
4. Correct the narrowest authoritative layer.
5. Regenerate hashes, search indexes, and dependent pages.
6. Add a revision note when the public meaning changed.
7. Preserve the earlier version for patch comparison.

This workflow avoids the common failure in which a number is corrected in one article while copies remain wrong elsewhere.

65. Patch refresh workflow

A later official patch should be processed as a controlled migration:

1. archive the current manifest and register;
2. import the new exact-version data into a separate build;

3. compare record hashes;
4. classify each delta as addition, removal, rename, mechanical change, or extraction change;
5. compare the official patch note with the observed delta;
6. update canonical prose only where the general rule changed;
7. update nation dossiers only where national conclusions changed;
8. publish a version digest and redirects for renamed objects.

The full official patch ledger remains the next separate structured-data project after this object layer.

66. Mod overlay workflow

Dominions Enhanced and Divinitus should be applied as versioned overlays, not folded into the vanilla records.

An overlay record should identify:

- base object ID, if an existing object is selected;
- mod source file and line;
- load-order position;
- field additions, replacements, and clears;
- newly allocated ID where known;
- unresolved automatic allocation where not known;
- final combined value after every earlier mod is applied.

Book IX already establishes the frozen mod order and collision discipline. The base object register now supplies the vanilla side of that comparison.

Essay I: Object Literacy Is Strategic Literacy

Dominions is often described as a game of hidden knowledge. The phrase is only partly true. Much of the knowledge is visible, but it is distributed across cards, paths, schools, shapes, national rosters, sites, rituals, and turn timing. The difficulty lies less in secrecy than in joining the pieces quickly enough to make a decision.

An object database does not remove judgment. It removes avoidable retrieval cost. A player who can immediately find every ritual that produces a Death commander can spend time comparing risk, timing, and price. A player who cannot find the candidates must rely on memory, and memory tends to preserve famous options while losing narrow or recently changed ones.

The same principle applies to counterplay. An unfamiliar item need not remain a mystery if its slot, resistances, automatic spells, movement changes, and bearer restrictions can be read in one place. The strategic question then becomes concrete: which part of the package creates the threat, and which part can be denied?

Object literacy also improves restraint. Easy access to a catalogue makes it tempting to select the most impressive card. A well-designed reference pushes in the opposite direction by showing access costs and relationships. The object exists inside a conversion chain. Research, gems, mage-turns, infrastructure, position, and risk all stand between possibility and effect.

The strongest use of the database is not encyclopaedic display. It is careful exclusion. Filters can remove options the nation cannot reach, afford, deliver, or exploit in time. The remaining set is small enough for genuine strategic reasoning.

Essay II: Versioned Facts and Reproducible Judgment

A strategy library becomes unreliable when it treats facts as timeless. Dominions patches can change a requirement, cost, unit, site, or exception. Mods can replace the same object again. A remembered truth may remain broadly sensible while its numerical premise has expired.

Versioned records solve only half of that problem. They can show what changed, but not whether the old recommendation still works. That requires reproducible judgment.

A good recommendation names its premises. It identifies the ruleset, object IDs, national access, research timing, costs, expected opponent, and intended role. When a patch changes one premise, the conclusion can be retested without reconstructing the original argument from memory.

This also improves disagreement. Two players may recommend different summons because they assume different map sizes, gem incomes, research rates, or enemy compositions. With explicit records and assumptions, the disagreement becomes informative rather than rhetorical.

The library's long-term value will not come from claiming finality. It will come from making correction cheap, visible, and local. Stable identities, source manifests, evidence labels, and record hashes turn a correction from an editorial crisis into routine maintenance.

Part XI: Practical Reference Sheets

67. Object-card minimum fields

Object	Minimum public card
Spell	Name, ID, school, level, paths, combat or ritual, cost, role, restriction, evidence
Item	Name, ID, slot, Construction level, paths, principal properties, restrictions, artifact state, evidence
Summon	Producing spell, possible units, selection rule, quantity status, permanence, evidence
Pretender	Name, ID, nations, starting dominion, path cost, innate paths, body, forms, discounts, evidence
Throne	Name, ID, level, claimed effects, income, recruitment, risks, evidence
Site	Name, ID, path, search level, terrain, income, recruitment, other effects, evidence
Mercenary	Company, leader, troop, age, strength, minimum bid, experience, recovery, evidence
Special dominion	System, nations, controlling variable, beneficiaries, victims, disciple rule, evidence

68. Beginner lookup checklist

- Confirm vanilla or modded ruleset.
- Search by name, then confirm engine ID.
- Check access before effect.
- Check cost and timing before enthusiasm.
- Open linked rules when a field is unfamiliar.
- Treat source-confirmed and unresolved badges differently.
- Use the current game interface when a campaign decision turns on an edge case.

69. Expert comparison checklist

- Compare stable IDs and record hashes between versions.
- Inspect chained spells and shape graphs.
- Separate raw fields from publication-derived tags.
- Resolve national and realm restrictions.
- Join summons to current unit records.
- Join sites to terrain and ownership conditions.
- Model mutable campaign state outside the base record.
- Record uncertainty instead of normalizing it away.

70. Editorial no-duplication checklist

- Search the Reader's Guide and object register before drafting.
- Link to Book II for economy, Book III for Pretenders and dominion, Book IV for combat, Book V for magic, Book VI for strategy, and Book XI for abilities.
- Add a new paragraph only when it explains an object-specific exception, application, correction, or evidence result.
- Keep complete inventories in data, not prose.
- Use one stable object ID across every dossier and essay.
- Update the source record once, then regenerate dependants.

71. What this unlocks

The base-game object layer is now substantial enough to support the next phases without returning to repeated manual research.

It unlocks:

- object-aware nation dossiers;
- vanilla-versus-DE-versus-Divinitus comparison pages;
- spell, item, summon, Pretender, Throne, site, and mercenary filters;
- cross-object search and access graphs;
- patch-by-patch record comparison;
- automatic detection of changed national recommendations;
- a reliable boundary between verified facts and unresolved engine behaviour.

The remaining G-03 work is narrow and explicit: resolve independent population types, close the twenty-five summon selection gaps, improve human labels for rare properties, and expand realm restrictions. None of those gaps prevents the current register from serving as the reusable foundation for the website and later dossiers.

Source Record

Official sources

- Illwinter Game Design, Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, especially Magic Sites, Mercenaries, Pretenders, artifacts, and Special Dominions, pp. 28-36, 79-88, and 100-116.
- Illwinter Game Design, Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34, for object selection, IDs, properties, sites, population types, spells, items, and national relations.
- Illwinter Dominions 6 documentation.

Version-matched extracted source

- Dominions 6 Data Inspector repository, commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbc036ba9bd5dc`, "Update to 6.35," 26 May 2026.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector, used as a public cross-check for the extracted object families.

Project artefacts

- `website/base-object-register.json` - 4,196 versioned records.
- `website/base-object-register.schema.json` - publication contract.
- `tools/build_base_object_register.py` - pinned, reproducible importer.
- `18-foundation-coverage-gap-audit.md` - ownership and G-03 definition.
- Book III - canonical Pretender and special-dominion rules.
- Book V - canonical magic, research, ritual, and forging method.
- Book VI - canonical Throne, mercenary, and campaign strategy.
- Book XI - canonical unit and ability interpretation.

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Foundation Book XIII: Version History and the Official Patch Ledger

Ruleset, purpose, and evidence boundary

Book XIII belongs to the unmodded Dominions 6.36 ruleset. Its history begins with the public 6.01 update of 19 January 2024 and ends with 6.36, released on 17 August 2026 UTC. Dominions Enhanced 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE remain separate rulesets. Their changes are not folded into the official chronology, even where a mod later adopted or anticipated a similar rule.

The official announcements contain 1,090 individual change bullets across 32 named updates. Book XIII turns that material into two complementary resources:

- a readable account of how the live ruleset developed;
- `website/official-patch-ledger.json`, a machine-readable record of every official bullet, its release, source locator, source hash, editorial classification, affected domains, and canonical library destinations.

The ledger does not reproduce the full wording of the announcements. Each record identifies its official source and preserves a hash of the normalized source bullet. The public layer adds only a restrained summary and editorial metadata. This keeps the history verifiable without making the project a mirror of Illwinter's publication.

The source of record is the complete official Dominions 6 announcement feed exposed through Steam, checked against the official announcement archive and the Illwinter Dominions 6 site. The official documentation page remains the authority for the main manual and the separate modding, event, map-making, and file-format manuals.

The no-duplication delta

Earlier books own the rules themselves. Book I owns ruleset labels and hosting order. Books II through VI own economy, religion, combat, magic, and campaign conduct. Book VIII owns mod construction. Book X owns operation and hosting. Books XI and XII own ability and object lookup. Repeating those explanations release by release would make the library harder to maintain.

Book XIII owns a different question: when did the current rule become current, what older statement did it displace, and which part of the library must be reviewed when it changes?

This produces a firm editorial boundary:

- use Book XIII to establish chronology, provenance, and change impact;
- use the linked foundation book to understand the current mechanic;
- use the official announcement when exact source wording is necessary;
- use a historical executable or preserved save only when a past-version interaction itself is under study.

The patch ledger is not a second combat guide, spell guide, or modding manual. It is the maintenance record that shows when another guide may have become stale.

What the ledger contains

Measure	Current result	Meaning
Official update announcements	32	Every public announcement titled Dominions 6.01 through Dominions 6.36 in the official feed
Individual change records	1,090	One record for every bullet under General, Modding, Map Making, or a named national section
First dated release	6.01, 19 January 2024	The first public post-launch update in the feed
Current baseline	6.36, 17 August 2026 UTC	The version used by this edition
Public version numbers without a matching announcement	4	6.10, 6.20, 6.22, and 6.26
Distinct `#commands` named in update bullets	226	A chronology link to the complete command lexicon in Book XIV
High-confidence editorial classifications	820	Records whose wording strongly identifies the change family
Medium-confidence classifications	20	Records with a probable family but weaker wording
Review-recommended classifications	250	Official records whose automated topic label should be checked before fine-grained publication

The four absent numbers are described only as numbers without matching public announcements. They are not called missing releases. A private build, skipped label, withdrawn build, or unannounced numbering decision cannot be distinguished from the public feed alone.

Part I: Reading Versioned Rules

1. The current rule and its history are different facts

A current rules reference should normally state the rule that applies now. A version history should state how that rule arrived. Mixing the two produces avoidable ambiguity.

Consider regeneration. A current ability entry should explain how regeneration behaves in 6.36. The historical note that version 6.31 changed percentage regeneration from bracketed results to a more exact percentage calculation matters when evaluating an older guide, battle report, or saved test. It does not need to interrupt every ordinary explanation of regeneration.

The same separation applies throughout the library:

Question	Proper home
What does this mechanic do in 6.36?	Its canonical foundation book
Which update changed it?	Book XIII and the patch ledger
What did the official announcement say?	The linked official update
How did it behave in a preserved older executable?	A version-labelled historical test
Does DE or Divinitus change it again?	Book IX or the later mod overlay

This division keeps ordinary reading smooth while preserving enough history to repair old claims.

2. A version label has five parts

The phrase "current Dominions" is too weak for durable research. A useful version label contains:

1. Game version. Here the baseline is Dominions 6.36.
2. Ruleset. Vanilla, DE, Divinitus, or a named combined load order must be explicit.
3. Manual revision. The main manual and auxiliary manuals do not necessarily advance together.
4. Data revision. Extracted object data needs its own commit, date, or hash.
5. Publication date. The date distinguishes a genuinely current statement from an undated page that merely uses present tense.

A concise public label can read:

```
Dominions 6.36, unmodded; official updates through 17 August 2026 UTC;
object data pinned separately; page reviewed 20 August 2026.
```

The full evidence record can then hold source hashes and tool versions without burdening the reader-facing sentence.

3. Patch notes are deltas, not replacement manuals

An update bullet usually assumes knowledge of the prior state. It may say that an effect now works during a siege, that a restriction was removed, or that a statistic was corrected. It rarely restates all eligibility rules, timing, exceptions, and downstream interactions.

Three consequences follow.

First, a patch bullet cannot safely be expanded beyond what it says. "Can now" proves a newly permitted case; it does not prove that every adjacent case works the same way. Second, a corrected bug can become part of ordinary current rules even when the old behaviour was never documented. Third, several bullets may jointly define the current state of one mechanic.

The editorial task is a merge:

```
current rule = surviving manual rule
+ later official deltas
+ current object data where appropriate
- superseded or corrected statements
```

The terms in that expression do not have equal authority. The manual and official updates are direct official evidence. Extracted data is version-pinned supporting evidence. A community test can resolve behaviour the documents do not expose, but its version and method must remain attached.

4. Four common patch-reading errors

4.1 Treating a bug as a permanent rule

An old battle report may accurately show what an earlier executable did. If the behaviour was later fixed, the report remains historical evidence but ceases to be a current rule source. The distinction is especially important for communions, mounted units, shape changes, retreat, remote rituals, and blessings, all of which received repeated corrections.

4.2 Treating a wording change as a mechanical change

Presentation, tooltip, message, and statistics-display corrections may reveal a rule more clearly without changing how it resolves. A revised icon does not automatically mean a revised ability. A display correction may instead expose a mechanical value that was already active. The ledger keeps presentation, interface, data correction, rule change, balance change, and bug fix separate.

4.3 Treating an added command as a fully documented command

An announcement can establish that a mod command exists. It does not necessarily provide its complete syntax, selection context, legal values, copying behaviour, clearing behaviour, or error handling. Those belong in the current Modding Manual and the future command lexicon.

4.4 Treating a missing number as a missing source

The public sequence skips 6.10, 6.20, 6.22, and 6.26. Nothing in the feed establishes why. The correct statement is narrow: no official announcement with any of those four titles appears in the complete app-news response used for this edition.

5. Which old claims deserve immediate review

A patch does not make every old guide equally unsafe. The highest review priority belongs to claims that determine legality, access, irreversible resource spending, survival, or multiplayer administration.

Review priority	Claim type	Typical consequence of being stale
Critical	Order legality, host validation, save integrity, exploit prevention	Failed turn, rejected order, corrupted workflow, unfair game state
High	Spell access, ritual targeting, communion behaviour, retreat, transformation, siege permissions	Lost mage, wasted gems, failed operation, destroyed army
High	Bless cost or activation, Pretender status, recruitment restriction	Invalid design or roster plan
Medium	Unit cost, item effect, Throne effect, site output	Mispriced strategy or inaccurate comparison
Medium	Interface shortcut, message, filter, overview	Avoidable operational friction
Low	Sprite, sound, typo, graphical effect	Little or no strategic error unless identity is obscured

This priority order controls the maintenance queue. It does not claim that a low-priority correction is unimportant to the quality of the game; it means the correction is less likely to invalidate strategic advice.

Part II: The Complete Official Release Spine

6. Release density and what it reveals

The update history is front-loaded. Twenty-one announcements and 774 of the 1,090 recorded changes appeared in 2024. Eight announcements and 222 changes appeared in 2025. Three updates in 2026 contribute the remaining 94 changes through the present baseline.

Calendar year	Announcements	Change records	Share of all records
2024	21	774	71.0%
2025	8	222	20.4%
2026 through 17 August	3	94	8.6%

This is not a measure of importance. A short later update can change a central rule. It does show why undated launch-era guides require careful repair: most of the public delta history accumulated during the first year.

7. The 2024 release sequence

Version	Date	Records	Historical profile
6.01	19 Jan	33	First balance and correctness pass; global-enchantment attacks were detached from NAP restrictions, and several roster and transformation problems were corrected.
6.02	24 Jan	29	Research and object corrections, hosting work, and the rule that dormant gods do not age while dormant.
6.03	25 Jan	17	Siege and NAP interaction, AI diplomacy, lobby research, and repeatable `#natcom` and `#natmon` use.
6.04	2 Feb	60	Broad bug-fix release with blessing, event, AI, hidden-map, national recruitment, and mod-command additions.
6.05	9 Feb	41	Combat-fatigue and lasting-HP corrections, recruitment fixes, resource-information privacy, prophet recovery, and hosting stability.
6.06	11 Feb	6	Small hotfix led by coastal-fort recruitment and network correction.
6.07	16 Feb	35	Lobby reversion to setup, siege-cast remote ritual repair, broader scale modding, and ammunition-fatigue mod support.
6.08	6 Mar	102	Largest announcement in the ledger: major Asphodel revision, extensive rules and UI repair, many commands, and important changes to Twiceborn, passive blessings, Fear and Dread, empowerment, and site searching.
6.09	12 Mar	18	Focused fixes to movement abilities, summons, items, networking, and mod commands.
6.11	20 Mar	24	Manikin and object work, roster corrections, and additions including `#hidedom`.
6.12	29 Apr	89	LA Pyrene, a large rules pass over disciples, communions, remote rituals, map targets, transformations, events, and modding.
6.13	15 May	52	Besieged-fort teleport targets, random preaching order, NAP siege movement, major experience changes, interface work, and new event/global commands.
6.14	16 May	5	Immediate correction release, including experience-related hit-point statistics.
6.15	29 May	33	Grand Communion, victory-graph handling, illusion and false-damage rules, communion gem correction, and event-variable expansion.
6.16	18 Jun	29	Fort-ritual repair, mercenary-screen operation, settlement and transformation work, plus map and event modding fixes.
6.17	20 Jun	3	Settings compatibility, vanilla gem-longevity default correction, and lobby connection tracking.
6.18	9 Jul	24	Undying healing, starvation removal after non-eating transformation, underwater and multiplane-map work, and defensive file handling.
6.19	26 Aug	38	Afflicted-mount reclaiming, blessing and item fixes, underwater cases, and notable event, fort, ritual, and nation commands.

Version	Date	Records	Historical profile
6.21	10 Oct	26	Income-overview improvements, siege and mount fixes, lobby retention policy, rebirth behaviour, cave growth, and map-editor repair.
6.23	3 Dec	53	A substantial balance and rules pass touching Fear, Dread, Asphodel, mounts, communions, events, research requirements, and terrain-linked recruitment.
6.24	17 Dec	57	Ind, new Thrones and a spell, combat and ritual restrictions, order copying, large-file networking, terrain recruitment, and a broad mod-command set.

8. The 2025 release sequence

Version	Date	Records	Historical profile
6.25	15 Jan	29	Praise, Pillar of Truths, battle-version display, indoor battlefield-wide spell restrictions, temperature display, and mount and bless corrections.
6.27	7 Mar	42	Seven new Thrones, treasury autosort, disease-spell resistance, Haunted Forest and Utterdark revision, ritual target validation, AI work, and new battle-summon commands.
6.28	8 Mar	4	Hotfix for Call God, event-producing rituals, map item spells, and scripted AI priority.
6.29	22 Apr	47	Planar ritual boundaries, order copying with `0`, allied-territory waiting, large-battle performance, communion backlash, AI ritual improvements, and many mod commands.
6.30	6 Oct	53	LA Zemaitia, Fay additions, lab-to-commander gem shortcuts, new Pretenders, many combat and movement corrections, larger network turns, and ritual-loop detection.
6.31	20 Oct	19	Exact percentage regeneration, longer wall enchantments, higher bless-effect limit, faster hosting, underwater Creeping Doom, and mounted/event fixes.
6.32	13 Nov	10	Mounted gateway crash fix, secondary-shape Soul Slay, remote Blood Vengeance loot restriction, Farstrike targeting, and `#forcess`.
6.33	16 Dec	18	Faster map rendering, cheat detection, barding and yearning fixes, AoE explanations, several unit corrections, and `#homerealm`.

9. The 2026 release sequence

Version	Date	Records	Historical profile
6.34	27 Feb	44	Fay summons and Pretenders, ritual-message and ability-icon work, AI corrections, automatic summons during siege, rebirth healing, security repair, and performance improvements.
6.35	18 May	24	Gnu content and the Throne of Violence, script resumption for innate casters, victory reveal behaviour, teleport movement from besieged forts, interface additions, mount recovery, and integrity fixes.
6.36	17 Aug	26	Touchscreen operation and research shortcuts; blessing-load, river-crossing, mount, Rust, Lost Land, and battle-replay corrections; five new event commands and a spell `spec2` bitmask.

10. The absent public numbers

No matching official announcement was present for 6.10, 6.20, 6.22, or 6.26. The ledger preserves that fact in `scope.unannounced_version_numbers`. These labels are intentionally excluded from the release table and from any inferred chronology.

A future source may explain one or more gaps. If that happens, the correction should add the source and revise the scope note. It should not silently manufacture release dates or change bullets from forum recollection.

Part III: The Classification and Evidence Model

11. One official bullet becomes one patch record

Every source bullet receives a stable record ID. `patch-6-35-015`, for example, identifies the fifteenth bullet in the normalized 6.35 announcement sequence. A record contains:

- version and publication date;
- official section and bullet index;
- source announcement identity and URL;
- SHA-256 of the source bullet and of the normalized record;
- editorial change class and confidence;
- affected domains;
- direction and materiality;
- named `#commands`, terms, and object mentions where detected;
- canonical destinations elsewhere in the library;
- a concise impact summary that does not reproduce the source text.

The ID is a publication key, not an official Illwinter identifier. The official source identity remains separate.

12. The fourteen change classes

Class	Records	Share	Editorial meaning
Bug fix	256	23.5%	A stated malfunction or inconsistency was corrected.
Rule or permission change	197	18.1%	Legality, timing, targeting, immunity, or behaviour changed.
Balance adjustment	162	14.9%	Cost, strength, chance, quantity, or comparative value changed.
Modding behaviour change	115	10.6%	Existing mod or parser behaviour changed or was repaired.
Mod-command addition	82	7.5%	One or more new `#commands` were announced.
Interface or quality of life	77	7.1%	A screen, shortcut, display, filter, or workflow changed.
Performance or stability	43	3.9%	Speed, memory, crash resistance, or hosting stability improved.
Artificial intelligence	40	3.7%	Strategic or spellcasting AI behaviour changed.
Network or hosting	36	3.3%	Lobby, server, connection, transfer, or turn-file behaviour changed.
Data correction	31	2.8%	Statistics, text-linked data, or object records were corrected.
Content addition	21	1.9%	A named nation, unit, spell, item, Throne, Pretender, or similar object was added.

Class	Records	Share	Editorial meaning
Presentation	20	1.8%	Graphics, sound, animation, text rendering, or appearance changed.
Security or integrity	8	0.7%	Cheat detection, exploit handling, validation, or corrupted-data handling changed.
Map-making change	2	0.2%	A map-making-only change was identified outside broader modding treatment.

These are navigation classes, not official headings. A single bullet can reasonably touch several ideas. The record stores one primary class to keep filters usable, then adds multiple affected domains.

13. Domain tags are many-to-many

A remote ritual that crosses planes, targets a besieged fort, spends gems, and moves an army may touch magic, movement, maps, hosting order, and interface messaging at once. Forcing it into one subject would hide the cross-system risk.

The most frequently tagged domains are:

Domain	Records carrying the tag	Canonical interpretation home
Modding	198	Book VIII
Magic and spells	173	Book V and Book XII records
Maps and scenarios	161	Book VIII
General game objects	156	Book XII
Combat	150	Book IV
Summons and transformations	122	Books V, XI, and XII
Operations and interface	95	Book X
Presentation	72	Book XIII maintenance layer
Hosting and network	67	Book X
Items and artifacts	68	Books V and XII
Events	68	Book VIII
Nations and rosters	57	Book VII dossier system
Movement and logistics	55	Book VI
Units, abilities, and conditions	54	Book XI
Dominion and blessings	50	Book III

Domain totals exceed 1,090 because one record can affect several domains. That overlap is a feature: it identifies which books and website records must be reviewed together.

14. Classification confidence is not source confidence

All 1,090 source bullets are official. The uncertainty concerns only the project's derived labels.

Label	Records	Meaning
High	820	Wording contains a strong signal such as "fixed," "new," "now," a command, an AI reference, or an explicit interface term.

Label	Records	Meaning
Medium	20	The broad family is probable, but wording is less diagnostic.
Editorial review	250	Source identity is settled; the fine-grained class should be checked before relying on it as an analytic statistic.

The review queue does not make the ledger incomplete. Every official bullet has an identity, source, hash, release, domain route, and public locator. The queue limits how confidently the automatically assigned category may be used.

An editorial correction changes the classification and record hash. It does not alter the source hash. This makes interpretation changes visible without pretending that the official announcement changed.

15. Materiality is contextual

The automated materiality field uses three coarse levels: major, notable, and maintenance. It is only a triage aid.

A one-line change to retreat legality can decide a multiplayer game. A new nation is obviously major content but may have no effect on a match where that nation is absent. A crash fix is critical to hosts running the affected setup and irrelevant to everyone else. Consequently, publication pages should combine materiality with domain, object identity, and reader task.

The strongest practical filter is often:

```
version range + domain + current canonical page + player-facing status
```

This finds changes that can invalidate a specific page without claiming a universal rank.

Part IV: Player-Facing Changes That Commonly Make Guides Stale

16. Economy, recruitment, and provincial state

Most economic formulas were stable enough to remain in Book II, but several surrounding permissions and displays changed.

16.1 Information and privacy

Version 6.05 stopped players from seeing resources already used inside another player's fort. This is an information rule, not an income formula. Old advice that assumes direct inspection of an enemy production queue is unsafe.

Version 6.21 made the income overview easier to audit, including colour coding and the display of zero-upkeep units. Version 6.18 corrected the omission of national income bonuses from Thrones in that overview. These changes affect diagnosis: a modern screen can reveal costs or bonuses that an older screenshot does not show.

16.2 Recruitment geography

Coastal-fort recruitment received corrections in 6.05 and 6.06. Later releases adjusted foreign recruitment in caves, reef-warrior availability, cave Province Defence, terrain-linked national recruitment, and underwater fort defence. Any roster claim must state both the nation and terrain context.

16.3 Borders and traced income

Version 6.30 stopped income from being traced through impassable borders. This is strategically important on unusual maps and multiple-plane layouts. Book II owns the current economic interpretation; Book XIII establishes when older connectivity assumptions became stale.

16.4 Population and events

Version 6.24 corrected a possible population overflow and made Conscription depend on the Order scale. Version 6.30 stopped Bringer of Fortune from producing events while under siege. These are narrow changes with wide planning consequences: scale value, siege economy, and event engines cannot be evaluated from launch-era behaviour alone.

17. Pretenders, dominion, disciples, and blessings

17.1 Dormancy and divine continuity

Version 6.02 established that gods do not age while dormant. Version 6.28 repaired Call God when invoked without the shortcut. Several releases corrected Pretender age, prophet replacement, resurrection, Twiceborn, Life after Death, and shape-related divine status.

The lesson is not that divine recovery is unreliable. It is that old demonstrations need their version attached, particularly where immortality, shape changes, mercenary status, or underwater laboratories are involved.

17.2 Passive and incarnate blessings

Version 6.04 changed Reconstruction from passive behaviour. Version 6.08 corrected the treatment of passive blessings outside friendly dominion: Pretenders no longer lost those passive effects merely by leaving dominion. Several releases repaired the displayed incarnate status or omitted bless effects.

Version 6.36 repaired a different layer: cancelling a loaded Pretender could leave that design's bless effects loaded. This belongs to setup-state integrity, not battlefield activation. Book III now separates those layers explicitly.

A blessing page needs three independent checks:

1. design legality and cost;
2. activation rule in the current version;
3. whether the interface correctly displays the active effect.

An interface omission is not proof that the effect is absent, and a displayed icon is not proof that every edge case resolves correctly.

17.3 Fear, Dread, and overlapping effects

Version 6.08 stopped Fear and Dread from stacking with each other. Version 6.23 revised their bless costs and capped the morale reduction attributable to Fear by the effect's value, with an upper limit stated in the announcement. This is a classic stale-guide trap: cost, stacking, and combat outcome changed at different times.

17.4 Experience and heroic value

Version 6.08 reduced the experience gain from the Heroism blessing. Version 6.13 added rare heroic abilities, limited battle-participation experience to once per month, granted Magic Resistance at five stars, and granted additional hit points at three stars and beyond. Version 6.14 immediately corrected related hit-point statistics.

Book XI owns the current experience and heroic reference. The patch history explains why older tables may disagree.

17.5 Disciples and religious state

Version 6.12 allowed diplomacy to continue through the first disciple when the Pretender was dead. Version 6.13 preserved dominion and ascension graphs while disciples remained alive. Version 6.24 allowed Pretender Throne sensing to reveal the site for disciples. Version 6.34 increased the maximum number of teams in disciple games.

These are multiplayer-state rules, not only interface conveniences. Disciple guides should be reviewed whenever team, death, diplomacy, graph, or Throne rules change.

18. Combat, fatigue, morale, and retreat

18.1 Fatigue delivery

Version 6.05 stopped a ranged weapon with a fatigue cost from adding the user's encumbrance to that cost. Version 6.15 corrected cases where communions consumed too many gems to reduce fatigue. Later releases corrected fatigue from flight, trampling, Earthquake, and scripted communion casting.

The practical danger is false arithmetic. An old calculator can be internally consistent and still model a superseded rule.

18.2 Lasting hit-point loss and equipment

Version 6.05 stopped never-healing wounds and similar maximum-hit-point reductions from reducing hit points supplied by armour. Version 6.16 repaired Undying interactions with the Shroud of the Battle Saint. Version 6.34 corrected shields against certain weapon blessings. These changes sit at the boundary between unit body, equipment, blessing, and damage resolution; all relevant layers must be checked together.

18.3 Illusions, false damage, and spirit forms

Version 6.15 allowed false damage to cause an HP rout and prohibited illusions from casting Phoenix Pyre. Version 6.30 repaired illusions harming one another, changed how spirit-form states interact with bleed, frozen, and burning effects, and corrected illusions disappearing at battle start. Older shorthand such as "false damage is harmless" or "ethereal is the relevant tag" is too crude for current play.

18.4 Morale and Fear

Fear's current cap arrived in 6.23. Version 6.27 stopped mindless units from receiving false damage when repelled. Version 6.30 made gods and prophets unable to fail the retreat morale roll. These are different layers: resistance to morale effects, repel consequences, and the retreat check should not be collapsed into one immunity claim.

18.5 Indoor and terrain restrictions

Version 6.25 prohibited battlefield-wide spells indoors, except Holy spells. Version 6.31 allowed Creeping Doom underwater. Every spell package that depends on cave, indoor, underwater, or planar conditions should include terrain legality as well as research and path access.

Version 6.36 also made Rust take effect when its damage packet caused no damage. That correction is a warning against treating "no HP loss" as proof that a secondary condition failed to apply.

19. Magic, communions, rituals, and global enchantments

19.1 Communions changed repeatedly

Communion-related deltas appear throughout the history:

- version 6.12 removed the communion-slave effect when a unit was thrown out of a communion;
- version 6.15 introduced Grand Communion and corrected excessive gem use in some fatigue-reduction cases;
- version 6.16 repaired missing Grand Communion ability entries on certain heroes;
- version 6.23 improved AI handling of multiple communion types;
- version 6.27 made `#aibadlvl` communion-aware;
- version 6.29 repaired communion backlash;
- version 6.30 corrected conservative-gem communion masters failing to attempt higher-level spells.

A communion guide without a version is unsafe even when its basic path-boosting explanation remains sound.

19.2 Remote rituals and targets

Version 6.07 repaired several remote attacks cast from a besieged fort. Version 6.12 stopped gem expenditure when a commander was the target of a remote attack ritual. Version 6.13 allowed teleport items and gems to target besieged forts. Version 6.27 added ritual host-target validation. Version 6.29 blocked most rituals from tracing across void and non-void planar boundaries. Version 6.32 changed Farstrike-style targeting toward the largest enemy army in a province.

Each change affects a different part of a remote operation:

Layer	Question
Origin legality	Can the caster act from the current province or siege state?
Path and cost	Can the caster meet the requirements and pay?
Route	Can the effect cross the relevant plane or boundary?
Destination legality	Is the target province valid?
Target selection	Which army, unit, or object is selected inside it?
Host validation	Will the order survive final processing?
Message and evidence	What report proves success, interception, or failure?

This checklist is more durable than memorising one patch sentence.

19.3 Global enchantments and layered counters

Version 6.01 separated global-enchantment attacks from NAP restrictions. Version 6.27 revised Utterdark and Haunted Forest. Version 6.30 allowed Arcane Decree to block Astral Disruption completely and allowed Sea of Ice to coexist with nexus-gate use. Version 6.34 stated that domes may protect against Astral Disruption and corrected Eternal Twilight's effect on resources.

Global strategy is consequently both political and versioned. A guide must distinguish the enchantment's current rule, the counters available in the same version, and the diplomacy settings of the match.

19.4 Rebirth and secondary forms

Version 6.12 stopped Life after Death commanders from becoming feebleminded in the corrected case. Version 6.24 prohibited Ritual of Rebirth on spirit-form beings. Version 6.27 made Lichcraft remove an existing Twiceborn enchantment. Version 6.32 made Soul Slay kill units with secondary shapes properly. Version 6.34 made Ritual of Rebirth remove most afflictions.

The current state cannot be derived from one of those bullets alone. Book V explains the access and strategic uses, Book XI explains the relevant conditions and forms, Book XII identifies the objects, and Book XIII supplies the chronological merge.

20. Movement, mounts, sieges, and planes

Mounted systems were among the most frequently corrected cross-object mechanics. The history includes sacred mounts, rider-bless interaction, floating mounts, afflicted mount recovery, siege retreat, unique event mounts, barding slots, gateway crashes, remount orders, and automatic recovery.

20.1 Siege exits and entries

Version 6.13 allowed certain teleport targets inside besieged forts and made it legal to move an army into NAP-protected forces besieging the mover's fort. Version 6.35 allowed commanders with teleport movement to leave a besieged fort. These statements are not interchangeable. Targeting a fort, entering a siege, and moving out of one are separate permissions.

20.2 Planar boundaries

Version 6.08 prevented return from the Void from placing a unit inside a cave wall. Version 6.12 stopped province-granting wishes from selecting empty cave-wall provinces. Version 6.29 restricted ritual tracing across void and non-void boundaries. Version 6.30 corrected global attacks against cave-wall provinces.

Multiple-plane maps turn topology into a rule layer. An apparent adjacency or province identity does not guarantee a legal magical route.

Version 6.36 extended Perpetual Storm's movement-cost increase into caves and underwater provinces and allowed Gift of Water Breathing to protect against Lost Land. Both are narrow corrections with large operational consequences: the environment of origin and destination must be included in route and survival audits.

20.3 Mount recovery

Version 6.19 allowed commanders to reclaim afflicted mounts. Version 6.21 repaired mounts retreating after fort defence. Version 6.30 corrected a reclaim order that could cause fall damage. Version 6.35 made mount return automatic at the end of the turn in the applicable case. Book I owns the end-of-turn timing; Book XI owns mounted identities; Book XIII shows why older manual procedures may now be unnecessary or wrong.

Version 6.36 added three more boundaries: a swimming mount is sufficient for river crossing, a tavern-charmed knight's mount changes side with the rider, and repeated recruitment of mounted commanders no longer creates the corrected queue-removal charge. These changes involve movement, allegiance, and recruitment state respectively; none establishes a universal rider-to-mount inheritance rule.

21. Interface and operating changes

Interface changes are strategically important when they reduce error rates.

Notable additions include:

- lobby reversion to setup in 6.07;
- colour-coded income review and zero-upkeep visibility in 6.21;
- copying and pasting army-position orders in 6.24;
- treasury autosort in 6.27;
- universal order copy/paste with the `0` key in 6.29;
- direct laboratory-to-commander gem transfers and repeated bless selection in 6.30;
- area-of-effect explanations in 6.33;
- the F1 pillage filter and related operational improvements in 6.35;
- touchscreen mode, long-click right-click emulation, drag scrolling, ten-point Province Defence changes, research-target navigation, research help, temporary-summon hiding, and spell-filter clearing in 6.36.

These belong in Book X as current procedure. Their history remains here so an older screenshot or tutorial can be interpreted correctly.

22. Hosting, networking, security, and integrity

The official history records repeated work on lobby connections, game retention, map upload and download, large turn files, large-game hosting speed, corrupt files, illegal orders, exploit prevention, and cheat detection.

A fair hosting standard should require:

1. an agreed executable version;
2. exact mod versions and load order;
3. a preserved setup sheet;
4. turn and save backups appropriate to the hosting method;
5. a documented response to version changes during a running game;
6. use of current validation rather than a claim that an old exploit is still possible;
7. a distinction between a client display problem and a host-resolution problem.

Version 6.24 repaired handling for turn files above an earlier network threshold. Version 6.30 further improved larger turn-file handling. Versions 6.33 and 6.34 added integrity and exploit corrections. A host diagnosing an old report should begin with version and file size before treating it as a current rules dispute.

Version 6.36 repaired a battle-replay inconsistency that could follow viewing an earlier battle beyond round 99. This is especially important for evidence capture: a replay mismatch is not automatically proof that the host resolved the battle differently, and current-version reproductions should begin from a fresh viewing sequence.

23. Artificial intelligence changes

Forty records were classified primarily as AI changes, with additional AI-relevant records under modding and other domains. They address siege behaviour, blood hunting, bless selection, gem preparation, research, preaching, ritual laboratories, dispels, Arcane Analysis, communion types, range buffs, target selection, and many spell preferences.

The correct conclusion is limited. The AI is not a static opponent, and old difficulty reviews may describe obsolete priorities. The patch notes do not establish that the AI now plans like an expert human. They establish particular improvements or corrections.

AI claims should use one of three forms:

Claim form	Evidence needed
Capability	Official bullet or current repeatable observation that the AI can perform the action
Preference	Versioned behavioural sample large enough to distinguish a tendency
Competence	A clearly defined task and comparative benchmark, not an impression from one game

This keeps official improvements from being inflated into unsupported strategic promises.

Part V: Modding and Command Chronology

24. Why patch history is indispensable to modders

The auxiliary manuals are versioned documents. The update stream can add a command, repair its parser, extend legal arguments, change an object limit, or alter runtime behaviour before the next manual revision is available.

Across the 32 announcements, 226 distinct `#commands` are named. Some bullets announce several commands at once; some commands appear again because their behaviour was later extended or fixed. The chronology answers three questions that a static manual cannot answer alone:

1. When did this command enter the public ruleset?
2. Was it later repaired or extended?
3. Which manual baseline is old enough that the command may be absent?

It does not answer the complete syntax question. That is the purpose of the next structured foundation, the command lexicon.

25. Command families visible in the update stream

The official bullets span most major modding surfaces.

Family	Representative chronology
National recruitment and terrain	Forest, coast, sea, deep, kelp, plain, cave, scale-linked fort, and non-capital fort recruitment commands accumulated across multiple releases.
Monsters, mounts, and shapes	Bug shapes, battle summons, barding and rider behaviour, forced secondary shapes, realms, tolerance, Fay summoning, and reclaim-related systems expanded over time.
Spells and rituals	AI modifiers, indoor restrictions, home realms, size and Twiceborn costs, mass teleport effects, new target controls, and ritual safety checks were added or changed.
Events	Research and path requirements, realm requirements, fort identities, nation-number variables, optional sites, unit variables, and repeated variable operations expanded the event language.
Items and weapons	Defence and morale rolls, Fay summoning, Praise, unseen status, ammunition-fatigue behaviour, protection parts, and new effect controls appeared in the chronology.
Maps and sites	Site copying, multiplane repair, terrain validation, gates, province insertion, and source-target realm controls developed alongside the map editor.
AI templates	Bless compatibility, research goals, communion-aware bad-spell ratings, and spell-assessment controls received explicit attention.

These descriptions are deliberately family-level. Exact command names, selectors, arguments, defaults, clearing semantics, version introduced, version changed, and minimal examples belong in the future lexicon.

26. The command-lexicon record required next

Each command should eventually receive a record containing:

Field	Purpose
Command	Exact `#name`
Current manual	Manual and revision in which it is documented
Selection context	Nation, monster, weapon, armour, spell, item, site, event, map, or general scope
Arguments	Count, types, ranges, sentinel values, and defaults
Repeatability	Whether repeated use appends, replaces, toggles, or errors

Field	Purpose
Copy and clear behaviour	Interaction with #copy, inherited values, and clear commands
Introduced	Earliest official update or manual in the evidence set
Changed	Later updates that repaired or extended it
Example	Minimal valid source block
Failure mode	Common parser or runtime mistake
Evidence	Official manual page, update source, and any bounded reproduction

The patch ledger already supplies introduced-or-mentioned candidates and official URLs. The lexicon must add manual parsing and context, not duplicate the whole patch history.

27. Safe treatment of post-manual commands

When an update introduces a command that is absent from the locally pinned manual, the public entry should state:

- that existence is official from the update;
- that syntax is documented only to the extent supported by current official material;
- that any additional example is derived from inspected source or a controlled test;
- that older game versions may reject the command;
- that a mod using it should declare a minimum Dominions version.

This avoids a common failure in mod guides: copying a working example and presenting every inferred argument as official syntax.

Part VI: Repairing Stale Guides and Maintaining the Library

28. The stale-guide repair workflow

The repair process begins with a claim, not with a whole document.

1. Extract the claim. Reduce the sentence to its subject, rule, value, and conditions.
2. Pin the guide's date or version. If neither is available, mark the claim undated.
3. Search the ledger forward. Filter from the guide's probable version through 6.36 by domain, named term, command, and canonical page.
4. Open every plausible official source. A classification hit is a lead, not proof that the claim changed.
5. Merge the deltas in order. Later official changes supersede earlier ones where they address the same state.
6. Check the current canonical book. Confirm that the library's ordinary explanation matches the resulting rule.
7. Check current object data. Use Book XII when the claim includes an ID, cost, path, statistic, or roster relation.
8. Preserve uncertainty. If the surviving rule is still incomplete, add or update a research-register item.
9. Record the repair. Store old claim, new claim, source release, affected pages, and review date.

This is slower than changing every sentence containing a keyword. It is much faster than allowing contradictory rules to accumulate.

29. A worked repair pattern: regeneration

Suppose an older guide describes regeneration through hit-point brackets and claims that a one-hit-point boundary can sharply increase the amount restored.

The repair trace is:

1. subject: regeneration calculation;
2. old source: guide predating October 2025;
3. ledger hit: version 6.31;
4. official delta: regeneration became accurate to the percentage value rather than the older bracket behaviour;
5. canonical home: Book XI's ability reference, with combat consequences in Book IV;
6. update: replace the bracket claim in current prose, retain a short version note where an older test is discussed;
7. dependent records: unit and item comparisons relying on boundary exploitation require recalculation.

The patch note supplies the transition. It does not by itself supply every rounding detail. If exact rounding remains unverified, that question stays explicit.

30. A worked repair pattern: besieged-fort teleportation

An old guide might state broadly that teleportation cannot interact with a besieged fort.

The chronological repair finds at least two distinct deltas:

- version 6.13 allowed teleport items and gems to target besieged forts;
- version 6.35 allowed commanders with teleport movement to move out of besieged forts.

The old sentence is too broad. The current replacement must distinguish targeting into the fort from teleport movement out of it. Book VI receives the operational rule; Book I supplies hosting context; Book XIII preserves both dates.

31. A worked repair pattern: communions

A communion guide written at launch may remain correct about path boosting but wrong about slave removal, gem conservation, Grand Communions, backlash, AI casting, or item support.

The correct repair is modular:

Subclaim	Relevant releases
Removal from communion	6.12
Grand Communion existence	6.15
Excessive gem spending correction	6.15
Missing hero ability	6.16
AI confusion between communion types	6.23
Communion-aware `#aibadlvl`	6.27
Backlash correction	6.29
Conservative-gem master casting	6.30

Each subclaim is updated in its own canonical paragraph. The guide does not need an eight-entry patch diary in the middle of the teaching sequence.

32. Dependency-driven maintenance

Every patch record carries canonical section IDs. These create a reverse index from change to affected publication area.

```
official update
-> patch records
-> domains and object mentions
-> canonical book sections
-> website pages and dossier imports
```

When a new update arrives, the maintenance process should produce:

- added, changed, and removed patch records;
- affected domains;
- affected object IDs where resolvable;
- canonical pages requiring review;
- unresolved classifications;
- newly named commands for the lexicon;
- a publication note describing what was actually revised.

This is the central reason to preserve hashes. A future import can prove which records are unchanged and direct human attention to the real delta.

33. Updating the official feed safely

The importer at `tools/build_official_patch_ledger.py` can rebuild the data layer from a saved official Steam news response or the current endpoint. A safe update follows this sequence:

1. preserve the previous JSON and its hash;
2. retrieve the complete official feed;
3. identify official update announcements by exact title pattern;
4. parse sectioned list bullets without importing comments or marketing articles;
5. compare announcement identities, dates, source hashes, and record counts;
6. fail closed if an older source unexpectedly disappears or changes;
7. classify new records and place uncertain labels in review;
8. validate the JSON against its schema;
9. review canonical links and command mentions;
10. publish the new ledger only with a matching game-baseline update.

The current importer asserts the known 6.36 completeness totals. Those assertions must be intentionally revised for a later baseline; bypassing them would remove the main guard against a partial feed.

34. Website uses

The public website can expose the ledger through several views without reproducing patch prose.

34.1 Release page

Show date, record count, class distribution, leading domains, and a link to the official announcement. Records can be grouped by source section and linked to canonical current pages.

34.2 Topic history

For a subject such as communions, retreat, mounts, or Thrones, show a chronological list of matching records with concise summaries and official locators. The current-rule page remains visually primary.

34.3 Stale-page warning

If a library page has not been reviewed after a later matching patch record, display a maintenance flag. The warning should say that review is due, not that the page is necessarily wrong.

34.4 Version comparison

Given two public versions, list intervening records by domain and class. This is a delta list, not a simulation of the older executable.

34.5 Command chronology

Expose commands named by each release and link them to the future lexicon. The patch record proves mention; the lexicon supplies syntax.

35. Publication cautions

The website should not:

- present editorial classifications as official categories;
- claim that absent public numbers are missing releases;
- display a hash as though it proves mechanical correctness;
- turn a one-line official delta into an invented complete rule;
- silently merge vanilla and modded histories;
- mark an old page wrong merely because a related record exists;
- reproduce the complete patch-note wording;
- hide review-recommended classifications from maintainers.

Part VII: Essays on Versioned Knowledge

Essay I: A Rule Without a Version Is Not a Complete Rule

Dominions invites timeless language. Armour reduces damage. Communions raise paths. A besieged fort restricts movement. Regeneration restores hit points. Such statements sound like permanent laws because they describe systems rather than content.

In a living strategy game, even a durable rule has a date. The underlying idea may survive while its boundary cases move. Regeneration can keep its name and strategic purpose while its calculation changes. Communions can remain communions while slave removal, gem use, backlash, and AI handling are corrected across several releases. Teleportation can keep its name while permissions around besieged forts expand in separate directions.

Versioning is not a scholarly ornament attached after the real work. It is part of the rule's conditions. A statement about Fire 3 already contains a threshold. A statement about a cave already contains terrain. A statement about 6.36 contains time.

This does not mean that every sentence needs a parenthetical patch number. Good writing keeps the current rule readable and places chronology where it resolves a real ambiguity. The version belongs in the page baseline, the evidence record, and any sentence that would otherwise conflict with a still-circulating older claim.

The most dangerous unversioned statements are not always obscure formulas. They are confident operational rules: an order is impossible, a ritual always spends a gem, a unit cannot retreat, a blessing remains passive, a target cannot be reached. Players build turns around categorical claims. When a patch changes one, the old sentence becomes more harmful than a missing statistic.

A versioned library behaves differently from a conventional guide. It preserves stable current teaching, while every claim has a route back to evidence and forward to maintenance. An official change is treated as a dependency event. The history of a rule stays separate from the rule now in force. This allows the library to say both "this is how 6.36 works" and "this older report was accurate when written" without forcing one to erase the other.

That is the deeper value of a patch ledger. It is not a museum of old notes. It is the mechanism that lets knowledge remain current without losing its memory.

Essay II: Bug Fixes Are Strategic History

Balance changes attract attention because their intent is visible. A unit becomes cheaper. A blessing becomes more expensive. A new Throne appears. Strategy writers naturally discuss the altered comparison.

Bug fixes are easier to dismiss as housekeeping. That is a mistake. A bug can define the apparent rule for every player who encountered it. If a communion failed to apply backlash, an item effect survived removal, a remote ritual selected the wrong target, or a mount behaved incorrectly during retreat, players adapted to the behaviour whether or not it was intended.

Once fixed, the behaviour acquires two identities. Historically, it was an observable property of the earlier version. Currently, it is a rejected state. Both facts matter. The first explains old reports and established habits. The second governs new play.

This makes bug fixes strategically significant in three ways.

First, they can invalidate empirical knowledge. A careful test may become obsolete without ever having been poorly designed. The version must travel with the result.

Second, they change risk. An interaction that once failed intermittently may become dependable; an exploit that once offered an advantage may become illegal or detectable; a crash-prone operation may become safe enough for ordinary use.

Third, they reveal system boundaries. Repeated fixes around mounts, shapes, communions, besieged forts, and planes show where several object models meet. Those areas deserve stronger test matrices and more cautious prose, not because the engine is unknowable, but because a one-object explanation is insufficient.

The correct editorial response is not to preserve every bug in the current chapter. It is to keep the ordinary rule clean, link consequential history, and retain the old behaviour only when it explains a source conflict or a still-common misconception.

Bug fixes are strategic history. They record what players could rely on, what they learned to fear, and what later ceased to be true.

Essay III: Maintenance Is Part of Authorship

A large strategy library can fail while every individual essay remains elegant. The failure occurs when pages stop sharing a baseline. A combat article uses launch behaviour, a nation dossier imports a current unit cost, a modding example requires a later command, and a hosting guide assumes an earlier file limit. Each page may sound reasonable. Together they describe no game that ever existed.

Maintenance solves this by treating the library as a dependency system. Canonical books own explanations. Structured registers own identities and deltas. Dossiers apply the common rules. A patch does not trigger a general rewrite; it triggers a bounded review of affected dependencies.

This approach also improves the prose. A chapter does not need to repeat every exception defensively when it can rely on stable cross-references and a visible baseline. Historical detail moves to the patch ledger. Exact object fields move to the object register. The main argument becomes easier to read because the maintenance record carries the bookkeeping.

Authorship in such a system includes deciding what not to repeat, recording uncertainty, and making future correction inexpensive. A finished paragraph is not the endpoint. The endpoint is a paragraph that can be found, tested, revised, and propagated when its evidence changes.

Part VIII: Practical Reference

36. Reader's patch-check routine

When an old guide or discussion appears to conflict with the current library:

1. record the guide's date, stated version, ruleset, and mods;
2. isolate the disputed claim;
3. search the patch ledger from that version onward;
4. read the linked official announcements;
5. check the current canonical book;
6. check current object data where the claim is numerical;
7. treat unresolved behaviour as a research question rather than a vote between authors.

37. Author's pre-publication version audit

- Is the game version visible?
- Are mods and load order visible?
- Is the manual revision appropriate to the claim?
- Have later official updates been searched?
- Is an old empirical test tied to its executable version?
- Are object values tied to a pinned data revision?
- Does each rule have one canonical explanatory home?
- Are historical deltas kept out of ordinary prose unless they resolve confusion?
- Are editorial classifications described as editorial?
- Are unresolved cases linked to the research register?

38. Host's mid-game update decision

Before changing executable version during a multiplayer game, record:

Question	Why it matters
Does the update change order legality or hosting?	Existing turns or procedures may resolve differently.
Does it change a nation, spell, item, bless, or Throne present in the game?	Competitive value may shift unevenly.
Does it repair an exploit or integrity problem?	Remaining on the old version may be riskier than updating.
Does it alter mods or command support?	The active mod set may fail or behave differently.
Are all players able to update and verify the same files?	Mixed clients undermine reproducibility.
Is a rollback path preserved?	A failed migration should not destroy the campaign.

The decision belongs to the game's agreed administration. The patch ledger supplies the relevant delta; it does not impose a social rule on the group.

39. Maintainer's new-release checklist

1. Archive the new official announcement and retrieval metadata.
2. Rebuild the ledger and confirm the prior 1,090 records remain stable unless an official source changed.
3. Validate every new record and release against the schema.
4. Review all new `#commands` against current manuals.
5. Resolve named objects against the base object register.
6. Review canonical pages reached by the new domain tags.
7. Run duplicate and voice checks on revised prose.
8. Rebuild website indexes, redirects, coverage, and research registers.
9. Rebuild and visually inspect the PDF.
10. Publish a bounded change note: what changed, what was reviewed, and what remains open.

40. Source and verification record

Source	Role in this volume	Evidence status
Official Steam announcement archive	Public release chronology and official change bullets	Official
Official Dominions 6.36 announcement	Current release delta and the 26 new ledger records	Official
Illwinter Dominions 6 site	Current game-update confirmation and publisher identity	Official
Official Dominions 6 documentation	Main and auxiliary manual baselines	Official
Steam app-news response archived for this edition	Complete machine-readable announcement feed and source hashes	Official feed, locally preserved
`website/official-patch-ledger.json`	Derived record identities, classifications, domains, commands, and links	Official source with editorial derivation
`website/official-patch-ledger.schema.json`	Publication and validation contract	Project schema
`tools/build_official_patch_ledger.py`	Reproducible import and completeness assertions	Project method

41. Explicit limitations

The current release closes the official-feed collection gap, but it does not claim more than the sources permit.

- The ledger records public announcements, not undocumented internal builds.
- The four absent public numbers are not assigned invented dates or content.
- The full official bullet text is not republished in the public JSON.
- Two hundred fifty fine-grained classifications remain marked for editorial review; source identity and completeness are unaffected.
- Command mention does not equal complete command documentation.
- Patch notes do not replace controlled tests for mechanics they leave unspecified.
- Historical behaviour is not reconstructed without the matching executable or a preserved reproduction.
- Vanilla history is not silently merged with DE, Divinitus, or any other mod.

What this unlocks

Book XIII completes the first full official version spine for the library. Every public update announcement through 6.36 is represented, every official bullet has a stable record and source locator, every record routes toward a canonical foundation, and the current ruleset can now be checked against the history that produced it.

Book XIV reconciles the 226 distinct named commands with the current official manuals. Five 6.36 event commands remain official patch-only entries because the announcement names them without supplying full syntax; their provenance is preserved without inventing arguments or parser context.

DOCUMENT 16 OF 16

Foundation Book XIV: The Command and Terminology Lexicon

Official syntax, context, provenance, and search discipline

The job of this volume

Dominions modding is written in a compact language whose commands often look self-explanatory. That appearance is deceptive. A token can be correctly spelled and still be unusable because it appears outside the right object block, follows the wrong selector, carries the wrong argument form, relies on an undocumented expansion, or belongs to a newer executable than the manual that a project was built against. A patch announcement can prove that a command existed or changed without explaining its complete syntax. A current manual can list a token without describing its behaviour. Several different object types can even use the same command spelling for different fields.

Book XIV provides the reference needed to navigate that language. Its main subjects are:

- official command spellings and syntax locators;
- object context and command-domain classification;
- current-manual, reference-list, mention-only, template, and patch provenance;
- controlled reconciliation of patch-note shorthand and spelling discrepancies;
- safe lookup, testing, versioning, and maintenance procedures;
- a complete searchable locator for the current official manuals;
- a website-ready command register with stable records and aliases.

Book VIII remains the canonical explanation of parser state, object design, events, maps, AI scaffolding, compatibility, and testing. Book XIII remains the canonical release chronology. Book XIV does not repeat either volume. It answers a narrower question: what exactly is this token, where is it officially located, what kind of evidence supports it, and which chapter owns the surrounding design problem?

The result serves two audiences at once. A new modder can identify the right manual and avoid common syntax traps. An experienced maintainer can search by command, domain, version, patch record, template expansion, documentation status, or canonical destination without manually combing through several PDFs.

Technical baseline

The ruleset baseline is unmodded Dominions 6.36. The currently published official documents carry different internal versions:

Official source	Document version	Pages	Role in this lexicon
Dominions 6 Modding Manual	6.34	65	General mod syntax and the principal object languages
Dominions 6 Event Modding Manual	6.29	20	Event requirements, effects, variables, targets, and message substitutions

Official source	Document version	Pages	Role in this lexicon
Dominions 6 Map Making Manual	6.26	11	Map-file structure, provinces, connections, starts, scenario state, and planes
Official update announcements	6.01-6.36	32 announcements	Additions, corrections, deprecations, and historical provenance

This version difference matters. "Current download" and "same version as the executable" are not synonyms. The Modding Manual is two numbered releases behind the game baseline, the Event Modding Manual is seven, and the Map Making Manual is ten. Nothing in that observation makes the documents unreliable. It means their claims must be labelled precisely and supplemented by later official patch evidence where necessary.

The compiled register contains 1,609 distinct official hash tokens found across the three manuals. Of these, 1,540 have an official definition or syntax line, 60 occur only in an official reference list or example-style block, and nine are mentioned without a complete definition line. The total also includes 29 double-hash message substitutions and thirteen documented command templates. Template expansion creates 97 additional lookup aliases without pretending that those aliases were separately printed as definitions. The patch layer contains 226 tokens. Five were introduced by 6.36 after the current Event Modding Manual and are retained as official patch-only spellings whose full syntax is still pending; every older token is reconciled to a current locator or a controlled exception. None remains silently unresolved.

Evidence key

The following labels appear throughout the volume and its data register.

Label	Meaning	What it permits
Defined	A bold command definition or syntax line appears in a current official manual	The printed syntax and context can be used as an official locator
Reference-only	The token appears in an official list or example-style block without a full definition line	Existence is supported; complete behaviour still requires caution
Mentioned-only	The token appears in official prose without a definition or reference entry	The mention may guide research but does not establish complete syntax
Template alias	A literal lookup term is derived from an official terrain or numeric template	The alias is searchable, while the template remains the cited definition
Exact patch match	An official update token matches a current-manual token	History and present documentation can be linked directly
Spelling mismatch	The update announcement and current manual use different spellings	Both forms are preserved; the discrepancy is not silently repaired
Family shorthand	A patch expression names several related commands rather than one literal token	The expression is expanded only through a controlled mapping
Message placeholder	A double-hash substitution is text grammar rather than a mod command	It belongs in message construction, not an object block as a command
Official patch-only	A later official announcement names a command absent from the current manuals	The spelling and introduction version are established; complete syntax is not inferred
Runtime-pending	Official text does not settle the operational result	A minimal reproduction remains necessary before a behavioural claim is promoted

The evidence label answers how the token is known. It does not say that the token is strategically wise, compatible with every other mod, or safe to add to an ongoing game.

Part I: Reading the Modding Language

A command is an instruction inside a stateful document

Every ordinary Dominions mod command begins with a single hash sign. The parser does not read each line as an isolated request. A selector or creation command establishes the current object, following commands alter that object, and #end closes the block where the language requires it. The same spelling can mean different things under different selectors.

Consider #name. The token is defined for weapons, armour, monsters, blessings, sites, nations, spells, magic items, and mercenaries. A search result that only says "#name exists" is almost useless. What matters is the active object, the syntax printed for that object, the parser phase that handles it, and the closing rule that applies. The register stores every official definition context instead of collapsing all occurrences into one sentence.

Book VIII, Part I owns the full parser model. The compact rule for lookup is simpler:

> Command spelling identifies a language feature; the active object block determines what that feature addresses.

Command, argument, value, and block

A command is the hash-prefixed keyword. An argument is information supplied after that keyword. A value is the concrete number, string, name, filename, or mask substituted for the argument notation. A block is the span between an object selector or creator and its terminating #end, where one is required.

The manual notation is descriptive rather than literal:

Notation	Reading rule	Example interpretation
#command	Literal command spelling	Type the hash and command name
<arg>	Required argument	Replace the entire bracketed label with a value
[<arg>]	Optional argument	Supply the argument only when the documented form requires it
A | B	Alternative arguments	Use the left or right form, not both
"<text>"	String argument	Replace the label while retaining quotation marks where the syntax shows them
<number>	Integer or numeric identifier	Supply a valid number within the documented domain
<percent>	Percentage represented as an integer	A value may exceed 100 when the command permits it
<bitmask>	Sum of enabled bit values	Combine flags arithmetically rather than typing their labels
#family1...5	Numeric command template	Use one literal member such as #family1 or #family5
#(terrain)rec	Word-substitution template	Replace (terrain) with an allowed terrain word
##name##	Message substitution	Insert inside supported message text; do not treat it as a command line

Angle brackets are not normally typed. A line such as `#gcost <gold>` means that `<gold>` is replaced by an integer. Square brackets in the printed syntax mark an optional component; they are not usually literal punctuation either. Quotation marks are different: when the manual prints a string in quotes, the quotes are part of the practical syntax.

Comments and explanatory text

Two consecutive hyphens begin a comment. The parser ignores the remainder of that line. Comments are not decoration in a serious project. They preserve intent, source version, ownership, compatibility decisions, reserved identifiers, and reasons for non-obvious values.

A useful comment records something that cannot be recovered by reading the command alone:

```
-- Reserved unit range 9100-9149; do not allocate automatically.
-- Vanilla 6.36; syntax located in Modding Manual 6.34, p. 13.
#newmonster 9100
```

Comments that merely repeat a token add little. "Set the name" above `#name` will not help a later maintainer understand why an identifier is fixed, why a copied field is retained, or which combined-mod collision was avoided.

The four principal argument classes

The Modding Manual identifies integer, percentage, string, and bitmask arguments. Their failure modes differ.

An integer is a whole number. It may be a quantity, identifier, level, code, index, flag value, or enumerated choice. Treating every integer as a quantity causes subtle errors: a path number is not a path level, a monster number is not a count, and an effect number is not a magnitude.

A percentage is also written as an integer. The command defines how that integer is interpreted. Some percentages accept values above 100; others describe chances bounded by a conventional range; still others act as modifiers instead of probabilities. The argument label is not a universal validation rule.

A string is text. Names and filenames are strings, but they carry different operational constraints. Object names can create ambiguous references when several objects share a name. Filenames are case-sensitive and must obey lobby-safe naming rules. Quotation marks protect spaces in string values; they do not remove filename restrictions.

A bitmask represents a set as a sum of powers of two. Bitmask errors are rarely obvious to the eye because an incorrect sum is still a valid integer. A proper record keeps both the decimal total and its component flags. When a terrain mask, path mask, damage mask, or event mask changes, the components should be recalculated rather than adjusted by guesswork.

Names and numbers are different forms of reference

Many selectors accept either an object name or number. Names are readable but can be ambiguous, can change between versions, and cannot reliably cross every mod boundary. Numbers are precise but can collide, can be allocated differently when content order changes, and are difficult to understand without a registry.

The safest choice depends on the project:

- a small private balance patch may prefer names for untouched vanilla objects;
- a distributable content mod benefits from fixed IDs and a published allocation register;
- a compatibility patch needs explicit knowledge of both source projects' identities;
- an ongoing-game update must preserve the identifiers already embedded in the save;
- a cross-mod reference should never assume that a name provides a stable linking contract.

Book VIII owns allocation and collision engineering. Book XIV records whether syntax allows a name, a number, or either form.

Binary commands and clearing state

A command printed without an argument commonly enables a fixed attribute. Its absence does not necessarily mean "false" after an object has been copied. A copied object may already carry the field, and a clearing command may be needed to remove inherited state.

This is why `#copy...`, `#clear`, specialised clearing commands, and zero-valued arguments cannot be treated as interchangeable. Their behaviour depends on the object language. Copy-first and clear-first create different starting states. The lexicon locates the commands; Book VIII, Section "Copy-first and clear-first are different designs" owns the design consequences.

Optional arguments are branches, not decorative hints

Square-bracket arguments represent alternative valid forms. The short form and long form may not be semantically identical. Optional identifiers can affect automatic allocation. Optional names can change display behaviour. Optional values can select defaults that later game versions revise.

For maintainable source, the chosen form should be deliberate and documented. Omitting an argument because the notation looked complicated is not the same as selecting the default knowingly.

The vertical bar means exclusive alternatives

The manual uses a vertical bar to mean "or". In syntax such as:

```
#selectweapon "<weapon name>" | <weapon nbr>
```

the selector takes a name or a number. The entire expression is not typed. Mixing both forms can produce a parse error or leave unexpected trailing input. Website presentation must escape the bar inside Markdown tables so it is not mistaken for a column boundary.

Templates describe a grammar

Thirteen official entries are templates rather than literal commands. Four substitute terrain words, while nine describe numeric ranges. `#(terrain)fortrec` is not a line to paste into a mod. It is a compact grammar covering forms such as `#forestfortrec`, `#plainfortrec`, and `#dripfortrec`, subject to the terrain restrictions printed beside the template.

The same principle governs `#hero1...10`, `#multihero1...7`, `#battlesum1...5`, and similar families. The ellipsis describes a range. It is not part of a literal command. Search systems should resolve a concrete family member back to the template without rewriting the official definition.

Template generation carries two risks. First, not every visually plausible substitution is legal. Sea, deep-sea, and kelp recruitment use special rules in the fort variants. Second, family notation in a patch announcement can be looser than the formal template in a manual. Controlled alias records solve the retrieval problem while retaining those qualifications.

Double-hash substitutions are not commands

Event and global-enchantment messages support substitutions such as `##landname##`, `##godname##`, and `##targname##`. These tokens are interpreted inside supported text. A single-hash command controls the event or object; a double-hash substitution changes the message produced by that object.

Capitalisation can be meaningful. The official reference includes both lower-case and capitalised pronoun forms. The lexicon preserves exact case for double-hash tokens even though ordinary command lookup is normalised for search.

Part II: Context Is Part of Syntax

The same spelling can serve several object languages

The register identifies 107 tokens whose official definition contexts span more than one command domain. Familiar examples include `#name`, `#descr`, `#clear`, `#end`, `#att`, `#def`, `#range`, `#sound`, `#sample`, `#homerealm`, and `#magic`.

This is not accidental duplication. Dominions exposes related fields through separate object parsers. A command can be legitimate in several places while accepting different arguments or changing different records. A flat alphabetical glossary that keeps only one definition will inevitably mislead readers.

Every context-sensitive record in the data layer retains:

- each official manual;
- the manual's internal version;
- the printed page;
- section and subsection;
- evidence strength;
- the syntax line where one is present;
- a domain-specific canonical destination.

Selection establishes the target

Selectors such as `#selectweapon`, `#selectarmor`, `#selectmonster`, `#selectnation`, `#selectspell`, and their counterparts establish which object receives subsequent changes. Creation commands such as `#newweapon`, `#newmonster`, and `#newspell` create a target and then open its modification context.

The selector line is part of the meaning of every command beneath it. Removing a selector while copying a snippet can redirect valid commands into the preceding object. This failure can survive superficial review because each individual line is spelled correctly.

`#end` closes a context, not a universal transaction

`#end` appears throughout the manuals. Its practical role is determined by the active parser. A missing `#end` can cause later commands to be swallowed by the wrong block; an extra one can close a block early. Source formatting should make block boundaries visually obvious even though indentation itself is not the primary parser rule.

A robust block convention uses:

- one blank line before a selector or creator;
- a comment naming the object's stable ID and purpose;
- consistent indentation for commands inside the block;
- an explicit `#end` aligned with the opening selector;
- a validation check that counts and pairs block openings with endings where the language permits that static test.

Load order changes what context can see

Dominions parses object categories in a documented order and loads each mod as a whole. A reference that appears later in the file can still work when its object category is parsed earlier, while a reference into a different enabled mod may fail even when the other file appears above it in a user's preference screen.

The command lexicon does not attempt to encode every cross-object dependency. It supplies domain and manual context. Book VIII, Part I owns parser order; Book VIII, Part XI owns compatibility engineering.

A syntax locator is not a compatibility promise

An officially defined command can still be unsafe in a particular project. Common causes include:

- both mods selecting and altering the same vanilla object;
- automatic IDs shifting after new content is inserted;
- a copied object inheriting fields that a later version added;
- event codes colliding between unrelated projects;
- a template alias being legal only for some terrain variants;
- a command added after the minimum game version declared by the mod;
- a mid-game change altering the meaning of identities already stored in the save.

The presence of a command in this lexicon establishes retrievability, not project compatibility.

Part III: The Evidence Ladder and Version Drift

Official definition

A defined token has a bold syntax or definition line in one of the current official manuals. This is the strongest documentation state in the register. It establishes the printed spelling, argument form, page, and object context. It may also supply constraints in the surrounding manual prose that the website register deliberately does not reproduce.

The register is a locator, not a replacement copy of the manuals. After a command is found, the cited page remains the authoritative place to read its complete official explanation.

Official reference-only entry

Sixty tokens occur only in an official list or example-style block. Several monster abilities fall into this category, including commands gathered in the Modding Manual's compact monster-command pages. Other entries are message substitutions printed as reference tables.

Reference-only does not mean unofficial. It means the official document supports the spelling or existence without supplying a full definition line. Behavioural summaries should not be invented to fill that gap. A verified mod example or controlled runtime test can add evidence later, but it must remain labelled separately from the manual.

Official mention-only entry

Nine tokens have only prose mentions in the current documents: `#afflictions`, `#airattuned`, `#coldrec`, `#dom6title`, `#fireattuned`, `#forestrec`, `#heatrec`, `#multihero1`, and `#nogeosrc`.

Some are understandable through a nearby template or surrounding discussion. Others expose a documentation gap. Mention-only status prevents an incidental sentence from being promoted into a complete syntax contract.

Official patch evidence

Patch announcements answer historical questions: when a token was added, corrected, expanded, deprecated, or discussed. They rarely define the entire command. Book XIII preserves the complete announcement chronology and record identity. Book XIV links each extracted token to that chronology and then asks whether current manual documentation matches it.

Of the 226 patch-note tokens:

- 196 match current official definitions exactly;
- two match current official reference-only entries;
- sixteen resolve through official templates;
- three require controlled spelling reconciliation;
- three are family shorthand rather than literal commands;
- one is a double-hash message placeholder rather than a command;
- five are official 6.36 commands whose complete syntax has not yet appeared in the current manuals.

This distribution is the clearest reason not to publish a raw patch-token list as a command manual.

The five 6.36 patch-only commands

The 6.36 announcement introduces `#healaffmount`, `#gainaffmount`, `#req_provnbr`, `#newnbor`, and `#remnbor` as event commands. Their names and introduction version are official. The announcement does not print their arguments, valid event phases, target semantics, or failure behaviour, and the Event Modding Manual remains at 6.29. The lexicon exposes them for search without fabricating syntax. A later official manual can replace the patch-only state while preserving the 6.36 provenance record.

Patch wording can be historically exact and operationally incomplete

The official announcement is preserved as the historical source even when a later manual clarifies a different spelling. The patch ledger should not be rewritten to make the historical text look cleaner. The command lexicon instead creates a reconciliation record containing the patch token, present locator, resolution status, note, version, record ID, and source locator.

That separation protects both forms of truth:

- Book XIII answers what the announcement said;
- Book XIV answers how that expression relates to the current official documentation.

Three controlled spelling discrepancies

`#addseduction` and `#addseductions`

The 6.12 announcement says `#addseduction`. The Event Modding Manual 6.29 defines `#addseductions <value>`. The lexicon preserves the singular patch token and resolves it to the plural manual command. No claim is made that both spellings are accepted by the executable.

`#illusionimmune` and `#illusionsimmune`

The 6.08 announcement says `#illusionimmune`. The Modding Manual 6.34 defines `#illusionsimmune`. The plural form receives the manual locator; the singular form remains a historical alias marked as a mismatch.

`#res_mnrbs` and `#req_mnrbs`

The 6.34 announcement says `#res_mnrbs`. The Event Modding Manual 6.29 defines `#req_mnrbs`. Since the manual predates the announcement, the difference could represent a patch-note typo, a renamed command, or an undocumented second form. Official text alone does not determine which spellings the 6.36 executable accepts. The controlled mapping supports retrieval, while runtime acceptance remains a separate question.

Three family expressions

The extracted token `#not` comes from the announcement expression `#not(dis)mounted`. It resolves to `#notmounted` and `#notdismounted`; there is no literal `#not` command claim.

The extracted token `#force` comes from `#force...vis`. It resolves to the documented forced-gem event-effect family: `#force1d3vis`, `#force1d6vis`, `#force2d4vis`, `#force2d6vis`, `#force3d6vis`, and `#force4d6vis`.

The expression `#battlesum1dX` uses a capital X as a family placeholder. The current manual defines `#battlesum1d2` and `#battlesum1d3`. The lexicon links the patch expression to both.

The patch placeholder `##varXXX##`

The 6.16 announcement describes `##varXXX##` for printing event variables in messages. The patch importer captured the inner `#varXXX` token because it was designed to find hash expressions. Book XIV corrects the classification, not the historical record: this is a double-hash message pattern, not a command line.

Part IV: Command Domains

Why domains matter

Alphabetical search is good for a known spelling. Domain search is better when the desired operation is known but the command name is not. The register assigns each occurrence to an object language using its official manual, page, section, and subsection. A token can belong to more than one domain.

Domain	Distinct tokens	What the domain controls	Canonical design route
Monster modding	584	Units, commanders, attributes, movement, leadership, magic, forms, mounts, and abilities	Book VIII, Part IV
Event modding	403	Event requirements, targets, effects, variables, codes, messages, and global events	Book VIII, Part VII
Nation modding	169	National identity, recruitment, defence, gods, forts, dominion, and reanimation	Book VIII, Part V
Weapon modding	121	Damage, delivery, qualifiers, secondary effects, and after-effects	Book VIII, Part III
Site modding	112	Site identity, income, recruitment, scales, rituals, and throne effects	Book VIII, Part V
Spell modding	105	Research, paths, fatigue, effects, targeting, AI hints, and globals	Book VIII, Part VI
Magic-item modding	102	Construction, paths, powers, restrictions, and carried abilities	Book VIII, Part VI
Map making	69	Map identity, provinces, neighbours, terrain, starts, scenario contents, and planes	Book VIII, Part IX
General modding	40	Cross-object and global configuration	Book VIII, Parts I-II
Bless modding	21	Bless identity, requirements, effects, and scale conditions	Book VIII, Part VI
Mercenary modding	16	Company identity, units, price, timing, and availability	Book VIII, Part VI supporting objects
Armour modding	15	Protection, defence, encumbrance, material, and type	Book VIII, Part III
Population-type modding	13	Independent population recruitment packages	Book VIII, Part VI supporting objects
Sound modding	11	Samples, modes, loops, and audio import	Book VIII, Part II
AI modding	10	Template construction, Pretender design, and research targets	Book VIII, Part X
Mod metadata	5	Display name, description, icon, version, and required game version	Book VIII, Part II

Domain	Distinct tokens	What the domain controls	Canonical design route
Name modding	4	Name-table selection, clearing, and addition	Book VIII, Part VI supporting objects

Counts overlap where a token has several contexts. They measure retrievable language surface, not relative strategic importance.

Mod metadata and sound

Metadata commands make a mod identifiable to the game and to players. A stable display name, meaningful version, clear description, and suitable icon are part of release engineering. `#domversion` deserves particular attention because it communicates a minimum executable version; leaving it absent does not make newer commands compatible with older builds.

Sound commands form a compact object language with selectors, import paths, sample modes, and looping rules. Filename and network-lobby constraints apply just as strongly to audio assets as to sprites and map files.

Weapons and armour

Weapon syntax separates base damage, number of attacks, attack and defence modifiers, length, range, ammunition, damage type, resistance interactions, targeting qualifiers, secondary effects, and post-hit effects. Similar-looking commands can belong to spell or item contexts as well, so the domain locator should be checked before reusing a line.

Armour commands are fewer but strongly coupled: protection, defence, encumbrance, resource cost, armour type, and material interact with unit statistics and damage resolution. The lexicon identifies syntax; Book IV owns combat interpretation and Book VIII owns object construction.

Monsters, commanders, mounts, and forms

Monster modding is the largest language surface in the general manual. It includes statistics, costs, recruitment rules, body types, slots, creature status, movement, stealth, healing, reduction, immortality, auras, seasonal powers, combat abilities, non-combat abilities, shape changes, summons, mounts, leadership, paths, research, gem production, and special magic.

The compact monster-command reference also contains dozens of reference-only tokens. Their presence is official, but complete semantics cannot be inferred from the spelling alone. A command named like a familiar in-game ability may expose only part of that ability or accept values whose interpretation is not shown in the list.

Names and blessings

Name-table modding is small but identity-sensitive. Clearing a name table and adding names changes a shared resource, not merely one unit's display label.

Bless modding uses familiar generic tokens such as `#name` within a specialised block. Its scale and path requirements are access rules, while effect commands alter sacred units. Strategic blessing design remains in Book III; the lexicon supplies only the language locator.

Sites and nations

Sites can grant income, recruitment, scales, ritual access, scrying, special effects, and throne powers. Nation blocks then assemble recruitment, province defence, gods, infrastructure, dominion, reanimation, and AI hints into a playable state.

Terrain recruitment is the main template-heavy area. Literal forms such as `#forestrec` and `#dripfortcom` resolve to `(terrain)` definitions. Fort and non-fort variants are distinct, and underwater cases carry explicit exceptions. Search aliases should never erase those restrictions.

Spells and magic items

Spell commands define access and delivery as well as effects. Research school, level, path requirements, fatigue cost, range, targeting, area, damage, precision, effect numbers, chaining, special attributes, global-enchantment behaviour, rare caster requirements, and AI hints can all matter.

Magic-item commands combine construction access with persistent abilities. Many monster abilities are reused in item context, which makes command collisions common. A token documented for monsters is not automatically documented for items; the entry must contain the item domain or an explicit cross-context statement.

Events

Event commands are divided into requirements and effects. Requirements filter when, where, for whom, and against which target an event is valid. Effects alter state after selection. Event codes and variables create memory across events. Message substitutions expose names and state inside text. Global events extend the scope beyond one province.

The event language is especially vulnerable to plausible but false assumptions. Several requirements can be combined, repeated, or negated; target requirements do not always select a target by themselves; and a perfectly valid event can remain practically impossible because its conditions never overlap.

Maps

Map commands define identity, image, size, provinces, connections, names, terrain, colours, starts, victory restrictions, scenario ownership, contents, magic, dominion, scales, and planes. Some commands act on an explicitly numbered province; others operate on the currently active province selected by `#land` or `#setland`.

The distinction between global map state and active-province state is another form of parser context. A copied line can be valid yet alter the wrong province if the selector context is missing.

AI and general commands

AI modding exposes bounded hints and templates, not a general programmable strategic brain. The language can shape Pretender design, research targets, and some preferences. Book VIII, Part X owns the capability boundary.

General commands affect broader game or mod state. Their apparent simplicity makes them easy to place without considering version, load order, or campaign consequences. Each should be treated as a project-level change.

Part V: A Safe Lookup Workflow

Beginner route: from desired result to a valid line

1. Define the object being changed: weapon, armour, monster, site, nation, spell, item, event, map, or another supported type.
2. Search the domain rather than guessing a command name.
3. Open the cited official page and read the surrounding explanation.
4. Confirm whether the entry is defined, reference-only, mentioned-only, or a template.
5. Copy the printed command spelling and replace argument labels deliberately.
6. Confirm the selector or creator that establishes the active object.
7. Confirm whether `#end` is required.
8. Load the smallest possible mod containing only the relevant block.
9. Inspect the resulting object or event before integrating the change into a larger project.
10. Record the game version, manual version, and result.

This route is slower than pasting an isolated line and much faster than debugging a large file whose parser context is already uncertain.

Expert route: from token to maintenance decision

1. Search the normalised token and all aliases.
2. Review every context when the token is marked context-sensitive.
3. Compare current-manual syntax with every linked patch record.
4. Check the mod's declared minimum game version.
5. Inspect neighbouring source for selector state, copied fields, clearing operations, and identifier ownership.
6. Check combined-load-order overlap with other active mods.
7. Decide whether the change is static, load-validated, object-validated, or behaviour-validated.
8. Preserve a minimal reproduction when runtime evidence adds knowledge beyond the official text.

When a command is known but its meaning is not

A reference-only or mention-only token should trigger a bounded evidence search:

- read the full surrounding official page;
- search later official patch announcements;
- inspect current official examples if available;
- inspect a reputable working mod while treating it as implementation evidence, not official documentation;
- create a minimal reproduction;
- vary one argument at a time;
- record accepted syntax separately from observed effect;
- avoid generalising beyond the tested version and context.

The absence of an official description is not permission to replace it with a confident guess.

When a patch token fails to parse

The reconciliation table should be checked before assuming the game rejected a once-valid command. The token may be:

- a family expression such as `#force...vis`;
- a terrain template member;
- a numeric template member;
- a manual spelling mismatch;
- a message placeholder;
- a command added after the running executable;
- a command valid only in another object context.

If none applies, the failure becomes a research item rather than an invitation to cycle through arbitrary spellings.

Minimal reproduction structure

The smallest useful test file contains metadata, one object, one disputed command, and no unrelated content:

```
#modname "Command Test"
#description "Isolates one syntax question."
#version 0.01
#domversion 6.36

-- One fixed object, one command under review, one expected result.
#selectmonster 123
#command_under_test <value>
#end
```

The selected object and command must be appropriate to the test. A disposable copy is preferable when altering a vanilla object would contaminate comparison. Event and map tests require their own minimal harnesses.

Four different validation claims

Claim	Evidence required	What remains unproven
The file parses	Load without a parse error	The command may still have no intended effect
The object changes	Inspect the resulting object or exported data	Battle, event, AI, or campaign behaviour may differ
The behaviour occurs	Controlled runtime observation	Compatibility and long-term balance remain open
The project is releasable	Regression, multiplayer, compatibility, packaging, and version checks	Future patches can still invalidate assumptions

These claims should not be collapsed into "works."

Deprecated commands

The official manuals mark `#coastunit1...3` and `#coastcom1...2` as deprecated. Their presence in the locator supports legacy-source diagnosis, not new use. A deprecated token should remain searchable because removing it would make old mods harder to audit. Search results should place the replacement route and warning ahead of convenience.

Minimum game version

`#domversion` states the minimum Dominions version required by a mod. The value should follow the newest feature actually required, not the version on the developer's computer by habit. Patch provenance makes that decision more defensible: if a required command first appears in 6.30, a lower declaration needs specific evidence that the command existed earlier.

The first patch mention is not always the true introduction. Some announcements describe a fix to an existing command. Direction and classification must be read with the version, not inferred from date alone.

Part VI: Patch-to-Manual Reconciliation

The controlled exceptions

The following table contains every patch token that does not resolve as an exact current-manual token. Exact matches remain available in the full patch index.

Patch token	Reconciliation	Resolves to	Version	Editorial note
`#addseduction`	manual spelling mismatch	`#addseductions`	6.12	The update announcement uses the singular form; the Event Modding Manual defines the plural command.
`#battlesum1dx`	family shorthand	`#battlesum1d2`, `#battlesum1d3`	6.27	The capital X denotes the dice-size family rather than a literal lower-case command.
`#coastcom1`	template alias	`#coastcom1...2`	6.04	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#coastfortcom`	template alias	`#(terrain)fortcom`	6.05	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#coastfortrec`	template alias	`#(terrain)fortrec`	6.05	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#coastunit1`	template alias	`#coastunit1...3`	6.04	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#deeprec`	template alias	`#(terrain)rec`	6.04	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#dripfortrec`	template alias	`#(terrain)fortrec`	6.04	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.

Patch token	Reconciliation	Resolves to	Version	Editorial note
`#driprec`	template alias	`#(terrain)rec`	6.04	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#force`	family shorthand	`#force1d3vis`, `#force1d6vis`, `#force2d4vis`, `#force2d6vis`, `#force3d6vis`, `#force4d6vis`	6.06	Extracted from #force...vis; resolve to the documented forced-gem event-effect family.
`#forestfortcom`	template alias	`#(terrain)fortcom`	6.04	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#forestfortrec`	template alias	`#(terrain)fortrec`	6.04	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#gainaffmount`	official patch only	Official announcement only; syntax pending	6.36	Introduced by the official 6.36 announcement after the current Event Modding Manual; the announcement establishes the spelling but does not supply full syntax.
`#healaffmount`	official patch only	Official announcement only; syntax pending	6.36	Introduced by the official 6.36 announcement after the current Event Modding Manual; the announcement establishes the spelling but does not supply full syntax.
`#illusionimmune`	manual spelling mismatch	`#illusionsimmune`	6.08	The update announcement uses the singular form; the Modding Manual defines #illusionsimmune.
`#kelpcom`	template alias	`#(terrain)com`	6.24	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#kelprec`	template alias	`#(terrain)rec`	6.04, 6.24	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#newnbor`	official patch only	Official announcement only; syntax pending	6.36	Introduced by the official 6.36 announcement after the current Event Modding Manual; the announcement establishes the spelling but does not supply full syntax.
`#not`	family shorthand	`#notmounted`, `#notdismounted`	6.12	Extracted from the official expression #not(dis)mounted; it is not a literal #not command.
`#plaincom`	template alias	`#(terrain)com`	6.24	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#plainfortcom`	template alias	`#(terrain)fortcom`	6.24	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#plainfortrec`	template alias	`#(terrain)fortrec`	6.24	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#plainrec`	template alias	`#(terrain)rec`	6.24	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#remnbor`	official patch only	Official announcement only; syntax pending	6.36	Introduced by the official 6.36 announcement after the current Event Modding Manual; the announcement establishes the spelling but does not supply full syntax.

Patch token	Reconciliation	Resolves to	Version	Editorial note
`#req_provnbr`	official patch only	Official announcement only; syntax pending	6.36	Introduced by the official 6.36 announcement after the current Event Modding Manual; the announcement establishes the spelling but does not supply full syntax.
`#res_mnrbs`	manual spelling mismatch	`#req_mnrbs`	6.34	The 6.34 announcement says #res_mnrbs; the Event Modding Manual defines #req_mnrbs.
`#searec`	template alias	`#(terrain)rec`	6.04	The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.
`#varxxx`	message placeholder	Message grammar; no command target	6.16	This is the ##varXXX## event-message substitution pattern, not a hash command.

How to read the table

A template alias resolves a concrete spelling to the official template that defines the family. A spelling mismatch preserves both source forms. A family shorthand expands an announcement expression into documented members. A message placeholder changes grammar class. None of these mappings asserts that every displayed form is accepted literally by the executable.

Exact matches still require context

An exact string match is not the end of analysis. `#clear`, `#name`, and `#end` all have exact definitions in several object contexts. The patch record establishes a historical change, while the manual entry establishes a current locator. The active object still determines practical meaning.

A patch can correct behaviour without changing syntax

Many patch records say that a command "didn't work," accepted a wider value, became valid in another context, or was deprecated. The syntax before and after the patch can be identical. A current command index needs both syntax status and behavioural history.

Book XIII remains the place to inspect the full release context. The command register stores only the links needed to move between the present locator and the historical ledger.

Part VII: Search and Website Architecture

One content identity, several views

The PDF and website should not maintain separate command facts. Both are generated from the same record identity. The website can provide several views without duplicating content:

- alphabetical command search;
- domain browser;
- manual and page browser;

- patch-version browser;
- documentation-gap queue;
- context-collision view;
- template and alias explorer;
- deprecated-command list;
- message-substitution reference;
- canonical links into Book VIII and Book XIII.

Command record fields

Each record contains:

Field	Purpose
`id`	Stable website and data identity
`command`	Officially printed token spelling
`normalized_command`	Search key; ordinary commands are case-normalised
`command_kind`	Literal command, template, or message placeholder
`documentation_status`	Defined, reference-only, or mentioned-only
`domains`	Every official object-language context located
`families`	Search facets such as requirements, lifecycle, events, maps, or magic
`manual_entries`	Manual ID, version, page, section, evidence, and syntax locator
`patch_records`	Linked version, patch record, source, class, and direction
`canonical_section_ids`	Reader destinations that own the surrounding explanation
`cautions`	Context, template, and documentation-gap warnings
`record_hash`	Stable integrity fingerprint for change detection

Alias records are explicit

An alias record contains the searchable literal form, the official template it resolves to, the derivation basis, and a synthetic flag. It does not copy the template definition into a second command record. This keeps search convenient without creating false official entries.

Patch reconciliation is a separate relation

The patch relation retains the historical token even when it differs from the current manual. Its status and note explain the mapping. This design prevents a later manual update from rewriting the patch archive and prevents a historical typo from contaminating current syntax search.

Useful search filters

Practical website filters include:

- exact spelling;
- substring or prefix;
- command kind;
- domain;
- manual version;

- documentation status;
- patch version;
- patch classification;
- direction such as added, corrected, deprecated, or changed;
- context-sensitive only;
- template-derived aliases only;
- entries needing runtime work.

Search results should show the caution before the syntax when an entry is ambiguous or incomplete.

Search examples

Research question	Effective query
Which commands control event targets?	Domain `event-modding`, prefix `#req_targ`
Where is a concrete terrain recruit command documented?	Search literal alias, then open its `(terrain)` template
Which patch-added commands still lack full definitions?	Has patch record, status `reference-only` or `mentioned-only`
Which spell commands changed after the Event Manual's version?	Domain `spell-modding`, patch version greater than the relevant manual baseline
Which spellings are unsafe to treat as literal?	Reconciliation status `family-shorthand` or `message-placeholder`
Which tokens need object context before use?	`cautions` contains context-sensitive warning

Schema and integrity checks

The JSON schema validates required identity, status, domain, locator, and hash fields. Additional semantic checks are still necessary:

- command and ID uniqueness;
- valid manual IDs;
- pages within each manual's page count;
- every alias target exists;
- every patch record ID exists in the official ledger;
- every patch token has one reconciliation outcome;
- no unresolved patch token is published as complete;
- status totals match the record collection;
- every canonical destination resolves in website navigation.

Part VIII: Expert Essays

Essay I: Syntax Is Not Semantics

Syntax answers whether a line belongs to the language. Semantics answers what state that line changes. Operational behaviour answers what happens when the state enters the game. Strategy answers whether that result is useful. Compatibility answers whether the project remains coherent beside other projects and across versions.

Dominions mod discussions often skip directly from syntax to strategy. A command is found, a line parses, and a broad claim follows. Each skipped layer creates a different risk. A correctly parsed event requirement may make an event impossible. A correctly displayed ability may apply to a mount rather than its rider. A correctly modified spell may never be selected by AI casting logic. A strategically interesting unit may collide with another mod's identifier.

The lexicon deliberately stops at retrieval and evidence. That limit makes it more useful, not less. A clear boundary allows every later claim to cite the right layer instead of treating a command name as proof of an entire system.

Essay II: Command Context Is a Public Interface

A mod file looks like a private implementation detail, but every released command block becomes part of a public interface. Save files retain identities. Compatibility patches select objects. Other maintainers read names and number ranges. Players depend on declared versions and load order. Workshop updates replace files inside ongoing campaigns.

Context-sensitive commands reveal this interface most clearly. `#name` is not a single global naming function; it is a family of fields exposed through different object parsers. The selector, parser phase, object ID, and closing boundary are part of the contract.

Good source makes that contract legible. It freezes identifiers, documents ranges, isolates object blocks, states dependencies, and avoids unnecessary selection of shared vanilla objects. Poor source can still load, but it forces every later maintainer to reconstruct the contract from behaviour.

Essay III: Patch Notes Are Change Evidence, Not a Replacement Manual

Patch notes are written to explain what changed. Compression is useful in that setting. `#force...vis` efficiently tells experienced modders that a family was fixed. `#not(dis)mounted` compactly names two related commands. "New nation commands: `#forestfortrec`, `#forestfortcom`, etc." signals a broader addition without printing a grammar.

The same compression becomes hazardous when harvested into a reference. Ellipses look like literal characters. Parentheses look like optional text. Singular and plural spellings become competing commands. A message placeholder becomes a single-hash token after naive extraction.

The solution is not to distrust patch notes. It is to preserve their purpose. Book XIII stores change evidence. Book XIV reconciles expressions to present documentation. Neither source is forced to do the other's job.

Essay IV: Templates Are Grammars, Not Abbreviations

A template such as `#(terrain)rec` defines a productive rule: substitute an allowed terrain word to create a literal command. This is more powerful than an ordinary abbreviation because it can generate forms not separately listed. It is also more dangerous because readers can generate plausible but invalid forms.

Formal grammar has constraints. The manual's terrain list, fort exceptions, and underwater alternatives define the valid language. A search system should expose those constraints with the template. Generating aliases without a target link produces convenient misinformation; refusing to generate aliases makes ordinary source unnecessarily hard to search.

The controlled alias is the middle path. It states that the concrete term is derived, records the official template, and retains the synthetic status. Search becomes broader while evidence remains exact.

Essay V: Documentation Gaps Should Remain Visible

A reference-only command creates an uncomfortable blank. The token is official, but the intended value range or detailed behaviour may not be printed. There is a temptation to fill the gap with community consensus and remove the warning once a likely explanation appears.

That approach destroys useful information. A later reader can no longer tell which part came from Illwinter, which part came from a working mod, and which part came from a test. The confident summary may remain correct for years, yet its evidence chain has been lost.

A visible gap supports cumulative research. Official existence, community implementation, runtime acceptance, observed effect, version, and test conditions can each be recorded. Later evidence adds a layer instead of replacing the uncertainty with anonymous certainty.

Part IX: Maintenance and Review Protocols

Before adding a command to a project

- Confirm the object domain.
- Open the official locator rather than relying on the command name.
- Verify every argument and alternative form.
- Check whether the token is a template or message substitution.
- Check linked patch records.
- Confirm the minimum executable version.
- Inspect selector, copy, clear, and `#end` context.
- Check identifier ownership and combined-mod overlap.
- Build a minimal reproduction for incomplete behaviour.
- Record the evidence level beside the design decision.

When reviewing a legacy mod

- Record the mod version and original game baseline.
- Extract every hash token without assuming all are commands.
- Resolve template members and deprecated families.
- Identify tokens absent from the current official register.
- Compare context-sensitive syntax against the active selector.
- Flag automatic IDs and shared event codes.
- Preserve old spellings until acceptance has been tested.
- Separate parser migration from balance changes.
- Test a clean new game before testing a historical save.
- Publish the compatibility boundary.

When an official source disagrees with another official source

- Preserve both spellings or statements.
- Record source version and date.
- Determine whether one source describes history and the other current syntax.
- Search later official corrections.
- Avoid inventing a winner when runtime evidence is absent.
- Test both forms in the smallest valid context if acceptance matters.
- Report the result as versioned runtime evidence.

When a new patch arrives

1. Archive the official announcement and metadata.
2. Rebuild the official patch ledger.
3. Extract candidate commands and message tokens.
4. Compare them with exact manual tokens.
5. Resolve templates, family expressions, and spelling discrepancies explicitly.
6. Download and hash any updated manuals.
7. Rebuild the command register and schema validation.
8. Review documentation-status changes.
9. Update Book XIII chronology only for historical change.
10. Update Book XIV only for syntax, context, provenance, or retrieval changes.
11. Re-run navigation, duplicate, voice, and visual checks.
12. Publish a bounded change note.

Documentation-defect report

A useful report contains:

- game version;
- manual title and internal version;
- page and section;
- exact printed token;
- conflicting official token or patch record;
- minimal valid block;
- parser result;
- observed behaviour;
- save, mods, and load order where relevant;
- a statement separating observation from inference.

This format is far more actionable than "the command does not work."

Part X: Complete Search Locators

How to use the appendices

The following appendices are mechanically generated from the validated command register. Their compact entries are locators rather than replacements for the official explanations. "Defined" points to an official syntax line. "Reference" marks an official list or example entry. "Mention" marks prose-only evidence. Template and message tokens retain their grammar class.

The first locator contains every distinct hash token found in the current official manuals. The patch column shows the first linked version when Book XIII contains a command record. The syntax column preserves the strongest official syntax line without copying the manual's explanatory prose.

Templates

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#(path)attuned	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#(path)attuned <chance>
#(terrain)com	Defined; template	Nation	M6.34 p45	#(terrain)com "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#(terrain)fortcom	Defined; template	Nation	M6.34 p45	#(terrain)fortcom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#(terrain)fortrec	Defined; template	Nation	M6.34 p45	#(terrain)fortrec "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#(terrain)rec	Defined; template	Nation	M6.34 p45	#(terrain)rec "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>

0-9

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#10d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#10d6units "name" | <number>
#11d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#11d6units "name" | <number>
#12d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#12d6units "name" | <number>
#13d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#13d6units "name" | <number>
#14d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#14d6units "name" | <number>
#15d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#15d6units "name" | <number>
#16d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#16d6units "name" | <number>
#1d3units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#1d3units "name" | <number>
#1d3vis	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#1d3vis <gem type>
#1d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#1d6units "name" | <number>
#1d6vis	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#1d6vis <gem type>
#1unit	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#1unit "name" | <number>
#2com	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#2com "name" | <number>
#2d3units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#2d3units "name" | <number>
#2d4vis	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#2d4vis <gem type>
#2d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14; E6.29 p19; E6.29 p20	#2d6units "name" | <number>
#2d6vis	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#2d6vis <gem type>
#3castbattlespell	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35	#3castbattlespell "<spell name>" | <nbr>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#3d3units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#3d3units "name" | <number>
#3d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14; E6.29 p19	#3d6units "name" | <number>
#3d6vis	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#3d6vis <gem type>
#4com	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#4com "name" | <number>
#4d3units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#4d3units "name" | <number>
#4d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#4d6units "name" | <number>
#4d6vis	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#4d6vis <gem type>
#5com	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#5com "name" | <number>
#5d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14; E6.29 p20	#5d6units "name" | <number>
#6d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#6d6units "name" | <number>
#7d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#7d6units "name" | <number>
#8d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#8d6units "name" | <number>
#9d6units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#9d6units "name" | <number>

A

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#acid	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#acid
#aciddigest	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#aciddigest <dmg>
#acidres	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p56	#acidres <prot>
#acidshield	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#acidshield <damage>
#addascension	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#addascension <AP>
#addequip	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#addequip <equipment level>
#addforeigncom	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#addforeigncom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#addforeignunit	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#addforeignunit "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#addgeo	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#addgeo <terrain bitmask>
#addgod	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#addgod "<monster name>" | <nbr>
#additem	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#additem "<item name>"
#addkills	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#addkills <value>
#addname	Defined	Names	M6.34 p36	#addname "name"
#addrandomage	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21	#addrandomage <years>
#addreccom	Defined	Nation, Poptype	M6.34 p45; M6.34 p63	#addreccom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#addrecunit	Defined	Nation, Poptype	M6.34 p45; M6.34 p63	#addrecunit "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#addseductions	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#addseductions <value>
#addsite	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#addsite <site number>
#addupkeep	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#addupkeep <gold>
#adeptsacr	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#adeptsacr <value>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#adventureruin	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#adventureruin <success chance>
#afflictions	Mention	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#afflictions
#aftercloud	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p12	#aftercloud <cloudstr> <cloudtype>
#aftercloudarea	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p12	#aftercloudarea <aoe>
#aiairnation	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aiairnation
#aiassmod	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p55	#aiassmod <bonus>
#aiastralnation	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aiastralnation
#aiawake	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aiawake <percent>
#aibadlvl	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p55	#aibadlvl <level>
#aibloodnation	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aibloodnation
#aicheapholy	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aicheapholy
#aideathnation	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aideathnation
#aiearthnation	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aiearthnation
#aifirenation	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aifirenation
#aiglamournation	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aiglamournation
#aigoodbless	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aigoodbless <0-100>
#aiheavyrec	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aiheavyrec <0-99>
#aiholdgod	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aiholdgod
#aiholyranged	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aiholyranged
#aimagerec	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aimagerec <0-99>
#aimusthavemag	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aimusthavemag <magic path number>
#ainaturenation	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#ainaturenation
#ainocast	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p55	#ainocast <0 or 1>
#ainorec	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#ainorec
#airattuned	Mention	Monster	M6.34 p28	#airattuned
#airblessbonus	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#airblessbonus <0 - 9>
#airboost	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#airboost "name" | <number>
#airelementals	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61	#airelementals <bonus>
#airrange	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p33; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#airrange <range>
#airshield	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#airshield <percent>
#aisinglerec	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#aisinglerec
#aispellmod	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p55	#aispellmod <bonus>
#aiwaternation	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#aiwaternation
#alchemy	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#alchemy <percent>
#allowedplayer	Defined	Map	P6.26 p5	#allowedplayer <nation nbr>
#allrange	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#allrange <range>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#allret	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#allret <chance>
#almostliving	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#almostliving
#almostundead	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#almostundead
#altcost	Defined	Site	M6.34 p39	#altcost <bonus>
#ambidextrous	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#ambidextrous <bonus>
#ammo	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p7	#ammo
#amphibian	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#amphibian
#animal	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#animal
#animalawe	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#animalawe <bonus>
#animated	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#animated "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#aoe	Defined	Spell, Weapon	M6.34 p10; M6.34 p51	#aoe <squares>
#ap	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p17	#ap <action points>
#appetite	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26	#appetite <value>
#aquatic	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#aquatic
#arena	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#arena
#arenagems	Defined	General	M6.34 p62	#arenagems <amount>
#arenagold	Defined	General	M6.34 p62	#arenagold <amount>
#armor	Defined	Item, Weapon	M6.34 p17; M6.34 p56	#armor "<armor name>" | <armor nbr>
#armornegating	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#armornegating
#armorpiercing	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#armorpiercing
#assassin	Defined	Event, Monster	E6.29 p14; M6.34 p20; M6.34 p60	#assassin "name" | <number>
#assencloc	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21	#assencloc <value>
#assfollower1	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#assfollower1 "name" | <number>
#assfollower1d3	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#assfollower1d3 "name" | <number>
#assfollower2	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#assfollower2 "name" | <number>
#assfollower3	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#assfollower3 "name" | <number>
#assowner	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#assowner <nation number>
#assownerench	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#assownerench <ench nbr>
#astralblessbonus	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#astralblessbonus <0 - 9>
#astralboost	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#astralboost "name" | <number>
#astralrange	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p33; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#astralrange <range>
#att	Defined	Item, Monster, Weapon	M6.34 p7; M6.34 p16; M6.34 p56; M6.34 p9	#att <attack>
#autoberserk	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25	#autoberserk <value>
#autobless	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#autobless
#autocompete	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p19; M6.34 p58	#autocompete

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#autocorpsehealer	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21	#autocorpsehealer <value>
#autodisgrinder	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59	#autodisgrinder <value>
#autodishealer	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59	#autodishealer <value>
#autohealer	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59	#autohealer <value>
#autospell	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p56	#autospell "<spell name>"
#autospellrepeat	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p56	#autospellrepeat <spells / round>
#autoundead	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#autoundead
#autumnshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#autumnshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#awe	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#awe <bonus>

B

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#badindpd	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#badindpd <0 or 1>
#banefireshield	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#banefireshield <damage>
#banished	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#banished <value>
#barkskin	Defined	Item	M6.34 p56	#barkskin
#batmap	Defined	Map	P6.26 p8	#batmap "<battlemap.d3m>
#batstartsum1	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#batstartsum1
#batstartsum1...5	Defined; template	Monster	M6.34 p29	#batstartsum1...5 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#batstartsum1d3	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p29	#batstartsum1d3 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#batstartsum1d6	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#batstartsum1d6
#batstartsum1d6...9d6	Defined; template	Monster	M6.34 p29	#batstartsum1d6...9d6 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#batstartsum2	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#batstartsum2
#batstartsum2d6	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#batstartsum2d6
#batstartsum3	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#batstartsum3
#batstartsum3d6	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#batstartsum3d6
#batstartsum4	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#batstartsum4
#batstartsum4d6	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#batstartsum4d6
#batstartsum5	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#batstartsum5
#batstartsum5d6	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#batstartsum5d6
#battleshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#battleshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#battlesum1	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#battlesum1
#battlesum1...5	Defined; template	Monster	M6.34 p29	#battlesum1...5 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#battlesum1d2	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61	#battlesum1d2 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#battlesum1d3	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61	#battlesum1d3 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#battlesum2	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#battlesum2
#battlesum3	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#battlesum3
#battlesum4	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#battlesum4
#battlesum5	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#battlesum5
#battlesumwarm	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61	#battlesumwarm "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#beam	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#beam
#beartattoo	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26	#beartattoo <value>
#beastmaster	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60	#beastmaster <bonus>
#beckon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21; M6.34 p58	#beckon <value>
#bers	Defined	Item	M6.34 p56	#bers
#berserk	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#berserk <bonus>
#bestowtomount	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#bestowtomount
#bird	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#bird
#bless	Defined	AI, Item	M6.34 p56; M6.34 p64	#bless
#blessairshld	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#blessairshld <value>
#blessanimawe	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#blessanimawe <value>
#blessatt	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#blessatt <value>
#blessawe	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#blessawe <value>
#blessbers	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#blessbers
#blessbonus	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#blessbonus <0 - 9>
#blesscoldres	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#blesscoldres <value>
#blessdarkvis	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#blessdarkvis <value>
#blessdef	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#blessdef <value>
#blessdtv	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#blessdtv <value>
#blessfireres	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#blessfireres <value>
#blessfly	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#blessfly
#blesshp	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#blesshp <value>
#blessmor	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#blessmor <value>
#blessmr	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#blessmr <value>
#blesspoisres	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#blesspoisres <value>
#blessprec	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#blessprec <value>
#blessreinvig	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#blessreinvig <value>
#blessshockres	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#blessshockres <value>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#blessstr	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#blessstr <value>
#blind	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#blind
#blink	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#blink
#bloodblessbonus	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#bloodblessbonus <0 - 9>
#bloodboost	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#bloodboost "name" | <number>
#bloodcost	Defined	Site	M6.34 p39	#bloodcost <bonus>
#bloodnation	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p44	#bloodnation
#bloodrange	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#bloodrange <range>
#bloodvengeance	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#bloodvengeance <strength>
#blunt	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#blunt
#bluntres	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#bluntres
#boartattoo	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26	#boartattoo <value>
#bodyguard	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60	#bodyguard <bonus>
#bodyguards	Defined	Map	P6.26 p8	#bodyguards <nbr> "<type>"
#bonus	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#bonus
#bonusspells	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#bonusspells <spells per round>
#bossname	Defined	Mercenary	M6.34 p63	#bossname "<name>"
#bowstr	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#bowstr
#bravemount	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#bravemount <percent>
#brief	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p42	#brief "<nation name>"
#bringeroffortune	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p36; M6.34 p60	#bringeroffortune
#bug	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#bug
#bugreform	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#bugreform <nbr of bugs>
#bugshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#bugshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#bugswarmshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#bugswarmshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#bugswarmuwshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#bugswarmuwshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#buguwshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#buguwshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#buildcoastfort	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#buildcoastfort <fort nbr>
#buildfort	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#buildfort <fort nbr>
#builduwfort	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#builduwfort <fort nbr>

C

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#cannotwin	Defined	Map	P6.26 p6	#cannotwin <nation nbr>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#carcasscollector	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p61	#carcasscollector <value>
#castledef	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60	#castledef <value>
#castleprod	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#castleprod <resource boost in percent>
#casttime	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p53	#casttime <1-1000>
#caveinc	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#caveinc <bonus>
#cavelabcost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#cavelabcost <price>
#cavenation	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#cavenation <0-3>
#caverecpt	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#caverecpt <bonus>
#caveres	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#caveres <bonus>
#cavetemplecost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#cavetemplecost <price>
#champprize	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#champprize
#chaospower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#chaospower <bonus>
#chaosrec	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15; M6.34 p58	#chaosrec <value>
#chaosrecscale	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#chaosrecscale <value>
#chaosscale	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#chaosscale <value>
#charge	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#charge
#cheapgod20	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#cheapgod20 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#cheapgod40	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#cheapgod40 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#chestwound	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#chestwound
#chorusmaster	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#chorusmaster
#chorusslave	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#chorusslave
#claim	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#claim
#claimthrone	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#claimthrone
#cleanshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#cleanshape
#clear	Defined	Armour, Event, Item, Monster, Names, Site, Spell, Weapon	E6.29 p2; M6.34 p7; M6.34 p12; M6.34 p13; M6.34 p36; +3	#clear
#clearallevents	Defined	Event	E6.29 p2	#clearallevents
#clearallitems	Defined	Item	M6.34 p55	#clearallitems
#clearallspells	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p50	#clearallspells
#cleararmor	Defined	Monster, Weapon	M6.34 p13	#cleararmor
#cleardef	Defined	Poptype	M6.34 p63	#cleardef
#clearfx	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#clearfx
#cleargods	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#cleargods
#clearmagic	Defined	Map, Monster	P6.26 p9; M6.34 p13	#clearmagic
#clearmercs	Defined	Mercenary	M6.34 p63	#clearmercs

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#clearnation	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p42	#clearnation
#clearrec	Defined	Nation, Poptype	M6.34 p45; M6.34 p63	#clearrec
#clearscales	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#clearscales
#clearsites	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#clearsites
#clearspec	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p13	#clearspec
#cleartarg	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#cleartarg
#clearvar	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#clearvar <event var>
#clearweapons	Defined	Monster, Weapon	M6.34 p13	#clearweapons
#clumsy	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#clumsy <0 or 1>
#cluster	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#cluster <value>
#coastcom1...2	Defined; template	Nation	M6.34 p45	#coastcom1...2 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#coastnation	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#coastnation
#coastunit1...3	Defined; template	Nation	M6.34 p45	#coastunit1...3 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#code	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17; E6.29 p19	#code <event code>
#code2	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#code2 <event code>
#codedelay	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#codedelay <event code>
#codedelay2	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#codedelay2 <event code>
#cold	Defined	Monster, Weapon	M6.34 p9; M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#cold
#coldblood	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#coldblood
#coldifhit	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p12	#coldifhit <dmg>
#coldincome	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#coldincome <percent>
#coldpower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#coldpower <bonus>
#coldrec	Mention	Monster	M6.34 p15	#coldrec
#coldrecscale	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#coldrecscale <value>
#coldres	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p56	#coldres <prot>
#coldscale	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#coldscale <value>
#coldsupply	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#coldsupply <percent>
#color	Defined	General, Nation	M6.34 p43; M6.34 p64	#color <red> <green> <blue>
#com	Defined	Event, Mercenary, Monster	E6.29 p14; M6.34 p38; M6.34 p63; E6.29 p19; E6.29 p20	#com "name" | <number>
#combatcaster	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p36; M6.34 p60	#combatcaster
#command	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31; M6.34 p60	#command <value>
#commander	Defined	Map	P6.26 p8	#commander "<type>"
#commaster	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#commaster
#comname	Defined	Map	P6.26 p8	#comname "<name>"
#computerplayer	Defined	Map	P6.26 p6	#computerplayer <nation nbr> <difficulty>
#comslave	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#comslave

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#conjcost	Defined	Site	M6.34 p39	#conjcost <bonus>
#constcost	Defined	Site	M6.34 p39	#constcost <bonus>
#constlevel	Defined	Item	M6.34 p55	#constlevel <level>
#copyarmor	Defined	Armour	M6.34 p12	#copyarmor "<armor name>" | <armor nbr>
#copyitem	Defined	Item	M6.34 p55	#copyitem "<item name>" | <item nbr>
#copysite	Defined	Site	M6.34 p37	#copysite "<site name>" | <site nbr>
#copyspell	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p50	#copyspell "<spell name>" | <spell nbr>
#copyspr	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p13; M6.34 p55	#copyspr <monster nbr>
#copystats	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p13	#copystats <monster nbr>
#copyweapon	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p7	#copyweapon "<weapon name>" | <weapon nbr>
#coridermnr	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30	#coridermnr "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#corpseeater	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22	#corpseeater <value>
#corpselord	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61	#corpselord <nbr>
#corruptor	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p59	#corruptor <value>
#cost0	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#cost0 <value>
#cost1	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#cost1 <value>
#crippled	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#crippled
#crossbreeder	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#crossbreeder <value>
#cure	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p54	#cure "text"
#curse	Defined	Event, Item, Site	E6.29 p15; M6.34 p40; M6.34 p57	#curse <percent>
#cursed	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#cursed
#curseluckshield	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#curseluckshield <penetration bonus>
#custommagic	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p33	#custommagic <path mask> <chance>

D

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
##dishe##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##dishe##
##dishim##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##dishim##
##dishimself##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##dishimself##
##disHis##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##disHis##
##dishis##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##dishis##

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
##disname##	Reference; message	Event, Spell	E6.29 p11; M6.34 p54	##disname##
##disnat##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##disnat##
#damage	Defined	Event, Spell	M6.34 p51; E6.29 p20	#damage <dmg>
#damagemon	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p51	#damagemon "<monster name>"
#damagerev	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#damagerev <strength>
#dancenof	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p58	#dancenof <nbr of sprites>
#dancenratt	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p58	#dancenratt <attacks>
#dancesize	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p58	#dancesize <size>
#dancespr	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p58	#dancespr <flysprite nbr>
#danceweapon	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p58	#danceweapon "<weapon name>" | <weapon nbr>
#darkpower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#darkpower <bonus>
#darkvision	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#darkvision <percent>
#deadhp	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#deadhp <value>
#deathbanish	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#deathbanish <-11 to -13>
#deathblessbonus	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#deathblessbonus <0 - 9>
#deathboost	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16; E6.29 p19	#deathboost "name" | <number>
#deathcurse	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59	#deathcurse
#deathdeath	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#deathdeath <0.01 percent>
#deathdisease	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59	#deathdisease <aoe>
#deathfire	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59	#deathfire <aoe>
#deathgrab	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26	#deathgrab <aoe>
#deathincome	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#deathincome <percent>
#deathparalyze	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59	#deathparalyze <aoe>
#deathpoison	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26	#deathpoison <aoe>
#deathpower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#deathpower <bonus>
#deathrange	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#deathrange <range>
#deathrec	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#deathrec <value>
#deathrecscale	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#deathrecscale <value>
#deathscale	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#deathscale <value>
#deathshock	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26	#deathshock <aoe>
#deathslime	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26	#deathslime <aoe>
#deathsupply	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#deathsupply <percent>
#dec10var	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#dec10var <event var>
#decayres	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p56	#decayres <0 or 1>
#decscale	Defined	Event, Monster, Site	E6.29 p12; M6.34 p27; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#decscale <scale>
#decscale2	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#decscale2 <scale>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#decscale3	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12; E6.29 p19	#decscale3 <scale>
#decunrest	Defined	Site	M6.34 p38	#decunrest <value>
#decvar	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#decvar <event var>
#def	Defined	Armour, Item, Monster, Weapon	M6.34 p7; M6.34 p12; M6.34 p16; M6.34 p56; M6.34 p9	#def <defense>
#defchaos	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#defchaos <-5 - 5>
#defcom	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#defcom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#defcom1	Defined	Nation, Poptype	M6.34 p45; M6.34 p63	#defcom1 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#defcom2	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#defcom2 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#defdeath	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#defdeath <-5 - 5>
#defdrain	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#defdrain <-5 - 5>
#defector	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#defector <percent>
#defence	Defined	Event, Map	E6.29 p13; P6.26 p8	#defence <value>
#defmisfortune	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#defmisfortune <-5 - 5>
#defmult	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#defmult <multiplier>
#defmult1	Defined	Nation, Poptype	M6.34 p46; M6.34 p63	#defmult1 <multiplier>
#defmult1b	Defined	Nation, Poptype	M6.34 p46; M6.34 p63	#defmult1b <multiplier>
#defmult1c	Defined	Nation, Poptype	M6.34 p46; M6.34 p63	#defmult1c <multiplier>
#defmult1d	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#defmult1d <multiplier>
#defmult2	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#defmult2 <multiplier>
#defmult2b	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#defmult2b <multiplier>
#defroll	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#defroll
#defsloth	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#defsloth <-5 - 5>
#defunit	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#defunit "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#defunit1	Defined	Nation, Poptype	M6.34 p46; M6.34 p63	#defunit1 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#defunit1b	Defined	Nation, Poptype	M6.34 p46; M6.34 p63	#defunit1b "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#defunit1c	Defined	Nation, Poptype	M6.34 p46; M6.34 p63	#defunit1c "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#defunit1d	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#defunit1d "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#defunit2	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#defunit2 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#defunit2b	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#defunit2b "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#delay	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17; E6.29 p19	#delay <value>
#delay25	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#delay25 <value>
#delay50	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#delay50 <value>
#delayskip	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#delayskip <percent>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#delgod	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#delgod "<monster>" | <monster nbr>
#demon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#demon
#demononly	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#demononly
#demonundead	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#demonundead
#descr	Defined	Event, General, Item, Monster, Nation, Spell	M6.34 p13; M6.34 p42; M6.34 p50; M6.34 p56; E6.29 p20; +1	#descr "<text description>"
#description	Defined	General, Map, Metadata	P6.26 p3; M6.34 p5; M6.34 p64	#description "text"
#deserter	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#deserter <percent>
#details	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p50	#details "<text>"
#digest	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#digest <dmg>
#disableoldnations	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p43	#disableoldnations
#disbless	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#disbless "bless name" | <nbr>
#disease	Defined	Event, Item, Site	E6.29 p15; M6.34 p40; M6.34 p57	#disease <percent>
#diseasecloud	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#diseasecloud <size>
#diseaseres	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59	#diseaseres <percent>
#dispglobals	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#dispglobals <str>
#dispimmune	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p54	#dispimmune <0 - 2>
#divinebeing	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#divinebeing
#divineins	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#divineins
#djinn	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#djinn
#dmg	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p7; M6.34 p9	#dmg <damage>
#doheal	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#doheal
#dom2title	Defined	Map	P6.26 p3	#dom2title <text>
#dom6title	Mention	Map	P6.26 p3	#dom6title
#domdeathsense	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#domdeathsense
#domimmortal	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#domimmortal
#dominion	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#dominion <temple checks per month>
#dominionstr	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#dominionstr <nation nbr> <1-10>
#domkill	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#domkill <value>
#dompower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#dompower <bonus>
#domrec	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#domrec <dominion>
#domsail	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#domsail
#domshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#domshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#domstr	Defined	AI	M6.34 p64	#domstr <level>
#domsummon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61	#domsummon "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#domsummon2	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61	#domsummon2 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#domsummon20	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61	#domsummon20 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#domunrest	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#domunrest <value>
#domversion	Defined	Map, Metadata	P6.26 p3; M6.34 p5	#domversion <version>
#domwar	Defined	Nation, Site	M6.34 p41; M6.34 p49	#domwar <value>
#doomhorror	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#doomhorror
#douse	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#douse <bonus>
#dragonlord	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61	#dragonlord <nbr>
#drainimmune	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#drainimmune
#drainscale	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#drainscale <value>
#drake	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#drake
#drawsize	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p13	#drawsize <value>
#dread	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24	#dread <value>
#dt_aff	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8; M6.34 p9	#dt_aff
#dt_bouncekill	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_bouncekill
#dt_cap	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_cap
#dt_constructonly	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_constructonly
#dt_demon	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_demon
#dt_drain	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_drain
#dt_holy	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_holy
#dt_interrupt	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_interrupt
#dt_large	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_large
#dt_magic	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_magic
#dt_normal	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p7	#dt_normal
#dt_paralyze	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_paralyze
#dt_poison	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p7	#dt_poison
#dt_raise	Defined	Monster, Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_raise
#dt_realstun	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_realstun
#dt_sizestun	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_sizestun
#dt_small	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_small
#dt_stun	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_stun
#dt_weakness	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_weakness
#dt_weapondrain	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p8	#dt_weapondrain
#dungeon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#dungeon
#dyingdom	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#dyingdom

E

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#earthblessbonus	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#earthblessbonus <0 - 9>
#earthboost	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#earthboost "name" | <number>
#earthelementals	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61	#earthelementals <bonus>
#earthrange	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p33; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#earthrange <range>
#effect	Defined	Event, Spell	M6.34 p51; E6.29 p20	#effect <eff>
#elegist	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60	#elegist <value>
#elementgems	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#elementgems <gems>
#elementrange	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#elementrange <range>
#emigration	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#emigration <percent>
#enc	Defined	Armour, Monster	M6.34 p12; M6.34 p17	#enc <encumbrance>
#enchantedblood	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p57	#enchantedblood <points>
#enchcost	Defined	Site	M6.34 p39	#enchcost <bonus>
#enchrebate10	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p14	#enchrebate10 <enchantment number>
#enchrebate100	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#enchrebate100 <enchantment number>
#enchrebate20	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#enchrebate20 <enchantment number>
#enchrebate25p	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#enchrebate25p <enchantment number>
#enchrebate50	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#enchrebate50 <enchantment number>
#enchrebate50p	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#enchrebate50p <enchantment number>
#enchrebate75	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#enchrebate75 <enchantment number>
#end	Defined	AI, Armour, Bless, Event, General, Item, Mercenary, Monster, Names, Nation, Poptype, Site, Sound, Spell, Weapon	E6.29 p2; M6.34 p5; M6.34 p6; M6.34 p12; M6.34 p13; +10	#end
#enemyimmune	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#enemyimmune
#entangle	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24	#entangle
#epithet	Defined	General, Nation	M6.34 p42; M6.34 p64	#epithet "<nation name>"
#era	Defined	General, Nation	M6.34 p42; M6.34 p64	#era <era nbr>
#eramask	Defined	Mercenary	M6.34 p63	#eramask <value>
#ethereal	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#ethereal
#eventisrare	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#eventisrare <percent>
#evil	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#evil
#evocost	Defined	Site	M6.34 p39	#evocost <bonus>
#exactgold	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#exactgold <value>
#expertleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#expertleader
#expertmagicleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#expertmagicleader

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#expertundeadleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#expertundeadleader
#explspr	Defined	Sound, Weapon	M6.34 p11; M6.34 p52	#explspr <fx nbr>
#extralife	Defined	Item	M6.34 p56	#extralife
#extralives	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22	#extralives <percent>
#extramsg	Defined	Event	E6.29 p11	#extramsg <nation number>
#eyeloss	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#eyeloss
#eyes	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p17	#eyes <nbr of eyes>

F

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
##fullgodname##	Reference; message	Event, Spell	E6.29 p11; M6.34 p54	##fullgodname##
##fullplayergodname##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##fullplayergodname##
##fullplayername##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##fullplayername##
##fulltargname##	Reference; message	Event	E6.29 p11	##fulltargname##
#fallpower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#fallpower <percent>
#false	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#false
#falsearmy	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21; M6.34 p58	#falsearmy <value>
#falseregen	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#falseregen <points>
#falsesupply	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60	#falsesupply <value>
#farsail	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58	#farsail <extra provinces>
#farsumcom	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p53	#farsumcom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#farthronekill	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#farthronekill <part>
#fastcast	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#fastcast <speedup>
#fatiguecost	Defined	Event, Spell	M6.34 p51; E6.29 p20	#fatiguecost <fat>
#favrit	Defined	AI	M6.34 p64	#favrit <disschool> <level> "ritual name" | "item name"
#faysummon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30	#faysummon <nbr>
#fear	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#fear <value>
#fearofflood	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59	#fearofflood <value>
#feature	Defined	Map	P6.26 p7	#feature "<site name>" | <site nbr>
#features	Defined	Map	P6.26 p4	#features <0-100>
#feeblemind	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#feeblemind
#female	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#female
#fire	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#fire
#fireattuned	Mention	Monster	M6.34 p28	#fireattuned

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#fireblessbonus	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#fireblessbonus <0 - 9>
#fireboost	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#fireboost "name" | <number>
#fireelementals	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61	#fireelementals <bonus>
#fireifhit	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p12	#fireifhit <dmg>
#firepower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#firepower <bonus>
#firerange	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p33; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#firerange <range>
#fireres	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p56	#fireres <prot>
#fireshield	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#fireshield <damage>
#firstshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27	#firstshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#fixedname	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p13	#fixedname "<Name>"
#fixedresearch	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34	#fixedresearch <value>
#fixforgebonus	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#fixforgebonus <value>
#flag	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p43	#flag "<imgfile>"
#flagland	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17; E6.29 p19	#flagland < 0 | 1 >
#flail	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#flail
#flightspr	Defined	Sound	M6.34 p52	#flightspr <flysprite nbr>
#float	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p19; M6.34 p57	#float
#fly	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#fly
#flying	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#flying
#flyingimmune	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#flyingimmune
#flyspr	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p11	#flyspr <flysprite nbr> <animation lgth>
#fogcol	Defined	Map	P6.26 p8	#fogcol <red> <green> <blue>
#foolscouts	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59	#foolscouts <value>
#force1d3vis	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#force1d3vis <gem type>
#force1d6vis	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#force1d6vis <gem type>
#force2d4vis	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#force2d4vis <gem type>
#force2d6vis	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#force2d6vis <gem type>
#force3d6vis	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#force3d6vis <gem type>
#force4d6vis	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#force4d6vis <gem type>
#forceexactgold	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#forceexactgold <value>
#forcegold	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#forcegold <value>
#forcess	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#forcess
#forcetransform	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#forcetransform "name" | <number>
#foreignguardcom	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#foreignguardcom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#foreignguardmult	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#foreignguardmult <multiplier>
#foreignguardunit	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#foreignguardunit "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#foreignshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#foreignshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#foreignwallcom	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#foreignwallcom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#foreignwallmult	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#foreignwallmult <multiplier>
#foreignwallunit	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#foreignwallunit "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#forestlabcost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#forestlabcost <price>
#forestrec	Mention	Nation	M6.34 p45	#forestrec
#forestshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#forestshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#forestsurvival	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#forestsurvival
#foresttemplecost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#foresttemplecost <price>
#forgebonus	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#forgebonus <percent>
#form	Defined	AI	M6.34 p64	#form "monster name"
#formationfighter	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60	#formationfighter <xsize>
#fort	Defined	Event, Map, Site	E6.29 p13; P6.26 p8; M6.34 p40	#fort <fort number>
#fortcoldscaleres	Defined	Site	M6.34 p44	#fortcoldscaleres <steps>
#fortcost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#fortcost <extra cost>
#fortera	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#fortera <0-4>
#fortheatscaleres	Defined	Site	M6.34 p44	#fortheatscaleres <steps>
#fortkill	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#fortkill <chance>
#fortunrest	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#fortunrest <value>
#friendlyench	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p53	#friendlyench <0 - 1>
#friendlyimmune	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#friendlyimmune
#fullstr	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#fullstr
#futuresite	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#futuresite "<site name>"

G

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
##goddisname##	Reference; message	Event	E6.29 p11	##goddisname##
##godhe##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##godhe##

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
##godhim##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##godhim##
##godhimself##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##godhimself##
##godHis##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##godHis##
##godhis##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##godhis##
##godname##	Reference; message	Event, Spell	E6.29 p11; M6.34 p54	##godname##
##godnat##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##godnat##
##godthrone##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##godthrone##
#gainaff	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#gainaff <affliction bitmask>
#gainmark	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#gainmark
#gate	Defined	Map	P6.26 p4	#gate <province nbr> <gate nbr>
#gcost	Defined	General, Monster	M6.34 p14; M6.34 p15	#gcost <gold>
#gemlongevity	Defined	General	M6.34 p62	#gemlongevity <level>
#gemloss	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#gemloss <gem type>
#gemlosslarge	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#gemlosslarge <gem type>
#gemlosssmall	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#gemlosssmall <gem type>
#gemprod	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#gemprod <type> <number>
#gems	Defined	Site	M6.34 p38	#gems <path> <amount>
#ghostreanim	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p50	#ghostreanim
#giftofwater	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58	#giftofwater <size points>
#glamour	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#glamour
#glamourboost	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#glamourboost "name" | <number>
#glamourmanip	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#glamourmanip <0 or 1>
#glamourrange	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#glamourrange <range>
#globallook	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p54	#globallook <1 - 9>
#god	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#god <nation nbr> "<type>"
#goddomchaos	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#goddomchaos <value>
#goddomcold	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#goddomcold <value>
#goddomdeath	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#goddomdeath <value>
#goddomdrain	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#goddomdrain <value>
#goddomlazy	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#goddomlazy <value>
#goddommisfortune	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#goddommisfortune <value>
#godpathspell	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p53	#godpathspell <-1 - 7>
#godrebirth	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#godrebirth
#godsite	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p14	#godsite "<site name>" | <site nbr>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#gold	Defined	Event, Monster, Site	E6.29 p12; M6.34 p27; M6.34 p38; E6.29 p20; M6.34 p60	#gold <value>
#golemhp	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#golemhp <percent>
#goodleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#goodleader
#goodmagicleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#goodmagicleader
#goodundeadleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#goodundeadleader
#grandcom	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#grandcom <0 or 1>
#greaterhorror	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#greaterhorror
#greekreanim	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p50	#greekreanim
#groundcol	Defined	Map	P6.26 p8	#groundcol <red> <green> <blue>
#growhp	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#growhp <hit points>
#growthpower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#growthpower <bonus>
#growthrecscale	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#growthrecscale <value>
#growthscale	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#growthscale <value>
#guardcom	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#guardcom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#guardmult	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#guardmult <multiplier>
#guardspirit	Defined	Monster, Nation	M6.34 p49	#guardspirit "<monster name>" | <nbr>
#guardspiritbonus	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p57	#guardspiritbonus <value>
#guardunit	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p46	#guardunit "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>

H

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#halfdeathinc	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#halfdeathinc
#halfdeathpop	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#halfdeathpop
#halfstr	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#halfstr
#haltheretic	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#haltheretic <bonus>
#hardmrneg	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#hardmrneg
#hatesterr	Defined	Site	M6.34 p44	#hatesterr <terrain mask>
#header	Defined	Event	E6.29 p11	#header <type>
#heal	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p21; M6.34 p40	#heal
#healaff	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#healaff <nbr>
#healer	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59	#healer <percent>
#heat	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#heat <value>
#heatrec	Mention	Monster	M6.34 p15	#heatrec
#heatrecscale	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#heatrecscale <value>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#heatscale	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#heatscale <value>
#heavyitem	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#heavyitem <0 or 1>
#heretic	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60	#heretic <value>
#hero1...10	Defined; template	Nation	M6.34 p45	#hero1...10 <monster nbr>
#hiddenench	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p53	#hiddenench <0 - 1>
#hiddensite	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#hiddensite <site number>
#hidedom	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#hidedom <0 or 1>
#holy	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#holy
#holyboost	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#holyboost "name" | <number>
#holycost	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#holycost <holy points>
#holyfire	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#holyfire <chance>
#holyifhit	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p11	#holyifhit <dmg>
#holypower	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#holypower <chance>
#holyrange	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#holyrange <range>
#holystunifhit	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p11	#holystunifhit <dmg>
#homecoldscaleres	Defined	Site	M6.34 p44	#homecoldscaleres <steps>
#homecom	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#homecom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#homefort	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#homefort <fort nbr>
#homeheatscaleres	Defined	Site	M6.34 p44	#homeheatscaleres <steps>
#homemon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#homemon "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#homerealm	Defined	General, Monster, Nation, Spell	M6.34 p14; M6.34 p47; M6.34 p53; M6.34 p64	#homerealm <realm nbr>
#homeshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#homeshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#homesick	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59	#homesick <percent>
#horrordeserter	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#horrordeserter <percent>
#horrormark	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p40	#horrormark
#horsereanim	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p50	#horsereanim
#horsetattoo	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26	#horsetattoo <value>
#hp	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p16; M6.34 p56	#hp <hit points>
#hpoverflow	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#hpoverflow
#humanoid	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#humanoid

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#iceforging	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60	#iceforging <value>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#icenatprot	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#icenatprot <prot>
#iceprot	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#iceprot <prot>
#iceweapon	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#iceweapon
#icon	Defined	General, Metadata	M6.34 p5	#icon "<image.tga>"
#id	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#id <eventid>
#idealcold	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#idealcold <cold>
#illusion	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#illusion
#illusionsimmune	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#illusionsimmune
#imagefile	Defined	Map	P6.26 p3	#imagefile <filename>
#immobile	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#immobile
#immortal	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#immortal
#inanimate	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#inanimate
#inanimateimmune	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#inanimateimmune
#inc10var	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#inc10var <event var>
#inccorpses	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#inccorpses <amount>
#incdom	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#incdom <value>
#incorporate	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#incorporate <dmg>
#incpop	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#incpop <dekapop>
#incprovdef	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#incprovdef <value>
#incscale	Defined	Event, Monster, Site	E6.29 p12; M6.34 p27; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#incscale <scale>
#incscale2	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12; E6.29 p19	#incscale2 <scale>
#incscale3	Defined	Event	E6.29 p12	#incscale3 <scale>
#incunrest	Defined	Event, Monster	M6.34 p27; E6.29 p19; M6.34 p60	#incunrest <value>
#incvar	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#incvar <event var>
#indepflag	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p41	#indepflag "<imgfile>"
#indepmove	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#indepmove <percent>
#indepspells	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35	#indepspells <level>
#indepstay	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#indepstay <0 - 1>
#infernoret	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#infernoret <chance>
#inquisitor	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60	#inquisitor
#insane	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22	#insane <percent>
#insanify	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#insanify <percent>
#inspirational	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60	#inspirational <bonus>
#inspiringres	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#inspiringres <value>
#internal	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#internal
#invisible	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#invisible
#invulnerable	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#invulnerable <prot>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#invvar	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#invvar <event var>
#ironarmor	Defined	Armour	M6.34 p13	#ironarmor
#ironskin	Defined	Item	M6.34 p56	#ironskin
#ironvul	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#ironvul <points>
#ironweapon	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#ironweapon
#islance	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#islance
#islandnation	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#islandnation
#islandsite	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#islandsite "<site name>"
#item	Defined	Mercenary	M6.34 p63	#item "<item name>"
#itemcost1	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#itemcost1 <bonus>
#itemcost2	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#itemcost2 <bonus>
#itemdrawsize	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#itemdrawsize <value>
#itemslots	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#itemslots <slot value>
#ivylord	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61	#ivylord <nbr>

K

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#kill	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#kill <percent>
#kill2d6mon	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#kill2d6mon "name" | <number>
#killcappop	Defined	Site	M6.34 p44	#killcappop <percent>
#killcom	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#killcom "name" | <number>
#killdemonifhit	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p11	#killdemonifhit <dmg>
#killfeatures	Defined	Map	P6.26 p7	#killfeatures
#killmagicifhit	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p11	#killmagicifhit <dmg>
#killmon	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#killmon "name" | <number>
#killpop	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#killpop <dekapop>
#killtarg	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#killtarg
#knownfeature	Defined	Map	P6.26 p8	#knownfeature "<site name>" | <site nbr>
#kokytosret	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#kokytosret <chance>

L

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
##landname##	Reference; message	Event	E6.29 p11	##landname##
#lab	Defined	Event, Map, Site	E6.29 p13; P6.26 p8; M6.34 p40	#lab < 0 | 1>
#labcost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#labcost <price>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#labxpshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#labxpshape <xp value>
#lamialord	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61	#lamialord <nbr>
#lanceok	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#lanceok
#land	Defined	Map	P6.26 p6	#land <province nbr>
#landcom	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#landcom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#landdamage	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21	#landdamage <percent>
#landgold	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#landgold <value>
#landname	Defined	Map	P6.26 p4	#landname <province nbr> "name"
#landprod	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#landprod <value>
#landrec	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#landrec "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#landshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#landshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#latehero	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p33	#latehero <min turn>
#len	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p7; M6.34 p9	#len <length>
#leper	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#leper <percent>
#lesserhorror	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#lesserhorror
#level	Defined	Mercenary, Site	M6.34 p38; M6.34 p63	#level <level>
#lich	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#lich "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#likespop	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#likespop <poptype>
#likesterr	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#likesterr <terrain mask>
#limitedregen	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#limitedregen <percent>
#linger	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#linger <nbr of turns>
#lizard	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#lizard
#loc	Defined	Site	M6.34 p37	#loc <locmask>
#localglobal	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p54	#localglobal <0 - 1>
#localsun	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#localsun
#look	Defined	Site	M6.34 p37	#look <site spr>
#loop	Defined	Sound	M6.34 p5	#loop <sample nbr>
#loseeye	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#loseeye
#luck	Defined	Item	M6.34 p56	#luck
#luckevents	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#luckevents <percent>
#luckscale	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#luckscale <value>

M

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#mag_air	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#mag_air <level>
#mag_astral	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#mag_astral <level>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#mag_blood	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#mag_blood <level>
#mag_death	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#mag_death <level>
#mag_earth	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#mag_earth <level>
#mag_fire	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#mag_fire <level>
#mag_glamour	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#mag_glamour <level>
#mag_nature	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#mag_nature <level>
#mag_priest	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#mag_priest <level>
#mag_water	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#mag_water <level>
#magic	Defined	AI, Weapon	M6.34 p9; M6.34 p64	#magic
#magicarmor	Defined	Armour	M6.34 p13	#magicarmor
#magicbeing	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#magicbeing
#magicboost	Defined	Monster, Spell	M6.34 p33; M6.34 p56	#magicboost <path> <boost>
#magiccommand	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60	#magiccommand <value>
#magicimmune	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#magicimmune
#magicitem	Defined	Event	E6.29 p11; E6.29 p19	#magicitem <rarity>
#magiconly	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#magiconly
#magicpower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#magicpower <bonus>
#magicscale	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#magicscale <value>
#magicskill	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p33	#magicskill <path> <level>
#magicstudy	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#magicstudy <bonus>
#mainlevel	Defined	Item	M6.34 p55	#mainlevel <path>
#mainpath	Defined	Item	M6.34 p55	#mainpath <path>
#makecrater	Defined	Sound	M6.34 p52	#makecrater <0 or 1>
#makemonsters1	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#makemonsters1
#makemonsters1...5	Defined; template	Monster	M6.34 p29	#makemonsters1...5 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#makemonsters2	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#makemonsters2
#makemonsters3	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#makemonsters3
#makemonsters4	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#makemonsters4
#makemonsters5	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#makemonsters5
#makepearls	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#makepearls <value>
#manikinreanim	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p50	#manikinreanim
#mapdomcol	Defined	Map	P6.26 p4	#mapdomcol <red> <green> <blue> <alpha>
#mapmove	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p17	#mapmove <speed>
#mapnohide	Defined	Map	P6.26 p3	#mapnohide
#mapsize	Defined	Map	P6.26 p3	#mapsize <width> <height>
#mapspeed	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#mapspeed <value>
#mapteleport	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#mapteleport

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#maptextcol	Defined	Map	P6.26 p4	#maptextcol <red> <green> <blue> <alpha>
#mason	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#mason
#masterrit	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p33	#masterrit <value>
#mastersmith	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35	#mastersmith <value>
#maxage	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21	#maxage <age>
#maxbounces	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p54	#maxbounces <bounces>
#maxdeadhp	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#maxdeadhp <HP>
#maxprison	Defined	Monster, Nation	M6.34 p14; M6.34 p47	#maxprison <0 - 2>
#maxsize	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#maxsize <size>
#maybeaddsite	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#maybeaddsite <site number>
#maybehiddensite	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#maybehiddensite <site number>
#melee50	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#melee50
#merccost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#merccost <percent>
#minascension	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#minascension <AP>
#mind	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#mind
#mindcollar	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60	#mindcollar <dmg>
#mindslime	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#mindslime <area>
#mindvessel	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27	#mindvessel <0 or 1>
#minmen	Defined	Mercenary	M6.34 p63	#minmen <value>
#minpay	Defined	Mercenary	M6.34 p63	#minpay <gold>
#minprison	Defined	Monster, Nation	M6.34 p14; M6.34 p47	#minprison <0 - 2>
#minsize	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#minsize <size>
#minsizeleader	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p36	#minsizeleader
#miscshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#miscshape
#misfortscale	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#misfortscale <value>
#misfortune	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#misfortune<percent>
#mobilearcher	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58	#mobilearcher <0 or 1>
#modname	Defined	General, Metadata	M6.34 p5; M6.34 p64	#modname "<name>"
#mon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#mon "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#monpresentrec	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#monpresentrec "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#montag	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p29	#montag <value>
#montagweight	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30	#montagweight <weight>
#mor	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p17	#mor <morale>
#morale	Defined	Item	M6.34 p56	#morale <value>
#moregrowth	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p14; M6.34 p44	#moregrowth <-5 - 5>
#moreheat	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p14; M6.34 p44	#moreheat <-5 - 5>
#moreluck	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p14; M6.34 p44	#moreluck <-5 - 5>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#moremagic	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p14; M6.34 p44	#moremagic <-5 - 5>
#moreorder	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p14; M6.34 p44	#moreorder <-5 - 5>
#moreprod	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p14; M6.34 p44	#moreprod <-5 - 5>
#morroll	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#morroll
#mountainsurvival	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#mountainsurvival
#mounted	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#mounted
#mountedhumanoid	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#mountedhumanoid
#mountiscom	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#mountiscom <0 or 1>
#mountlabcost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#mountlabcost <price>
#mountmnr	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30	#mountmnr "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#mounttemplecost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#mounttemplecost <price>
#mr	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p17; M6.34 p56	#mr <magic resistance>
#mrhalf	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#mrhalf
#mrnegates	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#mrnegates
#mrnegateseasily	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#mrnegateseasily
#msg	Defined	Event	E6.29 p11; E6.29 p5; E6.29 p19; E6.29 p20	#msg "<message text>"
#multihero1	Mention	Nation	M6.34 p45	#multihero1
#multihero1...7	Defined; template	Nation	M6.34 p45	#multihero1...7 <monster nbr>
#mute	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#mute

N

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
##natname##	Reference; message	Event	E6.29 p11	##natname##
#naga	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#naga
#name	Defined	Armour, Bless, Event, General, Item, Mercenary, Monster, Nation, Site, Spell, Weapon	M6.34 p7; M6.34 p12; M6.34 p13; M6.34 p37; M6.34 p42; +6	#name "<name>"
#nametype	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30	#nametype <name type nbr>
#napbreakrit	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p54	#napbreakrit <value>
#nat	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#nat <nation nbr>
#natcom	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#natcom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#nation	Defined	Event	E6.29 p11; E6.29 p19	#nation <nation number>
#nationench	Defined	Event	E6.29 p11; E6.29 p20	#nationench <ench nbr>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#nationinc	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#nationinc <percent>
#nationrebate	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#nationrebate <nation nbr> | "nation name"
#natmon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#natmon "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#natural	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p7	#natural
#natureblessbonus	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#natureblessbonus <0 - 9>
#natureboost	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#natureboost "name" | <number>
#naturerange	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#naturerange <range>
#neednoteat	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26	#neednoteat
#neighbour	Defined	Map	P6.26 p4	#neighbour <province nbr> <province nbr>
#neighbourspec	Defined	Map	P6.26 p4	#neighbourspec <land1> <land2> <spcnbr>
#newarmor	Defined	Armour	M6.34 p12	#newarmor <armor nbr>
#newdom	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#newdom <value>
#newevent	Defined	Event	E6.29 p2; E6.29 p19; E6.29 p20	#newevent
#newitem	Defined	Item	M6.34 p55	#newitem
#newmerc	Defined	Mercenary	M6.34 p63	#newmerc
#newmonster	Defined	General, Monster	M6.34 p13	#newmonster [<monster nbr>]
#newnation	Defined	General, Item, Nation, Spell	M6.34 p42; M6.34 p64	#newnation
#newsite	Defined	General, Site	M6.34 p37	#newsite [<site nbr>]
#newspell	Defined	Event, General, Spell	M6.34 p50; E6.29 p20	#newspell
#newtemplate	Defined	AI	M6.34 p63	#newtemplate <nation nbr>
#newweapon	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p7; M6.34 p9	#newweapon <weapon nbr>
#nextingeo	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p51	#nextingeo <terrain mask>
#nextspell	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p51	#nextspell "<spell name>" | <nbr>
#nhwound	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#nhwound
#nightmareaura	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24	#nightmareaura <area>
#noaging	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#noaging <percent>
#noagingland	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#noagingland <percent>
#nobadevents	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#nobadevents <value>
#nobarding	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#nobarding
#nocastmindless	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p53	#nocastmindless <0 - 1>
#nocoldblood	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#nocoldblood
#nodeathsupply	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#nodeathsupply
#nodeepcaves	Defined	Map	P6.26 p3	#nodeepcaves
#nodeepchoice	Defined	Map	P6.26 p3	#nodeepchoice

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#nodemon	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#nodemon
#nofalldmg	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#nofalldmg
#nofemale	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#nofemale
#nofind	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#nofind
#nofmounts	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30	#nofmounts <mounts>
#noforeignrec	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#noforeignrec
#noforgebonus	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#noforgebonus
#nofriders	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30	#nofriders <riders>
#nogeodst	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#nogeodst <terrain mask>
#nogeosrc	Mention	Spell	M6.34 p52	#nogeosrc
#noheal	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21	#noheal
#nohof	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27	#nohof
#nohomelandnam es	Defined	Map	P6.26 p5	#nohomelandnames
#noimmobile	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#noimmobile
#noinanim	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#noinanim
#noitem	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#noitem
#nolandtrace	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#nolandtrace <0 or 1>
#noleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#noleader
#nolog	Defined	Event	E6.29 p11	#nolog
#nomagicleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#nomagicleader
#nomounted	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#nomounted
#nomovepen	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58	#nomovepen
#nonamefilter	Defined	Map	P6.26 p5	#nonamefilter
#nopreach	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#nopreach
#norange	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58	#norange <chance>
#noremount	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#noremount
#norepel	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#norepel
#noreqlab	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#noreqlab
#noreqtemple	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#noreqtemple
#noriverpass	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58	#noriverpass
#noslowrec	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p14	#noslowrec
#nospiritform	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#nospiritform
#nostart	Defined	Map	P6.26 p6	#nostart <province nbr>
#nostr	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#nostr
#notdismounted	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p11	#notdismounted
#notdomshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#notdomshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#notext	Defined	Event	E6.29 p11; E6.29 p20	#notext

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#notfornation	Defined	Item, Spell	M6.34 p53; M6.34 p57	#notfornation <nation nbr> | "nation name"
#nothrowoff	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#nothrowoff
#notindoors	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p54	#notindoors <-1 to 1>
#notmnr	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p53	#notmnr "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#notmounted	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p11	#notmounted <1 - 2>
#noundead	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#noundead
#noundeadgods	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#noundeadgods
#noundeadleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#noundeadleader
#nouw	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p11	#nouw
#nowatertrace	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#nowatertrace <0 or 1>
#noweapon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#noweapon <0 or 1>
#nowish	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#nowish
#nratt	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p7	#nratt <nbr of attacks>
#nreff	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#nreff <nbr of effects>
#nrunits	Defined	Mercenary	M6.34 p63	#nrunits <value>

O

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#okleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#okleader
#okmagicleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#okmagicleader
#okundeadleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#okundeadleader
#older	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21	#older <age>
#onebattlespell	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35	#onebattlespell "<spell name>" | <nbr>
#onisummon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61	#onisummon <0 - 100>
#onlyatsite	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#onlyatsite <"site name"> | <site nbr>
#onlycoastsrc	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#onlycoastsrc <0 - 1>
#onlycoldblood	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#onlycoldblood
#onlydemon	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#onlydemon
#onlyfemale	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#onlyfemale
#onlyfriendlydst	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#onlyfriendlydst <0 - 2>
#onlygeodst	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#onlygeodst <terrain mask>
#onlygeosrc	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#onlygeosrc <terrain mask>
#onlyimmobile	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#onlyimmobile
#onlyinanim	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#onlyinanim

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#onlymnr	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p53	#onlymnr "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#onlymounted	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#onlymounted
#onlyowndst	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#onlyowndst <0 or 1>
#onlysitedst	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#onlysitedst <"site name"> | <site nbr>
#onlyundead	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#onlyundead
#order	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#order <order bitmask>
#orderrecscale	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#orderrecscale <value>
#orderscale	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#orderscale <value>
#overcharged	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#overcharged <dmg>
#owner	Defined	Map	P6.26 p7	#owner <nation nbr>
#ownsmonrec	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#ownsmonrec "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>

P

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
##playergodname##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##playergodname##
##playergodthrone##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##playergodthrone##
##playername##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##playername##
##playerthrone##	Reference; message	Spell	M6.34 p54	##playerthrone##
##profname##	Reference; message	Event	E6.29 p11	##profname##
#path	Defined	Event, Site, Spell	M6.34 p37; M6.34 p50; E6.29 p20	#path <path nbr>
#path0	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#path0 <path nbr>
#path1	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#path1 <path nbr>
#pathboost	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#pathboost <path>
#pathcost	Defined	Monster, Nation	M6.34 p14	#pathcost <design points>
#pathlevel	Defined	Event, Spell	M6.34 p50; E6.29 p20	#pathlevel <reqnr> <level>
#patience	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#patience <value>
#patrolbonus	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60	#patrolbonus <value>
#pb	Defined	Map	P6.26 p4	#pb <x> <y> <len> <province nbr>
#pen	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p56	#pen <value>
#petrifyifhit	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p11	#petrifyifhit <dmg>
#pierce	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#pierce
#pierceres	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#pierceres
#pillagebonus	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60	#pillagebonus <value>
#plaguedoctor	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59	#plaguedoctor <percent>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#plainshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#plainshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#planename	Defined	Map	P6.26 p3	#planename <text>
#plant	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#plant
#poison	Defined	Event, Weapon	E6.29 p15; M6.34 p9	#poison <dmg>
#poisonarmor	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#poisonarmor <dmg>
#poisoncloud	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#poisoncloud <size>
#poisonifdmg	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p12	#poisonifdmg <dmg>
#poisonres	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p56	#poisonres <prot>
#poisonskin	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#poisonskin <0-500>
#polygetmagic	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p53	#polygetmagic <0 - 1>
#polyimmune	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p19; M6.34 p57	#polyimmune
#pooramphibian	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#pooramphibian
#poorleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#poorleader
#poormagicleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#poormagicleader
#poorundeadleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#poorundeadleader
#popgrowth	Defined	Site	M6.34 p40	#popgrowth <per mille>
#popkill	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#popkill <amount>
#poppergold	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#poppergold <people>
#poptype	Defined	Map	P6.26 p6	#poptype <poptype nbr>
#population	Defined	Map	P6.26 p8	#population <0-50000>
#portent	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p54	#portent "text"
#powerofdeath	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59	#powerofdeath <limit>
#praise	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#praise <value>
#prec	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p16; M6.34 p56	#prec <precision>
#precision	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#precision <prec>
#priestreanim	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p50	#priestreanim
#prison	Defined	AI	M6.34 p64	#prison <nbr>
#prodscale	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#prodscale <value>
#prophetshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27	#prophetshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#prot	Defined	Armour, Monster	M6.34 p12; M6.34 p17	#prot <protection>
#protparts	Defined	Armour	M6.34 p12	#protparts <head prot> <body prot>
#provrange	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#provrange <range>
#purgecalendar	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#purgecalendar <attr>
#purgedelayed	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#purgedelayed <attr>

Q

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#quadruped	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#quadruped
#quickness	Defined	Item	M6.34 p56	#quickness

R

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#raiseonkill	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#raiseonkill <chance>
#raiseshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59	#raiseshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#randequip	Defined	Mercenary	M6.34 p63	#randequip <0-3>
#randomequip	Defined	Map	P6.26 p9	#randomequip <rich>
#randomspell	Defined	Monster, Spell	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p56	#randomspell <percent>
#range	Defined	Spell, Weapon	M6.34 p7; M6.34 p52	#range
#range0	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#range0
#range050	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#range050
#raredomsummon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61	#raredomsummon "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#rarity	Defined	Event, Site	E6.29 p2; M6.34 p38; E6.29 p19; E6.29 p20	#rarity <nbr>
#rcost	Defined	Armour, Monster, Weapon	M6.34 p7; M6.34 p12; M6.34 p15	#rcost
#reanimator	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p29	#reanimator <nbr>
#reanimpriest	Defined	Monster, Nation	M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61	#reanimpriest
#recallgod	Defined	Nation, Site	M6.34 p41; M6.34 p49	#recallgod <value>
#reclimit	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p14	#reclimit <units / turn>
#reconst	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#reconst <percent>
#recrate	Defined	Mercenary	M6.34 p63	#recrate <value>
#recuperation	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#recuperation
#reform	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#reform <chance>
#reformtime	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#reformtime <extra months>
#regainmount	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#regainmount <0 or 1>
#regeneration	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#regeneration <percent>
#reinvigoration	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#reinvigoration <points>
#remgeo	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#remgeo <terrain bitmask>
#remount	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#remount
#removesite	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#removesite <site number>
#req_2monsters	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_2monsters "name" | <number>
#req_5monsters	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_5monsters "name" | <number>
#req_ai	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_ai <0 | 1>
#req_anycode	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_anycode <event code>
#req_arenadone	Defined	Event	E6.29 p11	#req_arenadone <0 | 1>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#req_capital	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_capital < 0 | 1 >
#req_cave	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_cave < 0 | 1 >
#req_chaos	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_chaos <value>
#req_claimedthrone	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_claimedthrone < 0 | 1 >
#req_coast	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_coast < 0 | 1 >
#req_code	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10; E6.29 p19	#req_code <event code>
#req_cold	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_cold <value>
#req_commander	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_commander < 0 | 1 >
#req_crystal	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_crystal < 0 | 1 >
#req_deadmnr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_deadmnr "name" | <number>
#req_death	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_death <value>
#req_deep	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_deep < 0 | 1 >
#req_domchance	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_domchance <0 - 100>
#req_dominion	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_dominion <0 - 10>
#req_domowner	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_domowner <nation number>
#req_drip	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_drip < 0 | 1 >
#req_ench	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10; E6.29 p20	#req_ench <ench nbr>
#req_enchdom	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10; E6.29 p20	#req_enchdom <ench nbr>
#req_enchnearby	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_enchnearby <ench nbr>
#req_enchtarget	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_enchtarget <ench nbr>
#req_era	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_era <value>
#req_farm	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_farm < 0 | 1 >
#req_forest	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4; E6.29 p20	#req_forest < 0 | 1 >
#req_forestcave	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_forestcave < 0 | 1 >
#req_fornation	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_fornation <nation number>
#req_fort	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_fort < 0 | 1 >
#req_fortid	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_fortid <fort number>
#req_foundsite	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_foundsite < 0 | 1 >
#req_freesites	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_freesites <value>
#req_freshwater	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_freshwater < 0 | 1 >
#req_friendlyench	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_friendlyench <ench nbr>
#req_fullowner	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_fullowner <nation number>
#req_gem	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_gem <type>
#req_godawake	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_godawake <0 - 1>
#req_godismnr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_godismnr "name" | <number>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#req_godisnotmnr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_godisnotmnr "name" | <number>
#req_gold	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_gold <type>
#req_gorge	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_gorge < 0 | 1 >
#req_growth	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_growth <value>
#req_heat	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_heat <value>
#req_hiddensite	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5; E6.29 p19	#req_hiddensite < 0 | 1 >
#req_hostileench	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10; E6.29 p20	#req_hostileench <ench nbr>
#req_humanoidres	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_humanoidres
#req_indepok	Defined	Event	E6.29 p2; E6.29 p20	#req_indepok < 0 | 1 >
#req_kelp	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_kelp < 0 | 1 >
#req_lab	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_lab < 0 | 1 >
#req_land	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4; E6.29 p19	#req_land < 0 | 1 >
#req_lazy	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_lazy <value>
#req_luck	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_luck <value>
#req_magic	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_magic <value>
#req_maxcorpses	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_maxcorpses <dead>
#req_maxdef	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_maxdef <value>
#req_maxdominion	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_maxdominion <-10 - 10>
#req_maxglobals	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_maxglobals <nbr>
#req_maxpop	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_maxpop <dekapop>
#req_maxtroops	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_maxtroops <value>
#req_maxturn	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_maxturn <value>
#req_maxunrest	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_maxunrest <value>
#req_mincorpses	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_mincorpses <dead>
#req_mindef	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_mindef <value>
#req_minglobals	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_minglobals <nbr>
#req_minpop	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_minpop <dekapop>
#req_minresearch	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_minresearch <level>
#req_mintroops	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_mintroops <value>
#req_minunrest	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_minunrest <value>
#req_mnr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_mnr "name" | <number>
#req_mnrbs	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_mnrbs "name" | <number>
#req_monster	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_monster "name" | <number>
#req_monsterbs	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_monsterbs "name" | <number>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#req_month	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_month <0 - 11>
#req_mountain	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4; E6.29 p19; E6.29 p20	#req_mountain < 0 | 1 >
#req_mydominion	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_mydominion < 0 | 1 >
#req_myench	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10; E6.29 p20	#req_myench <ench nbr>
#req_nation	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_nation <nation number>
#req_nativesoil	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_nativesoil
#req_nearbycapital	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_nearbycapital < 0 | 1 >
#req_nearbycode	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_nearbycode <event code>
#req_nearbysite	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_nearbysite < 0 | 1 >
#req_nearbythrone	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_nearbythrone < 0 | 1 >
#req_nearowncode	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_nearowncode <event code>
#req_noench	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_noench <ench nbr>
#req_noera	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_noera <value>
#req_nomnr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_nomnr "name" | <number>
#req_nomonster	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_nomonster "name" | <number>
#req_nonation	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_nonation <nation number>
#req_nopathair	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_nopathair <level>
#req_nopathall	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_nopathall <level>
#req_nopathastral	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_nopathastral <level>
#req_nopathblood	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_nopathblood <level>
#req_nopathdeath	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_nopathdeath <level>
#req_nopathearth	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_nopathearth <level>
#req_nopathfire	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_nopathfire <level>
#req_nopathglamour	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_nopathglamour <level>
#req_nopathholy	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_nopathholy <level>
#req_nopathnature	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_nopathnature <level>
#req_nopathwater	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_nopathwater <level>
#req_norealmnr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_norealmnr "name" | <number>
#req_noseason	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_noseason <0 - 4>
#req_nositenbr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_nositenbr <site number>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#req_notanycode	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_notanycode <event code>
#req_notcode	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_notcode <event code>
#req_notforally	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_notforally <nation number>
#req_notfornation	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_notfornation <nation number>
#req_notpoptype	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_notpoptype <value>
#req_noworlditem	Defined	Event	E6.29 p11	#req_noworlditem "item name" | <item number>
#req_order	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_order <value>
#req_owncapital	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_owncapital < 0 | 1 >
#req_path	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_path <type>
#req_pathair	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_pathair <level>
#req_pathastral	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_pathastral <level>
#req_pathblood	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_pathblood <level>
#req_pathdeath	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_pathdeath <level>
#req_pathearth	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_pathearth <level>
#req_pathfire	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_pathfire <level>
#req_pathgems	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_pathgems <amount>
#req_pathglamour	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_pathglamour <level>
#req_pathholy	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_pathholy <level>
#req_pathnature	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_pathnature <level>
#req_pathwater	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_pathwater <level>
#req_permonth	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10; E6.29 p20	#req_permonth <nbr>
#req_plane	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_plane < planenr >
#req_pop0ok	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_pop0ok
#req_poptype	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_poptype <value>
#req_preach	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_preach <value>
#req_pregame	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_pregame <value>
#req_pretawake	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_pretawake <0 - 1>
#req_pretismnr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_pretismnr "name" | <number>
#req_prod	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_prod <value>
#req_rare	Defined	Event	E6.29 p2; E6.29 p20	#req_rare <percent>
#req_realmnr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_realmnr "name" | <number>
#req_researcher	Defined	Event	E6.29 p7	#req_researcher
#req_school	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_school <school>
#req_season	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_season <0 - 4>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#req_site	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5; E6.29 p19	#req_site < 0 | 1 >
#req_story	Defined	Event	E6.29 p2	#req_story < 0 | 1 >
#req_swamp	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_swamp < 0 | 1 >
#req_targaff	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targaff <affliction number>
#req_targally	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targally <nation number>
#req_targanimal	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targanimal <0 | 1>
#req_targdemon	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targdemon <0 | 1>
#req_targforeignok	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targforeignok
#req_targgod	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targgod < 0 - 2 >
#req_targhorrormark	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targhorrormark <value>
#req_targhumanoid	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8; E6.29 p19	#req_targhumanoid < 0 | 1 >
#req_targimmobile	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targimmobile <0 | 1>
#req_targinanimate	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targinanimate <0 | 1>
#req_targinsane	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targinsane <0 | 1>
#req_targitem	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targitem "item name" | <item number>
#req_targmagicbeing	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targmagicbeing <0 | 1>
#req_targmale	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targmale < 0 | 1 >
#req_targmanygems	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targmanygems <path number>
#req_targmaxkills	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_targmaxkills <value>
#req_targmaxmorale	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targmaxmorale <morale>
#req_targmaxsize	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targmaxsize <size>
#req_targmindless	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targmindless <0 | 1>
#req_targminkills	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targminkills <value>
#req_targminmorale	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targminmorale <morale>
#req_targminsize	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targminsize <size>
#req_targmnr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targmnr "name" | <number>
#req_targnoaff	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targnoaff <affliction number>
#req_targnoitem	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targnoitem "item name" | <item number>
#req_targnomnr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targnomnr "name" | <number>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#req_targnoorder	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targnoorder <order>
#req_targnopath1	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targnopath1 <path number>
#req_targnopath2	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targnopath2 <path number>
#req_targnopath3	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targnopath3 <path number>
#req_targnopath4	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targnopath4 <path number>
#req_targnorealmnr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targnorealmnr "name" | <number>
#req_targnotally	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targnotally <nation number>
#req_targnotowner	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targnotowner <nation number>
#req_targorder	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9; E6.29 p19	#req_targorder <order number>
#req_targowner	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targowner <nation number>
#req_targpath1	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targpath1 <path number>
#req_targpath2	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8; E6.29 p19	#req_targpath2 <path number>
#req_targpath3	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8; E6.29 p19	#req_targpath3 <path number>
#req_targpath4	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targpath4 <path number>
#req_targprophet	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targprophet < 0 | 1 >
#req_targrealmnr	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targrealmnr "name" | <number>
#req_targseductions	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targseductions <value>
#req_targsight	Defined	Event	E6.29 p8	#req_targsight < 0 | 1 >
#req_targundead	Defined	Event	E6.29 p9	#req_targundead <0 | 1>
#req_temple	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_temple < 0 | 1 >
#req_thronesite	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_thronesite < 0 | 1 >
#req_turn	Defined	Event	E6.29 p3	#req_turn <value>
#req_turnrare	Defined	Event	E6.29 p2	#req_turnrare <value>
#req_unclaimedthrone	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_unclaimedthrone < 0 | 1 >
#req_unique	Defined	Event	E6.29 p2; E6.29 p19	#req_unique <value>
#req_unluck	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_unluck <value>
#req_unmagic	Defined	Event	E6.29 p6	#req_unmagic <value>
#req_varneg	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_varneg <event var>
#req_varone	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_varone <event var>
#req_varpos	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_varpos <event var>
#req_varzero	Defined	Event	E6.29 p10	#req_varzero <event var>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#req_void	Defined	Event	E6.29 p5	#req_void < 0 | 1 >
#req_voidok	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4; E6.29 p5	#req_voidok < 0 | 1 >
#req_waste	Defined	Event	E6.29 p4	#req_waste < 0 | 1 >
#req_worlditem	Defined	Event	E6.29 p11	#req_worlditem "item name" | <item number>
#reqeyes	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#reqeyes
#reqlab	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#reqlab
#reqnoplant	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p55	#reqnoplant
#reqnoseduce	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p55	#reqnoseduce
#reqnospellsinger	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p55	#reqnospellsinger
#reqnotaskmaster	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p55	#reqnotaskmaster
#reqplant	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p55	#reqplant
#reqseduce	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p55	#reqseduce
#reqspellsinger	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p55	#reqspellsinger
#reqsun	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p54	#reqsun <0 - 1>
#reqtaskmaster	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p55	#reqtaskmaster
#reqtemple	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#reqtemple
#res	Defined	Site	M6.34 p38	#res <amount>
#researchaff	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#researchaff <affliction bitmask>
#researchbonus	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#researchbonus <value>
#researchgoal	Defined	AI	M6.34 p64	#researchgoal "spell name" | "item name"
#researchlevel	Defined	Event, Spell	M6.34 p50; E6.29 p20	#researchlevel <level>
#researchscale	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#researchscale <bonus>
#resetcode	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#resetcode <event code>
#resetcodedelay	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#resetcodedelay <event code>
#resetcodedelay2	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#resetcodedelay2 <event code>
#resolvearena1	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#resolvearena1
#resolvearena2	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#resolvearena2
#resourcemult	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#resourcemult <percent>
#resources	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26	#resources <value>
#ressize	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p16	#ressize <size>
#restricted	Defined	Item, Spell	M6.34 p53; M6.34 p57	#restricted <nation nbr> | "nation name"
#restricteditem	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#restricteditem <value>
#revealprov	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#revealprov
#revealsite	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13; E6.29 p19	#revealsite

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#revolt	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#revolt
#riverstart	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#riverstart
#rockcol	Defined	Map	P6.26 p8	#rockcol <red> <green> <blue>
#rpcost	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p15	#rpcost <recruitment points>
#run	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#run

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Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#sabbathmaster	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p60	#sabbathmaster
#sabbathslave	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#sabbathslave
#sacredonly	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#sacredonly
#sacrificedom	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#sacrificedom
#saildist	Defined	Map	P6.26 p4	#saildist <1-10>
#sailing	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#sailing <ship size> <max unit size>
#sample	Defined	Sound, Weapon	M6.34 p5; M6.34 p7; M6.34 p52	#sample "<filename>"
#scale	Defined	AI, Map	P6.26 p9; M6.34 p64	#scale chaos <nation nbr> <(-5)-5>
#scalewalls	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p59	#scalewalls
#school	Defined	Event, Spell	M6.34 p50; E6.29 p20	#school <school nbr>
#scry	Defined	Site	M6.34 p39	#scry <duration>
#scryrange	Defined	Site	M6.34 p39	#scryrange <range>
#seatrace	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#seatrace
#secondarycolor	Defined	General, Nation	M6.34 p43; M6.34 p64	#secondarycolor <red> <green> <blue>
#secondaryeffect	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#secondaryeffect "<weapon name>" | <weapon nbr>
#secondaryeffectalways	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#secondaryeffectalways "<weapon name>" | <weapon nbr>
#secondarylevel	Defined	Item	M6.34 p55	#secondarylevel <path>
#secondarypath	Defined	Item	M6.34 p55	#secondarypath <path>
#secondshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27	#secondshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#secondtmpshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#secondtmpshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#seduce	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58	#seduce <value>
#selectarmor	Defined	Armour	M6.34 p12	#selectarmor "<armor name>" | <nbr>
#selectbless	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p36	#selectbless "<bless name>" | <nbr>
#selectevent	Defined	Event	E6.29 p2	#selectevent <event nbr>
#selectitem	Defined	Item	M6.34 p55	#selectitem "<item name>" | <item nbr>

<table>
<tr><th>Token</th><th>Status</th><th>Domain</th><th>Official locator</th><th>Strongest syntax</th></tr>
<tr><td>#selectmonster</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p13</td><td>#selectmonster "<monster name>" | <monster nbr></td></tr>
<tr><td>#selectnametype</td><td>Defined</td><td>Names</td><td>M6.34 p36</td><td>#selectnametype <nametype nbr></td></tr>
<tr><td>#selectnation</td><td>Defined</td><td>Nation</td><td>M6.34 p41</td><td>#selectnation <nation nbr></td></tr>
<tr><td>#selectpoptype</td><td>Defined</td><td>Poptype</td><td>M6.34 p62</td><td>#selectpoptype <poptype></td></tr>
<tr><td>#selectsite</td><td>Defined</td><td>Site</td><td>M6.34 p37</td><td>#selectsite "<site name>" | <site nbr></td></tr>
<tr><td>#selectsound</td><td>Defined</td><td>Sound</td><td>M6.34 p5</td><td>#selectsound <nbr></td></tr>
<tr><td>#selectspell</td><td>Defined</td><td>Spell</td><td>M6.34 p50</td><td>#selectspell "<spell name>" | <nbr></td></tr>
<tr><td>#selectweapon</td><td>Defined</td><td>Weapon</td><td>M6.34 p6</td><td>#selectweapon "<weapon name>" | <weapon nbr></td></tr>
<tr><td>#sethome</td><td>Defined</td><td>Spell</td><td>M6.34 p54</td><td>#sethome</td></tr>
<tr><td>#setland</td><td>Defined</td><td>Map</td><td>P6.26 p6; P6.26 p3</td><td>#setland <province nbr></td></tr>
<tr><td>#setpoptype</td><td>Defined</td><td>Event</td><td>E6.29 p13</td><td>#setpoptype <value></td></tr>
<tr><td>#setxp</td><td>Defined</td><td>Event</td><td>E6.29 p16</td><td>#setxp <experience points></td></tr>
<tr><td>#shapechance</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p28</td><td>#shapechance <percent></td></tr>
<tr><td>#shapechange</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p27</td><td>#shapechange "<monster name>" | <monster nbr></td></tr>
<tr><td>#shatteredsoul</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60</td><td>#shatteredsoul <percent></td></tr>
<tr><td>#shock</td><td>Defined</td><td>Weapon</td><td>M6.34 p9</td><td>#shock</td></tr>
<tr><td>#shockifhit</td><td>Defined</td><td>Weapon</td><td>M6.34 p12</td><td>#shockifhit <dmg></td></tr>
<tr><td>#shockres</td><td>Defined</td><td>Item, Monster</td><td>M6.34 p22; M6.34 p56</td><td>#shockres <prot></td></tr>
<tr><td>#shrinkhp</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p28</td><td>#shrinkhp <hit points></td></tr>
<tr><td>#siegebonus</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60</td><td>#siegebonus <value></td></tr>
<tr><td>#singlebattle</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p15; M6.34 p58</td><td>#singlebattle</td></tr>
<tr><td>#size</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p17</td><td>#size <size></td></tr>
<tr><td>#sizecost</td><td>Defined</td><td>Spell</td><td>M6.34 p54</td><td>#sizecost <value></td></tr>
<tr><td>#sizeresist</td><td>Defined</td><td>Weapon</td><td>M6.34 p9</td><td>#sizeresist</td></tr>
<tr><td>#skilledrider</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p31</td><td>#skilledrider <value></td></tr>
<tr><td>#skip</td><td>Defined</td><td>Weapon</td><td>M6.34 p10</td><td>#skip</td></tr>
<tr><td>#skip2</td><td>Defined</td><td>Weapon</td><td>M6.34 p10</td><td>#skip2</td></tr>
<tr><td>#skirmisher</td><td>Reference</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p36; M6.34 p60</td><td>#skirmisher</td></tr>
<tr><td>#skybox</td><td>Defined</td><td>Map</td><td>P6.26 p8</td><td>#skybox "<pic.tga></td></tr>
<tr><td>#slash</td><td>Defined</td><td>Weapon</td><td>M6.34 p9</td><td>#slash</td></tr>
<tr><td>#slashres</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59</td><td>#slashres</td></tr>
<tr><td>#slave</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p32</td><td>#slave</td></tr>
<tr><td>#slaver</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p30</td><td>#slaver "<monster name>" | <monster nbr></td></tr>
<tr><td>#slaverbonus</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p30</td><td>#slaverbonus <modifier></td></tr>
<tr><td>#sleepaura</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p24</td><td>#sleepaura <area></td></tr>
<tr><td>#sleepres</td><td>Defined</td><td>Monster</td><td>M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60</td><td>#sleepres <bonus></td></tr>
</table>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#slimer	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#slimer <strength>
#slothincome	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#slothincome <percent>
#slothpower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#slothpower <bonus>
#slothresearch	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#slothresearch <value>
#slothresources	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#slothresources <percent>
#slothscale	Defined	Bless	M6.34 p37	#slothscale <value>
#slowrec	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p14	#slowrec
#smartmount	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#smartmount <smartness>
#smpmode	Defined	Sound	M6.34 p5	#smpmode <mode>
#snake	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#snake
#snaketattoo	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26	#snaketattoo <value>
#sneakunit	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#sneakunit <value>
#snow	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#snow
#sorcerygems	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#sorcerygems <gems>
#sorceryrange	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#sorceryrange <range>
#sound	Defined	Sound, Weapon	M6.34 p7; M6.34 p52	#sound <sample nbr>
#spec	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p53	#spec <spec bitmask>
#speciallook	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p13	#speciallook <value>
#specstart	Defined	Map	P6.26 p6	#specstart <nation nbr> <land nbr>
#speedmult	Defined	Sound, Weapon	M6.34 p11; M6.34 p52	#speedmult <1 - 3>
#spell	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p56	#spell "<spell name>"
#spellreqfly	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p53	#spellreqfly <0 - 1>
#spellsinger	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#spellsinger
#spikes	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#spikes <dmg>
#spiritform	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#spiritform
#spiritformimmune	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#spiritformimmune
#spiritsight	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#spiritsight
#spr	Defined	Item	M6.34 p55	#spr "<filename>"
#spr1	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p13	#spr1 "<imgfile>"
#spr2	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p13	#spr2 "<imgfile>"
#spreaddom	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60	#spreaddom <candles>
#springimmortal	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23	#springimmortal
#springpower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#springpower <percent>
#springshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#springshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#spy	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#spy
#standard	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60	#standard <bonus>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#start	Defined	Map	P6.26 p6	#start <province nbr>
#startaff	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22	#startaff <percent>
#startage	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21	#startage <age>
#startcom	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#startcom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#startdom	Defined	Monster, Nation	M6.34 p14	#startdom <dominion strength>
#startheroab	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22	#startheroab <percent>
#startingaff	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22	#startingaff <affliction bitmask>
#startitem	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#startitem "item name" | <item nbr>
#startmajoraff	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22	#startmajoraff <percent>
#startresearch	Defined	General	M6.34 p62	#startresearch <RP>
#startscout	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#startscout "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#startsite	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#startsite "<site name>"
#startunitnbrs1	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#startunitnbrs1 <nbr of units>
#startunitnbrs2	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#startunitnbrs2 <nbr of units>
#startunittype1	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#startunittype1 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#startunittype2	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#startunittype2 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#statbreak	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58	#statbreak <value>
#statstorm	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58	#statstorm <value>
#stealthboost	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#stealthboost <value>
#stealthcom	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#stealthcom "name" | <number>
#stealthy	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#stealthy <value>
#stonebeing	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19; M6.34 p58	#stonebeing
#stoneskin	Defined	Item	M6.34 p56	#stoneskin
#stormimmune	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p19; M6.34 p57	#stormimmune
#stormpower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#stormpower <bonus>
#str	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p16; M6.34 p56	#str <strength>
#strikesound	Defined	Sound	M6.34 p52	#strikesound <sample nbr>
#strikeunits	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#strikeunits <damage>
#succubus	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58	#succubus <value>
#sumhealaffs	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p54	#sumhealaffs <value>
#summary	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p42	#summary "<nation name>"
#summerpower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#summerpower <percent>
#summershape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#summershape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#summon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#summon "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#summon1	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#summon1

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#summon1...5	Defined; template	Monster	M6.34 p29	#summon1...5 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#summon2	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#summon2
#summon3	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#summon3
#summon4	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#summon4
#summon5	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p61	#summon5
#summonlvl2	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#summonlvl2 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#summonlvl3	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#summonlvl3 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#summonlvl4	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#summonlvl4 "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#sunawe	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#sunawe <bonus>
#supayareanim	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p50	#supayareanim
#superiorleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#superiorleader
#superiormagicleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#superiormagicleader
#superiorundeadleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32	#superiorundeadleader
#supply	Defined	Site	M6.34 p38	#supply <value>
#supplybonus	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60	#supplybonus <value>
#supplymult	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#supplymult <percent>
#swamplabcost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#swamplabcost <price>
#swampsurvival	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#swampsurvival
#swamptemplecost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#swamptemplecost <price>
#swift	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#swift <percent>
#swimming	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#swimming
#syncretism	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#syncretism <0 or 1>

T

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
##targhis##	Reference; message	Event	E6.29 p11	##targhis##
##targname##	Reference; message	Event	E6.29 p11	##targname##
#tainted	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p57	#tainted <chance>
#taskmaster	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60	#taskmaster <bonus>
#taxboost	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#taxboost <percent>
#taxcollector	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#taxcollector
#teamstart	Defined	Map	P6.26 p6	#teamstart <land nbr> <team nbr>
#teleport	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#teleport

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#temple	Defined	Event, Map, Site	E6.29 p13; P6.26 p8; M6.34 p40	#temple < 0 | 1 >
#templecost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#templecost <price>
#templegems	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#templegems <type>
#templeholypoints	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#templeholypoints <value>
#templepic	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#templepic <pic nbr>
#templetrainer	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61	#templetrainer "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#tempscalecap	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#tempscalecap <value>
#tempunits	Defined	Event	E6.29 p14	#tempunits < 0 | 1>
#terrain	Defined	Map	P6.26 p4; P6.26 p3	#terrain <province nbr> <terrain mask>
#thaucost	Defined	Site	M6.34 p39	#thaucost <bonus>
#thirdstr	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#thirdstr
#thronekill	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60	#thronekill <chance>
#tmpairgems	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#tmpairgems <gems>
#tmpastralgems	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p61	#tmpastralgems <gems>
#tmpbloodslaves	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p61	#tmpbloodslaves <slaves>
#tmpdeathgems	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p61	#tmpdeathgems <gems>
#tmpearthgems	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p61	#tmpearthgems <gems>
#tmpfiregems	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#tmpfiregems <gems>
#tmpglamourgems	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p61	#tmpglamourgems <gems>
#tmpnaturegems	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p61	#tmpnaturegems <gems>
#tmpwatergems	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60	#tmpwatergems <gems>
#togglevar	Defined	Event	E6.29 p18	#togglevar <event var>
#tolerateund	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p33	#tolerateund
#tombwyrmreanim	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p50	#tombwyrmreanim
#tradecoast	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p49	#tradecoast <income boost in percent>
#trample	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#trample
#trampswallow	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#trampswallow
#transform	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#transform "name" | <number>
#transformation	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#transformation <value>
#triple3mon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p14	#triple3mon
#triplegod	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p14	#triplegod <type>
#triplegodmag	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p14	#triplegodmag <penalty>
#troglodyte	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p18	#troglodyte
#truesight	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#truesight

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#turmoilevents	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#turmoilevents <percent>
#turmoilincome	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#turmoilincome <percent>
#twiceborn	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#twiceborn "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#twiceborncost	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p54	#twiceborncost <value>
#twistfate	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#twistfate
#twohanded	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p7	#twohanded
#type	Defined	Armour, Item	M6.34 p12; M6.34 p55	#type <type>

U

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#undcommand	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60	#undcommand <value>
#undead	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#undead
#undeadimmune	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#undeadimmune
#undeadonly	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p9	#undeadonly
#undeadreanim	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p50	#undeadreanim
#undisciplined	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60	#undisciplined
#undisleader	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p33	#undisleader <value>
#undregen	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#undregen <percent>
#unify	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p14	#unify
#unique	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p19; M6.34 p57	#unique
#unit	Defined	Mercenary	M6.34 p63	#unit "<monster name>"
#units	Defined	Map	P6.26 p8	#units <nbr of units> "<type>"
#unmountedspr1	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30	#unmountedspr1 "<imgfile>"
#unmountedspr2	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30	#unmountedspr2 "<imgfile>"
#unrepel	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#unrepel
#unrest	Defined	Event, Map	E6.29 p13; P6.26 p8	#unrest <value>
#unresthalfinc	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#unresthalfinc <unrest level>
#unresthalfres	Defined	General	M6.34 p61	#unresthalfres <unrest level>
#unseen	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59	#unseen
#unsurr	Reference	Monster	M6.34 p36; M6.34 p59	#unsurr
#unteleportable	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58	#unteleportable
#userestricteditem	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p18	#userestricteditem <value>
#uwbug	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p19	#uwbug
#uwbuild	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#uwbuild <0 or 1>
#uwcom	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#uwcom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#uwdamage	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59	#uwdamage <percent>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#uwfireshield	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#uwfireshield <damage>
#uwheat	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#uwheat <0-100>
#uwnation	Defined	Site	M6.34 p43	#uwnation
#uwok	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p11	#uwok
#uwrec	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p45	#uwrec "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#uwregen	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59	#uwregen <percent>
#uwwallcom	Defined	Monster, Nation	M6.34 p38; M6.34 p47	#uwwallcom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#uwwallmult	Defined	Monster, Nation	M6.34 p38; M6.34 p47	#uwwallmult <multiplier>
#uwwallunit	Defined	Monster, Nation	M6.34 p38; M6.34 p47	#uwwallunit "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>

V

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#var0units	Defined	Event	E6.29 p15	#var0units "name" | <number>
#version	Defined	General, Metadata	M6.34 p5; M6.34 p64	#version x.yy
#victorycondition	Defined	Map	P6.26 p6	#victorycondition <condition> <attribute>
#viewallbat	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p43	#viewallbat
#viewallprov	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p43	#viewallprov
#visitors	Defined	Event	E6.29 p13	#visitors
#voidgate	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p38	#voidgate <success chance>
#voidret	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60	#voidret <chance>
#voidsanity	Defined	Item, Monster	M6.34 p17; M6.34 p56	#voidsanity <value>

W

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#walkable	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p52	#walkable <0 or 1>
#wallcom	Defined	Monster, Nation	M6.34 p38; M6.34 p46	#wallcom "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#wallmult	Defined	Monster, Nation	M6.34 p38; M6.34 p46	#wallmult <multiplier>
#wallunit	Defined	Monster, Nation	M6.34 p38; M6.34 p46	#wallunit "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#warning	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60	#warning <bonus>
#wastelabcost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#wastelabcost <price>
#wastesurvival	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p20	#wastesurvival
#wastetemplecost	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p48	#wastetemplecost <price>
#waterblessbonus	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p47	#waterblessbonus <0 - 9>
#waterboost	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16; E6.29 p19	#waterboost "name" | <number>

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#waterbreathing	Defined	Item	M6.34 p57	#waterbreathing
#waterelementals	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61	#waterelementals <bonus>
#waterrange	Defined	Monster, Site	M6.34 p33; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60	#waterrange <range>
#watershape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#watershape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#weapon	Defined	Item, Weapon	M6.34 p17; M6.34 p56	#weapon "<weapon name>" | <nbr>
#wightreanim	Defined	Nation	M6.34 p50	#wightreanim
#wild	Defined	Site	M6.34 p41	#wild
#winterpower	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#winterpower <percent>
#wintershape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#wintershape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#wolftattoo	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p26	#wolftattoo <value>
#woodenarmor	Defined	Armour	M6.34 p13	#woodenarmor
#woodenweapon	Defined	Weapon	M6.34 p10	#woodenweapon
#worldage	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#worldage <years>
#worldcurse	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#worldcurse <percent>
#worlddarkness	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#worlddarkness
#worlddecscale	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#worlddecscale <scale>
#worlddecscale2	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#worlddecscale2 <scale>
#worlddecscale3	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#worlddecscale3 <scale>
#worlddisease	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17; E6.29 p20	#worlddisease <percent>
#worldheal	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#worldheal <percent>
#worldincdom	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#worldincdom <value>
#worldincscale	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#worldincscale <scale>
#worldincscale2	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#worldincscale2 <scale>
#worldincscale3	Defined	Event	E6.29 p16	#worldincscale3 <scale>
#worldmark	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#worldmark <percent>
#worldritrebate	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#worldritrebate <school>
#worldshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#worldshape "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#worldunrest	Defined	Event	E6.29 p17	#worldunrest <value>
#worldvisible	Defined	Spell	M6.34 p54	#worldvisible <0 - 1>
#woundfend	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#woundfend <value>

X

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#xp	Defined	Event, Map, Mercenary, Site	E6.29 p16; P6.26 p8; M6.34 p40; M6.34 p63	#xp <experience points>
#xpgain	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59	#xpgain <percent>
#xploss	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28; M6.34 p60	#xploss <0-100>
#xpshape	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#xpshape <xp value>
#xpshapeloss	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#xpshapeloss <0-100>
#xpshapemon	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p28	#xpshapemon "<monster name>" | <monster nbr>
#xspr1	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#xspr1 "<imgfile>"
#xspr2	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p31	#xspr2 "<imgfile>"

Y

Token	Status	Domain	Official locator	Strongest syntax
#yearaging	Defined	Item	M6.34 p58	#yearaging <value>
#yearturn	Defined	Monster	M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59	#yearturn <bonus>

Template and alias locator

The alias table lists concrete search terms generated from official terrain and numeric templates. Each alias points back to one canonical template definition.

Search alias	Official template	Derivation
#batstartsum1	#batstartsum1...5	Numeric range
#batstartsum1d6	#batstartsum1d6...9d6	Numeric range
#batstartsum2	#batstartsum1...5	Numeric range
#batstartsum2d6	#batstartsum1d6...9d6	Numeric range
#batstartsum3	#batstartsum1...5	Numeric range
#batstartsum3d6	#batstartsum1d6...9d6	Numeric range
#batstartsum4	#batstartsum1...5	Numeric range
#batstartsum4d6	#batstartsum1d6...9d6	Numeric range
#batstartsum5	#batstartsum1...5	Numeric range
#batstartsum5d6	#batstartsum1d6...9d6	Numeric range
#batstartsum6d6	#batstartsum1d6...9d6	Numeric range
#batstartsum7d6	#batstartsum1d6...9d6	Numeric range
#batstartsum8d6	#batstartsum1d6...9d6	Numeric range
#batstartsum9d6	#batstartsum1d6...9d6	Numeric range
#battlesum1	#battlesum1...5	Numeric range
#battlesum2	#battlesum1...5	Numeric range
#battlesum3	#battlesum1...5	Numeric range
#battlesum4	#battlesum1...5	Numeric range

Search alias	Official template	Derivation
#battlesum5	#battlesum1...5	Numeric range
#cavecom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#cavefortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	Terrain substitution
#cavefortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	Terrain substitution
#caverec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution
#coastcom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#coastcom1	#coastcom1...2	Numeric range
#coastcom2	#coastcom1...2	Numeric range
#coastfortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	Terrain substitution
#coastfortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	Terrain substitution
#coastrec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution
#coastunit1	#coastunit1...3	Numeric range
#coastunit2	#coastunit1...3	Numeric range
#coastunit3	#coastunit1...3	Numeric range
#deepcom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#deeprec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution
#dripcom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#dripfortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	Terrain substitution
#dripfortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	Terrain substitution
#driprec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution
#farmcom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#farmfortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	Terrain substitution
#farmfortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	Terrain substitution
#farmrec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution
#foreigncom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#foreignfortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	Terrain substitution
#foreignfortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	Terrain substitution
#foreignrec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution
#forestcom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#forestfortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	Terrain substitution
#forestfortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	Terrain substitution
#forestrec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution
#hero1	#hero1...10	Numeric range
#hero10	#hero1...10	Numeric range
#hero2	#hero1...10	Numeric range
#hero3	#hero1...10	Numeric range
#hero4	#hero1...10	Numeric range
#hero5	#hero1...10	Numeric range
#hero6	#hero1...10	Numeric range

Search alias	Official template	Derivation
#hero7	#hero1...10	Numeric range
#hero8	#hero1...10	Numeric range
#hero9	#hero1...10	Numeric range
#kelpcom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#kelprec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution
#makemonsters1	#makemonsters1...5	Numeric range
#makemonsters2	#makemonsters1...5	Numeric range
#makemonsters3	#makemonsters1...5	Numeric range
#makemonsters4	#makemonsters1...5	Numeric range
#makemonsters5	#makemonsters1...5	Numeric range
#mountaincom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#mountainfortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	Terrain substitution
#mountainfortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	Terrain substitution
#mountainrec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution
#multihero1	#multihero1...7	Numeric range
#multihero2	#multihero1...7	Numeric range
#multihero3	#multihero1...7	Numeric range
#multihero4	#multihero1...7	Numeric range
#multihero5	#multihero1...7	Numeric range
#multihero6	#multihero1...7	Numeric range
#multihero7	#multihero1...7	Numeric range
#plaincom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#plainfortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	Terrain substitution
#plainfortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	Terrain substitution
#plainrec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution
#seacom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#searec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution
#summon1	#summon1...5	Numeric range
#summon2	#summon1...5	Numeric range
#summon3	#summon1...5	Numeric range
#summon4	#summon1...5	Numeric range
#summon5	#summon1...5	Numeric range
#swampcom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#swampfortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	Terrain substitution
#swampfortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	Terrain substitution
#swamprec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution
#wastecom	#(terrain)com	Terrain substitution
#wastefortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	Terrain substitution
#wastefortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	Terrain substitution

Search alias	Official template	Derivation
#wasterec	#(terrain)rec	Terrain substitution

Complete patch-token index

This index contains all 226 hash tokens extracted from official 6.01-6.36 announcements. Exact entries link directly to the current manual record. Non-exact entries use the controlled reconciliation described in Part VI.

Patch token	Present resolution	First version	Patch records
#3castbattlespell	#3castbattlespell	6.30	1
#addgeo	#addgeo	6.08	1
#addkills	#addkills	6.12	1
#addseduction	#addseductions	6.12	1
#aftercloud	#aftercloud	6.08	1
#aftercloudarea	#aftercloudarea	6.08	1
#aiassmod	#aiassmod	6.18	1
#aibadlvl	#aibadlvl	6.27	1
#aimusthavemag	#aimusthavemag	6.04	1
#airshield	#airshield	6.04	1
#ammo	#ammo	6.07	1
#animated	#animated	6.12	1
#assassin	#assassin	6.09	1
#assencloc	#assencloc	6.04	1
#assfollower1	#assfollower1	6.07	1
#assfollower1d3	#assfollower1d3	6.07	1
#assownerench	#assownerench	6.19	1
#att	#att	6.08	1
#battlesum1dx	#battlesum1d2, #battlesum1d3	6.27	1
#battlesumwarm	#battlesumwarm	6.27	1
#bugshape	#bugshape	6.24	2
#bugswarmshape	#bugswarmshape	6.24	1
#bugswarmuwshape	#bugswarmuwshape	6.24	1
#buguwshape	#buguwshape	6.24	1
#caveinc	#caveinc	6.24	1
#cavenation	#cavenation	6.16	1
#caverecpt	#caverecpt	6.24	1
#caveres	#caveres	6.24	1
#chaosrecscale	#chaosrecscale	6.11	1
#chaosscale	#chaosscale	6.08	1
#chorusmaster	#chorusmaster	6.23	1

Patch token	Present resolution	First version	Patch records
#chorusslave	#chorusslave	6.23	1
#clear	#clear	6.19	1
#clearrec	#clearrec	6.23	1
#clumsy	#clumsy	6.08	1
#coastcom1	#coastcom1...2	6.04	1
#coastfortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	6.05	1
#coastfortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	6.05	1
#coastunit1	#coastunit1...3	6.04	1
#coldifhit	#coldifhit	6.08	1
#coldscale	#coldscale	6.16	1
#copysite	#copysite	6.29	1
#corruptor	#corruptor	6.09	1
#cure	#cure	6.13	1
#deathgrab	#deathgrab	6.04	1
#deathrecscale	#deathrecscale	6.11	1
#deathshock	#deathshock	6.04	1
#deathslime	#deathslime	6.04	1
#dec10var	#dec10var	6.15	1
#deeprec	#(terrain)rec	6.04	1
#defroll	#defroll	6.29	1
#disbless	#disbless	6.01	1
#dispglobals	#dispglobals	6.16	1
#dompower	#dompower	6.23	1
#domwar	#domwar	6.12	1
#dread	#dread	6.04	1
#dripfortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	6.04	1
#driprec	#(terrain)rec	6.04	1
#elementgems	#elementgems	6.12	1
#enchantedblood	#enchantedblood	6.27	1
#extralives	#extralives	6.04	1
#false	#false	6.08	1
#falseregen	#falseregen	6.04	1
#falsesupply	#falsesupply	6.08	1
#faysummon	#faysummon	6.30	1
#fearofflood	#fearofflood	6.08	1
#fireelementals	#fireelementals	6.04	1
#fireifhit	#fireifhit	6.08	1
#force	#force1d3vis, #force1d6vis, #force2d4vis, #force2d6vis, #force3d6vis, #force4d6vis	6.06	1
#force1d3vis	#force1d3vis	6.05	1

Patch token	Present resolution	First version	Patch records
#forceexactgold	#forceexactgold	6.05	1
#forcegold	#forcegold	6.05	1
#forcess	#forcess	6.32	1
#forestfortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	6.04	1
#forestfortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	6.04	1
#fort	#fort	6.19	1
#fortcoldscaleres	#fortcoldscaleres	6.23	1
#gainaffmount	official patch only	6.36	1
#gemlongevity	#gemlongevity	6.16	1
#gemlosslarge	#gemlosslarge	6.07	1
#gemlosssmall	#gemlosssmall	6.07	1
#glamourmanip	#glamourmanip	6.08	1
#globallook	#globallook	6.07	1
#godpathspell	#godpathspell	6.08	1
#godsite	#godsite	6.08	1
#grandcom	#grandcom	6.29	1
#growthpower	#growthpower	6.29	1
#growthrecscale	#growthrecscale	6.11	1
#header	#header	6.12	1
#healaff	#healaff	6.08	1
#healaffmount	official patch only	6.36	1
#hidedom	#hidedom	6.11	1
#holyifhit	#holyifhit	6.08	1
#holyrange	#holyrange	6.12	1
#homerealm	#homerealm	6.33	1
#icenatprot	#icenatprot	6.12	1
#illusionimmune	#illusionimmune	6.08	1
#inc10var	#inc10var	6.15	1
#kelpcom	#(terrain)com	6.24	1
#kelprec	#(terrain)rec	6.04	2
#killdemonifhit	#killdemonifhit	6.08	1
#killmagicifhit	#killmagicifhit	6.08	1
#localglobal	#localglobal	6.07	1
#look	#look	6.08	1
#magiconly	#magiconly	6.23	1
#makecrater	#makecrater	6.25	1
#maxage	#maxage	6.15	1
#maybeaddsite	#maybeaddsite	6.30	1
#maybehiddensite	#maybehiddensite	6.30	1

Patch token	Present resolution	First version	Patch records
#melee50	#melee50	6.07	1
#mindcollar	#mindcollar	6.19	1
#minsizeleader	#minsizeleader	6.04	1
#mobilearcher	#mobilearcher	6.12	1
#morroll	#morroll	6.29	1
#mrhalf	#mrhalf	6.24	1
#name	#name	6.05	1
#napbreakrit	#napbreakrit	6.19	1
#natcom	#natcom	6.03	1
#natmon	#natmon	6.03	1
#newnbor	official patch only	6.36	1
#nightmareaura	#nightmareaura	6.04	1
#nodeepchoice	#nodeepchoice	6.01	1
#norange	#norange	6.08	1
#not	#notmounted, #notdismounted	6.12	1
#notfornation	#notfornation	6.07	1
#notindoors	#notindoors	6.25	1
#notmnr	#notmnr	6.19	1
#notmounted	#notmounted	6.09	1
#onlyfriendlydst	#onlyfriendlydst	6.13	1
#onlymnr	#onlymnr	6.19	1
#onlysitedst	#onlysitedst	6.19	1
#orderrecscale	#orderrecscale	6.11	1
#orderscale	#orderscale	6.08	1
#petrifyifhit	#petrifyifhit	6.08	1
#plaguedoctor	#plaguedoctor	6.09	1
#plaincom	#(terrain)com	6.24	1
#plainfortcom	#(terrain)fortcom	6.24	1
#plainfortrec	#(terrain)fortrec	6.24	1
#plainrec	#(terrain)rec	6.24	1
#poisonifdmg	#poisonifdmg	6.08	1
#popgrowth	#popgrowth	6.11	1
#portent	#portent	6.13	1
#powerofdeath	#powerofdeath	6.08	1
#praise	#praise	6.25	1
#protparts	#protparts	6.21	1
#range0	#range0	6.07	1
#range050	#range050	6.07	1
#reclimit	#reclimit	6.24	1

Patch token	Present resolution	First version	Patch records
#reconst	#reconst	6.04	1
#remgeo	#remgeo	6.08	1
#remnbor	official patch only	6.36	1
#remount	#remount	6.04	2
#removesite	#removesite	6.35	1
#req_crystal	#req_crystal	6.15	1
#req_deep	#req_deep	6.15	1
#req_drip	#req_drip	6.15	1
#req_enchnearby	#req_enchnearby	6.11	1
#req_enchtarget	#req_enchtarget	6.07	2
#req_forestcave	#req_forestcave	6.15	1
#req_fortid	#req_fortid	6.19	1
#req_godawake	#req_godawake	6.12	1
#req_godismnr	#req_godismnr	6.02	1
#req_gorge	#req_gorge	6.15	1
#req_kelp	#req_kelp	6.15	1
#req_maxglobals	#req_maxglobals	6.16	1
#req_minglobals	#req_minglobals	6.16	1
#req_minresearch	#req_minresearch	6.23	1
#req_monsterbs	#req_monsterbs	6.34	1
#req_month	#req_month	6.07	1
#req_norealmnr	#req_norealmnr	6.29	1
#req_notcode	#req_notcode	6.07	1
#req_notpoptype	#req_notpoptype	6.12	1
#req_path	#req_path	6.23	1
#req_pathgems	#req_pathgems	6.23	1
#req_plane	#req_plane	6.12	2
#req_pretawake	#req_pretawake	6.12	1
#req_pretismnr	#req_pretismnr	6.12	1
#req_provnbr	official patch only	6.36	1
#req_realmnr	#req_realmnr	6.29	1
#req_school	#req_school	6.23	1
#req_targgod	#req_targgod	6.12	1
#req_targhorrormark	#req_targhorrormark	6.19	1
#req_targmanygems	#req_targmanygems	6.07	1
#req_targmaxkills	#req_targmaxkills	6.12	1
#req_targminkills	#req_targminkills	6.12	1

Patch token	Present resolution	First version	Patch records
#req_targnorealmnr	#req_targnorealmnr	6.24	1
#req_targrealmnr	#req_targrealmnr	6.24	1
#req_targseductions	#req_targseductions	6.12	1
#req_targsight	#req_targsight	6.07	1
#req_turnrare	#req_turnrare	6.19	1
#req_void	#req_void	6.13	1
#reqnoseduce	#reqnoseduce	6.04	1
#reqnospellsinger	#reqnospellsinger	6.04	1
#reqnotaskmaster	#reqnotaskmaster	6.04	1
#res_mnrbs	#req_mnrbs	6.34	1
#revealsite	#revealsite	6.35	1
#sabbathmaster	#sabbathmaster	6.23	1
#sabbathslave	#sabbathslave	6.23	1
#searec	#(terrain)rec	6.04	1
#selectevent	#selectevent	6.19	1
#shockifhit	#shockifhit	6.08	1
#sizecost	#sizecost	6.30	1
#sleepres	#sleepres	6.23	1
#sorcerygems	#sorcerygems	6.12	1
#speedmult	#speedmult	6.07	1
#spikes	#spikes	6.23	1
#spiritformimmune	#spiritformimmune	6.08	1
#startitem	#startitem	6.02	1
#startresearch	#startresearch	6.04	1
#statbreak	#statbreak	6.19	1
#statstorm	#statstorm	6.19	1
#sumhealaffs	#sumhealaffs	6.21	1
#summon	#summon	6.27	1
#swimming	#swimming	6.13	1
#templegems	#templegems	6.04	1
#templeholypoints	#templeholypoints	6.19	1
#tolerateund	#tolerateund	6.30	1
#twiceborncost	#twiceborncost	6.30	1
#undisleader	#undisleader	6.04	1
#unseen	#unseen	6.29	1
#var0units	#var0units	6.30	1

Patch token	Present resolution	First version	Patch records
`#varxxx`	message placeholder	6.16	1
`#viewallbat`	`#viewallbat`	6.07	1
`#viewallprov`	`#viewallprov`	6.07	1
`#worldshape`	`#worldshape`	6.05	1
`#worldvisible`	`#worldvisible`	6.07	1

Part XI: Source and Publication Register

Official sources

- Illwinter's Dominions 6 documentation page
- Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34
- Dominions 6 Event Modding Manual, version 6.29
- Dominions 6 Map Making Manual, version 6.26
- Official Dominions 6 announcement archive
- Book XIII's hashed 1,090-record official patch ledger

Publication boundary

The public register retains command and token spellings, syntax locators, pages, versions, section labels, hashes, classifications, aliases, and restrained editorial mappings. It does not reproduce the manuals' long descriptions. Readers requiring full official semantics are directed to the cited page.

Dominions Enhanced 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE remain separate rulesets. A token found only in either supplied `.dm` source is not promoted into the vanilla official lexicon. Mod-source usage analysis can reference this register later, but the command's official status and the mod's implementation evidence must remain distinct.

What this unlocks

The library now has five complementary retrieval layers:

- Book X explains how to operate the game;
- Book XI explains how to read units, abilities, experience, and conditions;
- Book XII indexes base-game objects;
- Book XIII explains when official rules and features changed;
- Book XIV identifies the official modding language used to alter those objects and systems.

This closes the principal shared-foundation gap before broad nation dossiers. Future mod analyses can identify every source token, resolve it to official context, detect documentation gaps, and link implementation choices to parser, object, event, map, AI, compatibility, and patch-history chapters without rebuilding the same glossary inside every faction or mod report.